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Crimes Act 1958

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Authorised Version No. 321

Crimes Act 1958

No. 6231 of 1958

Authorised Version incorporating amendments as at
26 April 2026

An Act to consolidate the Law Relating to Crimes and Criminal
Offenders.

**BE IT ENACTED by the Queen's Most Excellent Majesty by
and with the advice and consent of the Legislative Council
and the Legislative Assembly of Victoria in this present
Parliament assembled and by the authority of the same as
follows (that is to say):**

1 Short title and commencement

This Act may be cited as the **Crimes Act 1958**
and shall come into operation on a day to be fixed
by proclamation of the Governor in Council
published in the Government Gazette.

S. 1
amended by
Nos 6731
s. 2(1), 6958
s. 8(4)(a), 7088
s. 2(g), 7703
s. 5, 7884
s. 2(1), 8280
s. 2, 8338 ss 2,
7(a), 8425
s. 2(1), 8493
s. 33(a)(i)(ii),
8679 s. 3(1)
(a)(i)(ii), 8870
s. 6(3), 9019
s. 2(1)(Sch.
item 34), 9073
s. 2(c), 9155
s. 4(c), 9228
s. 2(1)(a)(b),
9407 s. 2(c)
(i)(ii), 9509
s. 3(1)(2), 9549
s. 2(1)(Sch.
item 50), 9576
s. 11(1), 10026
s. 2(a)(b),
10079 s. 7(1)
(a)(b), 10084
s. 15(a)(i)(ii),
25/1989 s. 4.

2 Repeals and savings

- (1) The Acts mentioned in the First Schedule to the extent thereby expressed to be repealed are hereby repealed accordingly.
- (2) Except as in this Act expressly or by necessary implication provided—
 - (a) all persons things and circumstances appointed or created by or under any of the repealed Acts or existing or continuing under any of such Acts immediately before the commencement of this Act shall under and subject to this Act continue to have the same status operation and effect as they respectively would have had if such Acts had not been so repealed;
 - (b) in particular and without affecting the generality of the foregoing paragraph, such repeal shall not disturb the continuity of status operation or effect of any proclamation regulation rule order application determination decision validation offence disqualification warrant instrument presentment direction appointment action prosecution proceeding liability or right made effected issued granted committed given presented passed fixed accrued incurred or acquired or existing or continuing by or under any of such Acts before the commencement of this Act.

S. 2(3)
repealed by
No. 8493
s. 33(b).

* * * *

2A Definitions

- (1) In this Act unless inconsistent with the context or subject-matter—

aircraft means every type of machine or structure used or intended to be used for navigation of the air;

* * * * *

* * * * *

drug of addiction means a drug of dependence within the meaning of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981**;

incite includes, except in section 195N, command, request, propose, advise, encourage or authorize;

Juries Commissioner has the same meaning as in the **Juries Act 2000**;

S. 2A
inserted by
No. 7088
s. 2(a),
amended by
No. 9509
s. 4(a).

S. 2A(1) def. of
*baseline
sentence*
inserted by
No. 52/2014
s. 11,
repealed by
No. 34/2017
s. 12.

S. 2A(1) def. of
brothel
inserted by
No. 9509
s. 4(b),
repealed by
No. 124/1986
s. 74(a).

S. 2A(1) def. of
*drug of
addiction*
inserted by
No. 9509
s. 4(b),
substituted by
No. 9719
s. 135.

S. 2A(1) def. of
incite
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 8(a),
amended by
No. 11/2025
s. 3.

S. 2A(1) def. of
*Juries
Commis-
sioner*
inserted by
No. 53/2000
s. 94(1).

S. 2A(1) def. of
*legal
practitioner*
inserted by
No. 18/2005
s. 18(Sch. 1
item 27.1),
amended by
No. 17/2014
s. 160(Sch. 2
item 28).

legal practitioner means an Australian lawyer;

S. 2A(1) def. of
*medicinal
cannabis
product*
inserted by
No. 20/2016
s. 143,
repealed by
No. 34/2019
s. 45.

* * * *

S. 2A(1) def. of
*member of
Victoria Police
personnel*
inserted by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.1(a)).

member of Victoria Police personnel has the
same meaning as in the **Victoria Police
Act 2013**;

S. 2A(1) def. of
motor car
inserted by
No. 8338 s. 3,
repealed by
No. 127/1986
s. 102(Sch. 4
item 5.1).

* * * *

S. 2A(1) def. of
motor vehicle
inserted by
No. 127/1986
s. 102(Sch. 4
item 5.1).

motor vehicle has the same meaning as in the
Road Safety Act 1986;

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958

*	*	*	*	*	S. 2A(1) def. of <i>patient medicinal cannabis access authorisation</i> inserted by No. 20/2016 s. 143, repealed by No. 34/2019 s. 45.
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<i>police officer</i> has the same meaning as in the Victoria Police Act 2013;	S. 2A(1) def. of <i>police officer</i> inserted by No. 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.1(a)).
--	---

*	*	*	*	*	S. 2A(1) def. of <i>prostitute, prostitution</i> inserted by No. 9509 s. 4(c), repealed by No. 124/1986 s. 74(a).
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<i>protective services officer</i> has the same meaning as in the Victoria Police Act 2013;	S. 2A(1) def. of <i>protective services officer</i> inserted by No. 43/2011 s. 14, substituted by No. 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.1(b)).
---	---

*	*	*	*	*	S. 2A(1) def. of <i>rape</i> inserted by No. 9509 s. 4(c), repealed by No. 8/1991 s. 6(a).
---	---	---	---	---	---

S. 2A(1) def. of
*standard
sentence*
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 24.

standard sentence, in relation to an offence,
has the same meaning as in the **Sentencing
Act 1991**.

S. 2A(1) def. of
Taxing Master
inserted by
No. 24/2008
s. 77,
repealed by
No. 78/2008
s. 25(1).

* * * *

S. 2A(2)(3)
inserted by
No. 9509
s. 4(d),
repealed by
No. 8/1991
s. 6(b).

* * * *

S. 2B
inserted by
No. 51/1989
s. 143(a).

2B Offences under this Act deemed to be indictable offences

Offences under this Act are, unless the contrary
intention appears, deemed to be indictable
offences.

Part I—Offences

Division 1—Offences against the person

(1) *Homicide*

3 Punishment for murder

(1) Notwithstanding any rule of law to the contrary, a person convicted of murder is liable to—

(a) level 1 imprisonment (life); or

(b) imprisonment for such other term as is fixed by the court—

as the court determines.

* * * *

S. 3 substituted by Nos 8679 s. 2, 37/1986 s. 8, amended by Nos 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 1(a)), 52/2014 s. 12 (ILA s. 39B(1)).

S. 3(1)(a) substituted by No. 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 1(b)), amended by No. 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 1).

S. 3(1)(b) amended by No. 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 1(c)).

Note to s. 3(1) inserted by No. 65/2016 s. 20(1), repealed by No. 34/2017 s. 25(1).

S. 3(2)
inserted by
No. 52/2014
s. 12,
substituted by
No. 69/2014
s. 11,
repealed by
No. 34/2017
s. 13(1),
new s. 3(2)
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 25(2).

- (2) The standard sentence for murder is—
- (a) 30 years if the court, in determining sentence, is satisfied that the prosecution has proved beyond reasonable doubt that—
 - (i) the person murdered was a custodial officer on duty or an emergency worker on duty; and
 - (ii) at the time of carrying out the conduct the accused knew or was reckless as to whether that person was a custodial officer or an emergency worker; and
 - (b) in any other case, 25 years.

Notes

- 1 See sections 5A and 5B of the **Sentencing Act 1991** as to standard sentences.
- 2 Murder is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2G) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence.

S. 3(3)
inserted by
No. 69/2014
s. 11,
repealed by
No. 34/2017
s. 13(1),
new s. 3(3)
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 25(2).

- (3) In subsection (2)(a) *custodial officer on duty*, *custodial officer*, *emergency worker on duty* and *emergency worker* have the same meanings as in section 10AA of the **Sentencing Act 1991**.

Note to s. 3
inserted by
No. 69/2014
s. 11,
repealed by
No. 34/2017
s. 13(2).

* * * * *

3A Unintentional killing in the course or furtherance of a crime of violence

S. 3A
inserted by
No. 9576
s. 3(1).

- (1) A person who unintentionally causes the death of another person by an act of violence done in the course or furtherance of a crime the necessary elements of which include violence for which a person upon first conviction may, under or by virtue of any enactment, be sentenced to level 1 imprisonment (life) or to imprisonment for a term of 10 years or more shall be liable to be convicted of murder as though he had killed that person intentionally.
- (2) The rule of law known as the felony-murder rule (whereby a person who unintentionally causes the death of another by an act of violence done in the course or furtherance of a felony of violence is liable to be convicted of murder as though he had killed that person intentionally) is hereby abrogated.

S. 3A(1)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 2),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 2(a)(b)).

3B Provocation no longer a partial defence to murder

S. 3B
inserted by
No. 77/2005
s. 3.

The rule of law that provocation reduces the crime of murder to manslaughter is abolished.

* * * * *

S. 4
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1),
repealed by
No. 10079
s. 8(b),
new s. 4
inserted by
No. 77/2005
s. 4,
repealed by
No. 63/2014
s. 3(1).

S. 4A
inserted by
No. 72/2014
s. 3.

4A Manslaughter—single punch or strike taken to be dangerous act

- (1) This section applies to a single punch or strike that—
 - (a) is delivered to any part of a person's head or neck; and
 - (b) by itself causes an injury to the head or neck.
- (2) A single punch or strike is to be taken to be a dangerous act for the purposes of the law relating to manslaughter by an unlawful and dangerous act.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (2), it is irrelevant that the single punch or strike is one of a series of punches or strikes.
- (4) A single punch or strike may be the cause of a person's death even if the injury from which the person dies is not the injury that the punch or strike itself caused to the person's head or neck but another injury resulting from an impact to the person's head or neck, or to another part of the person's body, caused by the punch or strike.

Example

If a person punches another person to the head, and that other person falls, hits their head on the road, and dies from the injury resulting from their head hitting the road, the punch may be the cause of their death.

- (5) Nothing in this section limits the circumstances in which a punch or strike may be an unlawful and dangerous act for the purposes of the law relating to manslaughter by an unlawful and dangerous act.

(6) In this section—

injury has the same meaning as in
Subdivision (4);

strike means a strike delivered with any part of the
body.

Notes

- 1 Under section 11 of the **Jury Directions Act 2015**, after the close of all evidence and before the closing address of the prosecution, defence counsel must inform the trial judge whether each element of the offence is or is not in issue, including—
 - whether the punch or strike was a dangerous act; and
 - whether the punch or strike caused the person's death.
- 2 Under section 12 of the **Jury Directions Act 2015**, the prosecution and defence counsel must each request that the trial judge give, or not give, to the jury particular directions in respect of the matters in issue, which may include—
 - whether the punch or strike was a dangerous act; and
 - whether the punch or strike caused the person's death.

Notes to s. 4A
amended by
No. 14/2015
s. 69(7)(8).

5 Punishment of manslaughter

Whosoever is convicted of manslaughter shall
be liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years
maximum).

No. 6103 s. 5.
S. 5
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 3),
48/1997 s.
60(1)(Sch. 1
item 3),
65/2016
s. 20(2),
16/2020 s. 3.

Notes

- 1 Manslaughter is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See subsection (2H) of section 5 of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.

Notes to s. 5
inserted by
No. 72/2014
s. 4,
amended by
No. 65/2016
s. 20(3)(4).

- 2 Sections 9B and 9C of the **Sentencing Act 1991** require that, in certain circumstances, a term of imprisonment be imposed for manslaughter and a non-parole period of not less than 10 years be fixed under section 11 of that Act unless the court finds under section 10A of that Act that a special reason exists.

Note 3 to s. 5
repealed by
No. 23/2020
s. 9.

* * * * *

- 4 Sections 9B and 9C of the **Sentencing Act 1991** do not apply unless the DPP serves and files a notice under section 9A of that Act.

S. 5A
inserted by
No. 7/2008
s. 3,
amended by
No. 16/2020
s. 4.

5A Child homicide

A person who, by his or her conduct, kills a child who is under the age of 6 years in circumstances that constitute manslaughter is guilty of child homicide and liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).

Note to s. 5A
inserted by
No. 65/2016
s. 20(5).

Note

Child homicide is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See subsection (2H) of section 5 of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.

S. 5B
inserted by
No. 16/2020
s. 5.

5B Homicide by firearm

- (1) A person who, by discharging a firearm, causes the death of another person in circumstances that constitute manslaughter is guilty of homicide by firearm and liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).
- (2) The standard sentence for homicide by firearm is 13 years.
- (3) In this section—

discharge has the same meaning as in section 31C(4);

firearm has the same meaning as in the **Firearms Act 1996**.

Notes

- 1 See sections 5A and 5B of the **Sentencing Act 1991** as to standard sentences.
- 2 Homicide by firearm is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2H) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that section exist.

5C Relationship between manslaughter, child homicide and homicide by firearm

S. 5C
inserted by
No. 16/2020
s. 5.

Nothing in section 5A or 5B is to be taken to provide that conduct that constitutes any one of the following offences is, because it constitutes that offence, incapable of constituting another of those offences—

- (a) manslaughter;
- (b) child homicide;
- (c) homicide by firearm.

6 Infanticide

- (1) If a woman carries out conduct that causes the death of her child in circumstances that would constitute murder and, at the time of carrying out the conduct, the balance of her mind was disturbed because of—
 - (a) her not having fully recovered from the effect of giving birth to that child within the preceding 2 years; or

No. 6103 s. 6.
S. 6
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 4),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 4),
substituted by
No. 77/2005
s. 5.

(b) a disorder consequent on her giving birth to that child within the preceding 2 years—

she is guilty of infanticide, and not of murder, and liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 6(2)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.1).

- (2) On an indictment for murder, a woman found not guilty of murder may be found guilty of infanticide.

Note

See sections 10(3) and 421 for other alternative verdicts.

- (3) Nothing in this Act affects the power of the jury on a charge of murder of a child to return a verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment.

S. 6A
inserted by
No. 7546 s. 2.

6A Suicide no longer a crime

The rule of law whereby it is a crime for a person to commit or to attempt to commit suicide is hereby abrogated.

S. 6B
inserted by
No. 7546 s. 2.

6B Survivor of suicide pact who kills deceased party is guilty of manslaughter

- (1) Where upon the trial of a person for the murder of another person the jury are satisfied that the accused caused or was a party to causing the death of that other person by a wilful act or omission but are satisfied on the balance of probabilities that the act was done or the omission made in pursuance of a suicide pact then the jury shall, notwithstanding that the circumstances were such that but for the provisions of this section they might have returned a verdict of murder, return a verdict of manslaughter in lieu thereof.

(1A) Despite section 5, a person convicted of manslaughter under subsection (1) is only liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 6B(1A)
inserted by
No. 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 5(a)),
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 5).

(2) Any person who—

S. 6B(2)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 5(b)),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 6(a)(b)).

(a) incites any other person to commit suicide and that other person commits or attempts to commit suicide in consequence thereof; or

S. 6B(2)(a)
amended by
No. 10079
s. 8(c).

(b) aids or abets any other person in the commission of suicide or in an attempt to commit suicide—

shall be guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum); but if the jury are satisfied on the balance of probabilities that the acts constituting the offence were done pursuant to a suicide pact the jury shall return a verdict of guilty of the indictable offence of being a party to a suicide pact and the convicted person shall be liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

(3) The fact that by virtue of this section any person who in pursuance of a suicide pact has killed another person has not been or is not liable to be convicted of murder shall not affect the question of whether the homicide amounted to murder in

the case of a third person who is a party to the homicide and is not a party to the suicide pact.

- (4) For the purposes of this section *suicide pact* means an agreement between two or more persons having for its object the death of all of them whether or not each is to take his own life; but nothing done by a person who enters into a suicide pact shall be treated as done by him in pursuance of the pact unless it is done while he has the settled intention of dying in pursuance of the pact.

S. 7
repealed by
No. 9576
s. 11(1).

* * * * *

No. 6103 s. 8.

8 Petit treason

Every offence which before the twenty-seventh day of June in the year of our Lord One thousand eight hundred and twenty-eight would have amounted to petit treason shall be deemed to be murder only; and all persons guilty in respect thereof whether as principals or as accessories shall be dealt with indicted tried and punished as principals and accessories in murder.

No. 6103 s. 9.
S. 9
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
77/2005
s. 8(3)(a)(i)(ii),
7/2008
s. 7(3)(a),
63/2014
s. 3(2),
16/2020 s. 6.

9 Provision for trial for murder or manslaughter in Victoria where death or cause of death only happens in Victoria

Where any person being criminally stricken poisoned or otherwise hurt upon the sea or at any place out of Victoria dies of such stroke poisoning or hurt in Victoria, or being criminally stricken poisoned or otherwise hurt at any place in Victoria dies of such stroke poisoning or hurt upon the sea or at any place out of Victoria, every offence committed in respect of any such case, whether the same amounts to the offence of murder or of manslaughter or of child homicide or of homicide by firearm or of being accessory to

murder or manslaughter or child homicide or homicide by firearm, may be dealt with inquired of tried determined and punished in Victoria in the same manner in all respects as if such offence had been wholly committed in Victoria.

9AA Abolition of year-and-a-day rule

S. 9AA
inserted by
No. 65/1991
s. 3.

- (1) The rule of law known as the year-and-a-day rule (under which an act or omission that in fact causes death is not regarded as the cause of death if the death occurs more than a year and a day after the act or omission) is abolished.
- (2) This section does not apply to acts or omissions alleged to have occurred—
 - (a) before the commencement of the **Crimes (Year and a Day Rule) Act 1991**; or
 - (b) between two dates, one before and one after that commencement.

* * * * *

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (1AA)
(Heading and
ss 9AB–9AJ)
inserted by
No. 77/2005
s. 6,
repealed by
No. 63/2014
s. 3(3).

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (1A)
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 9407
s. 2(a).
(1351–2) 25
Edward III
St V., c. II
(1695–6) 7 and
8 William III
c. III (1708)
7 Anne c. 21
s. 14. (1795)
36 George III
c. VII (1817)
57 George III
c. VI ss 1, 4
and 5.

(1A) *Treasonable offences*

S. 9A
inserted by
No. 9407
s. 2(a).

9A Treason

S. 9A(1)
amended by
Nos 37/1986
s. 9, 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 6(a)(i)).

(1) A person who—

- (a) kills the Sovereign, does the Sovereign any bodily harm tending to the death or destruction of the Sovereign or maims, wounds, imprisons or restrains the Sovereign;
- (b) kills the eldest child and heir apparent, or the Consort, of the Sovereign;
- (c) levies war, or does any act preparatory to levying war, against the Commonwealth of Australia;
- (d) assists by any means whatever, with intent to assist, an enemy at war with the Commonwealth of Australia, whether or not the existence of a state of war has been declared;

S. 9A(1)(b)
amended by
No. 60/2013
s. 6(Sch. 2
item 1).

- (e) instigates a foreigner to make an armed invasion of the Commonwealth or any Territory not forming part of the Commonwealth; or
- (f) forms an intention to do any act referred to in a preceding paragraph of this subsection and manifests that intention by an overt act—

shall be guilty of an indictable offence, called treason, and liable to—

- (g) level 1 imprisonment (life); or

S. 9A(1)(a) inserted by No. 37/1986 s. 9, amended by No. 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 6(a)(ii)), substituted as s. 9A(1)(g) by No. 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 7).

- (h) imprisonment for such other term as is fixed by the court—

S. 9A(1)(b) inserted by No. 37/1986 s. 9, amended by No. 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 6(a)(iii)), re-numbered as s. 9A(1)(h) by No. 48/1997 s. 62(1).

as the court determines.

- (2) A person who—

- (a) receives or assists another person who is to his knowledge guilty of treason in order to enable him to escape punishment; or

S. 9A(2) amended by Nos 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 6(b)), 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 8).

(b) knowing that a person intends to commit treason, does not give information thereof with all reasonable despatch to a constable or use other reasonable endeavours to prevent the commission of the offence—

shall be guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum).

(3) On the trial of a person charged with treason on the ground that he formed an intention to do an act referred to in paragraph (a), (b), (c), (d) or (e) of subsection (1) of this section and manifested that intention by an overt act, evidence of the overt act shall not be admitted unless the overt act was alleged in the indictment.

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (2)
(Heading and
s. 10)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 7),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 9), 7/2008
s. 7(3)(b),
repealed by
No. 58/2008
s. 9.

* * * *

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (3)
repealed.¹

* * * *

(4) Offences against the person

No. 6103 s. 15.
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (4)
(Heading and
s. 15)
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1),
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (4)
(Heading and
ss 15–31) by
No. 10233
s. 8(2).

15 Definitions

S. 15
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2).

In this subdivision—

abortion has the meaning given in the **Abortion
Law Reform Act 2008**;

S. 15 def. of
abortion
inserted by
No. 58/2008
s. 10(1).

child means any person under the age of 18 years;

S. 15 def. of
child
inserted by
No. 46/1996
s. 3.

female genital mutilation means all or any of the
following—

S. 15 def. of
*female genital
mutilation*
inserted by
No. 46/1996
s. 3.

- (a) infibulation;
- (b) the excision or mutilation of the whole
or a part of the clitoris;
- (c) the excision or mutilation of the whole
or a part of the labia minora or labia
majora;
- (d) any procedure to narrow or close the
vaginal opening;

- (e) the sealing or suturing together of the labia minora or labia majora;
- (f) the removal of the clitoral hood;

S. 15 def. of
firearm
inserted by
No. 6/2013
s. 3(c).

firearm has the same meaning as in the **Firearms Act 1996**;

S. 15 def. of
*harm to
mental health*
inserted by
No. 6/2013
s. 3(c).

harm to mental health includes psychological harm but does not include an emotional reaction such as distress, grief, fear or anger unless it results in psychological harm;

S. 15 def. of
*imitation
firearm*
inserted by
No. 6/2013
s. 3(c).

imitation firearm has the same meaning as in section 77(1A);

S. 15 def. of
injury
substituted by
No. 6/2013
s. 3(a).

injury means—

- (a) physical injury; or
- (b) harm to mental health—

whether temporary or permanent;

S. 15 def. of
*medical
practitioner*
inserted by
No. 46/1996
s. 3.

medical practitioner means—

- (a) a registered medical practitioner; or
- (b) in relation to the performance of female genital mutilation outside Victoria, a person who, in the place in which the female genital mutilation took place, holds an authority to practise medicine which is similar to that of a registered medical practitioner;

medical procedure, in relation to paragraph (b) of the definition of ***serious injury***, means—

S. 15 def. of *medical procedure* inserted by No. 58/2008 s. 10(1).

- (a) an abortion performed by a registered medical practitioner in accordance with the **Abortion Law Reform Act 2008**; or
- (b) the administration or supply of a drug or drugs by a registered pharmacist or registered nurse in accordance with the **Abortion Law Reform Act 2008** to cause an abortion;

midwife means—

S. 15 def. of *midwife* inserted by No. 46/1996 s. 3.

- (a) a registered midwife; or
- (b) in relation to the performance of female genital mutilation outside Victoria, a person who, in the place in which the female genital mutilation took place, holds an authority to practise midwifery which is similar to that of registered midwife;

offensive weapon has the same meaning as in section 77(1A);

S. 15 def. of *offensive weapon* inserted by No. 6/2013 s. 3(c).

physical injury includes unconsciousness, disfigurement, substantial pain, infection with a disease and an impairment of bodily function;

S. 15 def. of *physical injury* inserted by No. 6/2013 s. 3(c).

prohibited female genital mutilation means female genital mutilation the performance of which would be an offence under this Act if carried out in the State;

S. 15 def. of *prohibited female genital mutilation* inserted by No. 46/1996 s. 3.

S. 15 def. of
*registered
medical
practitioner*
inserted by
No. 46/1996
s. 3,
substituted by
Nos 97/2005
s. 182(Sch. 4
item 14.1(a)),
13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.1).

registered medical practitioner means a person registered under the Health Practitioner Regulation National Law to practise in the medical profession (other than as a student);

S. 15 def. of
*registered
midwife*
inserted by
No. 46/1996
s. 3,
amended by
No. 97/2005
s. 182(Sch. 4
item 14.1(b)),
substituted by
No. 13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.1).

registered midwife means a person registered under the Health Practitioner Regulation National Law—

- (a) to practise in the nursing and midwifery profession as a midwife (other than as a student); and
- (b) in the register of midwives kept for that profession;

S. 15 def. of
*registered
nurse*
inserted by
No. 58/2008
s. 10(1),
substituted by
No. 13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.1).

registered nurse means a person registered under the Health Practitioner Regulation National Law to practise in the nursing and midwifery profession as a nurse (other than as a student);

S. 15 def. of
*registered
pharmacist*
inserted by
No. 58/2008
s. 10(1),
substituted by
No. 13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.1).

registered pharmacist means a person registered under the Health Practitioner Regulation National Law to practise in the pharmacy profession (other than as a student);

serious injury means—

- (a) an injury (including the cumulative effect of more than one injury) that—
 - (i) endangers life; or
 - (ii) is substantial and protracted; or
- (b) the destruction, other than in the course of a medical procedure, of the foetus of a pregnant woman, whether or not the woman suffers any other harm;

S. 15 def. of *serious injury* substituted by Nos 58/2008 s. 10(2), 6/2013 s. 3(b).

woman means a female person of any age.

S. 15 def. of *woman* inserted by No. 58/2008 s. 10(1).

15A Causing serious injury intentionally in circumstances of gross violence

S. 15A inserted by No. 6/2013 s. 4.

- (1) A person must not, without lawful excuse, intentionally cause serious injury to another person in circumstances of gross violence.

S. 15A(1) amended by No. 54/2025 s. 3.

Penalty: Level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).

* * * * *

Note to s. 15A(1) inserted by No. 65/2016 s. 20(6), repealed by No. 23/2020 s. 10(1).

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), any one of the following constitutes circumstances of gross violence—

- (a) the offender planned in advance to engage in conduct and at the time of planning—
 - (i) the offender intended that the conduct would cause a serious injury; or

S. 15A(2)(c)
substituted by
No. 63/2014
s. 7(3).

- (ii) the offender was reckless as to whether the conduct would cause a serious injury; or
- (iii) a reasonable person would have foreseen that the conduct would be likely to result in a serious injury;
- (b) the offender in company with 2 or more other persons caused the serious injury;
- (c) the offender entered into an agreement, arrangement or understanding with 2 or more other persons to cause a serious injury;

Note

See Subdivision (1) (Complicity in commission of offences) of Division 1 of Part II.

- (d) the offender planned in advance to have with him or her and to use an offensive weapon, firearm or imitation firearm and in fact used the offensive weapon, firearm or imitation firearm to cause the serious injury;
- (e) the offender continued to cause injury to the other person after the other person was incapacitated;
- (f) the offender caused the serious injury to the other person while the other person was incapacitated.

Notes to
s. 15A
amended by
Nos 69/2014
s. 8(1)(2),
28/2016
s. 6(1),
65/2016
s. 20(7),
substituted by
No. 23/2020
s. 10(2).

Notes

- 1 See section 422(1) for an alternative verdict.
- 2 An offence against subsection (1) is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2G) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence.
- 3 See section 10 of the **Sentencing Act 1991** for the requirement that a term of imprisonment be imposed for an offence against section 15A(1) and that a non-parole period of not less than 4 years be fixed under section 11 of that Act

unless the court finds under section 10A of that Act that a special reason exists.

- 4 If a victim was an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty, see section 10AA(1) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** for the requirement that a non-parole period of not less than 5 years be fixed unless the court finds under section 10A of that Act that a special reason exists.

15B Causing serious injury recklessly in circumstances of gross violence

S. 15B
inserted by
No. 6/2013
s. 4.

- (1) A person must not, without lawful excuse, recklessly cause serious injury to another person in circumstances of gross violence.

S. 15B(1)
amended by
No. 54/2025
s. 4.

Penalty: Level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum).

* * * * *

Note to
s. 15B(1)
inserted by
No. 65/2016
s. 20(8),
repealed by
No. 23/2020
s. 11(1).

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), any one of the following constitutes circumstances of gross violence—

- (a) the offender planned in advance to engage in conduct and at the time of planning—

- (i) the offender intended that the conduct would cause a serious injury; or
(ii) the offender was reckless as to whether the conduct would cause a serious injury; or
(iii) a reasonable person would have foreseen that the conduct would be likely to result in a serious injury;

S. 15B(2)(c)
substituted by
No. 63/2014
s. 7(4).

- (b) the offender in company with 2 or more other persons caused the serious injury;
- (c) the offender entered into an agreement, arrangement or understanding with 2 or more other persons to cause a serious injury;

Note

See Subdivision (1) (Complicity in commission of offences) of Division 1 of Part II.

- (d) the offender planned in advance to have with him or her and to use an offensive weapon, firearm or imitation firearm and in fact used the offensive weapon, firearm or imitation firearm to cause the serious injury;
- (e) the offender continued to cause injury to the other person after the other person was incapacitated;
- (f) the offender caused the serious injury to the other person while the other person was incapacitated.

Notes to
s. 15B
amended by
Nos 69/2014
s. 8(1)(2),
28/2016
s. 6(1),
65/2016
ss 20(9), 25,
substituted by
No. 23/2020
s. 11(2).

Notes

- 1 See section 422(2) for an alternative verdict.
- 2 An offence against subsection (1) is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2G) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence.
- 3 See section 10 of the **Sentencing Act 1991** for the requirement that a term of imprisonment be imposed for an offence against section 15B(1) and that a non-parole period of not less than 4 years be fixed under section 11 of that Act unless the court finds under section 10A of that Act that a special reason exists.
- 4 If a victim was an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty, see section 10AA(1) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** for the requirement that a non-parole period of not less than 5 years be fixed unless the court finds under section 10A of that Act that a special reason exists.

15C Other offenders need not be prosecuted

A person may be found guilty of an offence against section 15A or 15B whether or not any other person is prosecuted for or found guilty of the offence.

S. 15C
inserted by
No. 6/2013
s. 4.

16 Causing serious injury intentionally

A person who, without lawful excuse, intentionally causes serious injury to another person is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum).

S. 16
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 8),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 10).

Notes

- 1 An offence against this section is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991** if the victim was an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty and the offender knew or was reckless as to whether the victim was such a person. See section 5(2G) and (2GA) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order or other specified order for this offence if committed in those circumstances.
- 2 An offence against section 16 (other than a category 1 offence referred to in note 1) is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2H) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.
- 3 See section 10AA(1) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** for the requirement that a term of imprisonment be imposed for an offence against section 16 and that a non-parole period of not less than 3 years be fixed under section 11 of that Act if the victim was an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty unless the court finds under section 10A of that Act that a special reason exists.
- 4 See section 10AA(2) and (3) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** that allow a youth justice centre order for a term of not less than 3 years to be made in certain circumstances in respect of a young offender for an offence against section 16 if the victim

Notes to s. 16
inserted by
No. 69/2014
s. 8(3),
amended by
Nos 28/2016
s. 6(2),
65/2016
s. 20(10)(11),
48/2018 s. 85,
substituted by
No. 23/2020
s. 12.

was an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty.

S. 17
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 9),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 11).

17 Causing serious injury recklessly

A person who, without lawful excuse, recklessly causes serious injury to another person is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

Notes to s. 17
inserted by
No. 69/2014
s. 8(4),
amended by
Nos 28/2016
s. 6(3),
48/2018 s. 86,
substituted by
No. 23/2020
s. 13.

Notes

- 1 An offence against this section is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991** if the victim was an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty and the offender knew or was reckless as to whether the victim was such a person. See section 5(2G) and (2GA) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order or other specified order for this offence if committed in those circumstances.
- 2 See section 10AA(1) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** for the requirement that a term of imprisonment be imposed for an offence against section 17 and that a non-parole period of not less than 2 years be fixed under section 11 of that Act if the victim was an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty unless the court finds under section 10A of that Act that a special reason exists.
- 3 See section 10AA(2) and (3) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** that allow a youth justice centre order for a term of not less than 2 years to be made in certain circumstances in respect of a young offender for an offence against section 17 if the victim was an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty.

18 Causing injury intentionally or recklessly

A person who, without lawful excuse, intentionally or recklessly causes injury to another person is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: If the injury was caused intentionally—
level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum);

If the injury was caused recklessly—
level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 18
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 11),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 12).

Notes

- 1 An offence against this section is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991** if the victim was an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty and the offender knew or was reckless as to whether the victim was such a person. See section 5(2G) and (2GA) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order or other specified order for this offence if committed in those circumstances.
- 2 See section 10AA(4) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** for the requirement that a term of imprisonment of not less than 6 months be imposed for an offence against section 18 if the victim was an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty unless the court finds under section 10A of that Act that a special reason exists.
- 3 See section 10AA(2) and (3) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** that allow a youth justice centre order for a term of not less than 6 months to be made in certain circumstances in respect of a young offender for an offence against section 18 if the victim was an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty.

Notes to s. 18
inserted by
No. 69/2014
s. 8(5),
amended by
Nos 28/2016
s. 6(4),
48/2018 s. 87,
substituted by
No. 23/2020
s. 14.

S. 19
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2).

19 Offence to administer certain substances

S. 19(1)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 12),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 16).

- (1) A person who—
- (a) without lawful excuse, administers to or causes to be taken by another person any substance which is capable, and which the first-mentioned person knows is capable, in the circumstances, of interfering substantially with the bodily functions of the other person; and
 - (b) knows that the other person has not consented to the administration or taking of the substance or is reckless as to whether or not the other person has so consented—

is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)—
- (a) a person is not to be taken to have consented to the administration or taking of a substance if, had the person known the likely consequences, the person would not be likely to have consented to the administration or taking; and
 - (b) a substance shall be taken to interfere substantially with bodily functions if the substance is capable of inducing unconsciousness or sleep.

* * * * *

S. 19A
inserted by
No. 19/1993
s. 3,
amended by
Nos 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 13),
46/2008 s. 272,
repealed by
No. 17/2015
s. 3.

20 Threats to kill

A person who, without lawful excuse, makes to another person a threat to kill that other person or any other person—

- (a) intending that that other person would fear the threat would be carried out; or
- (b) being reckless as to whether or not that other person would fear the threat would be carried out—

is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 20
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 12),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 14).

21 Threats to inflict serious injury

A person who, without lawful excuse, makes to another person a threat to inflict serious injury on that other person or any other person—

- (a) intending that that other person would fear the threat would be carried out; or

S. 21
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 13),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 16).

- (b) being reckless as to whether or not that other person would fear the threat would be carried out—

is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 21A
inserted by
No. 95/1994
s. 3.

21A Stalking

S. 21A(1)
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 14),
substituted by
No. 1/2026
s. 67(1).

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A engages in a course of conduct in relation to another person (B); and
 - (b) the course of conduct includes any conduct specified in subsection (2); and
 - (c) either—
 - (i) A intends that the course of conduct will cause a result described in subsection (3) or believes that the course of conduct will probably cause such a result; or
 - (ii) A ought to understand, in all the particular circumstances, that the course of conduct will probably cause a result described in subsection (3) and the course of conduct does cause such a result.

S. 21A(1A)
inserted by
No. 1/2026
s. 67(1).

- (1A) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- | | |
|--|--|
| (1B) For the purposes of subsection (1)(a), A engages in a course of conduct in relation to B if— | S. 21A(1B) inserted by No. 1/2026 s. 67(1). |
| (a) either— | |
| (i) A engages in conduct on more than one occasion; or | |
| (ii) A engages in conduct that is protracted; and | |
| (b) the conduct shows a continuity of purpose in relation to B. | |
| (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)(b), the following are specified— | S. 21A(2) amended by Nos 105/2003 s. 4(1), 20/2011 s. 3(3), 1/2026 s. 67(2)(a)(g). |
| (a) following B or any other person; | S. 21A(2)(a) amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(2)(b). |
| (b) contacting B or any other person by post, telephone, fax, text message, e-mail or other electronic communication or by any other means whatsoever; | S. 21A(2)(b) substituted by No. 105/2003 s. 3(1), amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(2)(b). |
| (ba) publishing on the Internet or by an e-mail or other electronic communication to any person a statement or other material— | S. 21A(2)(ba) inserted by No. 105/2003 s. 3(1). |
| (i) relating to B or any other person; or | S. 21A(2)(ba)(i) amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(2)(b). |
| (ii) purporting to relate to, or to originate from, B or any other person; | S. 21A(2)(ba)(ii) amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(2)(b). |

S. 21A(2)(bb)
inserted by
No. 105/2003
s. 3(1),
amended by
No. 1/2026
s. 67(2)(b).

(bb) causing an unauthorised computer function
(within the meaning of Subdivision (6) of
Division 3) in a computer owned or used by
B or any other person;

S. 21A(2)(bc)
inserted by
No. 105/2003
s. 3(1),
amended by
No. 1/2026
s. 67(2)(c).

(bc) tracing B's or any other person's use of the
Internet or of e-mail or other electronic
communications;

S. 21A(2)(c)
amended by
No. 1/2026
s. 67(2)(b)(c).

(c) entering or loitering outside or near B's or
any other person's place of residence or of
business or any other place frequented by B
or the other person;

S. 21A(2)(d)
amended by
No. 1/2026
s. 67(2)(c)(d).

(d) interfering with property in B's or any other
person's possession (whether or not A has an
interest in the property);

S. 21A(2)(da)
inserted by
No. 20/2011
s. 3(1),
amended by
No. 1/2026
s. 67(2)(b).

(da) making threats to B;

S. 21A(2)(dab)
inserted by
No. 1/2026
s. 67(2)(e).

(dab) causing or threatening to cause harm to any
animal—
(i) while in the presence of B or any other
person; or
(ii) in circumstances where the harm or the
threat of harm will be discovered by or
brought to the attention of B or any
other person;

- | | |
|---|---|
| (db) using abusive or offensive words to or in the presence of B; | S. 21A(2)(db) inserted by No. 20/2011 s. 3(1), amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(2)(b). |
| (dc) performing abusive or offensive acts in the presence of B; | S. 21A(2)(dc) inserted by No. 20/2011 s. 3(1), amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(2)(b). |
| (dd) directing abusive or offensive acts towards B; | S. 21A(2)(dd) inserted by No. 20/2011 s. 3(1), amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(2)(b). |
| (e) giving offensive material to B or any other person or leaving it where it will be found by, given to or brought to the attention of, B or the other person; | S. 21A(2)(e) amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(2)(b). |
| (f) keeping B or any other person under surveillance; | S. 21A(2)(f) amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(2)(b). |
| (g) acting in any other way that could reasonably be expected— | S. 21A(2)(g) substituted by No. 20/2011 s. 3(2). |
| (i) to cause physical or mental harm to B, including self-harm; or | S. 21A(2)(g)(i) amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(2)(b). |
| (ii) to arouse apprehension or fear in B for B's own safety or that of any other person. | S. 21A(2)(g)(ii) amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(2)(b)(f). |

S. 21A(3)
substituted by
No. 105/2003
s. 4(2),
amended by
No. 20/2011
s. 3(4),
substituted by
No. 1/2026
s. 67(3).

- (3) Each of the following is a result for the purposes of subsection (1)(c)—
- (a) physical or mental harm to B, including self-harm;
 - (b) apprehension or fear in B for B's own safety or that of any other person.
- (4) This section does not apply to conduct engaged in by a person performing official duties for the purpose of—
- (a) the enforcement of the criminal law; or
 - (b) the administration of any Act; or
 - (c) the enforcement of a law imposing a pecuniary penalty; or
 - (d) the execution of a warrant; or
 - (e) the protection of the public revenue—
- that, but for this subsection, would constitute an offence against subsection (1).

S. 21A(4A)
inserted by
No. 105/2003
s. 3(2).

- (4A) In a proceeding for an offence against subsection (1) it is a defence to the charge for the accused to prove that the course of conduct was engaged in without malice—
- (a) in the normal course of a lawful business, trade, profession or enterprise (including that of any body or person whose business, or whose principal business, is the publication, or arranging for the publication, of news or current affairs material); or
 - (b) for the purpose of an industrial dispute; or
 - (c) for the purpose of engaging in political activities or discussion or communicating with respect to public affairs.

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part I—Offences

*	*	*	*	*	S. 21A(5) repealed by No. 68/2008 s. 69(1).
*	*	*	*	*	S. 21A(5A) inserted by No. 52/2008 s. 242, repealed by No. 68/2008 s. 69(1).
(6)	It is immaterial that some or all of the course of conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as B was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.				S. 21A(6) inserted by No. 105/2003 s. 5, amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(4).
(7)	It is immaterial that B was outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the course of conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as that conduct occurred in Victoria.				S. 21A(7) inserted by No. 105/2003 s. 5, amended by No. 1/2026 s. 67(4).
(8)	In this section— <i>mental harm</i> includes— (a) psychological harm; and (b) suicidal thoughts.				S. 21A(8) inserted by No. 20/2011 s. 3(5).
Note	The Personal Safety Intervention Orders Act 2010 provides that the Court within the meaning of that Act may make a personal safety intervention order in respect of stalking.				Note to s. 21A inserted by No. 68/2008 s. 69(2), substituted by No. 53/2010 s. 221(Sch. item 4).

S. 22
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 9),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 14).

22 Conduct endangering life

A person who, without lawful excuse, recklessly engages in conduct that places or may place another person in danger of death is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 23
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 14),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 16).

23 Conduct endangering persons

A person who, without lawful excuse, recklessly engages in conduct that places or may place another person in danger of serious injury is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 24
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 12),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 16),
7/2008 s. 4.

24 Negligently causing serious injury

A person who by negligently doing or omitting to do an act causes serious injury to another person is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 25
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 8),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 11).

25 Setting traps etc. to kill

A person who sets a trap or device with the intention of killing another person (whether a trespasser or not) or being reckless as to whether or not another person (whether a trespasser or not) is killed is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

26 Setting traps etc. to cause serious injury

A person who sets a trap or device with the intention of causing, or being reckless as to whether or not there is caused, serious injury to another person (whether a trespasser or not) is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 26
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 9),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 14).

27 Extortion with threat to kill

A person who makes a demand of another person—

(a) with a threat to kill or inflict injury on a person (other than the offender or an accomplice of the offender); or

(b) with a threat in circumstances where, if the threat were carried out, the life of a person (other than the offender or an accomplice of the offender) would be endangered—

is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 27
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 14),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 11).

28 Extortion with threat to destroy property etc.

A person who makes a demand of another person with a threat to destroy, or endanger the safety of, a building, structure in the nature of a building, bridge, mine, aircraft, vessel, motor vehicle, railway engine or railway carriage is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 28
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 12),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 14).

29 Using firearm to resist arrest etc.

S. 29
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 8(2).

S. 29(1)
amended by
Nos 40/1988
s. 22, 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 10),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 15),
69/1997
s. 22(1).

S. 29(2)
amended by
No. 25/1989
s. 20(a).

S. 29(3)(a)
amended by
No. 24/1990
s. 16,
substituted by
No. 66/1996
s. 201(1).

- (1) A person who makes or attempts to make any use of a firearm or imitation firearm with intent to resist or prevent the lawful apprehension or detention of himself or herself or any other person is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum).

- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) in respect of the lawful apprehension or detention of himself or herself for any other offence committed by him or her is liable to the penalty provided by that subsection in addition to any penalty to which he or she may be liable for that other offence.

- (3) In this section—

(a) *firearm* has the same meaning as in the **Firearms Act 1996**; and

(b) *imitation firearm* means anything which has the appearance of being a firearm whether or not it is capable of discharging any shot or other missile.

30 Threatening injury to prevent arrest

A person who threatens injury to any other person or to any property with intent—

(a) to prevent or hinder the lawful apprehension or detention of himself or herself or any other person; or

(b) to prevent or hinder a police officer or a protective services officer from investigating in a lawful manner any act or circumstance which reasonably calls for investigation by a police officer or a protective services officer—

is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 30 substituted by No. 10233 s. 8(2), amended by Nos 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 12), 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 16).

S. 30(b) amended by Nos 43/2011 s. 15, 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.2).

31 Assaults

(1) A person who—

(a) assaults or threatens to assault another person with intent to commit an indictable offence; or

S. 31 substituted by No. 10233 s. 8(2).

S. 31(1) amended by Nos 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 13), 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 16).

S. 31(1)(b)
amended by
Nos 43/2011
s. 16, 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.3),
substituted by
No. 69/2014
s. 13(1),
amended by
Nos 28/2016
s. 7(1),
43/2017
s. 48(1),
52/2025
s. 3(1)(a).

- (b) assaults or threatens to assault, resists or intentionally obstructs an emergency worker on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty, or a custodial officer on duty, knowing or being reckless as to whether the person is an emergency worker or a youth justice custodial worker or a custodial officer; or

S. 31(1)(ba)
inserted by
No. 69/2014
s. 13(1),
amended by
Nos 20/2015
s. 21, 28/2016
s. 7(2),
43/2017
s. 48(2),
52/2025
s. 3(1)(a).

- (ba) assaults or threatens to assault, resists or intentionally obstructs a person lawfully assisting an emergency worker on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty, or a custodial officer on duty, knowing or being reckless as to whether the person is assisting an emergency worker or a youth justice custodial worker or a custodial officer; or

S. 31(1)(bb)
inserted by
No. 52/2025
s. 3(1)(b).

- (bb) assaults or threatens to assault an applicable customer-facing worker in connection with the performance of the worker's duties, knowing or being reckless as to whether the person is an applicable customer-facing worker; or

- (c) assaults or threatens to assault a person with intent to resist or prevent the lawful apprehension or detention of a person—

is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

- (2) In subsection (1), **assault** means the direct or indirect application of force by a person to the body of, or to clothing or equipment worn by, another person where the application of force is—

- (a) without lawful excuse; and
- (b) with intent to inflict or being reckless as to the infliction of bodily injury, pain, discomfort, damage, insult or deprivation of liberty—

and results in the infliction of any such consequence (whether or not the consequence inflicted is the consequence intended or foreseen).

(2A) In subsection (1)—

applicable customer-facing worker has the meaning given in section 51C of the **Summary Offences Act 1966**;

custodial officer has the same meaning as in section 10AA(8) of the **Sentencing Act 1991**;

emergency worker has the same meaning as in section 10AA(8) of the **Sentencing Act 1991**;

youth justice custodial worker has the same meaning as in section 10AA(8) of the **Sentencing Act 1991**.

S. 31(2A)
inserted by
No. 69/2014
s. 13(2),
amended by
Nos 28/2016
s. 7(3),
38/2017
s. 81(1),
43/2017
s. 48(3),
substituted by
No. 52/2025
s. 3(2).

(2B) In subsection (1), *on duty*—

- (a) in relation to an emergency worker, has the same meaning as in section 10AA(9) of the **Sentencing Act 1991**; and
- (b) in relation to a custodial officer, has the same meaning as in section 10AA(10) of the **Sentencing Act 1991**; and
- (c) in relation to a youth justice custodial worker, has the same meaning as in section 10AA(11) of the **Sentencing Act 1991**.

S. 31(2B)
inserted by
No. 52/2025
s. 3(2).

(3) In subsection (2)—

application of force includes—

- (a) application of heat, light, electric current or any other form of energy; and
- (b) application of matter in solid, liquid or gaseous form.

S. 31(4)
inserted by
No. 52/2025
s. 3(3).

(4) Without limiting subsection (1)(bb), an assault or threat to assault is connected with the performance of the worker's duties if the assault or threat occurs—

(a) when the worker is—

- (i) performing their duties; or
- (ii) taking a break from performing their duties; or
- (iii) arriving at, or leaving, a place at which they perform their duties; or

(b) in response to—

- (i) a thing done or omitted to be done by the worker when performing their duties; or
- (ii) a thing that the person who engages in the conduct believes the worker has done or omitted to do when performing their duties.

31A Use of firearms in the commission of offences

S. 31A
inserted by
No. 66/1996
s. 202 (as
amended by
Nos 26/1997
s. 35(2),
48/1997
s. 60(2) (as
amended by
No. 74/2000
s. 3(Sch. 1
item 114))).

- (1) A person who is found guilty of an indictable offence and who carried—

S. 31A(1)
substituted by
No. 50/2007
s. 57.

- (a) a firearm (within the meaning of the **Firearms Act 1996**); or
- (b) an imitation firearm (within the meaning of section 29(3)(b))—

when committing the offence is guilty of a further offence and is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

- (2) Despite anything to the contrary in the **Sentencing Act 1991** or in any other law, a court, in imposing a penalty under subsection (1)—

- (a) must direct that the sentence not be served concurrently with any other sentence; and
- (b) must not make an order suspending the whole or any part of the sentence.

31B Being armed with criminal intent

S. 31B
inserted by
No. 56/2005
s. 6.

- (1) In this section—

controlled weapon has the same meaning as in the **Control of Weapons Act 1990**;

firearm has the same meaning as in the **Firearms Act 1996**;

imitation firearm has the same meaning as in section 29;

prohibited weapon has the same meaning as in the
Control of Weapons Act 1990.

- (2) A person who, with criminal intent, is armed with a firearm, an imitation firearm, a prohibited weapon or a controlled weapon is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 31C
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 3.

31C Discharging a firearm reckless to safety of a police officer or a protective services officer

- (1) A person commits an offence if—
- (a) the person discharges a firearm and is reckless as to the safety of another person (the *victim*) due to the discharge of the firearm; and
 - (b) the victim is a police officer on duty or a protective services officer on duty; and
 - (c) the person knows or is reckless as to whether the victim is a police officer or a protective services officer.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).
- (3) Subsection (1) does not apply to conduct engaged in by a person who is—
- (a) a police officer or a protective services officer acting in the course of the police officer's or the protective services officer's official duties when authorised to discharge a firearm by the Chief Commissioner of Police; or
 - (b) a senior IBAC Officer carrying out the purposes for which firearms may be used under Part 5 of the **Independent Broad-**

based Anti-corruption Commission Act 2011 and as authorised under that Part;
or

- (c) a member of a police force or police service of the Commonwealth or of another State or a Territory discharging a firearm issued to the member for the performance of a detailed duty; or
- (d) a prison guard who holds a licence under the **Firearms Act 1996** issued for the requirement of the occupation of prison guard discharging a firearm as authorised under that licence while acting in the course of the prison guard's duties in the immediate pursuit of another person who is under the prison guard's custody; or
- (e) a person who holds a licence under the **Firearms Act 1996**, discharging a firearm the person is authorised to use under the licence in the course of the person's duties under—
 - (i) the **Conservation, Forests and Lands Act 1987**; or
 - (ii) the **Livestock Disease Control Act 1994**; or
 - (iii) the **Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act 1986**.

Notes

- 1 An offence against this section if committed in certain circumstances is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2H) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that section exist.
- 2 Section 16(3E) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** requires that every term of imprisonment imposed on a person for an offence against this section if committed in

certain circumstances must, unless otherwise directed by the court, be served cumulatively on any uncompleted sentence or sentences of imprisonment imposed on that offender, whether before or at the same time as that term.

(4) In this section—

discharge means the discharge of shot or a bullet or other missile from a firearm;

firearm has the same meaning as in the **Firearms Act 1996**;

police officer on duty means a police officer who is performing any duty or exercising any power as such an officer;

protective services officer on duty means a protective services officer who is performing any duty or exercising any power as such an officer;

senior IBAC Officer has the same meaning as it has in the **Independent Broad-based Anti-corruption Commission Act 2011**.

S. 31D
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 3.

31D Intimidation of a law enforcement officer or a family member of a law enforcement officer

(1) A person commits an offence if—

- (a) the person uses or procures the use of intimidation towards another person (the *victim*); and
- (b) the victim is a law enforcement officer or a family member of a law enforcement officer; and
- (c) the use or procuring of intimidation is for reasons related to the victim being a law enforcement officer or a family member of a law enforcement officer.

- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1)(a), a person uses *intimidation* towards a victim if—
 - (a) the person engages in conduct that could reasonably be expected to arouse apprehension or fear in the victim for the safety of the victim; and
 - (b) either—
 - (i) the person knows that engaging in that conduct would be likely to arouse that apprehension or fear; or
 - (ii) in all the particular circumstances, the person ought to have known that engaging in that conduct would be likely to arouse that apprehension or fear.
- (4) Subsection (3) applies whether or not the conduct arouses apprehension or fear in the victim.
- (5) In a proceeding for an offence against subsection (1) it is a defence to the charge for the accused to prove that conduct in respect of a victim referred to in paragraph (d), (e), (f) or (g) of the definition of *law enforcement officer* in subsection (8) was engaged in without malice—
 - (a) in the normal course of a lawful business, trade, profession or enterprise (including that of any body or person whose business, or whose principal business, is the publication, or arranging the publication, of news or current affairs material); or
 - (b) for the purposes of an industrial dispute; or

- (c) for the purpose of engaging in political activities or discussion or communicating with respect to public affairs.
- (6) For the purposes of this section a single act may amount to intimidation.
- (7) For the purposes of this section, it is immaterial—
 - (a) that some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as the victim was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred; or
 - (b) that the victim was outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as that conduct occurred in Victoria; or
 - (c) some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria and the victim was outside Victoria at the relevant time or times, so long as the conduct is for reasons related to the victim being a law enforcement officer in Victoria, or a family member of a law enforcement officer in Victoria.
- (8) In this section—
 - family member* has the meaning given in section 8 of the **Family Violence Protection Act 2008**;
 - law enforcement officer* means a person who is—
 - (a) a police officer; or
 - (b) a protective services officer; or
 - (c) a police custody officer within the meaning of the **Victoria Police Act 2013**; or

- (d) a Governor, prison officer or escort officer within the meaning of the **Corrections Act 1986**; or
- (e) authorised under section 9A(1) of the **Corrections Act 1986** to exercise a function or power of a Governor, a prison officer or an escort officer under that Act; or
- (f) authorised under section 9A(1A) or (1B) of the **Corrections Act 1986** to exercise a function or power referred to in that subsection; or
- (g) a youth justice custodial worker within the meaning of the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005**.

32 Offence to perform female genital mutilation

New s. 32
inserted by
No. 46/1996
s. 4.

- (1) A person must not perform female genital mutilation on a child.

Penalty: Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 32(1)
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 18).

- (2) A person must not perform on a person other than a child any type of female genital mutilation referred to in paragraphs (a) to (e) of the definition of female genital mutilation.

Penalty: Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 32(2)
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 18).

New s. 33
inserted by
No. 46/1996
s. 4.

33 Offence to take a person from the State with the intention of having prohibited female genital mutilation performed

S. 33(1)
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 18).

- (1) A person must not take another person from the State, or arrange for another person to be taken from the State, with the intention of having prohibited female genital mutilation performed on the other person.

Penalty: Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 33(2)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.2).

- (2) In proceedings for an offence under subsection (1), proof that—

S. 33(2)(a)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.2).

- (a) the accused took the person, or arranged for the person to be taken from the State; and

- (b) the person was subjected, while outside the State, to prohibited female genital mutilation—

is, in the absence of proof to the contrary, proof that the accused took the person or arranged for the person to be taken from the State with the intention of having prohibited female genital mutilation performed on the person.

New s. 34
inserted by
No. 46/1996
s. 4.

34 Consent not a defence to a charge under sections 32 or 33

It is not a defence to a charge brought under section 32 or 33 to prove that the person on whom the act which is the subject of the charge was performed, or the parents or guardian of that person, consented to the performance of that act.

34A Exceptions to offences under section 32

S. 34A
inserted by
No. 46/1996
s. 4.

- (1) It is not an offence against section 32 if the performance of the female genital mutilation is by a surgical operation which is—
 - (a) necessary for the health of the person on whom it is performed and which is performed by a medical practitioner; or
 - (b) is performed on a person in labour or who has just given birth, and for medical purposes or the relief of physical symptoms connected with that labour or birth, and which is performed by a medical practitioner or a midwife; or
 - (c) is a sexual reassignment procedure which is performed by a medical practitioner.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)(a), in determining whether an operation is necessary for the health of a person, the only matters to be taken into account are those relevant to the medical welfare or the relief of physical symptoms of the person.
- (3) The burden of proving that the performance of the female genital mutilation did not occur in any of the circumstances set out in subsection (1) lies with the prosecution.

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (4A)
(Heading and
ss 34AB–
34AL)
inserted by
No. 37/2023
s. 3.

(4A) *Non-fatal strangulation*

S. 34AB
inserted by
No. 37/2023
s. 3.

34AB Definitions

(1) In this Subdivision—

chokes, strangles or suffocates includes doing any of the following things—

- (a) applying pressure to the front or sides of a person's neck;
- (b) obstructing any part of, or interfering with the operation of, a person's respiratory system or accessory systems of respiration;
- (c) impeding a person's respiration;

family member has the meaning given by section 8 of the **Family Violence Protection Act 2008**;

injury has the same meaning as in section 15;

sexual activity has the meaning given by section 35D and subsection (2).

(2) If conduct constituting an offence against section 34AE(1) occurs during sexual activity (within the meaning of section 35D) that conduct is itself *sexual activity* for the purposes of this Subdivision.

34AC Guiding principles

It is the intention of Parliament that in interpreting and applying this Subdivision, courts are to have regard to the fact that—

S. 34AC
inserted by
No. 37/2023
s. 3.

- (a) non-fatal strangulation of a person by a current or former intimate partner indicates that the person is, statistically, significantly more likely to be killed by the current or former intimate partner; and
- (b) in circumstances of family violence, non-fatal strangulation can indicate an ongoing and escalating pattern of coercive and controlling behaviour by the perpetrator; and
- (c) even very short or individual instances of non-fatal strangulation can demonstrate the perpetrator's physical dominance and control over the victim and create an atmosphere of fear and compliance; and
- (d) non-fatal strangulation will not always leave physical signs or injuries, and it can result in physical signs or injuries that only appear after weeks or months have passed.

34AD Non-fatal strangulation intentionally causing injury

S. 34AD
inserted by
No. 37/2023
s. 3.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally and without lawful excuse chokes, strangles or suffocates another person (B); and
 - (b) A intends the choking, strangling or suffocation to cause an injury to B; and
 - (c) the choking, strangling or suffocation causes an injury to B; and

(d) A is a family member of B.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

Note

A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that A was not a family member of B is not a defence to this offence—see section 34AK.

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), it is not a lawful excuse that B consented to the conduct constituting the offence.
- (3) A does not commit an offence against subsection (1) if the conduct constituting the offence occurs in the course of a procedure carried out in good faith for medical or body modification purposes.

Examples

- 1 A tattoos B's neck at the request of B.
- 2 A gives B a neck piercing at the request of B.

S. 34AE
inserted by
No. 37/2023
s. 3.

34AE Non-fatal strangulation

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally and without lawful excuse chokes, strangles or suffocates another person (B); and
 - (b) A is a family member of B.

Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

Note

A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that A was not a family member of B is not a defence to this offence—see section 34AK.

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if the conduct constituting the offence is a sexual activity, that B consented to that conduct is not a lawful excuse except to the extent provided for by section 34AF.

- (3) Nothing in subsection (2) or section 34AF prevents B's consent to the conduct constituting the offence from being a lawful excuse for the purposes of subsection (1) if that conduct is not a sexual activity.
- (4) Nothing in sections 34AG to 34AJ applies in relation to consent being a lawful excuse where the conduct constituting the offence is not a sexual activity.

34AF Sexual activity and consent defence to offence of non-fatal strangulation

S. 34AF
inserted by
No. 37/2023
s. 3.

- (1) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 34AE(1) if—
 - (a) the conduct constituting the offence was a sexual activity; and
 - (b) either—
 - (i) B consented to the conduct; or
 - (ii) A reasonably believed that B consented to the conduct.
- (2) In this section—

consent has the meaning given by sections 34AG and 34AH.

34AG Sexual activity and consent defence—meaning of consent

S. 34AG
inserted by
No. 37/2023
s. 3.

For the purposes of section 34AF(1)(b)—

- (a) consent means free and voluntary agreement; and
- (b) a person does not consent to the conduct constituting the offence just because they do not resist the conduct verbally or physically; and

- (c) a person does not consent to the conduct constituting the offence just because they consented to—
 - (i) a different sexual activity with the same person; or
 - (ii) the same sexual activity with the same person at a different time or place; or
 - (iii) the same sexual activity with a different person; or
 - (iv) a different sexual activity with a different person.

S. 34AH
inserted by
No. 37/2023
s. 3.

34AH Sexual activity and consent defence—circumstances in which a person does not consent

For the purposes of section 34AF(1)(b), circumstances in which a person does not consent to the conduct constituting the offence include, but are not limited to, the following—

- (a) the person does not say or do anything to indicate consent to the conduct;
- (b) the person submits to the conduct because of force, a fear of force, harm of any type or a fear of harm of any type, whether to that person or someone else, regardless of—
 - (i) when the force, harm or conduct giving rise to the fear occurs; and
 - (ii) whether it is, or is a result of, a single incident or is part of an ongoing pattern;

Examples

Each of the following is a type of harm that can be done to a person as described in this paragraph—

- (a) economic or financial harm;
- (b) reputational harm;

- (c) harm to the person's family, cultural or community relationships;
 - (d) harm to the person's employment;
 - (e) family violence involving psychological abuse or harm to mental health;
 - (f) sexual harassment.
- (c) the person submits to the conduct because of coercion or intimidation—
- (i) regardless of when the coercion or intimidation occurs; and
 - (ii) whether it is, or is a result of, a single incident or is part of an ongoing pattern;
- (d) the person submits to the conduct because the person is unlawfully detained;
- (e) the person submits to the conduct because the person is overborne by the abuse of a relationship of authority or trust;
- (f) the person is asleep or unconscious;
- (g) the person is so affected by alcohol or another drug as to be incapable of consenting to the conduct;
- (h) the person is so affected by alcohol or another drug as to be incapable of withdrawing consent to the conduct;

Note

This circumstance may apply where a person gave consent when not so affected by alcohol or another drug as to be incapable of consenting.

- (i) having given consent to the conduct, the person later withdraws consent to the conduct taking place or continuing.

S. 34AI
inserted by
No. 37/2023
s. 3.

34AI Sexual activity and consent defence—reasonable belief in consent

- (1) For the purposes of section 34AF(1)(b)(ii), whether or not A reasonably believes that B is consenting to the conduct constituting the offence depends on the circumstances.

Note

See section 34AJ for the effect of intoxication on the standard to be applied in determining whether A had a reasonable belief.

- (2) A's belief that B consents to the conduct constituting the offence is not reasonable if, within a reasonable time before or at the time the conduct takes place, A does not say or do anything to find out whether B consents to the conduct.
- (3) Subsection (2) does not apply if—
- (a) A has a cognitive impairment or mental illness (other than the effects of intoxication that is self-induced within the meaning of section 34AJ); and
 - (b) that cognitive impairment or mental illness is a substantial cause of A not saying or doing anything to find out whether B consents to the conduct constituting the offence.
- (4) A bears the burden of proving on the balance of probabilities the matters referred to in subsection (3).

Note

References to A and B in this section are references to the same A and B referred to in section 34AE.

34AJ Sexual activity and consent defence—effect of intoxication on standard to be applied in determining reasonable belief

**S. 34AJ
inserted by
No. 37/2023
s. 3.**

- (1) In determining whether a person who is intoxicated has a reasonable belief at any time—
 - (a) if the intoxication is self-induced, regard must be had to the standard of a reasonable person who is not intoxicated and who is otherwise in the same circumstances as that person at the relevant time; and
 - (b) if the intoxication is not self-induced, regard must be had to the standard of a reasonable person who is intoxicated to the same extent as the person and who is in the same circumstances as that person at the relevant time.
- (2) For the purposes of this section, intoxication is self-induced unless it came about—
 - (a) involuntarily; or
 - (b) because of fraud, sudden or extraordinary emergency, accident, reasonable mistake, duress or force; or
 - (c) from the use of a drug for which a prescription is required and that was used in accordance with the directions of the person who prescribed it; or
 - (d) from the use of a drug for which a prescription is not required and that was used for a purpose, and in accordance with the dosage level, recommended by the manufacturer.

- (3) However, intoxication that comes about in the circumstances referred to in subsection (2)(c) or (d) is self-induced if the person using the drug knew, or had reason to believe, when taking the drug that it would significantly impair the person's judgement or control.

S. 34AK
inserted by
No. 37/2023
s. 3.

34AK No defence of mistaken but honest and reasonable belief regarding relationship

For an offence against section 34AD(1) or 34AE(1), it is not a defence to a charge that, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A was under a mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that A was not a family member of B.

Note

References to A and B in this section are references to the same A and B referred to in sections 34AD and 34AE.

S. 34AL
inserted by
No. 37/2023
s. 3.

34AL Review of amendments made by Crimes Amendment (Non-fatal Strangulation) Act 2023

- (1) The Attorney-General must cause a review to be conducted of the operation of—
- (a) this Subdivision; and
 - (b) section 5(2)(ba) of the **Family Violence Protection Act 2008**.
- (2) The review must be commenced no later than 2 years after the commencement of the **Crimes Amendment (Non-fatal Strangulation) Act 2023**.
- (3) The review must be completed no later than 6 months after it commences.
- (4) The Attorney-General must cause a copy of the review to be laid before each House of the Parliament no later than 14 sitting days after receiving it.

(5) *Corpses*

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (5)
(Heading and
ss 16–35)
amended by
Nos 7088
s. 2(b), 7645
s. 2, 8280 s. 4,
9155 s. 2, 9576
s. 11(1),
repealed by
No. 10233
s. 8(2), new
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (5)
(Heading and
s. 34B)
inserted by
No. 80/2003
s. 185,
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (5)
(Heading and
ss 34B–34BE)
by
No. 47/2016
s. 3.

34B Sexual activity with the corpse of a human being

S. 34B
substituted by
No. 47/2016
s. 3.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally engages in an activity involving the corpse of a human being; and
 - (b) the activity is sexual.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1)—
 - (a) an activity is sexual if it would involve sexual penetration as defined by section 35A were the corpse a person;

- (b) an activity may be sexual due to—
- (i) the area of A's body or of the corpse involved in the activity, including (but not limited to) the genital or anal region, the buttocks or, in the case of a female, the breasts; or
 - (ii) the fact that A seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from the activity; or
 - (iii) any other aspect of the activity, including the circumstances in which it takes place.

Notes

- 1 Exceptions apply to this offence—see section 34BD.
- 2 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the activity was not sexual is not a defence to this offence—see section 34BE.

S. 34BA
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 3.

34BA Removal of body parts from the corpse of a human being

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if A intentionally removes a body part from the corpse of a human being.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

Note

Exceptions apply to this offence—see section 34BD.

S. 34BB
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 3.

34BB Offensive conduct involving human remains

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally engages in conduct involving human remains; and
 - (b) the conduct is offensive.

- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 7 imprisonment (2 years maximum).
- (3) An offence against subsection (1) is a summary offence.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (1), conduct is offensive if, in all the circumstances, it is likely to arouse significant anger, resentment, outrage, disgust or repulsion in the minds of reasonable persons.
- (5) In this section—
human remains has the same meaning as in the **Cemeteries and Crematoria Act 2003**.

Notes

- 1 Exceptions apply to this offence—see section 34BD.
- 2 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the conduct was not offensive is not a defence to this offence—see section 34BE.

34BC Location of corpse or human remains immaterial

S. 34BC
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 3.

- (1) For the purposes of sections 34B and 34BA, it is immaterial whether the corpse is in a public cemetery within the meaning of the **Cemeteries and Crematoria Act 2003** or at any other place.
- (2) For the purposes of section 34BB, it is immaterial whether the human remains are in a public cemetery within the meaning of the **Cemeteries and Crematoria Act 2003** or at any other place.

34BD Exceptions

S. 34BD
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 3.

A does not commit an offence against a provision of this Subdivision if A's conduct occurs in the course of—

- (a) a procedure carried out in good faith for the purpose of preparing the corpse or human remains for cremation or for interment

within the meaning of the **Cemeteries and Crematoria Act 2003**; or

- (b) any other lawful procedure carried out in good faith for medical, hygienic, scientific, forensic or law enforcement purposes.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in the offence provisions in this Subdivision.

S. 34BE
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 3.

34BE No defence of mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that activity was not sexual or conduct was not offensive

It is not a defence to a charge that, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A was under a mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that—

- (a) for an offence against section 34B(1)—
the activity was not sexual; or
- (b) for an offence against section 34BB(1)—
the conduct was not offensive.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in the offence provisions in this Subdivision.

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (6)
(Heading and
s. 36)
amended by
Nos 9155 s. 3,
9576 s. 11(1),
repealed by
No. 10233
s. 8(2).

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Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part I—Offences

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Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (7)
(Heading and
ss 37–43)
amended by
Nos 6958
s. 8(4)(b), 7546
s. 4, 7876
s. 2(3), 8280
s. 5, 9576
s. 11(1),
repealed by
No. 10233
s. 8(2).

(8) *Sexual offences (general provisions)*

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8)
(Heading and
ss 44–62)
amended by
Nos 6761
s. 2, 7332
s. 2(Sch. 1
item 18), 7577
s. 2, 8280 s. 6,
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8)
(Heading and
ss 44–46) by
No. 9509 s. 5,
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8)
(Heading and
ss 36–39) by
No. 8/1991
s. 3,
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8)
(Heading and
ss 35–37) by
No. 81/1991
s. 3.

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S. 34C
inserted by
No. 74/2014
s. 3 (as
amended by
No. 14/2015
s. 69(2)),
repealed by
No. 47/2016
s. 4.

35 Definitions

New s. 35
inserted by
No. 81/1991
s. 3,
amended by
Nos 2/2006
s. 3, 12/2008
s. 73(1)(Sch. 1
item 16),
4/2009
s. 37(Sch. 1
item 9),
74/2014
s. 7(1),
substituted by
No. 47/2016
s. 5.

S. 35(1)
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 11.

S. 35(1) def. of
*cognitive
impairment*
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 7.

S. 35(1) def. of
*commercial
sexual
services*
inserted by
No. 7/2022
s. 39(1).

- (1) In this Subdivision and Subdivisions (8A) to (8FA)—

animal means any animal (other than a human being), whether vertebrate or not;

care, supervision or authority—see section 37;

cognitive impairment has the same meaning as in Subdivision (8E);

commercial sexual services means services involving the use or display of the body of the person providing the services for the sexual arousal or sexual gratification of others for—

- (a) commercial benefit; or
- (b) payment; or

- (c) reward (including the supply of a drug of dependence within the meaning of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981**)—

whether or not the commercial benefit, payment or reward accrues to, or is given to, the person providing the services or to another person;

consent—for the purposes of this Subdivision and Subdivisions (8A) to (8E)—see sections 36 and 36AA;

S. 35(1) def. of **consent** substituted by No. 38/2022 s. 4.

domestic partner of a person means—

- (a) a person who is in a registered domestic relationship with the person; or
- (b) a person to whom the person is not married but with whom the person is living as a couple on a genuine domestic basis (irrespective of gender or gender identity);

Note

See also subsection (2).

mental illness has the same meaning as in Subdivision (8E);

S. 35(1) def. of **mental illness** inserted by No. 38/2022 s. 7.

sexual, in relation to an activity—see section 35D;

sexual, in relation to touching—see section 35B;

sexual penetration—see section 35A;

take part in a sexual act—see section 35C;

touching—see section 35B;

S. 35(1) def. of
vagina
substituted by
No. 5/2018
s. 3(1),
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 91(1).

vagina includes the external genitalia.

S. 35(1A)
inserted by
No. 7/2022
s. 39(2).

- (1A) For the purposes of the definition of *commercial sexual services* in subsection (1), a person may provide services on a single occasion or on multiple occasions.
- (2) For the purposes of the definition of *domestic partner* in subsection (1)—
 - (a) *registered domestic relationship* has the same meaning as in the **Relationships Act 2008**; and
 - (b) in determining whether persons who are not in a registered domestic relationship are domestic partners of each other, all the circumstances of their relationship are to be taken into account, including any one or more of the matters referred to in section 35(2) of the **Relationships Act 2008** as may be relevant in a particular case.
- (3) For the purposes of this Subdivision and Subdivisions (8A) to (8FA), a reference to a part of the body includes a reference to a surgically altered or constructed part of the body.

S. 35(3)
inserted by
No. 5/2018
s. 3(2),
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 11.

S. 35A
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 5.

35A Sexual penetration

- (1) A person (A) sexually penetrates another person (B) if—
 - (a) A introduces (to any extent) a part of A's body or an object into B's vagina; or

- (b) A introduces (to any extent) a part of A's body or an object into B's anus; or
 - (c) A introduces (to any extent) their penis into B's mouth; or
 - (d) A, having introduced a part of A's body or an object into B's vagina, continues to keep it there; or
 - (e) A, having introduced a part of A's body or an object into B's anus, continues to keep it there; or
 - (f) A, having introduced their penis into B's mouth, continues to keep it there.
- (2) A person sexually penetrates themselves if—
- (a) the person introduces (to any extent) a part of their body or an object into their own vagina; or
 - (b) the person introduces (to any extent) a part of their body or an object into their own anus; or
 - (c) having introduced a part of their body or an object into their own vagina, they continue to keep it there; or
 - (d) having introduced a part of their body or an object into their own anus, they continue to keep it there.
- (3) A person (A) sexually penetrates an animal if A engages in conduct with the animal that would involve sexual penetration as defined by subsection (1) were the animal another person (B).

- (4) A person (B) is sexually penetrated by an animal if B engages in conduct with the animal that would involve sexual penetration as defined by subsection (1) were the animal another person (A).
- (5) In relation to sexual penetration of an animal, a reference to the vagina or anus includes a reference to any similar part.

Note

References to A and B are included to help readers understand the definition of sexual penetration. The same technique is used in the offence provisions involving sexual penetration. There is no connection between the A and B referred to in one section and the A and B referred to in another section.

S. 35B
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 5.

35B Touching

- (1) Touching may be done—
 - (a) with any part of the body; or
 - (b) with anything else; or
 - (c) through anything, including anything worn by the person doing the touching or by the person touched.
- (2) Touching may be sexual due to—
 - (a) the area of the body that is touched or used in the touching, including (but not limited to) the genital or anal region, the buttocks or, in the case of a female or a person who identifies as a female, the breasts; or
 - (b) the fact that the person doing the touching seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from the touching; or
 - (c) any other aspect of the touching, including the circumstances in which it is done.

35C Taking part in a sexual act

A person takes part in a sexual act if—

- (a) the person is sexually penetrated or sexually touched—
 - (i) by another person; or
 - (ii) by an animal; or
- (b) the person sexually penetrates or sexually touches—
 - (i) another person; or
 - (ii) themselves; or
 - (iii) an animal.

S. 35C
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 5.

35D Sexual activity

An activity may be sexual due to—

- (a) the area of the body that is involved in the activity, including (but not limited to) the genital or anal region, the buttocks or, in the case of a female or a person who identifies as a female, the breasts; or
- (b) the fact that the person engaging in the activity seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from the activity; or
- (c) any other aspect of the activity, including the circumstances in which it is engaged in.

S. 35D
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 5.

Example

A watches pornography in the presence of A's daughter (B) and her friend (C).

S. 36
substituted by
No. 81/1991
s. 3,
repealed by
No. 74/2014
s. 7(2),
new s. 36
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 5,
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 3(1),
substituted by
No. 38/2022
s. 5.

36 Consent

- (1) Consent means free and voluntary agreement.

Note

See also sections 37A and 37B which set out the objectives of Subdivisions (8A) to (8G) and the guiding principles that the courts are to have regard to in interpreting and applying those Subdivisions, including this section and section 36AA.

- (2) A person does not consent to an act just because they do not resist the act verbally or physically.
- (3) A person does not consent to an act just because they consented to—
- (a) a different act with the same person; or
 - (b) the same act with the same person at a different time or place; or
 - (c) the same act with a different person; or
 - (d) a different act with a different person.

S. 36AA
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 5.

36AA Circumstances in which a person does not consent

- (1) Circumstances in which a person does not consent to an act include, but are not limited to, the following—
- (a) the person does not say or do anything to indicate consent to the act;
 - (b) the person submits to the act because of force, a fear of force, harm of any type or a fear of harm of any type, whether to that person or someone else or to an animal, regardless of—
 - (i) when the force, harm or conduct giving rise to the fear occurs; and
 - (ii) whether it is, or is a result of, a single incident or is part of an ongoing pattern;

Examples

Each of the following is a type of harm that can be done to a person as described in this paragraph—

- (a) economic or financial harm;
 - (b) reputational harm;
 - (c) harm to the person's family, cultural or community relationships;
 - (d) harm to the person's employment;
 - (e) family violence involving psychological abuse or harm to mental health;
 - (f) sexual harassment.
- (c) the person submits to the act because of coercion or intimidation—
- (i) regardless of when the coercion or intimidation occurs; and
 - (ii) whether it is, or is a result of, a single incident or is part of an ongoing pattern;
- (d) the person submits to the act because the person is unlawfully detained;
- (e) the person submits to the act because the person is overborne by the abuse of a relationship of authority or trust;
- (f) the person is asleep or unconscious;
- (g) the person is so affected by alcohol or another drug as to be incapable of consenting to the act;
- (h) the person is so affected by alcohol or another drug as to be incapable of withdrawing consent to the act;

Note

This circumstance may apply where a person gave consent when not so affected by alcohol or another drug as to be incapable of consenting.

- (i) the person is incapable of understanding the sexual nature of the act;
 - (j) the person is mistaken about the sexual nature of the act;
 - (k) the person is mistaken about the identity of any other person involved in the act;
 - (l) the person mistakenly believes that the act is for medical or hygienic purposes;
 - (m) the act occurs in the provision of commercial sexual services and the person engages in the act because of a false or misleading representation that the person will be paid;
 - (n) if the act involves an animal, the person mistakenly believes that the act is for veterinary or agricultural purposes or scientific research purposes;
 - (o) the person engages in the act on the basis that a condom is used and either—
 - (i) before or during the act, any other person involved in the act intentionally removes the condom or tampers with the condom; or
 - (ii) the person who was to use the condom intentionally does not use it;
 - (p) having given consent to the act, the person later withdraws consent to the act taking place or continuing.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)(m), a false or misleading representation may be made by words or conduct (including by omission) and may be explicit or implicit.

* * * * *

S. 36AA(3)
repealed by
No. 7/2022
s. 39A (as
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 19).

36A Reasonable belief in consent

S. 36A
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 5,
substituted by
No. 38/2022
s. 8.

- (1) Whether or not a person (A) reasonably believes that another person (B) is consenting to an act depends on the circumstances.

Note

See section 36B for the effect of intoxication on the standard to be applied in determining whether a person has a reasonable belief.

- (2) A's belief that B consents to an act is not reasonable if, within a reasonable time before or at the time the act takes place, A does not say or do anything to find out whether B consents to the act.
- (3) Subsection (2) does not apply if—
- (a) A has a cognitive impairment or mental illness (other than the effects of intoxication that is self-induced within the meaning of section 36B); and
 - (b) that cognitive impairment or mental illness is a substantial cause of A not saying or doing anything to find out whether B consents to the act.
- (4) A bears the burden of proving on the balance of probabilities the matters referred to in subsection (3).

S. 36B
(Heading)
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 9.

S. 36B
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 5.

36B Effect of intoxication on standard to be applied in determining reasonable belief

- (1) In determining whether a person who is intoxicated has a reasonable belief at any time—
 - (a) if the intoxication is self-induced, regard must be had to the standard of a reasonable person who is not intoxicated and who is otherwise in the same circumstances as that person at the relevant time; and
 - (b) if the intoxication is not self-induced, regard must be had to the standard of a reasonable person who is intoxicated to the same extent as that person and who is in the same circumstances as that person at the relevant time.
- (2) For the purposes of this section, intoxication is self-induced unless it came about—
 - (a) involuntarily; or
 - (b) because of fraud, sudden or extraordinary emergency, accident, reasonable mistake, duress or force; or
 - (c) from the use of a drug for which a prescription is required and that was used in accordance with the directions of the person who prescribed it; or

S. 36B(2)(ca)
inserted by
No. 5/2018
s. 4(1)(a),
repealed by
No. 34/2019
s. 46(a).

* * * * *

S. 36B(2)(d)
amended by
Nos 5/2018
s. 4(1)(b),
34/2019
s. 46(b).

- (d) from the use of a drug for which a prescription is not required and that was used for a purpose, and in accordance with the dosage level, recommended by the manufacturer.

- (3) However, intoxication that comes about in the circumstances referred to in subsection (2)(c) or (d) is self-induced if the person using the drug knew, or had reason to believe, when taking the drug that it would significantly impair the person's judgement or control.

S. 36B(3)
amended by
Nos 5/2018
s. 4(2),
37/2023 s. 4.

37 Care, supervision or authority

- (1) Without limiting the circumstances in which a child is under the care, supervision or authority of a person, a person (A) has a child (B) under their care, supervision or authority if A is—
- (a) B's parent or step-parent; or
 - (b) B's teacher; or
 - (c) B's employer; or
 - (d) B's youth worker; or
 - (e) B's sports coach; or
 - (f) B's counsellor; or
 - (g) B's health professional; or
 - (h) a person who has parental responsibility (within the meaning of the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005**) for B; or
 - (i) a religious or spiritual guide, or a leader or official (including a lay member) of a church or religious body, however any such guide, leader, official, church or body is described, who provides care, advice or instruction to B or has authority over B; or
 - (j) an out of home carer (within the meaning given by section 161A of the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005**) of B; or
 - (k) a police officer acting in the course of their duty in respect of B; or

S. 37
substituted by
No. 81/1991
s. 3,
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 4, 2/2006
s. 4,
substituted by
No. 57/2007
s. 3,
repealed by
No. 74/2014
s. 7(3),
new s. 37
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 5.

S. 37(1)(j)
amended by
No. 17/2023
s. 59.

- (1) employed in, or providing services in, a remand centre, youth residential centre, youth justice centre or prison and is acting in the course of their duty in respect of B.

(2) In this section—

parent includes—

- (a) a parent by operation of the **Adoption Act 1984**; and
- (b) a parent by operation of the **Status of Children Act 1974**;

step-parent, in relation to a person, includes the spouse or domestic partner of the person's parent.

S. 37AAA
inserted by
No. 57/2007
s. 4,
repealed by
No. 74/2014
s. 7(3).

* * * *

S. 37AA
inserted by
No. 57/2007
s. 4,
repealed by
No. 74/2014
s. 7(3).

* * * *

S. 37A
(Heading)
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 6(1).

37A Objectives of Subdivisions (8A) to (8G)

The objectives of Subdivisions (8A) to (8G) are—

S. 37A
inserted by
No. 2/2006
s. 5.

S. 37A(a)
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 6(2).

- (a) to uphold the fundamental right of every person to make decisions about their sexual behaviour and to choose whether or not to engage in sexual activity;

- (ab) to promote the principle that consent to an act is not to be assumed—that consent involves ongoing and mutual communication and decision-making between each person involved (that is, each person should seek the consent of each other person in a way and at a time that makes it clear whether they consent);
- (b) to protect children and persons with a cognitive impairment or mental illness from sexual exploitation.

S. 37A(ab)
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 6(3).

S. 37A(b)
amended by
No. 47/2016
s. 6.

37B Guiding principles

S. 37B
inserted by
No. 2/2006
s. 5.

It is the intention of Parliament that in interpreting and applying Subdivisions (8A) to (8G), courts are to have regard to the fact that—

- (a) there is a high incidence of sexual violence within society; and
- (b) sexual offences are significantly under-reported; and
- (c) a significant number of sexual offences are committed against women, children and other vulnerable persons including persons with a cognitive impairment or mental illness; and
- (d) sexual offenders are commonly known to their victims; and
- (e) sexual offences often occur in circumstances where there is unlikely to be any physical signs of an offence having occurred.

S. 37B(c)
amended by
No. 47/2016
s. 7.

(8A) *Rape, sexual assault and associated sexual offences*

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8A)
(Heading)
substituted by
No. 47/2016
s. 8.

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8A)
(Heading and
ss 47–50)
inserted by
No. 9509 s. 5
amended by
No. 10079
s. 8(1),
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8A)
(Heading and
ss 40–43) by
No. 8/1991
s. 3,
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8A)
(Heading and
ss 38, 39) by
No. 81/1991
s. 3 amended
by Nos
49/1991
s. 119(3)(Sch.
3 item 1) (as
amended by
No. 81/1991
s.10(Sch. item
3.1)), 41/1993
s. 20, 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
items 19, 20),
67/2000 s. 4,
2/2006 ss 6, 7,
57/2007
ss 5–7,
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8A)
(Heading and
ss 37C–43) by
No. 74/2014
s. 4.

	*	*	*	*	*	Ss 37C–37G inserted by No. 74/2014 s. 4, repealed by No. 47/2016 s. 9.
	*	*	*	*	*	S. 37H inserted by No. 74/2014 s. 4, amended by No. 20/2016 s. 144, repealed by No. 47/2016 s. 9.
38 Rape						S. 38 substituted by No. 74/2014 s. 4.
(1) A person (A) commits an offence if—						
(a) A intentionally sexually penetrates another person (B); and						
(b) B does not consent to the penetration; and						
(c) A does not reasonably believe that B consents to the penetration.						
(2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).						
	*	*	*	*	*	Note to s. 38(2) inserted by No. 65/2016 s. 20(12), repealed by No. 34/2017 s. 26(1).

S. 38(3)
repealed by
No. 47/2016
s. 10(1),
new s. 38(3)
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 26(2).

- (3) The standard sentence for an offence against subsection (1) is 10 years.

Note to s. 38
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 10(2),
substituted as
Notes by
No. 34/2017
s. 26(3).

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 48A.
- 2 See sections 5A and 5B of the **Sentencing Act 1991** as to standard sentences.
- 3 An offence against subsection (1) is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2G) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence.

S. 39
substituted by
No. 74/2014
s. 4.

39 Rape by compelling sexual penetration

S. 39(1)
substituted by
No. 47/2016
s. 11(1).

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally causes another person (B)—
 - (i) to sexually penetrate A; or
 - (ii) to sexually penetrate themselves; or
 - (iii) to sexually penetrate another person (C) or an animal; or
 - (iv) to be sexually penetrated by C or by an animal; and
 - (b) B does not consent to the sexual penetration; and
 - (c) A does not reasonably believe that B consents to the sexual penetration.

- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).

Note

An offence against subsection (1) is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2G) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence.

Note to s. 39(2) inserted by No. 65/2016 s. 20(13).

* * * * *

S. 39(3) repealed by No. 47/2016 s. 11(2).

Note

Exceptions apply to this offence—see section 48A.

Note to s. 39 inserted by No. 47/2016 s. 11(3).

40 Sexual assault

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally touches another person (B); and
 - (b) the touching is sexual; and
 - (c) B does not consent to the touching; and
 - (d) A does not reasonably believe that B consents to the touching.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 40 substituted by No. 74/2014 s. 4.

* * * * *

S. 40(3)(4) repealed by No. 47/2016 s. 12(1).

Note to s. 40
substituted as
Notes by
No. 47/2016
s. 12(2).

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 48A.
- 2 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the touching was not sexual is not a defence to this offence—see section 48B.

S. 41
inserted by
No. 74/2014
s. 4.

41 Sexual assault by compelling sexual touching

(1) A person (A) commits an offence if—

S. 41(1)(a)
substituted by
No. 47/2016
s. 13(1).

- (a) A intentionally causes another person (B)—
- (i) to touch A; or
 - (ii) to touch themselves; or
 - (iii) to touch another person (C) or an animal; or
 - (iv) to be touched by C or by an animal; and
- (b) the touching is sexual; and
- (c) B does not consent to the touching; and
- (d) A does not reasonably believe that B consents to the touching.

(2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 41(3)(4)
repealed by
No. 47/2016
s. 13(2).

* * * * *

Note to s. 41
substituted as
Notes by
No. 47/2016
s. 13(3).

Notes

- 1 Exceptions apply to this offence—see section 48A.
- 2 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the touching was not sexual is not a defence to this offence—see section 48B.

42 Assault with intent to commit a sexual offence

S. 42
inserted by
No. 74/2014
s. 4.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally applies force to another person (B); and
 - (b) B does not consent to the application of that force; and
 - (c) at the time of applying that force A intends that B take part in a sexual act; and
 - (d) A does not reasonably believe that B would consent to taking part in that sexual act.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).
- (3) A may commit an offence against subsection (1) even if B is not aware of the application of force by A.
- (3A) Whether or not A reasonably believes that B would consent to taking part in a sexual act depends on the circumstances.

S. 42(3A)
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 10.

Note

See section 36B for the effect of intoxication on the standard to be applied in determining whether a person has a reasonable belief.

- (3B) A's belief that B would consent to a sexual act is not reasonable if A does not say or do anything to find out whether B would consent to the sexual act.
- (3C) Subsection (3B) does not apply if—
 - (a) A has a cognitive impairment or mental illness (other than the effects of intoxication that is self-induced within the meaning of section 36B); and

S. 42(3B)
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 10.

S. 42(3C)
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 10.

S. 42(3D)
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 10.

(b) that cognitive impairment or mental illness is a substantial cause of A not saying or doing anything to find out whether B would consent to the sexual act.

(3D) A bears the burden of proving on the balance of probabilities the matters referred to in subsection (3C).

(4) Force for the purposes of subsection (1) may be applied—

(a) directly or indirectly; or

(b) to the body of, or to clothing or equipment worn by, B.

(5) In subsection (1)—

application of force includes—

(a) application of heat, light, electric current or any other form of energy; and

(b) application of matter in solid, liquid or gaseous form.

S. 43
inserted by
No. 74/2014
s. 4.

43 Threat to commit a sexual offence

(1) A person (A) commits an offence if—

(a) A makes to another person (B) a threat to rape or sexually assault B or a third person (C); and

(b) A intends that B will believe, or believes that B will probably believe, that A will carry out the threat.

(2) Words or conduct may constitute a threat for the purposes of subsection (1) if by those words or that conduct an intention to do any of the following is conveyed—

(a) to sexually penetrate or sexually touch B or C without B or C's consent;

(b) to cause B or C, without B or C's consent, to sexually penetrate or sexually touch—

- (i) A; or
- (ii) C or B (as the case requires); or
- (iii) themselves; or
- (iv) another person; or
- (v) an animal;

S. 43(2)(b)(v)
amended by
No. 47/2016
s. 14(1)(a).

(c) to cause B or C, without B or C's consent, to be sexually penetrated or sexually touched by another person or by an animal.

S. 43(2)(c)
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 14(1)(b).

(3) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

(4) For the purposes of this section, a threat may be made by words or conduct and may be explicit or implicit.

S. 43(4)
substituted by
No. 47/2016
s. 14(2).

* * * * *

Note to s. 43
repealed by
No. 47/2016
s. 14(3).

44 Procuring sexual act by threat

New s. 44
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 15.

(1) A person (A) commits an offence if—

- (a) A makes a threat to another person (B) that A will cause harm of any kind to B, another person or an animal; and
- (b) A intends that B will believe, or believes that B will probably believe, that A will cause that harm; and

- (c) as a result of A's threat, B or another person takes part (whether at the time the threat is made or at a later time) in a sexual act with A or another person; and
 - (d) A intends that, as a result of A's threat, an outcome mentioned in paragraph (c) will occur.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
 - (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), a threat may be made by words or conduct and may be explicit or implicit.
 - (4) For the purposes of subsection (1)(c), a person who takes part in a sexual act with A or another person may or may not be the person to whom A has threatened to cause harm.

Note

See section 35C for the meaning of taking part in a sexual act.

New s. 45
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 15.

45 Procuring sexual act by fraud

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A makes a false or misleading representation; and
 - (b) A knows that—
 - (i) the representation is false or misleading; or
 - (ii) the representation is probably false or misleading; and
 - (c) as a result of A's representation, another person (B) takes part (whether at the time the representation is made or at a later time) in a sexual act with A or another person; and

- (d) A intends that, as a result of A's representation, an outcome mentioned in paragraph (c) will occur.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), a false or misleading representation may be made by words or conduct (including by omission) and may be explicit or implicit.

Note

See section 35C for the meaning of taking part in a sexual act.

46 Administration of an intoxicating substance for a sexual purpose

New s. 46
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 15.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A—
 - (i) administers an intoxicating substance to another person (B); or
 - (ii) causes B to take an intoxicating substance; or
 - (iii) causes another person (C) to administer an intoxicating substance to B; and
 - (b) A intends that the intoxicating substance—
 - (i) will impair B's capacity to give, withhold or withdraw consent to taking part in a sexual act; and
 - (ii) will facilitate B taking part in a sexual act with A or another person.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

(3) In this section—

intoxicating substance includes any substance that affects a person's senses or understanding.

Note

See section 35C for the meaning of taking part in a sexual act.

New s. 47
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 15.

47 Abduction or detention for a sexual purpose

(1) A person (A) commits an offence if—

(a) A—

(i) takes away or detains another person (B); or

(ii) causes B to be taken away or detained by another person; and

(b) B does not consent to being taken away or detained; and

(c) A knows that—

(i) B does not consent to being taken away or detained; or

(ii) B probably does not consent to being taken away or detained; and

(d) A intends that—

(i) B will take part in a sexual act with A or another person (C) or both; or

(ii) A or C will marry B (whether or not B consents to being married).

(2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (3) It is immaterial that the law prohibits or would not recognise (for whatever reason) a marriage between A and B or between C and B.

Note

See section 35C for the meaning of taking part in a sexual act.

48 Sexual activity directed at another person

**New s. 48
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 15.**

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A engages in an activity; and
 - (b) the activity is sexual; and
 - (c) another person (B) sees the activity or a part of the activity; and
 - (d) A knows that B will see, or will probably see, the activity or a part of the activity; and
 - (e) A—
 - (i) intends that B will experience fear or distress from seeing the activity or a part of the activity; or
 - (ii) knows that B will experience, or will probably experience, fear or distress from seeing the activity or a part of the activity.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

Note

A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the activity was not sexual is not a defence to this offence—see section 48B.

S. 48A
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 15.

48A Exceptions—medical, hygienic, veterinary, agricultural or scientific purposes

- (1) A does not commit an offence against—
- (a) section 38(1) or 40(1)—if the sexual penetration or touching (as the case requires) is of a person and is done in the course of a procedure carried out in good faith for medical or hygienic purposes; or
 - (b) section 39(1) or 41(1)—if the sexual penetration or touching (as the case requires) is of a person and is caused by A to be done in the course of a procedure carried out in good faith for medical or hygienic purposes.
- (2) A does not commit an offence against section 39(1) or 41(1)—if the sexual penetration or touching (as the case requires) is of an animal and is caused by A to be done in the course of a procedure being carried out in good faith for veterinary or agricultural purposes or scientific research purposes.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in sections 38, 39, 40 and 41.

S. 48B
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 15.

48B No defence of mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that touching or activity was not sexual

It is not a defence to a charge that, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A was under a mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that—

- (a) for an offence against section 40(1) or 41(1)—the touching was not sexual; or

- (b) for an offence against section 48(1)—
the activity was not sexual.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same
A referred to in sections 40, 41 and 48.

(8B) *Sexual offences against children*

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8B)
(Heading and
s. 51)
inserted by
No. 9509 s. 5,
amended by
No. 102/1986
s. 9(a)–(c),
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8B)
(Heading and
s. 44) by
No. 8/1991
s. 3,
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(3)
(Sch. 3
items 3A, 4),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 21),
2/2006 s. 8,
57/2007 s. 8,
52/2014 s. 13,
65/2016
s. 20(14)(15),
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8B)
(Heading and
ss 49A–49ZC)
by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49A Sexual penetration of a child under the age of 12

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—

- (a) A intentionally—

- (i) sexually penetrates another person (B);
or

New s. 49A
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

- (ii) causes or allows B to sexually penetrate A; or
- (iii) causes B—
 - (A) to sexually penetrate themselves; or
 - (B) to sexually penetrate another person (C); or
 - (C) to be sexually penetrated by C; and

(b) B is a child under the age of 12 years.

- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).
- (3) The standard sentence for an offence against subsection (1) is 10 years.

S. 49A(3)
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 27(1).

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 49T.
- 2 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that B was 12 years of age or more is not a defence to this offence—see section 49ZC.
- 3 See sections 5A and 5B of the **Sentencing Act 1991** as to standard sentences.
- 4 An offence against subsection (1) is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2G) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence.

Note 3 to
s. 49A
inserted by
No. 65/2016
s. 24(1),
substituted by
No. 34/2017
s. 27(2).

Note 4 to
s. 49A
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 27(2).

49B Sexual penetration of a child under the age of 16

New s. 49B
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally—
- (i) sexually penetrates another person (B);
or
- (ii) causes or allows B to sexually penetrate
A; or
- (iii) causes B—
- (A) to sexually penetrate themselves;
or
- (B) to sexually penetrate another
person (C); or
- (C) to be sexually penetrated by C;
and
- (b) B is a child under the age of 16 years.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against
subsection (1) is liable to level 4 imprisonment
(15 years maximum).
- (3) The standard sentence for an offence against
subsection (1) is 6 years.

S. 49B(3)
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 28(1).

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 49T.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 49V and 49W.
- 3 See sections 5A and 5B of the **Sentencing Act 1991** as
to standard sentences.

Note 3 to
s. 49B
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 28(2).

New s. 49C
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49C Sexual penetration of a child aged 16 or 17 under care, supervision or authority

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally—
 - (i) sexually penetrates another person (B);
or
 - (ii) causes or allows B to sexually
penetrate A; or
 - (iii) causes B—
 - (A) to sexually penetrate themselves;
or
 - (B) to sexually penetrate another
person (C); or
 - (C) to be sexually penetrated by C;
and
 - (b) B is—
 - (i) a child aged 16 or 17 years; and
 - (ii) under A's care, supervision or authority.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

Notes

- 1 Exceptions apply to this offence—see sections 49T and 49Y.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 49X, 49Z and 49ZA.

S. 49D
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49D Sexual assault of a child under the age of 16

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally—
 - (i) touches another person (B); or
 - (ii) causes or allows B to touch A; or

- (iii) causes B—
 - (A) to touch, or to continue to touch, themselves; or
 - (B) to touch, or to continue to touch, another person (C); or
 - (C) to be touched, or to continue to be touched, by C; and
- (b) B is a child under the age of 16 years; and
- (c) the touching is—
 - (i) sexual; and
 - (ii) contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (2A) The standard sentence for an offence against subsection (1) is 4 years.
- (3) Whether or not the touching is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct depends on the circumstances.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3)—
 - (a) the circumstances include—
 - (i) the purpose of the touching; and
 - (ii) whether A seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from the touching;
 - (b) the circumstances do not include—
 - (i) whether B consents to the touching; or

S. 49D(2A)
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 29(1).

- (ii) whether A believes that B consents to the touching.

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 49U.
- 2 A defence applies to this offence—see section 49W.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the touching was not sexual or contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct is not a defence to this offence—see section 49ZC.
- 4 See sections 5A and 5B of the **Sentencing Act 1991** as to standard sentences.

Note 4 to
s. 49D
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 29(2).

S. 49E
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49E Sexual assault of a child aged 16 or 17 under care, supervision or authority

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally—
 - (i) touches another person (B); or
 - (ii) causes or allows B to touch A; or
 - (iii) causes B—
 - (A) to touch, or to continue to touch, themselves; or
 - (B) to touch, or to continue to touch, another person (C); or
 - (C) to be touched, or to continue to be touched, by C; and
 - (b) B is—
 - (i) a child aged 16 or 17 years; and
 - (ii) under A's care, supervision or authority; and

- (c) the touching is—
 - (i) sexual; and
 - (ii) contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (3) Whether or not the touching is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct depends on the circumstances.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3)—
 - (a) the circumstances include—
 - (i) the purpose of the touching; and
 - (ii) whether A seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from the touching;
 - (b) the circumstances do not include—
 - (i) whether B consents to the touching; or
 - (ii) whether A believes that B consents to the touching.

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 49Y.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 49X, 49Z and 49ZA.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the touching was not sexual or contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct is not a defence to this offence—see section 49ZC.

S. 49F
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49F Sexual activity in the presence of a child under the age of 16

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally engages in an activity; and
 - (b) the activity is sexual; and
 - (c) another person (B) is present when A engages in the activity; and
 - (d) A knows that B is, or probably is, present when A engages in the activity; and
 - (e) B is a child under the age of 16 years; and
 - (f) engaging in the activity in the presence of B is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.

- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 49F(2A)
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 30(1).

- (2A) The standard sentence for an offence against subsection (1) is 4 years.

- (3) Whether or not engaging in the activity in the presence of B is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct depends on the circumstances.

- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3)—
- (a) the circumstances include—
 - (i) the purpose of the activity; and
 - (ii) whether A seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from engaging in the activity or from the presence of B;

- (b) the circumstances do not include—
 - (i) whether B consents—
 - (A) to being present when A engages in the activity; or
 - (B) to A engaging in the activity; or
 - (ii) whether A believes that B consents—
 - (A) to being present when A engages in the activity; or
 - (B) to A engaging in the activity.
- (5) For the purposes of subsection (1), when A engages in an activity, B may be present—
 - (a) in person; or
 - (b) by means of an electronic communication within the meaning of the **Electronic Transactions (Victoria) Act 2000** that is received by B in real time or close to real time.
- (6) It is immaterial that some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as B was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.
- (7) It is immaterial that B was outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as A was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 49U.
- 2 A defence applies to this offence—see section 49W.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the activity was not sexual or that engaging in the activity in the presence of B was not contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct is not a defence to this offence—see section 49ZC.

Note 4 to
s. 49F
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 30(2).

- 4 See sections 5A and 5B of the **Sentencing Act 1991** as to standard sentences.

S. 49G
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49G Sexual activity in the presence of a child aged 16 or 17 under care, supervision or authority

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally engages in an activity; and
 - (b) the activity is sexual; and
 - (c) another person (B) is present when A engages in the activity; and
 - (d) A knows that B is, or probably is, present when A engages in the activity; and
 - (e) B is—
 - (i) a child aged 16 or 17 years; and
 - (ii) under A's care, supervision or authority; and
 - (f) engaging in the activity in the presence of B is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (3) Whether or not engaging in the activity in the presence of B is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct depends on the circumstances.

- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3)—
 - (a) the circumstances include—
 - (i) the purpose of the activity; and
 - (ii) whether A seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from engaging in the activity or from the presence of B;
 - (b) the circumstances do not include—
 - (i) whether B consents—
 - (A) to being present when A engages in the activity; or
 - (B) to A engaging in the activity; or
 - (ii) whether A believes that B consents—
 - (A) to being present when A engages in the activity; or
 - (B) to A engaging in the activity.
- (5) For the purposes of subsection (1), when A engages in an activity, B may be present—
 - (a) in person; or
 - (b) by means of an electronic communication within the meaning of the **Electronic Transactions (Victoria) Act 2000** that is received by B in real time or close to real time.
- (6) It is immaterial that some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as B was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.

- (7) It is immaterial that B was outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as A was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 49Y.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 49X, 49Z and 49ZA.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the activity was not sexual or that engaging in the activity in the presence of B was not contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct is not a defence to this offence—see section 49ZC.

S. 49H
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49H Causing a child under the age of 16 to be present during sexual activity

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) another person (B) engages in an activity;
and
 - (b) the activity is sexual; and
 - (c) another person (C) is present when B engages in the activity; and
 - (d) A intentionally causes or allows C to be present when B engages in the activity; and
 - (e) C is a child under the age of 16 years; and
 - (f) A's causing or allowing C to be present when B engages in the activity is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (2A) The standard sentence for an offence against subsection (1) is 4 years.

S. 49H(2A)
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 31(1).

- (3) Whether or not causing or allowing C to be present when B engages in the activity is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct depends on the circumstances.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3)—
- (a) the circumstances include—
 - (i) the purpose of the activity; and
 - (ii) whether A seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from B engaging in the activity or from the presence of C;
 - (b) the circumstances do not include—
 - (i) whether C consents—
 - (A) to being present when B engages in the activity; or
 - (B) to B engaging in the activity; or
 - (ii) whether A believes that C consents—
 - (A) to being present when B engages in the activity; or
 - (B) to B engaging in the activity.
- (5) For the purposes of subsection (1), when B engages in an activity, C may be present—
- (a) in person; or
 - (b) by means of an electronic communication within the meaning of the **Electronic Transactions (Victoria) Act 2000** that is received by C in real time or close to real time.

- (6) It is immaterial that some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as C was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.
- (7) It is immaterial that C was outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as A was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 49U.
- 2 A defence applies to this offence—see section 49W.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the activity was not sexual or that causing or allowing C to be present when B engages in the activity was not contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct is not a defence to this offence—see section 49ZC.
- 4 See sections 5A and 5B of the **Sentencing Act 1991** as to standard sentences.

Note 4 to
s. 49H
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 31(2).

S. 49I
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49I Causing a child aged 16 or 17 under care, supervision or authority to be present during sexual activity

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) another person (B) engages in an activity;
and
 - (b) the activity is sexual; and
 - (c) another person (C) is present when B engages in the activity; and
 - (d) A intentionally causes or allows C to be present when B engages in the activity; and

- (e) C is—
 - (i) a child aged 16 or 17 years; and
 - (ii) under A's care, supervision or authority; and
 - (f) A's causing or allowing C to be present when B engages in the activity is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (3) Whether or not causing or allowing C to be present when B engages in the activity is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct depends on the circumstances.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3)—
- (a) the circumstances include—
 - (i) the purpose of the activity; and
 - (ii) whether A seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from B engaging in the activity or from the presence of C;
 - (b) the circumstances do not include—
 - (i) whether C consents—
 - (A) to being present when B engages in the activity; or
 - (B) to B engaging in the activity; or
 - (ii) whether A believes that C consents—
 - (A) to being present when B engages in the activity; or
 - (B) to B engaging in the activity.

- (5) For the purposes of subsection (1), when B engages in an activity, C may be present—
 - (a) in person; or
 - (b) by means of an electronic communication within the meaning of the **Electronic Transactions (Victoria) Act 2000** that is received by C in real time or close to real time.
- (6) It is immaterial that some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as C was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.
- (7) It is immaterial that C was outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as A was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 49Y.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 49X, 49Z and 49ZA.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the activity was not sexual or that causing or allowing C to be present when B engages in the activity was not contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct is not a defence to this offence—see section 49ZC.

S. 49J
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49J Persistent sexual abuse of a child under the age of 16

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A sexually abuses another person (B) on at least 3 occasions during a particular period; and
 - (b) B is a child under the age of 16 years during the whole of that period.

- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).
- (2A) The standard sentence for an offence against subsection (1) is 10 years.
- (3) It is not necessary that the alleged acts be of a similar nature or constitute an offence under the same provision.
- (4) It is not necessary to prove conduct constituting sexual abuse with the same degree of specificity as to date, time, place, circumstances or occasion as would be required if the accused were charged with an offence constituted by that conduct instead of an offence against subsection (1).
- (5) For the purposes of subsection (1), A sexually abuses B if A engages in conduct that would involve the commission by A of any of the following—
 - (a) an offence against a provision of Subdivision (8A) (rape, sexual assault and associated sexual offences);
 - (b) an offence against section 49A(1) (sexual penetration of a child under the age of 12);
 - (c) an offence against section 49B(1) (sexual penetration of a child under the age of 16);
 - (d) an offence against section 49D(1) (sexual assault of a child under the age of 16);
 - (e) an offence against section 49F(1) (sexual activity in the presence of a child under the age of 16);

S. 49J(2A)
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 32(1).

- (f) an offence against section 49H(1) (causing a child under the age of 16 to be present during sexual activity);
 - (g) an offence against a provision of Subdivision (8C) (incest).
- (6) Nothing in this section affects the operation of any exception or defence applicable or available to A in respect of the offence constituting the sexual abuse.
- (7) If, on the trial of A for an offence against subsection (1), the jury is not satisfied that A is guilty of that offence but is satisfied that A engaged in conduct during the particular period that constitutes one or more instances of an offence against a provision referred to in subsection (5)—
- (a) the jury—
 - (i) must find A not guilty of the offence against subsection (1); and
 - (ii) may find A guilty of the one or more instances of an offence against a provision referred to in subsection (5); and
 - (b) A is liable to the penalty for any offence of which, in accordance with this subsection, A is found guilty.
- (8) Subsection (7) does not restrict the operation of section 239 of the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009**.

- (9) A prosecution for an offence under subsection (1) must not be commenced without the consent of the Director of Public Prosecutions.

Notes

- 1 See sections 5A and 5B of the **Sentencing Act 1991** as to standard sentences.
- 2 An offence against subsection (1) is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2G) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence.

Note to s. 49J
inserted by
No. 65/2016
s. 24(2),
substituted as
Notes by
No. 34/2017
s. 32(2).

49K Encouraging a child under the age of 16 to engage in, or be involved in, sexual activity

S. 49K
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A is 18 years of age or more; and
 - (b) A encourages another person (B) to engage in, or be involved in, an activity; and
 - (c) the activity is sexual; and
 - (d) B is a child under the age of 16 years; and
 - (e) A seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from—
 - (i) the encouragement; or
 - (ii) the sexual activity that is encouraged.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1) encouraging may be done—
- (a) in person; or
 - (b) by means of an electronic communication within the meaning of the **Electronic Transactions (Victoria) Act 2000**.

- (4) It is not necessary to prove—
 - (a) that B in fact engaged in, or was involved in, the sexual activity that was encouraged; or
 - (b) that any sexual activity that B engaged in, or was involved in, was the same activity that was encouraged; or
 - (c) if B in fact engaged in, or was involved in, sexual activity (whether or not the same activity that was encouraged)—that A was present during that activity.
- (5) Despite anything to the contrary in Division 12, it is not an offence for a person to attempt to commit an offence against subsection (1).
- (6) It is immaterial that some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as B was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.
- (7) It is immaterial that B was outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as A was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.
- (8) In this section—
encourage includes suggest, request, urge and demand.

Notes

- 1 A defence applies to this offence—see section 49W.
- 2 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the activity was not sexual is not a defence to this offence—see section 49ZC.

**49L Encouraging a child aged 16 or 17 under care,
supervision or authority to engage in, or be involved
in, sexual activity**

S. 49L
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A is 18 years of age or more; and
 - (b) A encourages another person (B) to engage in, or be involved in, an activity; and
 - (c) the activity is sexual; and
 - (d) B is—
 - (i) a child aged 16 or 17 years; and
 - (ii) under A's care, supervision or authority; and
 - (e) A seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from—
 - (i) the encouragement; or
 - (ii) the sexual activity that is encouraged.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1) encouraging may be done—
 - (a) in person; or
 - (b) by means of an electronic communication within the meaning of the **Electronic Transactions (Victoria) Act 2000**.
- (4) It is not necessary to prove—
 - (a) that B in fact engaged in, or was involved in, the sexual activity that was encouraged; or
 - (b) that any sexual activity that B engaged in, or was involved in, was the same activity that was encouraged; or

- (c) if B in fact engaged in, or was involved in, sexual activity (whether or not the same activity that was encouraged)—that A was present during that activity.
- (5) Despite anything to the contrary in Division 12, it is not an offence for a person to attempt to commit an offence against subsection (1).
- (6) It is immaterial that some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as B was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.
- (7) It is immaterial that B was outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as A was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.
- (8) In this section—
encourage includes suggest, request, urge and demand.

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 49Y.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 49X, 49Z and 49ZA.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the activity was not sexual is not a defence to this offence—see section 49ZC.

49M Grooming for sexual conduct with a child under the age of 16

**S. 49M
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A is 18 years of age or more; and
 - (b) A communicates, by words or conduct (whether or not a response is made to the communication), with—
 - (i) another person (B) who is a child under the age of 16 years; or
 - (ii) another person (C) under whose care, supervision or authority B is; and
 - (c) A intends that the communication facilitate B engaging or being involved in the commission of a sexual offence by A or by another person who is 18 years of age or more.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (3) A does not intend to facilitate B engaging or being involved in the commission of a sexual offence by A or by another person who is 18 years of age or more if, were the conduct constituting the sexual offence to occur, A or the other person would satisfy an exception, or have a defence, to that sexual offence.
- (4) It is immaterial that some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as B or C was, or B and C were, in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.

- (5) It is immaterial that B or C was, or B and C were, outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as A was in Victoria at the time that conduct occurred.
- (6) It is immaterial that A, B and C were all outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as A intended that the sexual offence would occur in Victoria.
- (7) In this section—

communication includes an electronic communication within the meaning of the **Electronic Transactions (Victoria) Act 2000**;

sexual offence means—

- (a) an offence against a provision of Subdivision (8A), this Subdivision (other than section 49K(1) or this section), (8C), (8D), (8E), (8F) or (8FA); or
- (b) an attempt to commit an offence covered by paragraph (a); or
- (c) an assault with intent to commit an offence referred to in paragraph (a).

S. 49N
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49N Loitering near schools etc. by sexual offender

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A has been found guilty of a relevant offence; and
 - (b) A loiters at or near a place; and

- (c) the place is—
- (i) a school, a children's service centre or an education and care service premises; or
 - (ii) a public place within the meaning of the **Summary Offences Act 1966** regularly frequented by children and in which children are present at the time of the loitering; and
- (d) A knows that the place is—
- (i) a school, a children's service centre or an education and care service premises; or
 - (ii) a public place within the meaning of the **Summary Offences Act 1966** regularly frequented by children and in which children are present at the time of the loitering.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (3) In this section—

children's services centre means a place at which a children's service within the meaning of the **Children's Services Act 1996** operates;

education and care service premises means a place at which an education and care service (other than a family day care service) within the meaning of the Education and Care Services National Law (Victoria) educates or cares for children;

S. 49N(3)
def. of
*relevant
offence*
amended by
No. 7/2022
s. 40(a).

relevant offence means—

- (a) a sexual offence; or
- (b) murder where there are reasonable grounds to believe that a sexual offence was also committed on the victim; or
- (c) an offence against—
 - (i) section 5, 6, 7 or 11 of the **Sex Work Act 1994** despite its repeal by the **Sex Work Decriminalisation Act 2022**; or
 - (ii) section 6, 7, 8 or 9 of the **Prostitution Regulation Act 1986**; or
 - (iii) section 59(1)(a) or (b) or 60 inserted in this Act on 1 March 1981 by section 5 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1980** and repealed on 5 August 1991 by section 3 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1991**; or
 - (iv) section 19 of the **Summary Offences Act 1966**; or
 - (v) any of the following provisions as in force at any time before its repeal—
 - (A) section 60A of the **Classification of Films and Publications Act 1990**;
 - (B) section 57A of the **Classification (Publications, Films and Computer Games) (Enforcement) Act 1995**;

(C) section 168A, 168B or 168C
of the **Police Offences
Act 1958**; or

(vi) a provision referred to in
paragraphs (dam), (dama) or (dan)
of clause 1 of Schedule 1 to the
Sentencing Act 1991 or of
attempting to commit an offence
against a provision referred to in
paragraph (dama); or

(vii) section 51B(1), 51C(1), 51D(1),
51G(1) or 51H(1) or of attempting
to commit an offence against
section 51C(1);

sexual offence means—

S. 49N(3)
def. of *sexual
offence*
amended by
No. 7/2022
s. 40(b).

(a) an offence against section 38(1), 39(1),
40(1), 41(1), 47(1), 48(1), 49A(1),
49B(1), 49C(1), 49D(1), 49E(1),
49F(1), 49G(1), 49H(1), 49I(1), 49J(1),
49O(1), 50C(1), 50D(1), 50F(1),
53H(1), 53I(1), 53J(1) or 53K(1); or

(b) an offence against a provision referred
to in clause 7A, 7B, 8, 9, 10, 11A 11B,
11D(b), 11D(c), 11D(d), 11D(g),
11D(h), 11E, 11F or 12 of Schedule 8;
or

(c) an offence against section 44(1),
(2) or (4) (incest) as inserted in the
Crimes Act 1958 on 5 August 1991
by section 3 of the **Crimes (Sexual
Offences) Act 1991** and repealed by
section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment
(Sexual Offences) Act 2016**; or

- (d) an offence of conspiracy to commit, incitement to commit or attempting to commit an offence referred to in paragraph (a), (b) or (c).
- (4) If A has at any time been found guilty of an offence against a law of another State or a Territory of the Commonwealth which creates an offence substantially similar to a sexual offence, that finding of guilt must be taken for the purposes of this section to be a finding of guilt of a sexual offence.

Note

An exception applies to this offence—see section 49ZB.

S. 49O
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49O Failure by a person in authority to protect a child from a sexual offence

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A occupies a position within, or in relation to, a relevant organisation; and
 - (b) there is a substantial risk that a relevant child will become the victim of a sexual offence committed by another person who is—
 - (i) 18 years of age or more; and
 - (ii) a person associated with the relevant organisation; and
 - (c) A knows that the risk exists; and
 - (d) A, by reason of A's position, has the power or responsibility to reduce or remove that risk; and
 - (e) A negligently fails to reduce or remove that risk.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), a person negligently fails to reduce or remove a risk if that failure involves a great falling short of the standard of care that a reasonable person would exercise in the circumstances.
- (4) For the avoidance of doubt, in a prosecution for an offence against subsection (1), it is not necessary to prove that a sexual offence has been committed.
- (5) It is immaterial that some or all of the circumstances constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as the relevant child was in Victoria at any time while the substantial risk referred to in subsection (1)(b) existed.
- (6) It is immaterial that both A and the relevant child were outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the circumstances constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as the sexual offence was at risk of occurring in Victoria.
- (7) In this section—

person associated, in relation to a relevant organisation, includes but is not limited to a person who is an officer, employee, manager, owner, volunteer, contractor or agent of the organisation but does not include a person only because the person receives services from the organisation;

relevant child means a child (whether identifiable or not) under the age of 16 years who is, or may come, under the care, supervision or authority of a relevant organisation;

relevant organisation means—

- (a) an organisation that exercises care, supervision or authority over children, whether as its primary function or

otherwise, and includes but is not limited to—

- (i) a church; and
 - (ii) a religious body; and
 - (iii) a school; and
 - (iv) an education and care service within the meaning of the Education and Care Services National Law (Victoria); and
 - (v) a children's service within the meaning of the **Children's Services Act 1996**; and
 - (vi) an out of home care service within the meaning of the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005**; and
 - (vii) a hospital; and
 - (viii) a government department; and
 - (ix) a government agency; and
 - (x) a municipal council; and
 - (xi) a public sector body; and
 - (xii) a sporting group; and
 - (xiii) a youth organisation; and
 - (xiv) a charity or benevolent organisation; or
- (b) an organisation that, in accordance with an agreement or arrangement with an organisation referred to in paragraph (a), is required or permitted to engage in activities associated with the care, supervision or authority over

children exercised by the organisation
referred to in paragraph (a);

sexual offence means—

- (a) an offence against a provision of Subdivision (8A), this Subdivision (other than this section), (8C), (8D), (8E), (8F) or (8FA); or
- (b) an attempt to commit an offence covered by paragraph (a) (other than section 49K); or
- (c) an assault with intent to commit an offence covered by paragraph (a).

49P Abduction or detention of a child under the age of 16 for a sexual purpose

S. 49P
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

(1) A person (A) commits an offence if—

- (a) A—
 - (i) takes away or detains another person (B); or
 - (ii) causes B to be taken away or detained by another person; and
- (b) B is a child under the age of 16 years; and
- (c) the person who has lawful charge of B (C) does not consent to B being taken away or detained; and
- (d) A knows that—
 - (i) B is a child under the age of 16 years; or
 - (ii) B is probably a child under the age of 16 years; and
- (e) A knows that—
 - (i) C does not consent to B being taken away or detained; or

- (ii) C probably does not consent to B being taken away or detained; and
 - (f) A intends B will take part in a sexual act with A or another person or both; and
 - (g) B taking part in the sexual act would involve the commission by A, or the other person, or both, of an offence against section 38(1), 39(1), 40(1), 41(1) or a provision of this Subdivision (other than this section).
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

Note

See section 35C for the meaning of taking part in a sexual act.

S. 49Q
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49Q Causing or allowing a sexual performance involving a child

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally causes or allows another person (B) to take part in a sexual performance; and
 - (b) the sexual performance occurs in circumstances that involve any person receiving payment, reward or other benefit (whether before or after the performance) in respect of the performance; and
 - (c) B is a child under the age of 18 years.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

(3) In this section—

sexual performance means a live performance (whether in person or by an electronic communication within the meaning of the **Electronic Transactions (Victoria) Act 2000**) that is, or could reasonably be considered to be, for the sexual arousal or sexual gratification of any person.

Notes

- 1 A defence applies to this offence—see section 49X.
- 2 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the sexual performance did not occur in circumstances that involved payment, reward or other benefit to any person is not a defence to this offence—see section 49ZC.

49R Inviting or offering a sexual performance involving a child

**S. 49R
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally—
 - (i) invites another person (B) to take part in a sexual performance; or
 - (ii) offers to a third person that B will take part in a sexual performance; and
 - (b) the invitation or offer involves any person receiving payment, reward or other benefit (whether before or after the performance) in respect of the performance; and
 - (c) B is a child under the age of 18 years.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

(3) In this section—

sexual performance means a live performance (whether in person or by an electronic communication within the meaning of the **Electronic Transactions (Victoria) Act 2000**) that is, or could reasonably be considered to be, for the sexual arousal or sexual gratification of any person.

Notes

- 1 A defence applies to this offence—see section 49X.
- 2 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that the invitation or offer did not involve payment, reward or other benefit to any person is not a defence to this offence—see section 49ZC.

S. 49S
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49S Facilitating a sexual offence against a child

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A engages in conduct that aids, facilitates or contributes in any way to another person (B) engaging in sexual conduct (whether or not in Victoria) in relation to a child; and
 - (b) A engages in the conduct with the intention of obtaining a benefit for A or another person (C); and
 - (c) A—
 - (i) intends that the conduct will aid, facilitate or contribute in any way to B engaging in sexual conduct in relation to a child; or
 - (ii) knows that the conduct will, or probably will, aid, facilitate or contribute in any way to B engaging in sexual conduct in relation to a child; and

- (d) B's engaging in sexual conduct in relation to a child—
 - (i) constitutes an offence against section 38(1), 39(1), 40(1), 41(1) or a provision of this Subdivision (other than this section); or
 - (ii) constitutes an offence against a provision of Division 272 of Chapter 8 of the Criminal Code of the Commonwealth; or
 - (iii) takes place outside Victoria but would, if the conduct occurred in Victoria, constitute an offence against a provision covered by subparagraph (i) whether or not it constitutes an offence in the place in which it takes place.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum).
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), conduct that aids, facilitates or contributes in any way to another person engaging in sexual conduct in relation to a child includes—
 - (a) making travel arrangements; and
 - (b) causing or allowing a child to enter or remain on premises which A owns, occupies, manages or assists in managing.

Note

A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that B's engaging in sexual conduct in relation to a child did not constitute an offence or, if the conduct takes place outside Victoria, would not constitute an offence, is not a defence to this offence—see section 49ZC.

S. 49T
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49T Exception to sexual penetration offences—medical or hygienic purposes

A does not commit an offence against section 49A(1), 49B(1) or 49C(1) if A's conduct occurs in the course of a procedure carried out in good faith for medical or hygienic purposes.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in sections 49A, 49B and 49C.

S. 49U
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49U Exceptions to offences against children under 16—similarity in age

- (1) A does not commit an offence against section 49D(1) or 49F(1) if, at the time at which the offence is alleged to have been committed—
 - (a) A is not more than 2 years older than B; and
 - (b) B is 12 years of age or more.
- (2) A does not commit an offence against section 49H(1) if, at the time at which the offence is alleged to have been committed—
 - (a) A is not more than 2 years older than C; and
 - (b) C is 12 years of age or more.

Note

References to A, B and C in this section are references to the same A, B and C referred to in sections 49D, 49F and 49H.

S. 49V
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49V Defence to offence against a child under 16—similarity in age

It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 49B(1) if, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence—

- (a) A was not more than 2 years older than B; and

- (b) B was 12 years of age or more; and
- (c) B consented to the sexual penetration.

Note

References to A and B in this section are references to the same A and B referred to in section 49B.

**49W Defences to offences against children under 16—
reasonable belief as to age**

**S. 49W
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 49B(1), 49D(1) or 49F(1) if, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence—
 - (a) B was 12 years of age or more; and
 - (b) A reasonably believed that B was 16 years of age or more.
- (2) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 49H(1) if, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence—
 - (a) C was 12 years of age or more; and
 - (b) A reasonably believed that C was 16 years of age or more.
- (3) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 49K(1) if, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A reasonably believed that B was 16 years of age or more.
- (4) A bears the burden of proving (on the balance of probabilities) the matter referred to in subsection (1)(b), (2)(b) or (3).

Notes

- 1 References to A, B and C in this section are references to the same A, B and C referred to in sections 49B, 49D, 49F, 49H and 49K.
- 2 Whether or not A reasonably believed that B or C was 16 years of age or more depends on the circumstances. The circumstances include any steps that A took to find out B or C's age.

S. 49X
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

- 3 An evidential burden applies to the matters referred to in subsections (1)(a) and (2)(a).

49X Defences to offences against children aged 16 or 17 or under 18—reasonable belief as to age

- (1) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 49C(1), 49E(1), 49G(1) or 49L(1) if, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A reasonably believed that B was 18 years of age or more.
- (2) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 49I(1) if, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A reasonably believed that C was 18 years of age or more.
- (3) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 49Q(1) or 49R(1) if, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence—
 - (a) B was 12 years of age or more; and
 - (b) A reasonably believed that B was 18 years of age or more.
- (4) A bears the burden of proving (on the balance of probabilities) the matter referred to in subsection (1), (2) or (3)(b).

Notes

- 1 References to A, B and C in this section are references to the same A, B and C referred to in sections 49C, 49E, 49G, 49I, 49L, 49Q and 49R.
- 2 Whether or not A reasonably believed that B or C was 18 years of age or more depends on the circumstances. The circumstances include any steps that A took to find out B or C's age.
- 3 An evidential burden applies to the matter referred to in subsection (3)(a).

49Y Exceptions to offences against children aged 16 or 17—marriage or domestic partnership

**S. 49Y
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) A does not commit an offence against section 49C(1), 49E(1), 49G(1) or 49L(1) if, at the time at which the offence is alleged to have been committed—
 - (a) A and B are married to each other and the marriage is recognised as valid under the Marriage Act 1961 of the Commonwealth; or
 - (b) A—
 - (i) is not more than 5 years older than B; and
 - (ii) is B's domestic partner and the domestic partnership commenced before B came under A's care, supervision or authority.
- (2) A does not commit an offence against section 49I(1) if, at the time at which the offence is alleged to have been committed—
 - (a) A and C are married to each other and the marriage is recognised as valid under the Marriage Act 1961 of the Commonwealth; or
 - (b) A—
 - (i) is not more than 5 years older than C; and
 - (ii) is C's domestic partner and the domestic partnership commenced before C came under A's care, supervision or authority.

Note

References to A, B and C in this section are references to the same A, B and C referred to in sections 49C, 49E, 49G, 49I and 49L.

S. 49Z
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

**49Z Defences to offences against children aged 16
or 17—reasonable belief as to marriage or domestic
partnership**

- (1) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 49C(1), 49E(1), 49G(1) or 49L(1) if, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence—
 - (a) A reasonably believed that A and B were married to each other and that the marriage was recognised as valid under the Marriage Act 1961 of the Commonwealth; or
 - (b) A—
 - (i) was not more than 5 years older than B; and
 - (ii) reasonably believed that A was B's domestic partner and that the domestic partnership commenced before B came under A's care, supervision or authority.
- (2) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 49I(1) if, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence—
 - (a) A reasonably believed that A and C were married to each other and that the marriage was recognised as valid under the Marriage Act 1961 of the Commonwealth; or
 - (b) A—
 - (i) was not more than 5 years older than C; and
 - (ii) reasonably believed that A was C's domestic partner and that the domestic partnership commenced before C came under A's care, supervision or authority.

- (3) A bears the burden of proving (on the balance of probabilities) the matter referred to in subsection (1)(a) or (b)(ii) or (2)(a) or (b)(ii).

Notes

- 1 References to A, B and C in this section are references to the same A, B and C referred to in sections 49C, 49E, 49G, 49I and 49L.
- 2 An evidential burden applies to the matters referred to in subsections (1)(b)(i) and (2)(b)(i).

49ZA Defences to offences against children aged 16 or 17—reasonable belief as to care, supervision or authority

**S. 49ZA
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 49C(1), 49E(1), 49G(1) or 49L(1) if, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A reasonably believed that B was not under A's care, supervision or authority.
- (2) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 49I(1) if, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A reasonably believed that C was not under A's care, supervision or authority.
- (3) A bears the burden of proving (on the balance of probabilities) the matter referred to in subsection (1) or (2).

Note

References to A, B and C in this section are references to the same A, B and C referred to in sections 49C, 49E, 49G, 49I and 49L.

S. 49ZB
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49ZB Exception to loitering offence

A does not commit an offence against section 49N(1) if A has a reasonable excuse for loitering at or near a place referred to in section 49N(1)(c).

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in section 49N.

S. 49ZC
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

49ZC No defence of mistaken but honest and reasonable belief of certain matters

It is not a defence to a charge that, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A was under a mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that—

- (a) for an offence against section 49A(1)—
B was 12 years of age or more; or
- (b) for an offence against section 49D(1)
or 49E(1)—the touching was not—
 - (i) sexual; or
 - (ii) contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct; or
- (c) for an offence against section 49F(1)
or 49G(1)—
 - (i) the activity was not sexual; or
 - (ii) engaging in the activity in the presence of B was not contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct; or
- (d) for an offence against section 49H(1)
or 49I(1)—
 - (i) the activity was not sexual; or
 - (ii) A's causing or allowing C to be present when B engages in the activity was not contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct; or

- (e) for an offence against section 49K(1) or 49L(1)—the activity was not sexual; or
- (f) for an offence against section 49Q(1)—the sexual performance did not occur in circumstances that involved payment, reward or other benefit to any person in respect of the performance; or
- (g) for an offence against section 49R(1)—the invitation or offer did not involve payment, reward or other benefit to any person in respect of the performance; or
- (h) for an offence against section 49S(1)—B's engaging in sexual conduct in relation to a child did not constitute an offence or, if the conduct takes place outside Victoria, would not constitute an offence.

Note

References to A, B and C in this section are references to the same A, B and C referred to in sections 49A, 49D, 49E, 49F, 49G, 49H, 49I, 49K, 49L, 49Q, 49R and 49S.

(8C) *Incest*

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8C)
(Heading and
ss 52, 53)
inserted by
No. 9509 s. 5,
amended²,
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8C)
(Heading and
ss 50A–50K)
by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

50A Definitions

In this Subdivision—

child, in relation to a person, means—

- (a) the person's child by birth; or
- (b) the person's genetic child; or

S. 50A
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

(c) the person's child by operation of the **Adoption Act 1984**; or

(d) the person's child by operation of the **Status of Children Act 1974**;

half-sibling, in relation to a person, means a person who shares a common parent with the person;

lineal ancestor, in relation to a person, means a lineal ancestor of the person's parent;

lineal descendant, in relation to a person, means a lineal descendant of the person's child;

parent, in relation to a person, means—

(a) the person's birth parent; or

(b) the person's genetic parent; or

(c) the person's parent by operation of the **Adoption Act 1984**; or

(d) the person's parent by operation of the **Status of Children Act 1974**;

sibling, in relation to a person, means a person who has the same parents as the person;

step-parent, in relation to a person, means the spouse or domestic partner of the person's parent, being a person who is not the person's parent.

S. 50B
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

50B Rebuttable presumption as to family relationship

In a proceeding for an offence against a provision of this Subdivision, there is a rebuttable presumption that—

(a) A knows that A is related to B in the way alleged; and

- (b) people who are reputed to be related to each other in a particular way are in fact related in that way.

50C Sexual penetration of a child or lineal descendant

S. 50C
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally—
- (i) sexually penetrates another person (B);
or
- (ii) causes or allows B to sexually penetrate A; and
- (b) B is A's child or lineal descendant; and
- (c) A knows that B is A's child or lineal descendant.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).
- (3) The standard sentence for an offence against subsection (1) is 10 years if B is, at the time of the offence, under the age of 18 years.

S. 50C(3)
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 33(1).

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 50G.
- 2 A defence applies to this offence—see section 50H.
- 3 B's consent is not a defence to this offence—see section 50K.
- 4 See sections 5A and 5B of the **Sentencing Act 1991** as to standard sentences.
- 5 An offence against subsection (1) is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991** if B is, at the time of the offence, under the age of 18 years. See section 5(2G) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence.

Note 4 to
s. 50C
inserted by
No. 65/2016
s. 24(3),
substituted by
No. 34/2017
s. 33(2).

Note 5 to
s. 50C
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 33(2).

S. 50D
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

50D Sexual penetration of a step-child

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally—
 - (i) sexually penetrates another person (B);
or
 - (ii) causes or allows B to sexually penetrate
A; and
 - (b) B is a child or lineal descendant of A's
spouse or domestic partner; and
 - (c) A knows that B is a child or lineal
descendant of A's spouse or domestic
partner.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against
subsection (1) is liable to level 2 imprisonment
(25 years maximum).
- (3) The standard sentence for an offence against
subsection (1) is 10 years if B is, at the time
of the offence, under the age of 18 years.

S. 50D(3)
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 34(1).

Notes

- 1 Exceptions apply to this offence—see sections 50G and 50I.
- 2 A defence applies to this offence—see section 50H.
- 3 B's consent is not a defence to this offence—see section 50K.
- 4 See sections 5A and 5B of the **Sentencing Act 1991** as to
standard sentences.

Note 4 to
s. 50D
inserted by
No. 65/2016
s. 24(4),
substituted by
No. 34/2017
s. 34(2).

- 5 An offence against subsection (1) is a category 1 offence
under the **Sentencing Act 1991** if B is, at the time of the
offence, under the age of 18 years. See section 5(2G) of
that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for
this offence.

Note 5 to
s. 50D
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 34(2).

50E Sexual penetration of a parent, lineal ancestor or step-parent

**S. 50E
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally—
 - (i) sexually penetrates another person (B);
or
 - (ii) causes or allows B to sexually penetrate A; and
 - (b) A is 18 years of age or more; and
 - (c) B is A's parent, lineal ancestor or step-parent; and
 - (d) A knows that B is A's parent, lineal ancestor or step-parent.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

Notes

- 1 Exceptions apply to this offence—see sections 50G and 50J.
- 2 A defence applies to this offence—see section 50H.
- 3 B's consent is not a defence to this offence—see section 50K.

50F Sexual penetration of a sibling or half-sibling

**S. 50F
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally—
 - (i) sexually penetrates another person (B);
or
 - (ii) causes or allows B to sexually penetrate A; and
 - (b) B is A's sibling or half-sibling; and
 - (c) A knows that B is A's sibling or half-sibling.

- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 50G.
- 2 A defence applies to this offence—see section 50H.
- 3 B's consent is not a defence to this offence—see section 50K.

S. 50G
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

50G Exception—medical or hygienic purposes

A does not commit an offence against a provision of this Subdivision if A's conduct occurs in the course of a procedure carried out in good faith for medical or hygienic purposes.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in the offence provisions in this Subdivision.

S. 50H
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

50H Defence—accused did not consent

It is a defence to a charge for an offence against a provision of this Subdivision if A did not consent to the conduct constituting the offence.

Notes

- 1 The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in the offence provisions in this Subdivision.
- 2 A person may intentionally engage in conduct but not consent to it—see section 36AA. For example, B threatens to hurt A if A does not allow B to sexually penetrate A. A intentionally allows B to sexually penetrate A because A is afraid of harm. A did not consent to the conduct constituting the offence.

**Note 2 to
s. 50H**
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 12.

S. 50I
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

50I Exception to offences against section 50D

A does not commit an offence against section 50D(1) if, at the time at which the offence is alleged to have been committed—

- (a) B is 18 years of age or more; and
- (b) A has not engaged in sexual activity with B when B was under 18 years of age; and

- (c) B has not at any time been under A's care, supervision or authority.

Note

References to A and B in this section are references to the same A and B referred to in section 50D.

50J Exceptions to offences against section 50E

S. 50J
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

- (1) A does not commit an offence against section 50E(1) if, at the time at which the offence is alleged to have been committed—
- (a) B is A's step-parent; and
 - (b) A has not at any time been under B's care, supervision or authority.
- (2) A does not commit an offence against section 50E(1) if B engaged in sexual activity with A when A was under 18 years of age.

Note

References to A and B in this section are references to the same A and B referred to in section 50E.

50K Consent not a defence

S. 50K
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

It is not a defence to a charge for an offence against a provision of this Subdivision that B consented to the conduct constituting the offence.

Note

The reference to B in this section is a reference to the same B referred to in the offence provisions in this Subdivision.

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8D)
(Heading and
ss 54–57)
inserted by
No. 9509 s. 5,
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8D)
(Heading and
ss 50–52) by
No. 8/1991
s. 3,
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(3)
(Sch. 3
items 8, 9),
98/1995
s. 65(Sch. 1
item 3),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
items 28, 29),
2/2006 ss 14–
17, 23/2006
s. 236(1)(2),
49/2010
ss 227, 228,
26/2014
s. 455(Sch.
item 7.1),
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8D)
(Heading and
ss 51A–51Y)
by
No. 47/2016
s.16.

(8D) *Child abuse material*

S. 51A
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

51A Definitions

(1) In this Subdivision—

administer, in relation to a website, includes
building, developing and maintaining the
website but does not include hosting the
website;

authorised classifier means a person, or a person
who belongs to a class of person, prescribed
by the regulations for the purposes of this
definition;

child means a person under the age of 18 years;

child abuse material means material that—

(a) depicts or describes—

(i) a person who is, or who appears or is implied to be, a child—

(A) as a victim of torture, cruelty or physical abuse (whether or not the torture, cruelty or abuse is sexual); or

(B) as a victim of sexual abuse; or

(C) engaged in, or apparently engaging in, a sexual pose or sexual activity (whether or not in the presence of another person); or

(D) in the presence of another person who is engaged in, or apparently engaged in, a sexual pose or sexual activity; or

(ii) the genital or anal region of a person who is, or who appears or is implied to be, a child; or

(iii) the breast area of a person who is, or who appears or is implied to be, a female child; and

(b) reasonable persons would regard as being, in the circumstances, offensive;

child abuse material disposal order means an order made under section 51X(1);

child abuse material offence means an offence against a provision of this Subdivision;

classified means classified under the Commonwealth Act;

Commonwealth Act means the Classification (Publications, Films and Computer Games) Act 1995 of the Commonwealth;

deal, in relation to child abuse material, includes any of the following—

- (a) viewing, uploading or downloading child abuse material;
- (b) making child abuse material available for viewing, uploading or downloading;
- (c) facilitating the viewing, uploading or downloading of child abuse material;

distribute, in relation to material, includes—

- (a) publishing the material; and
- (b) exhibiting, communicating, sending, supplying or transmitting the material to any other person; and
- (c) making the material available for access by any other person;

electronic material includes data from which text, images or sound may be generated;

encourage includes suggest, request, urge and demand;

law enforcement agency means—

- (a) Victoria Police or the police force or police service of any other State or of the Northern Territory of Australia; or
- (b) the Australian Federal Police; or

S. 51A(1)
def. of
distribute
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 20(1).

- (c) the Australian Crime Commission established by the Australian Crime Commission Act 2002 of the Commonwealth; or
- (d) any other authority or person responsible for the enforcement of the laws of—
 - (i) Victoria or any other State; or
 - (ii) the Commonwealth; or
 - (iii) the Australian Capital Territory; or
 - (iv) the Northern Territory of Australia;

material means—

- (a) any film, audio, photograph, printed matter, image, computer game or text; or
- (b) any electronic material; or
- (c) any other thing of any kind;

Note

See also subsection (2).

police officer includes a member of the Australian Federal Police;

relevant industry regulatory authority means a person or body prescribed to be a relevant industry regulatory authority for the purposes of section 51S(2)(d);

seized thing means a thing that came into the possession of a police officer in the course of the exercise of functions as a police officer;

website includes a page, or a group of pages, on the Internet.

S. 51A(2)
substituted by
No. 38/2022
s. 20(2).

- (2) For the purposes of this Subdivision, an image may be still, moving, recorded or unrecorded.

S. 51B
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

51B Involving a child in the production of child abuse material

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally involves another person (B) in the production of material; and
 - (b) B is a child; and
 - (c) A knows that B is, or probably is, a child; and
 - (d) the material is child abuse material; and
 - (e) A knows that the material is, or probably is, child abuse material.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), the ways in which A involves B in the production of material may include—
- (a) inviting or encouraging B to be involved, or offering B to be involved, in the production of the material; or
 - (b) causing or allowing B to be involved in the production of the material; or
 - (c) using B in the production of the material.

Notes

- 1 B need not be described or depicted in the material.
- 2 Exceptions apply to this offence—see sections 51J, 51K and 51M.
- 3 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 51L, 51N, 51O, 51P, 51Q and 51R.

- 4 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that reasonable persons would not regard the child abuse material as offensive is not a defence to this offence—see section 51U.

51C Producing child abuse material

S. 51C
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally produces material; and
 - (b) the material is child abuse material; and
 - (c) A knows that the material is, or probably is, child abuse material.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), the ways in which material is produced may include—
- (a) filming, printing, photographing, recording, writing, drawing or otherwise generating material; or
 - (b) altering or manipulating material; or
 - (c) reproducing or copying material.

Notes

- 1 Exceptions apply to this offence—see sections 51J, 51K and 51M.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 51L, 51N, 51O, 51P, 51Q and 51R.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that reasonable persons would not regard the child abuse material as offensive is not a defence to this offence—see section 51U.

51D Distributing child abuse material

S. 51D
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A intentionally distributes material; and
 - (b) the material is child abuse material; and
 - (c) A knows that the material is, or probably is, child abuse material.

- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (3) It is not necessary to prove—
 - (a) the identity of any person to whom the material was distributed; or
 - (b) that another person in fact accessed the material.
- (4) It is immaterial that some or all of the child abuse material was distributed outside Victoria, so long as A was in Victoria at some or all of the time at which the material was distributed.
- (5) It is immaterial that A was outside Victoria at some or all of time at which the material was distributed, so long as some or all of the material was distributed in Victoria.

Notes

**Note 1 to
s. 51D
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 21.**

- 1 See section 51A(1) for the meaning of *distribute*.
- 2 Exceptions apply to this offence—see sections 51J, 51K and 51M.
- 3 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 51L, 51P, 51Q and 51R.
- 4 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that reasonable persons would not regard the child abuse material as offensive is not a defence to this offence—see section 51U.

**S. 51E
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

51E Administering a website used to deal with child abuse material

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A administers, or assists in the administration of, a website; and
 - (b) the website is used by another person to deal with child abuse material; and

(c) A—

- (i) intends that the website be used by another person to deal with child abuse material; or
- (ii) is aware that the website is being used by another person to deal with child abuse material.

Examples

- 1 A manages membership of a website. A intends that the website be used by other persons to view child abuse material.
 - 2 A monitors traffic through a website and ensures that the web server hardware and software are running correctly. A is aware that the website is being used by other persons to download child abuse material.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
 - (3) It is not necessary to prove the identity of the person using the website to deal with child abuse material.
 - (4) It is immaterial that some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria or that a computer or device used in connection with administering the website was outside Victoria, so long as—
 - (a) the person using the website to deal with child abuse material was in Victoria; or
 - (b) the computer or device used to deal with child abuse material was in Victoria.
 - (5) It is immaterial that the person using the website to deal with child abuse material was outside Victoria or that the computer or device used to deal with child abuse material was outside Victoria, so long as—

- (a) some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred in Victoria; or
- (b) a computer or device used in connection with administering the website was in Victoria.

Notes

- 1 Exceptions apply to this offence—see sections 51J, 51K and 51S.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see section 51L.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that reasonable persons would not regard the child abuse material as offensive is not a defence to this offence—see section 51U.

S. 51F
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

51F Encouraging use of a website to deal with child abuse material

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A is 18 years of age or more; and
 - (b) A encourages another person to use a website; and
 - (c) A intends that the other person use the website to deal with child abuse material.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (3) In determining whether A has encouraged another person to use a website to deal with child abuse material, it is not necessary to prove—
 - (a) the identity of the person encouraged to use the website to deal with child abuse material; or
 - (b) that another person in fact used the website to deal with child abuse material; or

- (c) if another person did in fact use the website to deal with child abuse material, that it was A's encouragement that caused the person to do so.
- (4) Despite anything to the contrary in Division 12, it is not an offence for a person to attempt to commit an offence against subsection (1).
- (5) It is immaterial that some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as the person being encouraged was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.
- (6) It is immaterial that the person being encouraged was outside Victoria at the time the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as some or all of that conduct occurred in Victoria.

Notes

- 1 If an adult uses a child as an innocent agent to encourage another person to use a website, intending that the other person use the website to deal with child abuse material, the adult commits an offence against subsection (1).
- 2 Exceptions apply to this offence—see sections 51J and 51K.
- 3 A defence applies to this offence—see section 51L.
- 4 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that reasonable persons would not regard the child abuse material as offensive is not a defence to this offence—see section 51U.

51G Possession of child abuse material

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if A knowingly possesses child abuse material.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

**S. 51G
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), A possesses child abuse material that is electronic material if A controls access to the material whether or not A has physical possession of the electronic material.
- (4) It is immaterial that the electronic material was outside Victoria, so long as A was in Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred.
- (5) It is immaterial that A was outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as the electronic material was in Victoria.

Examples

- 1 A has an online storage account for electronic material accessible with a username and password. A has control of what is stored in the account and can move material around within the account or delete material from the account. A has an electronic folder in the account that A has titled 'personal' in which A puts some electronic child abuse material. A knowingly has possession of child abuse material.
- 2 In an online chat A is given a password for a joint email account that is shared with multiple users that A doesn't know. A logs into the email account and views emails that contain child abuse material images. While logged in A has the ability to view, move or delete emails that contain child abuse material. A continues to access the email account to view images. A knowingly has possession of child abuse material.

Notes

- 1 Exceptions apply to this offence—see sections 51J, 51K and 51M.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 51L, 51N, 51O, 51P, 51Q, 51R and 51T.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that reasonable persons would not regard the child abuse material as offensive is not a defence to this offence—see section 51U.

51H Accessing child abuse material

**S. 51H
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally accesses material; and
 - (b) the material is child abuse material; and
 - (c) A knows that the material is, or probably is, child abuse material.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), the ways in which A accesses material may include—
 - (a) viewing material; or
 - (b) displaying material by an electronic medium or any other output of the material by an electronic medium.

Notes

- 1 Exceptions apply to this offence—see sections 51J, 51K and 51M.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 51L, 51N, 51O, 51P, 51Q and 51R.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that reasonable persons would not regard the child abuse material as offensive is not a defence to this offence—see section 51U.

51I Assisting a person to avoid apprehension

**S. 51I
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally provides information to another person (B); and
 - (b) A intends that B use the information for the purpose of avoiding or reducing the likelihood of apprehension for an offence committed by B against section 51B(1), 51C(1), 51D(1), 51E(1), 51F(1), 51G(1) or 51H(1).

Examples

- 1 A provides information to B about how to use a website to deal with child abuse material anonymously or how to encrypt electronic material containing child abuse material.
 - 2 A provides information to B about how to delete electronic material that records information about B's identity.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (3) It is not necessary to prove—
- (a) the identity of the person to whom the information was provided; or
 - (b) that the information was actually used by the other person.
- (4) It is immaterial that some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as the other person was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred.
- (5) It is immaterial that the other person was outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as that conduct occurred in Victoria.
- (6) For the purposes of subsections (4) and (5), information is provided by A to B at the place where A is at the time of giving that information irrespective of where B is at the time of receiving that information.

Note

A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that reasonable persons would not regard the child abuse material as offensive is not a defence to this offence—see section 51U.

51J Exception—administration of the law

S. 51J
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

A does not commit a child abuse material offence (other than an offence against section 51I(1)) if the conduct is engaged in by A in good faith in the course of official duties of A—

- (a) connected with the administration of the criminal justice system, including the investigation or prosecution of offences; or
- (b) as an employee of the Department of Justice and Regulation who is authorised to engage in that conduct by the Secretary to that Department.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in the child abuse material offence provisions.

51K Exception—classification

S. 51K
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

A does not commit a child abuse material offence (other than an offence against section 51I(1)) in respect of material that, at the time at which the offence is alleged to have been committed, was classified other than RC or would, if classified, have been classified other than RC.

Notes

- 1 The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in the child abuse material offence provisions.
- 2 Under the Classification (Publications, Films and Computer Games) Act 1995 of the Commonwealth, a classification of RC means Refused Classification.

S. 51L
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

51L Defence of artistic merit or public benefit

- (1) It is a defence to a charge for a child abuse material offence (other than an offence against section 51I(1)) if—
 - (a) the material—
 - (i) was not produced with the involvement of a person who was, at the time it was produced, under the age of 18 years; and
 - (ii) possesses artistic merit; or
 - (b) the material is of public benefit.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)(b), material that is of public benefit includes material that is for a genuine medical, legal, scientific or educational purpose.

Examples

- 1 A is a university lecturer in psychology. During a lecture on abnormal psychology, A shows a lecture slide with examples of textual child abuse material to illustrate the type of material associated with an abnormal psychological profile. The lecture slide is of public benefit.
- 2 A is a photojournalist in a war zone. A takes a photo of a child victim of torture and submits it to a news organisation for publication. The photo is of public benefit.
- (3) A bears the burden of proving (on the balance of probabilities) the matter referred to in subsection (1)(a)(ii) or (b).

Notes

- 1 The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in the child abuse material offence provisions.
- 2 An evidential burden applies to the matter referred to in subsection (1)(a)(i).

51M Exceptions applying to children

**S. 51M
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) A does not commit an offence against section 51B(1), 51C(1), 51D(1), 51G(1) or 51H(1) if—
- (a) A is a child; and
 - (b) the child abuse material is an image; and
 - (c) the image depicts A alone.

Example

A is 15 years old and takes a photograph of themselves. A stores the photograph on their mobile phone. The offences in 51B(1), 51C(1), 51D(1), 51G(1) or 51H(1) do not apply to A in respect of the image.

Note

Section 51O may apply if A is an adult.

- (2) A does not commit an offence against section 51B(1), 51C(1), 51D(1), 51G(1) or 51H(1) if—
- (a) A is a child; and
 - (b) the child abuse material is an image; and
 - (c) A is the victim of a criminal offence punishable by imprisonment and the image depicts that offence.

Example

The image depicts the child (A) being raped by another person. The offences in sections 51B(1), 51C(1), 51D(1), 51G(1) and 51H(1) do not apply to A in respect of the image.

- (3) In subsections (1) and (2), a reference to an image, in relation to an offence against section 51B(1), is a reference to the image that A involves the child in producing.

Note

References to A in this section are references to the same A referred to in sections 51B, 51C, 51D, 51G and 51H.

S. 51N
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

51N Defence applying to children

- (1) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 51B(1), 51C(1), 51D(1), 51G(1) or 51H(1) if—
- (a) A is a child; and
 - (b) the child abuse material is an image; and
 - (c) the image depicts one or more persons (whether or not it depicts A); and
 - (d) the image—
 - (i) does not depict an act that is a criminal offence punishable by imprisonment; or
 - (ii) depicts an act that is a criminal offence punishable by imprisonment but A reasonably believes that it does not; and
 - (e) at the time of the conduct constituting the offence—
 - (i) A was not more than 2 years older than the youngest child depicted in the image; or
 - (ii) A reasonably believed that they were not more than 2 years older than the youngest child depicted in the image.

Examples

- 1 The image depicts A taking part in an act of sexual penetration with another child who is not more than 2 years younger. Both are consenting to the act. A is not guilty of an offence against section 51B(1), 51C(1), 51D(1), 51G(1) or 51H(1) in respect of the image.
- 2 The image depicts a child being sexually penetrated. A is a child and A reasonably believes that the image depicts a consensual sexual relationship between two 16 year olds and is therefore not a criminal offence. A also reasonably believes that A is not more than 2 years older than the youngest child depicted in

the image. A is not guilty of an offence against section 51B(1), 51C(1), 51D(1), 51G(1) or 51H(1) in respect of the image.

- (2) In subsection (1), a reference to an image, in relation to an offence against section 51B(1), is a reference to the image that A involves the child in producing.
- (3) A bears the burden of proving (on the balance of probabilities) the matters referred to in subsection (1)(d)(ii) and (e)(ii).

Notes

- 1 References to A in this section are references to the same A referred to in sections 51B, 51C, 51D, 51G and 51H.
- 2 An evidential burden applies to the matters referred to in subsection (1)(a), (b), (c), (d)(i) and (e)(i).

51O Defence—image of oneself

**S. 51O
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 51B(1), 51C(1), 51G(1) or 51H(1) if—
 - (a) the child abuse material is an image; and
 - (b) the image depicts A as a child; and
 - (c) the image does not depict A committing a criminal offence punishable by imprisonment; and
 - (d) A does not distribute the image to any other person.
- (2) In subsection (1) a reference to an image, in relation to an offence against section 51B(1), is a reference to the image that A involves the child in producing.

- (3) A bears the burden of proving (on the balance of probabilities) the matter referred to in subsection (1)(b).

Notes

- 1 References to A in this section are references to the same A referred to in sections 51B, 51C, 51G and 51H.
- 2 An evidential burden applies to the matters referred to in subsection (1)(a), (c) and (d).
- 3 Sections 51M(1) or (2) or 51N may apply if A is a child.

S. 51P
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

51P Defence—accused not more than 2 years older than 16 or 17 year old child and acts with child's consent

- (1) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 51B(1), 51C(1), 51D(1), 51G(1) or 51H(1) if—
- (a) the child abuse material is an image; and
 - (b) at the time at which the image was first made, the child (B) whose depiction in the image makes it child abuse material—
 - (i) was aged 16 or 17 years; and
 - (ii) was not, or had not been, under A's care, supervision or authority; and
 - (c) the image does not depict an act that is a criminal offence punishable by imprisonment; and
 - (d) A does not distribute the image to any person other than B; and
 - (e) A is not more than 2 years older than B; and
 - (f) at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A reasonably believed that B consented to that conduct.

S. 51P(1)(d)
amended by
No. 5/2018
s. 5.

- (2) In subsection (1) a reference to an image, in relation to an offence against section 51B(1), is a reference to the image that A involves B in producing.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1)(b), the reference to the time at which the image was first made does not include a reference to any later time at which a copy, reproduction or alteration of the image is made.
- (4) A bears the burden of proving (on the balance of probabilities) the matters referred to in subsection (1)(e) and (f).

Notes

- 1 References to A and B in this section are references to the same A and B referred to in sections 51B, 51C, 51D, 51G and 51H.
- 2 An evidential burden applies to the matters referred to in subsection (1)(a), (b), (c) and (d).

51Q Defence—marriage or domestic partnership

**S. 51Q
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 51B(1), 51C(1), 51D(1), 51G(1) or 51H(1) if—
 - (a) the child abuse material is an image; and
 - (b) the image is child abuse material because of its depiction of another person (B); and
 - (c) the image does not depict a criminal offence punishable by imprisonment; and
 - (d) A does not distribute the image to any person other than B; and
 - (e) at the time at which the image was first made—
 - (i) B was 16 or 17 years of age; and

- (ii) either A and B were married to each other and the marriage was recognised as valid under the Marriage Act 1961 of the Commonwealth or A was B's domestic partner and was no more than 2 years older than B; and
 - (iii) where A was B's domestic partner, if B was under A's care, supervision or authority, the domestic partnership commenced before B came under A's care, supervision or authority; and
- (f) at the time of the conduct constituting the offence—
 - (i) either A and B were married to each other and the marriage was recognised as valid under the Marriage Act 1961 of the Commonwealth or A was B's domestic partner and was no more than 2 years older than B; and
 - (ii) A reasonably believed that B consented to the conduct constituting the offence.
- (2) In subsection (1) a reference to an image, in relation to an offence against section 51B(1), is a reference to the image that A involves the child in producing.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1)(e), the reference to the time at which the image was first made does not include a reference to any later time at which a copy, reproduction or alteration of the image is made.
- (4) A bears the burden of proving (on the balance of probabilities) the matter referred to in subsection (1)(f)(ii).

Notes

- 1 References to A and B in this section are references to the same A and B referred to in sections 51B, 51C, 51D, 51G and 51H.
- 2 An evidential burden applies to the matters referred to in subsection (1)(a), (b), (c), (d), (e) and (f)(i).
- 3 See sections 36 and 36AA for the meaning of consent.

**Note 3 to
s. 51Q
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 13.**

51R Defence—reasonable belief in marriage or domestic partnership

**S. 51R
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 51B(1), 51C(1), 51D(1), 51G(1) or 51H(1) if—
 - (a) the child abuse material is an image; and
 - (b) the image is child abuse material because of its depiction of another person (B); and
 - (c) the image does not depict a criminal offence punishable by imprisonment; and
 - (d) A does not distribute the image to any person other than B; and
 - (e) at the time at which the image was first made, A reasonably believed that—
 - (i) B was 16 or 17 years of age; and
 - (ii) either A and B were married to each other and that the marriage was recognised as valid under the Marriage Act 1961 of the Commonwealth or A was B's domestic partner and was no more than 2 years older than B; and

- (iii) where A was B's domestic partner, if B was under A's care, supervision or authority, the domestic partnership commenced before B came under A's care, supervision or authority; and
- (f) at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A reasonably believed that—
 - (i) either A and B were married to each other and that the marriage was recognised as valid under the Marriage Act 1961 of the Commonwealth or A was B's domestic partner and was no more than 2 years older than B; and
 - (ii) B consented to that conduct.
- (2) In subsection (1) a reference to an image, in relation to an offence against section 51B(1), is a reference to the image that A involves the child in producing.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1)(e), the reference to the time at which the image was first made does not include a reference to any later time at which a copy, reproduction or alteration of the image is made.
- (4) A bears the burden of proving (on the balance of probabilities) the matter referred to in subsection (1)(e) and (f).

Notes

- 1 References to A and B in this section are references to the same A and B referred to in sections 51B, 51C, 51D, 51G and 51H.
- 2 An evidential burden applies to the matters referred to in subsection (1)(a), (b), (c) and (d).
- 3 See sections 36 and 36AA for the meaning of consent.

**Note 3 to
s. 51R
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 14.**

51S Defence—reasonable steps to prevent use of a website for child abuse material

**S. 51S
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 51E(1) if A, on becoming aware that the website is being used, or has been used, by another person to deal with child abuse material, takes all reasonable steps in the circumstances to prevent any person from being able to use the website to deal with child abuse material.
- (2) In determining whether A has taken all reasonable steps in the circumstances for the purposes of subsection (1), regard must be had to whether A did any of the following as soon as it was practicable to do so—
 - (a) shut the website down;
 - (b) modified the operation of the website so that it could not be used to deal with child abuse material;
 - (c) notified a police officer that the website is being, or has been, used to deal with child abuse material and complied with any reasonable directions given to A by a police officer as to what to do in relation to that use of the website;
 - (d) notified a relevant industry regulatory authority that the website is being, or has been, used to deal with child abuse material and complied with any reasonable directions given to A by that authority as to what to do in relation to that use of the website.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in section 51E.

S. 51T
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

51T Defence—unsolicited possession

It is a defence to a charge for an offence against section 51G(1) for A to prove on the balance of probabilities that—

- (a) A did not intentionally come into possession of child abuse material; and
- (b) on becoming aware of having come into possession of child abuse material, A, as soon as it was practicable to do so, took all reasonable steps in the circumstances to cease possessing the material.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in section 51G.

S. 51U
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

51U No defence of mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that child abuse material not offensive

It is not a defence to a charge for a child abuse material offence that, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A was under a mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that reasonable persons would not regard the child abuse material as being, in the circumstances, offensive.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in the child abuse material offence provisions.

S. 51V
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

51V Use of random sample evidence in child abuse material cases

- (1) An authorised classifier, in connection with any proceeding for a child abuse material offence, may conduct an examination of a random sample of seized material.
- (2) In the proceeding for the child abuse material offence concerned, evidence adduced by the prosecution of any of the authorised classifier's findings as to the nature and content of the

random sample is admissible as evidence of the nature and content of the whole of the material from which the random sample was taken.

- (3) Accordingly, it is open to a court to find that any type of child abuse material found by an authorised classifier to be present in a particular proportion in the random sample is present in the same proportion in the material from which the random sample was taken.
- (4) A certificate of an authorised classifier that certifies the following is admissible in proceedings for a child abuse material offence as evidence of the matters certified—
 - (a) that the authorised classifier conducted an examination of a random sample of seized material;
 - (b) the findings of the authorised classifier as to the nature and content of the random sample.
- (5) A certificate signed by a person purporting to be an authorised classifier is, in the absence of evidence to the contrary, taken to be a certificate of an authorised classifier.
- (6) Evidence is admissible under this section only if the court is satisfied that an Australian legal practitioner representing the accused, or the accused, has been given a reasonable opportunity to inspect the seized material.
- (7) This section does not affect the operation of any provision of the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009** that restricts inspection by an accused of evidence that is child abuse material.

Note

See sections 46(3), 125(3) and 185A of the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009**.

- (8) The regulations may make further provision for or with respect to the taking and admissibility of random sample evidence under this section, including by providing for—
- (a) the circumstances or classes of case in which the prosecutor may adduce evidence of the findings of an authorised classifier under this section; and
 - (b) the procedure for taking and examining random samples of material; and
 - (c) any further requirements as to the content of a certificate of an authorised classifier.
- (9) In this section—
- seized material***, in relation to a proceeding for a child abuse material offence, means material—
- (a) that came into the possession of a police officer in the course of the exercise of functions as a police officer; and
 - (b) some of which is alleged to be child abuse material that is the subject of the proceeding.

Note

Section 177 of the **Evidence Act 2008** provides for the adducing of expert evidence by the tendering of a certificate.

51W Application for child abuse material disposal order

**S. 51W
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) The Director of Public Prosecutions or a police officer may apply to a court for a child abuse material disposal order in respect of a seized thing, or of electronic material contained in a seized thing, that—
- (a) was the subject of a criminal proceeding for a child abuse material offence in relation to which—
 - (i) the charge was discontinued, withdrawn or permanently stayed; or
 - (ii) the person charged was acquitted or found not guilty (including because of mental impairment) of the charge; or
 - (iii) the charge was dismissed; or
 - (iv) the person charged was released on an undertaking under section 75 of the **Sentencing Act 1991**; or
 - (b) was not the subject of a criminal proceeding.

Note

Sections 77 and 78 of the **Confiscation Act 1997** apply to the disposal of child abuse material where a person is convicted of an offence set out in Schedule 1 to that Act.

- (2) The court to which an application under subsection (1) is to be made is—
- (a) the court in which the proceeding was at the time at which the event mentioned in subsection (1)(a)(i) to (iv) occurred; or
 - (b) the Magistrates' Court.
- (3) The applicant must give written notice of an application under subsection (1) to every person whom the applicant has reason to believe has an interest in the seized thing or in the electronic material contained in the seized thing.

- (4) A notice under subsection (3) must be given by ordinary service at least 14 days before the return date.
- (5) The court may waive the requirement under subsection (3) to give notice if satisfied either—
 - (a) that all persons who have an interest mentioned in that subsection have appeared before the court; or
 - (b) that it is fair to waive the requirement despite a person who has such an interest not having appeared before the court.
- (6) At any time before the final determination of the application, the court may require the applicant to give notice of the application to any person, in any manner and within any period that the court thinks fit.
- (7) The following persons are entitled to appear and give evidence at the hearing of the application—
 - (a) any person notified under subsection (3) or (6);
 - (b) any other person who claims an interest in the seized thing or in electronic material contained in the seized thing.
- (8) However, the fact that a person mentioned in subsection (7) has not appeared before the court does not prevent the court from making a child abuse material disposal order.
- (9) In this section, *ordinary service* and *return date* have the same meanings as in the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009**.

51X Child abuse material disposal order

**S. 51X
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) On an application under section 51W, the court may order that the seized thing, or the electronic material contained in the seized thing, to which the application relates be—
 - (a) forfeited to the State; and
 - (b) destroyed or disposed of in a manner determined by the court and specified in the order.

Note

A child abuse material disposal order that relates to a seized thing that is child abuse material results in forfeiture of the seized thing. A child abuse material disposal order that relates to electronic material that is contained in a seized thing results in forfeiture of the electronic material only.

- (2) The court may only make a child abuse material disposal order—
 - (a) if satisfied, on the balance of probabilities, that—
 - (i) the seized thing is, or the electronic material contained in the seized thing includes, child abuse material; and
 - (ii) the return to a person of the seized thing, or of the electronic material contained in the seized thing, may result in the commission of a child abuse material offence; or
 - (b) if satisfied, on the balance of probabilities, that—
 - (i) the seized thing contains encrypted or password protected electronic material; and
 - (ii) there are reasonable grounds to believe that the electronic material includes child abuse material.

- (3) The court has power to give any direction necessary to give effect to a child abuse material disposal order made by it.
- (4) Without affecting any other right of appeal, a person who has an interest in a seized thing, or in electronic material contained in a seized thing, may appeal against a child abuse material disposal order made in respect of it.
- (5) An appeal is to be made by a person in the same manner as if the person had been convicted, by the court that made the order, of a child abuse material offence and the order were, or were part of, the sentence imposed in respect of that offence.
- (6) On appeal—
 - (a) the child abuse material disposal order may be confirmed, discharged or varied; or
 - (b) the matter may be remitted for re-hearing to the court that made the order with or without any direction in law.
- (7) A child abuse material disposal order is stayed during the appeal period.
- (8) In this section—

appeal period means the period permitted under the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009** for commencing an appeal of a kind mentioned in subsection (5) or, if such an appeal is commenced within that period, the determination of the appeal.

51Y Disposal of thing or material by consent

Nothing in section 51W or 51X prevents the destruction or disposal of a seized thing that is, or of electronic material contained in a seized thing that includes, child abuse material with the consent of all persons who have an interest in the thing or material.

(8E) *Sexual offences against persons with a cognitive impairment or mental illness*

S. 51Y
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8E)
(Heading and
s. 58)
inserted by
No. 9509 s. 5,
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8E)
(Heading and
ss 53–60) by
No. 8/1991
s. 3,
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(3)(Sch.
3 items 9–14),
41/1993 s. 21,
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
items 30–37),
69/1997
s. 22(2)(3),
2/2006 ss 18,
19, 8/2008
s. 22(1),
1/2009 s. 3,
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.4),
74/2014
s. 7(4),
substituted as
Part 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8E)
(Heading and
ss 52A–52K)
by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

S. 52A
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

52A Definitions

In this Subdivision—

cognitive impairment includes impairment
because of intellectual disability, dementia,
neurological disorder or brain injury;

intellectual disability has the same meaning as in
the **Disability Act 2006**;

mental illness has the same meaning as in the
Mental Health and Wellbeing Act 2022;

S. 52A def. of
mental illness
amended by
No. 39/2022
s. 811(a).

residential service includes—

S. 52A def. of
*residential
service*
amended by
Nos 19/2019
s. 257(1),
37/2021 s. 389,
9/2023 ss 233,
254.

- (a) a residential service within the meaning
of the **Disability Act 2006**; and
- (ab) accommodation approved for
supervised treatment under section 187
of the **Disability Act 2006**; and
- (ac) a short-term accommodation dwelling
within the meaning of the **Disability
Act 2006**; and
- (b) a supported residential service
within the meaning of section 214 of
the **Social Services Regulation
Act 2021**; and
- (ba) an SDA dwelling within the meaning of
the **Residential Tenancies Act 1997**;
and
- (c) residential care within the meaning
of the Aged Care Act 1997 of the
Commonwealth;

service provider includes—

- (a) a disability service provider within the meaning of the **Disability Act 2006**; and
- (ab) a registered NDIS provider within the meaning of the National Disability Insurance Scheme Act 2013 of the Commonwealth; and
- (b) a residential service; and
- (c) a designated mental health service within the meaning of the **Mental Health and Wellbeing Act 2022**; and
- (d) a person who, or a body that, delivers treatment or support services to persons with a cognitive impairment or mental illness;

S. 52A def. of
*service
provider*
amended by
Nos 19/2019
s. 257(2),
39/2022
s. 811(b).

treatment or support services means any of the following delivered in a professional capacity—

- (a) mental health treatment;
- (b) medical treatment;
- (c) therapeutic services;
- (d) personal care or support services;

Example

A worker supporting a person with a cognitive impairment to undertake tasks such as bathing and dressing.

worker means a person—

- (a) who delivers, assists in delivering, or who manages the delivery of, services to persons with a cognitive impairment or mental illness; and

Example

A cook at a supported residential service.

- (b) who does so for or on behalf of a service provider (whether paid or unpaid); and

Example

A volunteer bus driver for a mental health service.

- (c) who is not a person with a cognitive impairment or mental illness who receives treatment or support services from that service provider.

S. 52B
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

52B Sexual penetration of a person with a cognitive impairment or mental illness

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally—
 - (i) sexually penetrates another person (B); or
 - (ii) causes or allows B to sexually penetrate A; or
 - (iii) causes B—
 - (A) to sexually penetrate themselves; or
 - (B) to sexually penetrate another person (C) or an animal; or
 - (C) to be sexually penetrated by C or by an animal; and
 - (b) B has a cognitive impairment or mental illness; and
 - (c) A—
 - (i) provides treatment or support services to B; or

(ii) is a worker for a service provider that provides treatment or support services to B.

(2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

Notes

- 1 Exceptions apply to this offence—see sections 52F and 52G.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 52H, 52I and 52J.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief of certain matters is not a defence against this offence—see section 52K.

52C Sexual assault of a person with a cognitive impairment or mental illness

**S. 52C
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

(1) A person (A) commits an offence if—

(a) A intentionally—

- (i) touches another person (B); or
- (ii) causes or allows B to touch A; or
- (iii) causes B—
 - (A) to touch, or to continue to touch, themselves; or
 - (B) to touch, or to continue to touch, another person (C) or an animal; or
 - (C) to be touched, or to continue to be touched, by C or by an animal; and

(b) B has a cognitive impairment or mental illness; and

(c) A—

- (i) provides treatment or support services to B; or

- (ii) is a worker for a service provider that provides treatment or support services to B; and
- (d) the touching is—
 - (i) sexual; and
 - (ii) contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (3) Whether or not the touching is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct depends on the circumstances.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3)—
 - (a) the circumstances include—
 - (i) the purpose of the touching; and
 - (ii) whether A seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from the touching;
 - (b) the circumstances do not include—
 - (i) whether B consents to the touching; or
 - (ii) whether A believes that B consents to the touching.

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 52G.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 52H, 52I and 52J.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief of certain matters is not a defence against this offence—see section 52K.

52D Sexual activity in the presence of a person with a cognitive impairment or mental illness

S. 52D
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally engages in an activity; and
 - (b) the activity is sexual; and
 - (c) another person (B) is present when A engages in the activity; and
 - (d) A knows that B is, or probably is, present when A engages in the activity; and
 - (e) B has a cognitive impairment or mental illness; and
 - (f) A—
 - (i) provides treatment or support services to B; or
 - (ii) is a worker for a service provider that provides treatment or support services to B; and
 - (g) engaging in the activity in the presence of B is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (3) Whether or not engaging in the activity in the presence of B is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct depends on the circumstances.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3)—
 - (a) the circumstances include—
 - (i) the purpose of the activity; and

- (ii) whether A seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from engaging in the activity or from the presence of B;
- (b) the circumstances do not include—
 - (i) whether B consents—
 - (A) to being present when A engages in the activity; or
 - (B) to A engaging in the activity; or
 - (ii) whether A believes that B consents—
 - (A) to being present when A engages in the activity; or
 - (B) to A engaging in the activity.

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 52G.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 52H, 52I and 52J.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief of certain matters is not a defence against this offence—see section 52K.

S. 52E
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

52E Causing a person with a cognitive impairment or mental illness to be present during sexual activity

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) another person (B) engages in an activity; and
 - (b) the activity is sexual; and
 - (c) another person (C) is present when B engages in the activity; and
 - (d) A intentionally causes or allows C to be present when B engages in the activity; and
 - (e) C has a cognitive impairment or mental illness; and

- (f) A—
 - (i) provides treatment or support services to C; or
 - (ii) is a worker for a service provider that provides treatment or support services to C; and
 - (g) A's causing or allowing C to be present when B engages in the activity is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (3) Whether or not causing or allowing C to be present when B engages in the activity is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct depends on the circumstances.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3)—
- (a) the circumstances include—
 - (i) the purpose of the activity; and
 - (ii) whether A seeks or gets sexual arousal or sexual gratification from B engaging in the activity or from the presence of C;
 - (b) the circumstances do not include—
 - (i) whether C consents—
 - (A) to being present when B engages in the activity; or
 - (B) to B engaging in the activity; or
 - (ii) whether A believes that C consents—
 - (A) to being present when B engages in the activity; or
 - (B) to B engaging in the activity.

Notes

- 1 An exception applies to this offence—see section 52G.
- 2 Defences apply to this offence—see sections 52H, 52I and 52J.
- 3 A mistaken but honest and reasonable belief of certain matters is not a defence against this offence—see section 52K.

S. 52F
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

52F Exceptions to sexual penetration offence—medical, hygienic, veterinary, agricultural or scientific purposes

A does not commit an offence against section 52B(1) if—

- (a) the sexual penetration is of a person and is done in the course of a procedure carried out in good faith for medical or hygienic purposes; or
- (b) the sexual penetration is of an animal and is caused by A to be done in the course of a procedure being carried out in good faith for veterinary or agricultural purposes or scientific research purposes.

Example

A is a support worker assisting B on a farm. B assists in birthing a calf. During this process, A causes B to insert B's hand into the cow's vagina. A has not committed an offence against section 52B(1).

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in section 52B.

52G Exception—marriage or domestic partnership

S. 52G
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

A does not commit an offence against a provision of this Subdivision if, at the time at which the offence is alleged to have been committed—

- (a) A and the person who has a cognitive impairment or mental illness are married to each other and the marriage is recognised as valid under the Marriage Act 1961 of the Commonwealth; or
- (b) A is the domestic partner of the person who has a cognitive impairment or mental illness.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in the offence provisions in this Subdivision.

52H Defence—reasonable belief in marriage or domestic partnership

S. 52H
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

It is a defence to a charge for an offence against a provision of this Subdivision for A to prove on the balance of probabilities that, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A reasonably believed that—

- (a) A and the person who has a cognitive impairment or mental illness were married to each other and that the marriage was recognised as valid under the Marriage Act 1961 of the Commonwealth; or
- (b) A was the domestic partner of the person who has a cognitive impairment or mental illness.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in the offence provisions in this Subdivision.

S. 52I
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

52I Defence—reasonable belief a person does not have a cognitive impairment or mental illness

It is a defence to a charge for an offence against a provision of this Subdivision for A to prove on the balance of probabilities that, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A reasonably believed that the person who has a cognitive impairment or mental illness did not have a cognitive impairment or mental illness.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in the offence provisions in this Subdivision.

S. 52J
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

52J Defence—reasonable belief the service provider does not provide treatment or support services to the person with a cognitive impairment or mental illness

If A is a worker for a service provider, it is a defence to a charge for an offence against a provision of this Subdivision for A to prove on the balance of probabilities that, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A reasonably believed that the service provider was not providing treatment or support services to the person who has a cognitive impairment or mental illness.

Notes

- 1 The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in the offence provisions in this Subdivision.
- 2 The prosecution is required to prove that A is a worker for a service provider—see sections 52B, 52C, 52D and 52E.

52K No defence of mistaken but honest and reasonable belief of certain matters

S. 52K
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

- (1) It is not a defence to a charge that, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A was under a mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that—
 - (a) for an offence against section 52B(1), 52C(1) or 52D(1)—A did not provide treatment or support services to B or was not a worker for a service provider; or
 - (b) for an offence against section 52E(1)—A did not provide treatment or support services to C or was not a worker for a service provider.
- (2) It is not a defence to a charge that, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A was under a mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that—
 - (a) for an offence against section 52C(1)—the touching was not—
 - (i) sexual; or
 - (ii) contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct; or
 - (b) for an offence against section 52D(1)—
 - (i) the activity was not sexual; or
 - (ii) engaging in the activity in the presence of B was not contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct; or
 - (c) for an offence against section 52E(1)—
 - (i) the activity was not sexual; or

- (ii) A's causing or allowing C to be present when B engages in the activity was not contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.

Note

References to A, B and C in this section are references to the same A, B and C referred to in sections 52B, 52C, 52D and 52E.

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv.
(8EAA)
(Heading and
ss 60AB–
60AE)
inserted by
No. 20/2004
s. 3,
repealed by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

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Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8EA)
(Heading and
s. 60B)
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 10,
amended by
Nos 90/1995
s. 86, 22/1996
s. 7, 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 38),
69/1997
s. 22(4),
65/1998 s. 3,
67/2000
s. 7(1)(2),
56/2005 s. 7,
63/2010
s. 81(Sch.
item 4),
80/2011
s. 79(Sch.
item 3),
repealed by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

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(8F) *Sexual servitude*

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8F)
(Heading and
ss 59–61)
inserted by
No. 9509 s. 5,
amended by
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s. 14, 124/1986
ss 74(b)–(d),
80,
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8F)
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s. 61) by
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s. 3,
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 6, 76/2006
s. 3, 14/2015
s. 79,
substituted as
Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8F)
(Heading and
ss 53A–53G)
by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

53A Definitions

In this Subdivision—

S. 53A
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

* * * * *

S. 53A def. of
*commercial
sexual
services*
repealed by
No. 7/2022
s. 41(a).

threat means—

- (a) threat of force; or
- (b) threat to cause a person's deportation;
or

S. 53A def. of
threat
amended by
No. 7/2022
s. 41(b).

- (c) threat of any other detrimental action unless there are reasonable grounds for the threat of that action in connection with the provision of commercial sexual services;

Example

A manager may have reasonable grounds to threaten to dismiss a worker who is regularly late for work.

use, in relation to a debt or purported debt, includes impose, arrange, negotiate or refer to the debt or purported debt.

S. 53B
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

53B Using force, threat etc. to cause another person to provide commercial sexual services

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A—
 - (i) uses force against another person (B) or any other person; or
 - (ii) makes a threat to, or against, B or any other person; or
 - (iii) unlawfully detains B or any other person; or
 - (iv) engages in fraud or misrepresentation (including by omission) in relation to B or any other person; or
 - (v) uses a manifestly excessive debt owed, or purportedly owed, by B or any other person; and

- (b) A, by engaging in the conduct referred to in paragraph (a), causes B—
 - (i) to provide, or to continue to provide, commercial sexual services; or
 - (ii) to not be free to leave the place or area where B provides commercial sexual services; and
 - (c) A—
 - (i) intends that engaging in the conduct referred to in paragraph (a) will cause B—
 - (A) to provide, or to continue to provide, commercial sexual services; or
 - (B) to not be free to leave the place or area where B provides commercial sexual services; or
 - (ii) knows that engaging in the conduct referred to in paragraph (a) will, or probably will, cause B—
 - (A) to provide, or to continue to provide, commercial sexual services; or
 - (B) to not be free to leave the place or area where B provides commercial sexual services.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 53C
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

53C Causing another person to provide commercial sexual services in circumstances involving sexual servitude

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A causes or induces another person (B) to provide, or to continue to provide, commercial sexual services; and
 - (b) B is not free to stop providing those services, or to leave the place or area where B provides those services, because A or another person (C)—
 - (i) uses force against B or another person (D); or
 - (ii) makes a threat to, or against, B or D; or
 - (iii) unlawfully detains B or D; or
 - (iv) engages in fraud or misrepresentation (including by omission) in relation to B or D; or
 - (v) uses a manifestly excessive debt owed, or purportedly owed, by B or D; and
 - (c) A knows that engaging in the conduct referred to in paragraph (b) will, or probably will, cause B—
 - (i) to provide, or to continue to provide, commercial sexual services; or
 - (ii) to not be free to leave the place or area where B provides commercial sexual services.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

53D Conducting a business in circumstances involving sexual servitude

**S. 53D
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.**

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A conducts a business that involves the provision of commercial sexual services by another person (B); and
 - (b) B is not free to stop providing those services, or to leave the place or area where B provides those services, because A or another person (C)—
 - (i) uses force against B or another person (D); or
 - (ii) makes a threat to, or against, B or D; or
 - (iii) unlawfully detains B or D; or
 - (iv) engages in fraud or misrepresentation (including by omission) in relation to B or D; or
 - (v) uses a manifestly excessive debt, or purported debt, owed by B or D; and
 - (c) A knows that engaging in the conduct referred to in paragraph (b) will, or probably will, cause B—
 - (i) to provide, or to continue to provide, commercial sexual services; or
 - (ii) to not be free to leave the place or area where B provides commercial sexual services.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), conducting a business includes—
- (a) taking any part in the management of the business; or
 - (b) exercising control or direction over the business; or
 - (c) providing finance for the business.

S. 53E
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

53E Aggravated sexual servitude

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A commits an offence against section 53B(1), 53C(1) or 53D(1); and
 - (b) the person against whom the offence is committed (B) is under the age of 18 years; and
 - (c) A knows that B is, or probably is, under the age of 18 years.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum).

S. 53F
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

53F Deceptive recruiting for commercial sexual services

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A deceives another person (B) about the fact that an engagement will involve the provision of commercial sexual services by B; and
 - (b) A intends to induce B to enter into an engagement to provide commercial sexual services.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

53G Aggravated deceptive recruiting for commercial sexual services

S. 53G
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
- (a) A commits an offence against section 53F(1); and
 - (b) the person against whom the offence is committed (B) is under the age of 18 years; and
 - (c) A knows that B is, or probably is, under the age of 18 years.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

(8FAA) *Commercial sexual services*

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv.
(8FAA)
(Heading and
ss 53H–53N)
inserted by
No. 7/2022
s. 42.

53H Causing or inducing a child to take part in commercial sexual services

S. 53H
inserted by
No. 7/2022
s. 42.

- (1) A person (A) must not cause or induce a child (B) to take part in commercial sexual services or to continue to take part in such services, whether B takes part as the person providing the services, as the client, or in any other capacity.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (2) In a proceeding for an offence against subsection (1)—
- (a) it is not necessary for the prosecution to prove that A knew that B was a child; and

- (b) it is a defence to the charge for A to prove that, having taken all reasonable steps to find out the age of B, A believed on reasonable grounds, at the time the offence is alleged to have been committed, that B was aged 18 years or more.

S. 53I
inserted by
No. 7/2022
s. 42.

53I Obtaining a commercial benefit, payment or reward for commercial sexual services provided by a child

- (1) A person (A) must not receive a commercial benefit, or payment or reward (including the supply of a drug of dependence within the meaning of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981**) knowing that it or any part of it has been derived, directly or indirectly, from commercial sexual services provided by a child (B).

Penalty: Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

- (2) In a proceeding for an offence against subsection (1), if it is proved that A was residing, at the time the offence is alleged to have been committed, with B, a child who provides commercial sexual services, A is presumed to be guilty of the offence in the absence of proof to the contrary.
- (3) In a proceeding for an offence against subsection (1)—
 - (a) it is not necessary for the prosecution to prove that A knew that B was a child; and
 - (b) it is a defence to the charge for A to prove that, having taken all reasonable steps to find out the age of B, A believed on reasonable grounds, at the time the offence is alleged to have been committed, that B was aged 18 years or more.

53J Agreement for provision of commercial sexual services by a child

S. 53J
inserted by
No. 7/2022
s. 42.

- (1) A person (A) must not enter into or offer to enter into an agreement under which a child (B) is to provide commercial sexual services.

Penalty: Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

- (2) In a proceeding for an offence against subsection (1)—
- (a) it is not necessary for the prosecution to prove that A knew that B was a child; and
 - (b) if B was aged 16 years or more at the time the offence is alleged to have been committed, it is a defence to the charge for A to prove that, having taken all reasonable steps to find out the age of B, A believed on reasonable grounds, at the time the offence is alleged to have been committed, that B was aged 18 years or more.

53K Allowing a child to take part in commercial sexual services

S. 53K
inserted by
No. 7/2022
s. 42.

- (1) A person (A) who owns or occupies a premises, or who manages or assists in the management of a premises, must not allow a child (B) to enter or remain on the premises for the purpose of taking part in commercial sexual services, whether B is taking part as the person providing the services, as the client, or in any other capacity.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (2) In a proceeding for an offence against subsection (1)—
- (a) it is not necessary for the prosecution to prove that A knew that B was a child; and

- (b) it is a defence to the charge for A to prove that, having taken all reasonable steps to find out the age of B, A believed on reasonable grounds, at the time the offence is alleged to have been committed, that B was aged 18 years or more.
- (3) In a proceeding for an offence against subsection (1), if it is proved that—
 - (a) at the time the offence is alleged to have been committed, the premises were being used for the provision of commercial sexual services; and
 - (b) B was on the premises for the purpose of taking part in commercial sexual services—

A is presumed to have allowed B to enter or remain on the premises for that purpose, unless A satisfies the court on the balance of probabilities that A did not know, and could not reasonably have known, at the time the offence is alleged to have been committed, that B was on the premises for that purpose.

S. 53L
inserted by
No. 7/2022
s. 42.

53L Forcing a person into or to remain in commercial sexual service

A person (A) must not with intent to induce another person aged 18 years or more (B) to engage or continue to engage in commercial sexual services—

- (a) assault or threaten to assault B or any other person; or
- (b) intimidate B or any other person; or
- (c) supply or offer to supply a drug of dependence (within the meaning of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981**) to B or any other person; or

(d) make a false representation or use any false pretence or other fraudulent means.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

53M Forcing a person to provide financial support out of commercial sexual services

S. 53M
inserted by
No. 7/2022
s. 42.

A person (A) must not with intent to induce another person aged 18 years or more (B) to provide or continue to provide A with a commercial benefit, or payment or reward (including the supply of a drug of dependence with the meaning of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981**) derived, directly or indirectly, from commercial sexual services provided by B—

- (a) assault or threaten to assault B or any other person; or
- (b) intimidate B or any other person; or
- (c) supply or offer to supply a drug of dependence (within the meaning of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981**) to B or any other person.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

53N Living on the earnings of a person providing unlawful commercial sexual services

S. 53N
inserted by
No. 7/2022
s. 42.

A person (A) must not knowingly live wholly or in part on, or derive material benefit from, the earnings of commercial sexual services provided by another person (B) in circumstances that constitute an offence against section 53H(1), 53I(1), 53J(1), 53K(1), 53L or 53M.

Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv.
(8FAAB)
(Heading and
ss 53O–53ZB)
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

(8FAAB) *Producing, distributing or threatening to distribute intimate images*

S. 53O
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

53O Definitions

(1) In this Subdivision—

child means a person under the age of 18 years;

consent—see sections 53P and 53Q;

distribute, in relation to an image, includes—

- (a) publishing the image; and
- (b) exhibiting, communicating, sending, supplying or transmitting the image to any other person; and
- (c) making the image available for access by any other person;

electronic material includes data from which images may be generated;

intimate image means an image depicting—

- (a) a person engaged in a sexual activity; or
- (b) a person in a manner or context that is sexual; or
- (c) the genital or anal region of a person (whether bare or covered by underwear); or
- (d) if a person is female, or a transgender or intersex person identifying as female, the breasts of the person;

intimate image disposal order means an order made under section 53Z;

intimate image offence means an offence against section 53R(1), 53S(1) or 53T(1);

place includes land, premises and a vehicle;

police officer includes a member of the Australian Federal Police;

produce, in relation to an image, means—

- (a) filming, recording, taking or otherwise capturing the image; or
- (b) digitally creating the image;

seized thing means a thing that came into the possession of a police officer in the course of the exercise of functions as a police officer.

- (2) For the purposes of this Subdivision, an image may be—
 - (a) still, moving, recorded or unrecorded; and
 - (b) digitally created by—
 - (i) generating the image; or
 - (ii) altering or manipulating another image.

53P Meaning of consent

- (1) Consent, in relation to the production or distribution of an intimate image, means free and voluntary agreement.
- (2) A person does not consent to the production of an intimate image just because they consented to the production of a different intimate image (including an intimate image produced on a different occasion or in a different way).

Example

Consenting to a photograph being taken but not a video being recorded.

S. 53P
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

(3) A person does not consent to the distribution of an intimate image just because they—

(a) consented to the distribution of that intimate image—

(i) on a different occasion; or

(ii) in a different way; or

Example

Consenting to a photograph being emailed to another person but not uploaded to a social media website.

(b) consented to the distribution of a different intimate image; or

(c) consented to the production of that intimate image or a different intimate image; or

(d) distributed that intimate image or a different intimate image; or

(e) in the case of distribution of an intimate image to a particular person, consented to the distribution of that intimate image to a different person.

S. 53Q
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

53Q Circumstances in which a person does not consent

Circumstances in which a person does not consent to the production or distribution of an intimate image include, but are not limited to, the following—

(a) the person does not say or do anything to indicate consent to the production or distribution of the intimate image;

- (b) the person agrees to the production or distribution of the intimate image because of force, a fear of force, harm of any type or a fear of harm of any type, whether to that person or someone else, regardless of—
 - (i) when the force, harm or conduct giving rise to the fear occurs; and
 - (ii) whether it is, or is a result of, a single incident or part of an ongoing pattern;

Examples

Each of the following is an example of a type of harm referred to in this paragraph—

- (a) economic or financial harm;
 - (b) reputational harm;
 - (c) harm to the person's family, cultural or community relationships;
 - (d) harm to the person's employment;
 - (e) family violence involving psychological abuse or harm to mental health;
 - (f) sexual harassment.
- (c) the person agrees to the production or distribution of the intimate image because of coercion or intimidation—
 - (i) regardless of when the coercion or intimidation occurs; and
 - (ii) whether it is, or is a result of, a single incident or is part of an ongoing pattern;
 - (d) the person agrees to the production or distribution of the intimate image because the person is overborne by the abuse of a relationship of authority or trust;
 - (e) the person is asleep or unconscious;

- (f) the person is so affected by alcohol or another drug as to be incapable of consenting to the production or distribution of the intimate image;
- (g) the person is so affected by alcohol or another drug as to be incapable of withdrawing consent to the production or distribution of the intimate image.

Note

This circumstance may apply where a person gave consent when not so affected by alcohol or another drug as to be incapable of consenting.

S. 53R
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

53R Producing intimate image

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally produces an image depicting another person (B); and
 - (b) the image is an intimate image; and
 - (c) A knows that the image is, or probably is, an intimate image; and
 - (d) the production of the intimate image is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.

Examples

- 1 A person (A) live streams footage from a hidden camera placed in the bedroom of another person (B) to A's laptop and that footage depicts B engaging in sexual activity with another person.
- 2 A person (A) digitally superimposes another person's face (B) onto a photograph of a naked person taken from an online magazine.
- 3 A doctor taking a photo of an unconscious patient, which depicts the patient's genital region, during an operation to assist the doctor to perform a medical procedure may not be an offence against this section because of subsection (1)(d).

- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to 3 years imprisonment.
- (3) A does not commit an offence against subsection (1) if—
 - (a) B is not a child; and
 - (b) at the time of the production of the intimate image, B consented to—
 - (i) A producing the intimate image; and
 - (ii) how the intimate image was produced.

Note

A mistaken but honest belief that the production of the intimate image is not contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct is not a defence to this offence—see section 53V.

53S Distributing intimate image

**S. 53S
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.**

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A intentionally distributes an image depicting another person (B); and
 - (b) the image is an intimate image; and
 - (c) A knows that the image is, or probably is, an intimate image; and
 - (d) the distribution of the intimate image is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.

Examples

- 1 A person (A) intentionally posts a photograph of another person (B) on a social media website without B's consent and the photograph depicts B engaged in a sexual activity.
- 2 A person (A) sends a photograph of a person (B) to another person (C) using an instant messaging service without B's consent and the photograph depicts B's genital or anal region.

- 3 A parent emailing a photo of their naked newborn child to a family member or a friend may not be an offence against this section because of subsection (1)(d).
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to 3 years imprisonment.
- (3) A does not commit an offence against subsection (1) if—
- (a) B is not a child; and
 - (b) at the time of the distribution of the intimate image, B consented to—
 - (i) A distributing the intimate image; and
 - (ii) how the intimate image was distributed.
- (4) A does not commit an offence against subsection (1) if—
- (a) B is not a child; and
 - (b) the intimate image had been distributed previously in a place to which members of the public had access, irrespective of whether—
 - (i) that place was accessible on the Internet or not; and
 - (ii) access was free or for a payment of a fee; and
 - (c) B consented, or a reasonable person would believe that B consented, to that previous distribution; and
 - (d) in all the circumstances, a reasonable person would believe that B consented to the distribution of the intimate image to which the charge relates.

Note

A mistaken but honest belief that the distribution of the intimate image is not contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct is not a defence to this offence—see section 53V.

53T Threat to distribute intimate image

S. 53T
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if—
 - (a) A makes to another person (B) a threat to distribute an intimate image depicting B or another person; and
 - (b) the distribution of the image would be contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct; and
 - (c) A intends that B will believe, or believes that B will probably believe, that A will carry out the threat.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to 3 years imprisonment.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), a threat may be—
 - (a) made by words or conduct; and
 - (b) explicit or implicit.

Note

A mistaken but honest belief that the distribution of the intimate image would not be contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct is not a defence to this offence—see section 53V.

53U Community standards of acceptable conduct

S. 53U
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

- (1) Whether the production or distribution of an intimate image is contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct depends on the circumstances.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), the circumstances include—
 - (a) the nature and content of the intimate image;
 - (b) the circumstances in which the intimate image is produced or distributed;

- (c) the age, intellectual capacity, vulnerability or other relevant circumstances of a person depicted in the intimate image;
- (d) the degree to which the production or distribution of the intimate image affects the privacy of a person depicted in the intimate image.

S. 53V
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

53V No defence of honest and reasonable mistake

It is not a defence to a charge that, at the time of the conduct constituting the offence, A was under a mistaken but honest and reasonable belief that—

- (a) for an offence against section 53R(1)—production of the intimate image was not contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct; or
- (b) for an offence against section 53S(1)—distribution of the intimate image was not contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct; or
- (c) for an offence against section 53T(1)—distribution of the intimate image would not be contrary to community standards of acceptable conduct.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in sections 53R, 53S and 53T.

53W Consent of Director of Public Prosecutions required if accused is under 16 years of age

S. 53W
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

A prosecution for an intimate image offence must not be commenced without the consent of the Director of Public Prosecutions if A is under 16 years of age at the time of the alleged commission of the offence.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same A referred to in sections 53R, 53S and 53T.

53X Application for intimate image disposal order

S. 53X
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

- (1) The Director of Public Prosecutions or a police officer may apply to a court for an intimate image disposal order in respect of a seized thing, or of electronic material contained in a seized thing, that—
 - (a) was the subject of a criminal proceeding for an intimate image offence in which—
 - (i) the charge was discontinued, withdrawn or permanently stayed; or
 - (ii) the person was acquitted or found not guilty (including because of mental impairment) of the charge; or
 - (iii) the charge was dismissed; or
 - (iv) the person charged was released on an undertaking under section 75 of the **Sentencing Act 1991**; or
 - (b) was not the subject of a criminal proceeding.

Note

Sections 77 and 78 of the **Confiscation Act 1997** apply to the disposal of an intimate image if a person is convicted of an offence set out in Schedule 1 to that Act.

- (2) The court to which an application under subsection (1) is to be made is—
 - (a) the court in which the proceeding was at the time the event referred to in subsection (1)(a)(i) to (iv) occurred; or
 - (b) the Magistrates' Court.

S. 53Y
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

53Y Notice of application for intimate image disposal order and entitlement to appear

- (1) The applicant must give written notice of an application under section 53X to every person whom the applicant has reason to believe has an interest—
 - (a) in the seized thing; or
 - (b) in the electronic material contained in the seized thing.
- (2) A notice under subsection (1) must be given by ordinary service at least 14 days before the return date.
- (3) The court may waive the requirement under subsection (2) to give notice if satisfied—
 - (a) that all persons who have an interest referred to in that subsection have appeared before the court; or
 - (b) that it is fair to waive the requirement despite a person who has an interest referred to in that subsection not having appeared before the court.
- (4) At any time before the final determination of the application, the court may require the applicant to give notice of the application to any person, in any manner and within any period that the court thinks fit.

- (5) In this section, *ordinary service* and *return date* have the same meanings as in the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009**.

53Z Intimate image disposal order

S. 53Z
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

- (1) On an application under section 53X, the court may order that the seized thing, or the electronic material contained in the seized thing, to which the application relates—
- (a) be forfeited to the State; and
 - (b) be destroyed or disposed of in a manner—
 - (i) determined by the court; and
 - (ii) specified in the order.

Note

An intimate image disposal order that relates to a seized thing that is an intimate image results in forfeiture of the seized thing. An intimate image disposal order that relates to electronic material that is contained in a seized thing results in forfeiture of the electronic material only.

- (2) The court may only make an intimate image disposal order—
- (a) if satisfied, on the balance of probabilities, that—
 - (i) the seized thing is, or the electronic material contained in the seized thing includes, an intimate image; and
 - (ii) the return to a person of the seized thing, or of the electronic material contained in the seized thing, may result in the commission of an intimate image offence; or

- (b) if satisfied, on the balance of probabilities, that—
 - (i) the seized thing contains encrypted or password protected electronic material; and
 - (ii) there are reasonable grounds to believe that the electronic material includes an intimate image.
- (3) The court may give any direction necessary to give effect to an intimate image disposal order made by it.
- (4) The following persons are entitled to appear and give evidence at the hearing of the application—
 - (a) any person notified under section 53Y(1) or (4);
 - (b) any other person who claims an interest in the seized thing or in electronic material contained in the seized thing.
- (5) The court is not prevented from making an intimate image disposal order because a person referred to in subsection (4) has not appeared before the court.

S. 53ZA
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.

53ZA Appeal against intimate image disposal order

- (1) Without affecting any other right of appeal, a person who has an interest in a seized thing, or in electronic material contained in a seized thing, may appeal against an intimate image disposal order made in respect of it.
- (2) An appeal is to be made by a person in the same manner as if—
 - (a) the person had been convicted of an intimate image offence by the court that made the intimate image disposal order; and

- (b) the intimate image disposal order were, or were part of, the sentence imposed in respect of that offence.
- (3) On appeal—
 - (a) the intimate image disposal order may be—
 - (i) confirmed; or
 - (ii) discharged; or
 - (iii) varied; or
 - (b) the matter may be remitted for rehearing to the court that made the order with or without any direction in law.
- (4) An intimate image disposal order is stayed during the appeal period.
- (5) In this section—

appeal period means the period permitted under the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009** for—

 - (a) commencing an appeal of the kind referred to in subsection (2); or
 - (b) if an appeal of the kind referred to in subsection (2) is commenced within the period permitted, the determination of the appeal.

53ZB Disposal of thing or material by consent

Nothing in section 53X, 53Y, 53Z or 53ZA prevents the destruction or disposal of a seized thing that is, or of electronic material contained in a seized thing that includes, an intimate image with the consent of all persons who have an interest in the thing or material.

**S. 53ZB
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 22.**

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8FA)
(Heading and
ss 54A–54C)
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

(8FA) *Other sexual offences*

S. 54A
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

54A Bestiality

- (1) A person (A) commits an offence if
A intentionally—
 - (a) sexually penetrates an animal; or
 - (b) causes or allows an animal to sexually
penetrate A.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against
subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment
(5 years maximum).

Notes

- 1 See section 35A(3) for the meaning of sexual penetration of
an animal.
- 2 See section 35A(4) for the meaning of sexual penetration by
an animal.
- 3 An exception applies to this offence—see section 54B.

S. 54B
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

**54B Exception—veterinary, agricultural or scientific
research**

A does not commit an offence against section
54A(1) if A's conduct occurs in the course of a
procedure being carried out by A in good faith for
veterinary or agricultural purposes or scientific
research purposes.

Note

The reference to A in this section is a reference to the same
A referred to in section 54A.

54C Abolition of common law offence of wilful exposure

The offence of wilful exposure at common law is abolished.

S. 54C
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 16.

(8G) Abrogation of obsolete rules of law

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (8G)
(Heading and
s. 62)
inserted by
No. 9509 s. 5.

62 Abrogation of obsolete rules of law

S. 62
inserted by
No. 9509 s. 5.

- (1) The rule of law whereby a male person under the age of fourteen years is conclusively presumed to be impotent is hereby abrogated.
- (2) The existence of a marriage does not constitute, or raise any presumption of, consent by a person to an act of sexual penetration with another person or to touching that is sexual (with or without aggravating circumstances) by another person.
- (3) A reference in this section to sexual penetration means sexual penetration as defined by section 35A.

S. 62(2)
substituted by
No. 10233
s. 10,
amended by
No. 74/2014
s. 7(6).

S. 62(3)
repealed by
No. 8/1991
s. 6(c), new
s. 62(3)
inserted by
No. 74/2014
s. 7(7),
amended by
No. 47/2016
s. 17.

(9) Child stealing

63 Child stealing

No. 6103 s. 63.

- (1) Whosoever unlawfully either by force or fraud leads or takes away or decoys or entices away or detains any child under the age of sixteen years, with intent to deprive any parent or guardian or any other person having the lawful care or charge of such child of the possession of such child or with intent to steal any article upon or about the person of such child; and whosoever with any

S. 63(1)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 30(a)),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 39(a)).

such intent receives or harbors any such child knowing the same to have been by force or fraud led taken decoyed enticed away or detained, shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

No person who has claimed any right to the possession of such child, or is the mother or has claimed to be the father of an illegitimate child, shall be liable to be prosecuted under this or the next succeeding subsection on account of the getting possession of such child or taking such child out of the possession of any person having the lawful care or charge thereof.

S. 63(2)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 30(b)),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 39(b)).

- (2) Whosoever unlawfully takes decoys or entices away any child under the age of sixteen years out of the possession and against the will of the child's parent or guardian or of any other person having the lawful care or charge of the child shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (9A)
(Heading and
s. 63A)
inserted by
No. 6731
s. 2(2).

(9A) *Kidnapping*

S. 63A
inserted by
No. 6731
s. 2(2),
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 30A),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 40).

63A Kidnapping

Whosoever leads takes or entices away or detains any person with intent to demand from that person or any other person any payment by way of ransom for the return or release of that person or with intent to gain for himself or any other person any advantage (however arising) from the detention of that person shall, whether or not any demand or threat is in fact made, be guilty of an

indictable offence and liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).

Note

An offence against this section is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See subsection (2H) of section 5 of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.

Note to s. 63A
inserted by
No. 65/2016
s. 20(18).

(10) *Bigamy*

64 Bigamy

Whosoever being married goes through the form or ceremony of marriage with any other person during the life of her or his husband or wife, shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum). Nothing in this section contained shall extend to any person going through the form or ceremony of marriage as aforesaid whose husband or wife has been continually absent from such person for the space of seven years then last past and has not been known by such person to be living within that time; or shall extend to any person who at the time of her or his going through such form or ceremony of marriage has been divorced from the bond of the marriage; or to any person whose marriage at such time has been declared void by the sentence of any court of competent jurisdiction.

No. 6103 s. 64.
S. 64
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 32),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 41).

(11) Attempts to procure abortion

No. 6103 s. 65.

S. 65
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 33),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 42),
substituted by
No. 58/2008
s. 11.

65 Abortion performed by unqualified person

- (1) A person who is not a qualified person must not perform an abortion on another person.
Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (2) A woman who consents to, or assists in, the performance of an abortion on herself is not guilty of an offence against this section.
- (3) For the purposes of this section—
 - (a) a registered medical practitioner is a qualified person; and
 - (b) a registered pharmacist or registered nurse is a qualified person only for the purpose of performing an abortion by administering or supplying a drug or drugs in accordance with the **Abortion Law Reform Act 2008**.
- (4) In this section—

abortion has the same meaning as in the **Abortion Law Reform Act 2008**;

perform an abortion includes supply or procure the supply of any drug or other substance knowing that it is intended to be used to cause an abortion;

S. 65(4) def. of
*registered
medical
practitioner*
substituted by
No. 13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.2).

registered medical practitioner means a person registered under the Health Practitioner Regulation National Law to practise in the medical profession (other than as a student);

registered nurse means a person registered under the Health Practitioner Regulation National Law to practise in the nursing and midwifery profession as a nurse or as a midwife (other than as a student);

S. 65(4) def. of *registered nurse* substituted by No. 13/2010 s. 51(Sch. item 17.2).

registered pharmacist means a person registered under the Health Practitioner Regulation National Law to practise in the pharmacy profession (other than as a student);

S. 65(4) def. of *registered pharmacist* substituted by No. 13/2010 s. 51(Sch. item 17.2).

woman means a female person of any age.

66 Abortion—Abolition of common law offences

Any rule of common law that creates an offence in relation to procuring a woman's miscarriage is abolished.

No. 6103 s. 66.
S. 66 amended by Nos 9576 s. 11(1), 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 34), 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 43), substituted by No. 58/2008 s. 11.

(12) *Concealing the birth of a child*³

67 Concealing birth of a child

If any woman has been delivered of a child, every person who by any secret disposition of the dead body of the said child whether such child died before at or after its birth endeavours to conceal the birth thereof, shall be guilty of a summary offence, and shall be liable to level 9 imprisonment (6 months maximum).

No. 6103 s. 67.
S. 67 amended by Nos 9576 s. 11(1), 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 35), 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 44(a)(b)).

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part I—Offences

Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (13)
(Heading and
ss 68, 69)
amended by
No. 7577 s. 3,
repealed by
No. 9509 s. 6,
new Pt 1
Div. 1
Subdiv. (13)
(Heading and
ss 67A–70)
inserted by
No. 90/1995
s. 88,
amended by
Nos 22/1996
s. 8, 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
items 45–47),
108/1997
s. 151, 67/2000
s. 6, 69/2001
s. 20, 52/2003
s. 52(Sch. 1
item 2),
20/2004
ss 4–6, 6/2005
ss 12–13(3),
68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.5),
77/2013
ss 15, 16,
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
items 36.5,
36.6), 74/2014
s. 8, 42/2015
ss 3–7,
54/2016 s. 27,
repealed by
No. 47/2016
s. 18.

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Pt 1 Div. 1
Subdiv. (14)
(Heading and
s. 70)
repealed by
No. 9509 s. 6,
new Pt 1 Div.
1 Subdiv. (14)
(Heading and
ss 70AB,
70AC)
inserted by
No. 20/2004
s. 7,
repealed by
No. 47/2016
s. 18.

Division 1A—Piracy

Pt 1 Div. 1A
(Heading and
ss 70A–70D)
inserted by
No. 9407
s. 2(b).

70A Piracy with violence

(1837) 7
William IV and
1 Vict.
c. LXXXVIII
s. 2.

Any person who with intent to commit or at the
time of or immediately before or immediately
after committing the offence of piracy in respect
of any vessel—

S. 70A
inserted by
No. 9407
s. 2(b),
amended by
Nos 37/1986
s. 10, 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 36(a)).

- (a) assaults with intent to murder any person on
board or belonging to the vessel; or
- (b) wounds any such person; or

(c) unlawfully does any act by which the life of any such person may be endangered—

shall be liable to—

(d) level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum);
or

S. 70A(a)
(where
secondly
occurring)
inserted by
No. 37/1986
s. 10,
amended by
No. 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 36(b)),
substituted as
s. 70A(d) by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 48).

(e) imprisonment for such other term as is fixed
by the court—

S. 70A(b)
(where
secondly
occurring)
inserted by
No. 37/1986
s. 10,
amended by
No. 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 36(c)), re-
numbered as
s. 70A(e) by
No. 48/1997
s. 62(2).

as the court determines.

(1698) 11
William III,
c. VII ss 7, 8.
S. 70B
inserted by
No. 9407
s. 2(b).

70B Piratical acts

(1) A person commits a piratical act if—

(a) being an Australian citizen, he commits any piracy or robbery or any act of hostility or robbery against other Australian citizens on the sea under colour of any commission from any foreign ruler or under pretence of authority from any person whatever; or

(b) being on board any Australian ship he—

- (i) turns pirate, enemy or rebel, and piratically runs away with the ship, or any boat, munitions or goods;
- (ii) voluntarily yields up the ship, or any boat, munitions or goods to any pirate;
- (iii) brings any seducing message from any pirate, enemy or rebel;
- (iv) assaults the master of the ship in order to prevent him from fighting in defence of his ship and goods;
- (v) confines the master of the ship; or
- (vi) makes or endeavours to make a revolt in the ship.

(2) Any person who commits a piratical act shall be guilty of an offence and shall be liable on conviction upon indictment to—

S. 70B(2)
amended by
Nos 37/1986
s. 11, 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 37(a)).

(a) level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum);
or

S. 70B(2)(a)
inserted by
No. 37/1986
s. 11,
substituted by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 37(b)),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 49).

S. 70B(2)(b)
inserted by
No. 37/1986
s. 11,
amended by
No. 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 37(c)).

(b) imprisonment for such other term as is fixed
by the court—

as the court determines.

(1721) 8
George I,
c. XXIV s. 1.
S. 70C
inserted by
No. 9407
s. 2(b),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 38),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 50).

70C Trading etc. with pirates

Any person who knowingly—

- (a) trades with any pirate;
- (b) furnishes any pirate with any munitions or
stores of any kind;
- (c) fits out any vessel with a design to trade
with, supply or correspond with any pirate;
or

(d) conspires or corresponds with any pirate—

shall be guilty of an offence and shall be liable on
conviction upon indictment to level 5
imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 70D
inserted by
No. 9407
s. 2(b).

70D Being found on board piratical vessel and unable to prove non-complicity

S. 70D(1)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 39),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 51).

- (1) Any person who is found in Victoria on board any
vessel equipped for the purposes of piracy shall be
guilty of an offence and shall be liable on
conviction upon indictment to level 6
imprisonment (5 years maximum).

- (2) It shall be a defence to a charge under subsection (1) if the person charged proves—
- (a) that he was not on board the vessel willingly;
or
 - (b) that he did not know that the vessel was equipped for the purposes of piracy.

Division 2—Theft and similar or associated offences

Pt 1 Div. 2
(Heading)
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(a).

71 Definitions

S. 71
amended by
No. 8280 s. 7,
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

- (1) In this Division—

gain and *loss* are to be construed as extending only to gain or loss in money or other property, but as extending to any such gain or loss whether temporary or permanent; and—

- (a) *gain* includes a gain by keeping what one has, as well as a gain by getting what one has not; and
- (b) *loss* includes a loss by not getting what one might get, as well as a loss by parting with what one has;

goods except in so far as the context otherwise requires, includes money and every other description of property except land and includes things severed from the land by stealing;

property includes money and all other property real or personal including things in action and other intangible property.

- (2) In this Division property shall be regarded as belonging to any person having possession or control of it, or having in it any proprietary right or interest (not being an equitable interest arising only from an agreement to transfer or grant an interest).

S. 72
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

72 Basic definition of theft

- (1) A person steals if he dishonestly appropriates property belonging to another with the intention of permanently depriving the other of it.
- (2) A person who steals is guilty of theft; and "thief" shall be construed accordingly.

S. 73
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

73 Further explanation of theft

- (1) This section has effect as regards the interpretation and operation of section 72 and, except as otherwise provided in this Division, shall apply only for the purposes of that section and not otherwise.
- (2) A person's appropriation of property belonging to another is not to be regarded as dishonest—
- (a) if he appropriates the property in the belief that he has in law the right to deprive the other of it, on behalf of himself or of a third person; or
 - (b) if he appropriates the property in the belief that he would have the other's consent if the other knew of the appropriation and the circumstances of it; or
 - (c) (except where the property came to him as trustee or personal representative) if he appropriates the property in the belief that the person to whom the property belongs cannot be discovered by taking reasonable steps.

- (3) A person's appropriation of property belonging to another may be dishonest notwithstanding that he is willing to pay for the property.
- (4) Any assumption by a person of the rights of an owner amounts to an appropriation, and this includes, where he has come by the property (innocently or not) without stealing it, any later assumption of a right to it by keeping or dealing with it as owner.
- (5) Where property or a right or interest in property is or purports to be transferred for value to a person acting in good faith, no later assumption by him of rights which he believed himself to be acquiring shall, by reason of any defect in the transferor's title, amount to theft of the property.
- (6) A person cannot steal land, or things forming part of land and severed from it by him or by his directions, except in the following cases, that is to say—
 - (a) when he is a trustee or personal representative, or is authorized by power of attorney, or as liquidator of a company, or otherwise, to sell or dispose of land belonging to another, and he appropriates the land or anything forming part of it by dealing with it in breach of the confidence reposed in him; or
 - (b) when he is not in possession of the land and appropriates any thing forming part of the land by severing it or causing it to be severed, or after it has been severed; or

- (c) when, being in possession of the land under a tenancy, he appropriates the whole or part of any fixture or structure let to be used with the land.

For purposes of this subsection *land* does not include incorporeal hereditaments; *tenancy* means a tenancy for years or any less period and includes an agreement for such a tenancy, but a person who after the end of a tenancy remains in possession as statutory tenant or otherwise is to be treated as having possession under the tenancy, and "let" shall be construed accordingly.

- (7) Wild creatures, tamed or untamed, shall be regarded as property; but a person cannot steal a wild creature not tamed nor ordinarily kept in captivity, or the carcase of any such creature, unless either it has been reduced into possession by or on behalf of another person and possession of it has not since been lost or abandoned, or another person is in course of reducing it into possession.
- (8) Where property is subject to a trust, the persons to whom it belongs shall be regarded as including any person having a right to enforce the trust, and an intention to defeat the trust shall be regarded accordingly as an intention to deprive of the property any person having that right.
- (9) Where a person receives property from or on account of another, and is under an obligation to the other to retain and deal with that property or its proceeds in a particular way, the property or proceeds shall be regarded (as against him) as belonging to the other.

- (10) Where a person gets property by another's mistake, and is under an obligation to make restoration (in whole or in part) of the property or its proceeds or of the value thereof, then to the extent of that obligation the property or proceeds shall be regarded (as against him) as belonging to the person entitled to restoration, and an intention not to make restoration shall be regarded accordingly as an intention to deprive that person of the property or proceeds.
- (11) Property of a corporation sole shall be regarded as belonging to the corporation notwithstanding a vacancy in the corporation.
- (12) A person appropriating property belonging to another without meaning the other permanently to lose the thing itself is nevertheless to be regarded as having the intention of permanently depriving the other of it if his intention is to treat the thing as his own to dispose of regardless of the other's rights; and a borrowing or lending of it may amount to so treating it if, but only if, the borrowing or lending is for a period and in circumstances making it equivalent to an outright taking or disposal.
- (13) Without prejudice to the generality of subsection (12) where a person, having possession or control (lawfully or not) of property belonging to another, parts with the property under a condition as to its return which he may not be able to perform, this (if done for purposes of his own and without the other's authority) amounts to treating the property as his own to dispose of regardless of the other's rights.

(14) Notwithstanding anything contained in subsection (12) in any proceedings—

S. 73(14)(a)
amended by
No. 127/1986
s. 102(Sch. 4
item 5.2).

(a) for stealing a motor vehicle or an aircraft proof that the person charged took or in any manner used the motor vehicle or aircraft without the consent of the owner or person in lawful possession thereof shall be conclusive evidence that the person charged intended to permanently deprive the owner of it; and

S. 73(14)(b)
amended by
No. 127/1986
s. 102(Sch. 4
item 5.2).

(b) for attempting to steal a motor vehicle or an aircraft proof that the person charged attempted to take or in any manner use the motor vehicle or aircraft without the consent of the owner or person in lawful possession thereof shall be conclusive evidence that the person charged intended to permanently deprive the owner of it.

S. 73(15)
inserted by
No. 20/2015
s. 22.

(15) In this section—

motor vehicle includes vessel, whether or not the vessel is powered by a motor;

vessel has the same meaning as in the **Marine Safety Act 2010**.

Theft, robbery, burglary, &c.

Heading
preceding
s. 74
inserted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

74 Theft

S. 74
amended by
No. 8280 s. 8,
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b),
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
36/1988
s. 4(a).

- (1) A person guilty of theft is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 74(1)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 40),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 52).

- (2) Section 80A applies as if the reference in that section to sections 81–87 (both inclusive) were a reference to this section.

S. 74(2)
inserted by
No. 36/1988
s. 4(b).

* * * * *

S. 74A
inserted by
No. 9/2008
s. 10,
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.6),
repealed by
No. 27/2011
s. 5.

S. 74AA
inserted by
No. 44/2015
s. 9.

74AA Theft of firearm

- (1) A person must not steal a firearm.
Penalty: 1800 penalty units or 15 years imprisonment.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)—
firearm has the same meaning as in
section 3(1) of the **Firearms Act 1996**.

S. 75
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

75 Robbery

S. 75(1)
amended by
No. 9323
s. 2(a).

- (1) A person is guilty of robbery if he steals, and immediately before or at the time of doing so, and in order to do so, he uses force on any person or puts or seeks to put any person in fear that he or another person will be then and there subjected to force.

S. 75(2)
amended by
Nos 9048 s. 3,
9576 s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 41),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 53).

- (2) A person guilty of robbery, or of an assault with intent to rob, is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 75A
inserted by
No. 9048 s. 2.

75A Armed robbery

- (1) A person is guilty of armed robbery if he commits any robbery and at the time has with him a firearm, imitation firearm, offensive weapon, explosive or imitation explosive within the meaning assigned to those terms for the purposes of section 77(1).

- (2) A person guilty of armed robbery is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).

S. 75A(2)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 41A),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 54).

Note

An offence against this section is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991** if—

Note to s. 75A
inserted by
No. 48/2018
s. 88.

- (a) the offender has with him or her a firearm at the time of the offence; or
- (b) a victim of the offence has suffered injury as a direct result of the offence; or
- (c) the offence was committed by the offender in company with one or more other persons.

See section 5(2H) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.

76 Burglary

S. 76
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

- (1) A person is guilty of burglary if the person enters any building or part of a building as a trespasser with intent—

S. 76(1)
amended by
No. 52/2025
s. 6(1).

- (a) to steal anything in the building or part in question; or
- (b) to commit an offence—
 - (i) involving an assault to a person in the building or part in question; or
 - (ii) involving any damage to the building or to property in the building or part in question—

which is punishable with imprisonment for a term of five years or more.

S. 76(2)
amended by
No. 52/2025
s. 6(1).

- (2) References in subsection (1) to a building shall apply also to an inhabited vehicle or vessel, and shall apply to any such vehicle or vessel at times when the person having a habitation in it is not there as well as at times when the person is.

S. 76(3)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 42),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 55).

- (3) A person guilty of burglary is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 77
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

77 Aggravated burglary

S. 77(1)
amended by
Nos 9008
s. 2(1)
(Sch.
item 2(a)),
9048 s. 4(a)(b),
9323 s. 2(b),
66/1996
s. 201(2),
substituted by
No. 48/1997
s. 54,
amended by
No. 52/2025
s. 6(2)(a).

- (1) A person is guilty of aggravated burglary if the person commits a burglary and—

S. 77(1)(a)
amended by
No. 52/2025
s. 6(2)(b).

- (a) at the time has with them any firearm or imitation firearm, any offensive weapon or any explosive or imitation explosive; or

- (b) at the time of entering the building or the part of the building another person was then present in the building or part of the building and the person knew that another person was then so present or was reckless as to whether or not another person was then so present; or
- (c) used a vehicle to cause damage to the building, or to part of the building, for the purpose of gaining entry to the building or the part of the building.
- (1A) For the purposes of subsection (1)—
- explosive* means any article manufactured for the purpose of producing a practical effect by explosion, or intended by the person having it with them for that purpose;
- firearm* has the same meaning as in the **Firearms Act 1996**;
- imitation explosive* means any article which might reasonably be taken to be or to contain an explosive;
- imitation firearm* means anything which has the appearance of being a firearm, whether capable of being discharged or not;
- offensive weapon* means any article made or adapted for use for causing injury to or incapacitating a person, or which the person having it with them intends or threatens to use for such a purpose;
- vehicle* has the same meaning as in section 79.
- S. 77(1)(b) amended by No. 52/2025 ss 4(1), 6(2)(c).
- S. 77(1)(c) inserted by No. 52/2025 s. 4(2).
- S. 77(1A) inserted by No. 48/1997 s. 54.
- S. 77(1A) def. of *explosive* amended by No. 52/2025 s. 6(3).
- S. 77(1A) def. of *offensive weapon* amended by No. 52/2025 ss 4(3), 6(3).
- S. 77(1A) def. of *vehicle* inserted by No. 52/2025 s. 4(4).

S. 77(2)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 31),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 56).

- (2) A person guilty of aggravated burglary is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).

S. 77A
inserted by
No. 50/2016
s. 3.

77A Home invasion

- (1) A person commits a home invasion if—
- (a) the person enters a home as a trespasser with intent—
 - (i) to steal anything in the home; or
 - (ii) to commit an offence, punishable by imprisonment for a term of 5 years or more—
 - (A) involving an assault to a person in the home; or
 - (B) involving any damage to the home or to property in the home; and
 - (b) the person enters the home in company with one or more other persons; and
 - (c) either—
 - (i) at the time the person enters the home, the person has with them a firearm, an imitation firearm, an offensive weapon, an explosive or an imitation explosive; or
 - (ii) at any time while the person is present in the home, another person (other than a person referred to in paragraph (b)) is present in the home.

- (2) For the purpose of subsection (1)(c)(ii), it is immaterial whether or not the person knew that there was, or would be, another person present in the home.
- (3) A person who commits a home invasion commits an offence and is liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).
- (4) A person may be found guilty of an offence against this section whether or not any other person is prosecuted for or found guilty of the offence.

- (5) In this section—

explosive, firearm, imitation explosive, imitation firearm, and *offensive weapon* have the same meanings as in section 77;

home means any building, part of a building or other structure intended for occupation as a dwelling and includes the following—

- (a) any part of commercial or industrial premises that is used as residential premises;
- (b) a motel room or hotel room or other temporary accommodation provided on a commercial basis;
- (c) a rooming house within the meaning of the **Residential Tenancies Act 1997**;
- (d) a room provided to a person as accommodation in a residential care service, hospital or any other premises involved in the provision of health services to the person;
- (e) a caravan within the meaning of the **Residential Tenancies Act 1997** or any vehicle or vessel used as a residence.

Note to s. 77A
inserted by
No. 48/2018
s. 89.

Note

An offence against this section is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2H) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.

S. 77B
inserted by
No. 50/2016
s. 3.

77B Aggravated home invasion

- (1) A person commits an aggravated home invasion if—
- (a) the person enters a home as a trespasser with intent—
 - (i) to steal anything in the home; or
 - (ii) to commit an offence, punishable by imprisonment for a term of 5 years or more—
 - (A) involving an assault to a person in the home; or
 - (B) involving any damage to the home or to property in the home; and
 - (b) the person enters the home in company with 2 or more other persons; and
 - (c) at the time the person enters the home—
 - (i) the person has with them a firearm, an imitation firearm, an offensive weapon, an explosive or an imitation explosive; and
 - (ii) the person knows or is reckless as to whether there is or will be another person (other than a person referred to in paragraph (b)) present in the home while the person is present in the home; and

(d) at any time while the person is present in the home, another person (other than a person referred to in paragraph (b)) is present in the home.

(2) A person who commits an aggravated home invasion commits an offence and is liable to level 1 imprisonment (life).

S. 77B(2)
amended by
No. 54/2025
s. 5.

(3) A person may be found guilty of an offence against this section whether or not any other person is prosecuted for or found guilty of the offence.

(4) In this section—

explosive, firearm, imitation explosive, imitation firearm, and *offensive weapon* have the same meanings as in section 77;

home has the same meaning as in section 77A.

Notes

1AA An offence against this section is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2G) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence.

Note 1AA
to s. 77B
inserted by
No. 48/2018
s. 90(a).

1 Section 10AC of the **Sentencing Act 1991** requires that a term of imprisonment be imposed for an offence against section 77B and that a non-parole period of not less than 3 years be fixed under section 11 of that Act unless the court finds under section 10A of that Act that a special reason exists.

* * * * *

Note 2
to s. 77B
amended by
No. 48/2018
s. 90(b),
repealed by
No. 23/2020
s. 15.

S. 77C
inserted by
No. 50/2016
s. 3.

77C Alternative verdict for charge of aggravated home invasion

If on the trial of a person charged with an offence against section 77B (aggravated home invasion) the jury are not satisfied that the person is guilty of the offence charged but are satisfied that the person is guilty of an offence against section 77A (home invasion), the jury may acquit the person of the offence charged and find the person guilty of the offence against section 77A and the person is liable to punishment accordingly.

S. 78
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

78 Removal of articles from places open to the public

- (1) Subject to subsections (2) and (3), where the public have access to a building in order to view the building or part of it, or a collection or part of a collection housed in it, any person who without lawful authority removes from the building or its grounds the whole or part of any article displayed or kept for display to the public in the building or that part of it or in its grounds shall be guilty of an offence.

For this purpose *collection* includes a collection got together for a temporary purpose, but references in this section to a collection do not apply to a collection made or exhibited for the purpose of effecting sales or other commercial dealings.

- (2) It is immaterial for purposes of subsection (1) that the public's access to a building is limited to a particular period or particular occasion; but where anything removed from a building or its grounds is there otherwise than as forming part of, or being on loan for exhibition with, a collection intended for permanent exhibition to the public, the person removing it does not thereby commit an offence under this section unless he removes it on a day

when the public have access to the building as mentioned in subsection (1).

- (3) A person does not commit an offence under this section if he believes that he has lawful authority for the removal of the thing in question or that he would have it if the person entitled to give it knew of the removal and the circumstances of it.
- (4) A person guilty of an offence under this section is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 78(4)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 43),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 57).

79 Carjacking

S. 79
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b),
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1),
repealed by
No. 10084 s. 4,
new s. 79
inserted by
No. 50/2016
s. 4.

- (1) A person (A) commits a carjacking if A steals a vehicle and either—

S. 79(1)
amended by
No. 54/2025
s. 10(1)(a).

* * * * *

S. 79(1)(a)
repealed by
No. 54/2025
s. 10(1)(b).

- (b) immediately before or at the time of doing so, and in order to do so, A—

- (i) uses force on another person; or

S. 79(1)(b)(ii)
amended by
No. 54/2025
s. 10(1)(c).

(ii) puts or seeks to put another person (B)
in fear that B or anyone else will then
and there be subjected to force; or

S. 79(1)(c)
inserted by
No. 54/2025
s. 10(1)(d).

(c) a child who is under the age of 10 is in the
vehicle when A steals it.

S. 79(1A)
inserted by
No. 54/2025
s. 10(2).

(1A) For the purposes of subsection (1)(c), it is
immaterial whether or not A knew that the child
was in the vehicle.

(2) A person who commits a carjacking commits an
offence and is liable to level 4 imprisonment
(15 years maximum).

(3) In this section—

vehicle includes—

(a) a motor vehicle;

(b) a vessel within the meaning of
the **Marine Safety Act 2010**.

Note to s. 79
inserted by
No. 48/2018
s. 91.

Note

An offence against this section is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2H) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.

S. 79A
inserted by
No. 50/2016
s. 4.

79A Aggravated carjacking

(1) A person commits an aggravated carjacking if the
person commits a carjacking and—

(a) at the time the person has with them
a firearm, an imitation firearm, an offensive
weapon, an explosive or an imitation
explosive; or

(b) in the course of the carjacking the person
causes injury to another person.

- (2) A person who commits an aggravated carjacking commits an offence and is liable to level 1 imprisonment (life).

S. 79A(2)
amended by
No. 54/2025
s. 6.

- (3) In this section—

explosive, firearm, imitation explosive, imitation firearm, and *offensive weapon* have the same meanings as in section 77;

injury has the same meaning as in section 15.

Notes

- 1AA An offence against this section is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2G) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence.

Note 1AA
to s. 79A
inserted by
No. 48/2018
s. 92(a).

- 1 Section 10AD of the **Sentencing Act 1991** requires that a term of imprisonment be imposed for an offence against section 79A and that a non-parole period of not less than 3 years be fixed under section 11 of that Act unless the court finds under section 10A of that Act that a special reason exists.

* * * * *

Note 2
to s. 79A
amended by
No. 48/2018
s. 92(b),
repealed by
No. 23/2020
s. 16.

80 Unlawfully taking control of an aircraft

S. 80
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b),
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1).

- (1) A person who without lawful excuse takes or exercises control, whether direct or through another person, of an aircraft while another person not being an accomplice to the first-mentioned person is on board the aircraft shall be guilty of an indictable offence and shall be liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 80(1)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 41),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 58(a)).

S. 80(2)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 31),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 58(b)).

- (2) A person who without lawful excuse, by force or violence or threat of force or violence or by any trick of false pretence, takes or exercises control, whether direct or through another person, of an aircraft while another person not being an accomplice of the first-mentioned person is on board the aircraft shall be guilty of an indictable offence and shall be liable to level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum).

Heading
preceding
s. 80A
inserted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

Fraud and blackmail

S. 80A
inserted by
No. 36/1988
s. 5.

80A Extra-territorial offences

- (1) If—
- (a) a person does, or omits to do, an act or thing referred to in sections 81–87 (both inclusive) outside, or partly outside, Victoria; and
 - (b) there is a real and substantial link within the meaning of subsection (2) between doing, or omitting to do, the act or thing and Victoria—
- those sections apply to the act or thing or the omission as if it had been done, or omitted to be done, wholly within Victoria.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), there is a real and substantial link with Victoria—
- (a) if a significant part of the conduct relating to, or constituting the doing of the act or thing, or the omission, occurred in Victoria; or
 - (b) where the act or thing was done, or the omission occurred, wholly outside Victoria, if the act or thing was done, or omitted to be done, with the intention that substantial

harmful effects arise in Victoria and such effects did arise.

81 Obtaining property by deception

S. 81
amended by
Nos 6561 s. 2,
7263 s. 2(a),
8247 s. 3,
substituted by
Nos 8280
s. 10, 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

- (1) A person who by any deception dishonestly obtains property belonging to another, with the intention of permanently depriving the other of it, is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 81(1)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 40),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 59).

- (2) For purposes of this section a person is to be treated as obtaining property if he obtains ownership, possession or control of it, and *obtain* includes obtaining for another or enabling another to obtain or to retain.

- (3) Subsections (12) and (13) of section 73 shall apply for purposes of this section, with the necessary adaptation of the reference to appropriating, as it applies for purposes of section 72.

- (4) For the purposes of this section, *deception*—

S. 81(4)
substituted by
No. 36/1988
s. 6.

- (a) means any deception (whether deliberate or reckless) by words or conduct as to fact or as to law, including a deception as to the present intentions of the person using the deception or any other person; and
- (b) includes an act or thing done or omitted to be done with the intention of causing—
- (i) a computer system; or

- (ii) a machine that is designed to operate by means of payment or identification—

to make a response that the person doing or omitting to do the act or thing is not authorised to cause the computer system or machine to make.

S. 82
amended by
No. 7876
s. 2(3),
substituted by
Nos 8280
s. 10, 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

82 Obtaining financial advantage by deception

S. 82(1)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 40),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 59).

- (1) A person who by any deception dishonestly obtains for himself or another any financial advantage is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (2) For purposes of this section *deception* has the same meaning as in section 81.

S. 83
amended by
Nos 7184 s. 2,
7705 s. 10,
7876 s. 2(3),
7994 s. 5, 8280
s. 11(1)–(3),
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

83 False accounting

S. 83(1)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 33),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 60).

- (1) Where a person dishonestly, with a view to gain for himself or another or with intent to cause loss to another—
- (a) destroys, defaces, conceals or falsifies any account or any record or document made or required for any accounting purpose; or
 - (b) in furnishing information for any purpose produces or makes use of any account, or any such record or document as aforesaid,

which to his knowledge is or may be misleading, false or deceptive in a material particular—

he is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (2) For purposes of this section a person who makes or concurs in making in an account or other document an entry which is or may be misleading, false or deceptive in a material particular, or who omits or concurs in omitting a material particular from an account or other document, is to be treated as falsifying the account or document.

83A Falsification of documents

S. 83A
inserted by
No. 36/1988
s. 7.

- (1) A person must not make a false document with the intention that he or she, or another person, shall use it to induce another person to accept it as genuine, and by reason of so accepting it to do or not to do some act to that other person's, or to another person's prejudice.

S. 83A(1)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 44),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 61).

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (2) A person must not use a document which is, and which he or she knows to be, false, with the intention of inducing another person to accept it as genuine, and by reason of so accepting it to do or not to do some act to that other person's, or to another person's prejudice.

S. 83A(2)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 44),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 61).

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 83A(3)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 44),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 61).

- (3) A person must not make a copy of a document which is, and which he or she knows to be, a false document, with the intention that he or she, or another person, shall use it to induce another person to accept it as a copy of a genuine document and by reason of so accepting it to do or not to do some act to that other person's, or to another person's prejudice.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 83A(4)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 44),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 61).

- (4) A person must not use a copy of a document which is, and which he or she knows to be, a false document, with the intention of inducing another person to accept it as a copy of a genuine document and by reason of so accepting it to do or not to do some act to that other person's, or to another person's prejudice.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 83A(5)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 44),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 61).

- (5) A person must not have in his or her custody, or under his or her control, a document which is, and which he or she knows to be, false, with the intention that the person or another shall use it to induce another person to accept it as genuine, and by reason of so accepting it to do or not to do some act to that other person's, or to another person's, prejudice.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (5A) A person must not, with the intention that he or she may commit an offence against subsection (1), make, or have in his or her custody, or under his or her control, a machine or implement, or paper or other material, which is, and which he or she knows to be, specially designed or adapted for the making of a document which, if made by him or her, would be false.
- Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (5B) A person must not, with the intention that another person may commit an offence against subsection (1), make, or have in his or her custody, or under his or her control, a machine or implement, or paper or other material, which is, and which he or she knows to be, specially designed or adapted for the making of a document which, if made by that other person, would be false.
- Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (5C) A person must not, without lawful excuse, make or have in his or her custody, or under his or her control, a machine or implement, or paper or other material, which is and which the person knows to be specially designed or adapted for the making of a document which, if made by him or her, would be false.
- Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (6) For the purpose of this section, a document is false if it purports—
- (a) to have been made in the form in which it is made by a person who did not in fact make it in that form; or

S. 83A(5A)
inserted by
No. 25/1989
s. 5,
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 44),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 61).

S. 83A(5B)
inserted by
No. 25/1989
s. 5,
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 44),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 61).

S. 83A(5C)
inserted by
No. 25/1989
s. 5,
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 45),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 62).

- (b) to have been made in the form in which it is made on the authority of a person who did not in fact authorise its making in that form; or
 - (c) to have been made in the terms in which it is made by a person who did not in fact make it in those terms; or
 - (d) to have been made in the terms in which it is made on the authority of a person who did not in fact authorise its making in those terms; or
 - (e) to have been altered in any respect by a person who did not in fact alter it in that respect; or
 - (f) to have been altered in any respect on the authority of a person who did not in fact authorise the alteration in that respect; or
 - (g) to have been made or altered on a date on which, or at a place at which, or otherwise in circumstances in which, it was not in fact made or altered; or
 - (h) to have been made or altered by an existing person who did not in fact exist.
- (7) For the purposes of this section, a person is to be treated as making a false document if the person alters a document so as to make it false in any respect (whether or not it is false in some other respect apart from that alteration).
- (8) For the purposes of this section, an act or omission is to a person's prejudice if, and only if, it is one that, if it occurs—
- (a) will result—
 - (i) in the person's temporary or permanent loss of property; or

- (ii) in the person's being deprived of an opportunity to earn remuneration or greater remuneration; or
 - (iii) in the person's being deprived of an opportunity to obtain a financial advantage otherwise than by way of remuneration; or
 - (b) will result in any person being given an opportunity—
 - (i) to earn remuneration or greater remuneration from the first-mentioned person; or
 - (ii) to obtain a financial advantage from the first-mentioned person otherwise than by way of remuneration; or
 - (c) will be the result of the person's having accepted a false document as genuine, or a copy of a false document as a copy of a genuine one, in connection with the person's performance of a duty.
- (9) In this section—
- (a) a reference to inducing a person to accept a false document as genuine, or a copy of a false document as a copy of a genuine document, shall be read as including a reference to causing a machine to respond to the document or copy as if it were a genuine document or a copy of a genuine document, as the case may be; and
 - (b) if—
 - (i) a machine so responds to a document or copy; and
 - (ii) the act or omission intended to be caused by the machine's so responding is an act or omission that, if it were an

act or omission of a person, would be to a person's prejudice within the meaning of subsection (1)—

the act or omission intended to be caused by the machine's so responding shall be deemed to be an act or omission to a person's prejudice.

- (10) In proceedings for an offence against this section, if it is necessary to allege an intent to induce a person to accept a false document as genuine, or a copy of a false document as a copy of a genuine one, it is not necessary to allege that the accused intended so to induce a particular person.

S. 83B
inserted by
No. 25/1989
s. 6.

83B Abolition of common law offences of forgery and uttering

The offences at common law of forgery and uttering are abolished except as regards offences alleged to have been committed before the commencement of section 6 of the **Crimes Legislation (Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 1989**.

S. 84
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

84 Liability of company officers for certain offences by company

- (1) Where an offence committed by a body corporate under section 81, 82 or 83 is proved to have been committed with the consent or connivance of any director, manager, secretary or other similar officer of the body corporate, or any person who was purporting to act in any such capacity, he as well as the body corporate shall be guilty of that offence, and shall be liable to be proceeded against and punished accordingly.

- (2) Where the affairs of a body corporate are managed by its members, this section shall apply in relation to the acts and defaults of a member in connexion with his functions of management as if he were a director of the body corporate.

85 False statements by company directors etc.

S. 85
amended by
No. 7876
s. 2(3),
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

- (1) Where an officer of a body corporate or unincorporated association (or person purporting to act as such), with intent to deceive members or creditors of the body corporate or association about its affairs, publishes or concurs in publishing a written statement or account which to his knowledge is or may be misleading, false or deceptive in a material particular, he is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (2) For purposes of this section a person who has entered into a security for the benefit of a body corporate or association is to be treated as a creditor of it.
- (3) Where the affairs of a body corporate or association are managed by its members, this section shall apply to any statement which a member publishes or concurs in publishing in connexion with his functions of management as if he were an officer of the body corporate or association.

S. 85(1)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 33),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 63).

86 Suppression etc. of documents

S. 86
amended by
No. 7876
s. 2(3),
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

S. 86(1)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 33),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 64).

S. 86(2)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 46),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 64).

- (1) A person who dishonestly, with a view to gain for himself or another or with intent to cause loss to another, destroys, defaces or conceals any valuable security, any will or other testamentary document or any original document of or belonging to, or filed or deposited in, any court of justice or any government department is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (2) A person who dishonestly, with a view to gain for himself or another or with intent to cause loss to another, by any deception procures the execution of a valuable security is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) and this subsection shall apply in relation to the making, acceptance, indorsement, alteration, cancellation or destruction in whole or in part of a valuable security, and in relation to the signing or sealing of any paper or other material in order that it may be made or converted into, or used or dealt with as, a valuable security, as if that were the execution of a valuable security.
- (3) For purposes of this section **deception** has the same meaning as in section 81, and **valuable security** means any document creating, transferring, surrendering or releasing any right to, in or over property, or authorizing the payment of money or delivery of any property, or evidencing the creation, transfer, surrender or release of any such right, or the payment of money or delivery of any property, or the satisfaction of any obligation.

87 Blackmail

- (1) A person is guilty of blackmail if, with a view to gain for himself or another or with intent to cause loss to another, he makes any unwarranted demand with menaces; and for this purpose a demand with menaces is unwarranted unless the person making it does so in the belief—
 - (a) that he has reasonable grounds for making the demand; and
 - (b) that the use of the menaces is proper means of reinforcing the demand.
- (2) The nature of the act or omission demanded is immaterial, and it is also immaterial whether the menaces relate to action to be taken by the person making the demand.
- (3) A person guilty of blackmail is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 87
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

S. 87(3)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 41),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 65).

Offences relating to goods stolen, &c.

Heading
preceding
s. 88
inserted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

88 Handling stolen goods

S. 88
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b),
amended by
No. 70/1987
s. 5(a)(b).

- (1) A person handles stolen goods if knowing or believing them to be stolen goods he dishonestly receives the goods or brings them into Victoria, or dishonestly undertakes or assists in bringing them

S. 88(1)
amended by
No. 59/2004
s. 3.

into Victoria or in their retention, removal, disposal or realization by or for the benefit of another person, or if he arranges to do so.

S. 88(2)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 40),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 66).

- (2) A person guilty of handling stolen goods is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 88(3)
inserted by
No. 9073
s. 2(a).

- (3) Where a married woman handles stolen goods, the fact that the person from whom she receives the goods is her husband shall not of itself constitute a defence to a charge under this section.

S. 88A
(Heading)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.6)
S. 88A
inserted by
No. 59/2004
s. 4.

88A Alternative charges of theft and handling stolen goods

If—

S. 88A(a)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.7).

- (a) a charge for an offence of theft under section 74 and a charge for an offence of handling stolen goods under section 88 are joined in the same indictment as alternative charges and tried together; and
- (b) the jury are satisfied beyond reasonable doubt that the accused is either guilty of theft or guilty of handling stolen goods but are unable to agree on which offence the accused should be found guilty of—

the jury must acquit the accused of handling stolen goods and find the accused guilty of theft and the accused is liable to punishment accordingly.

89 Advertising rewards for return of goods stolen or lost

Where any public advertisement of a reward for the return of any goods which have been stolen or lost uses any words to the effect that no questions will be asked, or that the person producing the goods will be safe from apprehension or inquiry, or that any money paid for the purchase of the goods or advanced by way of loan on them will be repaid, the person advertising the reward and any person who prints or publishes the advertisement shall on summary conviction be liable to a level 11 fine (5 penalty units maximum).

S. 89
amended by
No. 8181
s. 2(1)(Sch.
item 33),
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b),
amended by
Nos 9554
s. 2(2)(Sch. 2
item 52),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 47),
69/1997
s. 22(5).

90 Scope of offences relating to stolen goods

- (1) The provisions of this Act relating to goods which have been stolen shall apply whether the stealing occurred in Victoria or elsewhere, and whether it occurred before or after the commencement of this Act, provided that the stealing (if not an offence under this Act) amounted to an offence where and at the time when the goods were stolen; and references to stolen goods shall be construed accordingly.
- (2) For purposes of those provisions references to stolen goods shall include, in addition to the goods originally stolen and parts of them (whether in their original state or not)—
 - (a) any other goods which directly or indirectly represent or have at any time represented the stolen goods in the hands of the thief as being the proceeds of any disposal or realization of the whole or part of the goods stolen or of goods so representing the stolen goods; and

S. 90
amended by
No. 8181
s. 2(1)
(Sch. item 33),
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

- (b) any other goods which directly or indirectly represent or have at any time represented the stolen goods in the hands of a handler of the stolen goods or any part of them as being the proceeds of any disposal or realization of the whole or part of the stolen goods handled by him or of goods so representing them.
- (3) But no goods shall be regarded as having continued to be stolen goods after they have been restored to the person from whom they were stolen or to other lawful possession or custody, or after that person and any other person claiming through him have otherwise ceased as regards those goods to have any right to restitution in respect of the theft.
- (4) For purposes of the provisions of this Act relating to goods which have been stolen (including subsections (1)(2) and (3)) goods obtained in Victoria or elsewhere either by blackmail or in the circumstances described in subsection (1) of section 81 shall be regarded as stolen; and *steal*, *theft* and *thief* shall be construed accordingly.

Heading
preceding
s. 91
inserted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

Possession of housebreaking implements, &c.

S. 91
amended by
No. 7876
s. 2(3),
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

91 Going equipped for stealing etc.

S. 91(1)
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 67(a)).

- (1) A person shall be guilty of a summary offence if, when not at his place of abode, he has with him any article for use in the course of or in connexion with any burglary, theft or cheat.

- (2) A person guilty of an offence under this section shall be liable to level 7 imprisonment (2 years maximum).

S. 91(2)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 34),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 67(b)).

- (3) Where a person is charged with an offence under this section, proof that he had with him any article made or adapted for use in committing a burglary, theft or cheat shall be evidence that he had it with him for such use.

- (4) On the conviction of a person for an offence under this section, the court may order the article to be forfeited to the Crown and disposed of in the manner set out in the order.

S. 91(4)
substituted by
No. 10249
s. 13.

92 Search for stolen goods

S. 92
amended by
No. 7876
s. 2(3),
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b),
amended by
No. 64/1990
s. 20(Sch.
item 3(a)(b)).

- (1) If a magistrate is satisfied by evidence on oath or by affirmation or by affidavit that there is reasonable cause to believe that any person has—
- (a) in the custody or possession of the person; or
 - (b) on any premises (including any vehicle on or in those premises) of the person; or
 - (c) on or in a particular vehicle located in a public place—

S. 92(1)
substituted by
No. 25/2009
s. 3(1),
amended by
No. 6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.1).

any stolen goods, the magistrate may grant a warrant to search for and seize those goods.

S. 92(1A)
inserted by
No. 25/2009
s. 3(1).

(1A) A warrant issued under subsection (1) must be addressed to a constable unless the warrant is issued under the authority of an enactment that expressly provides otherwise.

S. 92(2)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.7).

- (2) A police officer not below the rank of inspector may give a constable written authority to search any premises for stolen goods—
- (a) if the person in occupation of the premises has been convicted within the preceding five years of handling stolen goods or of any offence involving dishonesty and punishable with imprisonment; or
 - (b) if a person who has been convicted within the preceding five years of handling stolen goods has within the preceding twelve months been in occupation of the premises.

S. 92(3)
substituted by
No. 25/2009
s. 3(2).

(3) If under this section a person is authorised to search premises or a particular vehicle located in a public place for stolen goods, he or she may enter and search the premises or the vehicle accordingly, and may seize any goods the person believes to be stolen goods.

(4) This section is to be construed in accordance with section 90 and in subsection (2) the references to handling stolen goods shall include any corresponding offence committed before the commencement of the **Crimes (Theft) Act 1973**.

S. 92(5)
inserted by
No. 25/2009
s. 3(3).

(5) In this section—
public place has the same meaning as it has in section 3 of the **Summary Offences Act 1966**;
vehicle includes motor vehicle, aircraft and vessel.

93 Procedure and evidence

S. 93
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

- (1) Any number of persons may be charged in one indictment with reference to the same theft, with having at different times or at the same time handled all or any of the stolen goods, and the persons so charged may be tried together.
- (2) On the trial of two or more persons for jointly handling any stolen goods the jury may find any of the accused guilty if the jury are satisfied that he handled all or any of the stolen goods, whether or not he did so jointly with the other accused or any of them.
- (3) In any proceedings for the theft of anything in the course of transmission (whether by post or otherwise), or for handling stolen goods from such a theft, a statutory declaration made by any person that he despatched or received or failed to receive any goods or postal packet, or that any goods or postal packet when despatched or received by him were or was in a particular state or condition, shall be admissible as evidence of the facts stated in the declaration, subject to the following conditions—
 - (a) a statutory declaration shall only be admissible where and to the extent to which oral evidence to the like effect would have been admissible in the proceedings; and
 - (b) a statutory declaration shall only be admissible if at least seven days before the hearing or trial a copy of it has been given to the person charged, and he has not, at least three days before the hearing or trial or within such further time as the court may in special circumstances allow, given to the informant or the Director of Public

S. 93(1)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.8).

S. 93(3)(b)
amended by
No. 9848
s. 18(1).

Prosecutions as the case requires, written notice requiring the attendance at the hearing or trial of the person making the declaration.

- (4) This section is to be construed in accordance with section 90.

S. 94
amended by
No. 7876
s. 2(3),
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b),
repealed by
No. 10260
s. 114(Sch. 4
item 4).

* * * * *

Heading
preceding
s. 95
inserted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

General and consequential provisions

S. 95
amended by
No. 8181
s. 2(1)
(Sch. item 33),
substituted by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(b).

95 Husband and wife

- (1) This Act shall apply in relation to the parties to a marriage, and to property belonging to the wife or husband whether or not by reason of an interest derived from the marriage, as it would apply if they were not married and any such interest subsisted independently of the marriage.

S. 95(2)
amended by
No. 19/1987
s. 27(a),
repealed by
No. 69/2009
s. 37.

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S. 95(3)
amended by
No. 9848
s. 18(1),
repealed by
No. 19/1987
s. 27(b).

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Ss 96–174
repealed.⁴

Secret commissions prohibition

Heading
preceding
s. 175
amended by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(d).

175 Definitions⁵

No. 6103
s. 175.

(1) For the purposes of this subdivision—

advice given and words to the like effect include every report certificate statement and suggestion intended to influence the person to whom the same may be made or given and every influence exercised by one person over another;

agent includes any corporation or other person acting or having been acting or desirous or intending to act for or on behalf of any corporation or other person whether as agent partner co-owner clerk servant employee banker broker auctioneer architect clerk of works engineer legal practitioner surveyor buyer salesman foreman trustee executor administrator liquidator trustee within the meaning of any Act relating to bankruptcy receiver director manager or other officer or member of committee or governing body of any corporation club partnership or association or in any other capacity either alone or jointly with any other person and whether in his own name or in the name of his principal or otherwise and a person serving under the Crown;

S. 175(1)
def. of
agent
amended by
Nos 74/2000
s. 3(Sch. 1
item 30.1),
18/2005
s. 18(Sch. 1
item 27.2).

contract includes contract of sale or of employment or any other contract whatever;

in relation to his principal's affairs or business
implies the additional words "whether within the scope of his authority or course of his employment as agent or not";

person having business relations with the principal includes every corporation or other person whether as principal or agent carrying on or having carried on or desirous or intending to carry on any negotiation or business with or engaged or having been engaged or desirous or intending to be engaged in the performance of any contract with or in the execution of any work or business for or in the supply of any goods or chattels to any principal and also includes any agent of such corporation or other person;

principal includes a corporation or other person for or on behalf of whom the agent acts has acted or is desirous or intending to act;

solicit any valuable consideration and valuable consideration solicited and words to the like effect shall be construed with the following directions, namely:—That every agent who diverts obstructs or interferes with the proper course of business or manufacture or impedes or obstructs or fails to use due diligence in the prosecution of any negotiation or business with the intent to obtain the gift of any valuable consideration from any person interested in the said negotiation or business or with intent to injure any such person shall be deemed to have solicited a valuable consideration from a person having business relations with the principal of such agent;

trustee includes trustee executor administrator liquidator trustee within the meaning of any Act relating to bankruptcy receiver director administrator or guardian under the **Guardianship and Administration Act 2019** or attorney under an enduring power of attorney under the **Powers of Attorney Act 2014** or person having power to appoint a trustee or person entitled to obtain probate of the will or letters of administration to the estate of a deceased person;

S. 175(1)
def. of
trustee
amended by
Nos 25/1989
s. 20(c),
52/1998
s. 311(Sch. 1
item 17),
57/2014 s. 149,
13/2019
s. 221(Sch. 1
item 11).

valuable consideration includes any money loan office place employment agreement to give employment benefit or advantage whatsoever and any commission or rebate deduction or percentage bonus or discount or any forbearance to demand any money or money's worth or valuable thing and the acceptance of any of the said things shall be deemed the receipt of a valuable consideration;

valuable consideration when used in connexion with the offer thereof includes any offer of any agreement or promise to give and every holding out of any expectation of valuable consideration;

valuable consideration when used in connexion with the receipt thereof includes any acceptance of any agreement promise or offer to give and of any holding out of any expectation of valuable consideration.

- (2) Any act or thing prohibited by this subdivision is prohibited whether done directly or indirectly by the person mentioned or by or through any other person.

No. 6103
s. 176.

176 Receipt or solicitation of secret commission by an agent an indictable offence⁶

- (1) Whosoever being an agent corruptly receives or solicits from any person for himself or for any other person any valuable consideration—
- (a) as an inducement or reward for or otherwise on account of doing or forbearing to do or having done or forborne to do any act in relation to his principal's affairs or business; or
 - (b) the receipt or any expectation of which would in any way tend to influence him to show or to forbear to show favour or disfavour to any person in relation to his principal's affairs or business; or
- (2) Whosoever corruptly gives or offers to any agent any valuable consideration—
- (a) as an inducement or reward for or otherwise on account of doing or forbearing to do or having done or forborne to do any act in relation to his principal's affairs or business; or
 - (b) the receipt or any expectation of which would in any way tend to influence him to show or to forbear to show favour or disfavour to any person in relation to his principal's affairs or business—

S. 176(2)
amended by
Nos 9554
s. 2(2)(Sch. 2
item 53), 9576
s. 11(1),
36/1988
s. 8(a)(i)–(iii),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 48),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 68).

shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and
shall—

be liable if a corporation to a level 5 fine and
if any other person to level 5 imprisonment
(10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine or
both.

177 Secret gifts to parent, wife, child, partner etc. of agent deemed gifts to agent⁷

No. 6103
s. 177.

(1) Any valuable consideration given or offered to any parent husband wife or child of any agent or to his partner clerk or employee or at the agent's request to any person by any person having business relations with the principal of such agent shall be deemed to have been given or offered to the agent.

S. 177(1)
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 62(3).

(2) Any valuable consideration received or solicited by any parent husband wife or child of any agent or by his partner clerk or employee from any person having business relations with the principal of such agent shall be deemed to have been received or solicited by the agent, unless it is proved that the valuable consideration was so received or solicited without the consent knowledge or privity of the agent.

S. 177(2)
amended by
No. 74/2000
s. 3(Sch. 1
item 30.2).

178 Giving or receiving false or misleading receipt or account an indictable offence⁸

No. 6103
s. 178.

If with intent to deceive or defraud the principal any person gives to any agent or any agent receives or uses or gives to the principal any receipt invoice account or document in respect of which or in relation to a dealing transaction or matter in which the principal is interested and which—

S. 178
amended by
Nos 9554
s. 2(2)(Sch. 2
item 53), 9576
s. 11(1),
36/1988
s. 8(b)(i)–(iii),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 48),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 68).

(a) contains any statement which he knows is false or erroneous or defective in any important particular or is in any way likely to mislead the principal; or

- (b) omits to state explicitly and fully the fact of any commission percentage bonus discount rebate repayment gratuity or deduction having been made given or allowed or agreed to be made given or allowed—

he shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall—

be liable if a corporation to a level 5 fine and if any other person to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine or both.

No. 6103
s. 179.

179 Gift or receipt of secret commission in return for advice given⁹

S. 179(1)
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1).

- (1) Whenever any advice is given by one person to another and such advice is in any way intended to induce or influence the person advised—

- (a) to enter into a contract with any third person;
or

- (b) to appoint or join with another in appointing or to vote for or to aid in obtaining the election or appointment or to authorize or join with another in authorizing the appointment of any third person as trustee—

and any valuable consideration is given by such third person to the person giving the advice without the assent of the person advised the gift or receipt of the valuable consideration shall be an indictable offence, but this subsection shall not apply when the person giving the advice was to the knowledge of the person advised the agent of such third person, or when the valuable consideration was not given in respect of such advice.

- (2) Any offer or solicitation of a valuable consideration in respect of any advice given or to be given by one person to another with a view to induce or influence the person advised—

S. 179(2)
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1).

- (a) to enter into a contract with the person offering or solicited; or
- (b) to appoint or join with another in appointing or to vote for or to aid in obtaining the election or appointment or to authorize or join with another in authorizing the appointment of the person offering or solicited as trustee—

and with the intent that the gift or receipt of such valuable consideration is not to be made known to the person advised shall be an indictable offence, but this subsection shall not apply when such first-mentioned person is the agent of the person offering or solicited.

- (3) Any person on conviction of an indictable offence under any of the provisions of this section shall—

S. 179(3)
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1).

- (a) be liable if a corporation to a level 5 fine and if any other person to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine or both.

S. 179(3)(a)
amended by
Nos 9554
s. 2(2)(Sch. 2
item 54),
36/1988
s. 8(c)(i)(ii),
25/1989
s. 20(d),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 48),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 68).

* * * * *

S. 179(3)(b)
repealed by
No. 36/1988
s. 8(c)(iii).

S. 180
amended by
Nos 9554
s. 2(2)(Sch. 2
item 54), 9576
s. 11(1),
36/1988
s. 8(d),
25/1989
s. 20(e),
57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.5),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 48),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 68),
substituted by
No. 20/2025
s. 3.

180 Corrupt inducement or reward for replacement of trustee

- (1) A person must not offer or give valuable consideration to a trustee—
- (a) for a dishonest or otherwise corrupt purpose; and
 - (b) intending to induce the trustee to appoint a person in the trustee's place.

Penalty: In the case of an individual, level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum) or both;

In the case of a body corporate, a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum).

- (2) A person must not offer or give valuable consideration to a former trustee—
- (a) for a dishonest or otherwise corrupt purpose; and
 - (b) intending to reward the former trustee for having appointed a person in the former trustee's place.

Penalty: In the case of an individual, level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum) or both;

In the case of a body corporate, a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum).

- (3) A trustee must not solicit or receive valuable consideration for the trustee or any other person—
- (a) for a dishonest or otherwise corrupt purpose; and

- (b) intending to appoint a person in the trustee's place in return for that consideration.

Penalty: In the case of an individual, level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum) or both;

In the case of a body corporate, a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum).

- (4) A former trustee who has appointed a person in the former trustee's place must not solicit valuable consideration for the former trustee or any other person—

- (a) for a dishonest or otherwise corrupt purpose; and

- (b) intending that the consideration be a reward for that appointment.

Penalty: In the case of an individual, level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum) or both;

In the case of a body corporate, a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum).

- (5) A former trustee who has appointed a person in the former trustee's place must not receive valuable consideration for the former trustee or any other person that is given, and that the former trustee knows or believes is given—

- (a) for a dishonest or otherwise corrupt purpose; and

(b) as a reward for that appointment.

Penalty: In the case of an individual, level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum) or both;

In the case of a body corporate, a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum).

(6) In this section—

appoint includes—

- (a) authorise an appointment; or
- (b) join in an appointment; or
- (c) join in the authorising of an appointment.

No. 6103
s. 181.
S. 181
amended by
Nos 9554
s. 2(2)(Sch. 2
item 53), 9576
s. 11(1),
36/1988
s. 8(e)(i)–(iii),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 48),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 68).

181 Aiding and abetting offences within or outside Victoria¹⁰

Every person who being within Victoria knowingly aids, abets, counsels, or procures, or who attempts or takes part in or is in any way privy to—

- (a) doing any act or thing in contravention of this subdivision;
- (b) doing any act or thing outside Victoria, or partly within and partly outside Victoria, which if done within Victoria would be in contravention of this subdivision—

shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall—

be liable if a corporation to a level 5 fine and if any other person to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine or both.

182 Liability of directors etc. acting without authority¹¹

Every director manager or officer of a company and every person acting for another who knowingly takes part in or is in any way privy to doing or who attempts to do any act or thing without authority which if authorized would be in contravention of any of the provisions of this subdivision shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall—

- (a) be liable if a corporation to a level 5 fine and if any other person to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine or both.

No. 6103
s. 182.
S. 182
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1).

S. 182(a)
amended by
Nos 9554
s. 2(2)(Sch. 2
item 54),
36/1988
s. 8(f)(i)(ii),
25/1989
s. 20(f),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 48),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 68).

* * * *

S. 182(b)
repealed by
No. 36/1988
s. 8(f)(iii).

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S. 183
repealed by
No. 10260
s. 114(Sch. 4
item 4).

184 Protection of witness giving answers criminating himself¹²

A person who is called as a witness in any proceedings shall not be excused from answering any question relating to any offence under this subdivision on the ground that the answer thereto may criminate or tend to criminate him:

No. 6103
s. 184.

Provided that—

S. 184(a)
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.6).

- (a) a witness who in the judgment of the court answers truly all questions which he is required by the court to answer shall be entitled to receive a certificate from the court stating that such witness has so answered; and

S. 184(b)
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.6).

- (b) an answer by a person to a question put by or before the court in any proceeding under this subdivision shall not except in the said proceeding or in the case of any criminal proceedings for perjury in respect of such evidence be in any proceeding civil or criminal admissible in evidence against him.

No. 6103
s. 185.

185 Stay of proceedings against such witness¹³

S. 185
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.7).

When a person has received a certificate as aforesaid and any criminal proceeding is at any time instituted against him in respect of the offence which was in question in the proceeding in which the said person was called as a witness the court having cognizance of the case shall on proof of the certificate and of the identity of the offence in question in the two cases stay the proceedings.

No. 6103
s. 186.

186 Custom of itself no defence¹⁴

- (1) In any prosecution under this subdivision it shall not amount to a defence to show that any such valuable consideration as is mentioned in this subdivision is customary in any trade or calling.
- (2) For the purposes of this subdivision where it is proved that any valuable consideration has been received or solicited by an agent from or given or offered to an agent by any person having business relations with the principal without the assent of the principal the burden of proving that such valuable consideration was not received solicited

given or offered in contravention of any of the provisions of this subdivision shall be on the accused.

*	*	*	*	*	S. 186(3) repealed by No. 7546 s. 5.
*	*	*	*	*	S. 186(4) repealed by No. 9848 s. 18(1).
*	*	*	*	*	S. 186(5) amended by No. 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. item 42.8), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(1) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

Fraudulently inducing persons to invest

					Heading preceding s. 187 substituted by No. 8425 s. 2(1)(e) (as amended by No. 9019 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 257)).
*	*	*	*	*	Ss 187–190 repealed by No. 8425 s. 2(1)(f).

No. 6103
s. 191.

191 Fraudulently inducing persons to invest money

S. 191(1)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 49),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 69).

- (1) Any person who, by any statement promise or forecast which he knows to be misleading false or deceptive or by any dishonest concealment of material facts or by the reckless making of any statement promise or forecast which is misleading false or deceptive, induces or attempts to induce another person—
- (a) to enter into or offer to enter into—
 - (i) any agreement for or with a view to acquiring disposing of subscribing in or underwriting securities or lending or depositing money to or with any corporation; or
 - (ii) any agreement the purpose or pretended purpose of which is to secure a profit to any of the parties from the yield of securities or by reference to fluctuations in the value of securities; or
 - (b) to acquire or offer to acquire any right or interest under any arrangement the purpose or effect or pretended purpose or effect of which is to provide facilities for the participation by persons in profits or income alleged to arise or to be likely to arise from the acquisition holding management or disposal of any property other than securities; or

- (c) to enter into or offer to enter into an agreement the purpose or pretended purpose of which is to secure a profit to any of the parties by reference to fluctuations in the value of any property other than securities—

shall be guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

- (2) Any person guilty of conspiracy to commit any offence against the last preceding subsection shall be punishable as if he had committed such an offence.

- (3) In this section unless inconsistent with the context or subject-matter—

S. 191(3)
amended by
No. 6716
s. 2(Sch. 1).

corporation means any body corporate whether incorporated in Victoria or elsewhere;

debentures means any debentures debenture stock or bonds of a corporation, whether constituting a charge on the assets of the corporation or not;

securities means—

S. 191(3)
def. of
securities
amended by
No. 25/2023
s. 7(Sch. 1
item 6.1).

- (a) shares or debentures or rights or interests (whether described as units or otherwise) in any shares or debentures; or

- (b) securities of the Government of any part of His Majesty's dominions or the Government of any foreign state; or

- (c) rights (whether actual or contingent) in respect of money lent to or deposited with any corporation—

and includes rights or interests (whether described as units or otherwise) which may be acquired under any trust scheme under which all property for the time being subject to any trust created in pursuance of the

scheme consists of such securities as are mentioned in paragraph (a)(b) or (c) of this interpretation;

shares means shares in the share capital of a corporation or stock of a corporation.

S. 192
repealed by
No. 69/2009
s. 38.

* * * *

S. 193
repealed by
No. 9848
s. 18(1).

* * * *

Pt 1 Div. 2
Subdiv. (21)
(Heading and
ss 194, 195)
repealed by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(f).

* * * *

Pt 1 Div. 2AA
(Heading and
ss 192A–192E)
inserted by
No. 22/2009
s. 3.

Division 2AA—Identity crime

S. 192A
inserted by
No. 22/2009
s. 3.

192A Definitions

In this Division—

identification documentation means a document or other thing that—

- (a) contains or incorporates identification information; and
- (b) is capable of being used by a person for the purpose of pretending to be, or passing themselves off as, another person (whether living or dead, or real or fictitious);

identification information means information relating to a person (whether living or dead, or real or fictitious) that is capable of being used (whether alone or in conjunction with other information) to identify, or purportedly identify, the person, being information such as—

- (a) a name, address, date of birth or place of birth;
- (b) information as to the person's marital status;
- (c) information that identifies another person as a relative of the person;
- (d) a driver licence or driver licence number;
- (e) a passport or passport number;
- (f) biometric data;
- (g) a voice print;
- (h) a credit or debit card, its number or data stored or encrypted on it;
- (i) a financial account number, user name or password;
- (j) a digital signature;
- (k) a series of numbers or letters (or both) intended for use as a means of personal identification;
- (l) an Australian Business Number within the meaning of the A New Tax System (Australian Business Number) Act 1999 of the Commonwealth.

S. 192B
inserted by
No. 22/2009
s. 3.

192B Making, using or supplying identification information

- (1) A person, who makes, uses or supplies identification information (that is not identification information that relates to that person), and—
 - (a) who is aware that, or aware that there is a substantial risk that, the information is identification information; and
 - (b) who intends to use or supply the information to commit an indictable offence, or to facilitate the commission of an indictable offence—

is guilty of an offence and liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

Note

See section 426 for an alternative verdict for this offence.

- (2) A person may be found guilty of an offence against this section even if the commission of the indictable offence is impossible.
- (3) It is not a defence to a charge for an offence against this section that the person to whom the identification information relates consented to the making, use or supply of the identification information.

S. 192C
inserted by
No. 22/2009
s. 3.

192C Possession of identification information

- (1) A person, who possesses identification information (that is not identification information that relates to the person), and—
 - (a) who is aware that, or aware that there is a substantial risk that, the information is identification information; and

(b) who intends to use the information to commit an indictable offence, or to facilitate the commission of an indictable offence—

is guilty of an offence and liable to imprisonment for a term not exceeding 3 years.

- (2) A person may be found guilty of an offence against this section even if the commission of the indictable offence is impossible.
- (3) It is not a defence to a charge for an offence against this section that the person to whom the identification information relates consented to the possession of the identification information.

192D Possession of equipment used to make etc. identification documentation

S. 192D
inserted by
No. 22/2009
s. 3.

- (1) A person, who possesses equipment that is capable of being used to make, use, supply or retain identification documentation, and—
- (a) who intends to use, or who intends that another person will use, the equipment to make, use, supply or retain identification documentation; and
- (b) who intends to use any such identification documentation to commit an indictable offence or to facilitate the commission of an indictable offence—

is guilty of an offence and liable to imprisonment for a term not exceeding 3 years.

- (2) A person may be found guilty of an offence against this section even if the commission of the indictable offence is impossible.

192E Not an offence to attempt to commit an identity crime offence

S. 192E
inserted by
No. 22/2009
s. 3.

It is not an offence to attempt to commit an offence against section 192B, 192C or 192D.

Pt 1 Div. 2A
(Heading and
ss 193–195A)
inserted by
No. 104/2003
s. 3.

Division 2A—Money laundering etc.

New s. 193
inserted by
No. 104/2003
s. 3.

193 Definitions

(1) In this Division—

deal with includes receive, possess, conceal or dispose of;

instrument of crime means property that is used in the commission of, or used to facilitate the commission of—

- (a) an offence referred to in Schedule 1 to the **Confiscation Act 1997**; or
- (b) an offence against a law of the Commonwealth that may be dealt with as an indictable offence (even if it may, in some circumstances, be dealt with as a summary offence); or
- (c) an offence against a law of another State, a Territory or a country outside Australia that would have constituted an offence referred to in paragraph (a) if it had been committed in Victoria;

proceeds of crime means property that is derived or realised, directly or indirectly, by any person from the commission of—

- (a) an offence referred to in Schedule 1 to the **Confiscation Act 1997**; or
- (b) an offence against a law of the Commonwealth that may be dealt with as an indictable offence (even if it may, in some circumstances, be dealt with as a summary offence); or

- (c) an offence against a law of another State, a Territory or a country outside Australia that would have constituted an offence referred to in paragraph (a) if it had been committed in Victoria;

property includes money and all other property real or personal including things in action and other intangible property.

- (2) For the purposes of the definitions of *instrument of crime* and *proceeds of crime*, it is necessary to prove facts that constitute one or more offences referred to in paragraph (a), (b) or (c) of those definitions but the particulars of an offence need not be proven.

194 Dealing with proceeds of crime

New s. 194
inserted by
No. 104/2003
s. 3.

- (1) A person must not deal with proceeds of crime—
 - (a) knowing that it is proceeds of crime; and
 - (b) intending to conceal that it is proceeds of crime.

Penalty: Level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum).

- (2) A person must not deal with proceeds of crime knowing that it is proceeds of crime.

Penalty: Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

- (3) A person must not deal with proceeds of crime being reckless as to whether or not it is proceeds of crime.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (4) A person must not deal with proceeds of crime being negligent as to whether or not it is proceeds of crime.

Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

- (5) It is a defence to a prosecution for an offence under this section if the accused satisfies the court that the accused dealt with the property in order to assist the enforcement of a law of the Commonwealth, a State or a Territory.

New s. 195
inserted by
No. 104/2003
s. 3.

195 Dealing with property suspected of being proceeds of crime

A person who deals with property if there are reasonable grounds to suspect that the property is proceeds of crime is guilty of a summary offence and liable to level 7 imprisonment (2 years maximum).

S. 195A
inserted by
No. 104/2003
s. 3.

195A Dealing with property which subsequently becomes an instrument of crime

- (1) A person is guilty of an offence and liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum) if—
- (a) the person deals with property intending that the property will become an instrument of crime; and
 - (b) the property subsequently becomes an instrument of crime.
- (2) A person is guilty of an offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) if—
- (a) the person deals with property being reckless as to whether or not the property will become an instrument of crime; and
 - (b) the property subsequently becomes an instrument of crime.

- (3) A person is guilty of an offence and liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum) if—
 - (a) the person deals with property being negligent as to whether or not the property will become an instrument of crime; and
 - (b) the property subsequently becomes an instrument of crime.
- (4) A prosecution for an offence under this section must not be commenced without the consent of the Director of Public Prosecutions.
- (5) It is a defence to a prosecution for an offence under this section if the accused satisfies the court that the accused dealt with the property in order to assist the enforcement of a law of the Commonwealth, a State or a Territory.

Division 2B—Cheating at gambling

Pt 1 Div. 2B
(Heading and
ss 195B–
195F)
inserted by
No. 20/2013
s. 3.

195B Interpretation

S. 195B
inserted by
No. 20/2013
s. 3.

- (1) In this Division—
 - bet* includes—
 - (a) place, accept or withdraw a bet; and
 - (b) cause a bet to be placed, accepted or withdrawn;
 - causing a financial disadvantage* includes—
 - (a) causing a financial disadvantage to another person; and

- (b) inducing a third person to do something that results in another person suffering a financial disadvantage—

whether the financial disadvantage is permanent or temporary;

conduct means an act or omission to do an act;

conduct that corrupts or would corrupt a betting outcome of an event or an event contingency means conduct that—

- (a) affects or, if engaged in, would or would be likely to affect the outcome of any type of betting on the event or event contingency; and
- (b) is contrary to the standards of integrity that a reasonable person would expect of persons in a position to affect the outcome of any type of betting on the event or event contingency;

encourage includes incite, induce, persuade, urge, threaten or pressure;

engage in conduct means—

- (a) do an act; or
- (b) omit to do an act;

event means an event (whether it takes place in Victoria or elsewhere) on which it is lawful to bet under a law of Victoria, another State, a Territory or the Commonwealth;

event contingency means a contingency connected to an event, being a contingency on which it is lawful to bet under a law of Victoria, another State, a Territory or the Commonwealth;

obtaining a financial advantage includes—

- (a) obtaining a financial advantage for oneself or another person; and
- (b) inducing a third person to do something that results in obtaining a financial advantage for oneself or for another person; and
- (c) retaining a financial advantage that one has—

whether the financial advantage is permanent or temporary.

- (2) In a proceeding for an offence against this Division, an accused will be taken to have intended to obtain a financial advantage, or cause a financial disadvantage, if, and only if, it is proved that the accused—
 - (a) intended to obtain a financial advantage, or to cause a financial disadvantage, in connection with betting on an event or event contingency; or
 - (b) was aware that another person intended to obtain a financial advantage, or to cause a financial disadvantage, in connection with betting on an event or event contingency as a result of the conduct that is the subject of the charge.
- (3) In a proceeding for an offence against this Division, it is not necessary to prove that a financial advantage was actually obtained or a financial disadvantage was actually caused.

S. 195C
inserted by
No. 20/2013
s. 3.

**195C Engaging in conduct that corrupts or would corrupt
a betting outcome of event or event contingency**

A person must not engage in conduct that corrupts or would corrupt a betting outcome of an event or event contingency—

- (a) knowing that, or being reckless as to whether, the conduct corrupts or would corrupt a betting outcome of the event or the event contingency; and
- (b) intending to obtain a financial advantage, or to cause a financial disadvantage, in connection with any betting on the event or the event contingency.

Penalty: level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 195D
inserted by
No. 20/2013
s. 3.

**195D Facilitating conduct that corrupts or would corrupt
a betting outcome of event or event contingency**

- (1) A person must not offer to engage in, or encourage another person to engage in, conduct that corrupts or would corrupt a betting outcome of an event or event contingency—

- (a) knowing that, or being reckless as to whether, the conduct corrupts or would corrupt a betting outcome of the event or event contingency; and
- (b) intending to obtain a financial advantage, or to cause a financial disadvantage, in connection with any betting on the event or the event contingency.

Penalty: level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (2) A person must not enter into an agreement or arrangement in respect of conduct that corrupts or would corrupt a betting outcome of an event or event contingency—

- (a) knowing that, or being reckless as to whether, the conduct the subject of the agreement or arrangement corrupts or would corrupt a betting outcome of the event or event contingency; and
- (b) intending to obtain a financial advantage, or to cause a financial disadvantage, in connection with any betting on the event or the event contingency.

Penalty: level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

195E Concealing conduct, agreement or arrangement

S. 195E
inserted by
No. 20/2013
s. 3.

- (1) A person must not encourage another person to conceal from a relevant authority conduct, or an agreement or arrangement in respect of conduct, that corrupts or would corrupt a betting outcome of an event or event contingency—
 - (a) knowing that, or being reckless as to whether, the conduct corrupts or would corrupt a betting outcome of the event or event contingency; and
 - (b) intending to obtain a financial advantage, or cause a financial disadvantage, in connection with any betting on the event or event contingency.

Penalty: level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (2) In this section *relevant authority* means—

- (a) a police officer; or
- (b) a body that has the official function of controlling, regulating or supervising an event or betting on an event; or

S. 195E(2)(a)
substituted by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.8).

S. 195F
inserted by
No. 20/2013
s. 3.

- (c) any other authority of a kind prescribed by regulation.

195F Use of corrupt conduct information for betting purposes

- (1) A person who—
 - (a) possesses information in connection with an event or event contingency about conduct that corrupts or would corrupt a betting outcome of the event or event contingency; and
 - (b) knows that, or is reckless as to whether, the information is about conduct that corrupts or would corrupt a betting outcome of the event or event contingency—

must not, if the information is relevant to the bet—

- (c) bet on the event or event contingency; or
- (d) encourage another person to bet on the event or event contingency in a particular way; or
- (e) communicate the information, or cause the information to be communicated, to another person who the first person knows or ought reasonably to know would, or would be likely to, bet on the event or event contingency.

Penalty: level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (2) In a proceeding for an offence against subsection (1)(d) or (e), it is not necessary to prove that the other person actually bet on the event or event contingency concerned.

**Division 2C—Offences against public order
and grossly offensive public conduct**

Pt 1 Div. 2C
(Heading)
amended by
No. 35/2022
s. 3.

Pt 1 Div. 2C
(Heading and
ss 195G–195I)
inserted by
No. 32/2017
s. 8.

**195G Abolition of certain common law offences against
public order**

S. 195G
inserted by
No. 32/2017
s. 8.

The offences at common law of affray, rout and riot are abolished.

195H Affray

S. 195H
inserted by
No. 32/2017
s. 8.

- (1) A person who uses or threatens unlawful violence and whose conduct would cause a person of reasonable firmness present at the scene to be terrified commits an offence and is liable to—
- (a) level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum); or
 - (b) imprisonment for 7 years if, at the time of committing the offence, the person is wearing a face covering used primarily—
 - (i) to conceal the person's identity; or
 - (ii) to protect the person from the effects of a crowd-controlling substance.

Example of unlawful violence

Engaging in unlawful fighting with another person.

- (2) A person is guilty of an offence under subsection (1) only if the person intends to use or threaten violence or is reckless as to whether the person's conduct involves the use of violence or threatens violence.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), a threat of unlawful violence must involve more than words alone.

- (4) An offence under subsection (1) may be committed—
 - (a) in private as well as public places; and
 - (b) whether or not a person of reasonable firmness is present at the scene.
- (5) For the purpose of subsection (1), if 2 or more persons use or threaten unlawful violence—
 - (a) it is the conduct of them taken together that must be considered; and
 - (b) it is immaterial whether or not those persons use or threaten unlawful violence simultaneously.

S. 195I
inserted by
No. 32/2017
s. 8.

195I Violent disorder

- (1) Violent disorder occurs where 6 or more persons (the *participants*) who are present together use or threaten unlawful violence with a common goal or intention and the conduct of them, taken together, causes injury to another person or causes damage to property.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)—
 - (a) violent disorder may occur in private as well as public places; and
 - (b) it is immaterial whether or not the participants use or threaten unlawful violence simultaneously; and
 - (c) the common goal or intention may be inferred from the conduct of the participants.
- (3) A participant in violent disorder commits an offence and is liable to—
 - (a) level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum);
or

- (b) level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum) if, at the time of committing the offence, the participant is wearing a face covering used primarily—
 - (i) to conceal the participant's identity; or
 - (ii) to protect the participant from the effects of a crowd-controlling substance.
- (4) A person is guilty of an offence under subsection (3) only if the person intends to use or threaten violence or is reckless as to whether the person's conduct involves the use of violence or threatens violence.
- (5) Subsection (4) does not affect the determination for the purposes of subsection (1) of the number of persons who are engaging in the conduct referred to in subsection (1).

195J Abolition of common law offence of outraging public decency

The offence at common law of outraging public decency is abolished.

S. 195J
inserted by
No. 35/2022
s. 4.

195K Grossly offensive public conduct

- (1) A person (*the offender*) commits an offence if—
 - (a) the offender engages in conduct that grossly offends community standards of acceptable conduct; and
 - (b) that conduct—
 - (i) is engaged in at a public place; or
 - (ii) is seen or heard by a person in a public place; and

S. 195K
inserted by
No. 35/2022
s. 4.

- (c) the offender knows that, or is reckless as to whether—
 - (i) the place at which the conduct is engaged in is a public place; or
 - (ii) the conduct is likely to be seen or heard by a person in a public place; and
 - (d) the offender knows, or a reasonable person would know, that the conduct would likely grossly offend community standards of acceptable conduct.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
 - (3) A reference in subsection (1) to conduct being seen or heard does not include seeing or hearing it by using electronic communication.
 - (4) A person's conduct does not grossly offend community standards of acceptable conduct just because—
 - (a) the person uses language that is profane, indecent or obscene; or
 - (b) the person is intoxicated.
 - (5) It is a defence to a charge for an offence against subsection (1) if the accused engaged in the conduct reasonably and in good faith—
 - (a) in the performance, exhibition or distribution of an artistic work; or
 - (b) in the course of any statement or publication made, or discussion or debate held, or any other conduct engaged in, for—
 - (i) a genuine political, academic, educational, artistic, religious, cultural or scientific purpose; or

- (ii) a purpose that is in the public interest;
or
 - (c) in making or publishing a fair and accurate report of any event or matter of public interest.
- (6) In this section—
- public place* means—
- (a) a public place within the meaning of section 3 of the **Summary Offences Act 1966**; or
 - (b) a non-Government school within the meaning of section 1.1.3(1) of the **Education and Training Reform Act 2006**; or
 - (c) a post-secondary education institution within the meaning of section 1.1.3(1) of the **Education and Training Reform Act 2006**.

195L Consent of Director of Public Prosecutions required

A prosecution for an offence against section 195K(1) must not be commenced without the consent of the Director of Public Prosecutions.

S. 195L
inserted by
No. 35/2022
s. 4.

Division 2D—Serious vilification

Pt 1 Div. 2D
(Heading and
ss 195M–
195R)
inserted by
No. 11/2025
s. 4.

195M Definitions

In this Division—

disability has the same meaning as in section 4(1) of the **Equal Opportunity Act 2010**;

S. 195M
inserted by
No. 11/2025
s. 4.

gender identity has the same meaning as in section 4(1) of the **Equal Opportunity Act 2010**;

protected attribute means any of the following attributes—

- (a) disability;
- (b) gender identity;
- (c) race;
- (d) religious belief or activity;
- (e) sex;
- (f) sex characteristics;
- (g) sexual orientation;
- (h) personal association (whether as a relative or otherwise) with a person who is identified by reference to any of the above attributes;

race has the same meaning as in section 4(1) of the **Equal Opportunity Act 2010**;

religious belief or activity has the same meaning as in section 4(1) of the **Equal Opportunity Act 2010**;

sex characteristics has the same meaning as in section 4(1) of the **Equal Opportunity Act 2010**;

sexual orientation has the same meaning as in section 4(1) of the **Equal Opportunity Act 2010**.

195N Incitement on ground of protected attribute

S. 195N
inserted by
No. 11/2025
s. 4.

- (1) A person commits an offence if—
 - (a) the person engages in conduct that is likely to incite hatred against, serious contempt for, revulsion towards or severe ridicule of, another person or a group of persons; and
 - (b) the person engages in the conduct on the ground of a protected attribute of the other person or the group; and
 - (c) the person either—
 - (i) intends that conduct to incite hatred against, serious contempt for, revulsion towards or severe ridicule of, the other person or the group; or
 - (ii) believes that conduct will probably incite hatred against, serious contempt for, revulsion towards or severe ridicule of, the other person or the group.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to 3 years imprisonment.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), the conduct may be constituted by a single occasion or by a number of occasions over a period of time.
- (5) If conduct engaged in from outside Victoria is alleged to constitute an offence against subsection (1), every person against whom the offence is alleged to have been committed must have been in Victoria when at least some of the conduct was engaged in for the conduct to constitute that offence.
- (6) Conduct that—
 - (a) is engaged in from outside Victoria; and

- (b) is against a group of persons that is defined solely by the possession of a protected attribute—

does not constitute an offence against subsection (1).

Example

If a person in another State engages in conduct that is against all people of a certain race, whether or not those people are within Victoria, that conduct does not constitute an offence against subsection (1).

- (7) If any of the conduct alleged to constitute an offence against subsection (1) is engaged in from within Victoria, it does not matter whether a person against whom the offence is alleged to have been committed was outside Victoria at that time.

S. 195O
inserted by
No. 11/2025
s. 4.

195O Threaten physical harm or property damage on ground of protected attribute

- (1) A person commits an offence if—
 - (a) the person threatens—
 - (i) physical harm towards another person or a group of persons; or
 - (ii) to damage property of, or otherwise related to, another person or a group of persons; and
 - (b) the person threatens the physical harm or the property damage on the ground of a protected attribute of the other person or the group; and
 - (c) the person either—
 - (i) intends that the other person or a person of the group will believe the threat will be carried out; or

- (ii) believes that the other person or a person of the group will probably believe the threat will be carried out.
- (2) A person who commits an offence against subsection (1) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (3) If a threat made from outside Victoria is alleged to constitute an offence against subsection (1), the following persons or property must have been in Victoria when the threat was made for the threat to constitute that offence—
 - (a) in the case of a threat to physically harm a person or a group of persons, that person or group; or
 - (b) in the case of a threat to damage property, that property.
- (4) If a threat that is alleged to constitute an offence against subsection (1) is made from within Victoria, it does not matter whether the following persons or property were outside Victoria at that time—
 - (a) in the case of a threat to physically harm a person, that person; or
 - (b) in the case of a threat to physically harm a group of persons, any of those persons; or
 - (c) in the case of a threat to damage property, that property.

195P Irrelevant whether incorrect about protected attribute

**S. 195P
inserted by
No. 11/2025
s. 4.**

In determining whether a person has committed an offence against section 195N(1) or 195O(1), it is irrelevant that the person was incorrect about—

- (a) a protected attribute of the other person or group of persons; or

- (b) whether the other person or group of persons had a particular protected attribute.

S. 195Q
inserted by
No. 11/2025
s. 4,
substituted by
No. 8/2026
s. 3.

195Q Prosecution of offences

A prosecution for an offence against section 195N(1) or 195O(1)—

- (a) may only be commenced by the Director of Public Prosecutions or a police officer; and
- (b) if the prosecution is of a person under the age of 18 years, may only be commenced by a police officer with the consent of the Director of Public Prosecutions.

S. 195R
inserted by
No. 11/2025
s. 4.

195R Criminal liability of officers of bodies corporate—accessorial liability

- (1) If a body corporate commits an offence against a provision specified in subsection (2), an officer of the body corporate also commits an offence against the provision if the officer—
 - (a) authorised or permitted the commission of the offence by the body corporate; or
 - (b) was knowingly concerned in any way (whether by act or omission) in the commission of the offence by the body corporate.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), the following provisions are specified—
 - (a) section 195N(1);
 - (b) section 195O(1).
- (3) Without limiting any other defence available to the officer, an officer of a body corporate may rely on a defence that would be available to the body corporate if it were charged with the offence with which the officer is charged and, in doing so, the officer bears the same burden of proof that the body corporate would bear.

(4) An officer of a body corporate may commit an offence against a provision specified in subsection (2) whether or not the body corporate has been prosecuted for, or found guilty of, an offence against that provision.

(5) In this section—

body corporate has the same meaning as corporation has in section 57A of the Corporations Act;

officer, in relation to a body corporate, means—

- (a) a person who is an officer (as defined by section 9 of the Corporations Act) of the body corporate; or
 - (b) a person (other than a person referred to in paragraph (a)), by whatever name called, who is concerned in, or takes part in, the management of the body corporate.
- (6) This section does not affect the operation of Subdivision (1) of Division 1 of Part II of this Act.

Division 2E—Performance crime

Pt 1 Div. 2E
(Heading and
ss 195S–
195W)
inserted by
No. 29/2025
s. 3.

195S Definitions

S. 195S
inserted by
No. 29/2025
s. 3.

(1) For the purposes of this Division—

material means—

- (a) any film, audio, photograph, printed matter, image, computer game or text;
or

- (b) any electronic material, including data from which text, images or sound may be generated; or
- (c) any other thing of any kind;

Note

See also subsection (2).

publish has the meaning given by section 195T;

relevant offence has the meaning given by section 195U.

- (2) For the purposes of this Division, an image may be still, moving, recorded or unrecorded.

S. 195T
inserted by
No. 29/2025
s. 3.

195T Meaning of *publish*

- (1) For the purposes of this Division, to ***publish*** material means to make the material available to the public or a section of the public—
 - (a) by electronic communication; or
 - (b) by sending, supplying, exhibiting, transmitting or communicating the material by any other means.
- (2) A person does not publish material by making the material available to only one other person.

S. 195U
inserted by
No. 29/2025
s. 3.

195U Meaning of *relevant offence*

- (1) For the purposes of this Division, a ***relevant offence*** is—
 - (a) an offence against any of the following sections—
 - (i) section 74 (theft), if the property stolen is a motor vehicle;
 - (ii) section 75 (robbery);
 - (iii) section 75A (armed robbery);
 - (iv) section 76 (burglary);

- (v) section 77 (aggravated burglary);
 - (vi) section 77A (home invasion);
 - (vii) section 77B (aggravated home invasion);
 - (viii) section 79 (carjacking);
 - (ix) section 79A (aggravated carjacking);
 - (x) section 195H (affray);
 - (xi) section 195I (violent disorder); or
 - (b) an offence against section 321G (incitement) or 321M (attempt) in relation to an offence referred to in paragraph (a).
- (2) However, an offence referred to in subsection (1)(a) or (b) is not a relevant offence if it is committed before the commencement of section 195V.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (2), if an offence is committed—
- (a) at an unidentified time between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement of section 195V; or
 - (b) throughout a period during which section 195V commences—
- the offence is committed before that commencement.

195V Publishing material about the commission of a relevant offence

**S. 195V
inserted by
No. 29/2025
s. 3.**

- (1) A person must not—
- (a) publish or cause to be published material that depicts, describes or otherwise indicates the commission of a relevant offence by the person; and

- (b) undertake or cause that publication with the intention of attracting attention to the commission of that offence.

Penalty: Level 7 imprisonment (2 years maximum).

- (2) An offence against subsection (1) is a summary offence.
- (3) Without limiting subsection (1)(a), material that depicts, describes or otherwise indicates the commission of a relevant offence includes material that depicts or describes—
 - (a) anything done in the course of committing the relevant offence; or
 - (b) property obtained from committing the relevant offence; or
 - (c) damage or harm caused by committing the relevant offence.
- (4) A person is not liable for an offence against subsection (1) unless the person is found guilty of the relevant offence referred to in subsection (1)(a), whether in the same proceeding or in an earlier proceeding.
- (5) Nothing in subsection (4) requires that a person must have been found guilty of a relevant offence before they may be charged with an offence against subsection (1) in respect of that relevant offence.

S. 195W
inserted by
No. 29/2025
s. 3.

195W Issue of search warrant by magistrate in respect of performance crime offence

- (1) Section 465 applies to and in respect of an offence against section 195V(1) as if it were an indictable offence.

- (2) The other provisions of Subdivision (31) of Division 1 of Part III apply in relation to a warrant issued under section 465, as applied by subsection (1), in the same way that those provisions apply in relation to any other warrant issued under section 465.

Division 2F—Use of knives in the commission of certain indictable offences

Pt 1 Div. 2F
(Heading and
s. 195X)
inserted by
No. 54/2025
s. 9.

195X Use of knives in the commission of certain indictable offences

S. 195X
inserted by
No. 54/2025
s. 9.

- (1) A person must not use a knife in committing a relevant offence.
- Penalty: 3 years imprisonment.
- (2) Each of the following is a relevant offence for the purposes of this section—
- (a) an offence against section 16 (causing serious injury intentionally);
 - (b) an offence against section 17 (causing serious injury recklessly);
 - (c) an offence against section 18 (causing injury intentionally or recklessly);
 - (d) an offence against section 31(1) constituted by the conduct described in paragraph (a) of that provision (assaulting, or threatening to assault, with intent to commit an indictable offence);
 - (e) an offence against section 195H (affray);
 - (f) an offence against section 195I (violent disorder).
- (3) A person is not liable for an offence against subsection (1) unless the person is found guilty of the relevant offence referred to in that subsection.

- (4) Nothing in subsection (3) requires that a person must have been found guilty of a relevant offence before they may be charged with an offence against subsection (1) in respect of that relevant offence.

Pt 1 Div. 3
(Heading)
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c),
new Pt 1
Div. 3
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(d).

Division 3—Criminal damage to property

Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdiv. (1)
(Heading)
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c),
new Pt 1 Div 3
Subdiv. (1)
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(d).

(1) *General offences and procedural provisions*

S. 196
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c),
new s. 196
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(d).

196 Definition

- (1) In this subdivision—

property means property of a tangible nature, whether real or personal, including money and including wild creatures which have been tamed or are ordinarily kept in captivity and any other wild creatures or their carcasses if, but only if, they have been reduced into possession which has not been lost or abandoned or are in the course of being reduced into possession.

- (2) For the purposes of this subdivision property shall be treated as belonging to any person—
(a) having the custody or control of it;

- (b) having in it any proprietary right or interest (not being an equitable interest arising only from an agreement to transfer or grant an interest); or
- (c) having a charge on it.
- (3) For the purposes of this subdivision property which is subject to a trust shall be treated as belonging to the trustee or trustees and the person or persons who have a right to enforce the trust.
- (4) For the purposes of this subdivision property of a corporation sole shall be treated as belonging to the corporation notwithstanding a vacancy in the corporation.

197 Destroying or damaging property

- (1) A person who intentionally and without lawful excuse destroys or damages any property belonging to another or to himself and another shall be guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (2) A person who intentionally and without lawful excuse destroys or damages any property, intending by the destruction or damage to endanger the life of another, shall be guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 197
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c),
new s. 197
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(d).

S. 197(1)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 50(a)),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 70(a)).

S. 197(2)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 50(b)),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 70(b)).

S. 197(3)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 49),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 70(c)).

- (3) A person who dishonestly, with a view to gain for himself or another, destroys or damages any property shall be guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).
- (4) For the purposes of subsections (1) and (2) a person who destroys or damages property shall be taken as doing so intentionally if, but only if—
 - (a) his purpose or one of his purposes is to destroy or damage property; or
 - (b) he knows or believes that his conduct is more likely than not to result in destruction of or damage to property.
- (5) For the purposes of subsection (2), a person who destroys or damages property shall be treated as intending thereby to endanger the life of another if, but only if—
 - (a) his purpose or one of his purposes is to endanger the life of another by the destruction or damage; or
 - (b) he knows or believes that the life of another is more likely than not to be endangered by the destruction or damage.
- (6) An offence against this section committed by destroying or damaging property by fire shall be charged as arson.
- (7) A person guilty of arson is liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum) despite anything to the contrary in this section.

S. 197(7)
inserted by
No. 95/1994
s. 4,
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 70(b)).

197A Arson causing death

A person who commits arson as defined in section 197 and thereby causes the death of another person is guilty of an indictable offence.

Penalty: Level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).

Note

An offence against this section is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See subsection (2H) of section 5 of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.

S. 197A
inserted by
No. 48/1997
s. 55.

Note to
s. 197A
inserted by
No. 65/2016
s. 20(19).

198 Threats to destroy or damage property

A person who without lawful excuse makes to another a threat—

- (a) to destroy or damage any property belonging to that other or a third person or to himself and that other or a third person; or
- (b) to destroy or damage his own property in a way which he knows or believes is more likely than not to endanger the life of that other or a third person—

shall, if he made the threat with the purpose of causing the other to fear that it would be carried out, be guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 198
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c),
new s. 198
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(d),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 51),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 71).

S. 199
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c),
new s. 199
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(d),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 52),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 72).

199 Possessing anything with intent to destroy or damage property

A person who has anything in his custody or under his control—

- (a) with the purpose of using it, or causing or permitting another to use it, without lawful excuse—
 - (i) to destroy or damage any property belonging to some other person or to himself, the user or both of them and some other person; or
 - (ii) to destroy or damage any property in a way which he knows or believes is more likely than not to endanger the life of some other person; or
- (b) with the purpose of using it, or causing or permitting another to use it, dishonestly and with a view to gain for himself or another, to destroy or damage property—

shall be guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

* * * * *

S. 200
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c),
new s. 200
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(d),
repealed by
No. 9576
s. 11(1).

201 Lawful excuse

- (1) This section applies to any offence under section 197(1), 198(a) or 199(a)(i).

S. 201
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c),
new s. 201
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(d).

- (2) A person charged with an offence to which this section applies shall, whether or not he would be treated for the purposes of this subdivision as having a lawful excuse apart from this subsection, be treated for those purposes as having a lawful excuse—
- (a) if at the time of the conduct alleged to constitute the offence he believed—
 - (i) that the property in question belonged solely to himself;
 - (ii) that he held a right or interest in the property in question which authorized him to engage in the conduct; or
 - (iii) that the person or persons whom he believed to be entitled to consent to the destruction or damage in question had so consented or would have so consented if he or they had known the circumstances of the destruction or damage; or
 - (b) if he engaged in the conduct alleged to constitute the offence in order to protect property belonging to himself or another or a right or interest in property which was or which he believed to be vested in himself or another, and at the time of such conduct he believed—
 - (i) that the property, right or interest which he sought to protect was in immediate need of protection; and
 - (ii) that the means of protection adopted or proposed to be adopted were or would be reasonable having regard to all the circumstances.

- (3) For the purposes of this section it is immaterial whether a belief is justified or not if it is honestly held.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (2) a right or interest in property includes any right or privilege in or over land, whether created by grant, licence or otherwise.
- (5) This section shall not be construed as taking away or otherwise affecting any other defence recognized by law as a defence to criminal charges.

S. 201A
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 4.

201A Intentionally or recklessly causing a bushfire

- (1) A person who—
 - (a) intentionally or recklessly causes a fire; and
 - (b) is reckless as to the spread of the fire to vegetation on property belonging to another—is guilty of an offence and liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)(b), circumstances in which a person is not to be taken to be reckless as to the spread of a fire include the following—
 - (a) the person caused the fire in the course of carrying out a fire prevention, fire suppression or other land management activity; and
 - (b) at the time the activity was carried out—
 - (i) there was in force a provision made by or under an Act or by a Code of Practice approved under an Act, that regulated or otherwise applied to the carrying out of the activity and the person in carrying out that activity

acted in accordance with the provision;
and

- (ii) the person believed that his or her conduct in carrying out the activity was justified having regard to all of the circumstances.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (2)(b)(ii) it is sufficient that a person honestly believed that the conduct was justified.
- (4) In this section—
 - (a) a reference to causing a fire includes—
 - (i) lighting a fire;
 - (ii) maintaining a fire;
 - (iii) failing to contain a fire, except where the fire was lit by another person or the fire is beyond the control of the person who lit the fire;
 - (b) *spread of the fire* means spread of the fire beyond the capacity of the person who caused the fire to extinguish it.

202 Jurisdiction of magistrates' courts

No rule of law ousting the jurisdiction of the Magistrates' Court to try offences where a dispute of title to property is involved shall preclude the Magistrates' Court from trying offences mentioned in this subdivision or from trying any other offences of destroying or damaging property.

S. 202
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c),
new s. 202
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(d),
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 3(Sch. item
42.9(a)–(c)).

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part I—Offences

S. 203 repealed by No. 9228 s. 2(1)(c).	*	*	*	*	*
S. 203A inserted by No. 8280 s. 12, amended by No. 9019 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 35), repealed by No. 9228 s. 2(1)(c).	*	*	*	*	*
Pt 1 Div. 3 Subdiv. (2) (Heading and ss 204, 205) repealed by No. 9228 s. 2(1)(c).	*	*	*	*	*
Pt 1 Div. 3 Subdiv. (3) (Heading) repealed by No. 9228 s. 2(1)(c).	*	*	*	*	*

(2) Injuries to buildings &c. by rioters and forcible entries and detainers

New Pt 1
Div. 3
Subdiv. (2)
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(e).

206 Rioters demolishing buildings¹⁵

No. 6103
s. 206.

- (1) Whosoever is one of any persons riotously and tumultuously assembled together to the disturbance of the public peace who unlawfully and with force demolish or pull down or destroy or begin to demolish pull down or destroy any church chapel meeting-house or other place of divine worship, or any house stable coach-house outhouse warehouse office shop mill malthouse hop-oast barn granary shed hovel or fold, or any building or erection used in farming land or in carrying on any trade or manufacture or any branch thereof, or any building other than such as are in this section before mentioned belonging to the King or the Government of Victoria or to any municipal council or belonging to any university, or devoted or dedicated to public use or ornament, or erected or maintained by public subscription or contribution, or any machinery (whether fixed or movable) prepared for or employed in any manufacture or any steam-engine or other engine for sinking working ventilating or draining any mine, or any staith building or erection used in conducting the business of any mine or any bridge waggon-way tramway trunk or shoot for conveying minerals from any mine, shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 206(1)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
12/1989
s. 4(1)(Sch. 2
item 20.1) (as
amended by
No. 13/1990
s. 38(1)(h)),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 53),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 73(a)),
25/2023
s. 7(Sch. 1
item 6.2).

S. 206(2)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 51),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 73(b)).

- (2) Whosoever is one of any persons riotously and tumultuously assembled together to the disturbance of the public peace who unlawfully and with force injure or damage any such place building or erection or thing as is in the last subsection mentioned, shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

No. 6103
s. 207.

207 Forcible entry

S. 207(1)
repealed by
No. 44/1997
s. 3.

* * * * *

- (2) No person being in actual possession of land for a period of less than three years by himself or his predecessors shall without colour of right hold possession of it in a manner likely to cause a breach of the peace or a reasonable apprehension of a breach of the peace against a person entitled by law to the possession of the land and able and willing to afford reasonable information as to his being so entitled.

S. 207(3)
amended by
Nos 9554
s. 2(2)(Sch. 2
item 55), 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 54),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 74(a)(b)).

- (3) Every person who is guilty of a contravention of this section shall be guilty of a summary offence and liable to level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 10 fine or both.

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part I—Offences

*	*	*	*	*	Pt 1 Div. 3 Subdivs (4)(5) (Headings and ss 208–210) repealed by No. 9228 s. 2(1)(c).
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 1 Div. 3 Subdivs (6)(7) (Headings and ss 211–222) amended by No. 7876 s. 2(3), repealed by No. 9228 s. 2(1)(c).
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 1 Div. 3 Subdiv. (8) (Heading and ss 223, 224) repealed by No. 9228 s. 2(1)(c).
(3) <i>Interference with mines, sea banks &c., railways and navigation aids</i>					New Pt 1 Div. 3 Subdiv. (3) (Heading) inserted by No. 9228 s. 2(1)(f).
225 Conveying water into a mine					No. 6103 s. 225.
Whosoever unlawfully and maliciously causes any water to be conveyed or run into any mine or into any subterraneous passage communicating therewith with intent thereby to destroy or damage such mine or to hinder or delay the working thereof, or with the like intent unlawfully and maliciously pulls down fills up or obstructs or damages with intent to destroy obstruct or render useless any airway waterway drain pit level shaft or drive of or belonging to any mine, shall be					S. 225 amended by Nos 9576 s. 11(1), 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 55), 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 75).

guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum). This provision shall not extend to any damage committed underground by any owner of any adjoining mine in working the same or by any person duly employed in such working.

S. 226
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

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Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdiv. (9)
(Heading and
s. 227)
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

* * * *

No. 6103
s. 228.

228 Removing etc. piles of sea banks

S. 228
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 53),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 75).

Whosoever unlawfully and maliciously cuts off draws up or removes any piles chalk or other materials fixed in the ground and used for securing any sea bank or sea wall or the bank dam or wall of any river canal drain aqueduct marsh reservoir pool port harbor dock quay wharf jetty or lock, or unlawfully and maliciously opens or draws up any floodgate or sluice or does any other injury or mischief to any navigable river or canal with intent to obstruct or prevent the carrying on completing or maintaining the navigation thereof, shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdivs
(10)(11)
(Headings
and
ss 229–231)
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

* * * *

	*	*	*	*	*	Pt 1 Div. 3 Subdiv. (12) (Heading) repealed by No. 9228 s. 2(1)(c).
232	Placing things on railways to obstruct or overturn engine etc.¹⁶					No. 6103 s. 232. S. 232 amended by Nos 9576 s. 11(1), 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 53), 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 76).
	Whosoever unlawfully and maliciously puts places casts or throws upon or across any railway any wood stone or other matter or thing, or unlawfully and maliciously takes up removes or displaces any rail sleeper or other thing belonging to any railway, or unlawfully and maliciously turns moves or diverts any points or other machinery belonging to any railway, or unlawfully and maliciously makes or shows hides or removes any signal or light upon or near to any railway, or unlawfully and maliciously does or causes to be done any other matter or thing with intent in any such case to obstruct upset overthrow injure or destroy any engine tender carriage or truck on such railway, shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).					
233	Obstructing engine, carriage etc. on railway¹⁷					No. 6103 s. 233. S. 233 amended by Nos 9576 s. 11(1), 49/1991 s. 119(1) (Sch. 2 item 56), 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 77(a)(b)).
	Whosoever by any unlawful act or by any wilful omission or neglect obstructs or causes to be obstructed any engine or carriage on any railway, or aids or assists therein, shall be guilty of a summary offence, and shall be liable to level 7 imprisonment (2 years maximum).					
	*	*	*	*	*	S. 234 repealed by No. 9228 s. 2(1)(c).

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part I—Offences

S. 235
amended by
Nos 7876
s. 2(3), 8247
s. 4,
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

* * * *

Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdiv. (13)
(Heading and
s. 236)
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

* * * *

Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdiv. (14)
(Heading and
ss 237, 238)
amended by
Nos 8181
s. 2(1)
(Sch. item 33),
8870 s. 2(1)(2),
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

* * * *

Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdiv. (15)
(Heading and
ss 239–243)
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

* * * *

No. 6103
s. 244.
S. 244
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 53),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 76).

244 Altering signals or exhibiting false ones

Whosoever unlawfully masks alters or removes any light or signal or exhibits any false light or signal with intent to bring any ship vessel or boat into danger, or unlawfully and maliciously does anything tending to the immediate loss or destruction of any ship vessel or boat and for which no punishment is hereinbefore provided, shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

245 Removing buoy etc.

Whosoever unlawfully and maliciously cuts away casts adrift removes alters defaces sinks or destroys or in any other manner injures or conceals, or unlawfully and maliciously does any act with intent to cut away cast adrift remove alter deface sink destroy, or in any other manner injure or conceal, any boat buoy rope perch or mark used or intended for the guidance of seamen or the purpose of navigation, shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

No. 6103
s. 245.
S. 245
amended by
Nos 8181
s. 2(1)
(Sch. item 36),
9576 s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 52),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 78).

* * * *

S. 246
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

* * * *

Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdiv. (15A)
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 7088
s. 2(d),
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

(4) *Injuries to aircraft*

New Pt 1
Div. 3
Subdiv. (4)
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(g).

S. 246A
inserted by
No. 7088
s. 2(d),
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 49),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 79).

246A Endangering safe operation of an aircraft

Any person who does any act or thing with intent to prejudice the safe operation of an aircraft shall be guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 246B
inserted by
No. 7088
s. 2(d),
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 53),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 80).

246B Setting fire etc. to aircraft

Any person who unlawfully and maliciously sets fire to or in any way destroys any aircraft whether complete or incomplete shall be guilty of an indictable offence and shall be liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 246C
inserted by
No. 7088
s. 2(d),
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 57),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 81).

246C Endangering safety of aircraft

Any person who while on board an aircraft does any act or thing that is likely to endanger the safety of the aircraft shall be guilty of an indictable offence and shall be liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

246D Dangerous goods on aircraft

S. 246D
inserted by
No. 7088
s. 2(d).

(1) Subject to this section any person who—

S. 246D(1)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 57),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 82).

- (a) carries or places dangerous goods on board an aircraft;
- (b) delivers dangerous goods to a person for the purpose of their being placed on board an aircraft; or
- (c) has dangerous goods in his possession on board an aircraft—

shall be guilty of an indictable offence and shall be liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

(2) This section does not apply—

- (a) to or in relation to any act done with the consent of the owner or operator of the aircraft given with a knowledge of the nature of the goods concerned; or
- (b) to or in relation to the carrying or placing of firearms or ammunition for firearms on board an aircraft with permission granted under the Air Navigation Regulations of the Commonwealth.

(3) In this section *dangerous goods* means—

- (a) firearms, ammunition, weapons and explosive substances; and
- (b) substances or things that, by reason of their nature or condition, may endanger the safety of an aircraft or of persons on board an aircraft.

S. 246E
inserted by
No. 7088
s. 2(d),
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 57),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 82).

246E Threats to safety of aircraft

Any person who threatens, states that it is his intention, or makes a statement from which it could reasonably be inferred that it is his intention to destroy damage or endanger the safety of an aircraft or to kill or injure all or any of the persons on board an aircraft shall be guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdiv. (15B)
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 9155
s. 4(a),
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

* * * *

S. 246F
inserted by
No. 7088
s. 2(d),
substituted by
No. 9155
s. 4(b),
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

* * * *

(5) *False statements*

Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdiv. (5)
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(h) (as
amended by
No. 9427
s. 6(1)).

247 False statements

Any person who makes a statement or conveys information, being a statement or information that he knows to be false, to the effect or from which it could reasonably be inferred that there has been or is to be a plan, proposal, attempt, conspiracy or threat to—

- (a) take or exercise control by force or violence of any building (including any structure in the nature of a building or any bridge or mine) aircraft, vessel, motor vehicle or engine or carriage used upon a railway;
- (b) destroy, damage or endanger the safety thereof; or
- (c) kill or injure all or any of the persons therein or thereon—

shall be guilty of an indictable offence and shall be liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 247
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c),
new s. 247
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(h) (as
amended by
No. 9427
s. 6(1)),
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 56),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 83).

Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdiv. (6)
(Heading and
ss 247A–247I)
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 5.

S. 247A
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 5.

(6) *Computer offences*

247A Interpretation

(1) In this Subdivision—

access, in relation to data held in a computer,
means—

- (a) the display of the data by the computer
or any other output of the data from the
computer; or
- (b) the copying or moving of the data to
any other place in the computer or to a
data storage device; or
- (c) in the case of a program, the execution
of the program;

data includes—

- (a) information in any form; and
- (b) any program or part of a program;

data held in a computer includes—

- (a) data entered or copied into the
computer; and
- (b) data held in any removable data storage
device for the time being in the
computer; and
- (c) data held in a data storage device on a
computer network of which the
computer forms part;

data storage device means any thing (for example,
a disk or file server) containing or designed
to contain data for use by a computer;

electronic communication means a communication of information in any form by means of guided or unguided electromagnetic energy;

impairment, in relation to electronic communication to or from a computer, includes—

- (a) the prevention of any such communication; and
- (b) the impairment of any such communication on an electronic link or network used by the computer—

but does not include a mere interception of any such communication;

modification, in relation to data held in a computer, means—

- (a) the alteration or removal of the data; or
- (b) an addition to the data;

serious computer offence means—

- (a) an offence against section 247B, 247C or 247D; or
- (b) conduct in another jurisdiction that is an offence in that jurisdiction and that would constitute an offence against section 247B, 247C or 247D if the conduct occurred in Victoria;

unauthorised computer function means any of the following—

- (a) any unauthorised access to data held in a computer; or
- (b) any unauthorised modification of data held in a computer; or

- (c) any unauthorised impairment of electronic communication to or from a computer.
- (2) In this Subdivision, a reference to access to data, modification of data or impairment of electronic communication is limited to access, modification or impairment caused (whether directly or indirectly) by the execution of a function of a computer.
- (3) For the purposes of this Subdivision, access to data, modification of data or impairment of electronic communication by a person—
 - (a) is unauthorised if the person is not entitled to cause that access, modification or impairment;
 - (b) is not unauthorised merely because the person has an ulterior purpose for that action.
- (4) For the purposes of an offence against this Subdivision, a person causes an unauthorised computer function if the person's conduct substantially contributes to the unauthorised computer function.

S. 247B
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 5.

247B Unauthorised access, modification or impairment with intent to commit serious offence

- (1) A person who causes any unauthorised computer function—
 - (a) knowing it is unauthorised; and
 - (b) with the intention of committing a serious offence or facilitating the commission of a serious offence (whether by the person or by another person)—

is guilty of an offence and liable to the same maximum penalty as applies to the commission of the serious offence in Victoria.

- (2) In this section *serious offence* means—
- (a) an offence in Victoria punishable on conviction for a first offence with imprisonment for a term of 5 years or more; or
 - (b) an offence in any other jurisdiction that would be punishable on conviction for a first offence with imprisonment for a term of 5 years or more if committed in Victoria.
- (3) A person may be found guilty of an offence against this section—
- (a) even if committing the serious offence is impossible; or
 - (b) whether the serious offence is to be committed at the time of the unauthorised conduct or at a later time.
- (4) It is not an offence to attempt to commit an offence against this section.

247C Unauthorised modification of data to cause impairment

**S. 247C
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 5.**

A person who—

- (a) causes any unauthorised modification of data held in a computer; and
- (b) knows that the modification is unauthorised; and
- (c) intends by the modification to impair access to, or to impair the reliability, security or operation of, any data held in a computer or is reckless as to any such impairment—

is guilty of an offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 247D
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 5.

247D Unauthorised impairment of electronic communication

A person who—

- (a) causes any unauthorised impairment of electronic communication to or from a computer; and
- (b) knows that the impairment is unauthorised; and
- (c) intends to impair electronic communication to or from the computer or is reckless as to any such impairment—

is guilty of an offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 247E
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 5.

247E Possession of data with intent to commit serious computer offence

(1) A person who is in possession or control of data—

- (a) with the intention of committing a serious computer offence; or
- (b) with the intention of facilitating the commission of a serious computer offence (whether by the person or by another person)—

is guilty of an offence and liable to imprisonment for a term not exceeding 3 years.

(2) In this section, a reference to a person having possession or control of data includes a reference to a person—

- (a) having possession of a computer or data storage device that holds or contains the data; and
- (b) having possession of a document in which the data is recorded; and

(c) having control of data held in a computer that is in the possession of another person (whether the computer is in Victoria or outside Victoria).

(3) A person may be found guilty of an offence against this section even if committing the serious computer offence is impossible.

(4) It is not an offence to attempt to commit an offence against this section.

247F Producing, supplying or obtaining data with intent to commit serious computer offence

**S. 247F
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 5.**

(1) A person who produces, supplies or obtains data—

(a) with the intention of committing a serious computer offence; or

(b) with the intention of facilitating the commission of a serious computer offence (whether by the person or by another person)—

is guilty of an offence and liable to imprisonment for a term not exceeding 3 years.

(2) In this section, a reference to a person producing, supplying or obtaining data includes a reference to the person—

(a) producing, supplying or obtaining data held in a computer or contained in a data storage device; and

(b) producing, supplying or obtaining a document in which the data is recorded.

(3) A person may be found guilty of an offence against this section even if committing the serious computer offence is impossible.

S. 247G
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 5.

247G Unauthorised access to or modification of restricted data

- (1) A person who—
 - (a) causes any unauthorised access to or modification of restricted data held in a computer; and
 - (b) knows that the access or modification is unauthorised; and
 - (c) intends to cause the access or modification—is guilty of an offence and liable to level 7 imprisonment (2 years maximum).
- (2) An offence against this section is a summary offence.
- (3) In this section *restricted data* means data held in a computer to which access is restricted by an access control system associated with a function of the computer.

S. 247H
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 5.

247H Unauthorised impairment of data held in computer disk, credit card or other device

- (1) A person who—
 - (a) causes any unauthorised impairment of the reliability, security or operation of data held on a computer disk, credit card or other device used to store data by electronic means; and
 - (b) knows that the impairment is unauthorised; and
 - (c) intends to cause the impairment—is guilty of an offence and liable to level 7 imprisonment (2 years maximum).
- (2) An offence against this section is a summary offence.

- (3) For the purposes of this section, impairment of reliability, security or operation of data is unauthorised if the person is not entitled to cause the impairment.

247I Extra-territorial operation of offences

S. 247I
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 5.

- (1) It is immaterial that some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against this Subdivision occurred outside Victoria, so long as the computer or device used to store data by electronic means affected by the conduct was in Victoria at the time at which the conduct occurred.
- (2) It is immaterial that the computer or device used to store data by electronic means affected by some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against this Subdivision was outside Victoria at the time the conduct occurred, so long as that conduct occurred in Victoria.

(7) Sabotage

Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdiv. (7)
(Heading and
ss 247J–247L)
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 6.

247J Interpretation

S. 247J
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 6.

- (1) In this Subdivision—

property offence means—

- (a) an offence against Subdivision (1) of this Division or Division 4; or
- (b) conduct in another jurisdiction that is an offence in that jurisdiction and that would constitute an offence against Subdivision (1) of this Division or Division 4 if the conduct occurred in Victoria;

public facility means any of the following
(whether publicly or privately owned)—

- (a) a government facility, including premises used by government employees in connection with official duties;
- (b) a public infrastructure facility, including a facility providing or distributing water, sewerage, energy, fuel, communication or other services to, or for the benefit of, the public;
- (c) a public information system, including a system used to generate, send, receive, store or otherwise process electronic communications;
- (d) a public transport facility, including a conveyance used to transport people or goods;
- (e) a public place, including any premises, land or water open to the public;

unauthorised computer function has the same meaning as in Subdivision (6).

- (2) In this Subdivision ***damage***, in relation to a public facility, means—
 - (a) cause damage to the facility or any part of the facility; or
 - (b) cause disruption to the use or operation of the facility.
- (3) For the purposes of an offence against this Subdivision, a person causes any damage or disruption if the person's conduct substantially contributes to the damage or disruption.

247K Sabotage

**S. 247K
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 6.**

A person who—

- (a) damages a public facility by committing a property offence or by causing an unauthorised computer function; and
- (b) intends to cause—
 - (i) major disruption to government functions; or
 - (ii) major disruption to the use of services by the public; or
 - (iii) major economic loss—

is guilty of an offence and liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).

247L Threats to sabotage

**S. 247L
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 6.**

(1) A person who—

- (a) makes to another person a threat to damage a public facility by committing a property offence or by causing an unauthorised computer function; and
- (b) intends that person to fear that the threat will be carried out and will cause—
 - (i) major disruption to government functions; or
 - (ii) major disruption to the use of services by the public; or
 - (iii) major economic loss—

is guilty of an offence and liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

-
- (2) In the prosecution of an offence against this section it is not necessary to prove that the person threatened actually feared that the threat would be carried out.
- (3) For the purposes of this section—
- (a) a threat may be made by any conduct and may be explicit or implicit, conditional or unconditional; and
 - (b) a threat to a person includes a threat to a group of persons; and
 - (c) fear that a threat will be carried out includes apprehension that it will be carried out.

Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdiv. (16)
(Heading and
s. 247)
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

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Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdiv. (17)
(Heading and
s. 248)
amended by
No. 8870 s. 3,
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

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Pt 1 Div. 3
Subdivs
(18)(19)
(Headings
and
ss 249–251)
repealed by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(c).

* * * *

Division 4—Contamination of goods

Pt 1 Div. 4
(Heading and
ss 252–289)
amended by
Nos 7705
s. 10, 7876
s. 2(3), 8181
s. 2(1)
(Sch. item 34),
8750 s. 96,
9019 s. 2(1)
(Sch. items
36, 37), 9576
s. 11(1), 10087
s. 3(1)(Sch. 1
item 25),
10244 s. 10,
repealed by
No. 25/1989
s. 8(1), new
Pt 1 Div. 4
(Heading and
s. 248)
inserted by
No. 95/1994
s. 5.

248 Interpretation

(1) In this Division—

contaminate, in relation to goods, includes—

- (a) interfere with the goods; or
- (b) making it appear that the goods have
been contaminated or interfered with;

goods includes any substance—

- (a) whether or not for human consumption;
and
- (b) whether natural or manufactured; and
- (c) whether or not incorporated or mixed
with other goods.

New s. 248
inserted by
No. 95/1994
s. 5,
amended by
Nos 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 84),
69/1997
s. 22(6),
substituted by
No. 65/1998
s. 5.

(2) In this Division, a reference to economic loss caused through public awareness of the contamination of goods includes a reference to economic loss caused through—

- (a) members of the public not purchasing or using those goods or similar goods; or
- (b) steps taken to avoid public alarm or anxiety or to avoid harm to members of the public.

S. 249
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 66/2005
s. 3(1).

New s. 249
inserted by
No. 65/1998
s. 5,
amended by
No. 66/2005
s. 3(2)(a).

249 Contaminating goods with intent to cause, or being reckless as to whether it would cause, public alarm or economic loss

A person must not contaminate goods with the intention of causing, or being reckless as to whether or not the contamination would cause—

S. 249(a)
amended by
No. 66/2005
s. 3(2)(b).

- (a) public alarm or anxiety; or

S. 249(b)
amended by
No. 66/2005
s. 3(2)(b).

- (b) economic loss through public awareness of the contamination.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum) or both.

Note to s. 249
inserted by
No. 80/2001
s. 7(1).

Note

Division 2B of Part 4 of the **Sentencing Act 1991** provides for the making of cost recovery orders in respect of costs incurred by emergency service agencies in providing an immediate response to an emergency arising out of the commission of an offence against this section

250 Threatening to contaminate goods with intent to cause, or being reckless as to whether it would cause, public alarm or economic loss

S. 250
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 66/2005
s. 4(1).
New s. 250
inserted by
No. 65/1998
s. 5.

(1) A person must not make a threat that goods will be contaminated with the intention of causing, or being reckless as to whether or not the threat would cause—

S. 250(1)
amended by
No. 66/2005
s. 4(2)(a).

(a) public alarm or anxiety; or

S. 250(1)(a)
amended by
No. 66/2005
s. 4(2)(b).

(b) economic loss through public awareness of the threat.

S. 250(1)(b)
amended by
No. 66/2005
s. 4(2)(a)(b).

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum) or both.

(2) For the purposes of this section, a threat may be made by any conduct, and may be explicit or implicit and conditional or unconditional.

Note

Division 2B of Part 4 of the **Sentencing Act 1991** provides for the making of cost recovery orders in respect of costs incurred by emergency service agencies in providing an immediate response to an emergency arising out of the commission of an offence against this section.

Note to s. 250
inserted by
No. 80/2001
s. 7(2).

S. 251
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 66/2005
s. 5(1).

New s. 251
inserted by
No. 65/1998
s. 5.

S. 251(1)(b)
amended by
No. 66/2005
s. 5(2)(a).

S. 251(1)(b)(i)
amended by
No. 66/2005
s. 5(2)(b).

S. 251(1)(b)(ii)
amended by
No. 66/2005
s. 5(2)(b)(c).

Note to s. 251
inserted by
No. 80/2001
s. 7(3).

251 Making false statements concerning contamination of goods with intent to cause, or being reckless as to whether it would cause, public alarm or economic loss

- (1) A person must not make a statement that the person believes to be false—
- (a) with the intention of inducing the person to whom the statement is made or others to believe that goods have been contaminated; and
 - (b) with the intention of thereby causing, or being reckless as to whether or not the statement would cause—
 - (i) public alarm or anxiety; or
 - (ii) economic loss through public awareness of the statement.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) or a level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum) or both.

- (2) For the purposes of this section, making a statement includes conveying information by any means.

Note

Division 2B of Part 4 of the **Sentencing Act 1991** provides for the making of cost recovery orders in respect of costs incurred by emergency service agencies in providing an immediate response to an emergency arising out of the commission of an offence against this section.

252 Territorial nexus for offences

It is immaterial that the conduct of a person constituting an offence under this Division occurred outside Victoria, so long as the person intended by that conduct to cause, or was reckless as to whether or not that conduct would cause—

(a) public alarm or anxiety in Victoria; or

(b) economic loss in Victoria through public awareness of the contamination.

New s. 252
inserted by
No. 65/1998
s. 5,
amended by
No. 66/2005
s. 6(a).

S. 252(a)
amended by
No. 66/2005
s. 6(b).

S. 252(b)
amended by
No. 66/2005
s. 6(b).

Division 5—Destruction of evidence

Pt 1 Div. 5
(Heading and
ss 290–313)
amended by
Nos 7876 s. 2,
8181 s. 2(Sch.
item 33), 9554
s. 2(2)(Sch. 2
items 56, 57),
9576 s. 11(1),
9848 s. 18(1),
repealed by
No. 25/1989
s. 8(1),
new Pt 1
Div. 5
(Heading and
ss 253–255)
inserted by
No. 6/2006
s. 3.

253 Definitions

In this Division—

associate, in relation to a body corporate,
means—

(a) an employee or agent of the body corporate to the extent that he or she is acting within the actual or apparent scope of his or her employment or

New s. 253
inserted by
No. 6/2006
s. 3.

within his or her actual or apparent authority; or

(b) an officer of the body corporate;

board of directors means the body (by whatever name called) exercising the executive authority of the body corporate;

corporate culture means an attitude, policy, rule, course of conduct or practice existing within the body corporate generally or in the part of the body corporate in which the relevant conduct is carried out or the relevant intention formed;

legal proceeding has the same meaning as in the **Evidence (Miscellaneous Provisions) Act 1958**;

S. 253 def. of
*legal
proceeding*
amended by
No. 69/2009
s. 39.

officer, in relation to a body corporate, means an officer (as defined by section 9 of the Corporations Act) of the body corporate to the extent that he or she is acting within the actual or apparent scope of his or her employment or within his or her actual or apparent authority;

relevant conduct means the destruction, concealment, or rendering illegible, undecipherable or incapable of identification, of a document or other thing of any kind;

relevant intention means the intention of preventing a document or other thing of any kind from being used in evidence in a legal proceeding.

254 Destruction of evidence

New s. 254
inserted by
No. 6/2006
s. 3.

- (1) A person who—
- (a) knows that a document or other thing of any kind is, or is reasonably likely to be, required in evidence in a legal proceeding; and
 - (b) either—
 - (i) destroys or conceals it or renders it illegible, undecipherable or incapable of identification; or
 - (ii) expressly, tacitly or impliedly authorises or permits another person to destroy or conceal it or render it illegible, undecipherable or incapable of identification and that other person does so; and
 - (c) acts as described in paragraph (b) with the intention of preventing it from being used in evidence in a legal proceeding—

is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum) or a level 6 fine or both.

Notes

- 1 **Document** is defined in the **Evidence Act 2008**.
- 2 The maximum fine that may be imposed on a body corporate found guilty of an offence against this section is 3000 penalty units: see **Sentencing Act 1991** s. 113D.
- (2) This section applies with respect to a legal proceeding, whether the proceeding is one that is in progress or is to be, or may be, commenced in the future.

Note 1 to
s. 254(1)
substituted by
No. 69/2009
s. 40.

New s. 255
inserted by
No. 6/2006
s. 3.

255 Corporate criminal responsibility for offence against section 254

- (1) For the purposes of a proceeding against a body corporate for an offence against section 254—
 - (a) relevant conduct engaged in by an associate of the body corporate must also be attributed to the body corporate; and
 - (b) knowledge of an associate of the body corporate must also be attributed to the body corporate; and
 - (c) intention—
 - (i) of the body corporate's board of directors; or
 - (ii) of an officer of the body corporate; or
 - (iii) of any other associate of the body corporate if a corporate culture existed within the body corporate that directed, encouraged, tolerated or led to the formation of that intention—must also be attributed to the body corporate.
- (2) If an officer of a body corporate contravenes section 254, the body corporate must be taken to have also contravened that section and may be proceeded against and found guilty of an offence against that section whether or not the officer has been proceeded against or found guilty of that offence.
- (3) In a proceeding against a body corporate for an offence against section 254, brought in reliance on subsection (2), it is a defence to the charge for the body corporate to prove that it exercised due diligence to prevent the contravention of that section by the officer.

- (4) The means by which authorisation or permission as required by section 254(1)(b)(ii) may be established include—
 - (a) proving that an officer of the body corporate gave that authorisation or permission; or
 - (b) proving that the body corporate's board of directors gave that authorisation or permission; or
 - (c) proving that a corporate culture existed within the body corporate that directed, encouraged, tolerated or led to the relevant conduct being carried out.
- (5) Subsection (4)(a) does not apply if the body corporate proves that it exercised due diligence to prevent the authorisation or permission being given.
- (6) Factors relevant to the application of subsection (1)(c)(iii) or (4)(c) include—
 - (a) whether authority to commit an offence against section 254 or an offence of a similar character had been given by an officer of the body corporate; and
 - (b) whether the associate of the body corporate who carried out the relevant conduct or formed the relevant intention believed on reasonable grounds, or entertained a reasonable expectation, that an officer of the body corporate would have authorised or permitted the relevant conduct being carried out with the relevant intention.
- (7) Subject to subsection (8), it is not necessary that each element of an offence against section 254 that is attributed to a body corporate by force of subsection (1) be supplied by the same associate of the body corporate.

- (8) It is necessary that the elements referred to in section 254(1)(b)(i) and (c) be supplied by the same associate of the body corporate.

Pt 1 Div. 5A
(Heading
and new
ss 256, 257)
inserted by
No. 34/2016
s. 40.

Division 5A—Intimidation and reprisals relating to witnesses, etc.

New s. 256
inserted by
No. 34/2016
s. 40.

256 Interpretation

- (1) For the purposes of this Division, a person is involved in a criminal investigation if the person is—
- (a) a witness of an alleged crime or crimes being investigated; or
 - (b) a victim of an alleged crime or crimes being investigated; or
 - (c) involved in the investigation in any other capacity.
- (2) For the purposes of this Division, a person is involved in a criminal proceeding if the person is—
- (a) a witness in that proceeding; or
 - (b) a juror in that proceeding; or
 - (c) involved in the proceeding in any other capacity.
- (3) In this Division—
- detriment***, to a person, includes—
- (a) loss or damage to a person's property or business;

- (b) discrimination, disadvantage or adverse treatment in relation to a person's employment, career, business, trade, profession or enterprise.

257 Intimidation or reprisals relating to involvement in criminal investigation or criminal proceeding

New s. 257
inserted by
No. 34/2016
s. 40.

- (1) A person (the offender) must not—

- (a) use or procure the use of intimidation towards a person (the victim); or
- (b) cause or procure any physical harm or detriment of any kind to a person (the victim)—

because the offender knows or believes that the victim or another person is, was, may be or may become involved in a criminal investigation or a criminal proceeding.

Penalty: Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)(a), a person uses intimidation towards a victim if—

- (a) the person engages in conduct that could reasonably be expected to arouse apprehension or fear in the victim for the safety of the victim or another person or of detriment to the victim or another person; and
- (b) either—
 - (i) the person knows that engaging in that conduct would be likely to arouse that apprehension or fear; or

- (ii) in all the particular circumstances, the person ought to have known that engaging in that conduct would be likely to arouse that apprehension or fear.
- (3) Subsection (2) applies whether or not the conduct arouses apprehension or fear in the victim.
- (4) Subsection (1) does not apply to conduct engaged in by a person performing official duties for the purpose of—
 - (a) the enforcement of the criminal law; or
 - (b) the administration of any Act; or
 - (c) the enforcement of a law imposing a pecuniary penalty; or
 - (d) the execution of a warrant; or
 - (e) the protection of public revenue—that, but for this subsection, would constitute an offence against subsection (1).
- (5) In a proceeding for an offence against subsection (1) it is a defence to the charge for the accused to prove that the conduct was engaged in without malice—
 - (a) in the normal course of a lawful business, trade, profession or enterprise (including that of any body or person whose business, or whose principal business, is the publication, or arranging the publication, of news or current affairs material); or
 - (b) for the purpose of an industrial dispute; or
 - (c) for the purpose of engaging in political activities or discussion or communicating with respect to public affairs.

- (6) For the purposes of this section, it is immaterial that—
- (a) some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria, so long as the victim was in Victoria at the time at which that conduct occurred; or
 - (b) the victim was outside Victoria at the time at which some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred, so long as that conduct occurred in Victoria; or
 - (c) some or all of the conduct constituting an offence against subsection (1) occurred outside Victoria and the victim was outside Victoria at the relevant time or times, so long as the relevant criminal investigation or criminal proceeding is occurring, occurred, will occur or may occur in Victoria.

Division 6—Perjury

314 Perjury

No. 6103
s. 314.

- (1) Whosoever commits wilful and corrupt perjury or subornation of perjury shall be liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

S. 314(1)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 59),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 85).

- (2) Where in any Act it is provided that any person shall be liable to the penalties of perjury or shall be guilty of perjury or shall be deemed to have committed perjury or any similar expression is used such person shall be deemed to have committed an offence against subsection (1) and

may be proceeded against tried and punished accordingly.

S. 314(3)
amended by
No. 6/2018
ss 63,
68(Sch 2
item 35.2).

- (3) Where by or under any Act it is required or authorized that facts matters or things be verified or otherwise assured or ascertained by or upon the oath affirmation or affidavit of some or any person, any person who in any such case takes or makes any oath or affirmation so required or authorized and who knowingly wilfully and corruptly upon such oath or affirmation deposes swears to or affirms or makes any false statement as to any such fact matter or thing, and any person who knowingly wilfully and corruptly upon oath or by affirmation deposes to the truth of any statement for so verifying assuring or ascertaining any such fact matter or thing or purporting so to do, or who knowingly wilfully and corruptly takes makes signs or subscribes any such affirmation or affidavit as to any such fact matter or thing, such statement affirmation or affidavit being untrue wholly or in part, or who knowingly wilfully and corruptly omits from any such affirmation or affidavit made or sworn under the provisions of any law any matter which by the provisions of such law is required to be stated in such affirmation or affidavit, shall be deemed guilty of wilful and corrupt perjury. Nothing herein contained shall affect any case amounting to perjury at the common law or the case of any offence in respect of which other provision is made by any Act.

Note to
s. 314(3)
inserted by
No. 6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.4).

Note

Making a false statutory declaration is a separate offence under section 36 of the **Oaths and Affirmations Act 2018**.

315 All evidence material with respect to perjury

All evidence and proof whatsoever, whether given or made orally or by or in any affidavit examination statutory declaration or deposition, shall be deemed and taken to be material with respect to the liability of any person to be proceeded against and punished for perjury or subornation of perjury.

No. 6103
s. 315.

S. 315
amended by
No. 6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.5).

Division 7—Unlawful oaths

316 Unlawful oaths to commit treason, murder etc.

No. 6103
s. 316.

(1) Every person who—

S. 316(1)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 57),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 86(a)).

(a) administers or is present at and consents to the administering of any oath or engagement in the nature of an oath purporting to bind the person who takes it to commit treason or murder; or

S. 316(1)(a)
amended by
No. 9019
s. 2(1)(Sch.
item 38).

(b) takes any such oath or engagement not being compelled to do so; or

(c) induces or attempts to induce any person to take any such oath or engagement—

shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 316(2)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 52),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 86(b)).

S. 316(2)(a)(ii)
amended by
No. 9019
s. 2(1)(Sch.
item 39).

(2) Every person who—

- (a) administers or is present at and consents to the administering of any oath or engagement in the nature of an oath purporting to bind the person who takes it to act in any of the ways following (that is to say):—
 - (i) to engage in any mutinous or seditious enterprise;
 - (ii) to commit any indictable offence other than treason or murder;
 - (iii) to disturb the public peace;
 - (iv) to be of any association society or confederacy formed for the purpose of doing any such act as aforesaid;
 - (v) to obey the order or commands of any committee or body of men not lawfully constituted or of any leader or commander or other person not having authority by law for that purpose;
 - (vi) not to inform or give evidence against any associate confederate or other person;
 - (vii) not to reveal or discover any unlawful association society or confederacy or any illegal act done or to be done or any illegal oath or engagement that may have been administered or tendered to or taken by himself or any other person or the import of any such oath or engagement; or

(b) takes any such oath or engagement not being compelled to do so; or

(c) induces or attempts to induce any person to take any such oath or engagement—

shall be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

(3) A person who takes any such oath or engagement as is mentioned in the last two preceding subsections cannot set up as a defence that he was compelled to do so unless within fourteen days after taking it or if he is prevented by actual force or sickness within fourteen days after the termination of such prevention he declares by evidence on oath before some member of the Executive Council or a magistrate or if he is on actual service in His Majesty's forces by sea or land either by such evidence or by evidence on oath before his commanding officer the whole of what he knows concerning the matter, including the person or persons by whom and in whose presence and the place where and the time when the oath or engagement was administered or taken.

S. 316(3)
amended by
Nos 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.14),
68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.10),
25/2023
s. 7(Sch. 1
item 6.3).

(4) A person who has been tried and convicted or acquitted on a charge of any of the offences mentioned in this section shall not be afterwards prosecuted upon the same facts for treason or for failing when he knows that any person intends to commit treason to give information thereof with all reasonable despatch to a magistrate or use other reasonable endeavours to prevent the commission of the crime.

S. 316(4)
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.15).

Division 8—Offences connected with explosive substances¹⁸

317 Offences connected with explosive substances

No. 6103
s. 317.

- (1) In this Division unless inconsistent with the context or subject-matter—

S. 317(1)
def. of
explosive substance
amended by
No. 25/2009
s. 4(1)(a).

explosive substance includes—

- (a) any material for making any explosive substance;
- (b) any apparatus machine implement or materials used or intended to be used or adapted for causing or aiding in causing any explosion in or with any explosive substance; and
- (c) any part of any such apparatus machine or implement;

S. 317(1)
def. of
public place
inserted by
No. 25/2009
s. 4(1)(b).

public place has the same meaning as it has in section 3 of the **Summary Offences Act 1966**;

S. 317(1)
def. of
vehicle
inserted by
No. 25/2009
s. 4(1)(b).

vehicle includes motor vehicle, aircraft and vessel.

S. 317(2)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 59),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 87(a)).

- (2) Any person who unlawfully and maliciously causes by any explosive substance an explosion of a nature likely to endanger life or to cause serious injury to property shall, whether any injury to person or property has been actually caused or not, be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

(3) Any person who unlawfully and maliciously—

- (a) does any act with intent to cause by an explosive substance or conspires to cause by an explosive substance an explosion of a nature likely to endanger life or to cause serious injury to property; or

- (b) makes or has in his possession or under his control any explosive substance with intent by means thereof to endanger life or cause serious injury to property or to enable any other person by means thereof to endanger life or cause serious injury to property—

shall, whether any explosion does or does not take place and whether any injury to person or property has been actually caused or not, be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 317(3)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
101/1986 s. 56,
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 60(a)),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 87(b)).

- (4) Any person who makes or knowingly has in his possession or under his control any explosive substance, under such circumstances as to give rise to a reasonable suspicion that he is not making it or does not have it in his possession or under his control for a lawful object shall, unless he can show that he made it or had it in his possession or under his control for a lawful object, be guilty of an indictable offence, and shall be liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 317(4)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
101/1986 s. 56,
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 60(b)),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 87(c)).

* * * *

S. 317(5)
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1),
repealed by
No. 63/2014
s. 7(5).

* * * *

S. 317(6)
repealed by
No. 9848
s. 18(1).

S. 317(7)
amended by
Nos 25/1989
s. 19(a),
35/1996
s. 453(Sch. 1
item 16.1
(a)–(c)),
68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.11).

- (7) In any indictment the same criminal act may be charged in different charges as constituting different crimes under this Division, and upon the trial of any such indictment the prosecution shall not be put to its election as to the charge on which it must proceed.

S. 317(8)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.12).

- (8) This Division shall not exempt any person from any indictment or proceeding for a crime or offence which is punishable at common law or by any enactment other than this Division but no person shall be punished twice for the same criminal act.

S. 317(9)(a)
amended by
Nos 8179 s. 4,
57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.16(a)),
25/2009
s. 4(2),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.9),
6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.3).

- (9) (a) If a magistrate is satisfied by the evidence on oath or by affirmation or by affidavit of any police officer above the rank of senior sergeant authorized in writing by the Chief Commissioner of Police (whether generally or in any particular case) in that behalf that there is reasonable ground for suspecting that an offence under this Division has been, is being, or is about to be committed he may grant a search warrant authorizing any police officer named therein to enter at any time any premises or place (including any vehicle on or in the premises or place) mentioned in the warrant, or a particular vehicle mentioned in the warrant located in a public place, if necessary by force, and to search the premises, place or vehicle and every person found therein, and to seize and detain any explosive substance which he finds on the premises or place, or on or in the vehicle, or on any such person, in respect of which or in connexion with which he has reasonable grounds for suspecting that

an offence under this Division has been, is being, or is about to be committed.

- (b) The police officer making the search may arrest without warrant any person found on the premises or on or in the vehicle in the public place whom he has reason to believe to be guilty of an offence under this Division. S. 317(9)(b) amended by Nos 25/2009 s. 4(3), 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.9).
- (c) Save as aforesaid the rules to be observed with regard to search warrants mentioned in the **Magistrates' Court Act 1989** shall extend and apply to warrants under this section. S. 317(9)(c) amended by Nos 8731 s. 173, 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. item 42.16(b)).
- (d) The provisions of this section shall be read and construed as in aid and not in derogation of the provisions with regard to warrants to search contained in the said Act or elsewhere¹⁹.

317A Bomb hoaxes

S. 317A inserted by No. 95/1994 s. 6.

- (1) A person must not—
- (a) place an article or substance in any place; or
- (b) send an article or substance by any means of transportation—

S. 317A(1) amended by Nos 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 88), 69/1997 s. 22(7).

with the intention of inducing in another person a false belief that the article or substance is likely to explode or ignite or discharge a dangerous or deleterious matter.

Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum) or a level 6 fine (600 penalty units maximum) or both.

S. 317A(2)
amended by
Nos 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 88),
69/1997
s. 22(7).

- (2) A person must not, whether within or outside Victoria, make a statement or convey information to another person which the person making the statement or conveying the information knows or believes to be false with the intention of inducing in that person or any other person a belief that an article or substance liable to explode or ignite or discharge a dangerous or deleterious matter is present in any place in Victoria.

Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum) or a level 6 fine (600 penalty units maximum) or both.

- (3) For a person to be guilty of an offence against subsection (1) or (2) it is not necessary for him or her to have any particular person in mind as the person in whom he or she intends to induce the belief referred to in that subsection.

Note to
s. 317A
inserted by
No. 80/2001
s. 7(4)

Note

Division 2B of Part 4 of the **Sentencing Act 1991** provides for the making of cost recovery orders in respect of costs incurred by emergency service agencies in providing an immediate response to an emergency arising out of the commission of an offence against this section.

**Division 8A—Driving offences connected with
emergency workers, custodial officers, youth justice
custodial workers and emergency service vehicles**

Pt 1 Div. 8A
(Heading)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 4.

Pt 1 Div. 8A
(Heading and
ss 317AB–
317AG)
inserted by
No. 65/2017
s. 3.

317AB Interpretation

S. 317AB
inserted by
No. 65/2017
s. 3.

(1) In this Division—

custodial officer has the same meaning as
in section 10AA(8) of the **Sentencing
Act 1991**;

emergency worker has the same meaning as
in section 10AA(8) of the **Sentencing
Act 1991**;

S. 317AB(1)
def. of
*emergency
worker*
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 5(1)(a).

youth justice custodial worker has the same
meaning as in section 10AA(8) of the
Sentencing Act 1991.

S. 317AB(1)
def. of *youth
justice
custodial
worker*
inserted by
No. 65/2017
s. 5(1)(b).

(2) For the purposes of this Division—

(a) an emergency worker is on duty if they
would be on duty for the purposes of section
10AA(9) of the **Sentencing Act 1991**; and

(b) a custodial officer is on duty if they would
be on duty for the purposes of section
10AA(10) of the **Sentencing Act 1991**; and

S. 317AB(2)(b)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 5(2)(a).

S. 317AB(2)(c)
inserted by
No. 65/2017
s. 5(2)(b).

(c) a youth justice custodial worker is on duty if they would be on duty for the purposes of section 10AA(11) of the **Sentencing Act 1991**.

S. 317AC
(Heading)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 6.

317AC Intentionally exposing an emergency worker, a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial worker to risk by driving

S. 317AC
inserted by
No. 65/2017
s. 3.

(1) A person who—

S. 317AC(1)(a)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 7(1).

(a) drives a motor vehicle in the vicinity of another person who is an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty; and

S. 317AC(1)(b)
amended by
Nos 65/2017
s. 7(2), 3/2019
s. 5(1).

(b) knows that, or is reckless as to whether, the other person is an emergency worker, a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial worker; and

(c) without lawful excuse, drives the motor vehicle and intends to expose the other person to a risk to safety—

is guilty of an offence and liable to level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum).

S. 317AC(2)
amended by
Nos 65/2017
s. 7(2), 3/2019
s. 5(1).

(2) For the purposes of subsection (1), the person is taken to know that the other person is an emergency worker, a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial worker (as the case may be) if—

S. 317AC(2)(a)
amended by
Nos 65/2017
s. 7(2), 3/2019
s. 5(1).

(a) the other person has identified themselves as an emergency worker, a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial worker; or

- (b) the other person is inside or in the vicinity of a vehicle which—
- (i) bears the livery or insignia of an emergency service; or
 - (ii) is displaying a flashing blue or red light (whether or not it is displaying other lights); or
 - (iii) is sounding an alarm; or
- (c) the fact that the other person is an emergency worker, a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial worker is reasonably apparent, having regard to all the circumstances, including the conduct and manner of the emergency worker, custodial officer or youth justice custodial worker.
- (3) A person may be found guilty of an offence under subsection (1) irrespective of whether the emergency worker, custodial officer or youth justice custodial worker was injured by the conduct of the person driving the motor vehicle.

S. 317AC(2)(c) amended by Nos 65/2017 s. 7(2)(3), 3/2019 s. 5(2).

S. 317AC(3) amended by No. 65/2017 s. 7(3).²⁰

* * * * *

Notes to s. 317AC(3) amended by Nos 65/2017 s. 7(4), 48/2018 s. 93, repealed by No. 23/2020 s. 17(1).

Notes

- 1 An offence against this section is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991** if an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty was injured in the commission of the offence. See section 5(2G) and (2GA) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order or other specified order for this offence if committed in those circumstances.

Notes to s. 317AC inserted by No. 23/2020 s. 17(2).

- 2 See section 10AE(1) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** for the requirement that a term of imprisonment be imposed for an offence against section 317AC and that a non-parole period of not less than 2 years be fixed under section 11 of that Act if an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty was injured in the commission of the offence unless the court finds under section 10A of that Act that a special reason exists.
- 3 Section 16(3D) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** requires that every term of imprisonment imposed on a person for an offence against this section must, unless otherwise directed by the court, be served cumulatively on any uncompleted sentence or sentences of imprisonment imposed on that offender, whether before or at the same time as that term.

S. 317AD
(Heading)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 8.

317AD Aggravated offence of intentionally exposing an emergency worker, a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial worker to risk by driving

S. 317AD
inserted by
No. 65/2017
s. 3.

S. 317AD(1)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 9(1).

- (1) A person is guilty of the aggravated offence of intentionally exposing an emergency worker, a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial worker to risk by driving if the person commits an offence against section 317AC and any of the following apply—
 - (a) the motor vehicle driven by the person in the commission of the offence against section 317AC is stolen and the person knows that, or is reckless as to whether, the motor vehicle is stolen;
 - (b) the person commits the offence against section 317AC in connection with an offence committed by that person against section 317AG;

- (c) the person commits the offence against section 317AC in connection with another indictable offence committed by that person, punishable by 10 years imprisonment or more.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)(b) and (c), the offences are connected if—
 - (a) there is a close connection in time; or
 - (b) there is a close connection in place; or
 - (c) in the case of subsection (1)(c), the purpose of the commission of the offence against section 317AC is to avoid apprehension for the other indictable offence.
- (3) A person guilty of the aggravated offence of intentionally exposing an emergency worker, a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial worker to risk by driving is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum).

S. 317AD(3)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 9(1).

Notes

- 1 An offence against this section is a category 1 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991** if an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty was injured in the commission of the offence. See section 5(2G) and (2GA) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order or other specified order for this offence if committed in those circumstances.
- 2 An offence against this section (other than a category 1 offence referred to in note 1) is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2H) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.
- 3 See section 10AE(1) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** for the requirement that a term of imprisonment be imposed for an offence against section 317AD and that a non-parole period of not less than 2 years be fixed under section 11 of that Act if an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or

Notes to
s. 317AD
amended by
Nos 65/2017
s. 9(2),
48/2018 s. 94,
substituted by
No. 23/2020
s. 18.

a youth justice custodial worker on duty was injured in the commission of the offence unless the court finds under section 10A of that Act that a special reason exists.

- 4 Section 16(3D) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** requires that every term of imprisonment imposed on a person for an offence against this section must, unless otherwise directed by the court, be served cumulatively on any uncompleted sentence or sentences of imprisonment imposed on that offender, whether before or at the same time as that term.

S. 317AE
(Heading)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 10.

**317AE Recklessly exposing an emergency worker,
a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial
worker to risk by driving**

S. 317AE
inserted by
No. 65/2017
s. 3.

- (1) A person who—

S. 317AE(1)(a)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 11(1).

- (a) drives a motor vehicle in the vicinity of another person who is an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty; and

S. 317AE(1)(b)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 11(2).

- (b) knows that, or is reckless as to whether, the other person is an emergency worker, custodial officer or youth justice custodial worker; and

- (c) without lawful excuse, drives the motor vehicle and recklessly exposes the other person to a risk to safety—

is guilty of an offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), the person is taken to know that the other person is an emergency worker, custodial officer or youth justice custodial worker (as the case may be) if—
- (a) the other person has identified themselves as an emergency worker, custodial officer or youth justice custodial worker; or
- (b) the other person is inside or in the vicinity of a vehicle which—
- (i) bears the livery or insignia of an emergency service; or
- (ii) is displaying a flashing blue or red light (whether or not it is displaying other lights); or
- (iii) is sounding an alarm; or
- (c) the fact that the other person is an emergency worker, custodial officer or youth justice custodial worker is reasonably apparent, having regard to all the circumstances, including the conduct and manner of the emergency worker, custodial officer or youth justice custodial worker.
- (3) A person may be found guilty of an offence under subsection (1) irrespective of whether the emergency worker, custodial officer or youth justice custodial worker was injured by the conduct of the person driving the motor vehicle.

S. 317AE(2)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 11(2).

S. 317AE(2)(a)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 11(2).

S. 317AE(2)(c)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 11(2)(3).

S. 317AE(3)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 11(3).

Note

Section 16(3D) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** requires that every term of imprisonment imposed on a person for an offence against this section must, unless otherwise directed by the court, be served cumulatively on any uncompleted sentence or sentences of imprisonment imposed on that offender, whether before or at the same time as that term.

S. 317AF
(Heading)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 12.

**317AF Aggravated offence of recklessly exposing an
emergency worker, a custodial officer or a youth
justice custodial worker to risk by driving**

S. 317AF
inserted by
No. 65/2017
s. 3.

S. 317AF(1)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 13.

- (1) A person is guilty of the aggravated offence of recklessly exposing an emergency worker, a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial worker to risk by driving if the person commits an offence against section 317AE and any of the following apply—
- (a) the motor vehicle driven by the person in the commission of the offence against section 317AE is stolen and the person knows that, or is reckless as to whether, the motor vehicle is stolen;
 - (b) the person commits the offence against section 317AE in connection with an offence committed by that person against section 317AG;
 - (c) the person commits the offence against section 317AE in connection with another indictable offence committed by that person, punishable by 10 years or more imprisonment.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)(b) and (c), the offences are connected if—
- (a) there is a close connection in time; or
 - (b) there is a close connection in place; or

(c) in the case of subsection (1)(c), the purpose of the commission of the offence against section 317AE is to avoid apprehension for the other indictable offence.

- (3) A person guilty of the aggravated offence of recklessly exposing an emergency worker, a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial worker to risk by driving is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 317AF(3)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 13.

Notes

- 1 An offence against this section is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See subsection (2H) of section 5 of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.
- 2 Section 16(3D) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** requires that every term of imprisonment imposed on a person for an offence against this section must, unless otherwise directed by the court, be served cumulatively on any uncompleted sentence or sentences of imprisonment imposed on that offender, whether before or at the same time as that term.

317AG Damaging an emergency service vehicle

S. 317AG
inserted by
No. 65/2017
s. 3.

- (1) A person must not, without lawful excuse, recklessly drive a motor vehicle so that damage is caused to an emergency service vehicle.

Penalty: Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

- (2) To be guilty of an offence under subsection (1), the person must know that, or be reckless as to whether, the other vehicle is an emergency service vehicle.

- (3) For the purposes of subsection (2), the person is taken to know that the other vehicle is an emergency service vehicle if—
- (a) the motor vehicle bears the livery or insignia of an emergency service; or
 - (b) the motor vehicle is displaying a flashing blue or red light (whether or not it is displaying other lights); or
 - (c) the motor vehicle is sounding an alarm; or
 - (d) the fact that the motor vehicle is an emergency service vehicle is reasonably apparent, having regard to all of the circumstances, including the manner in which the emergency service vehicle is being driven.

S. 317AG(4)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 14(2).

- (4) In this section, *emergency service vehicle* means a motor vehicle that, at a particular time—

S. 317AG(4)(a)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 14(1).

- (a) is being used by an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty; or

S. 317AG(4)(b)
amended by
No. 65/2017
s. 14(1).

- (b) is ordinarily used by an emergency worker on duty, a custodial officer on duty or a youth justice custodial worker on duty—

regardless of whether it is occupied by an emergency worker, a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial worker at that time.

Note

Section 16(3D) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** requires that every term of imprisonment imposed on a person for an offence against this section must, unless otherwise directed by the court, be served cumulatively on any uncompleted sentence or sentences of imprisonment imposed on that offender, whether before or at the same time as that term.

**Division 9—Driving offences connected
with motor vehicles**

Pt 1 Div. 9
(Heading)
amended by
No. 127/1986
s. 102(Sch. 4
item 5.3).

317B Interpretation

S. 317B
inserted by
No. 93/2009
s. 44.

(1) In this Division—

drive, in relation to a motor vehicle, has the
same meaning as it has in the **Road Safety
Act 1986** and includes to operate a vessel;

S. 317B(1) def.
of *drive*
substituted by
No. 8/2018
s. 14.

motor vehicle includes vessel, whether or not the
vessel is powered by a motor;

operate, in relation to a vessel, means—

- (a) steer or navigate the vessel; or
- (b) direct the steering or navigation of the
vessel or provide instructions as to the
steering or navigation of the vessel; or
- (c) substantially change the movement or
direction of the vessel;

vessel has the same meaning as in the **Marine
Safety Act 2010**.

S. 317B(1)
def. of *vessel*
amended by
No. 65/2010
s. 420(Sch. 3
item 3).

(2) For the purposes of this Division—

- (a) a person may operate a vessel that is at
anchor, made fast to the shore or aground;
- (b) a person does not operate a vessel solely
because the person is in charge of the vessel.

318 Culpable driving causing death

S. 318
amended by
Nos 6762
s. 13(a)(b),
7184 s. 3, 7407
s. 2(a)(b),
substituted by
No. 7645 s. 3.

S. 318(1)
amended by
Nos 9554
s. 2(2)(Sch. 2
item 58), 9576
s. 11(1),
111/1986
s. 180(2)
(Sch. 2
item 5),
127/1986
s. 102(Sch. 4
item 5.4),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 61),
13/1992
s. 3(1),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 89).

Note to
s. 318(1)
inserted by
No. 48/2018
s. 95.

S. 318(1A)
inserted by
No. 52/2014
s. 16,
repealed by
No. 34/2017
s. 14, new
s. 318(1A)
inserted by
No. 34/2017
s. 35.

- (1) Any person who by the culpable driving of a motor vehicle causes the death of another person shall be guilty of an indictable offence and shall be liable to level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum) or a level 3 fine or both.

Note

An offence against this subsection is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2H) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.

- (1A) The standard sentence for an offence under subsection (1) is 8 years.

Note

See sections 5A and 5B of the **Sentencing Act 1991** as to standard sentences.

(2) For the purposes of subsection (1) a person drives a motor vehicle culpably if he drives the motor vehicle—

S. 318(2)
amended by
No. 127/1986
s. 102(Sch. 4
item 5.4).

- (a) recklessly, that is to say, if he consciously and unjustifiably disregards a substantial risk that the death of another person or the infliction of grievous bodily harm upon another person may result from his driving; or
- (b) negligently, that is to say, if he fails unjustifiably and to a gross degree to observe the standard of care which a reasonable man would have observed in all the circumstances of the case; or
- (c) whilst under the influence of alcohol to such an extent as to be incapable of having proper control of the motor vehicle; or
- (d) whilst under the influence of a drug to such an extent as to be incapable of having proper control of the motor vehicle.

(2A) Without limiting subsection (2)(b), negligence within the meaning of that subsection may be established by proving that—

S. 318(2A)
inserted by
No. 59/2004
s. 5.

- (a) a person drove a motor vehicle when fatigued to such an extent that he or she knew, or ought to have known, that there was an appreciable risk of him or her falling asleep while driving or of losing control of the vehicle; and
- (b) by so driving the motor vehicle the person failed unjustifiably and to a gross degree to observe the standard of care which a reasonable person would have observed in all the circumstances of the case.

S. 318(3)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.13).

- (3) An indictment for an indictable offence under this section shall specify which form of culpability within the meaning of subsection (2) is charged but evidence of the whole of the circumstances shall be admissible on the trial on the indictment.

S. 318(4)
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1).

- (4) A person who is convicted or acquitted of an indictable offence under this section shall not in respect of the death concerned subsequently be prosecuted for unlawful homicide or under this section.

S. 318(5)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.14).

- (5) A person who is convicted or acquitted of any form of unlawful homicide not referred to in this section shall not in respect of the death concerned subsequently be prosecuted under this section and no other form of unlawful homicide shall be charged in the same indictment with an indictable offence under this section.

S. 318(6)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
127/1986
s. 102(Sch. 4
item 5.4),
13/1992
s. 3(2),
68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.14),
93/2009 s. 45,
25/2025 s. 99.

- (6) A person who is convicted or acquitted of an indictable offence under this section shall not in respect of the circumstances concerned be proceeded against under the **Road Safety Act 1986** or the **Marine (Drug, Alcohol and Pollution Control) Act 1988** for having driven a motor vehicle whilst under the influence of alcohol or a drug and no such offence shall be charged in the same indictment with an indictable offence under this section.

S. 318(7)
substituted by
Nos 8338 s. 4,
78/1987
s. 4(2),

- (7) **Drug** means a drug within the meaning of the **Road Safety Act 1986**.

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S. 318(8)
repealed by
No. 78/1987
s. 4(3).

319 Dangerous driving causing death or serious injury

S. 319
amended by
Nos 6658 s. 3,
6762
s. 13(c)(d),
7332
s. 2(Sch. 1
item 19), 7546
s. 6,
repealed by
No. 7645 s. 5,
new s. 319
inserted by
No. 59/2004
s. 6.

- (1) A person who, by driving a motor vehicle at a speed or in a manner that is dangerous to the public having regard to all the circumstances of the case, causes the death of another person is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 319(1)
amended by
No. 7/2008
s. 5(1).

Note

An offence against this subsection is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2H) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.

Note to
s. 319(1)
inserted by
No. 48/2018
s. 96.

- (1A) A person who, by driving a motor vehicle at a speed or in a manner that is dangerous to the public having regard to all the circumstances of the case, causes serious injury to another person is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 319(1A)
inserted by
No. 7/2008
s. 5(2).

S. 319(1B)
inserted by
No. 48/2018
s. 19A.

- (1B) In a proceeding for an offence against subsection (1) or (1A), it is to be presumed, in the absence of evidence to the contrary, that the accused drove the motor vehicle in a manner that was dangerous to the public having regard to all the circumstances of the case if the prosecution proves that the accused, at the time of the driving, was knowingly or recklessly in contravention of section 18 or 30 of the **Road Safety Act 1986**.
- (2) In this section *serious injury* has the meaning given by section 15.

S. 319AA
inserted by
No. 83/2012
s. 32.

319AA Dangerous or negligent driving while pursued by police

- (1) A person must not drive a motor vehicle dangerously or negligently if he or she knows, or ought reasonably to know, that—
- (a) he or she has been given a direction to stop the vehicle by a police officer; and
- (b) a police officer is pursuing the vehicle.

S. 319AA(1)(a)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.9).

S. 319AA(1)(b)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.9).

Penalty: 3 years imprisonment.

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)—
- (a) a person drives a motor vehicle dangerously if he or she drives the vehicle at a speed or in a manner that is dangerous to the public having regard to all the circumstances of the case; and
- (b) a person drives a motor vehicle negligently if he or she fails unjustifiably and to a gross degree to observe the standard of care which a reasonable person would have observed in all the circumstances of the case; and

(c) a police officer may be pursuing a motor vehicle even if not travelling at the same speed as the vehicle; and

S. 319AA(2)(c)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.9).

(d) it is irrelevant that the police pursuit is suspended or terminated before the motor vehicle being pursued stops.

(3) In this section—

direction to stop has the same meaning as it has in section 64A(5) of the **Road Safety Act 1986**;

motor vehicle does not include a vessel.

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S. 320
amended by
Nos 6762
s. 13(e), 7184
s. 4,
substituted by
No. 7645 s. 4,
amended by
Nos 7876
s. 2(3), 9576
s. 11(1), 10084
s. 5,
repealed by
No. 10260
s. 114(Sch. 4
item 4).

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S. 321
amended by
No. 6561 s. 3,
repealed by
No. 7645 s. 5.

Pt 1 Div. 9AA
(Heading
amended by
No. 8/2014
s. 32.

Division 9AA—Offences connected with dangerous, menacing and restricted breed dogs and related court powers

Pt 1 Div. 9AA
(Heading and
ss 319A–
319C)
inserted by
No. 55/2011
s. 3.

Subdivision 1—Offences

Pt 1 Div. 9AA
Subdiv. 1
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 8/2014
s. 33.

319A Definitions

S. 319A
inserted by
No. 55/2011
s. 3.

In this Division—

S. 319A def. of
control
repealed by
No. 20/2015
s. 23(a).

* * * *

dangerous dog has the same meaning as in
section 3(1) of the **Domestic Animals
Act 1994**;

S. 319A def. of
*failure to keep
under control*
inserted by
No. 20/2015
s. 23(b).

failure to keep under control, in relation to a
dangerous dog, menacing dog or restricted
breed dog, includes a failure to comply with
any of the requirements under sections 26(1),
28, 29, 38, 39, 40, 41, 41E, 41F(1)(a), 41G,
41H, 41HA and 41I of the **Domestic
Animals Act 1994**;

menacing dog has the same meaning as in
section 3(1) of the **Domestic Animals
Act 1994**;

owner, in relation to a dangerous dog, menacing dog or restricted breed dog, has the same meaning as in section 3(1) of the **Domestic Animals Act 1994** and includes a person who is deemed to be an owner of the dog under section 4 of that Act;

restricted breed dog has the same meaning as in section 3(1) of the **Domestic Animals Act 1994** and includes a dog that is taken under section 3(3) of that Act to be a restricted breed dog.

319B Failure to control dangerous, menacing or restricted breed dog that kills person

S. 319B
inserted by
No. 55/2011
s. 3.

(1) If—

- (a) an owner of a dangerous dog, menacing dog or restricted breed dog fails to keep the dog under control; and
- (b) the dog kills another person (the ***victim***); and
- (c) a reasonable person would have realised that that failure would expose the victim or any other person to an appreciable risk of death—

the owner is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

(2) If—

- (a) a person (other than the owner of a dangerous dog, menacing dog or restricted breed dog)—
 - (i) is, for the time being, in charge or has care of the dog; and
 - (ii) fails to keep the dog under control; and

(iii) is reckless as to whether the dog is a dangerous dog, menacing dog or restricted breed dog; and

(b) the dog kills another person (the *victim*); and

(c) a reasonable person would have realised that that failure would expose the victim or any other person to an appreciable risk of death—

the first mentioned person is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 319C
inserted by
No. 55/2011
s. 3.

319C Recklessness as to whether controlling dangerous, menacing or restricted breed dog may place another person in danger of death

S. 319C(1)
amended by
No. 8/2014
s. 34(1).

(1) An owner of a dangerous dog, menacing dog or restricted breed dog who, without lawful excuse, recklessly engages in conduct so that the dog is not under control, and that conduct places or may place another person in danger of death, is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 319C(2)
amended by
No. 8/2014
s. 34(2).

(2) A person (other than the owner of a dangerous dog, menacing dog or restricted breed dog) who—

(a) for the time being, is in charge or has care of the dog; and

(b) is reckless as to whether the dog is a dangerous dog, menacing dog or restricted breed dog; and

(c) without lawful excuse, recklessly engages in conduct so that the dog is not under control, and that conduct places or may place another person in danger of death—

is guilty of an indictable offence and liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

**Subdivision 2—Disqualification of person from
owning or being in charge or control of a dog**

Pt 1 Div. 9AA
Subdiv. 2
(Heading and
ss 319D–
319L)
inserted by
No. 8/2014
s. 35.

**319D Court may disqualify person from owning or being
in charge or control of a dog**

S. 319D
inserted by
No. 8/2014
s. 35.

If a person has been convicted, found guilty or found not guilty because of mental impairment, of an offence against section 319B(1) or (2) or 319C(1) or (2), the court may, in addition to or instead of any other penalty, order—

- (a) that the person be disqualified for the period (not exceeding 10 years) specified in the order, from owning or being in charge or control of a dog; or
- (b) that the conditions, specified in the order, apply for the period specified in the order to the person whenever the person is in charge or control of a dog.

**319E Search warrant for failure to comply with court
order**

S. 319E
inserted by
No. 8/2014
s. 35.

- (1) An authorised officer who is appointed by a Council under section 72 of the **Domestic Animals Act 1994** may apply to a magistrate for the issue of a search warrant in relation to premises (including residential premises) in the municipal district of that Council, if the authorised officer believes on reasonable grounds that a person subject to an order under section 319D is holding a dog on the premises in contravention of that order.

S. 319E(2)
amended by
No. 6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.3).

- (2) If the magistrate is satisfied, by the evidence on oath or by affirmation or by affidavit of the authorised officer, that there are reasonable grounds to believe that a person subject to an order under section 319D is holding a dog on the premises in contravention of that order, the magistrate may issue a search warrant, in accordance with the **Magistrates' Court Act 1989**, authorising an authorised officer who is appointed under section 72 of the **Domestic Animals Act 1994** by the Council for the municipal district in which the premises is located and who is named in the warrant—
- (a) to enter the premises; and
 - (b) to search for and seize the dog; and
 - (c) to dispose of the dog in accordance with the directions set out in the warrant.

S. 319F
inserted by
No. 8/2014
s. 35.

319F Certain sections of the Domestic Animals Act 1994 apply to search warrant under this section

For the purposes of section 319E, sections 84EB, 84F and 84G of the **Domestic Animals Act 1994** apply as if a reference in those sections to a search warrant issued under Part 7A were a reference to a search warrant issued under section 319E.

S. 319G
inserted by
No. 8/2014
s. 35.

319G Order under section 319D may be suspended

A court that has made an order under section 319D may suspend the order—

- (a) for any period which the court considers necessary for the person subject to the order to make arrangements for the custody of a dog; or
- (b) pending the determination of an appeal against the order.

319H Person subject to order under section 319D may apply for variation, suspension or revocation of order

S. 319H
inserted by
No. 8/2014
s. 35.

- (1) A person who is subject to an order under section 319D may apply to the court that made the order for the variation, suspension or revocation of the order.
- (2) An application under subsection (1) may be made no earlier than 12 months after the order is made.

319I Power of court to vary etc. order under section 319D

S. 319I
inserted by
No. 8/2014
s. 35.

- (1) On application under section 319H, the court may by order—
 - (a) vary an order under section 319D as specified, and from the date specified, in the order; or
 - (b) suspend the order, from the date specified in the order, for a specified period; or
 - (c) revoke the order; or
 - (d) refuse the application.
- (2) In making an order under subsection (1), the court may have regard to any one or more of the following matters—
 - (a) the applicant's character;
 - (b) the applicant's conduct since the order under section 319D was made;
 - (c) the nature of the offence or offences (if any) on which that order was based;
 - (d) any other relevant circumstances.

S. 319J
inserted by
No. 8/2014
s. 35.

319J Person may not make another application for variation, suspension or revocation of order for 12 months

If a court makes an order for a variation under section 319I(1)(a) or refuses an application under section 319I(1)(d), the person who applied for the relevant application under section 319H must not make another application under section 319H until 12 months after the order for the variation was made or the application was refused (as the case may be).

S. 319K
inserted by
No. 8/2014
s. 35.

319K Orders under section 319D are to operate consecutively

If a person is disqualified under an order under section 319D(a) and, during the period of disqualification, a court makes a further order under that section in respect of that person, the further order takes effect immediately after the end of the period of disqualification fixed by the initial order.

S. 319L
inserted by
No. 8/2014
s. 35.

319L Person must comply with order under section 319D

A person who is subject to an order under section 319D must comply with the order.

Penalty: 240 penalty units or imprisonment for 2 years.

Division 9A—Penalties for certain common law offences

**Pt 1 Div. 9A
(Heading and
s. 320)
inserted by
No. 48/1997
s. 56.**

320 Maximum term of imprisonment for certain common law offences

**New s. 320
inserted by
No. 48/1997
s. 56,
amended by
No. 8/2008
s. 13.**

An offence at common law specified in column 1 of the Table is punishable by the maximum term of imprisonment specified opposite it in column 2 of the Table.

TABLE

S. 320 (Table)
- amended by
Nos 47/2016
s. 19, 32/2017
s. 10.

<i>Column 1</i>	<i>Column 2</i>
<i>Common law offence</i>	<i>Maximum Term of Imprisonment</i>
*	*
Attempt to pervert the course of justice	Level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum)
Breach of prison	Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum)
Bribery of public official	Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum)
Common assault	Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum)
Conspiracy to cheat and defraud	Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum)
Conspiracy to defraud	Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum)
Criminal defamation	Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum)
Embracery	Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum)
False imprisonment	Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum)
Kidnapping	Level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum)
Misconduct in public office	Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum)

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part I—Offences

<i>Column 1</i>	<i>Column 2</i>
<i>Common law offence</i>	<i>Maximum Term of Imprisonment</i>
Perverting the course of justice	Level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum)
Public nuisance	Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum)
*	* * *
*	* * *
Unlawful assembly	Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum)
*	* * *

Note to s. 320 inserted by No. 65/2016 s. 20(20).

Note

The offence of kidnapping at common law is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See subsection (2H) of section 5 of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that subsection exist.

S. 320A inserted by No. 3/2019 s. 4.

320A Maximum term of imprisonment for common assault in certain circumstances

- (1) Despite section 320, the maximum term of imprisonment for common assault is level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum) if—
 - (a) at the time of the assault, the person who commits the assault (the *offender*) has an offensive weapon readily available; and
 - (b) the person assaulted (the *victim*) is a police officer on duty or a protective services officer on duty; and
 - (c) the offender knows or is reckless as to whether the victim is a police officer or a protective services officer; and

(d) the offender—

- (i) enables the victim to see the offensive weapon or the general shape of the offensive weapon; or
- (ii) tells or suggests to the victim that the offender has an offensive weapon or a firearm readily available; and

(e) the offender—

- (i) knows that engaging in conduct referred to in subsection (1)(d) would be likely to arouse apprehension or fear; or
- (ii) in all the particular circumstances, the person ought to have known that engaging in conduct referred to in subsection (1)(d) would be likely to arouse that apprehension or fear.

Notes

- 1 A common assault referred to in this subsection if committed in certain circumstances is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2H) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (e) of that section exist.
- 2 Section 16(3E) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** requires that every term of imprisonment imposed on a person for a common assault at common law if committed in certain circumstances must, unless otherwise directed by the court, be served cumulatively on any uncompleted sentence or sentences of imprisonment imposed on that offender, whether before or at the same time as that term.

- (2) Despite section 320, the maximum term of imprisonment for common assault is level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum) if—
- (a) at the time of the assault, the person who commits the assault (the *offender*) has a firearm or an imitation firearm readily available; and
 - (b) the person assaulted (the *victim*) is a police officer on duty or a protective services officer on duty; and
 - (c) the offender knows or is reckless as to whether the victim is a police officer or a protective services officer; and
 - (d) the offender—
 - (i) enables the victim to see the firearm or the imitation firearm or the general shape of the firearm or the imitation firearm; or
 - (ii) tells or suggests to the victim that the offender has a firearm or an imitation firearm readily available; and
 - (e) the offender—
 - (i) knows that engaging in conduct referred to in subsection (2)(d) would be likely to arouse apprehension or fear; or
 - (ii) in all the particular circumstances, the person ought to have known that engaging in conduct referred to in subsection (2)(d) would be likely to arouse that apprehension or fear.

Notes

- 1 A common assault referred to in this subsection if committed in certain circumstances is a category 2 offence under the **Sentencing Act 1991**. See section 5(2H) of that Act for the requirement to impose a custodial order for this offence unless the circumstances set out in paragraphs (a) to (c) of that section exist.
 - 2 Section 16(3E) of the **Sentencing Act 1991** requires that every term of imprisonment imposed on a person for a common assault at common law if committed in certain circumstances must, unless otherwise directed by the court, be served cumulatively on any uncompleted sentence or sentences of imprisonment imposed on that offender, whether before or at the same time as that term.
- (3) For the purposes of subsections (1) and (2), a person has an offensive weapon, a firearm or an imitation firearm readily available if the offensive weapon, the firearm or the imitation firearm is—
- (a) in the person's hand; or
 - (b) on the person's body; or
 - (c) within the person's reach.
- (4) In this section—
- firearm*** has the same meaning as it has in the **Firearms Act 1996**;
- imitation firearm*** has the same meaning as in section 77(1A);
- offensive weapon*** means any article (other than a firearm or an imitation firearm) made or adapted for use for causing injury to or incapacitating a person, or which at the time of an assault the person having it with them intends or threatens to use for such a purpose;

police officer on duty means a police officer who is performing any duty or exercising any power as such an officer;

protective services officer on duty means a protective services officer who is performing any duty or exercising any power as such an officer.

Division 10—Conspiracy

Pt 1 Div. 10
(Heading and
s. 322)
repealed by
No. 9576
s. 8(a), new
Pt 1 Div. 10
(Heading and
ss 321–321F)
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

321 Conspiracy to commit an offence

New s. 321
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

S. 321(1)
amended by
No. 32/2024
s. 796.

- (1) Subject to this Act, if a person agrees with any other person or persons that a course of conduct shall be pursued which will involve the commission of an offence by one or more of the parties to the agreement, the person is guilty of the indictable offence of conspiracy to commit that offence.
- (2) For a person to be guilty under subsection (1) of conspiracy to commit a particular offence both the person and at least one other party to the agreement—
 - (a) must intend that the offence the subject of the agreement be committed; and
 - (b) must intend or believe that any fact or circumstance the existence of which is an element of the offence will exist at the time

S. 321(2)
amended by
No. 32/2024
s. 796.

when the conduct constituting the offence is to take place.

- (3) A person may be guilty under subsection (1) of conspiracy to commit an offence notwithstanding the existence of facts of which the person is unaware which make commission of the offence by the agreed course of conduct impossible.

S. 321(3)
amended by
No. 32/2024
s. 796.

- (4) An indictment charging an offence against this section must not be filed without the approval of the Director of Public Prosecutions or of a person authorized by the Director of Public Prosecutions to give approval for the purposes of this subsection.

S. 321(4)
inserted by
No. 10233
s. 9(a),
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.15).

321AA Agreement with child who may not be criminally responsible

S. 321AA
inserted by
No. 32/2024
s. 797.

A person may be found guilty of an offence against section 321 even if—

- (a) the other party to the agreement referred to in that section is a child, or, if there is more than one other party to the agreement, all of the other parties to the agreement are children; and
- (b) under section 10 or 11 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**, it is presumed that the child, or those children, cannot commit the offence that is the subject of the agreement.

Notes

- 1 It is conclusively presumed that a child who is under 12 years of age cannot commit an offence—see section 10 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**.
- 2 It is presumed that a child who is 12 or 13 years of age cannot commit an offence—see section 11 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**.

S. 321A
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

321A Agreements to commit offences outside Victoria

- (1) The expression *the commission of an offence* in section 321(1) extends to the commission of an offence against a law in force only in a place outside Victoria if, but only if—
 - (a) the necessary elements of that offence include elements which, if present or occurring in Victoria, would constitute an offence against a law in Victoria; and
 - (b) one or more of the persons referred to in section 321(1) is or are in Victoria when the agreement referred to in that subsection is made.
- (2) Where all parties to an agreement are outside Victoria when it is made, section 321 shall apply in relation to it if, but only if, that agreement is to pursue a course of conduct which, if the agreement is carried out in accordance with their intentions, will necessarily amount to or involve the commission of an offence against a law in force in Victoria.

(See *R. v. Darby* (1982) 40 ALR 594).
S. 321B
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

321B As to consequences of acquittal of co-conspirators

It is hereby declared that the conviction of a conspirator whether tried together with or separately from another alleged conspirator or other alleged conspirators may stand notwithstanding that the other alleged conspirator or conspirators is or may be acquitted unless in all the circumstances of the case the conviction is inconsistent with the acquittal of the other alleged conspirator or conspirators.

321C Penalties for conspiracy

(1) Where a person is convicted under section 321 of conspiracy to commit an offence or offences against a law or laws in force in Victoria—

S. 321C
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

(a) if the penalty for the relevant offence is fixed by law, the person shall be liable to a penalty not exceeding the penalty for the relevant offence;

(b) if the relevant offence, or any of the relevant offences, is an offence for which the penalty is imprisonment for a term the maximum length of which is not prescribed by law, the person shall be liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum);

S. 321C(1)(b)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 62(a)),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 90(a)).

(ba) despite paragraph (b), if the relevant offence, or any of the relevant offences, is murder or treason, the person is liable to—

S. 321C(1)(ba)
inserted by
No. 41/1993
s. 22(a),
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 90(b)(i)).

(i) level 1 imprisonment (life); or

S. 321C(1)
(ba)(i)
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 90(b)(ii)).

(ii) imprisonment for such other term as is fixed by the court—

as the court determines;

(c) subject to paragraphs (a), (b), (ba) and (d), if the relevant offence, or any of the relevant offences, is an offence for which a maximum penalty is prescribed by law, the person shall be liable to a penalty not exceeding that maximum penalty or the accumulated maximum penalties, as the case may be; or

S. 321C(1)(c)
amended by
No. 41/1993
s. 22(b).

S. 321C(1)(d)
amended by
Nos 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.17),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 62(b)(i)),
68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.16).

(d) if the relevant offence, or each of the relevant offences, may be heard and determined only in the Magistrates' Court, the person shall be liable to—

S. 321C(1)
(d)(i)
substituted by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 62(b)(ii)),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 90(c)(i)).

(i) level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum); or

S. 321C(1)
(d)(ii)
substituted by
No. 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 62(b)(iii)).

(ii) imprisonment for a term not exceeding the maximum term of imprisonment (if any) prescribed in respect of the relevant offence or the greatest of the maximum terms prescribed in respect of any of the relevant offences, as the case requires—

whichever is the greater.

(2) Where a person is convicted under section 321 of conspiracy to commit an offence or offences against a law or laws in force only in a place outside Victoria—

S. 321C(2)(a)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 62(c)(i)),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 91).

(a) the person shall, if the relevant offence, or any of the relevant offences, is punishable by a term of imprisonment, be liable to a term of imprisonment not exceeding the maximum term of imprisonment prescribed in respect of the relevant offence; and

- (b) the person shall, in any other case, be liable to a level 6 fine (600 penalty units maximum).

S. 321C(2)(b)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 62(c)(ii)),
69/1997
s. 22(8).

321D Application of certain provisions

Sections 321(2) and (3) and 321B shall apply, so far as they are capable of doing so and with such changes as are necessary, for the purpose of determining whether a person is guilty of conspiracy under any enactment other than section 321 or of conspiracy to cheat and defraud or of conspiracy to defraud.

S. 321D
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

321E Limitations on prosecution

- (1) Where any enactment prohibits the institution or continuance of proceedings for an offence otherwise than by or with the consent of any person, the prohibition shall apply in relation to proceedings under section 321 for conspiracy to commit that offence.
- (2) Where—
- (a) an indictable offence has been committed in pursuance of an agreement; and
 - (b) proceedings may not be instituted for that offence because a time limit applicable to the institution of such proceedings has expired—
- proceedings under section 321 for conspiracy to commit that offence shall not be instituted against any person on the basis of that agreement.
- (3) A person shall not be liable to be convicted in respect of the same agreement of both—
- (a) conspiracy under section 321; and

S. 321E
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

- (b) conspiracy under any enactment other than section 321 or of conspiracy to cheat and defraud or of conspiracy to defraud.

S. 321F
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

321F Abolition of certain offences of conspiracy at common law

- (1) The offence of conspiracy at common law is hereby abolished.
- (2) Nothing in subsection (1) shall affect the offence of conspiracy at common law so far as it relates to conspiracy to cheat and defraud and conspiracy to defraud.
- (3) Any offence at common law of incitement to commit the offence of conspiracy or attempt to commit the offence of conspiracy (whether the offence of conspiracy incited or attempted would be an offence at common law or under section 321 or any other enactment) is hereby abolished.
- (4) An indictment charging an offence of conspiracy to cheat and defraud or conspiracy to defraud must not be filed without the approval of the Director of Public Prosecutions or of a person authorized by the Director of Public Prosecutions to give approval for the purposes of this subsection.

S. 321F(4)
inserted by
No. 10233
s. 9(b),
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.17).

Pt 1 Div. 11
(Heading and
ss 321G–
321L)
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

Division 11—Incitement

S. 321G
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

321G Incitement

- (1) Subject to this Act, where a person in Victoria or elsewhere incites any other person to pursue a course of conduct which will involve the commission of an offence by—

- (a) the person incited;
 - (b) the inciter; or
 - (c) both the inciter and the person incited—
if the inciting is acted on in accordance with the inciter's intention, the inciter is guilty of the indictable offence of incitement.
- (2) For a person to be guilty under subsection (1) of incitement the person—
- (a) must intend that the offence the subject of the incitement be committed; and
 - (b) must intend or believe that any fact or circumstance the existence of which is an element of the offence in question will exist at the time when the conduct constituting the offence is to take place.
- (3) A person may be guilty under subsection (1) of incitement notwithstanding the existence of facts of which the person is unaware which make commission of the offence in question by the course of conduct incited impossible.

321GA Incitement of child who may not be criminally responsible

S. 321GA
inserted by
No. 32/2024
s. 798.

A person may be found guilty of an offence against section 321G even if—

- (a) the person incited is a child; and
- (b) under section 10 or 11 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**, it is presumed that the child cannot commit the offence that is the subject of the incitement.

Notes

- 1 It is conclusively presumed that a child who is under 12 years of age cannot commit an offence—see section 10 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**.

- 2 It is presumed that a child who is 12 or 13 years of age cannot commit an offence—see section 11 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**.

S. 321H
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2),
amended by
No. 25/1989
s. 20(g).

321H Incitement to commit offences outside Victoria

The expression *the commission of an offence* in section 321G(1) extends to the commission of an offence against a law in force only in a place outside Victoria if, but only if—

- (a) the necessary elements of the offence consist of or include elements which, if present or occurring in Victoria, would constitute an offence against a law in force in Victoria; and
- (b) the person inciting is in Victoria at the time of the inciting.

S. 321I
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

321I Penalties for incitement

- (1) Where a person is convicted under section 321G of incitement to commit an offence or offences against a law or laws in force in Victoria—
 - (a) if the penalty for the relevant offence is fixed by law, the person shall be liable to a penalty not exceeding the penalty for the relevant offence;
 - (b) if the relevant offence, or any of the relevant offences, is an offence for which the penalty is imprisonment for a term the maximum length of which is not prescribed by law, the person shall be liable to level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum);

S. 321I(1)(b)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 57),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 92(a)).

- (ba) despite paragraph (b), if the relevant offence, or any of the relevant offences, is murder or treason, the person is liable to—
- (i) level 1 imprisonment (life); or
- (ii) imprisonment for such other term as is fixed by the court—
- as the court determines;
- (c) subject to paragraphs (a), (b), (ba) and (d), if the relevant offence, or any of the relevant offences is an offence for which a maximum penalty is prescribed by law, the person shall be liable to a penalty not exceeding that maximum penalty or the accumulated maximum penalties, as the case may be; or
- (d) if the relevant offence, or each of the relevant offences, may be heard and determined only in the Magistrates' Court, the person shall be liable to—
- (i) level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum); or
- S. 321(1)(ba) inserted by No. 41/1993 s. 23(a), amended by No. 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 92(b)(i)).
- S. 321(1)(ba)(i) substituted by No. 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 92(b)(ii)).
- S. 321(1)(c) amended by No. 41/1993 s. 23(b).
- S. 321(1)(d) amended by Nos 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. item 42.18), 49/1991 s. 119(1)(Sch. 2 item 63(a)(i)), 68/2009 s. 97(Sch. item 40.18).
- S. 321(1)(d)(i) substituted by Nos 49/1991 s. 119(1)(Sch. 2 item 63(a)(ii)), 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 item 92(c)).

S. 321I(1)(d)(ii)
amended by
No. 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 63(a)(iii)).

- (ii) imprisonment for a term not exceeding the maximum term of imprisonment (if any) prescribed in respect of the relevant offence or the greatest of the maximum terms prescribed in respect of any of the relevant offences as the case requires—

whichever is the greater.

- (2) Where a person is convicted under section 321G of incitement to commit an offence or offences against a law in force only in a place outside Victoria—

S. 321I(2)(a)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 63(b)(i)),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 93).

- (a) the person shall, if the relevant offence, or any of the relevant offences, is punishable by a term of imprisonment, be liable to a term of imprisonment not exceeding the maximum term of imprisonment prescribed in respect of the relevant offence; and

S. 321I(2)(b)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 63(b)(ii)),
69/1997
s. 22(9).

- (b) the person shall, in any other case, be liable to a level 6 fine (600 penalty units maximum).

S. 321J
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

321J Application of certain provisions

Subsections (2) and (3) of section 321G shall apply, so far as they are capable of doing so and with such changes as are necessary, for the purpose of determining whether a person is guilty of incitement under any enactment other than section 321G.

321K Limitations on prosecution

S. 321K
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

- (1) Where any enactment prohibits the institution or continuance of proceedings for an offence otherwise than by or with the consent of any person, the prohibition shall apply in relation to proceedings under section 321G for incitement to commit that offence.
- (2) Where—
 - (a) an indictable offence has been committed; and
 - (b) proceedings may not be instituted for that offence because a time limit applicable to the institution of such proceedings has expired—proceedings under section 321G for incitement to commit that offence shall not be instituted against any person.
- (3) A person shall not be liable to be convicted in respect of the same inciting of both—
 - (a) incitement under section 321G; and
 - (b) incitement under any enactment other than section 321G.

321L Incitement at common law abolished

S. 321L
inserted by
No. 10079
s. 7(2).

The offence of incitement at common law is hereby abolished.

Division 11A—Recruiting a child to engage in criminal activity

Pt 1 Div. 11A
(Heading and
ss 321LA–
321LD)
inserted by
No. 43/2017
s. 4.

S. 321LA
inserted by
No. 43/2017
s. 4,
amended by
No. 32/2024
s. 799(2) (ILA
s. 39B(1)).

S. 321LA(1)
def. of *adult*
inserted by
No. 32/2024
s. 799(1).

321LA Definitions

(1) In this Division—

adult means a person who is 18 years of age or
over;

child means a person aged under 18 years;

criminal activity means conduct that constitutes
an offence punishable on first conviction
with imprisonment for life or for a term of
5 years or more;

recruit means incite, direct or induce.

S. 321LA(2)
inserted by
No. 32/2024
s. 799(2).

(2) Conduct by a child may be *criminal activity* even
if, under section 10 or 11 of the **Youth Justice
Act 2024**, it is presumed that the child cannot
commit the offence that the conduct would
constitute.

Notes

- 1 It is conclusively presumed that a child who is under 12
years of age cannot commit an offence—see section 10
of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**.
- 2 It is presumed that a child who is 12 or 13 years of age
cannot commit an offence—see section 11 of the
Youth Justice Act 2024.

321LB Recruiting a child to engage in criminal activity

S. 321LB
inserted by
No. 43/2017
s. 4.

- (1) An adult must not recruit another person to engage in criminal activity, knowing that the other person is a child.

S. 321LB(1)
amended by
Nos 32/2024
s. 800, 54/2025
s. 7.

Penalty: Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum).

- (2) For an adult to be guilty of an offence under subsection (1), the adult must know that it is likely the child will engage in the criminal activity that is the subject of the recruiting.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), the ages of the adult and the child are to be ascertained at the time of the recruitment.

321LC Child need not engage in conduct or be prosecuted or found guilty of an offence

S. 321LC
inserted by
No. 43/2017
s. 4,
amended by
No. 32/2024
s. 801.

An adult may be found guilty of the offence referred to in section 321LB(1) whether or not the child referred to in that section—

- (a) engages in criminal activity; or
- (b) is prosecuted for, or is found guilty of, any offence.

321LD Limitation on prosecution

S. 321LD
inserted by
No. 43/2017
s. 4,
amended by
No. 32/2024
s. 802.

An adult is not liable to be convicted in respect of the same conduct of both—

- (a) an offence under section 321LB(1); and
- (b) an offence under section 321G(1).

Division 12—Attempts

Pt 1 Div. 12
(Heading and
(ss 321M–
321S)
inserted by
No. 10233 s. 4.

S. 321M
inserted by
No. 10233 s. 4.

321M Attempt

A person who attempts to commit an indictable offence is guilty of the indictable offence of attempting to commit that offence.

S. 321N
inserted by
No. 10233 s. 4.

321N Conduct constituting attempt

(1) A person is not guilty of attempting to commit an offence unless the conduct of the person is—

- (a) more than merely preparatory to the commission of the offence; and
- (b) immediately and not remotely connected with the commission of the offence.

(2) For a person to be guilty of attempting to commit an offence, the person must—

- (a) intend that the offence the subject of the attempt be committed; and
- (b) subject to subsection (2A), intend or believe that any fact or circumstance the existence of which is an element of the offence will exist at the time the offence is to take place.

S. 321N(2)(b)
amended by
No. 6/2017
s. 13(1).

S. 321N(2A)
inserted by
No. 6/2017
s. 13(2).

(2A) For the purposes of subsection (2)(b), in the case of an attempt to commit an offence against section 38 (rape), section 39 (rape by compelling sexual penetration), section 40 (sexual assault) or section 41 (sexual assault by compelling sexual touching), instead of the element of the offence referred to in section 38(1)(c), 39(1)(c), 40(1)(d) or 41(1)(d), it must be proved that at the time of the attempt the person (A) does not reasonably believe that the person against whom the offence

is to be committed (B) would consent to the penetration or the touching (as the case requires).

- (3) A person may be guilty of attempting to commit an offence despite the existence of facts of which he or she is unaware which make the commission of the offence attempted impossible.

321O Attempts to commit offence outside Victoria

S. 321O
inserted by
No. 10233 s. 4.

- (1) A person in Victoria who attempts to commit in another State or in a Territory an offence which, if committed in whole or in part in Victoria, would be an indictable offence against the law of Victoria is guilty of the indictable offence of attempting to commit that offence.
- (2) A person outside Victoria who attempts to commit an indictable offence in Victoria is guilty of the indictable offence of attempting to commit that offence.
- (3) In subsection (1), *Territory* means the Australian Capital Territory, the Jervis Bay Territory or the Northern Territory.

321P Penalties for attempt

S. 321P
inserted by
No. 10233 s. 4.

- (1) A person convicted of attempting to commit an offence is liable—
- (a) if the penalty for the relevant offence is set out by reference to an expression specified in column 1 of the Table, to the penalty set out opposite it in column 2 of the Table:

S. 321P(1)
substituted by
No. 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 64).

TABLE

S. 321P(1)(a)
Table
substituted by
Nos 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 94(a)),
69/1997
s. 23.

<i>Column 1</i>	<i>Column 2</i>
Level 1 imprisonment (life)	Level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum)
Level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum)	Level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum)

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part I—Offences

<i>Column 1</i>	<i>Column 2</i>
Level 2 fine (3000 penalty units maximum)	Level 3 fine (2400 penalty units maximum)
Level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum)	Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum)
Level 3 fine (2400 penalty units maximum)	Level 4 fine (1800 penalty units maximum)
Level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum)	Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum)
Level 4 fine (1800 penalty units maximum)	Level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum)
Level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum)	Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum)
Level 5 fine (1200 penalty units maximum)	Level 6 fine (600 penalty units maximum)
Level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum)	Level 7 imprisonment (2 years maximum)
Level 6 fine (600 penalty units maximum)	Level 7 fine (240 penalty units maximum)
Level 7 imprisonment (2 years maximum)	Level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum)
Level 7 fine (240 penalty units maximum)	Level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum)
Level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum)	Level 9 imprisonment (6 months maximum)
Level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum)	Level 9 fine (60 penalty units maximum)
Level 9 imprisonment (6 months maximum)	Level 10 fine (10 penalty units maximum)
Level 9 fine (60 penalty units maximum)	Level 10 fine (10 penalty units maximum)

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part I—Offences

<i>Column 1</i>	<i>Column 2</i>
Level 10 fine (10 penalty units maximum)	Level 11 fine (5 penalty units maximum)
Level 11 fine (5 penalty units maximum)	Level 12 fine (1 penalty unit maximum)
Level 12 fine (1 penalty unit maximum)	Level 12 fine (1 penalty unit maximum)

- (b) if the penalty for the relevant offence is not set out by reference to an expression specified in column 1 of the Table in paragraph (a), to a penalty not exceeding 60% of the maximum penalty fixed or prescribed by law for the relevant offence; or
- (c) if the maximum penalty for the relevant offence is not fixed or prescribed by law, to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 321P(1)(c)
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 94(b)).

- (1A) For the avoidance of doubt, it is declared that if a person is convicted of attempting to commit murder or treason, the person is liable to level 2 imprisonment (25 years maximum).

S. 321P(1A)
inserted by
No. 41/1993
s. 24,
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 95(a)(b)).

- (2) A person convicted under this Division of attempting to commit an offence for which, under another enactment, a penalty is provided that is lower than that provided under subsection (1), the person is liable only to that lower penalty.
- (3) In this section, a reference to a maximum penalty includes, in relation to an offence against the law of a place outside Victoria, a reference to a maximum penalty (not exceeding life imprisonment) fixed or prescribed by a law of that place and, if a maximum penalty so fixed or

prescribed exceeds life imprisonment, is a reference to life imprisonment.

S. 321Q
inserted by
No. 10233 s. 4.

321Q Limitations on prosecution

- (1) Any provision to which this section applies has the same effect with respect to an offence of attempting to commit an offence as it has with respect to the offence attempted.
- (2) This section applies to provisions of any of the following descriptions made by or under any enactment—
 - (a) provisions concerning the power to institute proceedings;
 - (b) provisions conferring a power of search in respect of persons or property;
 - (c) provisions conferring a power of seizure or detention of property;
 - (d) provisions whereby a person may not be convicted or committed for trial on the uncorroborated evidence of one witness (including any provision requiring the evidence of not less than two credible witnesses);
 - (e) provisions conferring a power to fine or of forfeiture, including any power to deal with anything liable to be forfeited;
 - (f) provisions concerning the liability of a person for the commission of an offence by a body corporate.
- (3) A person is not liable to be convicted in respect of the same conduct of both—
 - (a) an offence under section 321M; and
 - (b) an offence under any other enactment of attempting to commit an offence.

321R Application of Division

**S. 321R
inserted by
No. 10233 s. 4.**

(1) This Division applies to and in respect of an offence under any other enactment of attempting to commit an offence.

(2) The preceding provisions of this Division do not apply to an attempt—

(a) to be involved in the commission of an indictable offence; or

**S. 321R(2)(a)
substituted by
No. 63/2014
s. 7(6).**

(b) to commit the offence of conspiracy whether that offence is a statutory offence or an offence at common law.

321S Abolition of attempt at common law

**S. 321S
inserted by
No. 10233 s. 4.**

The offence of attempt at common law is abolished.

Pt 1A
(Heading and
s. 322A)
inserted by
No. 7884
s. 2(2).

Part IA—Abolition of obsolete offences

S. 322A
inserted by
No. 7884
s. 2(2).

322A Maintenance and certain other offences abolished

Any distinct offences under the common law of maintenance (including champerty but not embracery), or of being a common barrator, a common scold or a common night walker are hereby abolished.

Part IB—Abolition of historical classifications

Pt 1B
(Heading and
ss 322B–
322F)
inserted by
No. 9576 s. 2.

322B Abolition of distinctions between felony and misdemeanour

S. 322B
inserted by
No. 9576 s. 2.

- (1) All distinctions between felony and misdemeanour are hereby abolished.
- (2) Subject to section 322D, in all matters in which before the commencement of this Part a distinction has been made between felony and misdemeanour (including mode of trial), the law and practice in relation to all indictable offences cognizable under the law of Victoria (including piracy and offences deemed to be piracy) shall be the law and practice applicable immediately before the commencement of this Part in relation to misdemeanour.

322C Nomenclature

S. 322C
inserted by
No. 9576 s. 2.

- (1) Subject to any express amendment or repeal made by the **Crimes (Classification of Offences) Act 1981**, any enactment passed before the commencement of this Part and creating an offence by directing it to be a felony shall be read as directing it to be an indictable offence.
- (2) Nothing in this Part shall affect the operation of any reference to an indictable offence in the enactments specially relating to that offence by reason only of the reference being in terms no longer applicable after the commencement of this Part.

- (3) Any offence known to the common law as a felony or a misdemeanour shall on and from the commencement of this Part be known as an indictable offence.
- (4) Subject to subsection (1) and to any express amendment or repeal made by the **Crimes (Classification of Offences) Act 1981**, a reference in any instrument or document whatsoever (including Acts, rules, regulations and other instruments of a legislative character) to—
- (a) a class of felony; or
 - (b) felonies in general—
- shall be read and construed as a reference to that class of serious indictable offence or to serious indictable offences generally, as the case requires; and for the purposes of this subsection the expression *serious indictable offence* has the same meaning as it has in section 325.
- (5) Where in any Act, rule, regulation or other instrument of a legislative character a provision is expressed to apply to or in relation to indictable offences, the provision shall be read and construed as applying to offences which may be tried on indictment, including offences which may, or may in certain circumstances, also be heard and determined summarily.

S. 322C(5)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.19).

S. 322D
inserted by
No. 9576 s. 2.

322D Transitional provisions

- (1) This Part, insofar as it affects any matter of procedure or evidence or the jurisdiction or powers of any court in relation to indictable offences, shall have effect in relation to proceedings on indictment or presentment for an offence (except as provided by the following subsections of this section) if, but only if, the person charged with the offence is arraigned after the commencement of this Part.

- (2) Where a person is arraigned after the commencement of this Part on indictment or presentment for a felony committed before that commencement, the offence shall for the purposes of his trial on that indictment or presentment be deemed always to have been a misdemeanour and, notwithstanding that the indictment or presentment is framed for felony, shall be deemed to be charged as a misdemeanour.
- (3) On an indictment or presentment found or made before the commencement of this Part a person may notwithstanding subsection (2) be found guilty of any offence of which he could have been found guilty on the indictment or presentment if the **Crimes (Classification of Offences) Act 1981** had not come into operation, but not of any other offence.

322E Treason and misprision of treason not affected

Nothing in this Part shall be taken to affect directly or indirectly any matter of law or practice applicable to treason or misprision of treason.

S. 322E
inserted by
No. 9576 s. 2.

322F Other enactments not affected

This Part shall not affect the operation of any enactment restricting the institution of proceedings for an offence.

S. 322F
inserted by
No. 9576 s. 2.

Pt 1C
(Headings
and ss 322G–
322J)
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

Part IC—Self-defence, duress, sudden or extraordinary emergency and intoxication

Division 1—General

S. 322G
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

322G Application of Part

This Part applies to any offence, whether against
any enactment or at common law.

S. 322H
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

322H Definitions

In this Part—

evidence of family violence has the meaning
given in section 322J;

really serious injury includes serious sexual
assault.

S. 322I
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

322I Onus of proof

- (1) The accused has the evidential onus of raising
self-defence, duress or sudden or extraordinary
emergency by presenting or pointing to evidence
that suggests a reasonable possibility of the
existence of facts that, if they existed, would
establish self-defence, duress or sudden or
extraordinary emergency (as the case may be).
- (2) If the accused satisfies the evidential onus referred
to in subsection (1), the prosecution has the legal
onus of proving beyond reasonable doubt that the
accused did not carry out the conduct in self-
defence, under duress or in circumstances of
sudden or extraordinary emergency (as the case
may be).

S. 322J
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

322J Evidence of family violence

- (1) Evidence of family violence, in relation to a
person, includes evidence of any of the
following—

- (a) the history of the relationship between the person and a family member, including violence by the family member towards the person or by the person towards the family member or by the family member or the person in relation to any other family member;
 - (b) the cumulative effect, including psychological effect, on the person or a family member of that violence;
 - (c) social, cultural or economic factors that impact on the person or a family member who has been affected by family violence;
 - (d) the general nature and dynamics of relationships affected by family violence, including the possible consequences of separation from the abuser;
 - (e) the psychological effect of violence on people who are or have been in a relationship affected by family violence;
 - (f) social or economic factors that impact on people who are or have been in a relationship affected by family violence.
- (2) In this section—

child means a person who is under the age of 18 years;

family member, in relation to a person, includes—

- (a) a person who is or has been married to the person; or
- (b) a person who has or has had an intimate personal relationship with the person; or

- (c) a person who is or has been the father, mother, step-father or step-mother of the person; or
- (d) a child who normally or regularly resides with the person; or
- (e) a guardian of the person; or
- (f) another person who is or has been ordinarily a member of the household of the person;

family violence, in relation to a person, means violence against that person by a family member;

violence means—

- (a) physical abuse; or
- (b) sexual abuse; or
- (c) psychological abuse (which need not involve actual or threatened physical or sexual abuse), including but not limited to the following—
 - (i) intimidation;
 - (ii) harassment;
 - (iii) damage to property;
 - (iv) threats of physical abuse, sexual abuse or psychological abuse;
 - (v) in relation to a child—
 - (A) causing or allowing the child to see or hear the physical, sexual or psychological abuse of a person by a family member; or

- (B) putting the child, or allowing the child to be put, at real risk of seeing or hearing that abuse occurring.
- (3) Without limiting the definition of *violence* in subsection (2)—
- (a) a single act may amount to abuse for the purposes of that definition; and
 - (b) a number of acts that form part of a pattern of behaviour may amount to abuse for that purpose, even though some or all of those acts, when viewed in isolation, may appear to be minor or trivial.

Division 2—Self-defence

322K Self-defence

S. 322K
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

- (1) A person is not guilty of an offence if the person carries out the conduct constituting the offence in self-defence.
- (2) A person carries out conduct in self-defence if—
 - (a) the person believes that the conduct is necessary in self-defence; and
 - (b) the conduct is a reasonable response in the circumstances as the person perceives them.
- (3) This section only applies in the case of murder if the person believes that the conduct is necessary to defend the person or another person from the infliction of death or really serious injury.

Notes

- 1 See section 322M as to belief in circumstances where family violence is alleged.
- 2 The circumstances in which a person may carry out conduct in self-defence include—
 - the defence of the person or another person;

- the prevention or termination of the unlawful deprivation of the liberty of the person or another person;
- the protection of property.

S. 322L
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

322L Self-defence does not apply to a response to lawful conduct

Section 322K does not apply if—

- (a) the person is responding to lawful conduct;
and
- (b) at the time of the person's response, the person knows that the conduct is lawful.

S. 322M
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

322M Family violence and self-defence

- (1) Without limiting section 322K, for the purposes of an offence in circumstances where self-defence in the context of family violence is in issue, a person may believe that the person's conduct is necessary in self-defence, and the conduct may be a reasonable response in the circumstances as the person perceives them, even if—
 - (a) the person is responding to a harm that is not immediate; or
 - (b) the response involves the use of force in excess of the force involved in the harm or threatened harm.
- (2) Without limiting the evidence that may be adduced, in circumstances where self-defence in the context of family violence is in issue, evidence of family violence may be relevant in determining whether—
 - (a) a person has carried out conduct while believing it to be necessary in self-defence;
or
 - (b) the conduct is a reasonable response in the circumstances as a person perceives them.

322N Abolition of self-defence at common law

Self-defence at common law is abolished.

S. 322N
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

Division 3—Duress

322O Duress

- (1) A person is not guilty of an offence in respect of conduct carried out by the person under duress.
- (2) A person carries out conduct under duress if—
 - (a) the person reasonably believes that—
 - (i) subject to subsection (3), a threat of harm has been made that will be carried out unless an offence is committed; and
 - (ii) carrying out the conduct is the only reasonable way that the threatened harm can be avoided; and
 - (b) the conduct is a reasonable response to the threat.
- (3) A person does not carry out conduct under duress if the threat is made by or on behalf of a person with whom the person is voluntarily associating for the purpose of carrying out violent conduct.
- (4) This section only applies in the case of murder if the person believes that the threat is to inflict death or really serious injury.

S. 322O
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

322P Family violence and duress

Without limiting the evidence that may be adduced, in circumstances where duress in the context of family violence is in issue, evidence of family violence may be relevant in determining whether a person has carried out conduct under duress.

S. 322P
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

S. 322Q
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

322Q Abolition of duress at common law

The defence at common law of duress is abolished.

Division 4—Sudden or extraordinary emergency

S. 322R
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

322R Sudden or extraordinary emergency

- (1) A person is not guilty of an offence in respect of conduct that is carried out in circumstances of sudden or extraordinary emergency.
- (2) This section applies if—
 - (a) the person reasonably believes that—
 - (i) circumstances of sudden or extraordinary emergency exist; and
 - (ii) the conduct is the only reasonable way to deal with the emergency; and
 - (b) the conduct is a reasonable response to the emergency.
- (3) This section only applies in the case of murder if the person believes that the emergency involves a risk of death or really serious injury.

S. 322S
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

322S Abolition of necessity at common law

The defence at common law of necessity is abolished.

Division 5—Intoxication

S. 322T
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 4.

322T Intoxication

- (1) In this section—

defence includes self-defence, duress and sudden or extraordinary emergency;

intoxication means intoxication because of the influence of alcohol, a drug or any other substance.

- (2) If any part of a defence to an offence relies on reasonable belief, in determining whether that reasonable belief existed, regard must be had to the standard of a reasonable person who is not intoxicated.
- (3) If any part of a defence to an offence relies on reasonable response, in determining whether that response was reasonable, regard must be had to the standard of a reasonable person who is not intoxicated.
- (4) If a person's intoxication is not self-induced, in determining whether any part of a defence to an offence relying on reasonable belief or reasonable response exists, regard must be had to the standard of a reasonable person intoxicated to the same extent as the person concerned.
- (5) For the purposes of this section, intoxication is self-induced unless it came about—
- (a) involuntarily; or
 - (b) because of fraud, sudden or extraordinary emergency, accident, reasonable mistake, duress or force; or
 - (c) from the use of a drug for which a prescription is required and that was used in accordance with the directions of the person who prescribed it; or
 - * * * * *
 - (d) from the use of a drug for which no prescription is required and that was used for a purpose, and in accordance with the dosage level, recommended by the manufacturer.

S. 322T(5)(ca)
inserted by
No. 20/2016
s. 145(1)(a),
repealed by
No. 34/2019
s. 47(1)(a).

S. 322T(5)(d)
amended by
Nos 20/2016
s. 145(1)(b),
34/2019
s. 47(1)(b).

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part IC—Self-defence, duress, sudden or
extraordinary emergency and intoxication

S. 322T(6)
amended by
Nos 20/2016
s. 145(2),
34/2019
s. 47(2).

- (6) Despite subsection (5), intoxication is self-induced in the circumstances referred to in subsection (5)(c) or (d) if the person using the drug knew, or had reason to believe, when the person took the drug that the drug would significantly impair the person's judgment or control.

Part II—Offenders

Division 1—Abettors, accessories and concealers of offences

Pt 2 Div. 1
(Heading)
substituted by
No. 9576
s. 4(1).

(1) *Complicity in commission of offences*

Pt 2 Div. 1
Subdiv. (1)
(Heading and
s. 323)
substituted by
No. 9576
s. 4(1),
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.20),
substituted by
No. 63/2014
s. 6.

323 Interpretation

S. 323
substituted by
No. 63/2014
s. 6.

- (1) For the purposes of this Subdivision, a person is involved in the commission of an offence if the person—
- (a) intentionally assists, encourages or directs the commission of the offence; or
 - (b) intentionally assists, encourages or directs the commission of another offence where the person was aware that it was probable that the offence charged would be committed in the course of carrying out the other offence; or
 - (c) enters into an agreement, arrangement or understanding with another person to commit the offence; or
 - (d) enters into an agreement, arrangement or understanding with another person to commit another offence where the person was aware that it was probable that the offence charged

would be committed in the course of carrying out the other offence.

- (2) In determining whether a person has encouraged the commission of an offence, it is irrelevant whether or not the person who committed the offence in fact was encouraged to commit the offence.

Note

A person who committed an offence may include 2 or more persons who entered into an agreement, arrangement or understanding to commit the offence.

- (3) A person may be involved in the commission of an offence, by act or omission—
- (a) even if the person is not physically present when the offence, or an element of the offence, is committed; and
 - (b) whether or not the person realises that the facts constitute an offence.

New s. 324
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 6.

324 Person involved in commission of offence taken to have committed the offence

- (1) Subject to subsection (3), if an offence (whether indictable or summary) is committed, a person who is involved in the commission of the offence is taken to have committed the offence and is liable to the maximum penalty for that offence.
- (2) Despite subsection (1), a person is not taken to have committed an offence if the person withdraws from the offence.

Note

The common law recognises that in certain circumstances a person may withdraw from an offence in which the person would otherwise be complicit: for example, *White v Ridley* [1978] HCA 38; (1978) 140 CLR 342; *R v Tietie, Tulele and Bolamatu* (1988) 34 A Crim R 438; *R v Jensen and Ward* [1980] VicRp 24; [1980] VR 194.

- (3) Nothing in this section imposes liability on a person for an offence that, as a matter of policy, is intended to benefit or protect that person.

324A Other offenders need not be prosecuted or found guilty

S. 324A
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 6.

A person who is involved in the commission of an offence may be found guilty of the offence whether or not any other person is prosecuted for or found guilty of the offence.

324AB Complicity with child who may not be criminally responsible

S. 324AB
inserted by
No. 32/2024
s. 803.

- (1) A person who is involved in the commission of an offence in the circumstances described in section 323(1)(a) or (c) may be found guilty of the offence even if—
- (a) the conduct that constitutes the offence, or an element of the offence, was committed by a child; and
 - (b) under section 10 or 11 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**, it is presumed that the child cannot commit that offence.
- (2) A person who is involved in the commission of an offence in the circumstances described in section 323(1)(b) or (d) may be found guilty of the offence even if—
- (a) the conduct that constitutes the other offence, or an element of the other offence, was committed by a child; and
 - (b) under section 10 or 11 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**, it is presumed that the child cannot commit that other offence.

- (3) Nothing in this section affects the application of section 10 or 11 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024** to a child who is involved in the commission of an offence.

Notes

- 1 It is conclusively presumed that a child who is under 12 years of age cannot commit an offence—see section 10 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**.
- 2 It is presumed that a child who is 12 or 13 years of age cannot commit an offence—see section 11 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**.

S. 324B
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 6.

324B Offender's role need not be determined

A person may be found guilty of an offence by virtue of section 324 if the trier of fact is satisfied that the person is guilty either as the person who committed the offence or as a person involved in the commission of the offence but is unable to determine which applies.

S. 324C
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 6.

324C Abolition of certain aspects of complicity at common law

- (1) The law of complicity at common law in relation to aiding, abetting, counselling or procuring the commission of an offence is abolished.
- (2) The doctrines at common law of acting in concert, joint criminal enterprise and common purpose (including extended common purpose) are abolished.

Note

The common law concerning the circumstances in which a person may withdraw from an offence in which the person would otherwise be complicit is not abolished by this section.

* * * * *

Pt 2 Div. 1
Subdiv. (2)
(Heading and
ss 324–328)
substituted as
Pt 2 Div. 1
Subdiv. (2)
(Heading and
s. 324) by
No. 9576
s. 4(1),
repealed by
No. 63/2014
s. 6.

(3) *Accessories*

Pt 2 Div. 1
Subdiv. (3)
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 9576
s. 4(1).

325 Accessories

S. 325
substituted by
No. 9576
s. 4(1).

- (1) Where a person (in this section called *the principal offender*) has committed a serious indictable offence (in this section called *the principal offence*), any other person who, knowing or believing the principal offender to be guilty of the principal offence or some other serious indictable offence, without lawful authority or reasonable excuse does any act with the purpose of impeding the apprehension, prosecution, conviction or punishment of the principal offender shall be guilty of an indictable offence.
- (2) If, on the trial of any person for a serious indictable offence, the jury are satisfied that the offence charged (or some other serious indictable offence of which the accused might on that charge be found guilty) was committed, but find the accused not guilty of it, they may find him guilty of any offence under subsection (1) of which they are satisfied that he is guilty in relation to the offence charged (or that other offence).

S. 325(3)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.21).

(3) A person charged with an offence against subsection (1) may be indicted and convicted together with or before or after the principal offender and whether or not the principal offender is amenable to justice.

(4) A person convicted of an offence against subsection (1) shall be liable—

S. 325(4)(a)
substituted by
No. 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 65(a)),
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 96(a)).

(a) if the principal offence is one for which the penalty is level 1 imprisonment (life) to level 3 imprisonment (20 years maximum);
or

(b) in any other case, to imprisonment for a term which is neither—

S. 325(4)(b)(i)
amended by
No. 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 65(b)),
substituted by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 96(b)).

(i) more than 5 years in length; nor

(ii) more than one-half the length of the longest term which may be imposed on first conviction for the principal offence.

S. 325(5)
repealed by
No. 9848
s. 18(1).

* * * * *

(6) In this section, *serious indictable offence* means an indictable offence which, by virtue of any enactment, is punishable on first conviction with imprisonment for life or for a term of five years or more.

(4) *Concealers of offences*

Pt 2 Div. 1
Subdiv. (4)
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 9576
s. 4(1).

326 Concealing offences for benefit

S. 326
substituted by
No. 9576
s. 4(1).

- (1) Where a person has committed a serious indictable offence, any other person who, knowing or believing that the offence, or some other serious indictable offence, has been committed and that he has information which might be of material assistance in securing the prosecution or conviction of an offender for it, accepts any benefit for not disclosing that information shall be guilty of a summary offence and liable to level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum).
- (2) Notwithstanding anything to the contrary in subsection (1), it is no offence against this section to fail to disclose the commission of any offence against—
- (a) Division 2 of Part I; or
 - (b) subdivision (1), (2) or (3) of Division 3 of Part I—

S. 326(1)
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 66),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 97(a)(b)).

if the only benefit accepted in return for failing to disclose the commission of the offence is the making good of any loss or injury caused by its commission or the making of reasonable compensation for any such loss or injury.

- (3) For the purposes of this section a person shall be deemed to accept a benefit if he accepts or agrees to accept any benefit or advantage, or the promise of any benefit or advantage, either to himself or to another, whether or not the benefit or advantage is in money or money's worth.

S. 326(4)
repealed by
No. 9848
s. 18(1).

* * * * *

- (5) The compounding of an offence other than treason shall not be an offence otherwise than under this section.

- (6) In this section, *serious indictable offence* has the same meaning as it has in section 325.

New s. 327
inserted by
No. 36/2014
s. 4.

327 Failure to disclose sexual offence committed against child under the age of 16 years

- (1) In this section—

interests includes reputation, legal liability and financial status;

organisation includes a body corporate or an unincorporated body or association, whether the body or association—

- (a) is based in or outside Australia; or
- (b) is part of a larger organisation;

sexual offence means—

- (a) an offence committed under Subdivision (8A), (8B), (8C), (8E), (8F) or (8FA) of Division 1 of Part I on or after 1 July 2017; or
- (b) an offence committed under Subdivision (8D) of Division 1 of Part I on or after 1 July 2017 other than an offence that only relates to child

S. 327(1) def.
of *sexual
offence*
substituted by
No. 5/2018
s. 6.

abuse material of a kind described in paragraph (a)(i)(A) of the definition of *child abuse material* in section 51A(1), where the torture, cruelty or abuse is not sexual; or

Example

An offence committed under Subdivision (8D) of Division 1 of Part I that relates to child abuse material that depicts or describes a child as a victim of sexual abuse.

- (c) an offence committed before 1 July 2017 under Subdivision (8A), (8B), (8C), (8D), (8E) or (8EAA) as then in force; or
 - (d) an attempt to commit an offence referred to in paragraph (a), (b) or (c); or
 - (e) an assault with intent to commit an offence referred to in paragraph (a), (b) or (c).
- (2) Subject to subsections (5) and (7), a person of or over the age of 18 years (whether in Victoria or elsewhere) who has information that leads the person to form a reasonable belief that a sexual offence has been committed in Victoria against a child under the age of 16 years by another person of or over the age of 18 years must disclose that information to a police officer as soon as it is practicable to do so, unless the person has a reasonable excuse for not doing so.

**S. 327(2)
amended by
No. 36/2014
s. 7(1)(a).**

Penalty: 3 years imprisonment.

- (3) For the purposes of subsection (2) and without limiting that subsection, a person has a reasonable excuse for failing to comply with that subsection if—
- (a) the person fears on reasonable grounds for the safety of any person (other than the person reasonably believed to have committed, or to have been involved in, the sexual offence) were the person to disclose the information to police (irrespective of whether the fear arises because of the fact of disclosure or the information disclosed) and the failure to disclose the information to police is a reasonable response in the circumstances; or
 - (b) the person believes on reasonable grounds that the information has already been disclosed to police by another person and the firstmentioned person has no further information.

Example

A person may believe on reasonable grounds that the information has already been disclosed to police by another person if the person has made a report disclosing all of the information in his or her possession in compliance with mandatory reporting obligations under the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005**.

- (4) For the purposes of subsection (2) and without limiting that subsection, a person does not have a reasonable excuse for failing to comply with that subsection only because the person is concerned for the perceived interests of—
- (a) the person reasonably believed to have committed, or to have been involved in, the sexual offence; or
 - (b) any organisation.

- (5) A person does not contravene subsection (2) if—
- (a) the information forming the basis of the person's belief that a sexual offence has been committed came from the victim of the alleged offence, whether directly or indirectly; and
 - (b) the victim was of or over the age of 16 years at the time of providing that information to any person; and
 - (c) the victim requested that the information not be disclosed.
- (6) Subsection (5) does not apply if—
- (a) at the time of providing the information, the victim of the alleged sexual offence—
 - (i) has an intellectual disability (within the meaning of the **Disability Act 2006**); and
 - (ii) does not have the capacity to make an informed decision about whether or not the information should be disclosed; and
 - (b) the person to whom the information is provided is aware, or ought reasonably to have been aware, of those facts.
- (7) A person does not contravene subsection (2) if—
- (a) the person comes into possession of the information referred to in subsection (2) when a child; or
 - (b) the information referred to in subsection (2) would be privileged under Part 3.10 (other than section 127) of Chapter 3 of the **Evidence Act 2008**; or

S. 327(7)(b)
amended by
No. 30/2019
s. 16.

S. 327(7)(e)
amended by
No. 36/2014
s. 7(1)(b).

- (c) the information referred to in subsection (2) is a confidential communication within the meaning of section 32B of the **Evidence (Miscellaneous Provisions) Act 1958**; or
- (d) the person comes into possession of the information referred to in subsection (2) solely through the public domain or forms the belief referred to in subsection (2) solely from information in the public domain; or
- (e) the person is a police officer acting in the course of his or her duty in respect of the victim of the alleged sexual offence; or
- (f) the victim of the alleged sexual offence has attained the age of 16 years before the commencement of section 4 of the **Crimes Amendment (Protection of Children) Act 2014**.

S. 327(8)
inserted by
No. 19/2017
s. 54.

- (8) A prosecution for an offence under subsection (2) must not be commenced without the consent of the Director of Public Prosecutions.

S. 327(9)
inserted by
No. 19/2017
s. 54.

- (9) In determining whether to consent to a prosecution for an offence under subsection (2), the Director of Public Prosecutions must consider whether the alleged offender has been subjected to family violence (within the meaning of the **Family Violence Protection Act 2008**) that is relevant to the circumstances in which the offence is alleged to have been committed.

New s. 328
inserted by
No. 36/2014
s. 4.

328 Protection of those who disclose under section 327

A disclosure made under section 327(2) in good faith—

- (a) does not for any purpose constitute unprofessional conduct or a breach of professional ethics on the part of the person by whom it is made; and

- (b) does not make the person by whom it is made subject to any liability in respect of it; and
- (c) without limiting paragraphs (a) and (b), does not constitute a contravention of—
 - (i) section 141 of the **Health Services Act 1988**; or
 - (ii) section 730 of the **Mental Health and Wellbeing Act 2022**.

S. 328(c)(ii)
substituted by
No. 36/2014
s. 8,
amended by
No. 39/2022
s. 812.

329 Evidence and legal proceedings

New s. 329
inserted by
No. 36/2014
s. 4.

- (1) In any legal proceeding evidence may be given as to the information contained in a disclosure under section 327(2).
- (2) However in a legal proceeding evidence that a particular matter is contained in information disclosed under section 327(2) or evidence that identifies the person who made that disclosure, or is likely to lead to the identification of that person is only admissible in the proceeding if—
 - (a) the court or tribunal grants leave for the evidence to be given; or
 - (b) the person who made the disclosure consents in writing to the admission of that evidence.
- (3) A witness appearing in a legal proceeding must not be asked and, if asked, is entitled to refuse to answer—
 - (a) any question to which the answer would or might identify the person who made a disclosure under section 327(2) or would or might lead to the identification of that person; or

- (b) any question as to whether a particular matter is contained in information disclosed under section 327(2)—

unless the court or tribunal grants leave for the question to be asked or the person who made the disclosure has consented in writing to the question being asked.

- (4) A court or tribunal may only grant leave under subsection (2) or (3) if it is satisfied that the interests of justice require that the evidence be given.

New s. 330
inserted by
No. 36/2014
s. 4.

330 Confidentiality

S. 330(1)
amended by
No. 36/2014
s. 7(2).

- (1) If a disclosure is made under section 327(2), a person (other than the person who made it or a person acting with the written consent of the person who made it) must not disclose to any person other than a police officer or the Secretary (within the meaning of the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005**) or any other person to the extent reasonably required for law enforcement purposes—

- (a) the name of the person who made the disclosure; or
(b) any information that is likely to lead to the identification of the person who made the disclosure.

Penalty: Level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum).

S. 330(1A)
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 20.

- (1A) An offence against subsection (1) is a summary offence.

- (2) Subsection (1) does not apply to a disclosure made to a court or tribunal in accordance with section 329.
- (3) Part 4.4 of Chapter 4 of the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005** applies to information disclosed under subsection (1) to the Secretary (within the meaning of that Act) as if it were a report under Division 2 of that Part.

*	*	*	*	*	Ss 327–332 repealed. ²¹
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 2 Div. 1 Subdivs (4)(5) (Headings and ss 333, 334) repealed by No. 9576 s. 4(1).
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 2 Div. 2 (Heading) repealed by No. 74/2000 s. 3(Sch. 1 item 30.3).
*	*	*	*	*	S. 335 repealed by No. 56/1989 s. 286(Sch. 2 item 7.1).

Pt 2 Div. 3
(Heading and
ss 336–350)
amended by
Nos 7705
s. 10, 7876
s. 2(3),
repealed by
No. 8338 s. 5,
new Pt 2
Div. 3
(Heading and
ss 336–339)
inserted by
No. 9073
s. 2(b).

Division 3—Criminal liability of married persons

New s. 336
inserted by
No. 9073
s. 2(b).

336 Marital coercion

S. 336(2)
amended by
No. 77/2005
s. 9.

- (1) Any presumption that an offence committed by a wife in the presence of her husband is committed under his coercion is hereby abolished.
- (2) Where a woman is charged with an offence other than treason or murder, that woman shall have a complete defence to such charge if her action or inaction (as the case may be) was due to coercion by a man to whom she was then married.
- (3) For the purposes of this section *coercion* means pressure, whether in the form of threats or in any other form, sufficient to cause a woman of ordinary good character and normal firmness of mind, placed in the circumstances in which the woman was placed, to conduct herself in the manner charged.
- (4) Without limiting the generality of the expression "the circumstances in which the woman was placed" in subsection (3), such circumstances shall include the degree of dependence, whether economic or otherwise, of the woman on her husband.

- (5) The accused shall bear the burden of adducing evidence that she conducted herself in the manner charged because she was coerced by her husband, but if such evidence has been adduced, the prosecution shall bear the burden of proving that the action or inaction charged was not due to coercion by the husband.
- (6) This section shall operate in substitution for the common law as to any presumption or defence of marital coercion.
- (7) This section shall not affect the law relating to the defence of duress.

337 Misprision

A married person shall not become guilty of misprision by concealing or failing to disclose the commission of an indictable offence by his or her spouse, or by the spouse and another party or parties, nor by concealing or failing to disclose facts which might lead to the apprehension of the spouse, or the spouse and such other or others, in respect of the offence.

New s. 337
inserted by
No. 9073
s. 2(b).

338 Accessory after the fact

A married person shall not become an accessory to any indictable offence by receiving, relieving, comforting or assisting his or her spouse, or the spouse and another person or persons, though with knowledge that the spouse, whether alone or with the other person or persons, has committed an offence and though the purpose of what is done is to enable the spouse, or the spouse and the other person or persons, to escape being apprehended, tried or punished.

New s. 338
inserted by
No. 9073
s. 2(b),
amended by
Nos 9228
s. 2(1)(i), 9576
s. 11(1),
19/1987 s. 28.

New s. 339
inserted by
No. 9073
s. 2(b).

339 Conspiracy and incitement

- (1) A married person shall be criminally responsible for incitement or conspiracy to commit treason or murder and for any offence specified in section 4 as if he or she were unmarried.
- (2) Subject to subsection (1), a married person shall not be criminally responsible for conspiracy with his or her spouse alone, nor for incitement of his or her spouse to commit a criminal offence.
- (3) Nothing in subsection (2) shall affect the liability of a married person as a principal offender in any offence except conspiracy or incitement.

S. 339(3)
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1).

Ss 340–350
repealed by
No. 8338 s. 5.

* * * * *

Part IIA—Extra-territorial offences

Pt 2A
(Heading and
ss 340–345)
inserted by
No. 70/1987
s. 4.

340 Definitions

New s. 340
inserted by
No. 70/1987
s. 4.

(1) In this Part—

appropriate authority means—

S. 340(1)
def. of
*appropriate
authority*
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.10(a)).

- (a) in relation to another State of the Commonwealth, or a Territory of the Commonwealth (other than the Australian Capital Territory)—an authority exercising in relation to the police force or police service of that State or Territory functions corresponding to those of the Chief Commissioner appointed under the **Victoria Police Act 2013** in relation to Victoria Police;
- (b) in relation to the Australian Capital Territory—the Commissioner of the Australian Federal Police;

corresponding law means a law of another State, or of a Territory, of the Commonwealth declared by Proclamation to be a corresponding law;

night means the interval between 9 o'clock in the evening and 6 o'clock in the morning;

obstruct includes assault, threaten, abuse, insult, intimidate, hinder and attempt to obstruct;

offence to which this Part applies means an indictable offence against the law of a reciprocating State (being an offence arising from an act, omission or state of affairs which, if done or occurring in Victoria, would attract criminal liability under the law of Victoria);

owner, of an object, includes a person entitled to possession of the object;

S. 340(1)
def. of
police force
repealed by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.10(b)).

* * * * *

premises means a building, structure or any place whatsoever (whether built upon or not and whether enclosed or unenclosed) and includes an aircraft, vessel or vehicle;

reciprocating State means another State, or a Territory, of the Commonwealth—

- (a) in which a corresponding law is in force; and
- (b) in relation to which arrangements are in force under section 344;

search warrant means a warrant under this Part authorising a search of premises.

(2) For the purposes of this Part—

- (a) anything obtained by the commission of an offence, used for the purpose of committing an offence, or in respect of which an offence has been committed; or
- (b) anything that may afford evidence of the commission of an offence; or

(c) anything intended to be used for the purpose of committing an offence—

is an object relevant to the investigation of the offence.

- (3) The Governor in Council may, by proclamation published in the Government Gazette, declare a law of another State, or of a Territory, of the Commonwealth to be a corresponding law.

341 Issue of search warrant

New s. 341
inserted by
No. 70/1987
s. 4.

- (1) If, upon the application of a police officer, a magistrate is satisfied that there are reasonable grounds to believe—
- (a) that an offence to which this Part applies has been, or is intended to be, committed; and
- (b) that there is at any premises an object relevant to the investigation of that offence—

S. 341(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.11).

the magistrate may issue a search warrant in respect of those premises.

- (2) The grounds of an application for a search warrant must be verified by affidavit.
- (3) A magistrate by whom a search warrant is issued must file the warrant, or a copy of the warrant, and the affidavit verifying the grounds on which the application for the warrant was made, with the principal registrar of the Court.

S. 341(3)
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.19).

342 Authority conferred by and other incidents of a search warrant

New s. 342
inserted by
No. 70/1987
s. 4.

S. 342(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.11).

(1) A search warrant authorises any police officer, with such assistants as he or she thinks necessary, to enter and search the premises to which the warrant relates, and anything in those premises.

(2) Subject to any direction by a magistrate authorising execution of a search warrant at night, or during specified hours of the night, it must not be executed at night.

S. 342(3)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.11).

(3) A police officer, or a person assisting him or her, may use such force as is reasonably necessary for the execution of a search warrant.

S. 342(4)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.11).

(4) A police officer executing a search warrant may seize and remove any object that he or she believes on reasonable grounds to be relevant to the investigation of the offence in relation to which the warrant was issued.

(5) An object seized and removed under subsection (4) must be dealt with in accordance with arrangements in force under section 344.

S. 342(6)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.11).

(6) A police officer who executes a search warrant—
(a) must prepare a notice in the prescribed form containing—
(i) his or her own name and rank;
(ii) the name of the magistrate who issued the warrant and the date and time of its issue; and
(iii) a description of any objects seized and removed in pursuance of the warrant;
and

- (b) as soon as practicable, after the execution of the warrant, must give the notice to the occupier (if any) of the premises in respect of which the warrant was issued or leave it for him or her in a prominent position on those premises.
- (7) A search warrant, if not executed at the expiration of one month from the date of its issue, then expires.

343 Obstruction

New s. 343
inserted by
No. 70/1987
s. 4,
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 67),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 98).

- (1) A person must not, without lawful excuse, obstruct a police officer, or a person assisting a police officer, in the execution of a search warrant.

S. 343(1)
amended by
Nos 69/1997
s. 22(10),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.11).

Penalty: Level 9 fine (60 penalty units maximum).

- (2) An offence under subsection (1) is a summary offence.

S. 343(2)
inserted by
No. 48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 99).

344 Ministerial arrangements for transmission and return of seized objects

New s. 344
inserted by
No. 70/1987
s. 4.

- (1) The Minister may enter into arrangements with a Minister to whom the administration of a corresponding law is committed under which—
 - (a) objects seized under this Part that may be relevant to the investigation of an offence against the law of the State, or Territory in which the corresponding law is in force—

- (i) are to be transmitted to the appropriate authority in that State or Territory for the purposes of investigation of, or proceedings in respect of, that offence; and
 - (ii) when no longer required for the purpose of any such investigation or proceedings, are (unless disposed of by order or direction of a court) to be returned to the Chief Commissioner of Police for Victoria; and
- (b) objects seized under the corresponding law that may be relevant to the investigation of an offence against the law of Victoria—
 - (i) are to be transmitted to the Chief Commissioner of Police of Victoria; and
 - (ii) when no longer required for the purposes of investigation of an offence, or proceedings in respect of an offence, are (unless disposed of by order or direction of a court) to be returned to the appropriate authority in the State or Territory in which they were seized.
- (2) The owner of an object returned to the Chief Commissioner of Police in pursuance of arrangements under subsection (1) is entitled to the return of the objects.
- (3) The right referred to in subsection (2) is enforceable by action in detinue in a court of competent jurisdiction.

New s. 345
inserted by
No. 70/1987
s. 4,
amended by
No. 10/1999
s. 31(5)(a).

345 Regulations

The Governor in Council may make regulations for or with respect to any matter or thing required or permitted by this Part to be prescribed to give effect to this Part.

Part III—Procedure and punishment

Division 1—Pleading procedure, proof &c.

*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (1) (Heading and ss 351–356) repealed. ²²
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (2) (Heading) repealed by No. 25/1989 s. 20(h)(i).
*	*	*	*	*	S. 357 amended by Nos 8338 s. 7(c), 9554 s. 2(2)(Sch. 2 item 59), 9576 s. 11(1), 9848 s. 18(1), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).
*	*	*	*	*	New Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (2) (Heading and s. 357) inserted by No. 49/1991 s. 119(7) (Sch. 4 item 4.1), repealed by 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

Crimes Act 1958
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Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (3) (Heading) repealed by No. 7703 s. 5, new Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (3) (Heading) inserted by No. 8280 s. 13, amended by No. 9019 s. 2(1) (Sch. item 40), repealed by No. 9902 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 52).	*	*	*	*	*
S. 358 repealed by No. 7703 s. 5, new s. 358 inserted by No. 8280 s. 13, repealed by No. 9008 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 2(b)).	*	*	*	*	*
Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (4) (Heading) repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).	*	*	*	*	*
S. 359 repealed ²³	*	*	*	*	*

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*	*	*	*	*	S. 359AA inserted by No. 10026 s. 4, amended by Nos 110/1986 s. 140(2), 25/1989 s. 19(b), 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. items 42.24, 42.25), 92/2000 s. 11, 50/2006 s. 12, repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(3) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h))
*	*	*	*	*	S. 359A inserted by No. 8950 s. 4, substituted by No. 9509 s. 7(1), amended by Nos 110/1986 s. 140(2), 25/1989 s. 7, 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. item 42.26), 8/1991 s. 4, 81/1991 s. 10(Sch. item 1.1), 35/1999 s. 34(2), 67/2000 s. 7(3), 50/2006 s. 7(3)(4), 18/2008 s. 3, repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

Crimes Act 1958
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Part III—Procedure and punishment

S. 359B inserted by No. 50/2006 s. 8, repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).	*	*	*	*	*
Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (5) (Heading and s. 360) repealed. ²⁴	*	*	*	*	*
Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (6) (Heading and s. 361) repealed. ²⁵	*	*	*	*	*
Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (7) (Heading) repealed by No. 9902 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 53).	*	*	*	*	*
S. 362 amended by No. 8338 s. 7(a), repealed by No. 9008 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 2(e)).	*	*	*	*	*
Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (8) (Heading and s. 363) amended by Nos 8425 s. 2(1)(i), 9576 s. 11(1), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).	*	*	*	*	*

Crimes Act 1958
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*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (9) (Heading and ss 364–387) repealed. ²⁶
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (10) (Heading and s. 388) amended by No. 35/1996 s. 453(Sch. 1 item 16.3), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (11) (Heading and s. 389) amended by Nos 7705 s. 10, 9576 s. 11(1), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (12) (Heading and ss 390–396) repealed. ^{27 28}

Crimes Act 1958
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Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (13)
(Heading and
s. 397)
amended by
Nos 35/1996
s. 453(Sch. 1
item 16.6),
18/2005
s. 18(Sch. 1
item 27.6),
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(a) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

* * * *

*(14) Evidence. Depositions. Subpoenas and
warrants against witnesses*

S. 398
amended by
Nos 8731
s. 173, 25/1989
s. 19(e),
57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.32),
12/1993
s. 4(a),
35/1996
s. 453(Sch. 1
item 16.7),
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(b) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

* * * *

S. 398A
inserted by
No. 37/1986
s. 5(a),
repealed by
No. 12/1993
s. 4(b),
new s. 398A
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 14,
repealed by
No. 69/2009
s. 42.

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Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part III—Procedure and punishment

*	*	*	*	*	S. 399 amended by Nos 7546 s. 8, 8870 s. 5(2), 9008 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 2(f)), substituted by No. 9230 s. 2, amended by Nos 37/1986 s. 5(b), 25/1989 s. 19(f)(g), 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. items 42.33, 42.34), 12/1993 s. 4(c)–(e), 35/1996 s. 453(Sch. 1 item 16.8), 68/2009 s. 97(Sch. item 40.22), repealed by No. 69/2009 s. 43.
*	*	*	*	*	S. 399A inserted by No. 8870 s. 4(1), amended by Nos 9848 s. 18(1), 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. item 42.35), 35/1996 s. 453(Sch. 1 item 16.9), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(b) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

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S. 399B
inserted by
No. 8870
s. 4(1),
amended by
No. 35/1996
s. 453(Sch. 1
item 16.10),
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(b) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

* * * * *

S. 400
substituted by
No. 7546 s. 9,
amended by
Nos 7994 s. 3,
8338 s. 6, 8410
s. 2, 9019
s. 2(1)(Sch.
item 44),
substituted by
No. 9230 s. 3,
amended by
Nos 25/1989
s. 19(h),
57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
items 42.36,
42.37),
35/1996
s. 453(Sch. 1
item 16.11),
repealed by
No. 69/2009
s. 44.

* * * * *

S. 401
amended by
Nos 8338
s. 7(h)(k), 9576
s. 11(1),
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(b) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

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*	*	*	*	*	S. 402 amended by No. 9576 s. 11(1), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(b) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).
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*	*	*	*	*	S. 403 repealed by No. 6758 s. 3.
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404 Proof of marriage on trial for bigamy

No. 6103
s. 404.

On the hearing before a magistrate of or on the trial of any person on a charge of having (during the life of his or her wife or husband) gone through the form or ceremony of marriage with some other person, the production of a copy of the register or other official record of a marriage or of an extract from such register or other official record shall on proof of the identity of such first-mentioned person be prima facie evidence of his or her marriage or of his or her having gone through the ceremony of marriage—

S. 404
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.38).

- (a) if such copy or extract is proved to be an examined copy or extract of or from the register or other official record of marriages kept in any portion of His Majesty's dominions; or

S. 404(a)
amended by
No. 25/2023
s. 7(Sch. 1
item 6.4).

- (b) if such copy or extract purports to be signed and certified as a true copy or extract by the officer to whose custody the original is intrusted, and if the facts that such officer is an officer intrusted with the custody of the original register or official record and that the signature thereto is the signature of such officer and that such register or other official record is an official record within the

S. 404(b)
amended by
No. 25/2023
s. 7(Sch. 1
item 6.4).

meaning of this Act purports to be certified to by a judge of a superior court or Governor or Administrator of the Government of that portion of His Majesty's dominions in which such register or official record is kept.

No. 6103
s. 405.
S. 405(1)
amended by
No. 25/2023
s. 7(Sch. 1
item 6.5).

405 Meaning of term *official record*

- (1) For the purposes of the last preceding section, an official record of a marriage shall be such record of marriages as is required by law to be kept, or as is made by law evidence of marriages celebrated in that portion of His Majesty's dominions in which the same is kept.
- (2) Nothing in this or the last preceding section shall apply to the proof of a marriage celebrated or of a ceremony of marriage performed in Victoria.

Ss 406–408A
repealed.²⁹

* * * *

S. 409
amended by
Nos 8425
s. 2(1)(l), 9576
s. 11(1),
25/1989 s. 10,
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(b) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

* * * *

S. 410
repealed by
No. 51/1989
s. 143(b).

* * * *

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part III—Procedure and punishment

*	*	*	*	*	S. 411 amended by Nos 7705 s. 10, 7876 s. 2(3), 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. item 42.39), repealed by No. 69/2009 s. 46.
*	*	*	*	*	S. 412 repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(b) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).
*	*	*	*	*	S. 413 amended by Nos 8275 s. 12, 9059 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 10), 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. item 42.40), 10/1999 s. 8(5), 68/2009 s. 97(Sch. item 40.23), repealed by No. 69/2009 s. 47.
*	*	*	*	*	No. 6103 s. 414. S. 414 amended by No. 7703 s. 5, repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(b) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part III—Procedure and punishment

S. 415
amended by
Nos 7705
s. 10, 8410
s. 3, 9554
s. 2(2)(Sch. 2
item 60),
110/1986
s. 140(2),
19/1989
s. 16(Sch.
items 16.6,
16.7), 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
items 42.41,
42.42),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 68),
69/1997
s. 22(11),
repealed by
No. 69/2009
s. 48.

* * * *

Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (15)
(Heading and
s. 416)
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(a) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

* * * *

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part III—Procedure and punishment

*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (16) (Heading and s. 417) amended by Nos 7705 s. 10, 8870 s. 5(1), 37/1986 s. 5(c), 12/1993 s. 4(f)(g), 35/1996 s. 453(Sch. 1 item 16.12), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (17) (Heading and s. 418) amended by Nos 8870 s. 5(1), 10084 s. 7, 37/1986 s. 5(d), 12/1993 s. 4(h), 35/1996 s. 453(Sch. 1 item 16.13), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (18) (Heading) repealed by No. 43/2012 s. 3(Sch. item 11.1)).
*	*	*	*	*	S. 419 repealed by No. 69/2009 s. 49.

(19) *Verdicts. Attempts, &c.*

Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (19)
(Heading)
amended by
No. 65/1997
s. 82(2)(b).

S. 420
amended by
Nos 6884
s. 2(2),
102/1986
s. 8(c)(d),
repealed by
No. 65/1997
s. 82(2)(c).³⁰

* * * * *

cf. [1792] 32
George III
c. LX s. 1.

**420A Where person charged with unlawful publication of
defamatory matter**

S. 420A
inserted by
No. 9407
s. 2(e).

On the trial of a person charged with the unlawful
publication of defamatory matter—

- (a) the jury may give a general verdict of guilty
or not guilty upon the whole matter in issue,
in like manner as in other cases; and
- (b) the question whether any matter alleged to be
defamatory is or is not capable of a
defamatory meaning is a question of law.

S. 421
substituted by
No. 9576 s. 6.

421 Alternative verdicts on charge of murder

S. 421(1)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.24).

- (1) On an indictment for murder a person found not
guilty of murder may be found guilty of—

S. 421(1)(ab)
inserted by
No. 7/2008
s. 7(3)(c).

- (a) manslaughter;
- (ab) child homicide;

S. 421(1)(ac)
inserted by
No. 16/2020
s. 7.

- (ac) homicide by firearm;

- (b) any offence of which he may be found guilty under an enactment specifically so providing;
 - (c) an offence against section 325; or
 - (d) an attempt to commit murder or an attempt to commit any offence of which he may by virtue of this subsection be found guilty—
- but may not be found guilty of any other offence.

* * * * *

S. 421(2)(3)
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(c) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

* * * * *

S. 421(4)
amended by
Nos 110/1986
s. 140(2),
19/1989
s. 16(Sch.
item 16.8),
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(c) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

422 Alternative verdict on charge of causing serious injury in circumstances of gross violence

- (1) If on the trial of a person charged with an offence against section 15A the jury are not satisfied that the person is guilty of the offence charged but are satisfied that he or she is guilty of an offence against section 16, the jury may acquit the accused of the offence charged and find the person guilty of an offence against section 16 and the person charged is liable to punishment accordingly.

S. 422
substituted by
No. 9576 s. 6,
repealed by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.25),
new s. 422
inserted by
No. 6/2013
s. 5.

- (2) If on the trial of a person charged with an offence against section 15B the jury are not satisfied that the person is guilty of the offence charged but are satisfied that he or she is guilty of an offence against section 17, the jury may acquit the accused of the offence charged and find the person guilty of an offence against section 17 and the person charged is liable to punishment accordingly.

S. 422A
inserted by
No. 59/2004
s. 7.

422A Alternative verdict for certain charges relating to driving

S. 422A(1)
substituted by
No. 7/2008
s. 5(3).

- (1) If on the trial of a person charged with an offence against section 318 (culpable driving causing death) the jury are not satisfied that he or she is guilty of the offence charged but are satisfied that he or she is guilty of an offence against section 319(1) (dangerous driving causing death), the jury may acquit the accused of the offence charged and find him or her guilty of the offence against section 319(1) and he or she is liable to punishment accordingly.

S. 422A(1A)
inserted by
No. 7/2008
s. 5(3).

- (1A) If on the trial of a person charged with an offence against section 24 (negligently causing serious injury) the jury are not satisfied that he or she is guilty of the offence charged but are satisfied that he or she is guilty of an offence against section 319(1A) (dangerous driving causing serious injury), the jury may acquit the accused of the offence charged and find him or her guilty of the offence against section 319(1A) and he or she is liable to punishment accordingly.

S. 422A(2)
repealed by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.26).

* * * *

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
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*	*	*	*	*	No. 6103 s. 423. S. 423 amended by Nos 9576 s. 11(1), 77/2005 s. 8(3)(b), 7/2008 s. 7(3)(d), repealed by No. 68/2009 s. 97(Sch. item 40.27).
*	*	*	*	*	No. 6103 s. 424. S. 424 amended by No. 9576 s. 11(1), repealed by No. 68/2009 s. 97(Sch. item 40.28).

S. 425
substituted by
Nos 7577 s. 4,
9509 s. 8,
8/1991 s. 5,
amended by
Nos 65/1991
s. 4, 81/1991
s. 10(Sch.
items 1.2, 1.3),
67/2000
s. 7(4)–(6),
68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.29),
74/2014
s. 7(8),
47/2016 s. 21,
repealed by
No. 5/2018
s. 7,
new s. 425
inserted by
No. 1/2026
s. 68.

425 Alternative verdicts for certain sexual offences

- (1) On the trial of a person charged with an offence against a provision specified in column 2 of an item in the Table, if the jury are not satisfied that the person is guilty of the offence charged or of an attempt to commit the offence charged but are satisfied that the person is guilty of an offence against a provision specified in column 3 of that item (an *alternative offence*), the jury may acquit the person of the offence charged and find the person guilty of the alternative offence and the person is liable to punishment accordingly.

Table

<i>Column 1</i>	<i>Column 2</i>	<i>Column 3</i>
<i>Item No.</i>	<i>Offence charged</i>	<i>Alternative offence</i>
1	Section 38(1) (rape)	Section 40(1) (sexual assault) Section 42(1) (assault with intent to commit a sexual offence)
2	Section 39(1) (rape by compelling sexual penetration)	Section 41(1) (sexual assault by compelling sexual touching) Section 42(1) (assault with intent to commit a sexual offence)

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<i>Column 1</i>	<i>Column 2</i>	<i>Column 3</i>
<i>Item No.</i>	<i>Offence charged</i>	<i>Alternative offence</i>
3	Section 49A(1) (sexual penetration of a child under the age of 12)	Section 42(1) (assault with intent to commit a sexual offence) Section 49B(1) (sexual penetration of a child under the age of 16) Section 49D(1) (sexual assault of a child under the age of 16)
4	Section 49B(1) (sexual penetration of a child under the age of 16)	Section 42(1) (assault with intent to commit a sexual offence) Section 49D(1) (sexual assault of a child under the age of 16)
5	Section 50C(1) (sexual penetration of a child or lineal descendant)	Section 42(1) (assault with intent to commit a sexual offence) Section 49D(1) (sexual assault of a child under the age of 16) Section 49E(1) (sexual assault of a child aged 16 or 17 under care, supervision or authority)

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<i>Column 1</i>	<i>Column 2</i>	<i>Column 3</i>
<i>Item No.</i>	<i>Offence charged</i>	<i>Alternative offence</i>
6	Section 50D(1) (sexual penetration of a step-child)	Section 42(1) (assault with intent to commit a sexual offence) Section 49D(1) (sexual assault of a child under the age of 16) Section 49E(1) (sexual assault of a child aged 16 or 17 under care, supervision or authority)

- (2) On the trial of a person charged with an offence against section 49C(1) (sexual penetration of a child aged 16 or 17 under care, supervision or authority), if the jury are not satisfied that the person is guilty of the offence charged or of an attempt to commit the offence charged but are satisfied that the person is guilty of—
- (a) an offence against section 31(1) (assault) constituted by assault with intent to commit the offence charged; or
 - (b) an offence against section 49E(1) (sexual assault of a child aged 16 or 17 under care, supervision or authority)—

the jury may acquit the person of the offence charged and find the person guilty of that other offence and the person is liable to punishment accordingly.

426 Alternative verdict for identity crime offences

If, on the trial of a person charged with an offence against section 192B, the jury are not satisfied that the person charged is guilty of the offence charged but are satisfied that the person charged is guilty of an offence against section 192C, the jury may acquit the person charged of the offence charged and find the person charged guilty of an offence against section 192C and the person charged is liable to punishment accordingly.

S. 426
repealed by
No. 9576
s. 11(1)(Sch.),
new s. 426
inserted by
No. 22/2009
s. 4.

427 Alternative verdict for destroying property charges

- (1) Where a person is charged with committing an offence against section 197(2) or section 197(3) and the jury are not satisfied that he is guilty of that offence but are satisfied that he is guilty of an offence against section 197(1), the jury may return as their verdict that he is not guilty of the offence charged but is guilty of the offence against section 197(1).
- (2) If on the trial of a person charged with an offence against section 197A the jury are not satisfied that he or she is guilty of the offence charged but are satisfied that he or she is guilty of an offence against section 197, the jury may acquit the accused of the offence charged and find him or her guilty of whichever of the offences against section 197 they are satisfied that he or she is guilty of and he or she is liable to punishment accordingly.

S. 427
repealed by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(h),
new s. 427
inserted by
No. 9228
s. 2(1)(j),
amended by
No. 48/1997
s. 58(1).

S. 427(2)
inserted by
No. 48/1997
s. 58(2).

S. 428
amended by
Nos 8425
s. 2(1)(m),
9019
s. 2(1)(Sch.
item 45),
repealed by
No. 9576
s. 11(1),
new s. 428
inserted by
10/2003 s. 7.

**428 Alternative verdict for charges of unauthorised
modification of data to cause impairment**

If on the trial of a person charged with an offence against section 247C the jury are not satisfied that he or she is guilty of the offence charged but are satisfied that he or she is guilty of—

- (a) an offence under section 197(1); or
- (b) an offence under section 247D—

the jury may acquit the accused of the offence charged and find him or her guilty of whichever of those offences they are satisfied that he or she is guilty and he or she is liable to punishment accordingly.

New s. 429
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 7.

**429 Alternative verdict for charges of unauthorised
impairment of electronic communication**

If on the trial of a person charged with an offence against section 247D the jury are not satisfied that he or she is guilty of the offence charged but are satisfied that he or she is guilty of—

- (a) an offence under section 197(1); or
- (b) an offence under section 247C—

the jury may acquit the accused of the offence charged and find him or her guilty of whichever of those offences they are satisfied that he or she is guilty and he or she is liable to punishment accordingly.

Ss 429–434
repealed by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(h).

* * * * *

435 Alternative verdict for charges relating to riots

Where on the trial of a person for any offence against section 206(1) the jury are not satisfied that he is guilty of the offence charged but are satisfied that he is guilty of an offence against section 206(2), the jury may return as their verdict that he is not guilty of the offence charged but is guilty of the offence against section 206(2); and he shall be liable to punishment accordingly.

* * * * *

S. 435
substituted by
No. 9576
s. 11(1).

Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (19A)
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 8870
s. 6(1),
repealed by
No. 25/1989
s. 20(h)(ii).

* * * * *

S. 435A
inserted by
No. 8870
s. 6(1),
amended by
No. 9848
s. 18(1),
repealed by
No. 10260
s. 114(Sch. 4
item 4).

* * * * *

Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (20)
(Heading and
s. 436)
amended by
No. 9902
s. 2(1)(Sch.
item 54)
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(a) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

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Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (21)
(Heading and
ss 437–439)
amended by
Nos 7184 s. 6,
7703 s. 5, 7705
s. 10, 7876
s. 2(3), 8338
s. 7(a)(d), 8731
s. 173, 9427
s. 6(1)(Sch. 5
item 39), 9576
s. 11(1), 10152
s. 9(a),
57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.44),
53/2000
s. 94(3),
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(a) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

* * * *

Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (22)
(Heading and
ss 440–443)
amended by
Nos 7577 s. 5,
8280 s. 15,
8425 s. 2(1)(h),
9554
s. 2(2)(Sch. 2
item 61), 9848
s. 18(1),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 69),
69/1997
s. 22(12),
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(a) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

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Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part III—Procedure and punishment

*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (23) (Heading and s. 444) repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (24) (Heading and s. 445) amended by Nos 7705 s. 10, 7876 s. 2(3), 9008 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 2(g)), 110/1986 s. 140(2), 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. item 42.45) repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (25) (Heading and ss 446–450) repealed.³¹

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No. 6231 of 1958
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Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (26)
(Heading and
ss 451–453)
amended by
Nos 110/1986
s. 140(2),
35/1996
s. 453(Sch. 1
items 16.15,
16.16),
78/2008
s. 25(3),
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(a) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

* * * *

Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (27)
(Heading and
s. 454)
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.46),
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(a) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

* * * *

Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (28)
(Heading and
s. 455)
amended by
No. 7705 s. 10,
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(a) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

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Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (29)
(Heading and
s. 456)
amended by
No. 19/1989
s. 16(Sch.
items 16.9,
16.10),
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(2)(a) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

(29A) *Giving name and address on demand*

Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (29A)
(Heading and
s. 456AA)
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 4 (as
amended by
No. 33/1994
s. 27(5)).

456AA Requirement to give name and address

S. 456AA
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 4 (as
amended by
No. 33/1994
s. 27(5)).

- (1) A police officer or a protective services officer on duty at a designated place may request a person to state his or her name and address if the police officer or the protective services officer believes on reasonable grounds that the person—
- (a) has committed or is about to commit an offence, whether indictable or summary; or
 - (b) may be able to assist in the investigation of an indictable offence which has been committed or is suspected of having been committed.

S. 456AA(1)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.12(a)),
45/2017
s. 15(1).

S. 456AA(2)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.12(b)),
45/2017
s. 15(2).

- (2) A police officer or a protective services officer who makes a request under subsection (1) must inform the person of the grounds for his or her belief in sufficient detail to allow the person to understand the nature of the offence or suspected offence.

S. 456AA(3)
amended by
Nos 69/1997
s. 22(13),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.12(b)),
45/2017
s. 15(3).

- (3) A person who, in response to a request made by a police officer or a protective services officer in accordance with this section—
- (a) refuses or fails to comply with the request; or
 - (b) states a name that is false in a material particular; or
 - (c) states an address other than the full and correct address of his or her ordinary place of residence or business—

is guilty of a summary offence punishable on conviction by a level 11 fine (5 penalty units maximum).

S. 456AA(4)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.12(c)),
45/2017
s. 15(4).

- (4) A person who is requested by a police officer or a protective services officer under subsection (1) to state his or her name and address may request the officer to state, orally or in writing, his or her name, rank and place of duty.

S. 456AA(5)
amended by
Nos 69/1997
s. 22(13),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.12(d)(i)),
45/2017
s. 15(5).

- (5) A police officer or a protective services officer who, in response to a request under subsection (4)—
- (a) refuses or fails to comply with the request; or
 - (b) states a name or rank that is false in a material particular; or

S. 456AA(5)(c)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.12(d)(iii)),
45/2017
s. 15(6).

- (c) states as his or her place of duty an address other than the name of the police station which is the police officer's or the protective services officer's ordinary place of duty; or

(d) refuses to comply with the request in writing
if requested to do so—

is guilty of a summary offence punishable on
conviction by a level 11 fine (5 penalty units
maximum).

(6) A protective services officer may only exercise
the power under this section in relation to a person
who is at, or in the vicinity of, a designated place.

S. 456AA(6)
inserted by
No. 45/2017
s. 15(7).

(7) In this section—

S. 456AA(7)
inserted by
No. 45/2017
s. 15(7).

designated place has the same meaning as in the
Victoria Police Act 2013.

* * * * *

Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (29B)
(Heading and
ss 456A–
456F)
inserted by
No. 120/1993
s. 79,
repealed by
No. 30/1997
s. 6.

(30) *Apprehension of offenders*

457 No person to be arrested without warrant except under this Act etc.

S. 457
substituted by
No. 8247 s. 2.

After the commencement of the **Crimes (Powers
of Arrest) Act 1972** no person shall be arrested
without warrant except pursuant to the provisions
of—

- (a) this Act; or
- (b) some other Act expressly giving power to
arrest without warrant.

S. 458
substituted by
No. 8247 s. 2,
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.47).

458 Person found committing offences may be arrested without warrant by any person

S. 458(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.13).

(1) Any person, whether a police officer or not, may at any time without warrant apprehend and take before a bail justice or the Magistrates' Court to be dealt with according to law or deliver to a police officer to be so taken, any person—

(a) he finds committing any offence (whether an indictable offence or an offence punishable on summary conviction) where he believes on reasonable grounds that the apprehension of the person is necessary for any one or more of the following reasons, namely—

S. 458(1)(a)(i)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.30).

(i) to ensure the attendance of the offender before a court of competent jurisdiction;

(ii) to preserve public order;

(iii) to prevent the continuation or repetition of the offence or the commission of a further offence; or

(iv) for the safety or welfare of members of the public or of the offender;

S. 458(1)(b)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.13).

(b) when instructed so to do by any police officer having power under this Act to apprehend that person; or

- (c) he believes on reasonable grounds is escaping from legal custody or aiding or abetting another person to escape from legal custody or avoiding apprehension by some person having authority to apprehend that person in the circumstances of the case. **S. 458(1)(c) amended by No. 117/1986 s. 6(Sch. 1 item 1(8)(a)).**
- (2) For the purposes of paragraph (a) in subsection (1) *offence* means offence at common law or a contravention of or failure to comply with a provision of an Act of Parliament and unless otherwise by Act of Parliament expressly provided does not include a contravention of or failure to comply with a rule regulation by-law or other law made under an Act of Parliament.
- (3) A person who has been apprehended without warrant pursuant to the provisions of paragraph (a) in subsection (1) in respect of any offence punishable on summary conviction (not being an indictable offence that may be heard and determined summarily) and taken into custody shall be held in the custody of the person apprehending him only so long as any reason referred to in the said paragraph for his apprehension continues and where, before that person is charged with an offence, it appears to the person arresting that person that the reason no longer continues the person arresting that other person shall, without any further or other authority than this subsection, release that person from custody without bail or cause him to be so released and whether or not a summons has been issued against him or a notice to appear has been served on him with respect to the offence alleged. **S. 458(3) amended by Nos 9008 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 2(k)), 68/2009 s. 97(Sch. item 40.31).**
- (4) In subsection (3), *notice to appear* has the same meaning as in the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009**. **S. 458(4) inserted by No. 68/2009 s. 97(Sch. item 40.32).**

459 Powers of police officer or protective services officer to apprehend offenders

S. 459
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 43/2011
s. 17(1),
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.14).
S. 459
substituted by
No. 8247 s. 2,
amended by
No. 43/2011
s. 17(2)(3)
(ILA s. 39B(1)).

S. 459(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.15(a)).

S. 459(a)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.33).

S. 459(b)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.33).

Note to
s. 459(1)
inserted by
No. 1/2016
s. 22(1).

S. 459(2)
inserted by
No. 43/2011
s. 17(3),
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.15(a)).

- (1) In addition to exercising any of the powers conferred by section 458 or by or under any other Act a police officer, or a protective services officer on duty at a designated place, may at any time without warrant apprehend any person—
- (a) he believes on reasonable grounds has committed an indictable offence in Victoria (including any indictable offence which may be heard and determined summarily); or
 - (b) he believes on reasonable grounds has committed an offence elsewhere which if committed in Victoria would be an indictable offence against the law of Victoria (including any indictable offence which may be heard and determined summarily).

Note

There is a presumption in favour of proceeding by summons if an accused is a child—see section 345 of the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005**.

- (2) If a protective services officer arrests a person under subsection (1), the protective services officer must hand the person into the custody of a police officer as soon as practicable after the person is arrested.

- (2A) A protective services officer may only exercise the power to apprehend without warrant under this section in relation to a person who is at, or in the vicinity of, a designated place. **S. 459(2A) inserted by No. 45/2017 s. 52.**
- (3) In this section, *designated place* has the same meaning as it has in the **Victoria Police Act 2013**. **S. 459(3) inserted by No. 43/2011 s. 17(3), amended by No. 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.15(b)).**

459A Entry and search of premises

S. 459A inserted by No. 9576 s. 7(a).

- (1) A police officer may, for the purpose of arresting under section 458 or 459 or any other enactment a person whom he—
- (a) believes on reasonable grounds—
- (i) to have committed in Victoria a serious indictable offence;
 - (ii) to have committed an offence elsewhere which if committed in Victoria would be a serious indictable offence; or
 - (iii) to be escaping from legal custody; or
- (b) finds committing a serious indictable offence—
- enter and search any place where the police officer on reasonable grounds believes him to be.
- (2) In order to enter a place pursuant to subsection (1), a police officer may, if it is necessary to do so, use reasonable force. **S. 459A(2) amended by No. 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.16).**

- (3) In this section *serious indictable offence* has the same meaning as it has in section 325.

S. 460
substituted by
No. 8247 s. 2,
amended by
Nos 8410 s. 4,
9008
s. 2(1)(Sch.
item 2(I)),
substituted by
No. 10076
s. 4(1),
amended by
No. 16/1986
s. 30,
repealed by
No. 37/1988
s. 4.

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S. 461
amended by
No. 7546 s. 11,
substituted by
No. 8247 s. 2.

461 Arrest on reasonable grounds not to be taken to be unlawful

- (1) Where an apprehension is made under a belief on reasonable grounds in accordance with the provisions of section 458 or section 459 the apprehension shall not cease to be lawful or be taken to be unlawful where it subsequently appears or is found that the person apprehended did not commit the offence alleged.
- (2) A police officer shall not be bound to take into custody or to take before a bail justice or the Magistrates' Court any person found committing an offence if the police officer believes on reasonable grounds that proceedings can effectively be brought against that person by way of summons or notice to appear.

S. 461(2)
amended by
Nos 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.54),
68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.34),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.17).

S. 461(3)
inserted by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.35).

- (3) In subsection (2) *notice to appear* has the same meaning as in the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009**.

462 Definition of *finds committing*

S. 462
substituted by
No. 8247 s. 2.

In this Act the expression *finds committing* and any derivative thereof extends to the case of a person found doing any act or so behaving or conducting himself or in such circumstances that the person finding him believes on reasonable grounds that the person so found is guilty of an offence.

462A Use of force to prevent the commission of an indictable offence

S. 462A
inserted by
No. 9576
s. 7(b).

A person may use such force not disproportionate to the objective as he believes on reasonable grounds to be necessary to prevent the commission, continuance or completion of an indictable offence or to effect or assist in effecting the lawful arrest of a person committing or suspected of committing any offence.

Example

Example to
s. 462A
inserted by
No. 32/2018
s. 131.

A police officer or protective services officer uses lethal force on a person to prevent that person from committing an indictable offence that involves causing really serious injury or death because the officer believes on reasonable grounds that it is necessary to use that force for that purpose. The police officer or protective services officer may do so before that offence is committed.

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S. 463
repealed by
No. 8247 s. 2.

463A Arrest of offenders on board aircraft

S. 463A
inserted by
No. 7088
s. 2(e),
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.55).

- (1) The person in command of an aircraft may, on board the aircraft, with such assistance as is necessary, arrest without warrant a person whom he finds committing, or reasonably suspects of having committed, or of having attempted to commit, an offence on or in relation to or affecting the use of an aircraft and that person in command or a person authorized by him may hold the person so arrested in custody until he can be

brought before a bail justice or the Magistrates' Court or other proper authority to be dealt with in accordance with law.

- (2) The person in command of an aircraft may, where he considers it necessary so to do in order to prevent an offence on or in relation to or affecting the use of an aircraft or to avoid danger to the safety of the aircraft or of persons on board the aircraft, with such assistance as he thinks necessary—
- (a) place a person who is on board the aircraft under restraint or in custody; and
 - (b) if the aircraft is not in the course of a flight—remove a person from the aircraft.

S. 463B
inserted by
No. 7546 s. 3.

463B Prevention of suicide

Every person is justified in using such force as may reasonably be necessary to prevent the commission of suicide or of any act which he believes on reasonable grounds would, if committed, amount to suicide.

S. 464
repealed by
No. 8425
s. 2(1)(h).

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Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (30A)
(Heading and
ss 464–464J)
inserted by
No. 37/1988
s. 5.

(30A) *Custody and investigation*

New s. 464
inserted by
No. 37/1988
s. 5.

464 Definitions

- (1) For the purposes of this Subdivision a person is in custody if he or she is—
- (a) under lawful arrest by warrant; or
 - (b) under lawful arrest under section 458 or 459 or a provision of any other Act; or

(c) in the company of an investigating official and is—

- (i) being questioned; or
- (ii) to be questioned; or
- (iii) otherwise being investigated—

to determine his or her involvement (if any) in the commission of an offence if there is sufficient information in the possession of the investigating official to justify the arrest of that person in respect of that offence.

(2) In this Subdivision—

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S. 464(2)
def. of
*Aboriginal
person*
inserted by
No. 48/2018
s. 16,
repealed by
No. 26/2023
s. 76.

appropriate authority means—

- (a) in relation to the Commonwealth or the Australian Capital Territory—the Commissioner (within the meaning of section 23WA of the Crimes Act 1914 of the Commonwealth) of the Australian Federal Police or any other prescribed authority; or
- (b) in relation to any other participating jurisdiction—an authority exercising, in relation to the police force or police service of that jurisdiction, functions corresponding to those of the Chief Commissioner of Police or any other prescribed authority;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*appropriate
authority*
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5,
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.18(a)(i)).

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part III—Procedure and punishment

S. 464(2)
def. of
*approved
mental health
service*
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 16(a),
repealed by
No. 26/2014
s. 455(Sch.
item 7.2(a)).

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S. 464(2)
def. of
*Australian
Crime
Commission*
inserted by
No. 54/2016
s. 28(a).

Australian Crime Commission means
the Australian Crime Commission
(by whatever name described) established by
the Australian Crime Commission Act 2002
of the Commonwealth;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*authorised
person*
inserted by
No. 25/1989
s. 11(a),
repealed by
No. 23/1991
s. 8(1)(a),
new def. of
*authorised
person*
inserted by
No. 23/1991
s. 8(1)(b).

authorised person means a person appointed as an
authorised person under subsection (3);

S. 464(2)
def. of
*compulsory
procedure*
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 6(a).

compulsory procedure means the taking of an
intimate or non-intimate sample or the
conduct of a physical examination;

corresponding law means a law relating to the carrying out of forensic procedures and DNA databases that—

S. 464(2)
def. of
corresponding law
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5.

- (a) substantially corresponds to this Subdivision; or
- (b) is prescribed for the purposes of this definition;

crime scene index means an index of DNA profiles derived from forensic material found or other material found—

S. 464(2)
def. of
crime scene index
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5.

- (a) at any place (whether within or outside Victoria) where an offence (whether under the law of Victoria or of a participating jurisdiction) was, or is reasonably suspected of having been, committed; or
- (b) on the victim of the offence or on anything reasonably believed to have been worn or carried by the victim when the offence was committed; or
- (c) on an object or person reasonably believed to have been associated with the commission of the offence;

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S. 464(2)
def. of
CrimTrac
inserted by
No. 32/2007
s. 4(2),
repealed by
No. 54/2016
s. 28(b).

S. 464(2)
def. of
dentist
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 6(a),
substituted by
No. 26/1999
s. 107(Sch.
item 1),
amended by
No. 97/2005
s. 182(Sch. 4
item 14.2(a)),
substituted by
No. 13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.3(a)).

dentist means a person registered under the Health Practitioner Regulation National Law—

- (a) to practise in the dental profession as a dentist (other than as a student);
- (b) in the dentists division of that profession;

S. 464(2)
def. of
designated mental health service
inserted by
No. 26/2014
s. 455(Sch.
item 7.2(b)),
amended by
No. 39/2022
s. 813(a).

designated mental health service has the same meaning as in the **Mental Health and Wellbeing Act 2022**;

S. 464(2)
def. of
destruction
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 3(b).

destruction, in relation to any sample taken or given and any related material and information, means—

- (a) the physical destruction of the sample; and
- (b) the removal from any DNA database on which matching occurs of any DNA profile derived from analysis of the sample; and
- (c) the destruction of the DNA profile in any form that can readily be recombined with information that identifies the person from whom the sample was taken or who gave the sample, except for a DNA profile held

on an electronic system used for forensic analysis by the Victoria Police Forensic Services Department;

detained or protected person means a person who—

- (a) is held in a prison, police gaol, youth justice centre or youth residential centre; or
- (b) is a prisoner in a prison or a person detained in a police gaol who is transferred from the prison or police gaol to a facility or an institution referred to in section 56AB(1) of the **Corrections Act 1986**; or
- (ba) is a forensic patient or a forensic resident within the meaning of the **Crimes (Mental Impairment and Unfitness to be Tried) Act 1997**; or
- (c) is a security resident within the meaning of the **Disability Act 2006**; or
- (d) is an assessment patient, a court assessment patient, a temporary treatment patient, a treatment patient or a security patient within the meaning of the **Mental Health and Wellbeing Act 2022**;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*detained or
protected
person*
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 4(a),
amended by
Nos 93/1990
s. 27(a),
23/2006
s. 236(4),
48/2006
s. 42(Sch.
item 9.2(a)),
26/2014
s. 455(Sch.
item 7.2(c)),
3/2019
s. 52(2),
39/2022
s. 813(b).

DNA database means—

- (a) the Victorian DNA database; or
- (b) NCIDD; or
- (c) another DNA database system that is kept under a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*DNA
database*
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5,
substituted by
No. 32/2007
s. 4(1).

S. 464(2)
def. of
DNA
database
system
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5.

DNA database system means a database
(whether in computerised or other form
and however described) containing—

(a) one or more of the following indexes of
DNA profiles—

- (i) a crime scene index;
- (ii) a missing persons index;
- (iii) an unknown deceased persons
index;
- (iv) a serious offenders index;
- (v) a volunteers (unlimited purposes)
index;
- (vi) a volunteers (limited purposes)
index;
- (vii) a suspects index—

and information that may be used to
identify the person from whose forensic
material each DNA profile was derived;
and

- (b) a statistical index; and
- (c) any other prescribed index;

S. 464(2)
def. of
DNA person
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 52(1).

DNA person means—

(a) a person who is of or above the age of
18 years who—

- (i) is suspected of having committed
or attempted to commit an
indictable offence; or
- (ii) has been charged with an
indictable offence; or
- (iii) has been summonsed to answer to
a charge for an indictable offence;
or

- (b) a child of or above the age of 15 years but under the age of 18 years who—
 - (i) is suspected of having committed or attempted to commit a DNA sample offence; or
 - (ii) has been charged with a DNA sample offence; or
 - (iii) has been summonsed to answer to a charge for a DNA sample offence;

DNA profile sample means a sample taken for the purpose of deriving a DNA profile that is—

- (a) a blood sample;
- (b) a sample of hair, other than pubic hair, including the root if required;
- (c) a sample of saliva;
- (d) a scraping taken from the mouth;

DNA sample offence means any indictable offence specified in Schedule 9;

fingerprints includes finger, palm, toe and sole prints;

S. 464(2)
def. of
DNA profile sample
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 52(1).

S. 464(2)
def. of
DNA sample offence
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 52(1).

S. 464(2)
def. of
fingerprints
inserted by
No. 38/1988
s. 5(a).

S. 464(2)
def. of
fingerscan
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 3.

fingerscan means fingerprints taken by means of a device to obtain a record of the fingerprints;

Example

Fingerprints may be taken by a scanning device to obtain a digital record of the fingerprints.

S. 464(2)
def. of
forensic material
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5.

forensic material means any material—

- (a) from which a DNA profile may be derived; and
- (b) which is obtained from samples taken or procedures conducted in accordance with this Subdivision—

but does not include a sample taken for the sole purpose of establishing the identity of the person from whom it is taken;

S. 464(2)
def. of
forensic procedure
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 6(b),
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 52(3).

forensic procedure means the taking of a sample from any part of the body, whether an intimate or non-intimate sample or any other type of sample, or the conduct of any procedure on or physical examination of the body but does not include the taking of a fingerprint or a DNA profile sample;

held in a prison, police gaol, youth justice centre or youth residential centre means—

- (a) deemed by section 6A of the **Corrections Act 1986** to be in the custody of the Secretary within the meaning of that Act; or
- (b) deemed by section 6D of the **Corrections Act 1986** to be in the custody of the Chief Commissioner of Police; or
- (c) detained in a youth justice centre in the custody of the Secretary within the meaning of the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005**; or
- (d) detained in a youth residential centre in the custody of the Secretary within the meaning of the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005**;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*held in a
prison, police
gaol, youth
training centre
or youth
residential
centre*
inserted by
No. 38/1988
s. 5(a),
amended by
Nos 93/1990
s. 27(b)(i)(ii),
56/1989
s. 286(Sch. 2
item 7.3),
46/1998
s. 7(Sch. 1) (as
amended by
No. 12/1999
s. 3(Sch. 1
item 6)),
amended as
*held in a
prison, police
gaol, youth
justice centre
or youth
residential
centre* by
No. 48/2006
s. 42(Sch.
item 9.2(b)),
amended by
No. 59/2015
s. 25(b).

IBAC has the same meaning as in the
**Independent Broad-based Anti-corruption
Commission Act 2011**;

S. 464(2)
def. of *IBAC*
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 52(1).

intimate part of the body means the genital or
anal region of a male or female or the breast
of a female;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*intimate part
of the body*
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 6(c).

S. 464(2)
def. of
*intimate
sample*
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 6(c).

intimate sample means—

- (a) a blood sample;
- (b) a sample of pubic hair, including the root if required;
- (c) a swab, washing or sample taken from the external genital or anal region of a male or female or from the breast of a female;
- (d) a sample of saliva;
- (e) a scraping taken from the mouth;
- (f) a dental impression;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*investigating
official*
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.18(a)(ii)).

investigating official means a police officer or a person appointed by or under an Act (other than a police officer or person who is engaged in covert investigations under the orders of a superior) whose functions or duties include functions or duties in respect of the prevention or investigation of offences;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*legal
practitioner*
repealed by
No. 18/2005
s. 18(Sch. 1
item 27.3).

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medical practitioner means a person registered under the Health Practitioner Regulation National Law to practise in the medical profession (other than as a student);

S. 464(2)
def. of
*medical
practitioner*
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 6(d),
substituted by
No 81/1997
s. 16(b),
amended by
No. 97/2005
s. 182(Sch. 4
item 14.2(b)),
substituted by
No. 13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.3(b)).

mental impairment includes impairment because of mental illness, intellectual disability, dementia or brain injury;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*mental
impairment*
inserted by
No. 23/1991
s. 4(a).

midwife means a person registered under the Health Practitioner Regulation National Law—

S. 464(2)
def. of
midwife
inserted by
No. 13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.3(d)).

- (a) to practise in the nursing and midwifery profession as a midwife (other than as a student); and
- (b) in the register of midwives kept for that profession;

missing persons index means an index of DNA profiles, derived from forensic material, of—

S. 464(2)
def. of
*missing
persons index*
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5.

- (a) persons who are missing; and
- (b) volunteers who are relatives by blood of missing persons;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*National
Criminal
Investigation
DNA
Database*
inserted by
No. 32/2007
s. 4(2).

National Criminal Investigation DNA Database

means the DNA database system that—

- (a) is known as the National Criminal Investigation DNA Database; and
- (b) is managed by the Commonwealth;

S. 464(2)
def. of
NCIDD
inserted by
No. 32/2007
s. 4(2).

NCIDD means the National Criminal Investigation DNA Database;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*non-intimate
part of the
body*
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 6(e).

non-intimate part of the body means any part of the body other than an intimate part;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*non-intimate
sample*
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 6(e).

non-intimate sample means—

- (a) a sample of hair, other than pubic hair, including the root if required;
- (b) a sample of matter taken from under a fingernail or toenail;
- (c) a swab, washing or sample taken from any external part of the body other than the genital or anal region of a male or female or the breast of a female;

<i>nurse</i> means a person registered under the Health Practitioner Regulation National Law to practise in the nursing and midwifery profession as a nurse (other than as a midwife or as a student);	S. 464(2) def. of <i>nurse</i> inserted by No. 81/1997 s. 16(c), amended by No. 97/2005 s. 182(Sch. 4 item 14.2(c)), substituted by No. 13/2010 s. 51(Sch. item 17.3(c)).
<i>participating jurisdiction</i> means the Commonwealth, another State or a Territory in which there is a corresponding law in force;	S. 464(2) def. of <i>participating jurisdiction</i> inserted by No. 16/2002 s. 5.
<i>physical examination</i> means an examination of the external part of a person's body requiring touching of the person or removal of the person's clothing;	S. 464(2) def. of <i>physical examination</i> inserted by No. 129/1993 s. 6(e).
<i>police custody officer</i> has the same meaning as in the Victoria Police Act 2013 ;	S. 464(2) def. of <i>police custody officer</i> inserted by No. 59/2015 s. 25(a).
<i>police gaol</i> has the same meaning as in the Corrections Act 1986 ;	
<i>prison</i> has the same meaning as in the Corrections Act 1986 but includes a youth justice centre established under section 478 of the Children, Youth and Families Act 2005 ;	S. 464(2) def. of <i>prison</i> amended by No. 56/1989 s. 286(Sch. 2 item 7.4), substituted by No. 48/2006 s. 42(Sch. item 9.2(c)).

S. 464(2)
def. of
*registered
medical
practitioner*
inserted by
No. 23/1994
s. 118(Sch. 1
item 15.1),
repealed by
No. 81/1997
s. 16(d).

* * * *

S. 464(2)
def. of
*related
material and
information*
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 16(e),
amended by
Nos 27/2006
ss 3(a), 17(1),
25/2017 s. 50,
3/2019
s. 52(4).

related material and information—

- (a) in relation to any DNA profile sample or any sample taken in a forensic procedure conducted in accordance with sections 464R to 464ZA or section 464ZF, 464ZFAAA or 464ZFAB, means notes and audiovisual recordings made of the taking of the DNA profile sample or the conduct of the forensic procedure and any information which may identify the person contained in any record of or report relating to the DNA profile sample or the forensic procedure and in any copy of the record or report;
- (b) in relation to any sample voluntarily given by a person in accordance with sections 464ZGB to 464ZGD, means notes and audiovisual recording (if any) made of the procedure to take the sample and any information which may identify the person contained in any record of or report relating to the taking of the sample and in any copy of a record or report;

relevant suspect means a person of or above the age of 18 years who—

- (a) is suspected of having committed or attempted to commit an indictable offence; or
- (b) has been charged with an indictable offence;

S. 464(2)
def. of
relevant suspect
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 4(b),
substituted by
No. 23/1991
s. 4(b),
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 16(f),
61/2001
s. 16(1)(a),
16/2002
s. 17(1),
35/2002
s. 28(Sch.
item 3.1),
72/2004 s. 24,
substituted by
No. 72/2013
s. 3(a).

responsible Minister, in relation to a participating jurisdiction means a Minister of that jurisdiction who is responsible for administration of a corresponding law;

S. 464(2)
def. of
responsible Minister
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5.

responsible person, in relation to a DNA database, means the person responsible for the care, control and management of the system;

S. 464(2)
def. of
responsible person
inserted by
No. 32/2007
s. 4(2).

security patient has the same meaning as in the **Mental Health and Wellbeing Act 2022**;

S. 464(2)
def. of
security patient
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 16(g),
amended by
Nos 26/2014
s. 455(Sch.
item 7.2(d)),
39/2022
s. 813(c).

S. 464(2)
def. of
*senior police
officer*
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 8,
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.18(a)(iii)).

senior police officer means a police officer of or
above the rank of senior sergeant;

S. 464(2)
def. of *senior
police officer
authorisation*
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 52(1).

senior police officer authorisation means an
authorisation under section 464ZFAFAC;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*serious
offenders
index*
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5, amended
by No. 3/2019
s. 52(5).

serious offenders index means an index of DNA
profiles derived from forensic material taken
from—

- (a) offenders in accordance with
section 464ZFF, or under a
corresponding law of a participating
jurisdiction; and
- (ab) registrable offenders in accordance
with section 464ZFAB; and
- (ac) offenders in accordance with
section 464ZFAC(2)(a)(i); and
- (b) suspects who have been convicted of—
 - (i) an offence and an order has been
made under section 464ZFB(1); or
 - (ia) an offence and to which section
464ZFB(1AA) applies; or
 - (ii) an offence in respect of which a
forensic procedure may be
conducted under a corresponding
law of a participating jurisdiction;

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part III—Procedure and punishment

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S. 464(2)
def. of
*sexual
offence*
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 4(b),
amended by
No. 8/1991
s. 6(d),
repealed by
No. 23/1991
s. 4(c).

statistical index means an index of information
that—

S. 464(2)
def. of
*statistical
index*
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5.

- (a) is obtained from the analysis of forensic
material taken from persons in
accordance with this Subdivision or
under a corresponding law of a
participating jurisdiction; and
- (b) has been compiled for statistical
purposes; and
- (c) cannot be used to discover the identity
of persons from whom the forensic
material was taken;

suspect means a person of or above the age of
18 years who—

S. 464(2)
def. of
suspect
inserted by
No. 38/1988
s. 5(b),
amended by
Nos 25/1989
s. 14(a),
72/2004 s. 25.

- (a) is suspected of having committed an
offence; or
- (b) has been charged with an offence; or
- (c) has been summonsed to answer to a
charge;

S. 464(2)
def. of
suspects
index
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5,
amended by
Nos 27/2006
s. 3(b), 3/2019
s. 52(6).

suspects index means an index of DNA profiles derived from forensic material taken from suspects in accordance with section 464R, 464T or 464U, DNA profile samples taken in accordance with section 464SC or 464SE or under a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction or taken from persons found not guilty because of mental impairment in accordance with section 464ZF AAA or section 464ZFAC(2)(a)(ii);

S. 464(2)
def. of
tape
recording
repealed by
No. 27/2006
s. 3(c).

* * * * *

S. 464(2)
def. of
unknown
deceased
persons index
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5.

unknown deceased persons index means an index of DNA profiles of deceased persons whose identities are unknown where the DNA profile is derived from forensic material;

S. 464(2)
def. of
Victorian DNA
database
inserted by
No. 32/2007
s. 4(2).

Victorian DNA database means the DNA database system kept under section 464ZFD;

S. 464(2)
def. of
volunteer
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5.

volunteer means a person who volunteers to give a sample under section 464ZGB;

S. 464(2)
def. of
volunteers
(limited
purposes)
index
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5.

volunteers (limited purposes) index means an index of DNA profiles derived from forensic material taken from volunteers, under section 464ZGB or a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction, who have chosen that the information obtained from analysis

of the material may be used only for a limited purpose that is specified by the volunteer and noted on the index;

volunteers (unlimited purposes) index means an index of DNA profiles derived from forensic material taken from volunteers, under section 464ZGB or a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction, who have chosen that the information obtained from analysis of the material may be used for the purpose of a criminal investigation or any other purpose for which the DNA database may be used;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*volunteers
(unlimited
purposes)
index*
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 5.

youth residential centre has the same meaning as in the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005**;

S. 464(2)
def. of
*youth
residential
centre*
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 6(g),
amended by
No. 48/2006
s. 42(Sch.
item 9.2(d)).

* * * * *

S. 464(2)
def. of
*young
person*
inserted by
No. 38/1988
s. 5(c),
repealed by
No. 129/1993
s. 6(f).

- (3) The Minister administering the **Victoria Police Act 2013** may appoint by notice published in the Government Gazette a person or class of persons as a person or persons authorised to take fingerprints in accordance with this Subdivision.

S. 464(3)
inserted by
No. 25/1989
s. 11(b).
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.18(b)).

S. 464AA
inserted by
No. 27/2006
s. 4.

464AA Digital recordings

If this Subdivision requires an audio recording or an audiovisual recording to be made and the recording is made in a digitised format, the maker of the recording must certify that the recording has not been altered after its making and that the prescribed requirements, if any, in relation to the method of recording have been met.

S. 464AAB
(Heading)
amended by
No. 26/2023
s. 77(1).

464AAB Investigating official to ask whether person in custody is an Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander person

If a person is taken into custody, an investigating official must ask the person whether they are an Aboriginal person or a Torres Strait Islander—

- (a) as soon as practicable after the person is taken into custody; and
- (b) in any event, before any questioning or investigation under section 464A(2) commences.

Note to
s. 464AAB
amended by
No. 26/2023
s. 77(3).

Note

Section 464FA requires that the Victorian Aboriginal Legal Service be notified if an Aboriginal person or a Torres Strait Islander is taken into custody.

S. 464A
inserted by
No. 37/1988
s. 5.

464A Detention of person in custody

- (1) Every person taken into custody for an offence (whether committed in Victoria or elsewhere) must be—
 - (a) released unconditionally; or
 - (b) released on bail; or

(c) brought before a bail justice or the Magistrates' Court—

S. 464A(1)(c)
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 5(1)(a)(i).

within a reasonable time of being taken into custody.

Note

Section 10 of the **Bail Act 1977** applies at the expiration of the reasonable time referred to in subsection (1).

Note to
s. 464A(1)
inserted by
No. 26/2017
s. 21.

(2) If a person suspected of having committed an offence is in custody for that offence, an investigating official may, within the reasonable time referred to in subsection (1)—

- (a) inform the person of the circumstances of that offence; and
- (b) question the person or carry out investigations in which the person participates in order to determine the involvement (if any) of the person in that offence.

(3) Before any questioning (other than a request for the person's name and address) or investigation under subsection (2) commences, an investigating official must inform the person in custody that he or she does not have to say or do anything but that anything the person does say or do may be given in evidence.

S. 464A(3)
amended by
No. 129/1993
s. 5.

(4) In determining what constitutes a reasonable time for the purposes of subsection (1) the following matters may be considered—

- (a) the period of time reasonably required to bring the person before a bail justice or the Magistrates' Court;

S. 464A(4)(a)
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 5(1)(a)(ii).

- (b) the number and complexity of offences to be investigated;
- (c) any need of the investigating official to read and collate relevant material or to take any other steps that are reasonably necessary by way of preparation for the questioning or investigation;
- (d) any need to transport the person from the place of apprehension to a place where facilities are available to conduct an interview or investigation;
- (e) the number of other people who need to be questioned during the period of custody in respect of the offence for which the person is in custody;
- (f) any need to visit the place where the offence is believed to have been committed or any other place reasonably connected with the investigation of the offence;
- (g) any time taken to communicate with a legal practitioner, friend, relative, parent, guardian or independent person;
- (h) any time taken by a legal practitioner, interpreter, parent, guardian or independent person to arrive at the place where questioning or investigation is to take place;
- (i) any time during which the questioning or investigation of the person is suspended or delayed to allow the person to receive medical attention;
- (j) any time during which the questioning or investigation of the person is suspended or delayed to allow the person to rest;

- (k) the total period of time during which the person has been in the company of an investigating official before and after the commencement of custody;
- (l) any other matters reasonably connected with the investigation of the offence.

Note

Section 78D of the **Corrections Act 1986** provides for the application of section 464A in relation to persons detained under that Act.

**Note to
s. 464A
inserted by
No. 25/2014
s. 14.**

464B Questioning or investigation of person already held for another matter

**S. 464B
inserted by
No. 37/1988
s. 5.**

- (1) An investigating official may apply to the Magistrates' Court or, if the application is in respect of a child, the Children's Court for an order that a person—

**S. 464B(1)
amended by
Nos 56/1989
s. 286(Sch. 2
item 7.5),
57/1989
s. 5(1)(b)(i),
86/2000
s. 4(1)(a).**

- (a) who is—

**S. 464B(1)(a)
substituted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(1)(b).**

- (i) held in a prison or police gaol; or

- (ii) a forensic resident or a security resident within the meaning of the **Disability Act 2006**; or

**S. 464B
(1)(a)(ii)
amended by
No. 23/2006
s. 236(5).**

- (iii) a forensic patient or a security patient within the meaning of the **Mental Health and Wellbeing Act 2022**; and

**S. 464B(1)
(a)(iii)
substituted by
No. 26/2014
s. 455(Sch.
item 7.3),
amended by
No. 39/2022
s. 814.**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part III—Procedure and punishment

S. 464B(1)
(a)(iv)
repealed by
No. 26/2014
s. 455(Sch.
item 7.3).

* * * * *

S. 464B(1)(b)
amended by
Nos 86/2000
s. 4(1)(c),
72/2013
s. 4(1).

(b) reasonably suspected of having committed an offence (being, in the case of an application in respect of a child, an indictable offence), whether in Victoria or elsewhere, other than the offence for which he or she is being held—

be delivered into the custody of the investigating official for the purpose of questioning or investigation in respect of the first-mentioned offence.

(2) An application under subsection (1) must—

- (a) be in writing; and
- (b) state the grounds on which the application is made; and
- (c) be served on the person who is the subject of the application by delivering a true copy of the application—

S. 464B(2)(c)
amended by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(2)(a).

(i) to the person personally; or

S. 464B(2)
(c)(ii)
substituted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(2)(b).

(ii) to the person in charge of the place where the person is being held or detained.

S. 464B(3)
amended by
Nos 56/1989
s. 286(Sch. 2
item 7.6),
86/2000
s. 4(3).

(3) At any time after the filing of an application under subsection (1), the Magistrates' Court or Children's Court (as the case may be) may order that the person who is the subject of the application be brought before the court for the hearing of the application under subsection (1).

(4) While an order made under subsection (3) is being carried out, the person is to be taken to be in the legal custody of the person acting under the order.

(4A) The Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be) must not hear or determine an application under subsection (1) unless the person who is the subject of the application is before the Court.

S. 464B(4A)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(4).

(4B) If the person who is the subject of an application under subsection (1) is not legally represented in a proceeding on the application, the Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be)—

S. 464B(4B)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(4).

(a) must adjourn the hearing of the proceeding to enable the person to obtain legal representation unless satisfied that the person has had, or has refused to have, legal advice provided to him or her in relation to the application; and

(b) must not resume the hearing unless the person is legally represented or the Court is satisfied that he or she has had, or has refused to have, legal advice provided to him or her in relation to the application.

(4C) The Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be) may order Victoria Legal Aid to provide legal assistance (of a kind to which section 26(1) of the **Legal Aid Act 1978** applies) to the person who is the subject of an application under subsection (1) and, despite anything to the contrary in that Act, Victoria Legal Aid must provide legal assistance in accordance with the order.

S. 464B(4C)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(4).

S. 464B(5)
amended by
Nos 56/1989
s. 286(Sch. 2
item 7.7),
57/1989
s. 5(1)(b)(ii),
substituted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(4).

(5) On an application under subsection (1), the Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be) may, if satisfied that it is in the interests of justice to do so but subject to subsection (5C), order the transfer of the custody of the person who is the subject of the application to the applicant for the purpose of questioning or investigation for a maximum period of time specified in the order, being a reasonable period within which the questioning or investigation may take place.

S. 464B(5A)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(4).

(5A) In determining what constitutes a reasonable period for the purposes of an order under subsection (5), the Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be) must have regard to—

- (a) the matters specified in section 464A(4), with any necessary modifications; and
- (b) if the person is a child, his or her age.

S. 464B(5B)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(4).

(5B) The Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be), on making an order under subsection (5), may make any further order that it thinks fit as to where, and the circumstances under which, the questioning or investigation may take place but it must not order that the questioning or investigation take place somewhere other than the place at which the person who is the subject of the order was held or detained at the time of the application for the order under subsection (5) unless it is not practicable for the questioning or investigation to take place there.

(5C) The Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be) must not make an order under subsection (5) in respect of a person referred to in subsection (1)(a)(ii) or (iii) unless—

S. 464B(5C)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(4),
amended by
No. 29/2020
s. 9(1).

- (a) having considered any known likely psychological effect of the questioning on the person; and
- (b) having received evidence (whether oral or written) on the fitness of the person to be questioned given by a medical practitioner—

it is satisfied on the balance of probabilities that the person is fit to be questioned.

(5D) A person is unfit to be questioned for the purposes of subsection (5C) if, because the person's mental processes are disordered or impaired, the person is or, at some time during the questioning, will be—

S. 464B(5D)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(4).

- (a) unable to understand the nature of the questioning (namely that it is questioning to ascertain his or her involvement in the commission of an offence); or
- (b) unable to follow the course of questioning;
or
- (c) unable to give instructions to his or her legal practitioner; or
- (d) unable to understand that he or she does not have to say or do anything but that anything he or she does say or do may be given in evidence.

S. 464B(5E)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(4),
amended by
No. 29/2020
s. 9(1).

- (5E) On making an order under subsection (5) in respect of a person referred to in subsection (1)(a)(ii) or (iii), the Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be)—
- (a) must include in that order a condition that—
 - (i) subject to subsection (5F), an independent person is to be present while any questioning or investigation takes place in accordance with the order; and
 - (ii) before the commencement of any questioning or investigation, the investigating official must allow the person to communicate with the independent person in circumstances in which as far as practicable the communication will not be overheard; and
 - (b) may include in that order any other condition that it thinks fit in the interests of the well-being of the person during any questioning or investigation.

S. 464B(5F)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(4).

- (5F) The Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be) is not required to include in an order under subsection (5) a condition referred to in subsection (5E)(a)(i) if the person who is the subject of the order applies to the Court for that condition not to be included and the Court is satisfied that, in all the circumstances, it is appropriate not to include it.

- (5G) On making an order under subsection (5), the Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be) must inform the person who is the subject of the order—
- (a) that he or she does not have to say or do anything but that anything he or she does say or do may be given in evidence; and
- (b) that the investigating official must give him or her the information required to be given by subsection (6) and section 464C(1); and
- (c) if the person was held in a prison or police gaol at the time of the application, that the making of the order does not prevent a senior police officer from authorising the conduct of a non-intimate compulsory procedure on the person under section 464SA.
- (5H) An audiovisual recording must be made of the following—
- (a) the giving of any information required to be given by subsection (6) and section 464C(1);
- (b) any response of the person in custody to the giving of that information;
- (c) any questioning that takes place in accordance with an order made under subsection (5) and anything said by the person questioned.
- (6) If an order is made under subsection (5), before any questioning or investigation commences, an investigating official must inform the person who is the subject of the order that he or she does not have to say or do anything but that anything the person does say or do may be given in evidence.

S. 464B(5G)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(4).

S. 464B(5G)(b)
amended by
No. 41/2004
s. 9(1)(a).

S. 464B(5G)(c)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 9(1)(b).

S. 464B(5H)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(4),
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(2).

S. 464B(6)
amended by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(5).

S. 464B(8)
amended by
Nos 56/1989
s. 286(Sch. 2
item 7.7),
57/1989
s. 5(1)(b)(iii),
86/2000
s. 4(6)(a).

S. 464B(8)(b)
amended by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(6)(b).

S. 464B(8A)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(7).

S. 464B(8B)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(7).

- (7) An order under subsection (5) has effect as a suspension of a direction in a warrant of commitment to deliver a person to the place of detention specified in the warrant or to hold a person in that place (as the case may be).
- (8) The Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be) may, subject to subsection (8A)—
 - (a) extend a period of custody ordered under subsection (5); or
 - (b) on a subsequent application under subsection (1), make orders whether in respect of the same or a different offence reasonably suspected of having been committed by the person.
- (8A) The Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be) must not extend a period of custody ordered under subsection (5) or, on a subsequent application under subsection (1), make an order against the same person in respect of the same offence unless satisfied that there is a reasonable prospect that further questioning or investigation will assist in determining the involvement (if any) of the person in the commission of the offence.
- (8B) In determining the length of any extension of a period of custody ordered under subsection (5), the Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be) must have regard to—
 - (a) the matters specified in section 464A(4), with any necessary modifications; and
 - (b) if the person is a child, his or her age.

(9) At—

(a) the end of the period, or any extended period, specified in an order under subsection (5); or

(b) the cessation of questioning or investigation—

whichever is the earlier, the investigating official must deliver the person who is the subject of the order to the place of detention at which the person was held or detained at the time of the application for the order.

S. 464B(9)
amended by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(8)(a)(b).

(9A) The making of an order under subsection (5) does not prevent a senior police officer from giving an authorisation under section 464SA.

S. 464B(9A)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 9(2).

(10) In this section—

S. 464B(10)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 4(9),
amended by
No. 72/2004
s. 26(a)(b).

child, in relation to a person suspected of having committed an offence, means a person who is under 18 years of age at the time of the suspected commission of the offence but does not include any person who is 19 years of age or over when—

S. 464B(10)
def. of
child
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 4(2)(a),
substituted by
No. 32/2024
s. 804.

(a) an application is made under this section in respect of the person; or

(b) the person gives informed consent under this section;

Note

It is conclusively presumed that a child who is under 12 years of age cannot commit an offence—see section 10 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**.

S. 464B(10)
def. of
*investigating
official*
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 4(2)(b).

investigating official, in relation to an offence committed outside Victoria, includes a person (other than a person who is engaged in covert investigations under the orders of a superior) who is—

- (a) a member of—
 - (i) the Australian Federal Police; or
 - (ii) the police force of another State or a Territory; or
- (b) a person appointed by or under an Act of the Commonwealth or another State or a Territory whose functions or duties include functions or duties in respect of the prevention or investigation of offences;

Note

Part IC of the Crimes Act 1914 of the Commonwealth applies if the investigating official is a member of the Australian Federal Police.

S. 464B(10)
def. of *offence*
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 4(2)(b).

offence includes an offence against a law of the Commonwealth or another State or a Territory.

S. 464B(11)
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 4(3).

- (11) An investigating official may question a person (other than a child) who is held in a prison or police gaol and is reasonably suspected of having committed an offence (whether in Victoria or elsewhere) other than the offence for which he or she is being held about his or her involvement (if any) in that offence if—
 - (a) the investigating official is satisfied that the person is not incapable of giving informed consent by reason of mental impairment; and

- (b) the person gives informed consent in accordance with subsection (13).

Note

Section 41 of the **Corrections Act 1986** provides for visits by the police to prisoners, which may include questioning to which this section does not apply.

- (12) A person must not be removed from the prison or police gaol in which he or she is being held for the purpose of questioning under subsection (11) unless subsection (16) applies.

S. 464B(12)
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 4(3),
amended by
No. 29/2020
s. 9(2).

Note

Questioning or investigations involving removal from prison or police gaol may be authorised by a court order under subsection (5).

- (13) A person gives informed consent to be questioned if the person consents after an investigating official informs the person, in language likely to be understood by the person, of the following matters—

S. 464B(13)
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 4(3).

- (a) the nature of the offence which the person is suspected of having committed;
- (b) that the person may refuse to be questioned;
- (c) that if the person gives consent, he or she does not have to say or do anything but that anything the person does say or do may be given in evidence;
- (d) that if the person gives consent, he or she may withdraw that consent at any time before the questioning is completed but anything the person says or does before withdrawal of consent may be given in evidence;
- (e) that if the person refuses to be questioned, an application may be made to the Magistrates' Court for an order under this section;

S. 464B(14)
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 4(3).

S. 464B(15)
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 4(3).

S. 464B(16)
inserted by
No. 29/2020
s. 9(3).

- (f) that if the Magistrates' Court makes an order under this section, the person may be delivered into the custody of the investigating official for the purpose of questioning;
 - (g) the person's rights under sections 464C, 464D and 464F, unless Part IC of the Crimes Act 1914 of the Commonwealth applies.
- (14) A person may exercise any applicable right under section 464C, 464D or 464F before deciding whether or not to consent to be questioned.
- (15) An audiovisual recording must be made of—
- (a) the giving of the information referred to in subsection (13); and
 - (b) any response of the person in custody to the giving of that information; and
 - (c) any questioning of the person that takes place and anything said by the person questioned; and
 - (d) any withdrawal of consent to the questioning.
- (16) An investigating official may remove a person being held in a police gaol for the purpose of questioning under subsection (11) if—
- (a) the police gaol is located in the same building as a police station; and
 - (b) the person is to be removed to a room in the police station; and
 - (c) the person is not to be taken outside the building; and
 - (d) the person consents to being removed to a room in the police station; and

- (e) the officer in charge of the police gaol gives approval under subsection (17).
- (17) An officer in charge of a police gaol may approve the removal of a person to a room in a police station under subsection (16) if satisfied that the use of the room—
- (a) is in the best interests of the person to be questioned, having regard to privacy and confidentiality; or
- (b) enables an audiovisual recording required by subsection (15) to be made; or
- (c) for any other reason is preferable to conducting the questioning in the police gaol.
- (18) A person removed under subsection (16) from a police gaol to a room in a police station is in the custody of the investigating official.
- (19) The removal of a person from a police gaol to another part of the same building under subsection (16) has effect as a suspension of a direction in a warrant of commitment to deliver the person to the place of detention specified in the warrant or to hold the person in that place.
- (20) At the cessation of questioning, the investigating official must deliver the person to the police gaol from which the person was removed.

S. 464B(17)
inserted by
No. 29/2020
s. 9(3).

S. 464B(18)
inserted by
No. 29/2020
s. 9(3).

S. 464B(19)
inserted by
No. 29/2020
s. 9(3).

S. 464B(20)
inserted by
No. 29/2020
s. 9(3).

Note

Section 78D of the **Corrections Act 1986** provides for the application of section 464B in relation to persons detained under that Act.

Note to
s. 464B
inserted by
No. 25/2014
s. 15.

S. 464C
inserted by
No. 37/1988
s. 5.

464C Right to communicate with friend, relative and legal practitioner

- (1) Before any questioning or investigation under section 464A(2) commences, an investigating official must inform the person in custody that he or she—
- (a) may communicate with or attempt to communicate with a friend or relative to inform that person of his or her whereabouts; and
 - (b) may communicate with or attempt to communicate with a legal practitioner (whether the term legal practitioner or lawyer is used)—

S. 464C(1)(b)
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 5(1).

and, unless the investigating official believes on reasonable grounds that—

- (c) the communication would result in the escape of an accomplice or the fabrication or destruction of evidence; or
- (d) the questioning or investigation is so urgent, having regard to the safety of other people, that it should not be delayed—

the investigating official must defer the questioning and investigation for a time that is reasonable in the circumstances to enable the person to make, or attempt to make, the communication.

- (2) Subject to subsection (1), if a person wishes to communicate with a friend, relative or legal practitioner, the investigating official in whose custody the person then is—
- (a) must afford the person reasonable facilities as soon as practicable to enable the person to do so; and

- (b) must allow the person's legal practitioner or a clerk of the legal practitioner to communicate with the person in custody in circumstances in which as far as practicable the communication will not be overheard.
- (3) This section also applies to any questioning or investigation in accordance with an order made under section 464B(5) or any questioning conducted by consent under section 464B(11), unless Part IC of the Crimes Act 1914 of the Commonwealth applies.
- (4) This section does not apply to questioning or investigation in connection with an offence under section 49(1) of the **Road Safety Act 1986**.

S. 464C(3)
amended by
Nos 86/2000
s. 5, 72/2013
s. 5(2).

464D Right to an interpreter

S. 464D
inserted by
No. 37/1988
s. 5.

- (1) If a person in custody does not have a knowledge of the English language that is sufficient to enable the person to understand the questioning, an investigating official must, before any questioning or investigation under section 464A(2) commences, arrange for the presence of a competent interpreter and defer the questioning or investigation until the interpreter is present.
- (2) This section also applies to any questioning or investigation in accordance with an order made under section 464B(5) or any questioning conducted by consent under section 464B(11), unless Part IC of the Crimes Act 1914 of the Commonwealth applies.
- (3) This section does not apply to questioning or investigation in connection with an offence under section 49(1) of the **Road Safety Act 1986**.

S. 464D(2)
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 6.

S. 464E
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 72/2004
s. 27(1).

S. 464E
inserted by
No. 37/1988
s. 5.

S. 464E(1)
amended by
No. 72/2004
s. 27(2).

464E Persons under 18 years

- (1) If a person in custody is under the age of 18 years, an investigating official must not, subject to subsection (2), question or carry out an investigation under section 464A(2) unless—
 - (a) a parent or guardian of the person in custody or, if a parent or guardian is not available, an independent person is present; and
 - (b) before the commencement of any questioning or investigation, the investigating official has allowed the person in custody to communicate with his or her parent or guardian or the independent person in circumstances in which as far as practicable the communication will not be overheard.
- (2) Subsection (1) does not apply if the investigating official believes on reasonable grounds that—
 - (a) the communication necessary to give effect to subsection (1)(a) would result in the escape of an accomplice or the fabrication or destruction of evidence; or
 - (b) the questioning or investigation is so urgent, having regard to the safety of other people, that it should not be delayed.
- (3) This section also applies to any questioning or investigation in accordance with an order made under section 464B(5).

- (4) This section does not apply to questioning or investigation in connection with an offence under section 49(1) of the **Road Safety Act 1986**.

464F Right of foreign national to communicate with consular office

S. 464F
inserted by
No. 37/1988
s. 5.

- (1) If a person in custody is not a citizen or permanent resident of Australia, the investigating official in whose custody the person then is must, before any questioning or investigation under section 464A(2) commences, inform the person in custody that he or she may communicate with or attempt to communicate with the consular office of the country of which the person is a citizen and, unless the investigating official believes on reasonable grounds that—
- (a) the communication would result in the escape of an accomplice or the fabrication or destruction of evidence; or
 - (b) the questioning or investigation is so urgent, having regard to the safety of other people, that it should not be delayed—

the investigating official must defer the questioning or investigation for a time that is reasonable in the circumstances to enable the person to make, or attempt to make, the communication.

- (2) Subject to subsection (1), if a person referred to in that subsection wishes to communicate with the consular office of the country of which he or she is a citizen, the investigating official in whose custody the person then is must afford the person reasonable facilities as soon as practicable to enable the person to do so.

S. 464F(2A)
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 7.

- (2A) This section also applies to any questioning or investigation in accordance with an order made under section 464B(5) or any questioning conducted by consent under section 464B(11), unless Part IC of the Crimes Act 1914 of the Commonwealth applies.
- (3) This section does not apply to questioning or investigation in connection with an offence under section 49(1) of the **Road Safety Act 1986**.

S. 464FA
(Heading)
amended by
No. 26/2023
s. 78(1).

464FA Victorian Aboriginal Legal Service to be notified if Aboriginal person or Torres Strait Islander taken into custody

S. 464FA
inserted by
No. 48/2018
s. 18.

S. 464FA(1)
substituted by
No. 26/2023
s. 78(2).

- (1) An investigating official must notify VALS if—
- (a) a person is taken into custody; and
 - (b) either—
 - (i) the person states (whether or not in response to a question asked by an investigating official) that they are an Aboriginal person or a Torres Strait Islander; or
 - (ii) the investigating official who took the person into custody knows or is of the opinion that the person is an Aboriginal person or a Torres Strait Islander.

Note

Note

Section 464AAB requires that an investigating official who takes a person into custody must ask the person whether they are an Aboriginal person or a Torres Strait Islander.

(2) The notification must be made—

- (a) within one hour of the person being taken into custody; or
- (b) if it is not practicable to do so within one hour, as soon as it is practicable to do so.

S. 464FA(2)
substituted by
No. 26/2023
s. 78(2).

(3) As soon as practicable after VALS is notified, an investigating official must inform the person taken into custody of that notification.

S. 464FA(3)
amended by
No. 26/2023
s. 78(3).

(4) In this section—

VALS means the Victorian Aboriginal
Legal Service Co-operative Ltd
(ABN 45 926 675 900).

**464G Recording of information required to be given to
person in custody**

S. 464G
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(3).

S. 464G
inserted by
No. 37/1988
s. 5,
amended by
No. 86/2000
s. 8(1) (ILA
s. 39B(1)).

(1) If a person is in custody in relation to an indictable offence, an investigating official who is required by sections 464A(3), 464C(1) and 464F(1) to give the person in custody certain information must record (by audio recording or audiovisual recording), if practicable, the giving of that information and the person's responses, if any.

S. 464G(1)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(4).

(2) Subsection (1) is subject to section 464B(5H) and (15).

S. 464G(2)
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 8(1),
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 8.

464H Recording of confessions and admissions

S. 464H
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(5).

S. 464H
inserted by
No. 37/1988
s. 5.

S. 464H(1)
amended by
Nos 86/2000
s. 6(1)(c),
27/2006
s. 17(6)(c),
87/2009
s. 3(1).

- (1) Subject to subsection (2), evidence of a confession or admission made to an investigating official by a person who—

- (a) was suspected; or
- (b) ought reasonably to have been suspected—

of having committed an offence is inadmissible as evidence against the person in proceedings for an indictable offence unless—

S. 464H(1)(c)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(6)(a).

- (c) if the confession or admission was made before the commencement of questioning, the confession or admission was recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording, or the substance of the confession or admission was confirmed by the person and the confirmation was recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording; or

S. 464H(1)(d)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(6)(a).

- (d) if the confession or admission was made during questioning at a place where facilities were available to conduct an interview, the questioning and anything said by the person questioned was recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording; or

S. 464H(1)(e)
amended by
Nos 86/2000
s. 6(1)(a),
27/2006
s. 17(6)(a).

- (e) if the confession or admission was made during questioning at a place where facilities were not available to conduct an interview, the questioning and anything said by the person questioned was recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording, or the substance of the confession or admission was

confirmed by the person questioned and the confirmation was recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording; or

- (f) if the confession or admission was made during questioning in accordance with an order made under section 464B(5), the questioning and anything said by the person was recorded by audiovisual recording—

S. 464H(1)(f) inserted by No. 86/2000 s. 6(1)(b), amended by No. 27/2006 s. 17(6)(b).

and, if either an audio recording or an audiovisual recording was made, that recording or, if both an audio recording and an audiovisual recording were made, the audiovisual recording is available to be tendered in evidence.

- (2) A court may admit evidence of a confession or admission otherwise inadmissible by reason of subsection (1) if the person seeking to adduce the evidence satisfies the court on the balance of probabilities that the circumstances—

- (a) are exceptional; and
(b) justify the reception of the evidence.

- (3) If the questioning or confession or admission, or the confirmation of a confession or admission, of a person is recorded as required under this section or the giving of information is recorded as required under section 464B(5H) or 464G, the investigating official must give to the person or his or her legal practitioner without charge—

S. 464H(3) amended by No. 86/2000 s. 6(2)(a).

- (a) if either an audio recording or an audiovisual recording was made, a copy of that recording as soon as practicable but not later than 7 days after the recording was made; and

S. 464H(3)(a) amended by Nos 86/2000 s. 6(2)(b), 27/2006 s. 17(7)(a), substituted by No. 87/2009 s. 3(2).

S. 464H(3)(b)
amended by
Nos 86/2000
s. 6(2)(b),
27/2006
s. 17(7)(b),
substituted by
No. 87/2009
s. 3(2).

(b) if both an audio recording and an audiovisual recording were made—

- (i) the audio recording as soon as practicable but not later than 7 days after the recording was made; and
- (ii) if the person is charged with an offence to which the recording relates, a copy of the audiovisual recording as soon as practicable but not later than 7 days after the person is charged; and

S. 464H(3)(c)
inserted by
No. 87/2009
s. 3(2).

(c) if a transcript of the recording is prepared, a copy of the transcript as soon as practicable but not later than 7 days after the transcript was made.

S. 464H(3A)
inserted by
No. 87/2009
s. 3(3).

(3A) On request by a person charged with an offence or the legal practitioner representing that person, the investigating official must provide an additional copy of the audiovisual recording referred to in subsection (3).

S. 464H(4)
amended by
Nos 86/2000
s. 6(3),
27/2006
s. 17(8).

(4) Nothing in this section prevents the use of an audio recording or audiovisual recording in a proceeding for a summary offence.

S. 464I
inserted by
No. 37/1988
s. 5,
amended by
No. 86/2000
s. 8(2).

464I No power to detain person not under arrest

Nothing in sections 464 to 464H (except as provided by an order made under section 464B(5)) confers a power to detain against his or her will a person who is not under arrest.

464J Right to remain silent etc. not affected

Nothing in this subdivision affects—

- (a) the right of a person suspected of having committed an offence to refuse to answer questions or to participate in investigations except where required to do so by or under an Act or a Commonwealth Act; or
- (b) the onus on the prosecution to establish the voluntariness of an admission or confession made by a person suspected of having committed an offence; or
- (ba) the onus on the prosecution to prove that an admission or confession was made in such circumstances as to make it unlikely that the truth of the admission or confession was adversely affected; or
- (c) the discretion of a court to exclude unfairly obtained evidence; or
- (d) the discretion of a court to exclude illegally or improperly obtained evidence.

S. 464J
inserted by
No. 37/1988
s. 5,
amended by
No. 84/1989
s. 6.

S. 464J(ba)
inserted by
No. 69/2009
s. 50.

464JA Offences in relation to recordings

- (1) In this section—

authorised person means—

- (a) a member of Victoria Police personnel (other than a protective services officer);
- (b) a person or body engaged to provide services to Victoria Police in relation to the installation or maintenance of recording equipment;

S. 464JA
inserted by
No. 87/2009
s. 4.

S. 464JA(1)
def. of
authorised person
amended by
Nos 64/2010
s. 3(1),
43/2012
s. 3(Sch.
item 11.2),
82/2012
s. 159(1),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.19(a)),
31/2024
s. 113(Sch. 1
item 7).

- (c) the Director of Public Prosecutions for Victoria or a person acting under the authority of the Director;
- (d) the Chief Crown Prosecutor or a Crown Prosecutor or Associate Crown Prosecutor appointed under the **Public Prosecutions Act 1994**;
- (e) a person employed in the Office of Public Prosecutions under the **Public Prosecutions Act 1994**;
- (f) a legal practitioner representing—
 - (i) the State; or
 - (ii) an informant;
- (g) a legal practitioner representing—
 - (i) a suspect recorded under section 464B(5H), 464G or 464H; or
 - (ii) a co-accused of the suspect;
- (h) an officer or employee of Victoria Legal Aid employed under the **Legal Aid Act 1978**;
- (i) a court or a person acting under the direction of a court;
- (j) a coroner within the meaning of the **Coroners Act 2008** or a person acting under the direction of a coroner;
- (k) the Commissioner for Law Enforcement Data Security appointed under Part 2 of the **Commissioner for Law Enforcement Data Security Act 2005** or a person acting under his or her direction;

- (l) the Chief Examiner or an Examiner appointed under Part 3 of the **Major Crime (Investigative Powers) Act 2004** or a person acting under the direction of the Chief Examiner or an Examiner;
- (m) the Commissioner within the meaning of the **Independent Broad-based Anti-corruption Commission Act 2011** or a person acting under his or her direction;
- (n) the Chief Integrity Inspector within the meaning of the **Integrity Oversight Victoria Act 2011** or a person acting under his or her direction;
- (o) a member of the Legislative Assembly or Legislative Council or a person acting under his or her direction;
- (p) a person, or person belonging to a class of persons, prescribed for the purposes of this definition;
- (q) an investigating official or person acting under his or her direction;
- (r) a person engaged by a Department or agency to store or retrieve a record;

publish means—

- (a) insert in a newspaper or other publication; or
- (b) disseminate by broadcast, telecast or cinematograph; or
- (c) bring to the notice of the public or any member of the public by any other means, including by publication on the Internet;

recording means a recording made in accordance with section 464B(5H), 464G or 464H.

- (2) A person must not knowingly possess an audio recording or an audiovisual recording unless the person—
- (a) is the suspect; or
 - (b) is a legal practitioner representing the suspect; or
 - (c) is an authorised person acting in the performance of his or her duties; or
 - (d) has possession of the recording in a sealed package in the course of his or her duties as a person engaged by a person referred to in paragraph (a), (b) or (c) to transport the recording to that person.

Penalty: Level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum).

Note

The maximum fine that may be imposed on a body corporate found guilty of an offence against this subsection is 600 penalty units: see section 113D of the **Sentencing Act 1991**.

- (3) A person must not play an audio recording or an audiovisual recording to another person unless—
- (a) the recording is played for purposes connected with any civil or criminal proceeding and any inquiry before any court or tribunal; or
 - (b) the recording is played for purposes connected with an investigation of a death or a fire or an inquest held by a coroner; or
 - (c) the recording is played for purposes connected with disciplinary action against a police officer under the **Victoria Police Act 2013**; or

S. 464JA(3)(a)
substituted by
No. 64/2010
s. 3(2).

S. 464JA(3)(c)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.19(b)).

- (d) the recording is played for purposes connected with disciplinary action against a legal practitioner; or
- (e) the recording is played in accordance with the direction of a court under section 464JB; or
- (f) the recording is played in accordance with section 464JD; or
- (g) the recording is played by an authorised person acting in the course of his or her duties.

Penalty: Level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum).

Note

The maximum fine that may be imposed on a body corporate found guilty of an offence against this subsection is 600 penalty units: see section 113D of the **Sentencing Act 1991**.

- (4) A person must not supply or offer to supply an audio recording or an audiovisual recording to another person other than—
 - (a) the suspect in relation to whom the recording was made;
 - (b) a legal practitioner representing the suspect;
 - (c) an authorised person acting in the performance of his or her duties;
 - (d) a person engaged by a person referred to in paragraph (a), (b) or (c) to transport the recording.

Penalty: Level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum).

Note

The maximum fine that may be imposed on a body corporate found guilty of an offence against this subsection is 600 penalty units: see section 113D of the **Sentencing Act 1991**.

- (5) A person, other than an authorised person acting in the performance of his or her duties, must not copy the whole or any part of an audio recording or an audiovisual recording or permit another person to make such a copy, unless the person is acting in accordance with the direction of a court under section 464JB.

Penalty: Level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum).

Note

The maximum fine that may be imposed on a body corporate found guilty of an offence against this subsection is 600 penalty units: see section 113D of the **Sentencing Act 1991**.

- (6) An authorised person must not knowingly or recklessly tamper with, modify or erase (in whole or in part) a recording while the recording is being retained under section 464JC, except in accordance with the direction of a court under section 464JB.

Penalty: Level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum).

Note

The maximum fine that may be imposed on a body corporate found guilty of an offence against this subsection is 600 penalty units: see section 113D of the **Sentencing Act 1991**.

S. 464JA(6)
amended by
No. 64/2010
s. 3(3).

- (7) A person must not publish or cause to be published the whole or any part of an audio recording or an audiovisual recording except in accordance with the direction of a court under section 464JB.

Penalty: Level 7 imprisonment (2 years maximum).

Note

The maximum fine that may be imposed on a body corporate found guilty of an offence against this subsection is 1200 penalty units: see section 113D of the **Sentencing Act 1991**.

- (8) An offence against a provision of this section is a summary offence.

464JB Court may give directions in relation to a recording

S. 464JB
inserted by
No. 87/2009
s. 4.

- (1) In this section—

recording has the same meaning as in section 464JA.

- (2) A court may give directions, with or without conditions, as to the supply, copying, editing, erasure, playing or publishing of an audio recording or an audiovisual recording.

464JC Retention of copy of recording

S. 464JC
inserted by
No. 87/2009
s. 4.

- (1) In this section—

authorised person has the same meaning as in section 464JA;

court means—

- (a) if a criminal proceeding to which the recording relates has commenced but has not been completed, the court hearing the proceeding;
- (b) in any other case, the Magistrates' Court;

S. 464JC(1)
def. of
*Department
Head*
inserted by
No. 64/2010
s. 4(1).

Department Head has the same meaning as in the
Public Administration Act 2004;

recording has the same meaning as in
section 464JA.

S. 464JC(2)
amended by
Nos 64/2010
s. 4(2)(3),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.20).

- (2) The Chief Commissioner of Police must keep a copy of a recording, if the recording has been made by a police officer in the course of an investigation, in safe custody.

S. 464JC(2A)
inserted by
No. 64/2010
s. 4(4),
amended by
Nos 48/2012
s. 47, 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.20).

- (2A) If the recording has been made by an investigating official who is not a police officer, the recording must be kept in the custody of the Department Head for the Department, where the investigating official made the recording in the course of carrying out duties for or on behalf of that Department.

S. 464JC(2B)
inserted by
No. 64/2010
s. 4(4).

- (2B) A recording referred to in subsection (2) or (2A) must be kept for a period of 7 years from the making of the recording.

S. 464JC(3)
amended by
No. 64/2010
s. 4(5).

- (3) If the court is satisfied that there is good cause to keep a copy of a recording for a period longer than 7 years, the court may order that the Chief Commissioner of Police or the Department Head retain the copy for a further period specified in the order.
- (4) An application for an order under subsection (3) may be made by—
- (a) the suspect in relation to whom the recording was made; or
 - (b) an authorised person acting in the performance of his or her duties.

(5) The court must not make an order under subsection (3) unless—

- (a) the court is satisfied that the applicant has given reasonable notice of the application to the suspect and the Chief Commissioner of Police or the Department Head; and
- (b) the court has given the suspect and the Chief Commissioner of Police or the Department Head a reasonable opportunity to be heard.

S. 464JC(5)(a)
amended by
No. 64/2010
s. 4(6)(a).

S. 464JC(5)(b)
amended by
No. 64/2010
s. 4(6)(b).

464JD Use of recordings for training, teaching or testing purposes

S. 464JD
inserted by
No. 87/2009
s. 4.

(1) In this section—

prescribed person means—

S. 464JD(1)
def. of
prescribed person
amended by
Nos 64/2010
s. 5(1),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.21).

- (a) a member of Victoria Police personnel (other than a protective services officer);
- (b) a person or body engaged to provide services to Victoria Police in relation to the installation or maintenance of recording equipment;
- (c) a legal practitioner or a person training to become a legal practitioner;
- (d) a person, or a person belonging to a class of persons, prescribed for the purposes of this section;
- (e) an investigating official or a person acting under his or her direction;

recording has the same meaning as in section 464JA.

- (2) Subject to section 464JA, a recording may be played to a prescribed person for the purposes of training or teaching that person or testing the recording equipment if—
- (a) the suspect has been convicted or found guilty of the charge to which the recording relates; and
 - (b) all legal proceedings in relation to the subject matter in the recording have been concluded; and
 - (c) all reasonable measures have been taken to prevent the identification of the suspect or any other person (including an alleged victim) from the recording when it is played.

Heading
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 4(a).

Fingerprinting

S. 464K
inserted by
No. 38/1988
s. 4,
amended by
Nos 25/1989
s. 11(c),
57/1989
s. 5(1)(c),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

464K Fingerprinting of adults and children aged 15 or above

S. 464K(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.22(a)).

- (1) A police officer may take, or cause to be taken by an authorised person, the fingerprints of a person of or above the age of 15 years who—
- (a) is believed on reasonable grounds to have committed; or
 - (b) has been charged with; or
 - (c) has been summonsed to answer to a charge for—

an indictable offence or a summary offence referred to in Schedule 7.

- (2) A police officer intending to fingerprint a person under this section must inform the person in language likely to be understood by him or her—
- (a) of the purpose for which the fingerprints are required; and
 - (b) of the offence which the person is believed to have committed or with which the person has been charged or for which the person has been summonsed to answer to a charge; and
 - (c) that the fingerprints may be used in evidence in court; and
 - (d) that if the person refuses to give his or her fingerprints voluntarily, a police officer may use reasonable force to obtain them; and
 - (e) that if the person is not charged with a relevant offence within 6 months or is so charged but the charge is not proceeded with or the person is not found guilty of the offence or any other relevant offence before the end of that period, the fingerprints will be destroyed; and
 - (f) that if the person is or has been fingerprinted under this Subdivision on another occasion, section 464O(3A) may apply to the collective destruction of the person's fingerprints; and
 - (g) that the fingerprints may not be destroyed if the person dies before the fingerprints are required to be destroyed; and
 - (h) that the fingerprints may be used for the purposes specified in section 464NB.

S. 464K(2) amended by No. 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.22(a)).

S. 464K(2)(d) amended by No. 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.22(a)).

S. 464K(2)(e) amended by No. 44/2022 s. 80(1).

S. 464K(2)(f) inserted by No. 44/2022 s. 80(2).

S. 464K(2)(g) inserted by No. 44/2022 s. 80(2).

S. 464K(2)(h) inserted by No. 44/2022 s. 80(2).

S. 464K(3)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.22(a)).

- (3) Subject to subsection (4), the police officer who informs a person of the matters in subsection (2) must—

S. 464K(3)(a)
substituted by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(9).

- (a) record (whether by audio recording or audiovisual recording); or
(b) record in writing signed by the person—the giving of that information and the person's responses, if any.

S. 464K(4)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(10).

- (4) If a person is in custody within the meaning of this Subdivision in relation to an indictable offence, the giving of the information under subsection (2) and the person's responses, if any, must be recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording.

S. 464K(5)
amended by
Nos 27/2006
s. 17(11)(a),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.22(a)).

- (5) If information and a person's responses are recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording in accordance with this section, the police officer giving the information must give or send by post to the person or his or her legal practitioner without charge—

S. 464K(5)(a)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(11)(b).

- (a) the recording (whether audio recording or audiovisual recording) or a copy of it within 7 days; and

S. 464K(5)(b)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(11)(c).

- (b) if a transcript of the recording is prepared, a copy of the transcript as soon as practicable.

S. 464K(6)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.22(b)).

- (6) If information and a person's responses are recorded in writing in accordance with this section, the police officer requesting the person's fingerprints must give to the person, or cause the person to be given, a copy of the signed record forthwith.

- (7) A police officer may use reasonable force to take the fingerprints of a person referred to in subsection (1) who refuses to give them voluntarily if the use of reasonable force is authorised by a police officer in charge of a police station at the time of the request or a police officer of or above the rank of sergeant. **S. 464K(7) amended by No. 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.22(c)).**
- (8) If the person from whom fingerprints are required is a child aged 15, 16 or 17 years— **S. 464K(8) amended by No. 72/2004 s. 28.**
- (a) a parent or guardian of the child or, if a parent or guardian cannot be located, an independent person must be present during the request for the fingerprints, the giving of the information referred to in subsection (2) and the taking of the fingerprints; and
- (b) if the use of reasonable force has been authorised in accordance with subsection (7), the taking of the fingerprints must be recorded by audiovisual recording, if practicable, or by audio recording. **S. 464K(8)(b) amended by No. 27/2006 s. 17(12).**

464L Fingerprinting of children aged 14 or under

S. 464L inserted by No. 38/1988 s. 4, amended by No. 23/1991 s. 5(a)(b), substituted by No. 129/1993 s. 7.

- (1) A police officer must not do any of the following in respect of a child who was under 12 years of age at the time that the child is alleged to have done any act or made any omission which would constitute an offence if the child had been of the age of criminal responsibility— **S. 464L(1) substituted by No. 32/2024 s. 805(1).**
- (a) request the child to give the child's fingerprints;
- (b) take fingerprints from the child;

- (c) cause any other person to take fingerprints from the child.

Note

It is conclusively presumed that a child who is under 12 years of age cannot commit an offence—see section 10 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**.

- (a) be requested to give his or her fingerprints;
or
- (b) have his or her fingerprints taken.

S. 464L(2)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.23(a)),
32/2024
s. 805(2).

- (2) A police officer may take, or cause to be taken by an authorised person, the fingerprints of a child who is 12 years of age or over but under 15 years of age and who—

- (a) is believed on reasonable grounds to have committed; or
- (b) has been charged with; or
- (c) has been summonsed to answer to a charge for—

an indictable offence or a summary offence referred to in Schedule 7 if—

- (d) both the child and a parent or guardian of the child consent; or
- (e) where consent is refused or the parent or guardian cannot be located, the Children's Court makes an order under section 464M(5).

S. 464L(3)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.23(a)).

- (3) A police officer wishing to fingerprint a child referred to in subsection (2) must inform the child and the parent or guardian of the child in language likely to be understood by each of them—

- (a) of the purpose for which the fingerprints are required; and

- (b) of the offence which the child is believed to have committed or with which the child has been charged or for which the child has been summonsed to answer to a charge; and
- (c) that the fingerprints may be used in evidence in court; and
- (d) that the child, or the child's parent or guardian, may refuse consent to the child's fingerprints being taken; and S. 464L(3)(d) amended by No. 44/2022 s. 81(1).
- (e) that if consent is refused, an application may be made to the Children's Court for an order directing the child to give the child's fingerprints; and S. 464L(3)(e) amended by No. 32/2024 s. 805(3).
- (f) that if the child is not charged with a relevant offence within 6 months or is so charged but the charge is not proceeded with or the child is not found guilty of the offence or any other relevant offence before the end of that period, the fingerprints will be destroyed; and S. 464L(3)(f) amended by No. 44/2022 s. 81(2).
- (g) that if the child is or has been fingerprinted under this Subdivision on another occasion, section 464O(3A) may apply to the collective destruction of the child's fingerprints; and S. 464L(3)(g) inserted by No. 44/2022 s. 81(3).
- (h) that the fingerprints may not be destroyed if the child dies before the fingerprints are required to be destroyed; and S. 464L(3)(h) inserted by No. 44/2022 s. 81(3).
- (i) that the fingerprints may be used for the purposes specified in section 464NB. S. 464L(3)(i) inserted by No. 44/2022 s. 81(3).

S. 464L(5)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.23(a)).

- (4) A parent or guardian of a child must be present during the request for the fingerprints under this section, the giving of the information referred to in subsection (3) and the taking of the fingerprints with consent.
- (5) Subject to subsection (6), the police officer who informs a child of the matters in subsection (3) must—

S. 464L(5)(a)
substituted by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(13).

- (a) record by audio recording or audiovisual recording; or

- (b) record in writing signed by the child and the parent or guardian present—

the giving of that information and the responses, if any, of the child and the parent or guardian.

S. 464L(6)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(14).

- (6) If a child is in custody within the meaning of this Subdivision in relation to an indictable offence, the giving of the information under subsection (3) and the responses, if any, of the child and the parent or guardian must be recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording.

S. 464L(7)
amended by
Nos 27/2006
s. 17(15)(a),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.23(a)),
32/2024
s. 805(3).

- (7) If information and the responses of the child and parent or guardian are recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording, the police officer giving the information must give or send by post to the child or the child's legal practitioner without charge—

S. 464L(7)(a)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(15)(b).

- (a) the recording (whether audio recording or audiovisual recording) or a copy of it within 7 days; and

S. 464L(7)(b)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(15)(c).

- (b) if a transcript of the recording is prepared, a copy of the transcript as soon as practicable.

- (8) If information and the responses of the child and parent or guardian are recorded in writing, the police officer requesting the child's fingerprints must give to the child, or cause the child to be given, a copy of the signed record forthwith.

S. 464L(8)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.23(b)).

464M Children's Court may order fingerprinting

S. 464M
inserted by
No. 38/1988
s. 4,
amended by
Nos 25/1989
s. 14(b),
57/1989
s. 5(1)(d)(e),
23/1991
s. 6(1),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

- (1) If a child referred to in section 464L(2) or the child's parent or guardian refuses to consent to the taking of the child's fingerprints or the parent or guardian cannot be located, a police officer may apply to the Children's Court for an order under subsection (5).

S. 464M(1)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.24),
32/2024
s. 806(1).

- (2) An application under subsection (1)—

- (a) must be in writing supported by evidence on oath or by affirmation or by affidavit; and

S. 464M(2)(a)
amended by
No. 6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.3).

- (b) if the child is held in a police gaol or is detained in a youth residential centre, must state that fact.

- (3) Notice of an application under subsection (1) must be served on—

- (a) a parent or guardian of the child; and
(b) if the child is not in custody within the meaning of this Subdivision, the child.

S. 464M(5)
amended by
No. 32/2024
s. 806(2).

- (4) The court may dispense with the requirement of subsection (3)(a) if satisfied that it is impracticable for the applicant to comply.
- (5) The Children's Court may make an order directing a child who is 12 years of age or over but under 15 years of age to give the child's fingerprints if satisfied on the balance of probabilities that—
 - (a) there are reasonable grounds to believe that the child has committed an indictable offence or a summary offence referred to in Schedule 7; and
 - (b) in all the circumstances the making of the order is justified.
- (6) In considering whether the making of the order is justified, the court must take into account amongst other things—
 - (a) the seriousness of the circumstances surrounding the commission of the offence; and
 - (b) the alleged degree of participation by the child in the commission of the offence; and
 - (c) the age of the child.
- (7) A child in respect of whom an application under subsection (1) is made—
 - (a) is not a party to the application; and
 - (b) may not call or cross-examine any witnesses; and
 - (c) may not address the court, other than in respect of any matter referred to in subsection (5)(a) or (b) or subsection (6).
- (8) In exercising the right of address under subsection (7)(c), a child may be represented by a legal practitioner or, with the leave of the court, a parent or guardian of the child.

S. 464M(8)
amended by
No. 35/1996
s. 453(Sch. 1
item 16.17).

- (9) If the court makes an order under subsection (5)—
- (a) a parent or guardian of the child or, if a parent or guardian cannot be located, an independent person must be present during the taking of the child's fingerprints; and
 - (b) a police officer may use reasonable force to take the fingerprints; and S. 464M(9)(b) amended by No. 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.24).
 - (c) the taking of the fingerprints must be recorded by audiovisual recording, if practicable, or otherwise by audio recording. S. 464M(9)(c) amended by No. 27/2006 s. 17(16).
- (10) After an order under subsection (5) is executed—
- (a) the independent person, if any, who witnessed the taking of the fingerprints must endorse on the order the independent person's name and sign the endorsement; and S. 464M(10)(a) amended by No. 32/2024 s. 806(3).
 - (b) the person who took the fingerprints must endorse on the order the name of the person, if any, who made the audiovisual recording of the taking of the fingerprints; and S. 464M(10)(b) amended by No. 27/2006 s. 17(17).
 - (c) the person who took the fingerprints must give a copy of the order so endorsed to the child.
- (11) The endorsements required by subsection (10) to be made on an order under subsection (5) may be made on a copy of the order transmitted by facsimile machine.
- (12) If the Children's Court makes an order under subsection (5), it may issue a warrant authorising the person to whom it is directed—
- (a) to break, enter and search, if necessary, any place where the child named or described in the warrant is suspected to be; and

- (b) to arrest the child named or described in the warrant; and
 - (c) to take the child without delay to the nearest accessible police station for fingerprinting.
- (13) If the Children's Court makes an order under subsection (5) or issues a warrant under subsection (12), it must—
 - (a) give reasons for its decision; and
 - (b) cause a note of the reasons to be entered in the records of the court.
- (14) The failure of the court to comply with subsection (13) does not invalidate any order made by it but constitutes non-compliance for the purposes of section 464Q(1)(a).
- (15) If a child is apprehended under a warrant issued under subsection (12), the warrant ceases to have effect immediately after the child's fingerprints have been taken.
- (16) If the Children's Court makes an order under subsection (5) in respect of a child who is held in a prison, police gaol, youth justice centre or youth residential centre, the court must also order that the officer in charge of the place at which the child is held must take the fingerprints of the child or cause them to be taken and must deliver the fingerprints to the applicant within a period of time specified in the order.

S. 464M(16)
amended by
No. 48/2006
s. 42(Sch.
item 9.3).

464N Taking of fingerprints

S. 464N
inserted by
No. 38/1988
s. 4,
amended by
Nos 25/1989
ss 11(d),
12(1)(2),
14(c)(d),
56/1989
s. 286(Sch. 2
items 7.8–
7.10),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

- (1) Fingerprints may be taken by means of a device to obtain a record of the fingerprints (a fingerscan) or by any other means.

S. 464N(1)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 4(1).

- (2) If—

S. 464N(2)
amended by
Nos 41/2004
s. 4(2),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.24).

- (a) fingerprints are to be taken in accordance with a court order; or
(b) reasonable force is to be used to take fingerprints—

a person of the same sex as the person to be fingerprinted must, if practicable, take the fingerprints and a police officer involved in investigating the offence for which the fingerprints are required must not, if practicable, take the fingerprints.

464NA Fingerscanning for identification purposes

S. 464NA
inserted by
No. 35/2002
s. 3.

* * * * *

S. 464NA(1)
repealed by
No. 41/2004
s. 5(1).

S. 464NA(2)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.25(a)),
59/2015
s. 26(1).

- (2) If a person of or above the age of 15 years—
- (a) has been charged with an indictable offence or a summary offence referred to in Schedule 7; and
 - (b) is present in a police station because of the charging or has been remanded in custody in relation to the charge—

a police officer may take, or cause to be taken by an authorised person, a fingerscan of the person for the purpose only of identifying the person.

S. 464NA(3)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.25(a)),
59/2015
s. 26(2).

- (3) A police officer intending to fingerscan a person under this section must inform the person, in language likely to be understood by the person, that the fingerscan—
- (a) is to be taken only for the purpose of identifying the person; and
 - (b) is inadmissible as evidence.

S. 464NA(4)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.25
(b)(i)).

- (4) A police officer may use reasonable force to take the fingerscan of a person referred to in subsection (2) who refuses to allow it to be taken voluntarily if—

S. 464NA(4)(a)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.25(b)(iii)),
20/2015 s. 49.

- (a) the use of reasonable force is authorised by a police officer in charge of a police station at the relevant time or a police officer of or above the rank of sergeant; and

S. 464NA(4)(b)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.25
(b)(i)).

- (b) before fingerscanning the person, the police officer informs the person, in language likely to be understood by the person, that reasonable force may be used to obtain it.
- (5) A person of the same sex as the person to be fingerscanned must, if practicable, take the fingerscan.

- (6) A fingerscan taken under this section is inadmissible as evidence in any proceeding.

S. 464NA(6)
amended by
No. 41/2004
s. 5(2).

- (7) A fingerscan taken under this section which is not required to be destroyed under section 464O may be recorded on a computerised database and may be accessed, disclosed, communicated or made use of by a person for the performance of official duties if the recording, accessing, disclosing, communicating or making use of fingerscans on that database by that person, or a person belonging to a class of persons, for that purpose is authorised in writing by the Chief Commissioner of Police.

S. 464NA(7)
amended by
No. 41/2004
s. 5(3).

464NB Other purposes for the use or disclosure of fingerprint information

S. 464NB
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 82.

- (1) Fingerprints taken in accordance with this Subdivision and any record, copy or photograph of them may be used by a person authorised in writing by the Chief Commissioner of Police for any of the following purposes—
- (a) to identify a deceased person;
 - (b) to identify a person who has suffered a serious injury;
 - (c) to identify a deceased person in a coronial inquest or investigation.
- (2) The Chief Commissioner of Police may disclose the identity of a person who is identified through the use of fingerprints under subsection (1) to a coroner.
- (3) The Chief Commissioner of Police may disclose the identity of a person who is identified through the use of fingerprints for the purposes of subsection (1)(b) to a medical practitioner.

464O Destruction of records

S. 464O
inserted by
No. 38/1988
s. 4,
amended by
Nos 25/1989
s. 11(e),
56/1989
s. 286(Sch. 2
items 7.11–
7.13), 57/1989
s. 5(1)(f)(i)–(iii),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

(1) In this section—

S. 464O(1)
def. of
destroy
inserted by
No. 35/2002
s. 4.

destroy, in relation to a fingerscan, means
permanently de-identify information—

- (a) which identifies the person from whom
the fingerscan was taken; or
- (b) from which the person's identity may be
ascertained;

S. 464O(1)
def. of
fingerprints
inserted by
No. 35/2002
s. 4,
amended by
No. 41/2004
s. 6.

fingerprints includes fingerscan taken under
section 464NA or any other provision of this
Subdivision;

relevant offence means—

- (a) the offence in respect of which the
fingerprints were taken; or
- (b) any other offence arising out of the
same circumstances; or
- (c) any other offence in respect of which
the fingerprints have probative value.

(2) If a person has been fingerprinted in accordance with this Subdivision and—

S. 464O(2)
amended by
No. 44/2022
s. 83(1).

- (a) the person has not been charged with a relevant offence at the end of the period of 6 months after the taking of the fingerprints; or
- (b) the person has been so charged but the charge is not proceeded with or the person is not found guilty of the offence or any other relevant offence, whether on appeal or otherwise, before the end of that period—

the Chief Commissioner of Police must, subject to subsections (4) and (5A), destroy the fingerprints and any record, copy or photograph of them, or cause them to be destroyed at the time specified in subsection (3).

(3) For the purposes of subsection (2), fingerprints taken in accordance with this Subdivision and any record, copy or photograph of them must be destroyed—

- (a) where the person has not been so charged or the charge is not proceeded with, within one month after the period referred to in subsection (2)(a); or
- (b) where the person is not found guilty, within one month after the conclusion of the proceedings and the end of any appeal period.

S. 464O(3)(a)
amended by
Nos 44/2022
s. 83(2),
1/2026
s. 70(1).

S. 464O(3)(b)
amended by
No. 1/2026
s. 70(1).

(3A) Despite subsection (3), if a person has been fingerprinted in accordance with this Subdivision on more than one occasion, those fingerprints and each record, copy or photograph of the fingerprints must be collectively destroyed within one month of the date on which the person satisfies the criteria under subsection (2) in relation to all of those fingerprints.

S. 464O(3A)
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 83(3),
amended by
No. 1/2026
s. 70(2).

S. 464O(4)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.26).

(4) A police officer may, within the period referred to in subsection (3)(a) or (b) and on one occasion only, apply without notice to any other person to the Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case requires) for an order extending the period by not more than 6 months within which the fingerprints and any record, copy or photograph of them must be destroyed.

(5) If a court makes an order under subsection (4), it must cause a copy of the order to be served on the person from whom the fingerprints were taken.

S. 464O(5A)
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 83(4).

(5A) The Chief Commissioner of Police is not required to destroy or cause to be destroyed a person's fingerprints taken in accordance with this Subdivision or any record, copy or photograph of the fingerprints if—

(a) the person has had their fingerprints taken in accordance with this Subdivision on another occasion and those other fingerprints are not required to be destroyed under this section;
or

(b) the person to whom the fingerprints belong has died.

(6) If fingerprints or any record, copy or photograph of them are destroyed in accordance with this section, the Chief Commissioner of Police must give notice within 14 days of the destruction to the person from whom the fingerprints were taken.

(7) A person who—

- (a) fails to destroy; or
- (b) uses or makes, or causes or permits to be used or made—

any record, copy or photograph of fingerprints required by this section to be destroyed is guilty of a summary offence punishable on conviction by a level 10 fine (10 penalty units maximum).

S. 464O(7)
amended by
No. 69/1997
s. 22(14).

464P Records of juvenile

S. 464P
inserted by
No. 38/1988
s. 4,
amended by
No. 25/1989
s. 11(f),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

(1A) In this section, ***fingerprints*** includes fingerscan taken under section 464NA or any other provision of this Subdivision.

S. 464P(1A)
inserted by
No. 35/2002
s. 5,
amended by
No. 41/2004
s. 7.

(1) Subject to subsection (2), if—

- (a) a person is fingerprinted as a child in accordance with this Subdivision, whether before or after the commencement of section 7 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1993**; and
- (b) the fingerprints are not required to be destroyed under this Subdivision; and
- (c) the person is not found guilty of any further offence before attaining the age of 26 years; and

- (d) in the case of fingerprints taken before the commencement of section 7 of that Act, a request has been made to the Chief Commissioner of Police for their destruction—

the Chief Commissioner must without delay destroy the fingerprints and any record, copy or photograph of them, or cause them to be destroyed.

S. 464P(2)
amended by
Nos 77/2005
s. 8(3)(c),
7/2008
s. 7(3)(e),
63/2014
s. 3(4),
substituted by
No. 5/2018
s. 8.

- (2) Subsection (1) does not apply to fingerprints retained as a result of a finding of guilt of an offence if—

- (a) the offence is—

- (i) an offence against this Act; or
(ii) an offence at common law the maximum penalty for which is specified by this Act; and

- (b) the offence is punishable by level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum) or more (however the penalty is described).

S. 464Q
inserted by
No. 38/1988
s. 4,
amended by
Nos 25/1989
ss 11(g)(h),
13(a)(b),
56/1989
s. 286(Sch. 2
item 7.14),
57/1989
s. 5(1)(g)(i)(ii),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

464Q Evidence of fingerprints

- (1) Evidence in respect of fingerprints taken from a person is inadmissible as part of the prosecution case in proceedings against that person for an offence if—

- (a) the requirements of sections 464K to 464N have not been complied with; or
(b) the fingerprints or any record, copy or photograph of them should have been but have not been destroyed as required by section 464O or 464P.

- (2) A court may admit evidence in respect of fingerprints otherwise inadmissible by reason of subsection (1)(a) if—
- (a) the prosecution satisfies the court on the balance of probabilities that the circumstances are exceptional and justify the reception of the evidence; or
 - (b) the accused consents to the reception of the evidence.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (2)(a), the probative value of the fingerprints is not to be regarded as an exceptional circumstance.

Forensic procedures and DNA profile samples

Heading
preceding
s. 464R
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 4(b),
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 53.

464R Forensic procedure on adult

S. 464R
inserted by
No. 38/1988
s. 4,
amended by
Nos 56/1989
s. 286(Sch. 2
item 7.15),
57/1989
s. 5(1)(h),
49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 70),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

- (1) A police officer may request a suspect to undergo a forensic procedure only if there are reasonable grounds to believe that the procedure would tend to confirm or disprove the involvement of the

S. 464R(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.26).

suspect in the commission of an indictable offence and the suspect—

- (a) is suspected on reasonable grounds of having committed the indictable offence; or
- (b) has been charged with the indictable offence; or
- (c) has been summonsed to answer to a charge for the indictable offence.

(2) A forensic procedure may be conducted on a suspect if—

- (a) the suspect gives his or her informed consent; or
- (b) the Magistrates' Court makes an order under section 464T(3) or 464V(5); or
- (c) a senior police officer gives an authorisation under section 464SA.

S. 464R(2)(b)
amended by
No. 41/2004
s. 10(a).

S. 464R(2)(c)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 10(b).

S. 464S
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
amended by
No. 84/1989
s. 7(a)(b),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

464S Informed consent³²

S. 464S(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.26).

- (1) A person gives informed consent to a request to undergo a forensic procedure if he or she consents to the request after a police officer informs the person in language likely to be understood by the person—
 - (a) of the purpose for which the procedure is required; and
 - (b) of the nature of the procedure sought to be conducted; and

- (c) that the person may request that the procedure be conducted by or in the presence of a medical practitioner or nurse or midwife of his or her choice or, where the procedure is the taking of a dental impression, a dentist of his or her choice; and S. 464S(1)(c) amended by Nos 81/1997 s. 19(1), 13/2010 s. 51(Sch. item 17.4).
- (d) of the offence which the person is suspected of having committed or with which the person has been charged or for which the person has been summonsed to answer to a charge; and
- (e) that the procedure could produce evidence to be used in a court; and
- (ea) that information obtained from analysis of forensic material obtained by the procedure will be placed on a DNA database and may be used for the purpose of a criminal investigation or any other purpose for which the DNA database may be used under this Subdivision or under a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction; and S. 464S(1)(ea) inserted by No. 16/2002 s. 6.
- (f) that the person may refuse to undergo the procedure; and
- (g) where the sample or examination sought may be obtained by a compulsory procedure and the person refuses to undergo the procedure, that an application may be made to the Magistrates' Court for an order authorising the conduct of the procedure; and S. 464S(1)(g) amended by No. 41/2004 s. 11(a).
- (h) where the sample or examination sought may be obtained by a non-intimate compulsory procedure within the meaning of section 464SA and the person refuses to consent to the procedure, that a senior police officer may authorise the conduct of the procedure. S. 464S(1)(h) inserted by No. 41/2004 s. 11(b).

S. 464S(2)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.26).

- (2) A police officer who informs a person of the matters in subsection (1)—

S. 464S(2)(a)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(18)(a).

- (a) must record the giving of the information and the person's responses, if any, by audio recording or audiovisual recording or in writing signed by the person; and
- (b) must give or send by registered post to the person or his or her legal practitioner, without charge—

S. 464S(2)(b)(i)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(18)(b).

- (i) if the giving of the information and the responses are recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording, a copy of the recording as soon as practicable, but not more than 7 days after the information is given, and, if a transcript of the recording is prepared, a copy of the transcript as soon as practicable; and
- (ii) if the giving of the information and the responses are recorded in writing signed by the person, a copy of the record forthwith.

S. 464S(3)
amended by
No. 48/2006
s. 42(Sch.
item 9.3),
substituted by
No. 3/2019
s. 54.

- (3) A person is taken as having refused consent if—
- (a) the person is—
- (i) held in a prison, police gaol or youth justice centre; or
- (ii) a prisoner in a prison or a person detained in a police gaol who is transferred from the prison or police gaol to a facility or an institution referred to in section 56AB(1) of the **Corrections Act 1986**; and

- (b) within 24 hours after the giving of the information referred to in subsection (1) the person refuses or fails to consent to the request to undergo a forensic procedure.

464SA Senior police officer may authorise non-intimate compulsory procedure for certain adults

S. 464SA
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 12.

- (1) In this section and section 464SB, *non-intimate compulsory procedure* means the taking of a non-intimate sample or the conduct of a physical examination of a non-intimate part of the body.
- (2) A senior police officer who is not involved in investigating the offence for which the compulsory procedure is required may authorise the conduct of a non-intimate compulsory procedure on a person if the senior police officer is satisfied that—
- (a) the person is a relevant suspect who is—
- (i) under lawful arrest by warrant; or
- (ii) under lawful arrest under section 458 or 459 or a provision of any other Act; or
- (iii) in the custody of an investigating official in accordance with an order of the Magistrates' Court under section 464B(5) and, at the time of the application for that order, the person was held in a prison or police gaol; and
- (b) the person is not under the age of 18 years; and
- (c) the person is not incapable of giving informed consent by reason of mental impairment; and

S. 464SA(2)(b)
amended by
No. 72/2004
s. 29.

- (d) the person has refused to give consent to a request under section 464R(1); and
 - (e) there are reasonable grounds to believe that the person has committed the offence in respect of which the authorisation is sought; and
 - (f) the requirements of section 464T(3)(c), (d), (e) and (f) are met; and
 - (g) in all the circumstances, the giving of the authorisation is justified.
- (3) A senior police officer must not give an authorisation for a compulsory procedure on a person if—
- (a) an application to a court for an order under this Subdivision in respect of that person has been made in relation to the same matter and on the same grounds but has been refused; or
 - (b) a previous application for an authorisation under this section in respect of that person has been considered in relation to the same matter and on the same grounds but has not been given.
- (4) An authorisation given in contravention of subsection (3) is void.
- (5) Nothing in subsection (3) prevents a later application for an order under this Subdivision or an authorisation under this section on different or further grounds.
- (6) An authorisation under this section may only be given to a police officer.

S. 464SA(6)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.26).

464SB Making or refusing authorisation

- (1) Before a senior police officer gives or refuses to give an authorisation under section 464SA, the senior police officer must allow the suspect or the suspect's legal practitioner, if any, a reasonable opportunity, if practicable in person, to inform the senior police officer whether there is any reason why the non-intimate compulsory procedure should not be conducted.
- (2) An authorisation under section 464SA must be made in writing signed by the senior police officer giving it and include—
 - (a) the date and time when the authorisation is given; and
 - (b) the grounds for giving the authorisation; and
 - (c) the type of sample or examination authorised.
- (3) The senior police officer must give, or cause another police officer to give, to the suspect a copy of the authorisation as soon as practicable after the authorisation is made and, in any event, before the conduct of the compulsory procedure.
- (4) Before the compulsory procedure is conducted, a police officer must inform the suspect orally and in person of the following—
 - (a) that an authorisation under section 464SA has been given; and
 - (b) the matters referred to in subsection (2)(a), (b) and (c); and
 - (c) that a police officer may use reasonable force to enable the compulsory procedure to be conducted; and

S. 464SB
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 12.

S. 464SB(3)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.26).

S. 464SB(4)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.26).

S. 464SB(4)(c)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.26).

(d) if the authorisation is to take a sample of hair, that the suspect may elect to provide instead a scraping taken by the suspect from his or her mouth, if it is considered appropriate to do so.

(5) The person who gives the information required to be given by subsection (4) must—

S. 464SB(5)(a)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(19)(a).

(a) record, or cause to be recorded, the giving of that information by audio recording or audiovisual recording; and

S. 464SB(5)(b)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(19)(b).

(b) give or send by registered post, or cause to be given or sent by registered post, to the suspect or his or her legal practitioner, without charge, a copy of the recording as soon as practicable, but not more than 7 days after the conduct of the compulsory procedure.

(6) If a senior police officer refuses to give an authorisation under section 464SA in respect of a suspect, the senior police officer must—

S. 464SB(6)(a)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.26).

(a) inform, or cause another police officer to inform, the suspect orally of the decision as soon as practicable after the refusal; and

(b) give written notice of the decision to the suspect within 7 days after the refusal.

S. 464SB(7)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.26).

(7) A failure of the senior police officer or a police officer to comply with this section does not invalidate any authorisation made by the senior police officer but constitutes non-compliance for the purposes of section 464ZE(1)(a).

464SC DNA profile sample from DNA person

**S. 464SC
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 55.**

- (1) A police officer may request a DNA person who is an adult to give a DNA profile sample only if the police officer is satisfied that the taking of the sample is justified in all of the circumstances, and the DNA person—
 - (a) is suspected on reasonable grounds of having committed the indictable offence; or
 - (b) has been charged with the indictable offence; or
 - (c) has been summonsed to answer to a charge for the indictable offence.
- (2) A police officer may request a DNA person who is a child to give a DNA profile sample only if the police officer is satisfied that the taking of the sample is justified in all of the circumstances, and the DNA person—
 - (a) is believed on reasonable grounds of having committed the DNA sample offence; or
 - (b) has been charged with the DNA sample offence; or
 - (c) has been summonsed to answer to a charge for the DNA sample offence.
- (3) A DNA profile sample may be taken from—
 - (a) a DNA person who is an adult if—
 - (i) the adult gives informed consent; or
 - (ii) a senior police officer gives an authorisation under section 464SE; or
 - (b) a DNA person who is a child if—
 - (i) the child and a parent or guardian of the child give informed consent; or

- (ii) a senior police officer gives
an authorisation under section 464SE.

S. 464SD
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 55.

464SD Informed consent—DNA person and their parent or guardian

- (1) In this section—

parent or guardian means a parent or guardian of
a DNA person who is a child.

- (2) A DNA person or a parent or guardian gives
informed consent to a request for the DNA person
to give a DNA profile sample if the DNA person
or the parent or guardian consents to the request
after a police officer informs the DNA person or
the parent or guardian in language likely to be
understood by the DNA person or the parent or
guardian—

- (a) of the purpose for which the sample is
required; and
- (b) of the nature of the procedure sought to be
conducted to take the sample; and
- (c) for a DNA person who is an adult, of the
indictable offence which the person is
suspected of having committed or with
which the person has been charged or for
which the person has been summonsed to
answer to a charge; and
- (d) for a DNA person who is a child, of the
DNA sample offence which the child is
believed on reasonable grounds of having
committed or with which the child has been
charged or for which the child has been
summonsed to answer to a charge; and
- (e) for a DNA person who is a child, that for the
child to give informed consent both the child
and the child's parent or guardian must
consent to the taking of the sample; and

- (f) that the taking of the sample could produce evidence to be used in a court; and
- (g) that information obtained from analysis of forensic material obtained by the taking of the sample will be placed on a DNA database and may be used for the purpose of a criminal investigation or any other purpose for which the DNA database may be used under this Subdivision or under a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction; and
- (h) that if a sample is taken from the DNA person and—
 - (i) the person has not been charged with an indictable offence or a DNA sample offence (as the case requires) at the end of 12 months after the taking of the sample; or
 - (ii) the person has been so charged but the charge is not proceeded with or the DNA person is not found guilty of the offence whether on appeal or otherwise before the end of that period—the sample taken will be destroyed; and
- (i) that the DNA person or the parent or guardian may refuse to consent to the taking of the sample; and
- (j) that if the DNA person or the parent or guardian refuses to consent to the taking of the sample, that a senior police officer may authorise the taking of the sample.

- (3) A police officer who informs a DNA person or a parent or guardian of the matters in subsection (2)—
- (a) must record the giving of the information and the person's responses, if any, by audio recording or audiovisual recording or in writing signed by the person; and
 - (b) must give or send by registered post to the person or the person's legal practitioner or the parent or guardian of the child if the child's legal practitioner is not known, without charge—
 - (i) if the giving of the information and the responses are recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording, a copy of the recording as soon as practicable, but not more than 7 days after the information is given, and, if a transcript of the recording is prepared, a copy of the transcript as soon as practicable; and
 - (ii) if the giving of the information and the responses are recorded in writing signed by the person, a copy of the record as soon as practicable.
- (4) A DNA person is taken as having refused consent if—
- (a) the DNA person is—
 - (i) held in a prison, police gaol or youth justice centre; or
 - (ii) a prisoner in a prison or a person detained in a police gaol who is transferred from the prison or police gaol to a facility or an institution referred to in section 56AB(1) of the **Corrections Act 1986**; and

(b) within 24 hours after the giving of the information referred to in subsection (2) the DNA person fails to consent to the request to take the sample.

(5) A parent or guardian is taken as having refused consent if the parent or guardian is not capable of giving informed consent by reason of mental impairment.

464SE Senior police officer may authorise the taking of a DNA profile sample from DNA person

**S. 464SE
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 55.**

(1) A senior police officer who is not involved in investigating the offence for which the taking of a sample is required may authorise the taking of a DNA profile sample from a DNA person if the senior police officer is satisfied that—

- (a) the person is a DNA person who is—
 - (i) under lawful arrest by warrant; or
 - (ii) under lawful arrest under section 458 or 459 or a provision of any other Act; or
 - (iii) in the custody of an investigating official in accordance with an order of the Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case requires) under section 464B(5) and, at the time of the application for that order, the person was held in a prison or police gaol; and
- (b) the person is not incapable of giving informed consent by reason of mental impairment; and
- (c) for a DNA person who is an adult, the person has refused to give consent to a request under section 464SC(1); and

- (d) for a DNA person who is a child, both the child and the child's parent or guardian have refused to give consent to a request under section 464SC(2); and
 - (e) for a DNA person who is an adult, there are reasonable grounds to believe the person has committed the indictable offence in respect of which the authorisation is sought; and
 - (f) for a DNA person who is a child, the person is believed on reasonable grounds of having committed the DNA sample offence in respect of which the authorisation is sought; and
 - (g) the taking of the sample without the consent of the person is justified in all of the circumstances.
- (2) A senior police officer must not give an authorisation for the taking of a DNA profile sample from a DNA person if—
- (a) an application to a court for an order under section 464T, 464U or 464V in respect of that person has been made in relation to the same matter and on the same grounds but has been refused; or
 - (b) a previous application for an authorisation under this section in respect of that person has been considered in relation to the same matter and on the same grounds but has not been given.
- (3) An authorisation given in contravention of subsection (2) is void.
- (4) Nothing in subsection (2) prevents a later application for an order under section 464T, 464U or 464V or an authorisation under this section on different or further grounds.

- (5) An authorisation under this section must be given to a police officer.

464SF Making or refusing authorisation—DNA profile sample

S. 464SF
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 55.

- (1) Before a senior police officer gives or refuses to give an authorisation under section 464SE, the senior police officer must allow a reasonable opportunity, if practicable in person, for the following persons to inform the senior police officer whether there is any reason why the DNA profile sample should not be taken—
- (a) the DNA person;
 - (b) the parent or guardian of the DNA person if the DNA person is a child;
 - (c) the DNA person's legal practitioner, if any.
- (2) An authorisation under section 464SE must be given in writing, be signed by the senior police officer giving it and include—
- (a) the date and time when the authorisation is given; and
 - (b) the grounds for giving the authorisation.

Note

The **Electronic Transactions (Victoria) Act 2000** applies to enable an authorisation to be given electronically, including facsimile transmission and email, in accordance with that Act.

- (3) The senior police officer must give, or cause another police officer to give, to the DNA person a copy of the authorisation as soon as practicable after the authorisation is made and, in any event, before the taking of the DNA profile sample.

- (4) Before the DNA profile sample is taken, a police officer must inform the DNA person orally and in person of the following—
 - (a) that an authorisation under section 464SE has been given;
 - (b) the matters referred to in subsection (2)(a) and (b);
 - (c) that a police officer may use reasonable force to enable the DNA profile sample to be taken.
- (5) The person who gives the information required to be given by subsection (4) must—
 - (a) record, or cause to be recorded, the giving of that information by audio recording or audiovisual recording; and
 - (b) give or send by registered post, or cause to be given or sent by registered post without charge, a copy of the recording as soon as practicable, but not more than 7 days after the taking of the DNA profile sample to—
 - (i) the DNA person or their legal practitioner; or
 - (ii) the parent or guardian of a DNA person who is a child if the child's legal practitioner is not known.
- (6) If a senior police officer refuses to give an authorisation under section 464SE in respect of a DNA person, the senior police officer must—
 - (a) inform, or cause another police officer to inform, the DNA person orally of the decision as soon as practicable after the refusal; and

- (b) give written notice of the decision to the DNA person within 7 days after the refusal and to the parent or guardian of a DNA person who is a child.
- (7) A failure of the senior police officer or a police officer to comply with this section does not invalidate any authorisation made by the senior police officer but constitutes non-compliance for the purposes of section 464ZE(1)(a).

464T Court may order compulsory procedure

S. 464T
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
amended by
No. 84/1989
s. 7(c),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

- (1) If—
 - (a) a person refuses to undergo a forensic procedure after being requested to do so or is incapable of giving informed consent by reason of mental impairment; and
 - (b) the sample or examination sought may be obtained by a compulsory procedure; and
 - (c) the person is a relevant suspect³³; and
 - (d) a police officer believes on reasonable grounds that the person has committed the offence in respect of which the procedure was requested—

S. 464T(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.27(a)(ii)).

S. 464T(1)(d)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.27
(a)(i)).

the police officer may apply to the Magistrates' Court for an order directing the person to undergo the compulsory procedure.

S. 464T(2)(a)
amended by
No. 6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.3).

(2) An application under subsection (1)—

- (a) must be in writing supported by evidence on oath or by affirmation or by affidavit; and
- (b) if the person is a detained or protected person, must state that fact and identify the place where the person is held or resides; and
- (c) must specify the type of compulsory procedure sought to be conducted.

(3) The Court may make an order directing a person to undergo a compulsory procedure if the Court is satisfied on the balance of probabilities that—

S. 464T(3)(c)
amended by
No. 81/1997
s. 17(1).

- (a) the person is a relevant suspect; and
- (b) there are reasonable grounds to believe that the person has committed the offence in respect of which the application is made; and
- (c) in the case of an application for a sample other than one referred to in paragraph (d), any of the following applies—
 - (i) material reasonably believed to be from the body of a person who committed the offence has been found—
 - (A) at the scene of the offence; or
 - (B) on the victim of the offence or on anything reasonably believed to have been worn or carried by the victim when the offence was committed; or
 - (C) on an object or person reasonably believed to have been associated with the commission of the offence; or

- (ii) there are reasonable grounds to believe that, because of the nature of the offence or injuries inflicted during the commission of the offence, material from the body or clothing of the victim is present—
 - (A) on the person who committed the offence or on anything reasonably believed to have been worn or carried by that person when the offence was committed; or
 - (B) on an object reasonably believed to have been associated with the commission of the offence; or
- (iii) the victim of the offence has not been found, and there are reasonable grounds to believe that material reasonably believed to be from the body of the victim is present on a person suspected of having committed the offence; or
- (iv) the offence in respect of which the application is made is an offence against a provision of Subdivision (8A), (8B) or (8C) of Division 1 of Part I and there are reasonable grounds to believe that the conduct of the procedure on the person may be relevant in determining the paternity of a child that has been conceived allegedly as a result of the offence; and
- (d) in the case of an application to take a sample or washing from the skin to determine the presence of gunshot residue, a firearm was discharged during the commission of the offence; and

S. 464T(3)(c)
(ii)(B)
amended by
No. 81/1997
s. 17(2).

S. 464T(3)
(c)(iii)
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 17(3).

S. 464T(3)
(c)(iv)
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 17(3).

- (e) in the case of an application to conduct a physical examination, the person who committed the offence had distinguishing marks or injuries, whether acquired during the commission of the offence or otherwise; and
 - (f) there are reasonable grounds to believe that the conduct of the procedure on the person may tend to confirm or disprove his or her involvement in the commission of the offence; and
 - (g) the person has refused to give consent to a request under section 464R(1) or the person is incapable of giving informed consent by reason of mental impairment; and
 - (h) in all the circumstances, the making of the order is justified.
- (4) Except as provided for by section 464V(5A), the Magistrates' Court must not make an order directing a person to undergo a compulsory procedure unless the person is present in court or appearing by audio visual link.
- (5) A relevant suspect in respect of whom an application is made—
- (a) is not a party to the application; and
 - (b) may not call or cross-examine any witnesses; and
 - (c) may not address the Court, other than in respect of any matter referred to in subsection (3)(a) to (h).
- (6) In exercising the right of address under subsection (5)(c), a relevant suspect may be represented by a legal practitioner.

S. 464T(4)
substituted by
No. 55/2025
s. 12(1).

S. 464T(6)
amended by
No. 35/1996
s. 453(Sch. 1
item 16.17).

- (7) If the Magistrates' Court makes an order under subsection (3), it must—
- (a) give reasons for its decision; and
 - (b) state the evidence on which it is satisfied of the matters referred to in subsection (3); and
 - (c) cause a note of the reasons to be entered in the records of the Court; and
 - (d) inform the person ordered to undergo a compulsory procedure that a police officer may use reasonable force to enable the procedure to be conducted.
- S. 464T(7)(d)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.27(b)).
- (8) A failure of the Court to comply with subsection (7) does not invalidate any order made by it but constitutes non-compliance for the purposes of section 464ZE(1)(a).
- (9) If—
- S. 464T(9)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.27(b)).
- (a) a police officer proposes to make an application to the Magistrates' Court under subsection (1) in respect of a person; and
- S. 464T(9)(a)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.27(b)).
- (b) the person is a detained or protected person—
- the Court may, on the application of a police officer, issue a warrant directing the officer-in-charge of the place where the person is held to deliver the person into the custody of the applicant or another police officer for the purpose—
- (c) of attending the hearing of the application under subsection (1); and
 - (d) if that application is granted, of conducting the procedure on the person.

S. 464T(10)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.27(b)).

- (10) A police officer into whose custody the person is delivered under a warrant issued under subsection (9) must return the person to the officer-in-charge of the place where the person was held—
- (a) forthwith after the hearing of the application under subsection (1); or
 - (b) if the application is granted, within such period after the hearing of the application as reasonably permits the conduct of the procedure on the person.

S. 464T(11)
inserted by
No. 55/2025
s. 12(2).

- (11) If—
- (a) the Magistrates' Court grants an application under subsection (1) in respect of a detained or protected person; and
 - (b) that person appears by audio visual link at the hearing of the application—
- the Court may, on the application of a police officer, issue a warrant directing the officer in charge of the place where the person is held to deliver the person into the custody of the applicant or another police officer for the purpose of conducting the procedure on the person.

S. 464T(12)
inserted by
No. 55/2025
s. 12(2).

- (12) A police officer into whose custody the person is delivered under a warrant issued under subsection (11) must return the person to the officer in charge of the place where the person was held within such period after the person was delivered into the police officer's custody as reasonably permits the conduct of the procedure on the person.

464U Forensic procedure on child

S. 464U
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
amended by
Nos 84/1989
s. 7(d)–(h)
(i)(ii), 23/1991
s. 6(2)(3),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

- (1) A police officer must not do any of the following in respect of a child who was under 12 years of age at the time that the child is alleged to have done any act or made any omission which would constitute an offence if the child had been of the age of criminal responsibility—
- (a) request the child to undergo a forensic procedure;
 - (b) conduct a forensic procedure on the child;
 - (c) request any other person to conduct a compulsory procedure on the child.

S. 464U(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.28),
substituted by
No. 32/2024
s. 807(1).

Note

It is conclusively presumed that a child who is under 12 years of age cannot commit an offence—see section 10 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**.

- (2) A police officer must not request a child who is 12 years of age or over but under 18 years of age and who—
- (a) is suspected of having committed; or
 - (b) has been charged with; or
 - (c) has been summonsed to answer to a charge for—

S. 464U(2)
amended by
Nos 72/2004
s. 30(1),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.28),
32/2024
s. 807(2).

an offence, whether indictable or summary, to undergo a forensic procedure or request that a compulsory procedure be conducted on the child

unless the Children's Court has made an order under subsection (7) or section 464V(5).

S. 464U(3)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.28).

- (3) A police officer may apply to the Children's Court for an order under subsection (7) if the child—

S. 464U(3)(a)
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 18, 61/2001
s. 16(1)(b)(i),
16/2002
s. 17(2),
35/2002
s. 28(Sch.
item 3.2).

- (a) is suspected on reasonable grounds of having committed or attempted to commit an indictable offence against the person at common law or an indictable offence under Division 1 of Part I or under section 75, 75A, 76, 77, 197 (in circumstances where the offence is charged as arson), 197A, 249, 250, 251, 317, 317A or 318 or under section 71, 71AA, 72 or 72A of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981** or under section 71, 72(1)(ab) or 72(1)(b) of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981** as in force immediately before the commencement of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances (Amendment) Act 2001**; or

S. 464U(3)(b)
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 18, 61/2001
s. 16(1)(b)(ii),
16/2002
s. 17(2),
35/2002
s. 28(Sch.
item 3.2).

- (b) has been charged with an indictable offence against the person at common law or an indictable offence under Division 1 of Part I or under section 75, 75A, 76, 77, 197 (in circumstances where the offence is charged as arson), 197A, 249, 250, 251, 317, 317A or 318 or under section 71, 71AA, 72 or 72A of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981** or under section 71, 72(1)(ab) or 72(1)(b) of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981** as in force immediately before the commencement of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances (Amendment) Act 2001**.

(4) An application under subsection (3)—

- (a) must be in writing supported by evidence on oath or by affirmation or by affidavit; and

**S. 464U(4)(a)
amended by
No. 6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.3).**

- (b) if the child is a detained or protected person, must state that fact and identify the place where the child is held or resides; and

- (c) must specify the type of compulsory procedure sought to be conducted.

(5) Notice of an application under subsection (3) must be served on³⁴—

- (a) a parent or guardian of the child; and

- (b) if the child is not in custody within the meaning of this Subdivision, the child.

(6) The court may dispense with the requirement of subsection (5)(a) if satisfied that it is impracticable for the applicant to comply.

(7) The Children's Court may make an order directing a child who is 12 years of age or over but under 18 years of age to undergo a compulsory procedure if satisfied on the balance of probabilities that—

**S. 464U(7)
amended by
Nos 72/2004
s. 30(2),
32/2024
s. 807(3).**

- (a) the child is a person referred to in subsection (3)(a) or (b); and

- (b) there are reasonable grounds to believe that the child has committed the offence in respect of which the application is made; and

- (c) in the case of an application for a sample other than one referred to in paragraph (d), either—
 - (i) material reasonably believed to be from the body of a person who committed the offence has been found—
 - (A) at the scene of the offence; or
 - (B) on the victim of the offence or on anything reasonably believed to have been worn or carried by the victim when the offence was committed; or
 - (C) on an object or person reasonably believed to have been associated with the commission of the offence; or
 - (ii) there are reasonable grounds to believe that, because of the nature of the offence or injuries inflicted during the commission of the offence, material from the body or clothing of the victim is present—
 - (A) on the person who committed the offence or on anything reasonably believed to have been worn or carried by that person when the offence was committed; or
 - (B) on an object reasonably believed to have been associated with the commission of the offence; and
- (d) in the case of an application to take a sample or washing from the skin to determine the presence of gunshot residue, a firearm was discharged during the commission of the offence; and

- (e) in the case of an application to conduct a physical examination, the person who committed the offence had distinguishing marks or injuries, whether acquired during the commission of the offence or otherwise; and
 - (f) there are reasonable grounds to believe that the conduct of the procedure on the child may tend to confirm or disprove the child's involvement in the commission of the offence; and
 - (g) in all the circumstances, the making of the order is justified.
- (8) In considering whether the making of the order is justified, the court must take into account amongst other things—
- (a) the seriousness of the circumstances surrounding the commission of the offence; and
 - (b) the alleged degree of participation by the child in the commission of the offence; and
 - (c) the age of the child.
- (9) If the Children's Court makes an order under subsection (7), it must—
- (a) give reasons for its decision; and
 - (b) state the evidence on which it is satisfied of the matters referred to in subsection (7); and
 - (c) cause a note of the reasons to be entered in the records of the court; and
 - (d) inform the child ordered to undergo a compulsory procedure that a police officer may use reasonable force to enable the procedure to be conducted.

S. 464U(7)(f)
amended by
No. 32/2024
s. 807(4).

S. 464U(9)(d)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.28).

S. 46U(11)
substituted by
No. 55/2025
s. 13(1).

- (10) A failure of the court to comply with subsection (9) does not invalidate any order made by it but constitutes non-compliance for the purposes of section 464ZE(1)(a).
- (11) Except as provided for by section 464V(5A), the Children's Court must not make an order under subsection (7) unless—
- (a) the child is present in court; or
 - (b) the court directs that the child is permitted to appear by audio visual link and the child does so appear.
- (12) A child in respect of whom an application is made—
- (a) is not a party to the application; and
 - (b) may not call or cross-examine any witnesses; and
 - (c) may not address the court, other than in respect of any matter referred to in subsection (7)(a) to (g) or subsection (8).
- (13) In exercising the right of address under subsection (12)(c), a child may be represented by a legal practitioner or, with the leave of the court, a parent or guardian of the child.
- (14) The provisions of section 464T(9), (10), (11) and (12) apply as if—
- (a) a reference to an application to the Magistrates' Court under subsection (1) of that section were a reference to an application to the Children's Court under subsection (3) of this section; and
 - (b) a reference to the person were a reference to the child; and
 - (c) a reference to the Magistrates' Court were a reference to the Children's Court.

S. 464U(13)
amended by
No. 35/1996
s. 453(Sch. 1
item 16.17).

S. 46U(14)
amended by
No. 55/2025
s. 13(2).

464V Interim orders

- (1) This section does not apply to an application in respect of a blood sample.
- (2) A police officer may apply, with or without notice to any other person, for an interim order directing a person to undergo a compulsory procedure if the police officer believes on reasonable grounds that the sample or evidence sought to be obtained by the compulsory procedure is likely to be lost if the procedure is delayed until the final determination of the application.
- (3) Section 464T(1), (2), (5), (6), (7) and (8) or section 464U(3), (4), (9), (10), (12) and (13) as the case requires apply to applications for interim orders.
- (4) If a police officer believes on reasonable grounds that—
- (a) it is necessary to obtain an interim order; and
 - (b) the sample or evidence sought to be obtained by the compulsory procedure is likely to be lost if the making of an application for an interim order is delayed until the time when the application could be made in person—
- the police officer may apply for an interim order by audio link or audio visual link in accordance with the procedure in section 464W.

S. 464V
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
amended by
Nos 84/1989
ss 7(i)(j),
8(a)(i)–(iv),
23/1991
s. 7(1)(2),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

S. 464V(2)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.29(a)).

S. 464V(4)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.29(b)),
33/2018
s. 86(1).

(5) The court may make an interim order directing a person to undergo a compulsory procedure if—

(a) the court is satisfied that the sample or evidence sought to be obtained by the compulsory procedure is likely to be lost if the procedure is delayed until the final determination of the application; and

S. 464V(5)(b)
amended by
No. 6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.6).

(b) on the evidence, whether sworn or affirmed, or unsworn or not affirmed, before it at that time, it appears to the court that there may be sufficient evidence to satisfy it of the matters set out in section 464T(3) or 464U(7) (as the case requires); and

S. 464V(5)(c)
amended by
No. 33/2018
s. 86(2).

(c) on an application by audio link or audio visual link, the court is satisfied that the sample or evidence sought to be obtained by the compulsory procedure is likely to be lost if the making of the application is delayed until the time when the application could be made in person.

S. 464V(5A)
inserted by
No. 55/2025
s. 14(1).

(5A) The court may make the interim order in the absence of the person whom the order directs to undergo a procedure.

(6) If the court makes an interim order—

(a) it must adjourn the further hearing of the application to enable the compulsory procedure to be conducted; and

(b) section 464T or 464U (as the case requires) applies to the further hearing; and

S. 464V(6)(c)
amended by
No. 33/2018
s. 86(3),
repealed by
No. 55/2025
s. 14(2)(a).

* * * * *

- (d) in the case of an interim order made by the Magistrates' Court, the person on whom the compulsory procedure is conducted must—
- (i) be present in court for the further hearing; or
- (ii) appear at the further hearing by audio visual link; and
- (e) in the case of an interim order made by the Children's Court, the child on whom the compulsory procedure is conducted must—
- (i) be present in court for the further hearing; or
- (ii) if the court directs that the child is permitted to do so, appear at the further hearing by audio visual link.
- (7) On the further hearing of an application—
- (a) if the court is satisfied of the matters set out in section 464T(3) or 464U(7), it must, subject to subsections (7A) and (7B), confirm the order made under this section; or
- (b) if the court is not so satisfied, it must order the destruction of any sample taken and any other evidence obtained as a result of the compulsory procedure.
- (7A) The Magistrates' Court must not, under subsection (7)(a), confirm an order made under this section unless the person whom the order directs to undergo a procedure is present in court or appearing by audio visual link.
- (7B) The Children's Court must not, under subsection (7)(a), confirm an order made under this section unless—
- (a) the child whom the order directs to undergo a procedure is present in court; or

S. 464V(6)(d)
substituted by
No. 55/2025
s. 14(2)(b).³⁵

S. 464V(6)(e)
inserted by
No. 55/2025
s. 14(2)(b).

S. 464V(7)(b)
amended by
No. 55/2025
s. 14(3).

S. 464V(7A)
inserted by
No. 55/2025
s. 14(4).

S. 464V(7B)
inserted by
No. 55/2025
s. 14(4).

(b) the court directs that the child is permitted to appear by audio visual link and the child does so appear.

(8) A sample taken in accordance with an interim order must not be analysed before the final determination of the application.

S. 464W
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 33/2018
s. 87(1).

464W Application by audio link or audio visual link for interim order

S. 464W
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
amended by
Nos 84/1989
ss 7(k), 8(b),
8/1991
s. 22(1)(a)–(d),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

S. 464W(1)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.30(a)),
33/2018
s. 87(2).

(1) A police officer making an application by audio link or audio visual link for an interim order must make the application in accordance with this section.

S. 464W(2)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.30(b)),
6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.7).

(2) Before making the application, the police officer must prepare an affidavit setting out the grounds on which the order is sought, but may, if necessary, make the application before the affidavit has been sworn or affirmed.

S. 464W(3)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.30(b)),
6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.8),
33/2018
s. 87(3).

(3) If transmission by facsimile machine or other electronic communication is available, the police officer must transmit a copy of the affidavit, even if the affidavit is not sworn or affirmed, to the magistrate or Children's Court magistrate constituting the court that is to hear the application.

- (4) If the person the subject of the application is present with the applicant, the court must, if practicable, hear the person on any matter referred to in section 464T(3)(a) to (h), in the case of a relevant suspect, or section 464U(7)(a) to (g) and section 464U(8), in the case of a child.
- (5) If the court makes an interim order on an application made by audio link or audio visual link, the court must inform the applicant of the terms of the order, the date on which and the time at which it was made, and the date on which and the venue of the court at which the further hearing of the application will take place. **S. 464W(5) amended by No. 33/2018 s. 87(4).**
- (6) If transmission by facsimile machine or other electronic communication is available, the court must transmit a copy of its order to the applicant. **S. 464W(6) amended by No. 33/2018 s. 87(5).**
- (7) A failure of the court to comply with subsection (4), (5) or (6) does not invalidate any order made by it but constitutes non-compliance for the purposes of section 464ZE(1)(a).
- (8) If an interim order is made on an application made by audio link or audio visual link, the applicant must— **S. 464W(8) amended by No. 33/2018 s. 87(6)(a).**
- (a) if a copy of the order has not been transmitted by facsimile machine or other electronic communication, complete a form of order in the terms indicated by the court under subsection (5) and must write on it the name of the magistrate or Children's Court magistrate who constituted the court that made the order and the date on which and the time at which it was made; and **S. 464W(8)(a) amended by No. 33/2018 s. 87(6)(b).**

S. 464W(8)(b)
amended by
No. 33/2018
s. 87(6)(b).

(b) if a copy of the order has been transmitted by facsimile machine or other electronic communication, serve a copy of the order on the person ordered to undergo the compulsory procedure; and

(c) inform the person ordered to undergo the compulsory procedure—

(i) of the terms of the order; and

S. 464W(8)
(c)(ii)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.30(c)).

(ii) that a police officer may use reasonable force to enable the procedure to be conducted; and

S. 464W(8)(d)
substituted by
No. 55/2025
s. 15(1).

(d) give notice in writing to the person ordered to undergo the compulsory procedure—

(i) of the date on which the further hearing of the application will take place; and

(ii) of the venue of the court at which that hearing will take place; and

(iii) of the requirements under section 464V(6)(d) or (e) (as the case requires) for the person's presence or appearance at that hearing; and

(e) not later than the day following the making of the order, send the form of order, if any, completed by the applicant to the magistrate or Children's Court magistrate who constituted the court that made the order.

S. 464W(9)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.30(c)).

(9) A police officer who informs a person of the matters in subsection (8)(c)—

S. 464W(9)(a)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(20)(a).

(a) must record the giving of the information by audio recording or audiovisual recording or in writing signed by the person; and

- (b) must give or send by registered post to the person or his or her legal practitioner, without charge—
- (i) if the giving of the information is recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording, a copy of the recording as soon as practicable but not more than 7 days after the information is given, and, if a transcript of the recording is prepared, a copy of the transcript as soon as practicable; and
- (ii) if the giving of the information is recorded in writing, a copy of the record forthwith.
- (10) If an application is made by audio link or audio visual link, whether or not an interim order is made, the applicant must, not later than the day following the making of the application, send the affidavit duly sworn or affirmed to the magistrate or Children's Court magistrate who constituted the court that heard the application.

S. 464W(9)
(b)(i)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(20)(b).

S. 464W(10)
amended by
Nos 6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.9),
33/2018
s. 87(7).

* * * * *

S. 464W
(11)(12)
inserted by
No. 33/2018
s. 87(8),
repealed by
No. 55/2025
s. 15(2).

**464WA Part IIA of the Evidence (Miscellaneous Provisions)
Act 1958 is not engaged**

S. 464WA
inserted by
No. 55/2025
s. 16.

- (1) In sections 464T, 464U, 464V and 464W, *audio link* and *audio visual link* each has the meaning given by Part IIA of the **Evidence (Miscellaneous Provisions) Act 1958**.
- (2) Nothing in section 464T, 464U, 464V or 464W engages the provisions of Part IIA of the **Evidence (Miscellaneous Provisions) Act 1958** except as provided for by subsection (1).

464X Warrants

S. 464X
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

- (1) If an application is made to³⁶—
 - (a) the Magistrates' Court under section 464T(1) or 464V(2); or
 - (b) the Children's Court under section 464U(3) or 464V(2)—and the person in respect of whom the application is made is not a detained or protected person, the court may issue a warrant authorising the person to whom it is directed, if necessary—
 - (c) to break, enter and search by day or by night any place where the person named in the warrant is suspected to be; and
 - (d) to arrest the person; and
 - (e) to bring the person before the court for the hearing of the application, including any further hearing of the application that is required by section 464V(6); and
 - (f) other than where the person is brought before the court for a further hearing required by section 464V(6), to detain the person, if the application is granted, for so long as reasonably permits the conduct of the compulsory procedure.
- (2) If a court issues a warrant under subsection (1) it must—
 - (a) give reasons for its decision; and
 - (b) cause a note of the reasons to be entered in the records of the court.
- (3) A failure of a court to comply with subsection (2) does not invalidate any order made by it but constitutes non-compliance for the purposes of section 464ZE(1)(a).

S. 464X(1)(e)
substituted by
No. 55/2025
s. 17(1).

S. 464X(1)(f)
substituted by
No. 55/2025
s. 17(1).

- (4) If a person is apprehended under a warrant issued under subsection (1) in respect of a hearing other than a further hearing required by section 464V(6), the warrant ceases to have effect immediately after the procedure is completed or on the expiration of a reasonable time (whichever is the earlier).
- (5) If a person is apprehended under a warrant issued under subsection (1) in respect of a further hearing required by section 464V(6), the warrant ceases to have effect immediately after the expiry of a reasonable time

S. 464X(4)
amended by
No. 55/2025
s. 17(2).

S. 464X(5)
inserted by
No. 55/2025
s. 17(3).

464Y Caution before forensic procedure or taking of a DNA profile sample

S. 464Y
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 56(1).

S. 464Y
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
amended by
No. 84/1989
s. 8(c),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

- (1) Immediately before a DNA profile sample is taken in accordance with section 464SC, 464SE, 464ZFAC or 464ZFAC or 464ZFAC or a forensic procedure is conducted in accordance with sections 464R to 464ZA or section 464ZF or 464ZFAC (as the case may be), a police officer must inform the person on whom the procedure is to be conducted that he or she does not have to answer any questions asked by the registered medical practitioner, nurse, midwife or other person taking the sample or conducting the procedure but that anything the person does say may be given in evidence.

S. 464Y(1)
amended by
Nos 23/1994
s. 118(Sch. 1
item 15.7),
81/1997
s. 20(a)(b),
27/2006 s. 5,
13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.5),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.31),
3/2019
s. 56(2).

S. 464Y(2)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.31).

- (2) A police officer who informs a person of the matters in subsection (1)—

S. 464Y(2)(a)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(21)(a).

- (a) must record the giving of the information and the person's responses, if any, by audio recording or audiovisual recording or in writing signed by the person or, if the person refuses to sign, by an independent person, if present; and

S. 464Y(2)(b)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 56(3).

- (b) must give or send by registered post to the person or his or her legal practitioner or the parent or guardian of a DNA person who is a child if the child's legal practitioner is not known, without charge—

S. 464Y(2)(b)(i)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(21)(b).

- (i) if the giving of the information and the responses are recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording, a copy of the recording as soon as practicable but not more than 7 days after the information is given, and, if a transcript of the recording is prepared, a copy of the transcript as soon as practicable; and

- (ii) if the giving of the information and the responses are recorded in writing, a copy of the record forthwith.

S. 464Z
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

464Z Procedure for taking samples etc.

S. 464Z(1)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 57(1).

- (1) The Chief Commissioner of Police may authorise a person or a class of persons to take non-intimate samples or to conduct physical examinations of a

non-intimate part of the body for the purposes of this Subdivision.

- (1A) The Chief Commissioner of Police may authorise a police officer or police custody officer, or a class of police officers or police custody officers, to supervise for the purposes of subsection (3A) or (3AC)—
- (a) the taking of scrapings from the mouth; or
 - (b) the taking of a DNA profile sample that is a scraping from the mouth.
- (2) The Chief Commissioner must give a copy of an authority under subsection (1) or (1A) to the Minister who must cause it to be laid before the Legislative Council and the Legislative Assembly before the expiration of the seventh sitting day of the Council or the Assembly, as the case may be, after it has been received by the Minister.
- (2A) The taking of a DNA profile sample or the conduct of a forensic procedure in accordance with this Subdivision, must be taken or conducted by the least intrusive and least painful method practicable in the circumstances.
- (3) For the purposes of a forensic procedure under this Subdivision—
- (a) an intimate sample (other than a dental impression) or a physical examination of an intimate part of the body may only be taken or conducted by a medical practitioner or nurse or midwife of the same sex, if practicable, as the person from whom the sample is to be taken or who is to be examined;
 - (b) a dental impression may only be taken by a dentist;

S. 464Z(1A)
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 7(1),
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.32(a)),
59/2015
s. 27(1),
substituted by
No. 3/2019
s. 57(2).

S. 464Z(2)
amended by
No. 16/2002
s. 7(2).

S. 464Z(2A)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 57(3).

S. 464Z(3)(a)
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 19(2),
13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.6(a)).

S. 464Z(3)(c)
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 19(2),
16/2002
s. 7(3),
13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.6(b)).

- (c) a non-intimate sample or a physical examination of a non-intimate part of the body may be taken or conducted by a medical practitioner or nurse, or midwife or a person authorised in accordance with subsection (1).

S.
464Z(3AAA)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 57(4).

(3AAA) For the purposes of a DNA profile sample taken in accordance with this Subdivision—

- (a) a sample may only be taken by a medical practitioner or nurse of the same sex, if practicable, as the person from whom the sample is to be taken; and
- (b) if the sample is to be taken from a child the sample must be taken in the presence of a parent or guardian of the child or, if a parent or guardian cannot be located, an independent person of the same sex, if practicable, as the child.

S. 464Z(3AA)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 13(1),
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.32(b)).

(3AA) Despite subsection (3), a person from whom a sample of hair, other than pubic hair, is to be taken in accordance with—

- (a) an authorisation given under section 464SA;
or
- (b) an order made by a court under this Subdivision—

may elect to provide instead a scraping taken by the person from his or her mouth if a police officer authorised in accordance with subsection (1A) considers that—

- (c) a scraping is appropriate in the circumstances; and
- (d) it is appropriate for the person to take the scraping.

- | | |
|--|--|
| (3AB) An election made by a person under subsection (3AA) must be recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording or in writing signed by the person. | S. 464Z(3AB)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 13(1),
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(22). |
| (3AC) Despite subsection (3AAA), a person from whom a DNA profile sample is to be taken in accordance with this Subdivision may elect to provide instead a scraping taken by the person from their mouth if a police officer authorised in accordance with subsection (1A) considers that it is appropriate for the person to take the scraping. | S. 464Z(3AC)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 57(5). |
| (3AD) An election made by a person under subsection (3AC) must be recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording or in writing signed by the person. | S. 464Z(3AD)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 57(5). |
| (3A) Nothing in subsection (3) or (3AAA) prevents a person from whom a scraping from the mouth is to be taken from taking the scraping himself or herself under the supervision of a police officer or police custody officer authorised in accordance with subsection (1A) if— | S. 464Z(3A)
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 7(4),
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.32(c)(i)),
59/2015
s. 27(2),
3/2019
s. 57(6). |
| (a) the police officer or police custody officer considers it appropriate for the person to do so; and | S. 464Z(3A)(a)
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.32(c)(ii)),
59/2015
s. 27(2). |
| (b) the person consents to taking the scraping and the consent is recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording or in writing signed by the person. | S. 464Z(3A)(b)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(23). |

S. 464Z(3B)
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 7(4),
amended by
Nos 41/2004
s. 13(2)(a),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.32(d)),
59/2015
s. 27(3),
3/2019
s. 57(7).

(3B) The police officer referred to in subsection (3AA) or (3AC), or the police officer or police custody officer referred to in subsection (3A), must give or send by registered post to the person from whom a scraping is taken or his or her legal practitioner, without charge—

S. 464Z(3B)(a)
amended by
Nos 41/2004
s. 13(2)(b)(i)(ii),
27/2006
s. 17(24).

(a) if the election or consent is recorded by audio recording or audiovisual recording, a copy of the recording as soon as practicable but not more than 7 days after the election is made or the consent is given, and, if a transcript of the recording is prepared, a copy of the transcript as soon as practicable; and

S. 464Z(3B)(b)
amended by
No. 41/2004
s. 13(2)(c).

(b) if the election or consent is recorded in writing, a copy of the record forthwith.

S. 464Z(4)
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 19(3),
41/2004
s. 13(3),
13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.6(c)).

(4) A person from whom an intimate sample is to be taken (except a scraping from a person's mouth to be taken by that person) or who is to undergo a physical examination of an intimate part of the body may request that a medical practitioner or nurse or midwife or, if a dental impression is to be taken, a dentist of his or her choice take the sample or conduct the examination or be present during the forensic procedure.

S. 464Z(5)
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 19(4),
13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.6(d)).

(5) If a medical practitioner, nurse, midwife or dentist is chosen by a person under subsection (4)—
(a) if practicable, the forensic procedure is to be conducted by or in the presence of the chosen person; and

- | | |
|--|--|
| (b) if the chosen person conducts the forensic procedure, a medical practitioner, nurse or dentist (as the case requires) nominated by the police must be present. | S. 464Z(5)(b) amended by No. 81/1997 s. 19(4). |
|
(6) A sample must be taken or a physical examination must be conducted— | |
| (a) if taken or conducted by a medical practitioner, nurse, midwife or dentist, in a manner consistent with the appropriate medical or dental standards; and | S. 464Z(6)(a) amended by Nos 81/1997 s. 21(a), 13/2010 s. 51(Sch. item 17.6(e)). |
| (ab) in the presence of a police officer or police custody officer who is present to witness the taking of the sample or the conduct of the physical examination, subject to subsection (9), and is of the same sex, if practicable, as the person from whom the sample is to be taken or who is to be examined; and | S. 464Z(6)(ab) inserted by No. 81/1997 s. 21(b), amended by Nos 16/2002 s. 7(5)(a), 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.32(d)), 59/2015 s. 27(4). |
| (b) in circumstances affording reasonable privacy to the person from whom the sample is to be taken or who is to be examined; and | |
| (c) in the presence only of— | |
| (i) a police officer or police custody officer required by paragraph (ab) to be present; and | S. 464Z(6)(c)(i) amended by Nos 81/1997 s. 21(c), 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.32(d)), 59/2015 s. 27(4). |
| (ii) a person required by section 464ZA to be present; and | |
| (iii) a person referred to in subsection (5); and | S. 464Z(6)(c)(iii) amended by No. 16/2002 s. 7(5)(b). |

S. 464Z(6)
(c)(iv)
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 7(5)(b).
amended by
Nos 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.32(d)),
59/2015
s. 27(4).

(iv) a police officer or police custody
officer referred to in subsection (3A).

(7) A blood sample for the purposes of this
Subdivision must not exceed 10 millilitres.

S. 464Z(7A)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 13(4).

- (7A) For the purposes of this Subdivision, a person is
authorised to take a sample of hair by removing
the root of the hair only if—
- (a) the person takes only so much hair as the
person believes is necessary for analysis of
the sample or other examination of the hair;
and
 - (b) strands of hair are taken using the least
painful technique known and available to the
person.

S. 464Z(8)
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 19(5),
13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.6(f)).

(8) This Subdivision does not compel any medical
practitioner, nurse, midwife or dentist to take a
sample from a person nor to conduct a physical
examination of a person nor to be present when a
sample is taken or an examination is conducted.

S. 464Z(9)
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 7(6).

(9) If a scraping is to be taken from a person's mouth
and the person is to take it, the witness required by
subsection (6)(ab) to be present need not be of the
same sex as the person.

464ZA Execution of authorisation, direction or order

S. 464ZA
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 14(1),
amended by
No. 25/2017
s. 51(1).
S. 464ZA
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

(1) If—

- (a) a senior police officer gives an authorisation under section 464SA for the conduct of a non-intimate compulsory procedure; or

S. 464ZA(1)
amended by
No. 81/1997
s. 22(1)(a)(b),
substituted by
No. 41/2004
s. 14(2),
amended by
Nos 13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.7),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.33(a)),
3/2019
s. 58(2)(c).

- (ab) a senior police officer gives an authorisation under section 464SE for the taking of a DNA profile sample; or

S.
464ZA(1)(ab)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 58(1).

- (ac) a senior police officer gives an authorisation under section 464ZFAE for the taking of a DNA profile sample from a person; or

S.
464ZA(1)(ac)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 58(1).

- (b) a court makes an order under section 464T(3), 464U(7) or 464V(5) for the conduct of a compulsory procedure; or

- (c) a court makes an order under section 464ZF or 464ZFAAA for the conduct of a forensic procedure; or

S. 464ZA(1)(c)
amended by
Nos 27/2006
s. 6(a).
25/2017
s. 51(2)(a).

S. 464ZA(1)(d)
inserted by
No. 25/2017
s. 51(2)(b),
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 58(2)(a).

- (d) a police officer directs that a DNA profile sample be taken from a person under section 464ZFAB; or

S. 464ZA(1)(e)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 58(2)(b).

- (e) a senior police officer authorises the taking of a DNA profile sample from a person under section 464ZFAC or 464ZFAE—

a police officer, with such assistance as he or she considers necessary, may use reasonable force to assist a medical practitioner, nurse, midwife, dentist or person authorised under section 464Z to take the sample or conduct the procedure.

S. 464ZA(2)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.33(b)).

- (2) If practicable, a police officer acting in accordance with subsection (1) and any person assisting the police officer—

S. 464ZA(2)(a)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 58(3).

- (a) must be of the same sex as the person from whom the sample is to be taken or on whom the procedure is to be conducted; and

- (b) must not be involved in investigating the offence for which the procedure is required.

- (3) If the Children's Court makes an order under section 464U(7) or 464V(5), a parent or guardian of the child or, if a parent or guardian cannot be located, an independent person of the same sex, if practicable, as the child must be present during the conduct of a compulsory procedure on the child.

S. 464ZA(3A)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 58(4).

- (3A) The taking of a DNA profile sample (other than a scraping from the person's mouth taken by that person)—
- (a) must be recorded by audiovisual recording, if practicable; or

- (b) must be witnessed by an independent medical practitioner or independent nurse.
- (4) The taking of an intimate sample (other than a blood sample or a scraping from a person's mouth taken by that person) or the examination of an intimate part of the body in accordance with the order of a court—
- (a) must be recorded by audiovisual recording, if practicable and if the person on whom the procedure is to be conducted consents; or
- (b) must be witnessed by an independent medical practitioner or independent nurse or independent midwife or, if a dental impression is to be taken, an independent dentist or the medical practitioner, nurse, midwife or dentist chosen by the person to be present at the procedure.
- (5) All other compulsory or forensic procedures (except a scraping from a person's mouth taken by that person) conducted in accordance with the authorisation of a senior police officer or the order of a court must be recorded by audiovisual recording, if practicable, or witnessed by an independent person.
- (6) After an authorisation under section 464SA, 464SE, 464ZFAC or 464ZFAC or an order under section 464T(3), 464U(7), 464V(5), 464ZF or 464ZFAC or a direction under section 464ZFAC is executed—
- S. 464ZA(4) amended by No. 16/2002 s. 8(1).
- S. 464ZA(4)(a) amended by No. 27/2006 s. 17(25).
- S. 464ZA(4)(b) amended by Nos 81/1997 s. 19(6)(a)(b), 13/2010 s. 51(Sch. item 17.8).
- S. 464ZA(5) amended by Nos 81/1997 s. 22(2), 16/2002 s. 8(2), 41/2004 s. 14(3), 27/2006 s. 17(26).
- S. 464ZA(6) substituted by No. 81/1997 s. 22(3), amended by Nos 41/2004 s. 14(4)(a), 27/2006 s. 6(b), 25/2017 s. 51(3), 3/2019 s. 58(5)(a).

S. 464ZA(6)(a)
amended by
Nos 41/2004
s. 14(4)(b),
27/2006
s. 17(27),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.33(c)),
3/2019
s. 58(5)(b).

(a) if the taking of the sample or the procedure was recorded by audiovisual recording, the person who recorded the conduct of the procedure, or the police officer who witnessed the conduct of the procedure, must endorse on the authorisation or order his or her own name and sign the endorsement; or

S. 464ZA(6)(b)
amended by
Nos 41/2004
s. 14(4)(b),
13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.9),
3/2019
s. 58(5)(c).

(b) if an independent medical practitioner, nurse, midwife, dentist or other person witnessed the taking of the sample or the conduct of the procedure, the witness must endorse on the authorisation or order his or her own name and sign the endorsement.

S. 464ZA(6A)
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 22(3),
amended by
Nos 41/2004
s. 14(5),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.33(c)),
3/2019
s. 58(6).

(6A) A police officer must give a copy of the authorisation or order so endorsed to the person from whom the sample was taken or on whom the procedure was conducted.

S. 464ZA(7)
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 22(4),
41/2004
s. 14(6)(a)(b),
27/2006
s. 17(28),
substituted by
No. 3/2019
s. 58(7).

(7) If a DNA profile sample taken in accordance with an authorisation or a direction, or a compulsory procedure or a forensic procedure conducted in accordance with an authorisation of a senior police officer or an order of a court, is recorded by audiovisual recording, the applicant for the authorisation, direction or order must—

(a) without charge; and

- (b) as soon as practicable but not more than 7 days after the procedure was conducted or the sample was taken—

give or send by registered post a copy of the audiovisual recording to the person from whom the sample was taken or on whom the procedure was conducted or to the person's legal practitioner.

- (8) If the person referred to in subsection (7) from whom the sample was taken or on whom the procedure was conducted was a child, the applicant for the authorisation or order must also give or send by registered post a copy of the audiovisual recording to the parent or guardian of the child if the child's legal practitioner is not known.

S. 464ZA(8)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 58(7).

464ZB Analysis of samples

- (1) If a sample taken in accordance with this Subdivision is analysed, it must be analysed—
- (a) in accordance with the prescribed standards, if any; and
- (b) by an analyst authorised under this section, if the regulations so require.
- (2) The Minister may authorise, by notice published in the Government Gazette, persons whom the Minister considers to be appropriately qualified to carry out analyses for the purposes of this Subdivision.
- (3) An authority given under subsection (1) may be in respect of a particular type of analysis specified in the authority.
- (4) The Minister must cause the name of a person authorised under this section to be laid before the Legislative Council and the Legislative Assembly before the expiration of the seventh sitting day of the Council or the Assembly, as the case may be,

S. 464ZB
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

after the date of publication of the notice in the
Government Gazette.

S. 464ZC
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

464ZC Analysis of material found at scene of offence etc.

S. 464ZC(1)
amended by
No. 81/1997
s. 23 (ILA
s. 39B(1)).

- (1) If material reasonably believed to be from the
body of a person who committed an indictable
offence has been found—
- (a) at the scene of the offence; or
 - (b) on the victim of the offence or on anything
reasonably believed to have been worn or
carried by the victim when the offence was
committed; or
 - (c) on an object or person reasonably believed to
have been associated with the commission of
the offence—

and there is sufficient material to be analysed both
in the investigation of the offence and on behalf of
a person from whom a sample has been taken in
relation to that offence, a part of the material
sufficient for analysis must, on request, be
delivered to that person.

S. 464ZC(2)
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 23.

- (2) If material, reasonably believed to be from the
body of a victim of an indictable offence which
has not been found, has been found on a person
reasonably believed to have been associated with
the commission of the offence, and there is
sufficient material to be analysed both in the
investigation of the offence and on behalf of a
person from whom a sample has been taken in
relation to that offence, a part of the material
sufficient for analysis must, on request, be
delivered to that person.

(3) If—

- (a) a sample has been taken from a child in connection with an investigation into an offence against a provision of Subdivision (8A), (8B) or (8C) of Division 1 of Part I; and

- (b) that child was conceived allegedly as a result of that offence—

a person suspected of having committed that offence and from whom a sample has been taken in relation to that offence may request a part of the child's sample.

- (4) A part of that child's sample requested by a person under subsection (3) must be delivered to that person provided that there is sufficient material to be analysed both in the investigation of the offence and on behalf of the person suspected of having committed the offence.

S. 464ZC(3)
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 23.

S. 464ZC(4)
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 23.

464ZD Forensic reports to be made available

- (1) If a forensic procedure has been conducted on a person in accordance with section 464R, 464SA, 464T(3), 464U(7), 464V(5), 464ZF(2) or (3) or 464ZFAAA(2) or sections 464ZGB to 464ZGD or otherwise in accordance with this Subdivision, a copy of every forensic report must be given or sent by registered post as soon as practicable to that person (or, in the case of a forensic procedure conducted in accordance with section 464ZF or 464ZFAAA on a person who is a child within the meaning of that section, to that child and a parent or guardian of that child) or his or her legal practitioner.

S. 464ZD
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
amended by
No. 84/1989
ss 7(l)(m),
8(d),
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7,
amended by
Nos 80/1998
s. 3(a)(i)–(iii),
41/2004 s. 15,
27/2006 s. 7,
3/2019 s. 59
(ILA s. 39B(1)).

S. 464ZD(2)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 59.

- (2) If a DNA profile sample has been taken from a DNA person in accordance with section 464SC or 464SE, a copy of every forensic report must be given or sent by registered post as soon as practicable to—
- (a) that person or the person's legal practitioner;
and
 - (b) if that person is a child, also to the child's parent or guardian.

S. 464ZD(3)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 59.

- (3) If a DNA profile sample has been taken from a person in accordance with section 464ZFAB, a senior police officer authorisation or an authorisation under section 464ZFAE, a copy of every forensic report must be given or sent by registered post as soon as practicable to that person or the person's legal practitioner.

S. 464ZE
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 60(1).

464ZE Evidence relating to forensic procedures or DNA profile samples³⁷

S. 464ZE
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

S. 464ZE(1)
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 24(1)(a),
16/2002 s. 9,
3/2019
s. 60(2)(a).

- (1) Subject to subsection (4) and section 464ZGO, evidence obtained as a result of a DNA profile sample taken from a person or a forensic procedure conducted on a person, or from a sample voluntarily given by a person in accordance with sections 464ZGB to 464ZGD, is inadmissible as part of the prosecution case in proceedings against that person for any offence if—

S. 464ZE(1)(a)
amended by
No. 81/1997
s. 24(1)(b).

- (a) the requirements of sections 464R to 464ZA, sections 464ZF to 464ZFB, sections

464ZGB to 464ZGD or section 464ZGF
(as the case may be) have not been complied
with; or

- (ab) a copy of a forensic report relating to the taking of the sample or the procedure required by section 464ZD to be given or sent by registered post to a person had not been given or sent to that person before the end of the period of 7 days after its receipt by the prosecution; or
- (b) the taking of the sample or the procedure was not conducted in accordance with the prescribed standards, if any; or
- (c) any sample taken was not analysed—
- (i) in accordance with the prescribed standards, if any; or
 - (ii) if the regulations so require, by an analyst authorised under section 464ZB; or
- (d) any sample taken and any information which may identify the person contained in—
- (i) any record of or report relating to the taking of the sample or the forensic procedure; or
 - (ii) any copy of such a record or report—
should have been but has not been destroyed as required by section 464ZF, 464ZFAAA, 464ZFAC, 464ZFC, 464ZG, 464ZGA or 464ZGE; or

S. 464ZE
(1)(ab)
inserted by
No. 80/1998
s. 3(b),
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 60(2)(b).

S. 464ZE(1)(b)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 60(2)(c).

S. 464ZE(1)(d)
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 24(1)(c),
27/2006 s. 8,
3/2019
s. 60(2)(d)(ii).

S.
464ZE(1)(d)(i)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 60(2)(d)(i).

- (e) the evidence was obtained as a result of a procedure conducted in accordance with an interim order which subsequently is not confirmed under section 464V(7).
- S. 464ZE(2)**
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 24(2)(a),
80/1998
s. 3(c), 3/2019
s. 60(2)(e).
- (2) A court may admit evidence obtained as a result of the taking of a DNA profile sample or a forensic procedure, or from a sample voluntarily given by a person in accordance with sections 464ZGB to 464ZGD, otherwise inadmissible by reason of subsection (1)(a) or (1)(ab) if—
- S. 464ZE(2)(a)**
amended by
No. 81/1997
s. 24(2)(b).
- (a) the prosecution satisfies the court on the balance of probabilities that the circumstances justify the reception of the evidence; or
- (b) the accused consents to the reception of the evidence.
- S. 464ZE(2A)**
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 24(3),
amended by
No. 80/1998
s. 3(c).
- (2A) In determining whether the circumstances justify the reception of evidence otherwise inadmissible by reason of subsection (1)(a) or (1)(ab), the court may have regard to the following—
- S. 464ZE(2A)(b)**
amended by
No. 80/1998
s. 3(c).
- (a) the probative value of the evidence, including whether equivalent evidence or evidence of equivalent probative value could have been obtained by other means;
- (b) the reasons given for the failure to comply with a provision referred to in subsection (1)(a) or (1)(ab);
- (c) the gravity of that failure and whether it deprived the person of a significant protection under this Subdivision;
- (d) whether that failure was intentional or reckless;
- (e) the nature of the requirement that was not complied with;

- (f) the nature of the offence alleged against the person and the subject-matter of the proceedings;
 - (g) whether the reception of the evidence would seriously undermine the protection given to persons under this Subdivision;
 - (h) any other matters the court considers relevant.
- (3) The probative value of the evidence does not by itself justify the reception of the evidence. S. 464ZE(3) substituted by No. 81/1997 s. 24(3).
- (4) If the taking of a DNA profile sample or the conduct of a forensic procedure is recorded by audiovisual recording, the recording is inadmissible as evidence except— S. 464ZE(4) amended by Nos 27/2006 s. 17(29), 3/2019 s. 60(2)(f).
- (a) to establish or rebut an allegation that unreasonable force was used to enable the sample to be taken or the procedure to be conducted; or S. 464ZE(4)(a) amended by No. 3/2019 s. 60(2)(g).
 - (b) to determine the admissibility of a confession or admission or other evidence adverse to the accused where the accused alleges that the evidence was induced or obtained by the use of unreasonable force.
- (5) If evidence obtained as a result of a DNA profile sample taken from a person or a forensic procedure conducted on a person would be admissible in proceedings against that person for an offence, that evidence is admissible in proceedings against that person for a relevant offence within the meaning of section 464ZG. S. 464ZE(5) amended by No. 3/2019 s. 60(2)(h).

- (6) Evidence obtained as a result of a physical examination conducted in good faith on a person for the purposes of medical or dental treatment is admissible in proceedings against that person for an offence.

S. 464ZF
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
substituted by
Nos 129/1993
s. 7, 81/1997
s. 25.

464ZF Forensic procedure following the commission of forensic sample offence

- (1) In this section—

S. 464ZF(1)
def. of
child
amended by
Nos 72/2004
s. 31(1),
32/2024 s. 808.

child means a child who is 12 years of age or over but under 18 years of age;

S. 464ZF(1)
def. of
forensic sample offence
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 9(1).

forensic sample offence means any indictable offence or any offence specified in Schedule 8.

S. 464ZF(2)
amended by
Nos 14/2006
s. 13(1)(a),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.34).

- (2) If at any time on or after the commencement of section 25 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997** a court finds a person guilty of—

S. 464ZF(2)(a)
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 9(2).

- (a) a forensic sample offence (within the meaning of that term as then in force); or

- (b) an offence of conspiracy to commit, incitement to commit or attempting to commit a forensic sample offence—

a police officer, at any time following that finding but not later than 6 months after the final

determination of an appeal against conviction or sentence or the expiration of any appeal period (whichever is the later), may apply to the court for an order directing the person to undergo a forensic procedure for the taking of a sample from any part of the body and the court may make an order accordingly.

(2AA) If the finding of guilt referred to in subsection (2)—

- (a) occurs between 1 January 2002 and the commencement of item 3.4 in the Schedule to the **Criminal Justice Legislation (Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 2002**; and

- (b) is in respect of an offence referred to in item 29, 30 or 31 of Schedule 8—

an application under subsection (2) may be made not later than 12 months after the final determination of an appeal against conviction or sentence or the expiration of any appeal period (whichever is the later).

(2A) An order under subsection (2) in respect of a person who is not a detained or protected person must include a direction that the person attend—

- (a) at a place; and
- (b) within a period, commencing after the expiry of the period referred to in subsection (6) during which the order must not be executed—

specified in the order to undergo the forensic procedure.

S. 464ZF(2AA)
inserted by
No. 35/2002
s. 28(Sch.
item 3.3),
amended by
No. 14/2006
s. 13(1)(b).

S. 464ZF(2A)
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 10.

S. 464ZF(3)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.34).

(3) If—

S. 464ZF(3)(a)
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 9(3).

- (a) at any time before the commencement of section 25 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997**, a person has been found guilty by a court of a forensic sample offence (within the meaning of that term as then in force); and

S. 464ZF(3)(b)
amended by
Nos 48/2006
s. 42(Sch.
item 9.3),
26/2014
s. 455(Sch.
item 7.4).

- (b) at any time on or after that commencement, that person is serving a term of imprisonment or a period of detention in a prison, police gaol or youth justice centre or as a security patient in a designated mental health service for any offence, whether or not a forensic sample offence—

a police officer may apply to the Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case may be) for an order directing the person to undergo a forensic procedure for the taking of a sample from any part of the body and the court may make an order accordingly.

S. 464ZF(4)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.34).

- (4) In any application to a court under subsection (2) or (3), the police officer must specify the type of sample (whether intimate or non-intimate) sought to be taken in the forensic procedure.

S. 464ZF(5)
substituted by
No. 41/2004
s. 16,
amended by
No. 72/2004
s. 31(2).

- (5) If, on or after the commencement of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2004**, an application under subsection (2) or (3) is made in respect of a person aged 18 years or more—
- (a) the application may be made without notice to any person; and
- (b) the person is not a party to the application; and

- (c) the person may not call or cross-examine any witnesses; and
- (d) the person may not address the court, other than in response to inquiries made by the court under subsection (8)(c).

(5A) If, on or after the commencement of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2004**, an application under subsection (2) or (3) is made in respect of a child—

S. 464ZF(5A)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 16.

- (a) notice of the application must be served on the child and a parent or guardian of the child; and
- (b) the child is not a party to the application; and
- (c) the child may not call or cross-examine any witnesses; and
- (d) the child may not address the court, other than in respect of any matter referred to in subsection (8)(a) or (b) or in response to inquiries made by the court under subsection (8)(c).

(5B) In exercising the right of address under subsection (5A)(d), a child may be represented by a legal practitioner, or, with the leave of the court, a parent or guardian of the child.

S. 464ZF(5B)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 16.

(6) An order made by a court under subsection (2) or (3) before the appeal period in relation to the conviction for the forensic sample offence has expired or an appeal against conviction (if any) has been finally determined (whichever is the later), must not be executed unless—

S. 464ZF(6)
amended by
No. 14/2006
s. 13(1)(c)(i)(ii).

- (a) that appeal period expires; or

S. 464ZF(6)(b)
amended by
No. 14/2006
s. 13(1)(c)(ii).

- (b) an appeal against conviction (if any) is finally determined and the conviction for the forensic sample offence is upheld—

whichever is the later.

S. 464ZF(6A)
inserted by
No. 14/2006
s. 13(2).

- (6A) If leave to appeal against a conviction for a forensic sample offence is sought after the expiry of the appeal period in relation to the conviction, an order made by a court under subsection (2) before leave to appeal is sought, if not executed before that leave is sought, must not be executed unless—

- (a) leave to appeal against the conviction is refused; or
- (b) leave to appeal against the conviction is granted and the appeal is finally determined and the conviction for the forensic sample offence is upheld.

S. 464ZF(6B)
inserted by
No. 14/2006
s. 13(2).

- (6B) If an order made by a court under subsection (2) has been executed after the expiration of the appeal period in relation to the conviction for the forensic sample offence and leave to appeal against the conviction is granted after the expiry of that period—

- (a) any sample and any related material and information taken may be retained by a police officer pending the final determination of the appeal against conviction; and
- (b) if, on appeal, the conviction for the forensic sample offence is set aside, the Chief Commissioner of Police must without delay destroy, or cause to be destroyed, any sample taken and any related material and information.

S. 464ZF
(6B)(a)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.34).

S. 464ZF
(6B)(b)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.36).

- (7) If on appeal a conviction for the forensic sample offence is set aside, an order made by a court under subsection (2) or (3) ceases to have effect. **S. 464ZF(7) amended by No. 68/2009 s. 97(Sch. item 40.36).**
- (8) A court hearing an application under subsection (2) or (3)—
- (a) must take into account the seriousness of the circumstances of the forensic sample offence in determining whether to make the order under subsection (2) or (3); and
 - (b) must be satisfied that, in all the circumstances, the making of the order is justified; and
 - (c) may make such inquiries on oath or by affirmation or otherwise as it considers desirable. **S. 464ZF(8)(c) amended by No. 6/2018 s. 68(Sch. 2 item 35.11).**
- (9) If a court makes an order under subsection (2) or (3), it must—
- (a) give reasons for its decision and cause a copy of the order and reasons to be served—
 - (i) if the order directs a person (other than a child) to undergo the forensic procedure, on the person; or
 - (ii) if the order directs a child to undergo the forensic procedure, on the child and a parent or guardian of the child; and
 - (b) inform the person ordered to undergo the forensic procedure that a police officer may use reasonable force to enable the procedure to be conducted. **S. 464ZF(9)(b) amended by No. 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.34).**

- (10) A failure of a court to comply with subsection (9) does not invalidate any order made by it but constitutes non-compliance for the purposes of section 464ZE(1)(a).

S. 464ZF(11)
repealed by
No. 80/1998
s. 3(d).

* * * *

S. 464ZFAAA
inserted by
No. 27/2006
s. 9.

464ZFAAA Forensic procedure following finding of not guilty because of mental impairment

- (1) In this section—

S. 464ZFAAA
(1) def. of
child
amended by
No. 32/2024
s. 809(1).

child means a child who is 12 years of age or over but under 18 years of age;

S. 464ZFAAA
(1) def. of
forensic sample offence
amended by
Nos 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.37),
72/2013
s. 10(1).

forensic sample offence means any indictable offence or any offence specified in Schedule 8, other than an offence heard and determined summarily.

S. 464ZFAAA
(2)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.34).

- (2) If a court finds a person not guilty because of mental impairment of—

S. 464ZFAAA
(2)(a)
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 10(2).

- (a) a forensic sample offence (within the meaning of that term as then in force); or

- (b) an offence of conspiracy to commit, incitement to commit or attempting to commit a forensic sample offence—

a police officer, at any time following that finding but not later than 6 months after the final determination of an appeal or the expiration of any appeal period (whichever is the later), may apply to the court for an order directing the person to undergo a forensic procedure for the taking of a sample from any part of the body and the court may make an order accordingly.

- (3) In an application under subsection (2), the police officer must specify the type of sample (whether intimate or non-intimate) sought to be taken in the forensic procedure. **S. 464ZFAAA (3) amended by No. 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.34).**
- (4) Notice of an application under subsection (2)—
- (a) must be served on the person in respect of whom the order is sought and, if the person is a child, on a parent or guardian of the child; and
 - (b) must include a requirement that the person in respect of whom the order is sought attend the hearing of the application in person or by the person's legal practitioner. **S. 464ZFAAA (4)(b) amended by No. 32/2024 s. 809(2).**
- (5) In determining whether to make an order under subsection (2), a court—
- (a) must take into account the seriousness of the circumstances of the forensic sample offence of which the person has been found not guilty because of mental impairment; and
 - (b) must be satisfied that, in all the circumstances, the making of the order is justified; and
 - (c) may make such inquiries on oath or by affirmation or otherwise as it considers desirable. **S. 464ZFAAA (5)(c) amended by No. 6/2018 s. 68(Sch. 2 item 35.11).**

S. 464ZFAAA
(6)
amended by
No. 32/2024
s. 809(3).

- (6) An application made under subsection (2) must be heard in the presence of the person in respect of whom the order is sought or the person's legal practitioner.
- (7) A person in respect of whom an application under subsection (2) is made—
 - (a) is not a party to the application; and
 - (b) may not call or cross-examine any witnesses; and
 - (c) may not address the court other than in response to inquiries made by the court under subsection (5)(c).
- (8) In exercising the right of address under subsection (7)(c), a person may be represented by a legal practitioner.
- (9) An order under subsection (2) in respect of a person who is not a forensic patient or a forensic resident within the meaning of the **Crimes (Mental Impairment and Unfitness to be Tried) Act 1997** must include a direction that the person attend—
 - (a) at a place; and
 - (b) within a period (commencing after the expiry of the period referred to in subsection (12) during which the order must not be executed)—specified in the order to undergo the forensic procedure.
- (10) If a court makes an order under subsection (2), it must—
 - (a) give reasons for its decision and cause a copy of the order and reasons to be served on the person ordered to undergo the forensic procedure; and

- (b) inform the person ordered to undergo the forensic procedure that a police officer may use reasonable force to enable the procedure to be conducted.

**S. 464ZFAAA
(10)(b)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.34).**

- (11) A failure of a court to comply with subsection (10) does not invalidate any order made by it but constitutes non-compliance for the purposes of section 464ZE(1)(a).
- (12) An order made by a court under subsection (2) before the appeal period in relation to the verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment has expired or an appeal against the verdict (if any) has been finally determined (whichever is the later), must not be executed unless—
 - (a) that appeal period expires; or
 - (b) the appeal against the verdict is dismissed—whichever is the later.
- (13) If leave to appeal against a verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment in respect of a forensic sample offence is sought after the expiry of the appeal period in relation to the verdict, an order made by a court under subsection (2) before leave to appeal is sought, if not executed before that leave is sought, must not be executed unless—
 - (a) leave to appeal against the verdict is refused; or
 - (b) leave to appeal against the verdict is granted but the appeal is dismissed.
- (14) If an order made by a court under subsection (2) has been executed after the expiry of the appeal period in relation to the verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment in respect of a forensic sample offence and leave to appeal

against the verdict is granted after the expiry of that period—

S. 464ZFAAA
(14)(a)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.34).

- (a) any sample and any related material and information taken may be retained by a police officer but may not be used for any purpose pending the final determination of the appeal against the verdict; and
 - (b) if, on appeal, the verdict is set aside, the Chief Commissioner of Police must, without delay, destroy or cause to be destroyed any sample taken and any related material and information.
- (15) If on appeal a verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment is set aside, an order made by a court under subsection (2) ceases to have effect.

S. 464ZFAA
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 11.

464ZFAA Notice to attend for forensic procedure

S. 464ZFAA(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.35(a)).

- (1) If a senior police officer is satisfied that—
- (a) an order under section 464ZF(2) in respect of a person was made—
 - (i) before the commencement of section 11 of the **Crimes (DNA Database) Act 2002**; or
 - (ii) when the person was a detained or protected person and within the period of 6 months immediately preceding the serving of the notice the person ceased to be a detained or protected person; and
 - (b) the order has not been executed; and

- (c) the period referred to in section 464ZF(6) during which the order must not be executed has expired—

the senior police officer may serve on the person a notice in accordance with subsections (2) and (3).

- (2) A notice must direct the person to attend at a police station specified in the notice within 28 days after service of the notice to undergo the forensic procedure ordered by the court and must state—
 - (a) the date on which the order under section 464ZF(2) was made;
 - (b) the court which made the order;
 - (c) that the person has not undergone the forensic procedure;
 - (d) that if the person fails to comply with the notice, application for a warrant to arrest the person may be made without further notice to the person;
 - (e) that the person may wish to seek legal advice as to the effect of the notice;
 - (f) the name, rank and telephone number of the senior police officer serving the notice.
- (3) A copy of the order under section 464ZF(2) must be attached to and served with the notice.
- (4) A notice may be served on a person by—
 - (a) delivering a true copy of the notice to the person personally; or
 - (b) leaving a true copy of the notice for the person at the person's last or most usual place of residence or business with a person

**S. 464ZFAA
(2)(f)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.35(b)).**

who apparently resides or works there and who is apparently not less than 16 years of age; or

(c) posting the notice to the person at their last known place of residence or business.

(5) If a notice is served by post in accordance with subsection (4)(c), evidence of service must state the manner of ascertainment of the address to which the notice was posted and the time and place of posting.

S. 464ZFAA(6)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.35(c)).

(6) If a person does not comply with a notice served under this section, a police officer may apply to a magistrate or a registrar of the Magistrates' Court for a warrant under subsection (7).

S. 464ZFAA(7)
amended by
No. 6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.10).

(7) If a magistrate or a registrar to whom such an application is made is satisfied by evidence on oath or by affirmation or affidavit that—

(a) a notice was served on a person in accordance with this section; and

(b) the person has not undergone the forensic procedure—

the magistrate or registrar may issue a warrant authorising the person to whom it is directed, if necessary—

(c) to break, enter and search by day or by night any place where the person named in the warrant is suspected to be; and

(d) to arrest the person; and

(e) to detain the person for as long as reasonably permits the conduct of the forensic procedure.

(8) Section 464ZFA(2), (3), (4), (5), (6) and (7) apply to a warrant issued under subsection (7) as if it were a warrant issued under section 464ZFA(1B).

**464ZFAB DNA profile sample from registrable offenders
under the Sex Offenders Registration Act 2004**

S. 464ZFAB
(Heading)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 61(1).

S. 464ZFAB
inserted by
No. 25/2017
s. 52.

(1) In this section—

initial period means the period of 3 years
commencing on the day on which section 52
of the **Sex Offenders Registration
Amendment (Miscellaneous) Act 2017**
comes into operation;

S. 464ZFAB(1)
def. of *initial
period*
inserted by
No. 25/2017
s. 53(1).

registrable offender has the same meaning as in
section 3 of the **Sex Offenders Registration
Act 2004**.

(2) A police officer may, at any time, direct that a
DNA profile sample be taken from a person if, at
the time that the direction is given—

S. 464ZFAB(2)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 61(2)(a).

(a) the person is a registrable offender; and

(b) the Chief Commissioner of Police does not
have a sample from the person that may be
retained indefinitely.

S.
464ZFAB(2)(b)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 61(2)(b).

(3) A senior police officer may serve, or may cause
to be served, a notice on a person referred to in
subsection (2) directing the person to attend at a
police station specified in the notice to have the
DNA profile sample taken within 28 days after
service of the notice.

S. 464ZFAB(3)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 61(3).

- (4) A notice under subsection (3) must—
- (a) state that if the person fails to comply with the notice, an application for a warrant to arrest the person may be made without further notice to the person; and
 - (b) state that the person may wish to seek legal advice as to the effect of the notice; and
 - (c) state the name, rank and telephone number of the senior police officer serving the notice or causing the notice to be served; and
 - (d) contain the prescribed information, if any.
- (5) A notice under subsection (3) must be served by delivering a true copy of the notice to the person personally.
- (6) Section 464ZFAA(6), (7) and (8) apply to a notice served under subsection (3) as if it were a notice served under that section.
- (7) If a DNA profile sample is taken from a person under this section, the sample taken and any related material and information may be retained indefinitely.
- (8) Subsection (7) does not apply if, on appeal against conviction, the finding of guilt of the registrable offender in respect of an offence is quashed or set aside and, but for that offence, the person would not be a registrable offender.
- (9) Subject to subsection (10), a police officer may give a direction under subsection (2) to a registrable offender whose reporting obligations under the **Sex Offenders Registration Act 2004**—
- (a) have been suspended under Division 6 of Part 3 of that Act; or

S. 464ZFAB(7)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 61(4).

S. 464ZFAB(9)
inserted by
No. 25/2017
s. 53(2) (as
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 80).

(b) have been suspended under section 32(1)(b) of that Act; or

(c) have expired under section 34(1) of that Act—

only if a notice under subsection (3) has been served on the registrable offender.

(10) A registrable offender referred to in subsection (9) may refuse to have a DNA profile sample taken and to attend at a police station in compliance with a notice under subsection (3) if the registrable offender demonstrates to the reasonable satisfaction of the senior police officer referred to in subsection (3)—

**S. 464ZFAB
(10)
inserted by
No. 25/2017
s. 53(2) (as
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 80).**

(a) if the registrable offender was a registrable offender on the commencement of the initial period, that the registrable offender has been resident in Victoria for not less than 2 years and 6 months in aggregate during the initial period; or

(b) that the registrable offender has been resident in Victoria for a continuous period of 12 months at any time after the expiry of the initial period and was a registrable offender during the whole of that period of 12 months.

(11) A person serving a notice under subsection (3) on a registrable offender referred to in subsection (9) must inform the registrable offender, in a manner likely to be understood by the offender, of the following matters—

**S. 464ZFAB
(11)
inserted by
No. 25/2017
s. 53(2) (as
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 80).**

(a) that the offender may refuse to comply with the notice;

(b) the grounds on which the offender may refuse to comply;

**S. 464ZFAB
(11)(b)
amended by
No. 38/2022
s. 91(2).**

(c) that the offender may wish to seek legal advice as to the effect of the notice.

S. 464ZFAB
(12)
inserted by
No. 25/2017
s. 53(2) (as
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 80).

(12) A senior police officer referred to in subsection (10) must take into account any information provided by the registrable offender.

S. 464ZFAB
(13)
inserted by
No. 25/2017
s. 53(2) (as
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 80).

(13) Before a registrable offender referred to in subsection (9) has a DNA profile sample taken, a police officer must, in a manner likely to be understood by the offender—

(a) inform the offender of the grounds on which the offender may refuse to have the DNA profile sample taken; and

(b) ask the offender whether the offender wishes to refuse.

S. 464ZFAB
(14)
inserted by
No. 25/2017
s. 53(2) (as
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 80).

(14) If a registrable offender does not have a knowledge of the English language that is sufficient to enable the person to understand the matters referred to in subsection (11) or (13), the person informing the offender must arrange for the presence of a competent interpreter and defer the giving of the information until the interpreter is present.

S. 464ZFAC
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 62.

464ZFAC Senior police officer authorisation—to take DNA profile sample from certain adults

(1) In this section—

DNA offence means—

(a) an indictable offence or an offence specified in Schedule 8; or

(b) any offence of conspiracy to commit, incitement to commit or attempting to commit an indictable offence or an offence specified in Schedule 8.

- (2) A senior police officer may authorise the taking of a DNA profile sample from a person if—
- (a) the person—
 - (i) is found guilty of a DNA offence; or
 - (ii) is found not guilty of a DNA offence, other than an offence heard and determined summarily, because of mental impairment under the **Crimes (Mental Impairment and Unfitness to be Tried) Act 1997**; and
 - (b) it is not more than 6 months after—
 - (i) the final determination of an appeal against the conviction or the verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment (as the case requires); or
 - (ii) the expiration of any appeal period; and
 - (c) the person is not under the age of 18 years at the time—
 - (i) the finding of guilt for the DNA offence is made; or
 - (ii) the finding of not guilty for the DNA offence because of mental impairment is made; and
 - (d) the Chief Commissioner of Police does not have a sample from the person that may be retained indefinitely.
- (3) An authorisation given for a sample to be taken from a person referred to in subsection (2)(a)(i) before the appeal period in relation to a conviction for the DNA offence has expired or an appeal against the conviction (if any) has been finally determined (whichever is the later), must not be carried out unless—
- (a) the appeal period expires; or

- (b) an appeal against conviction (if any) is finally determined and the conviction for the DNA offence is upheld.
- (4) An authorisation given for a sample to be taken from a person referred to in subsection (2)(a)(ii) before the appeal period in relation to the verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment has expired or an appeal against the verdict (if any) has been finally determined (whichever is the later), must not be carried out unless—
 - (a) the appeal period expires; or
 - (b) an appeal against the verdict is dismissed.
- (5) If leave to appeal against a verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment in respect of a DNA offence is sought after the expiry of the appeal period in relation to the verdict, an authorisation for a sample to be taken from a person referred to in subsection (2)(a)(ii) before leave to appeal is sought, if not carried out before that leave is sought, must not be carried out unless—
 - (a) leave to appeal against the verdict is refused; or
 - (b) leave to appeal against the verdict is granted but the appeal is dismissed.
- (6) If leave to appeal against a conviction for a DNA offence is sought after the expiry of the appeal period in relation to the conviction, an authorisation for a sample to be taken from a person referred to in subsection (2)(a)(i) before leave to appeal is sought, if not carried out before that leave is sought, must not be carried out unless—
 - (a) leave to appeal against the conviction is refused; or

- (b) leave to appeal against the conviction is granted and the appeal is finally determined and the conviction for the DNA offence is upheld.
- (7) If an authorisation for a sample to be taken from a person referred to in subsection (2)(a) has been carried out after the expiry of the appeal period in relation to the conviction for the DNA offence or the verdict of not guilty for the DNA offence because of mental impairment and leave to appeal against the conviction or the verdict (as the case requires) is granted after the expiry of that period—
- (a) any sample and any related material and information taken may be retained by a police officer but must not be used for any purpose pending the final determination of the appeal against the conviction or the verdict; and
 - (b) if, on appeal, the conviction or the verdict is set aside, the Chief Commissioner of Police must, without delay, destroy or cause to be destroyed any sample taken and any related material and information.
- (8) If on appeal a conviction for the DNA offence or the verdict of not guilty for the DNA offence because of mental impairment (as the case requires) is set aside, an authorisation for a sample to be taken from a person in respect of the DNA offence ceases to have effect.
- (9) An authorisation given under this section must be in writing signed by the senior police officer giving it.

S. 464ZFAD
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 62.

464ZFAD Notice to attend—to take DNA profile sample from certain adults

(1) In this section—

relevant person means a person other than a person who is a detained or protected person.

(2) If a senior police officer authorisation for a DNA profile sample to be taken from a relevant person is given, a notice to attend must be attached to the authorisation and served on the person, that requires the person to attend a police station specified in the notice to have the DNA profile sample taken, within 28 days after the expiry of the period referred to in section 464ZFAC(3) or (4) (as the case requires) or the date of service of the notice (whichever is the later).

(3) A notice under subsection (2) must state—

- (a) the date on which the senior police officer authorisation was given; and
- (b) the kind of DNA profile sample that is to be taken from the person; and
- (c) the name, rank and telephone number of the senior police officer who gave the senior police officer authorisation; and
- (d) the Chief Commissioner of Police does not have a sample from the person that may be retained indefinitely; and
- (e) that if the person fails to comply with the notice, an application for a warrant to arrest the person may be made without further notice to the person; and
- (f) that the person may wish to seek legal advice as to the effect of the notice; and

- (g) the name, rank and telephone number of the police officer serving the notice or causing the notice to be served; and
 - (h) that a police officer may use reasonable force to enable the sample to be taken.
- (4) A notice under subsection (2) must be served in accordance with section 464ZFAA(4) and (5).
- (5) Section 464ZFAA(6), (7) and (8) apply to a notice served under subsection (2) as if it were a notice served under that section.
- (6) If a notice under subsection (2) is not served within the period referred to in section 464ZFAC(2)(b), a police officer may, within 28 days of the expiry of that period, apply to a magistrate or registrar of the Magistrates' Court for a warrant under subsection (7).
- (7) On an application referred to in subsection (6) being made a magistrate or a registrar may, if satisfied by evidence on oath or by affidavit that the notice was not served on the relevant person, issue a warrant authorising the person to whom it is directed, if necessary—
 - (a) to break, enter and search by day or by night any place where the relevant person named in the warrant is suspected to be; and
 - (b) to arrest the relevant person; and
 - (c) to detain the relevant person for as long as reasonably permits for the DNA profile sample to be taken.
- (8) A magistrate or a registrar must not issue a warrant under subsection (7) unless satisfied by evidence on oath or by affidavit that—
 - (a) reasonable attempts have been made to serve the notice on the relevant person; and

- (b) the DNA profile sample has not been taken from the relevant person.
- (9) Section 464ZFA(2), (3), (4), (5), (6) and (7) apply to a warrant issued under subsection (7) as if it were a warrant issued under section 464ZFA(1B).

S. 464ZFAE
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 62.

464ZFAE Senior police officer may authorise taking a DNA profile sample from certain adults and children who have previously provided a sample

- (1) A senior police officer, on request from a police officer, may authorise the taking of a DNA profile sample from a person if the senior police officer is satisfied that—
 - (a) a sample for the purpose of deriving a DNA profile was previously taken from the person—
 - (i) in accordance with an order made by a court under section 464T, 464U, 464V, 464ZF or 464ZFAAA; or
 - (ii) in accordance with section 464SC, an authorisation given under section 464SE, a direction given under section 464ZFA or a senior police officer authorisation; and
 - (b) a forensic scientist has not derived a DNA profile from the sample taken from the person.
- (2) A senior police officer may serve, or may cause to be served, a notice on a person referred to in subsection (1) directing the person to attend at a police station specified in the notice within 28 days after service of the notice to take a DNA profile sample.
- (3) A notice under subsection (2) must state—
 - (a) the date on which the senior police officer authorisation was given; and

- (b) the kind of DNA profile sample that is to be taken from the person; and
 - (c) the name, rank and telephone number of the senior police officer who gave the authorisation; and
 - (d) that the Chief Commissioner of Police does not have a DNA profile of the person; and
 - (e) that a DNA profile was not able to be derived by a forensic scientist from the sample given by the person—
 - (i) in accordance with an order made by a court under section 464T, 464U, 464V, 464ZF or 464ZFAAA; or
 - (ii) in accordance with section 464SC, an authorisation given under section 464SE, a direction given under section 464ZFAB or a senior police officer authorisation; and
 - (f) that if the person fails to comply with the notice, application for a warrant to arrest the person may be made without further notice to the person; and
 - (g) that the person may wish to seek legal advice as to the effect of the notice; and
 - (h) the name, rank and telephone number of the police officer serving the notice or causing the notice to be served; and
 - (i) that a police officer may use reasonable force to enable the DNA profile sample to be taken.
- (4) A notice under subsection (2) must be served by delivering a true copy of the notice to the person personally.

- (5) Section 464ZFAA(6), (7) and (8) apply to a notice served under subsection (2) as if it were a notice served under that section.

S. 464ZFA
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 27/2006
s. 10(1).

464ZFA Warrants issued for forensic procedures under section 464ZF or 464ZFAAA

S. 464ZFA
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 25.

S. 464ZFA(1)
substituted by
No. 27/2006
s. 10(2),
amended by
No. 48/2006
s. 42(Sch.
item 9.3).

- (1) If—

S. 464ZFA
(1)(a)
amended by
No. 26/2014
s. 455(Sch.
item 7.5).

- (a) before a court makes an order under section 464ZF(3) directing a person to undergo a forensic procedure, that person has been released from the prison, police gaol, youth justice centre or designated mental health service where he or she was serving a term of imprisonment or a period of detention at the time the application for the order was made; or
- (b) a person fails to attend the hearing of an application under section 464ZFAAA(2) for an order directing the person to undergo a forensic procedure—

the court may issue a warrant authorising the person to whom it is directed, if necessary—

- (c) to break, enter and search by day or by night any place where the person named in the warrant is suspected to be; and
- (d) to arrest the person; and
- (e) to bring the person before the court for the hearing of the application; and

- (f) if that application is granted, to detain the person for as long as reasonably permits the conduct of the forensic procedure.
- (1A) If a court makes an order under section 464ZF(2) or 464ZFAAA(2) directing a person to undergo a forensic procedure and the person does not comply with a direction referred to in section 464ZF(2A) or 464ZFAAA(9), as the case may be, a police officer may apply to a magistrate or a registrar of the Magistrates' Court for a warrant under subsection (1B).
- (1B) If a magistrate or a registrar to whom such an application is made is satisfied by evidence on oath or by affirmation or affidavit that the person has not complied with a direction referred to in section 464ZF(2A) or 464ZFAAA(9), the magistrate or registrar may issue a warrant authorising the person to whom it is directed, if necessary—
- (a) to break, enter and search by day or by night any place where the person named in the warrant is suspected to be; and
- (b) to arrest the person; and
- (c) to detain the person for as long as reasonably permits the conduct of the forensic procedure.
- (2) A warrant issued under subsection (1) or (1B) may be directed to—
- (a) a named police officer; or
- S. 464ZFA(1A)**
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 12(1),
amended by
Nos 27/2006
s. 10(3),
20/2011
s. 5(1),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.36(a)).
- S. 464ZFA(1B)**
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 12(1),
amended by
Nos 27/2006
s. 10(4),
6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.10).
- S. 464ZFA(2)**
amended by
No. 16/2002
s. 12(2)(a).
- S. 464ZFA**
(2)(a)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.36
(b)(i)).

S. 464ZFA
(2)(b)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.36(b)(iii)).

(b) generally all police officers.

S. 464FA(3)
amended by
Nos 16/2002
s. 12(2)(b),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.36(c)).

(3) A warrant issued under subsection (1) or (1B) directed to a named police officer may be executed by any police officer.

S. 464ZFA(4)
amended by
No. 16/2002
s. 12(2)(c)(i).

(4) If a court issues a warrant under subsection (1) or a magistrate or registrar issues a warrant under subsection (1B), the court, magistrate or registrar must—

S. 464ZFA
(4)(a)
amended by
No. 16/2002
s. 12(2)(c)(ii).

(a) give reasons for the decision; and

(b) cause a note of the reasons to be entered in the records of the court.

S. 464ZFA(5)
amended by
No. 16/2002
s. 12(2)(d)(i)(ii).

(5) A failure of a court, magistrate or registrar to comply with subsection (4) does not invalidate any order made by the court, magistrate or registrar but constitutes non-compliance for the purposes of section 464ZE(1)(a).

S. 464ZFA(6)
amended by
No. 16/2002
s. 12(2)(e).

(6) If a person is arrested under a warrant issued under subsection (1) or (1B), the warrant ceases to have effect immediately after the procedure is completed or on the expiration of a reasonable time (whichever is the earlier).

(7) A police officer who executes a warrant issued under subsection (1B) must, as soon as practicable after executing the warrant—

S. 464ZFA(7)
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 12(3),
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.36(d)(i)).

(a) endorse the warrant to that effect; and

(b) cause to be lodged with a registrar of the Magistrates' Court a report signed by the police officer and containing particulars of—

S. 464ZFA
(7)(b)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.36(d)(ii)).

(i) the date and time at which the person was arrested;

(ii) the date and time at which the person was released from custody;

(iii) the date, time and place at which the forensic procedure was conducted;

(iv) the name and position of the person who conducted the forensic procedure and every other person present;

(v) the type of sample taken;

(vi) whether reasonable force was used to enable the forensic procedure to be conducted.

S. 464ZFB
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 27/2006
s. 11(1).

**464ZFB Retention of information following finding of
guilt etc.**

S. 464ZFB
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 26.

S. 464ZFB
(1AA)
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 11(1).

(1AA) If—

S. 464ZFB
(1AA)(a)
substituted by
No. 3/2019
s. 63(1).

(a) a DNA profile sample is taken or a forensic procedure is conducted on a person of or above the age of 18 years in accordance with section 464R, 464SA, 464SC, 464SE, 464T(3) or 464V(5); and

(b) a court finds the person guilty, or not guilty because of mental impairment, of—

S. 464ZFB
(1AA)(b)(i)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 63(2)(a).

(i) the indictable offence in respect of which the DNA profile sample was taken or the forensic procedure was conducted; or

(ii) any other indictable offence arising out of the same circumstances; or

S. 464ZFB
(1AA)(b)(iii)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 63(2)(b).

(iii) any other indictable offence in respect of which evidence obtained as a result of the DNA profile sample or the forensic procedure had probative value—

the sample taken and any related material and information may be retained indefinitely.

(1AB) Subsection (1AA) does not apply if—

- (a) on appeal against conviction, the finding of guilt or conviction referred to in subsection (1AA) is set aside; or
- (b) on appeal against the verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment, the verdict referred to in subsection (1AA) is set aside.

S. 464ZFB
(1AB)
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 11(1).

(1) If at any time on or after the commencement of section 26 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997**—

S. 464ZFB(1)
amended by
Nos 16/2002
s. 13(1)(a)(b),
14/2006
s. 14(a),
72/2013
s. 11(2)(c),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).

- (a) a DNA profile sample is taken from a DNA person who is a child in accordance with section 464SC or 464SE or a forensic procedure is conducted on a child in accordance with section 464U(7) or 464V(5); and

S. 464ZFB
(1)(a)
amended by
No. 41/2004
s. 17,
substituted by
No. 72/2013
s. 11(2)(a),
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 63(3)(a).

- (b) a court finds the child guilty of—

S. 464ZFB
(1)(b)
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 11(2)(b).

- (i) the offence in respect of which the DNA profile sample was taken or the forensic procedure was conducted; or

S. 464ZFB
(1)(b)(i)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 63(3)(b).

S. 464ZFB
(1)(b)(iii)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 63(3)(c).

- (ii) any other offence arising out of the same circumstances; or
- (iii) any other offence in respect of which evidence obtained as a result of the DNA profile sample or forensic procedure had probative value—

a police officer, at any time after the finding of guilt but not later than 6 months after the final determination of an appeal against conviction or sentence or the expiry of any appeal period in respect of the offence (whichever is the later), may apply to the court referred to in paragraph (b) or to the Children's Court for an order permitting the retention of any sample taken and any related material and information and the court may make an order accordingly.

S. 464ZFB(1A)
inserted by
No. 27/2006
s. 11(2),
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).

(1A) If—

S. 464ZFB
(1A)(a)
substituted by
No. 72/2013
s. 11(3)(a),
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 63(4)(a).

- (a) a DNA profile sample is taken from a DNA person who is a child in accordance with section 464SC or 464SE or a forensic procedure is conducted on a child in accordance with section 464U(7) or 464V(5); and

S. 464ZFB
(1A)(b)
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 11(3)(b).

- (b) a court finds the child not guilty because of mental impairment of—

S. 464ZFB
(1A)(b)(i)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 63(4)(b).

- (i) the offence in respect of which the DNA profile sample was taken or the forensic procedure was conducted; or

(ii) any other offence arising out of the same circumstances; or

(iii) any other offence in respect of which evidence obtained as a result of the DNA profile sample or forensic procedure had probative value—

**S. 464ZFB
(1A)(b)(iii)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 63(4)(c).**

a police officer, at any time after the verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment, but not later than 6 months after the final determination of an appeal against the verdict or the expiry of any appeal period in respect of the verdict (whichever is the later), may apply to the court referred to in paragraph (b) for an order permitting the retention of any sample taken and any related material and information and the court may make an order accordingly.

(1B) Subsection (1A) does not apply to an offence heard and determined summarily.

**S. 464ZFB(1B)
inserted by
No. 27/2006
s. 11(2),
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.38).**

(2) A court hearing an application under subsection (1) or (1A)—

**S. 464ZFB(2)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 11(3)(a).**

(a) must take into account the seriousness of the circumstances of the offence in determining whether to make the order under subsection (1) or (1A), as the case requires; and

**S. 464ZFB
(2)(a)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 11(3)(b).**

(b) must be satisfied that, in all the circumstances, the making of the order is justified; and

S. 464ZFB
(2)(c)
amended by
No. 6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.11).

(c) may make such inquiries on oath or by affirmation or otherwise as it considers desirable.

S. 464ZFB(2A)
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 13(2),
amended by
No. 14/2006
s. 14(b)(i)(ii).

(2A) An order made under subsection (1) before the expiry of the appeal period in respect of the conviction for the offence or the final determination of an appeal against conviction (whichever is the later)—

(a) takes effect on that expiry or final determination; and

(b) has no effect if, on appeal against conviction, the finding of guilt or conviction is set aside.

S. 464ZFB
(2A)(b)
amended by
Nos 14/2006
s. 14(b)(ii),
68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.39) (as
amended by
No. 29/2011
s. 3(Sch. 1
item 25.1)).

S. 464ZFB(2B)
inserted by
No. 27/2006
s. 11(4).

(2B) An order made under subsection (1A) before the expiry of the appeal period in respect of the verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment or the final determination of an appeal against the verdict (whichever is later)—

(a) takes effect on that expiry or final determination; and

(b) has no effect if, on appeal, the verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment is set aside.

S. 464ZFB(3)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 11(5).

(3) If a court makes an order under subsection (1) or (1A), it must give reasons for its decision and cause a copy of the order and reasons to be served on the person on whom the forensic procedure was conducted.

- (4) A failure of a court to comply with subsection (3) does not invalidate any order made by it but constitutes non-compliance for the purposes of section 464ZE(1)(a).

464ZFC Destruction of information following finding of guilt etc.

- (1) Subject to section 464ZFD(2), if—

- (aa) a finding of guilt, a conviction or a verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment referred to in section 464ZFB(1AA) is set aside on appeal; or

- (ab) the finding of guilt of a registrable offender within the meaning of section 3(1) of the **Sex Offenders Registration Act 2004** is quashed or set aside on appeal and, but for that offence, the person would not be a registrable offender; or

- (a) a police officer does not make an application under section 464ZFB(1) or (1A) within the period specified by that subsection; or

- (b) a court refuses to make an order under section 464ZFB(1) or (1A)—

the Chief Commissioner of Police must without delay destroy, or cause to be destroyed, any sample taken and any related material and information.

S. 464ZFC
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 27/2006
s. 12(1).

S. 464ZFC
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 26.

S. 464ZFC
(1)(aa)
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 12(a).

S. 464ZFC
(1)(ab)
inserted by
No. 25/2017
s. 54.

S. 464ZFC
(1)(a)
amended by
Nos 27/2006
s. 12(2),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).

S. 464ZFC
(1)(b)
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 12(b).

- (2) If a sample or related material and information is required to be destroyed in accordance with this section, the Chief Commissioner of Police must, if the person on whom the procedure was conducted so requests, within 14 days after receiving the request, notify in writing that person of whether the destruction has occurred.
- (3) A person who knowingly—
 - (a) fails to destroy; or
 - (b) uses, or causes or permits to be used—
a sample or related material and information required by this section to be destroyed is guilty of a summary offence punishable on conviction by level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).
- (4) A person who at any time uses, or causes or permits to be used, or otherwise disseminates information derived from, any sample or related material and information required by this section to be destroyed except in good faith for the purposes of section 464ZFD(2) is guilty of a summary offence punishable on conviction by level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

S. 464ZFD
(Heading)
substituted by
No. 32/2007
s. 5(1).
S. 464ZFD
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 26.

464ZFD Victorian DNA database

S. 464ZFD
(1AA)
inserted by
No. 32/2007
s. 5(2).

- (1AA) The Chief Commissioner of Police may keep a DNA database system.

- (1) Information (including information which may identify the person from whom a DNA profile sample was taken or on whom a forensic procedure was conducted) obtained from the analysis of samples taken or procedures conducted in accordance with sections 464R to 464ZA, section 464ZF, 464ZFAAA or 464ZFAB, 464ZFAC, 464ZFAE or sections 464ZGB to 464ZGD (as the case may be), and which in accordance with this Subdivision may be retained, may be included in the DNA database system kept under subsection (1AA).

S. 464ZFD(1)
amended by
Nos 27/2006
s. 13, 32/2007
s. 5(3),
25/2017 s. 55,
3/2019
s. 64(1).

- (2) Information (other than information which may identify the person from whom a DNA profile sample was taken or on whom a forensic procedure was conducted) obtained from the analysis of samples taken or procedures conducted in accordance with this Subdivision may be retained and included in the DNA database system kept under subsection (1AA) for statistical purposes.

S. 464ZFD(2)
amended by
Nos 16/2002
s. 14, 32/2007
s. 5(4), 3/2019
s. 64(2).

464ZFE Report to Attorney-General

S. 464ZFE
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 26.

The Chief Commissioner of Police, on or as soon as practicable after 1 January, 1 April, 1 July and 1 October of each year, must submit to the Attorney-General a report that contains—

- (a) a list that identifies by a unique identifying number every sample taken in accordance with this Subdivision within the period to which the report relates; and
- (b) the date on which every sample listed in the report was taken; and

S. 464ZFE(c)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 65(a).

(c) information on whether any of the samples listed in the report or in any previous report submitted under this section have been destroyed within the period to which the report relates and the reason for the destruction of the sample; and

S. 464ZFE(d)
amended by
No. 41/2004
s. 18(a),
substituted by
No. 3/2019
s. 65(b).

(d) if a sample has been destroyed, the date that the requirement to destroy it arose, the date of destruction and the name of the person who has destroyed it; and

S. 464ZFE(da)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 65(b).

(da) information on any DNA profile sample that has been retained for 12 months or more including the status of any investigation of the DNA person from whom the sample was taken; and

S. 464ZFE(db)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 65(b).

(db) information on forensic material taken from suspects in accordance with section 464R, 464T or 464U that has been retained for 12 months or more including the status of any investigation of the suspect from whom the forensic material was taken; and

S. 464ZFE(e)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 18(b),
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 65(c).

(e) the number of authorisations given under sections 464SA and 464SE within the period to which the report relates; and

S. 464ZFE(f)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 18(b),
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 65(d).

(f) the number of authorisations refused to be given under sections 464SA and 464SE within the period to which the report relates.

464ZG Destruction of identifying information

(1) In this section, *relevant offence* means—

S. 464ZG
inserted by
No. 84/1989
s. 5,
substituted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

(a) the indictable offence in respect of which the DNA profile sample was taken or the forensic procedure was conducted; or

S. 464ZG(1)(a)
amended by
Nos 72/2013
s. 13, 3/2019
s. 66(a).

(b) any other indictable offence arising out of the same circumstances; or

S. 464ZG(1)(b)
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 13.

(c) any other indictable offence in respect of which the evidence obtained as a result of the DNA profile sample or the forensic procedure has probative value.

S. 464ZG(1)(c)
amended by
Nos 72/2013
s. 13, 3/2019
s. 66(b).

* * * * *

S. 464ZG(2)
repealed by
No. 81/1997
s. 27(1).

(3) Subject to section 464ZFD(2), if a DNA profile sample has been taken or a forensic procedure has been conducted on a person and—

S. 464ZG(3)
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 27(2)(a)(c),
3/2019
s. 66(c).

(a) the person has not been charged with a relevant offence at the end of the period of 12 months after the taking of the sample or the conduct of the procedure; or

S. 464ZG(3)(a)
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 27(2)(b),
3/2019
s. 66(d).

S. 464ZG(3)(b)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 14.

- (b) the person has been so charged but the charge is not proceeded with or the person is not found guilty (except because of mental impairment) of the offence or any other relevant offence, whether on appeal or otherwise, before the end of that period—

the Chief Commissioner of Police, subject to subsection (5), must destroy, or cause to be destroyed, at the time specified in subsection (4) any sample taken and any related material and information.

S. 464ZG(4)
amended by
No. 81/1997
s. 27(3)(a).

- (4) A sample and any related material and information referred to in subsection (3) must be destroyed—

S. 464ZG(4)(a)
amended by
No. 81/1997
s. 27(3)(b).

- (a) in a case to which subsection (3)(a) applies, immediately after that period of 12 months; or

- (b) in a case to which subsection (3)(b) applies—

S. 464ZG
(4)(b)(i)
amended by
No. 1/2026
s. 70(3).

- (i) within one month after the conclusion of the proceedings and the end of any appeal period; or

S. 464ZG
(4)(b)(ii)
amended by
No. 1/2026
s. 70(3).

- (ii) if the proceedings have been adjourned under section 75 of the **Sentencing Act 1991**, within one month of dismissal under that section.

S. 464ZG(5)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).

- (5) A police officer may, before the end of a period referred to in subsection (4), apply, without notice to any other person, to the Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court (as the case requires) for an order extending that period and, if the court makes such an order, the reference to the period in subsection (4) is a reference to that period as so extended.

- (6) If the Magistrates' Court or the Children's Court makes an order under subsection (5), it must give reasons for its decision and cause a copy of the order to be served on the person from whom the DNA profile sample was taken or on whom the forensic procedure was conducted. **S. 464ZG(6) amended by No. 3/2019 s. 66(e).**
- (7) If a sample or related material and information is required to be destroyed in accordance with this section, the Chief Commissioner of Police must, if the person on whom the procedure was conducted so requests, within 14 days after receiving the request, notify in writing that person of whether the destruction has occurred. **S. 464ZG(7) substituted by No. 81/1997 s. 27(4).**
- (8) A person who knowingly—
- (a) fails to destroy; or
- (b) uses, or causes or permits to be used—
- a sample or related material and information required by this section to be destroyed is guilty of a summary offence punishable on conviction by level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).
- S. 464ZG(8) amended by Nos 69/1997 s. 22(15), 81/1997 s. 27(5)(a)(c).
S. 464ZG(8)(b) amended by No. 81/1997 s. 27(5)(b).**
- (9) A person who at any time uses, or causes or permits to be used, or otherwise disseminates information derived from, any sample or related material and information required by this section to be destroyed except in good faith for the purposes of a relevant offence or for the purposes of section 464ZFD(2) is guilty of a summary offence punishable on conviction by level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum). **S. 464ZG(9) amended by Nos 69/1997 s. 22(15), 81/1997 s. 27(6)(a)–(c).**

464ZGA Forensic information from juveniles

S. 464ZGA
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 28.

(1) Subject to section 464ZFD(2), if—

S.
464ZGA(1)(a)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 67(1).

- (a) a person has a DNA profile sample taken or undergoes a forensic procedure as a child in accordance with this Subdivision, whether before or after the commencement of section 28 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997**; and
- (b) any sample taken is not required to be destroyed under this Subdivision, other than under this subsection; and
- (c) the person is not found guilty of any further offence before attaining the age of 26 years—

the Chief Commissioner of Police must without delay destroy, or cause to be destroyed, any sample taken and any related material and information.

S. 464ZGA(2)
amended by
Nos 77/2005
s. 8(3)(d),
7/2008
s. 7(3)(f),
63/2014
s. 3(5),
substituted by
No. 5/2018
s. 9.

(2) Subsection (1) does not apply if—

- (a) the person from whom the sample was taken is found guilty of—

S. 464ZGA
(2)(a)(i)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 67(2)(a).

- (i) the offence in relation to which the DNA profile sample was taken or the forensic procedure was conducted; or

- (ii) an offence arising out of the same circumstances as the offence referred to in subparagraph (i); or
 - (iii) an offence in respect of which evidence obtained as a result of the DNA profile sample or the forensic procedure had probative value; and
- (b) the offence of which the person is found guilty is—
- (i) an offence against this Act; or
 - (ii) an offence at common law the maximum penalty for which is specified by this Act; and
- (c) the offence of which the person is found guilty is punishable by level 4 imprisonment (15 years maximum) or more (however the penalty is described); and
- (d) the sample—
- (i) was taken in accordance with an order under section 464ZF(2); or
 - (ii) is the subject of an order under section 464ZFB(1).

**S. 464ZGA
(2)(a)(iii)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 67(2)(b).**

464ZGB Samples given voluntarily

**S. 464ZGB
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 28.**

- (1) A person of or above the age of 18 years may volunteer to give a sample (whether an intimate or non-intimate sample) to a police officer.
- (2) A sample may only be given under this section if the person volunteering to give it consents in accordance with this section and that consent is not withdrawn prior to the giving of the sample.

**S. 464ZGB(1)
amended by
Nos 72/2004
s. 32, 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).**

S. 464ZGB(3)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).

(3) A person consents in accordance with this section only if, in the presence of an independent person, he or she consents after a police officer has informed the person in language likely to be understood by the person—

(a) that any sample that is given will be analysed;

S. 464ZGB
(3)(b)
substituted by
No. 16/2002
s. 15.

(b) that information obtained from the analysis will be placed on a DNA database and may be used for the purpose of a criminal investigation or any other purpose for which the DNA database may be used under this Subdivision or under a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction;

S. 464ZGB
(3)(ba)
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 15.

(ba) that the person may choose whether the information obtained from analysis of the sample may be used—

(i) only for a limited purpose to be specified by the volunteer; or

(ii) for the purpose of a criminal investigation or any other purpose for which the DNA database may be used under this Subdivision or under a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction;

S. 464ZGB
(3)(bb)
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 15.

(bb) that information obtained from the analysis could produce evidence to be used in a court;

(c) that the person is under no obligation to give a sample;

(d) that if the person consents to give a sample, he or she may at any time before the sample is taken, withdraw that consent;

- | | |
|---|--|
| (e) that the person may consult a legal practitioner (whether the term legal practitioner or lawyer is used) before deciding whether or not to consent to give a sample; | S. 464ZGB
(3)(e)
amended by
No. 72/2013
s. 14. |
| (f) that the person may at any time (including after he or she has been charged with an offence) withdraw his or her consent to the retention of the sample; | |
| (g) that where the person withdraws his or her consent to the retention of the sample, a police officer may nevertheless apply to a court for an order to retain the sample and any related material and information; | S. 464ZGB
(3)(g)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37). |
| (h) that the person may request that the sample be taken by or in the presence of a medical practitioner, nurse, midwife or dentist of his or her choice. | S. 464ZGB
(3)(h)
amended by
No. 13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.10). |
| (4) A police officer who informs a person of the matters in subsection (3) must— | S. 464ZGB(4)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37). |
| (a) record the giving of the information and the person's responses, if any— | |
| (i) in writing signed by both the person and the independent person witnessing the giving of the consent; and | |
| (ii) by audiovisual recording, if practicable, or otherwise by audio recording; and | S. 464ZGB
(4)(a)(ii)
substituted by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(30)(a). |
| (b) give or send by registered post to the person or his or her legal practitioner, without charge— | |
| (i) a copy of the audiovisual recording or audio recording as soon as practicable, but not more than 7 days after the information is given; and | S. 464ZGB
(4)(b)(i)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(30)(b). |

- (ii) a copy of the written record, signed by both the person and the independent person, forthwith.

S. 464ZGC
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 28.

464ZGC Withdrawal of consent prior to giving sample

S. 464ZGC(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).

- (1) A person, at any time prior to giving a sample, may withdraw the consent that was given by him or her in accordance with section 464ZGB either—

- (a) orally; or
- (b) in writing—

to a police officer or to the person authorised to take the sample.

S. 464ZGC(2)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).

- (2) If, prior to giving a sample, a person withdraws his or her consent orally, a police officer or the person authorised to take the sample must, as soon as practicable, record in writing the withdrawal of consent.

S. 464ZGD
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 28.

464ZGD Procedure to take sample

- (1) The procedure to be conducted to take a sample from a person following the giving of consent in accordance with section 464ZGB must—

- (a) be in accordance with the procedure set out in section 464Z; and
- (b) be recorded by audiovisual recording, if practicable, and if the person consents.

S. 464ZGD
(1)(b)
amended by
No. 27/2006
s. 17(31)(a).

- (2) If the taking of a sample voluntarily given by a person is recorded by audiovisual recording, a police officer must—

- (a) without charge; and
- (b) as soon as practicable but not more than 7 days after the sample was taken—

give or send by registered post a copy of the audiovisual recording to the person who voluntarily gave the sample.

S. 464ZGD(2)
amended by
Nos 27/2006
s. 17(31)(b),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).

464ZGE Safeguards after giving sample

S. 464ZGE
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 28.

- (1) If a person has given his or her consent in accordance with section 464ZGB, and a sample has been taken, that person may at any time after the sample has been taken, by notice in writing to the Chief Commissioner of Police, withdraw his or her consent to the retention of that sample.
- (2) Subject to subsection (5) and section 464ZFD(2), if a person has voluntarily given a sample in accordance with sections 464ZGB to 464ZGD and either—
 - (a) that person in accordance with subsection (1) has withdrawn his or her consent to the retention of that sample; or
 - (b) a court has made an order under section 464ZGF for the retention of that sample and any related material and information, and—
 - (i) the person has not been charged with an indictable offence at the end of the period of 12 months after the order of the court; or
 - (ii) the person has been so charged but the charge is not proceeded with, or the person is not found guilty of the indictable offence or any other

indictable offence for which the sample and any related material and information had probative value, whether on appeal or otherwise, before the end of that period—

the Chief Commissioner of Police, at the time specified in subsection (3), must destroy, or cause to be destroyed, any sample given and any related material and information.

(3) A sample and any related material and information referred to in subsection (2) must be destroyed—

(a) within 28 days after the receipt of the person's notice of withdrawal of consent under subsection (1); or

(b) in a case to which subsection (2)(b)(i) applies, immediately after that period of 12 months; or

(c) in a case to which subsection (2)(b)(ii) applies—

(i) within one month after the conclusion of the proceedings and the end of any appeal period; or

(ii) if the proceedings have been adjourned under section 75 of the **Sentencing Act 1991**, within one month after dismissal under that section.

(4) The Chief Commissioner of Police is not required to comply with the requirements in subsections (2) and (3) to destroy or cause to be destroyed a sample and any related material and information by reason of the person's withdrawal of consent if the Magistrates' Court makes an order under

S. 464ZGE
(3)(c)(i)
amended by
No. 1/2026
s. 70(4).

S. 464ZGE
(3)(c)(ii)
amended by
No. 1/2026
s. 70(4).

section 464ZGF for the retention of that sample and any related material and information.

- (5) If the Magistrates' Court refuses to make an order under section 464ZGF for the retention of a sample and any related material and information, and a person in accordance with subsection (1) has withdrawn his or her consent to the retention of that sample, the Chief Commissioner of Police must immediately destroy, or cause to be immediately destroyed, the sample given and any related material and information.
- (6) A police officer may, before the end of a period referred to in subsection (3)(b) or (3)(c), apply, without notice to any other person, to the Magistrates' Court for an order extending that period and, if the court makes such an order, the reference to the period in subsection (3)(b) or (3)(c) is a reference to that period as so extended.
- (7) If the Magistrates' Court makes an order under subsection (6), it must give reasons for its decision and cause a copy of the order to be served on the person who voluntarily gave the sample.
- (8) If a sample or related material and information is destroyed in accordance with this section, the Chief Commissioner of Police must, within 14 days, give notice of the destruction to the person who voluntarily gave the sample.
- (9) A person who knowingly—
 - (a) fails to destroy; or
 - (b) uses, or causes or permits to be used—a sample or related material and information required by this section to be destroyed is guilty of a summary offence punishable on conviction by level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

S. 464ZGE(6)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).

- (10) A person who at any time uses, or causes or permits to be used, or otherwise disseminates information derived from any sample or related material and information required by this section to be destroyed except in good faith for the purposes of section 464ZFD(2) is guilty of a summary offence punishable on conviction by level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).
- S. 464ZGE(11)**
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).
- (11) This section does not prevent a police officer, in respect of a person who has voluntarily given a sample under sections 464ZGB to 464ZGD—
- (a) requesting, under section 464R, the person to undergo a forensic procedure; or
- S. 464ZGE**
(11)(ab)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 68.
- (ab) requesting, under section 464SC, the person to give a DNA profile sample; or
- S. 464ZGE**
(11)(ac)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 68.
- (ac) making an authorisation under section 464SE for the taking of a DNA profile sample from the person; or
- (b) making an application under section 464T or 464V for a court order directing the person to undergo a compulsory procedure.
- S. 464ZGE(12)**
repealed by
No. 80/1998
s. 3(e).
- * * * * *

464ZGF Application to court where consent to retention of sample withdrawn

S. 464ZGF
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 28.

- (1) A police officer may apply to the Magistrates' Court for an order to retain a sample that has been voluntarily given by a person in accordance with sections 464ZGB to 464ZGD, and any related material and information, and the court may make an order accordingly, if during an investigation into the commission of an indictable offence—

S. 464ZGF(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).

(a) either—

- (i) material reasonably believed to be from the body of a person who committed the indictable offence has been found—

(A) at the scene of the offence; or

(B) on the victim of the offence or on anything reasonably believed to have been worn or carried by the victim when the offence was committed; or

(C) on an object or person reasonably believed to have been associated with the commission of the offence; or

- (ii) if the offence is an offence against a provision of Subdivision (8A), (8B) or (8C) of Division 1 of Part I, and a police officer reasonably believes that a child has been conceived as a result of the commission of the offence and a sample has been taken from that child; and

S. 464ZGF(1)
(a)(ii)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).

S. 464ZGF
(1)(b)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.37).

- (b) a police officer reasonably believes that information obtained from the analysis of the sample voluntarily given by the person, and from any related material and information, has probative value in relation to the indictable offence being investigated; and
 - (c) the person who voluntarily gave that sample has withdrawn his or her consent to the retention of that sample; and
 - (d) the information obtained from the analysis of the voluntary sample, and from any related material and information, has not been destroyed in accordance with section 464ZGE(2)(a) and (3)(a).
- (2) A court hearing an application under subsection (1) must—
- (a) be satisfied on the balance of probabilities that there are reasonable grounds to believe that the person has committed the offence in respect of which the application is made; and
 - (b) be satisfied that, in all the circumstances, the making of the order is justified.
- (3) If the court makes an order under subsection (1), it must give reasons for its decision and cause a copy of the order and reasons to be served on the person who voluntarily gave the sample.
- (4) A failure of a court to comply with subsection (3) does not invalidate any order made by it but constitutes non-compliance for the purposes of section 464ZE(1)(a).

464ZGFA Voluntary samples given by police or VIFM personnel

S. 464ZGFA
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 15.

(1) In this section—

Institute means the Victorian Institute of Forensic Medicine established under the **Victorian Institute of Forensic Medicine Act 2024**;

S. 464ZGFA(1)
def. of
Institute
amended by
No. 34/2024
s. 50(1).

relevant agency means—

- (a) Victoria Police; or
 - (b) the Institute.
- (2) Any of the following persons may volunteer to give to a relevant agency a sample of material from which a DNA profile may be derived—

(a) a member of Victoria Police personnel;

S. 464ZGFA
(2)(a)
substituted by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.38(a)).

(b) the Chief Executive Officer of the Institute or a person employed under section 30 or 31 of the **Victorian Institute of Forensic Medicine Act 2024**;

S. 464ZGFA
(2)(b)
substituted by
No. 34/2024
s. 50(2).

(c) a visitor to—

- (i) any premises at which the Victoria Police Forensic Services Department performs functions; or
- (ii) any premises at which the Institute performs any of its functions.

- (3) A sample may only be given under this section if the relevant agency has provided to the person volunteering to give the sample—
- (a) a written statement that the sample is to be provided for the purpose of comparing a DNA profile obtained from the sample against any other DNA profile held by the relevant agency to eliminate the person as a possible source of DNA in—
 - (i) the investigation of a crime; or
 - (ii) the investigation of a reportable death within the meaning of the **Coroners Act 2008**; or
 - (iii) in the case of the Institute, testing conducted by the Institute in the performance of its objects and functions; and
 - (b) a written statement of the requirements of section 464ZGFB(3) and (5).
- (4) A sample given under this section may be used only for the purpose referred to in subsection (3)(a).
- (5) Evidence of a sample given by a person under this section and any DNA profile obtained from the sample is inadmissible as evidence against the person, unless the person consents to the admission of the evidence, in—
- (a) any proceeding, whether civil or criminal; or
 - (b) a proceeding arising out of, or connected with, an investigation under Division 6 of Part 4, Part 5, Part 7, Part 9 or Part 10 of the **Victoria Police Act 2013** in respect of the person; or

S. 464ZGFA
(5)(b)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.38(b)(i)).

(c) a proceeding arising out of, or connected with, a critical incident (within the meaning of section 82 of the **Victoria Police Act 2013**).

S. 464ZGFA
(5)(c)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item
36.38(b)(ii)).

- (6) In subsection (5) a *proceeding* includes a coronial inquest or inquiry.
- (7) A sample given under this section and any DNA profile obtained from the sample may not be released to any person outside the relevant agency unless the person who gave the sample consents to the release.
- (8) A person must not knowingly use, or cause or permit to be used, or otherwise disseminate information derived from, a sample given under this section, any DNA profile obtained from the sample or any related information, other than in accordance with this section.
- Penalty: level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum).
- (9) An offence against subsection (8) is a summary offence.
- (10) This section does not affect any other power to require a person referred to in subsection (2) to provide a sample or to undergo a forensic procedure.

464ZGFB Destruction of samples given by police and VIFM personnel and storage of DNA information

S. 464ZGFB
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 15.

- (1) The Chief Commissioner of Police is responsible for ensuring the destruction under this section of samples and DNA profiles that are held or managed by Victoria Police.

S. 464ZGFB(2)
amended by
No. 34/2024
s. 51(1).

- (2) The Chief Executive Officer of the Institute is responsible for ensuring the destruction under this section of samples and DNA profiles that are held or managed by the Institute.
- (3) A DNA profile derived from a sample given under section 464ZGFA must be stored on a database that—
 - (a) is not a DNA database; and
 - (b) is not connected to any other database on which matching of DNA profiles occurs.

Notes

- 1 *DNA database* is defined in section 464(2).
- 2 A sample given under section 464ZGFA must not be entered in NCIDD.

S. 464ZGFB(4)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 69.

- (4) A sample given under section 464ZGFA and a DNA profile derived from the sample must be destroyed if—

S. 464ZGFB
(4)(a)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.39(a)).

- (a) in the case of a sample given by the Chief Commissioner of Police, the Chief Commissioner requests the destruction of the sample by notice in writing to the Minister administering the **Victoria Police Act 2013**; or

S. 464ZGFB
(4)(b)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.39(b)).

- (b) in the case of a sample given by any other member of Victoria Police personnel or a visitor to any premises at which the Victoria Police Forensic Services Department performs functions, the member or visitor requests the destruction of the sample by notice in writing to the Chief Commissioner of Police; or

- (c) in the case of a sample given by the Chief Executive Officer of the Institute, the Chief Executive Officer requests the destruction of the sample by notice in writing to the Attorney-General; or **S. 464ZGFB (4)(c) amended by No. 34/2024 s. 51(2)(a).**
- (d) in the case of a sample given by an employee of the Institute or a visitor to any premises at which the Institute performs any of its functions, the employee or visitor requests the destruction of the sample by notice in writing to the Chief Executive Officer of the Institute; or **S. 464ZGFB (4)(d) amended by No. 34/2024 s. 51(2)(b).**
- (e) 12 months have elapsed since the person who gave the sample ceased to be a member of Victoria Police personnel, the Chief Executive Officer of the Institute or an employee of the Institute, as the case may be. **S. 464ZGFB (4)(e) amended by Nos 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.39(b)), 34/2024 s. 51(2)(b).**
- (5) Without affecting any other arrangements for destruction of samples, this section also applies, on and from its commencement, to a sample given voluntarily by a person referred to in section 464ZGFA(2) before the commencement of this section.
- (6) A person must not knowingly—
- (a) fail to destroy; or
 - (b) use, or cause or permit to be used, or otherwise disseminate information derived from—
- a sample, or a DNA profile derived from a sample, that is required by this section to be destroyed.
- Penalty: level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum).

- (7) An offence against subsection (6) is a summary offence.

Heading
preceding
s. 464ZGFC
inserted by
No. 32/2024
s. 810.

Destruction of identifying information for children under 12 years of age

S. 464ZGFC
inserted by
No. 32/2024
s. 810.

464ZGFC Destruction of fingerprints for children under 12 years of age

- (1) This section applies despite anything to the contrary in this Subdivision.
- (2) Subject to subsection (3), within 12 months of the commencement of Part 1.2 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**, the Chief Commissioner of Police must destroy or cause to be destroyed—
 - (a) any fingerprint taken from a person under this Subdivision in respect of the commission or alleged commission of an offence by the person when the person was under 12 years of age; and
 - (b) any record, copy or photograph of that fingerprint.
- (3) The Chief Commissioner of Police is not required to destroy or cause to be destroyed a person's fingerprint referred to in subsection (2)(a) or a record, copy or photograph of that fingerprint if the person has died.
- (4) If a person's fingerprint and any record, copy or photograph of that fingerprint is required by this section to be destroyed, the Chief Commissioner of Police, on the request of that person, must notify the person in writing as to whether that fingerprint and other information has been destroyed.

(5) Notice under subsection (4) must be given within 14 days after the Chief Commissioner of Police receives the person's request.

(6) A person must not knowingly fail to destroy a fingerprint, or record, copy or photograph of a fingerprint, that is required by this section to be destroyed.

Penalty: Level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

(7) A person must not knowingly use, or cause or permit to be used, or otherwise disseminate information derived from a fingerprint, or record, copy or photograph of a fingerprint, that is required by this section to be destroyed.

Penalty: Level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

(8) An offence against subsection (6) or (7) is a summary offence.

(9) In this section—

destroy includes—

- (a) physically destroy; and
- (b) permanently de-identify information which identifies the person from whom the fingerprint was taken; and
- (c) permanently de-identify information from which the person's identity may be ascertained;

fingerprints includes a fingerscan taken under this Subdivision.

S. 464ZGFD
inserted by
No. 32/2024
s. 810.

464ZGFD Destruction of samples and other identifying information for children under 12 years of age

- (1) This section applies despite anything to the contrary in this Subdivision.
- (2) Subject to section 464ZFD(2), within 12 months of the commencement of Part 1.2 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**, the Chief Commissioner of Police must destroy or cause to be destroyed any of the following taken from a person under this Subdivision in respect of the commission or alleged commission of an offence by the person when the person was under 12 years of age—
 - (a) any sample taken from the person in a forensic procedure and any related material and information;
 - (b) any DNA profile sample taken from the person and any related material and information;
 - (c) any other sample taken from the person and any related material and information.
- (3) If a person's sample and any related material and information is required by this section to be destroyed, the Chief Commissioner of Police, on the request of that person, must notify the person in writing as to whether that sample and related material and information has been destroyed.
- (4) Notice under subsection (3) must be given within 14 days after the Chief Commissioner of Police receives the person's request.
- (5) A person must not knowingly fail to destroy a sample or any related material and information that is required by this section to be destroyed.

Penalty: Level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

- (6) A person must not knowingly use, or cause or permit to be used, or otherwise disseminate information derived from a sample or any related material and information that is required by this section to be destroyed, except in good faith for the purposes of section 464ZFD(2).

Penalty: Level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

- (7) An offence against subsection (5) or (6) is a summary offence.

DNA database systems

Heading preceding s. 464ZGG inserted by No. 16/2002 s. 16, amended by No. 32/2007 s. 6.

464ZGG Supply of forensic material for purposes of DNA database

S. 464ZGG inserted by No. 16/2002 s. 16.

- (1) In this section—

excluded forensic material means forensic material—

S. 464ZGG(1) def. of *excluded forensic material* amended by Nos 27/2006 s. 15, 3/2019 s. 70.

- (a) found at a crime scene; or
- (b) taken from a suspect in accordance with this Subdivision or under a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction; or
- (ba) taken from a DNA person in accordance with section 464SC or 464SE; or
- (bb) taken from a person in accordance with section 464ZFAC; or

- (bc) taken from a person in accordance with section 464ZF AE; or
- (c) taken from an offender under section 464ZF or 464ZGB or under a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction; or
- (ca) taken from a person under section 464ZF AAA following a finding of not guilty because of mental impairment; or
- (d) taken from the body of a deceased person; or
- (e) from the body of a missing person; or
- (f) taken from a volunteer who is a relative by blood of a deceased or missing person;

prohibited analysis means analysis for the purpose of deriving a DNA profile for inclusion on a DNA database when the forensic material is required to be destroyed by this Subdivision or under a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction.

(2) A person—

- (a) whose conduct causes the supply of forensic material taken from a person under this Subdivision (or under a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction) to a person for prohibited analysis; and
- (b) who intends or is reckless as to the supply of material of that kind—

is guilty of a summary offence and liable to level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

(3) A person—

- (a) whose conduct causes the supply of forensic material (other than excluded forensic material) to a person for analysis for the purpose of deriving a DNA profile for inclusion on a DNA database; and
- (b) who intends or is reckless as to the supply of material of that kind—

is guilty of a summary offence and liable to level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

464ZGH Use of information on Victorian DNA database

S. 464ZGH
(Heading)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 7(1).

S. 464ZGH
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 16.

- (1) A person who accesses information stored on the Victorian DNA database except in accordance with this section is guilty of a summary offence and liable to level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

S. 464ZGH(1)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 7(1).

- (2) A person may access information stored on the Victorian DNA database for one or more of the following purposes—

S. 464ZGH(2)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 7(1).

- (a) forensic comparison permitted under section 464ZGI (permissible matching);
- (b) making the information available, in accordance with the regulations, to the person to whom the information relates;
- (c) administering the Victorian DNA database;

S. 464ZGH
(2)(c)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 7(1).

S. 464ZGH
(2)(d)
substituted by
No. 32/2007
s. 7(2).

(d) in accordance with an arrangement entered
into under section 464ZGN;

(e) in accordance with the Mutual Assistance in
Criminal Matters Act 1987 of the
Commonwealth or the Extradition Act 1988
of the Commonwealth;

(f) a coronial investigation or inquest;

(g) an investigation of a complaint by—

S. 464ZGH
(2)(g)(i)
substituted by
No. 60/2014
s. 140(Sch. 3
item 8.1),
repealed by
No. 20/2017
s. 134(Sch. 1
item 5.1(a)).

* * * * *

S. 464ZGH
(2)(g)(ii)
amended by
No. 22/2016
s. 167.

(ii) the Health Complaints Commissioner
within the meaning of the **Health
Records Act 2001** for the purposes of
that Act; or

S. 464ZGH(2)
(g)(iii)
substituted by
No. 32/2007
s. 7(3).

(iii) the Ombudsman appointed under the
Ombudsman Act 1973; or

S. 464ZGH(2)
(g)(iv)
inserted by
No. 32/2007
s. 7(3),
amended by
Nos 34/2008
s. 143(Sch. 2
item 3.1),
82/2012
s. 159(2),
20/2017
s. 134(Sch. 1
item 5.1(b)),
substituted by
No. 3/2019
s. 71(1).

(iv) the IBAC;

(ga) the IBAC performing its functions under this Act;

S. 464ZGH
(2)(ga)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 71(2).

(h) an investigation of a complaint by the Information Commissioner under the **Privacy and Data Protection Act 2014**.

S. 464ZGH
(2)(h)
inserted by
No. 20/2017
s. 134(Sch. 1
item 5.1(c)).

(3) This section does not apply to information that cannot be used to discover the identity of any person.

464ZGI Permissible matching of DNA profiles

S. 464ZGI
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 16.

(1) A matching of a DNA profile on an index of the Victorian DNA database specified in column 1 of the following Table with a DNA profile on another index of the database specified in column 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7 or 8 of the Table is not permitted by this Subdivision if—

S. 464ZGI(1)
substituted by
No. 32/2007
s. 8(1).

(a) "only if within purpose" is shown in relation to the index specified in column 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7 or 8 opposite the volunteers (limited purposes) index specified in column 1; and

(b) the matching is carried out for a purpose other than a purpose for which the DNA profile placed on the volunteers (limited purposes) index specified in column 1 was so placed.

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part III—Procedure and punishment

S. 464ZGI(1)
(Table)
substituted by
No. 32/2007
s. 8(1).

TABLE

<i>Profile to be matched</i>	<i>Is matching permitted?</i>						
<i>Column 1</i>	<i>Column 2</i>	<i>Column 3</i>	<i>Column 4</i>	<i>Column 5</i>	<i>Column 6</i>	<i>Column 7</i>	<i>Column 8</i>
	<i>Crime Scene</i>	<i>Suspects</i>	<i>Volunteers (limited purposes)</i>	<i>(Volunteers (unlimited purposes))</i>	<i>Serious offenders</i>	<i>Missing persons</i>	<i>Unknown deceased persons</i>
1. crime scene	yes	yes	only if within purpose	yes	yes	yes	yes
2. suspects	yes	yes	only if within purpose	yes	yes	yes	yes
3. volunteers (limited purposes)	only if within purpose	only if within purpose	only if within purpose	only if within purpose	only if within purpose	only if within purpose	only if within purpose
4. volunteers (unlimited purposes)	yes	yes	only if within purpose	yes	yes	yes	yes
5. serious offenders	yes	yes	only if within purpose	yes	yes	yes	yes
6. missing persons	yes	yes	only if within purpose	yes	yes	yes	yes
7. unknown deceased persons	yes	yes	only if within purpose	yes	yes	yes	yes

(2) A person—

S. 464ZGI
(2)(a)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 8(2).

- (a) whose conduct causes the matching that is not permitted by this Subdivision of a DNA profile on an index of the Victorian DNA database with a DNA profile on the same or another index of the Victorian DNA database; and
- (b) who intends or is reckless as to any such matching of profiles—

is guilty of a summary offence and liable to level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

- (3) A person is not guilty of an offence against subsection (2) if the person's conduct causes a matching that is not permitted by this Subdivision but the matching is solely for the purpose of administering the Victorian DNA database.

S. 464ZGI(3)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 8(2).

464ZGJ Recording, retention and removal of identifying information on DNA database

S. 464ZGJ
(Heading)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 9(1).

- (1) In this section—

S. 464ZGJ
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 16.

identifying information means information referred to in section 464ZFD(1), whether or not kept on the Victorian DNA database;

S. 464ZGJ(1)
def. of
*identifying
information*
substituted by
No. 32/2007
s. 9(2).

identifying period for identifying information means—

S. 464ZGJ(1)
def. of
*identifying
period*
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 9(1)(3)-(5).

- (a) except as provided by paragraphs (b) and (c), the period of 12 months after the information is placed on the DNA database;
- (b) if the information is derived from forensic material taken from a volunteer—the period after the information is placed on the DNA database that is agreed by the Chief Commissioner of Police and the volunteer;
- (c) if the information is derived from forensic material taken from a deceased person (not being a person who was a volunteer) whose identity is known—the period for which the Chief Commissioner of Police orders the

responsible person to retain the
information;

S. 464ZGJ(1)
def. of
*responsible
person*
repealed by
No. 32/2007
s. 9(6).

* * * * *

S. 464ZGJ(2)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 9(1)(7).

- (2) A person who intentionally or recklessly causes any identifying information to be recorded or retained in a DNA database at any time after this Subdivision requires the forensic material to be destroyed is guilty of a summary offence and liable to level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

S. 464ZGJ(3)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 9(1)(8)-(10).

- (3) A responsible person who does not ensure that any identifying information on the volunteers (unlimited purposes) index or volunteers (limited purposes) index of the DNA database is removed from the database as soon as practicable after the end of the identifying period for the information is guilty of a summary offence and liable to level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

S. 464ZGJ(4)
amended by
Nos 32/2007
s. 9(1)(9)(11),
68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.40).

- (4) A responsible person who does not ensure that any identifying information relating to an offender on the serious offenders index of the DNA database is removed from the database as soon as practicable after becoming aware that the offender has been pardoned or acquitted of the offence concerned or if the conviction has been set aside is guilty of a summary offence and liable to level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

464ZGK Disclosure of Victorian information

(1) A person who—

S. 464ZGK
(Heading)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 10(1).

S. 464ZGK
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 16.

(a) has access to Victorian information; and

S. 464ZGK
(1)(a)
substituted by
No. 32/2007
s. 10(2).

(b) intentionally or recklessly causes the
disclosure of the Victorian information other
than as provided by this section—

S. 464ZGK
(1)(b)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 10(3).

is guilty of a summary offence and liable to
level 8 imprisonment (1 year maximum) or a
level 8 fine (120 penalty units maximum).

(2) A person may only disclose Victorian information
stored on a DNA database for one or more of the
following purposes—

S. 464ZGK(2)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 10(4).

(a) forensic comparison in the course of a
criminal investigation by a police officer or
any other person authorised in writing by the
Chief Commissioner of Police;

S. 464ZGK
(2)(a)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.40).

(b) making the information available, in
accordance with the regulations, to the
person to whom the information relates;

(c) administering the DNA database;

S. 464ZGK
(2)(c)
substituted by
No. 32/2007
s. 10(5).

(d) in accordance with an agreement entered into
under section 464ZGN;

S. 464ZGK
(2)(d)
substituted by
No. 32/2007
s. 10(5).

- (e) in accordance with the Mutual Assistance in Criminal Matters Act 1987 of the Commonwealth or the Extradition Act 1988 of the Commonwealth;
- (f) a coronial investigation or inquest;
- (g) an investigation of a complaint by—

S. 464ZGK
(2)(g)(i)
substituted by
No. 60/2014
s. 140(Sch. 3
item 8.2),
repealed by
No. 20/2017
s. 134(Sch. 1
item 5.2(a)).

* * * * *

S. 464ZGK
(2)(g)(ii)
amended by
No. 22/2016
s. 168.

- (ii) the Health Complaints Commissioner within the meaning of the **Health Records Act 2001** for the purposes of that Act; or

S. 464ZGK(2)
(g)(iii)
substituted by
No. 32/2007
s. 10(6).

- (iii) the Ombudsman appointed under the **Ombudsman Act 1973**; or

S. 464ZGK(2)
(g)(iv)
inserted by
No. 32/2007
s. 10(6),
amended by
Nos 34/2008
s. 143(Sch. 2
item 3.2),
82/2012
s. 159(3),
substituted by
No. 3/2019
s. 72(1).

- (iv) the IBAC; or

S. 464ZGK(2)
(g)(v)
inserted by
No. 32/2007
s. 10(6),
amended by
No. 20/2017
s. 134(Sch. 1
item 5.2(b)).

- (v) an authority of a participating jurisdiction, but only if the authority would be entitled to the information if it were held on the participating jurisdiction's DNA database;

- | | |
|---|---|
| (ga) the IBAC performing its functions under this Act; | S. 464ZGK
(2)(ga)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 72(2). |
| (h) an investigation of a complaint by the Information Commissioner under the Privacy and Data Protection Act 2014 . | S. 464ZGK
(2)(h)
inserted by
No. 20/2017
s. 134(Sch. 1
item 5.2(c)). |
| (3) A person may only disclose Victorian information revealed by the taking of a DNA profile sample or the carrying out of a forensic procedure as follows— | S. 464ZGK(3)
amended by
Nos 32/2007
s. 10(7),
3/2019
s. 72(3). |
| (a) if the person is the suspect, DNA person, offender or volunteer to whom the information relates; | S.
464ZGK(3)(a)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 72(4)(a). |
| (b) if the information is already publicly available; | |
| (c) in accordance with any other provision of this Subdivision; | |
| (d) in accordance with the Mutual Assistance in Criminal Matters Act 1987 of the Commonwealth or the Extradition Act 1988 of the Commonwealth; | |
| (e) for the purposes of the investigation of an offence or offences generally; | |
| (f) for the purpose of a decision whether to institute proceedings for an offence; | |
| (g) for the purpose of proceedings for an offence; | |
| (h) for the purpose of a coronial investigation or inquest; | |

S.
464ZGK(3)(j)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 72(4)(b).

(i) for the purpose of civil proceedings
(including disciplinary proceedings) that
relate to the way in which the procedure is
carried out;

(j) for the purpose of the suspect's, DNA
person's, offender's or volunteer's medical
treatment;

(k) for the purpose of the medical treatment of a
person if necessary to prevent or lessen a
serious threat to that person's life or health;

(l) if necessary to prevent or lessen a serious
threat to public health;

(m) if the suspect, offender or volunteer consents
in writing to the disclosure.

S. 464ZGK(4)
amended by
No. 32/2007
s. 10(8).

(4) This section does not apply to Victorian
information that cannot be used to discover the
identity of any person.

S. 464ZGK(5)
inserted by
No. 32/2007
s. 10(9).

(5) In this section—

Victorian information means information referred
to in section 464ZFD(1), whether or not kept
on the Victorian DNA database.

Heading
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 16.

Inter-jurisdictional enforcement

S. 464ZGL
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 16.

464ZGL Registration of orders

(1) The Minister may enter into arrangements with
the responsible Ministers of the participating
jurisdictions for the establishment and
maintenance, in one or more of those jurisdictions,
of a register of orders for the carrying out of
forensic procedures made under this Subdivision
or corresponding laws of participating
jurisdictions.

- (2) An order is registered when a copy of the order (being a copy certified as required under subsection (2A)) is registered in accordance with the law of the participating jurisdiction in which the register is kept.

S. 464ZGL(2)
amended by
No. 48/2018
s. 19(1).

- (2A) The copy of the order must be certified by—

S. 464ZGL(2A)
inserted by
No. 48/2018
s. 19(2).

- (a) the person who made it; or
(b) if that person is not available, a judicial officer of the participating jurisdiction in which the order was made.

- (3) An application for registration of an order, or for cancellation of registration of an order, may be made by an appropriate authority.

464ZGM Carrying out of registered orders

S. 464ZGM
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 16.

- (1) A person is authorised to carry out the forensic procedure authorised by an order that is registered in accordance with an arrangement referred to in section 464ZGL(1) anywhere in Victoria. The person is authorised to carry out the procedure in accordance with sections 464Y, 464Z and 464ZA and not otherwise.
- (2) A police officer, or other person assisting a police officer in accordance with this Subdivision or a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction, is not compelled by this Subdivision, or an arrangement referred to in section 464ZGL(1), to execute an order registered under such an arrangement.

S. 464ZGM(2)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.41).

S. 464ZGN
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 16,
substituted by
No. 32/2007
s. 11.

464ZGN Arrangements for transmission of information on DNA database

- (1) The Minister may enter into an arrangement with the responsible Minister for a participating jurisdiction, under which—
 - (a) information from the Victorian DNA database is to be transmitted to the responsible person for the DNA database of the participating jurisdiction for the purposes of—
 - (i) the investigation of, or the conduct of proceedings for, an offence against the law of this State or the law of the participating jurisdiction; or
 - (ii) the identification of missing or deceased persons; and
 - (b) information from the DNA database of the participating jurisdiction is to be transmitted to the Chief Commissioner of Police for the purposes of—
 - (i) the investigation of, or the conduct of proceedings for, an offence against the law of this State or the law of the participating jurisdiction; or
 - (ii) the identification of missing or deceased persons.
- (2) The Minister may enter into an arrangement with the Australian Crime Commission, under which—
 - (a) information from the Victorian DNA database is to be transmitted to the Australian Crime Commission for comparison with information on the NCIDD for the purposes of—

S. 464ZGN(2)
amended by
No. 54/2016
s. 29(1)(a).

S. 464ZGN
(2)(a)
amended by
No. 54/2016
s. 29(1)(b).

- (i) the investigation of, or the conduct of proceedings for, an offence against the law of this State or the law of a participating jurisdiction; or
 - (ii) the identification of missing or deceased persons; and
- (b) information from the Australian Crime Commission obtained as a result of a comparison with the NCIDD is to be transmitted to the Chief Commissioner of Police for the purposes of—
 - (i) the investigation of, or the conduct of proceedings for, an offence against the law of this State or the law of a participating jurisdiction; or
 - (ii) the identification of missing or deceased persons.
- (3) Without limiting subsection (2), an arrangement made under that subsection may provide for the Australian Crime Commission—
 - (a) to compare information from the Victorian DNA database with information supplied to it from the DNA database of another participating jurisdiction; and
 - (b) to identify to the Chief Commissioner of Police and the responsible person for the DNA database of the participating jurisdiction any matches that are found as a result of the comparison.
- (4) An arrangement entered into under this section may not authorise the comparison of information so as to match DNA profiles in a way that would contravene section 464ZGI were the information contained wholly within the Victorian DNA database.

**S. 464ZGN
(2)(b)
amended by
No. 54/2016
s. 29(1)(c).**

**S. 464ZGN(3)
amended by
No. 54/2016
s. 29(2).**

Notes

- 1 Information that is transmitted under this section must not be recorded or maintained in any database of information that may be used to discover the identity of a person or to obtain information about an identifiable person at any time after the time for destruction of the forensic material that is required by this Subdivision or a corresponding law of a participating jurisdiction. See section 464ZGJ.
- 2 A person who has access to information from the Victorian DNA database must not disclose the information other than in limited, specified circumstances. See section 464ZGK.

S. 464ZGO
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 16.

464ZGO Taking, retention and use of forensic material authorised by laws of other jurisdictions

- (1) Subject to section 464ZGM and this section, nothing in this Subdivision affects the taking, retention or use of forensic material, or information obtained from forensic material, if the taking, retention or use of the material is authorised by or under a corresponding law of the Commonwealth, another State or a Territory.
- (2) Forensic material taken, or information obtained from it, in accordance with a corresponding law of the Commonwealth, another State or a Territory may be retained or used for investigative, evidentiary or statistical purposes even if its retention or use would, but for this subsection, constitute a contravention of a provision of this Subdivision relating to the carrying out of forensic procedures.
- (3) Forensic material taken, or information obtained from it, in accordance with a law of the Commonwealth, another State or a Territory as in force immediately before the commencement of section 16 of the **Crimes (DNA Database) Act 2002**, may be retained or used for investigative, evidentiary or statistical purposes even if its retention or use would, but for this

subsection, constitute a contravention of a provision of this Subdivision relating to the carrying out of forensic procedures.

General

464ZH Immunity of medical practitioners, nurses, midwives, dentists and other persons

No action lies against a medical practitioner or nurse or midwife or dentist or a person authorised under section 464Z or a person assisting the medical practitioner, nurse, midwife, dentist or person in respect of anything properly and necessarily done by the medical practitioner, nurse, midwife, dentist or person in the course of taking a DNA profile sample or conducting any forensic procedure which the medical practitioner, nurse, midwife, dentist or person believes on reasonable grounds—

(a) was requested to be taken from or conducted on another person under this Subdivision in accordance with—

(i) a request of a police officer given under section 464R; or

(ii) an authorisation given by a senior police officer under section 464SA; or

(iia) a request given by a police officer under section 464SC; or

Heading
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 4(c).

S. 464ZH
(Heading)
inserted by
No. 13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.11).
S. 464ZH
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7,
amended by
Nos 81/1997
s. 29(1)(a)–(d),
13/2010
s. 51(Sch.
item 17.12),
3/2019
s. 73(1).

S. 464ZH(a)
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 29(1)(d),
substituted by
No. 41/2004
s. 19,
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 73(2).

S. 464ZH(a)(i)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.42).

S.
464ZH(a)(iia)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 73(3).

S.
464ZH(a)(iib)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 73(3).

(iib) an authorisation given by a senior
police officer under section 464SE; or

S.
464ZH(a)(iic)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 73(3).

(iic) a direction given by a police officer
under section 464ZFAB; or

S.
464ZH(a)(iid)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 73(3).

(iid) a senior police officer authorisation; or

S.
464ZH(a)(iie)
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 73(3).

(iie) an authorisation given by a senior
police officer under section 464ZFAE;
or

(iii) an order made by a court under this
Subdivision; or

S. 464ZH(b)
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 29(1)(d).

(b) was consented to by a person in accordance
with sections 464ZGB to 464ZGD.

S. 464ZI
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7,
amended by
No. 41/2004
s. 20 (ILA
s. 39B(1)).

464ZI Supreme Court—limitation of jurisdiction

- (1) It is the intention of this section to alter or vary
section 85 of the **Constitution Act 1975** to the
extent necessary—
- (a) to prevent the bringing before the Supreme
Court of an action seeking to permit an
application under section 464M(1), 464T(1),
464U(3) or 464V(2) being conducted
otherwise than in accordance with the
procedure expressed to be required by this
Act; and

(b) to prevent the bringing before the Supreme Court of an action of a kind referred to in section 464ZH.

- (2) It is the intention of section 464ZH as amended by section 19 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2004** to alter or vary section 85 of the **Constitution Act 1975**.

S. 464ZJ(2)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 20.

464ZJ Regulations

S. 464ZJ
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

- (1) The Governor in Council may make regulations for or with respect to—
- (a) accreditation of experts giving forensic evidence in a court; and
 - (b) testing of the proficiency of experts in conducting procedures about which an expert gives forensic evidence; and
 - (c) the application and use of statistical analysis to data the subject of forensic evidence; and
 - (d) standards for taking DNA profile samples or conducting forensic procedures in accordance with this Subdivision and the analysis of any samples taken; and
 - (e) generally prescribing any other matter or thing required or permitted by this Subdivision to be prescribed or necessary to be prescribed to give effect to this Subdivision.
- (2) The regulations—
- (a) may be of general or limited application; and
 - (b) may differ according to differences in time, place or circumstance; and
 - (c) may confer a discretionary authority or impose a duty on a specified person or class of persons.

S. 464ZJ(1)(d)
amended by
No. 3/2019
s. 74.

S. 464ZJ(3)(4)
repealed by
No. 10/1999
s. 31(5)(c).

* * * *

S. 464ZJ(5)
substituted by
No. 10/1999
s. 31(5)(d).

- (5) If a regulation made under subsection (1) is disallowed by the Parliament or a House of the Parliament, no regulation which is the same in substance as the disallowed regulation may be made within 6 months after the date of the disallowance, unless—
- (a) if the regulation was disallowed by one House of the Parliament, that House approves the making of a regulation the same in substance as the disallowed regulation; or
 - (b) if the regulation was disallowed by both Houses of the Parliament, each House approves the making of a regulation the same in substance as the disallowed regulation.
- (6) Any regulation made in contravention of subsection (5) is void.

S. 464ZK
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 7.

464ZK Operation of other Acts

Nothing in this Subdivision affects the operation of any other Act or enactment with respect to the taking of samples or the conduct of forensic procedures.

S. 464ZL
inserted by
No. 58/2001
s. 3.

464ZL Validation of certain orders

- (1) If, on or before 22 December 2000, an order under section 464ZF(3) is purported to have been made by—
- (a) the Magistrates' Court not sitting in open court; or
 - (b) a magistrate not constituting the Magistrates' Court—

the order is deemed to have, and always to have had, the same force and effect as it would have had if the order had been made by the Magistrates' Court sitting in open court.

- (2) Subsection (1) does not affect the rights of the parties in the proceeding known as *Lednar, O'Brien and Hill v. The Magistrates' Court and The Chief Commissioner of Police (Victoria)* (No. 6292 of 2000) in the Supreme Court of Victoria.
- (3) An order purporting to have been made under section 464ZF(2) before the commencement of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2004** in respect of a person is not invalid only because the person was not given—
- S. 464ZL(3)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 21.
- (a) notice of the application for the order; or
- (b) an opportunity to be heard on the application.
- (4) An order purporting to have been made under section 464ZF(3) before the commencement of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2004** in respect of a person aged 17 years or more is not invalid only because the person was not given—
- S. 464ZL(4)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 21.
- (a) notice of the application for the order; or
- (b) an opportunity to be heard on the application.
- (5) Subsection (4) does not affect the rights of the parties in the proceeding known as *Pavic v. Magistrates' Court of Victoria and Chief Commissioner of Police* (No. 1001 of 2002) in the Supreme Court of Victoria.
- S. 464ZL(5)
inserted by
No. 41/2004
s. 21.
- (6) If, before the commencement of section 4(1) and (2) of the **Crimes Amendment (Investigation Powers) Act 2013**, an order is purported to have been made under
- S. 464ZL(6)
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 16.

section 464B(5) in respect of an offence committed outside Victoria against a law of the Commonwealth or another State or a Territory, the order is taken to have, and always to have had, the same force and effect as it would have had if the order had been made after that commencement.

S. 464ZL(7)
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 16.

- (7) Any questioning or investigation conducted pursuant to an order referred to in subsection (6) by a member of the Australian Federal Police or a member of the police force of another State or a Territory before the commencement of section 4(1) and (2) of the **Crimes Amendment (Investigation Powers) Act 2013** is taken to have, and always to have had, the same force and effect as it would have had if conducted after that commencement.

S. 464ZL(8)
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 16.

- (8) Subsections (6) and (7) do not affect the rights of the parties in the proceeding known as *Detective Jason Wallace v Bandali Debs and the Magistrates' Court of Victoria* (No. 10194 of 2008) in the Supreme Court of Victoria.

S. 464ZLA
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 75.

464ZLA Validation of sample taken in accordance with section 464ZFAB

- (1) In this section—
commencement day means the day on which section 79 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Police and Other Matters) Act 2019** comes into operation.
- (2) A sample taken in a forensic procedure conducted in accordance or purported to be conducted in accordance with section 464ZFAB before the commencement day in a prison was not unlawfully taken only because the person taking the sample had no lawful authority to enter and remain in the prison.

Oversight by IBAC

Heading
preceding
s. 464ZM
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 76.

464ZM Functions of IBAC

S. 464ZM
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 76.

The IBAC has the following functions under this Subdivision to monitor compliance by police officers and members of Victoria Police personnel or any other person who carried out a function or power in respect of—

- (a) the taking of a DNA profile sample;
- (b) a senior police officer authorisation;
- (c) an authorisation under section 464ZF AE;
- (d) any matter on which the Chief Commissioner is required to report on under section 464ZFE.

464ZN Chief Commissioner of Police to report to IBAC

S. 464ZN
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 76.

- (1) As soon as practicable after 1 January but not later than 1 March in each year, the Chief Commissioner of Police must provide a written report to the IBAC for the previous 12 months in relation—
 - (a) to any DNA profile sample taken or senior police officer authorisation or authorisation given and applied for; and
 - (b) to the destruction of any DNA profile sample taken or given in accordance with a senior police officer authorisation or authorisation; and
 - (c) to any matter on which the Chief Commissioner is required to report on under section 464ZFE.

(2) The report must include—

- (a) a list that identifies by a unique identifying number every DNA profile sample taken or given in accordance with a senior police officer authorisation or authorisation under this Subdivision within the period to which the report relates; and
- (b) information on whether any of the DNA profile samples listed in the report were taken from a child; and
- (c) the date on which every DNA profile sample listed in the report was taken; and
- (d) information on whether any of the DNA profile samples listed in the report or in any previous report submitted under this section have been destroyed within the period to which the report relates and the reason for the destruction of the sample; and
- (e) if a DNA profile sample has been destroyed the date that the requirement to destroy it arose under section 464ZFC, the date of destruction and the name of the person who destroyed it; and
- (f) the number of senior police officer authorisations and authorisations under section 464SE or 464ZF AE given within the period to which the report relates; and
- (g) the number of DNA profile samples taken by consent in accordance with section 464SC within the period to which the report relates; and
- (h) the number of authorisations under section 464SE, senior police officer authorisations and authorisations under section 464ZF AE refused within the period to which the report relates; and

- (i) information on any DNA profile sample that has been retained for 12 months or more including the status of any investigation of the DNA person from whom the sample was taken within the period to which the report relates.

464ZO Inspection of records by authorised officers

S. 464ZO
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 76.

- (1) In this section—

authorised officer is—

- (a) the IBAC Commissioner; or
- (b) a sworn IBAC Officer who is authorised under subsection (2);

IBAC Commissioner means the Commissioner within the meaning of the **Independent Broad-based Anti-corruption Commission Act 2011**;

police personnel premises has the same meaning as it has in the **Independent Broad-based Anti-corruption Commission Act 2011**;

records include the following—

- (a) forensic material;
- (b) records or recordings, whether in writing or in digital, audio or audiovisual form or otherwise, of—
 - (i) the taking of a DNA profile sample by informed consent in accordance with section 464SC; and
 - (ii) an authorisation under section 464SE or a senior police officer authorisation or an authorisation under section 464ZF AE;
- (c) documents on a database;

sworn IBAC Officer has the same meaning as in the **Independent Broad-based Anti-corruption Commission Act 2011**.

- (2) The IBAC Commissioner may authorise a sworn IBAC Officer to exercise the powers of an authorised officer under this section.
- (3) An authorised officer must, from time to time, inspect any records of Victoria Police or any other person or body that carried out a function or power for the taking of a DNA profile sample that the authorised officer considers necessary to determine the extent of compliance by a member of Victoria Police personnel or the person or body with this Subdivision for the following—
 - (a) the taking of a DNA profile sample by way of informed consent in accordance with section 464SC;
 - (b) an authorisation under section 464SE;
 - (c) a senior police officer authorisation;
 - (d) an authorisation under section 464ZFAE;
 - (e) any matter on which the Chief Commissioner is required to report on under section 464ZFE.
- (4) For the purpose of an inspection under this section, an authorised officer—
 - (a) after notifying the Chief Commissioner of Police, may enter at any reasonable time police personnel premises or any premises occupied by any other person or body that carried out a function or power under this Subdivision; and

- (b) is entitled to have full and free access at all reasonable times to all records of Victoria Police or any other person or body that carried out a function or power under this Subdivision that are relevant to the inspection; and
 - (c) may require a member of Victoria Police personnel or a relevant person or body to give the authorised officer any information that the IBAC considers necessary, being information that is in that person's or body's possession, or to which the person or body has access, and that is relevant to the inspection; and
 - (d) may do anything that is necessary or convenient to be done to enable an inspection to be carried out under this section.
- (5) The Chief Commissioner of Police must ensure that members of Victoria Police personnel give an authorised officer any assistance that the authorised officer reasonably requires to enable the authorised officer to perform functions under this section.

464ZP IBAC to report to the Attorney-General

- (1) The IBAC must give a written report to the Attorney-General at yearly intervals on—
- (a) the report given by the Chief Commissioner of Police to the IBAC under section 464ZN; and
 - (b) the results of each inspection under section 464ZO; and
 - (c) any recommendations about actions that should be taken in relation to a matter arising out of the report.

**S. 464ZP
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 76.**

- (2) The Attorney-General must cause a report under this section to be laid before each House of Parliament within 15 sitting days after the day on which the Attorney-General receives the report.

S. 464ZQ
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 76.

464ZQ Recommendations

- (1) The IBAC may at any time make recommendations to the Chief Commissioner about actions that should be taken in relation to a matter arising out of the functions of IBAC under this Subdivision.
- (2) Within a reasonable time after receiving a recommendation under subsection (1), the Chief Commissioner must—
- (a) take the recommended action; or
 - (b) if the Chief Commissioner has not taken the recommended action or does not intend to take the recommended action—give a report to the IBAC stating the reason for not taking or intending to take the action.

S. 464ZR
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 76.

464ZR Attorney-General may make a complaint to the IBAC

The Attorney-General may make a complaint to the IBAC under section 51 of the **Independent Broad-based Anti-corruption Commission Act 2011** about the taking, use, retention or destruction of forensic material under this Subdivision.

S. 464ZS
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 76.

464ZS Immunity of the IBAC and sworn IBAC Officers

- (1) The IBAC or a sworn IBAC Officer is not personally liable for anything necessarily or reasonably done or omitted to be done in good faith—
- (a) in the performance of a duty or a function or the exercise of a power under this Subdivision; or

- (b) in the reasonable belief that the act or omission was in the performance of a duty or a function or the exercise of a power under this Act.
- (2) Any liability resulting from an act or omission that would, but for subsection (1), attach to the IBAC or a sworn IBAC Officer attaches instead to the State.

(31) *Search warrants for and seizure of things*

464ZT Definitions

In this Subdivision—

evidentiary material means a thing that will afford evidence as to the commission of an offence for which a warrant has been issued under section 465;

warrant premises, in relation to a warrant, means a building, receptacle, place or vehicle that is subject to the warrant.

S. 464ZT
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 72.

465 Issue of search warrant by magistrate

No. 6103
s. 465.

- (1) Any magistrate who is satisfied by the evidence on oath or by affirmation or affidavit of any police officer of or above the rank of senior sergeant that there is reasonable ground for believing that there is, or will be within the next 72 hours, in any building (including any vehicle in that building), receptacle or place (including any vehicle on or in that place) or on or in a particular vehicle located in a public place—

S. 465(1)
amended by
Nos 7184 s. 7,
8179 s. 4,
16/1986 s. 30,
57/1989
s. 3(Sch. item
42.56(a)–(d)),
22/1996
s. 6(1)(a),
25/2009
s. 5(1),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.42),
6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.10),
44/2022
s. 73(1).

S. 465(1)(a)
amended by
No. 22/1996
s. 6(1)(b).

- (a) anything upon or in respect of which any indictable offence has been or is suspected to have been committed or is being or is likely to be committed within the next 72 hours; or
- (b) anything which there is reasonable ground to believe will afford evidence as to the commission of any such offence; or
- (c) anything which there is reasonable ground to believe is intended to be used for the purpose of committing any indictable offence against the person for which the offender may be arrested without warrant—

may at any time issue a warrant authorizing some police officer or other person named therein to search such building receptacle, place or vehicle for any such thing and to seize and hold or retain it according to law.

S. 465(1A)
inserted by
No. 22/1996
s. 6(2),
repealed by
No. 42/2015
s. 8, new
s. 465(1A)
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 73(2).

- (1A) Subject to this Subdivision, a warrant issued under subsection (1) authorises the police officer executing it to hold or retain a seized thing for as long as is reasonably required for the purposes of—
 - (a) the investigation of the offence in relation to which it was seized; or
 - (b) a criminal proceeding for the offence in relation to which it was seized.

S. 465(1B)
inserted by
No. 63/2003
s. 43.

- (1B) A magistrate who issues a warrant under subsection (1), if satisfied on reasonable grounds by the evidence given under that subsection that the thing to which the warrant relates is also tainted property within the meaning of the **Confiscation Act 1997**, may, in that warrant, direct that the applicant hold or retain that thing as if it were tainted property seized under a warrant under section 79 of that Act as and from the date

when that thing is no longer required for evidentiary purposes under this Act.

- (2) Subject to this section the rules to be observed with regard to search warrants mentioned in the **Magistrates' Court Act 1989** shall extend and apply to warrants under this section.

S. 465(2)
amended by
Nos 9427
s. 6(1)(Sch. 5
item 40),
57/1989
s. 3(Sch. item
42.57(a)(b)).

- (2A) Despite section 78(1)(b)(ii) of the **Magistrates' Court Act 1989**, a warrant issued under subsection (1) does not require an article, thing or material to be brought before the Magistrates' Court.

S. 465(2A)
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 73(3).

- (3) The provisions of this section shall be read and construed as in aid of and not in derogation of the provisions with regard to warrants to search contained in this or any other Act, except as set out in subsection (2A).

S. 465(3)
amended by
No. 44/2022
s. 73(4).

- (4) The Governor in Council may make regulations prescribing the form of any warrant to be issued under this section and any such regulations shall be published in the Government Gazette and shall be laid before both Houses of Parliament within fourteen days after the making thereof if Parliament is then sitting, and if not then within fourteen days after the next meeting of Parliament.

- (5) In this section—

public place has the same meaning as it has in section 3 of the **Summary Offences Act 1966**;

vehicle includes motor vehicle, aircraft and vessel.

S. 465(5)
inserted by
No. 22/1996
s. 6(3),
repealed by
No. 48/1997
s. 61, new
s. 465(5)
inserted by
No. 25/2009
s. 5(2).

S. 465AAAA
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 74.

465AAAA Powers relating to receptacles

- (1) A police officer executing a warrant issued under section 465 in relation to warrant premises is authorised to break open or unlock any receptacle in or on the warrant premises as is reasonably necessary for conducting a search under the warrant.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), the police officer executing the warrant is authorised to take any action that is reasonably necessary—
 - (a) to determine whether the receptacle is, or contains, a thing that may be seized; or
 - (b) to determine whether the receptacle is, or contains, a thing that may pose a hazard to a person; or
 - (c) to assess or remove any thing in the receptacle that may pose a hazard to a person; or
 - (d) to deal with the receptacle or any thing in the receptacle to prevent any hazard or mitigate the risk of any hazard to a person.
- (3) A police officer executing a warrant issued under section 465 in relation to warrant premises is authorised to move a receptacle to another place, for up to 7 business days, for examination to determine whether the receptacle is, or contains, a thing that may be seized under the warrant, if—
 - (a) it is significantly more practicable to do so having regard to the following—
 - (i) the timeliness;
 - (ii) the cost of examining the receptacle at another place;
 - (iii) the availability of expert assistance;

- (iv) the safety of a person at the warrant premises during the execution of the warrant; and
- (b) there are reasonable grounds to suspect the receptacle is, or contains, a thing that may be seized under the warrant.
- (4) In this section—

business day means a day other than a Saturday or Sunday or a day appointed as a public holiday under the **Public Holidays Act 1993**.

465AAAAB Police may use assistants and equipment

S. 465AAAAB
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 74.

- (1) A police officer executing a warrant issued under section 465 in relation to warrant premises may do any of the following—
 - (a) seek the assistance of a person (an ***assistant***) who possesses specialised skills or technical knowledge necessary for exercising a power authorised by the warrant and bring the assistant onto the warrant premises;
 - (b) bring onto the warrant premises any equipment, vehicle, animal or material that the police officer reasonably requires for exercising a power authorised by the warrant.
- (2) The police officer may direct an assistant—
 - (a) to take stated action at the premises; and
 - (b) to exercise stated powers that the police officer is authorised by the warrant to exercise.

- (3) For the purposes of subsection (2), the police officer—
 - (a) is only permitted to direct an assistant to take stated action or exercise stated powers that are consistent with the specialist skills or technical knowledge of the assistant; and
 - (b) cannot direct the assistant to arrest a person.
- (4) The police officer must inform the assistant of—
 - (a) the action that the assistant is directed to take; and
 - (b) the assistant's powers under this section.
- (5) The police officer may seek the assistance of as many assistants as are reasonably necessary to exercise the powers authorised by the warrant.

S. 465AAAAC
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 74.

465AAAAC Police officer may arrange for expert to operate electronic equipment at premises being searched

- (1) This section applies to a police officer executing a warrant issued under section 465 in relation to warrant premises who believes on reasonable grounds that—
 - (a) evidentiary material may be accessible by operating electronic equipment found at the warrant premises; and
 - (b) expert assistance is required to operate the equipment; and
 - (c) if the police officer does not take action under this section, the material may be destroyed, altered or otherwise interfered with.

- (2) Subject to subsections (4), (5) and (6), the police officer may—
 - (a) do whatever is necessary to secure the electronic equipment at the warrant premises, including—
 - (i) locking the equipment in a secure room; and
 - (ii) guarding or placing a guard at the equipment; and
 - (b) arrange for an expert to attend and operate the equipment.
- (3) The police officer must notify the occupier of the warrant premises of—
 - (a) the police officer's intention to secure the electronic equipment; and
 - (b) the periods that electronic equipment may be secured under subsections (5) and (6).
- (4) In securing electronic equipment under subsection (2), a police officer must cause the least disruption and inconvenience to the occupier of the warrant premises as is reasonably practicable in the circumstances.
- (5) Subject to subsection (6), the electronic equipment may be secured for a period not exceeding 24 hours.
- (6) If an expert attends within the period referred to in subsection (5), the electronic equipment may be secured for—
 - (a) an additional period ending when the expert finishes operating the equipment or 24 hours after the expert arrives (whichever occurs first); or

- (b) if the Magistrates' Court extends the period under section 465AAAAE(1), the period as so extended.

S. 465AAAAAD
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 74.

465AAAAAD Application for extension of time to allow expert to finish operating equipment

- (1) This section applies if a police officer—
 - (a) secures electronic equipment under section 465AAAAC; and
 - (b) believes on reasonable grounds that an expert—
 - (i) will not arrive within 24 hours of the equipment being secured; or
 - (ii) will not finish operating the equipment within 24 hours after arriving.
- (2) A police officer may apply to the Magistrates' Court for an extension of the period for which the electronic equipment may be secured under section 465AAAAC by not more than 7 days.
- (3) The occupier of the warrant premises is entitled to be heard in relation to an application made under subsection (2).
- (4) The police officer must notify the occupier of the warrant premises—
 - (a) that the police officer intends to apply for an extension of the period for which the electronic equipment is secured; and
 - (b) that the occupier is entitled to be heard in relation to the application.

465AAAAE Determination of application for extension of time to allow expert to finish operating equipment

S. 465AAAAE
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 74.

- (1) On an application under section 465AAAAD, the Magistrates' Court may extend the period that the electronic equipment may be secured if the Magistrates' Court is satisfied that the extension is appropriate in the circumstances and the expert—
 - (a) will not arrive within 24 hours of the equipment being secured; or
 - (b) will not finish operating the equipment within 24 hours after arriving.
- (2) In determining whether the extension is appropriate in the circumstances, the Magistrates' Court may have regard to the following—
 - (a) the length of time that is likely required for an expert to attend the warrant premises and operate the equipment;
 - (b) the inconvenience that securing the equipment may cause to a person;
 - (c) the likelihood that operating the electronic equipment will enable evidentiary material to be accessed, copied or converted into documentary form in accordance with section 465AAAAD;
 - (d) any other matters the Magistrates' Court considers relevant.
- (3) The Magistrates' Court may direct that a police officer must not take a specified action in relation to the secured electronic equipment during the extended period if it appears to the Magistrates' Court that—
 - (a) the taking of that action would cause unreasonable disruption and inconvenience to an occupier of the warrant premises; and

- (b) it is appropriate in the circumstances to limit the exercise of the police officer's powers under the warrant.
- (4) A period extended under subsection (1) ends at the earlier of either—
 - (a) the end of the further period specified by the Magistrates' Court in the extension; or
 - (b) the time at which the expert finishes operating the equipment.
- (5) The further period specified by the Magistrates' Court must not exceed 7 days.
- (6) The Magistrates' Court may extend a period under subsection (1) in relation to particular equipment more than once.

S. 465AAAAF
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 74.

465AAAAF Warrant authorises a police officer to access data held in or accessible from a computer or data storage device

A warrant issued under section 465 in relation to warrant premises authorises a police officer executing the warrant to do one or more of the following things—

- (a) access data held in, or accessible from, a computer or data storage device that—
 - (i) is on warrant premises; or
 - (ii) has been seized under the warrant and is at a place other than warrant premises;
- (b) copy to another data storage device data held in, or accessible from, a computer or data storage device described in paragraph (a);

(c) convert into documentary form—

- (i) data held in, or accessible from, a computer or data storage device described in paragraph (a); or
- (ii) data held in a data storage device to which the data was copied as described in paragraph (b).

465AAA Warrant may authorise the giving of a direction requiring assistance from person with knowledge of a computer or computer network

S. 465AAA
inserted by
No. 42/2015
s. 9.

(1) Subject to subsection (3), a warrant issued under section 465 in relation to warrant premises may authorise a police officer executing the warrant to give a direction under subsection (2) to a specified person.

S. 465AAA(1)
amended by
No. 44/2022
s. 75.

(2) A police officer may direct a specified person to provide any information or assistance that is reasonable and necessary to allow the police officer to do one or more of the following things—

(a) access data held in, or accessible from, a computer or data storage device that—

- (i) is on warrant premises; or
- (ii) has been seized under the warrant and is at a place other than warrant premises;

(b) copy to another data storage device data held in, or accessible from, a computer, or data storage device, described in paragraph (a);

(c) convert into documentary form or another form intelligible to a police officer—

- (i) data held in, or accessible from, a computer, or data storage device, described in paragraph (a); or

- (ii) data held in a data storage device to which the data was copied as described in paragraph (b).
- (3) A warrant may authorise the giving of a direction under subsection (2) if the magistrate issuing the warrant is satisfied that—
 - (a) there are reasonable grounds for suspecting that data held in, or accessible from, a computer, or data storage device, described in subsection (2)(a) will afford evidence as to the commission of an indictable offence; and
 - (b) the specified person is—
 - (i) reasonably suspected of having committed an indictable offence in relation to which the warrant was issued; or
 - (ii) the owner or lessee of the computer or device; or
 - (iii) an employee of the owner or lessee of the computer or device; or
 - (iv) a person engaged under a contract for services by the owner or lessee of the computer or device; or
 - (v) a person who uses or has used the computer or device; or
 - (vi) a person who is or was a system administrator for the computer network of which the computer or device forms or formed a part; and
 - (c) the specified person has relevant knowledge of—
 - (i) the computer or device or a computer network of which the computer or device forms or formed a part; or

- (ii) measures applied to protect data held in, or accessible from, the computer or device.
- (4) A person commits an offence if—
 - (a) the person has relevant knowledge of—
 - (i) the computer or data storage device or a computer network of which the computer or data storage device forms or formed a part; or
 - (ii) measures applied to protect data held in, or accessible from, the computer or data storage device; and
 - (b) the person is informed by a police officer—
 - (i) of the authorisation to give the direction under subsection (2) and of its terms; and
 - (ii) that it is an offence to fail to comply with the direction; and
 - (c) the person fails to comply with the direction without reasonable excuse.
- (5) A person who commits an offence against subsection (4) is liable to level 7 imprisonment (2 years maximum).
- (6) An offence against subsection (4) is a summary offence.
- (7) A person is not excused from complying with a direction under subsection (2) on the ground that complying with it may result in information being provided that might incriminate the person.
- (8) In this section *access*, *data*, *data held in a computer* and *data storage device* have the meanings given by section 247A(1).

S. 465AA
inserted by
No. 79/2014
s. 69.

**465AA Power to require assistance from person with
knowledge of a computer or computer network**

S. 465AA(1)
amended by
No. 44/2022
s. 76.

- (1) This section applies if a magistrate has issued a warrant under section 465 in relation to warrant premises.
- (2) The Magistrates' Court may, on the application of a police officer of or above the rank of senior sergeant, make an order requiring a specified person to provide any information or assistance that is reasonable and necessary to allow a police officer to do one or more of the things specified in subsection (3).
- (3) The things are—
 - (a) access data held in, or accessible from, a computer or data storage device that—
 - (i) is on warrant premises; or
 - (ii) has been seized under the warrant and is at a place other than warrant premises;
 - (b) copy to another data storage device data held in, or accessible from, a computer, or data storage device, described in paragraph (a);
 - (c) convert into documentary form or another form intelligible to a police officer—
 - (i) data held in, or accessible from, a computer, or data storage device, described in paragraph (a); or
 - (ii) data held in a data storage device to which the data was copied as described in paragraph (b).

- (4) An application may be made under subsection (2) at the same time as an application is made for the warrant under section 465 or at any time after the issue of the warrant.
- (5) The Magistrates' Court may make the order if satisfied that—
 - (a) there are reasonable grounds for suspecting that data held in, or accessible from, a computer, or data storage device, described in subsection (3)(a) will afford evidence as to the commission of an indictable offence; and
 - (b) the specified person is—
 - (i) reasonably suspected of having committed an indictable offence in relation to which the warrant was issued; or
 - (ii) the owner or lessee of the computer or device; or
 - (iii) an employee of the owner or lessee of the computer or device; or
 - (iv) a person engaged under a contract for services by the owner or lessee of the computer or device; or
 - (v) a person who uses or has used the computer or device; or
 - (vi) a person who is or was a system administrator for the computer network of which the computer or device forms or formed a part; and
 - (c) the specified person has relevant knowledge of—
 - (i) the computer or device or a computer network of which the computer or device forms or formed a part; or

- (ii) measures applied to protect data held in, or accessible from, the computer or device.
- (6) A person is not excused from complying with an order on the ground that complying with it may result in information being provided that might incriminate the person.
- (7) If—
 - (a) the computer or data storage device that is the subject of the order is seized under the warrant; and
 - (b) the order was granted on the basis of an application made before the seizure—the order does not have effect on or after the completion of the execution of the warrant.

Note

An application for another order under this section relating to the computer or data storage device may be made after the completion of the execution of the warrant.

- (8) If the computer or data storage device is not on warrant premises, the order must—
 - (a) specify the period within which the person must provide the information or assistance; and
 - (b) specify the place at which the person must provide the information or assistance; and
 - (c) specify the conditions (if any) to which the requirement to provide the information or assistance is subject.

- (9) A person commits an offence if—
- (a) the person has relevant knowledge of—
 - (i) the computer or data storage device or a computer network of which the computer or data storage device forms or formed a part; or
 - (ii) measures applied to protect data held in, or accessible from, the computer or data storage device; and
 - (b) the person is informed by a police officer—
 - (i) of the order made under this section and of its terms; and
 - (ii) that it is an indictable offence punishable by imprisonment to fail to comply with the order; and
 - (c) the person fails to comply with the order without reasonable excuse.
- (10) A person who commits an offence against subsection (9) is liable to level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).
- (10A) This section applies in addition to section 465AAA, whether or not in relation to the same specified person. However, a person may be charged with an offence against either section 465AAA(4) or subsection (9) but not both.
- (11) In this section *access*, *data*, *data held in a computer* and *data storage device* have the meanings given by section 247A(1).

S. 465AA(10A)
inserted by
No. 42/2015
s. 10.

S. 465AAB
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 77.

465AAB Informing a person about a report relating to the execution of a warrant

A police officer executing a warrant issued under section 465 in relation to warrant premises must inform the occupier of the warrant premises (if any) of—

- (a) the requirement for a report about the execution of the warrant to be made in accordance with section 465AAC; and
- (b) the venue of the Magistrates' Court at which the report will be lodged; and
- (c) the time period in which the report will be lodged; and
- (d) the persons who may be authorised by the Magistrates' Court to inspect the report under section 465AAE.

S. 465AAC
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 77.

465AAC Report to the Magistrates' Court after executing search warrant

- (1) A police officer who is issued a warrant under section 465 in relation to warrant premises must make and sign a report on the execution or non-execution of the warrant.
- (2) The police officer must cause the report under subsection (1) to be lodged—
 - (a) with a registrar at the venue of the Magistrates' Court that is nearest to the warrant premises; and
 - (b) no later than 10 days after the execution or expiry of the warrant, whichever is earlier.

- (3) A report under subsection (1) made in relation to a warrant that was executed must—
- (a) contain particulars of—
 - (i) the name of the police officer in charge of the execution of the warrant; and
 - (ii) if the police officer who executed the warrant sought the assistance of a person under section 465AAAAB—
 - (A) the person's name; and
 - (B) the person's expertise or qualifications; and
 - (iii) the date on which the warrant was executed; and
 - (iv) the powers that were executed under the warrant; and
 - (v) if electronic equipment was secured and operated by an expert under section 465AAAAC—
 - (A) the electronic equipment secured and operated; and
 - (B) the name of the expert who operated the electronic equipment; and
 - (vi) if an application to extend the time for electronic equipment to be secured is made under section 465AAAAD, the outcome of that application; and
 - (vii) the result of the execution of the warrant, including—
 - (A) the name of any persons arrested; and
 - (B) a description of any thing seized; and

(C) a description of any searches undertaken; and

(D) a description of any thing that was broken open, unlocked, destroyed or disposed or moved to another place under section 465AAAA(3) during the execution of the warrant; and

(b) be in the prescribed form (if any).

(4) A report under subsection (1) made in relation to a warrant that was not executed must contain reasons why the warrant was not executed.

S. 465AAD
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 77.

465AAD The Magistrates' Court may summon a police officer to give evidence about a report

(1) After a report about a warrant is filed or lodged at a venue of the Magistrates' Court under section 465AAC(2), the Magistrates' Court may issue a summons to the police officer who signed the report to give evidence on the matters contained in the report.

(2) The summons must include the venue of the Magistrates' Court and the date and time at which the police officer is to appear before the Magistrates' Court to give evidence.

(3) The Magistrates' Court may direct that any thing seized under a warrant, to which the report relates, is to be returned to its owner, subject to any condition that the Magistrates' Court thinks fit, if in the opinion of the Magistrates' Court it can be returned consistently with the interests of justice.

S. 465AAE
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 77.

465AAE Application to inspect a report

(1) A person may apply to the Magistrates' Court at the venue where the report was filed or lodged under section 465AAC(2) for an order authorising the person to inspect the report.

- (2) The Magistrates' Court may, on an application made under subsection (1), make an order authorising the person to inspect the report or a part of the report that is relevant to the person, if satisfied that the person is—
- (a) a person who was arrested during the execution of the warrant; or
 - (b) the owner or occupier of the building, receptacle, place or vehicle that was subject to the execution of the warrant; or
 - (c) the owner of property that was seized during the execution of the warrant; or
 - (d) the owner of property that was broken open, unlocked, destroyed or disposed of during the execution of the warrant; or
 - (e) a person who has an interest in a thing that was seized, broken open, unlocked, destroyed or disposed of during the execution of the warrant; or
 - (f) if electronic equipment was secured for operation by an expert under section 465AAAAC, a person who has an interest in the equipment.

465A Notice that seized thing is being held for purposes of Confiscation Act 1997

S. 465A
inserted by
No. 63/2003
s. 44.

- (1) If a thing seized under a warrant issued under section 465 to which a direction under section 465(1B) applies is no longer required for evidentiary purposes under this Act, the person to whom that warrant was issued must give notice to all persons known to have an interest in that thing that the thing is being held or retained as if it were tainted property seized under a warrant under section 79 of the **Confiscation Act 1997**.

- (2) A notice under subsection (1) must be—
- (a) given within 7 days after the thing is no longer required for evidentiary purposes under this Act; and
 - (b) in the prescribed form.

S. 465B
(Heading)
amended by
No. 44/2022
s. 78(1).

465B Application for tainted property to be held or retained

S. 465B
inserted by
No. 63/2003
s. 44.

S. 465B(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.42),
substituted by
No. 44/2022
s. 78(2).

- (1) After a police officer has executed the warrant issued under section 465 and seized a thing under the warrant, the police officer named in the warrant or another police officer may apply to the Magistrates' Court at a venue of the Magistrates' Court that is nearest to the warrant premises for a direction that the thing so seized be held or retained as if it were tainted property seized under a warrant under section 79 of the **Confiscation Act 1997**.
- (2) An application may only be made under subsection (1) if a direction under section 465(1B) was not made in relation to the warrant when it was issued.

S. 465C
inserted by
No. 63/2003
s. 44.

465C Court may make direction

S. 465C(1)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.42).

- (1) On an application under section 465B, if the Court is satisfied on reasonable grounds that the thing seized under the warrant issued under section 465 is tainted property within the meaning of the **Confiscation Act 1997**, the Court may direct that

the thing be held or retained by the police officer or other person named in the warrant as if it were tainted property seized under a warrant under section 79 of that Act.

- (2) A direction under this section takes effect on and from the date that the thing is no longer required for evidentiary purposes under this Act.
- (3) In determining whether the thing which is the subject of the application is in fact tainted property within the meaning of the **Confiscation Act 1997**, the Court may require the applicant to provide any information that the Court considers necessary.
- (4) The power of the Court under this section is in addition to its powers under section 78 of the **Magistrates' Court Act 1989** in relation to seized property.

465D Notice of direction under section 465C

S. 465D
inserted by
No. 63/2003
s. 44.

- (1) If the Magistrates' Court makes a direction under section 465C, the applicant for the direction must give notice to all persons known to have an interest in the thing to which the direction applies that the thing is being held or retained as if it were tainted property seized under a warrant under section 79 of the **Confiscation Act 1997** by virtue of a direction made under section 465C.
- (2) A notice under subsection (1) must be—
 - (a) given within 7 days after the thing is no longer required for evidentiary purposes under this Act; and
 - (b) in the prescribed form.

S. 465E
inserted by
No. 63/2003
s. 44.

465E Effect of directions under sections 465(1B) and 465C

If a direction has been made under section 465(1B) or 465C, the thing to which the direction applies—

- (a) is deemed, on and from the date on which the thing is no longer required for evidentiary purposes under this Act, to have been seized as tainted property under a warrant under section 79 of the **Confiscation Act 1997**; and
- (b) is to be dealt with under that Act accordingly.

S. 465F
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 79.

465F Display of seized things

- (1) The Chief Commissioner of Police may display a thing seized under a warrant issued under section 465 to the public in any manner, including the following—
 - (a) by displaying the thing at a conference attended by one or more media organisations;
 - (b) by publishing a photo or video of the thing.
- (2) This section applies despite anything to the contrary in Subdivision 5 of Division 3 of Part 4 of the **Magistrates' Court Act 1989**.
- (3) In this section—

journalism means the practice of collecting, preparing for dissemination or disseminating any of the following material for the purpose of making it available to the public—

- (a) material having the character of news or current affairs;
- (b) material consisting of commentary or opinion on or analysis of news or current affairs;

media organisation means a person or body that engages in journalism;

publish means disseminate or provide access to the public or a section of the public by—

- (a) publication in a newspaper; or
- (b) broadcast by television; or
- (c) electronic communication (including social media).

466 Justice may issue warrant to search for gunpowder³⁸

Where any credible person on oath or by affirmation before a magistrate shows reasonable cause to suspect that a person named or described has in his possession or on his premises any machine or implement or gunpowder or other explosive dangerous or noxious substance or things suspected to be made or kept or carried for the purpose of committing any of the felonies in Division one or three of Part I, the magistrate may grant a warrant to search for the same by day or by night.

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No. 6103
s. 466.
S. 466
amended by
Nos 25/1989
s. 15(a)(b),
57/1989
s. 3(Sch. item
42.58(a)(b)),
6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.11).

S. 467
repealed by
No. 25/1989
s. 16.

Ss 468, 469
repealed by
No. 25/1989
s. 9.

cf. [1819] 60
George III,
and 1 George
IV, c. VIII ss 1,
2, 4, 8.
(Criminal Libel
Act 1819.)

S. 469AA
inserted by
No. 9407
s. 2(f).

469AA Seizure and destruction of documents containing libel

- (1) Upon the conviction of any person for—
 - (a) publishing a blasphemous libel; or
 - (b) publishing a seditious libel—the Court by which such conviction is recorded may order the seizure and destruction of any documents proved to exist and to contain any such libel or to have been written, printed or published in breach of the said section.
- (2) Any such order shall be carried into execution not earlier than thirty days from the making thereof or at such time as a court of competent jurisdiction may order.
- (3) If the conviction is set aside on appeal, the order for seizure and destruction shall be ipso facto vacated.

S. 469AA(3)
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 97(Sch.
item 40.41).

S. 469A
inserted by
No. 7088
s. 2(f),
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.62).

469A Power of persons to search aircraft

- (1) If, the person in command of the aircraft or any person authorized in writing in a particular case by a magistrate reasonably suspects that an offence involving the safety of an aircraft has been, is being or may be committed on board or in relation to an aircraft, he may, with such assistance as is necessary, search or cause to be searched—
 - (a) the aircraft and any person, luggage or freight on board the aircraft; and
 - (b) any person who is about to board the aircraft and any luggage or freight that is about to be placed on board the aircraft.
- (2) A female shall not be searched under the last preceding subsection except by a female.

(32) *Search warrants for women and girls*

470 Power of search when female unlawfully detained for immoral purposes

No. 6103
s. 470.

- (1) If it appears to a magistrate, on the evidence on oath or by affirmation or affidavit of any parent relative or guardian of any woman or girl or by any other person who in the opinion of the magistrate is bona fide acting in the interest of any woman or girl, that there is reasonable cause to suspect that such woman or girl is unlawfully detained for immoral purposes by any person in any place, he may issue a warrant authorizing any person named therein to search for and when found to take to and detain in a place of safety such woman or girl until she can be brought before the Magistrates' Court.
- (2) The Magistrates' Court on the woman or girl being brought before it may cause her to be delivered up to her parent or guardian or otherwise dealt with as circumstances may permit and require.
- (3) The magistrate at the time of or after issuing such warrant may issue another warrant for the arrest of any person accused of so unlawfully detaining such woman or girl and may order proceedings to be taken for prosecuting such person according to law.
- (4) A woman or girl shall be deemed to be unlawfully detained for an immoral purpose if she is so detained for the purpose of being unlawfully and carnally known by any man whether any particular man or generally, and—
- (a) is under the age of sixteen years; or
- (b) if of or above the age of sixteen years and under the age of eighteen years is so detained against her will or against the will of her

S. 470(1)
amended by
Nos 57/1989
s. 3(Sch. item
42.63(a)–(d)),
6/2018
s. 68(Sch. 2
item 35.12).

S. 470(2)
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.64).

S. 470(3)
amended by
No. 57/1989
s. 3(Sch.
item 42.65).

father or mother or of any other person
having the lawful care or charge of her; or

(c) if of or above the age of eighteen years is so
detained against her will.

(5) Any person authorized by warrant under this
section to search for any woman or girl so
detained as aforesaid may enter (if need be, by
force) any house building or other place specified
in such warrant, and may remove such woman or
girl therefrom.

(6) Every warrant issued under this section shall be
addressed to and executed by a police officer of or
above the rank of sergeant, who shall be
accompanied by the parent relative or guardian or
other person referred to in subsection (1) if such
person so desire unless the magistrate otherwise
directs.

S. 470(6)
amended by
Nos 8179 s. 4,
57/1989
s. 3(Sch. item
42.66(a)(b)),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.42).

Pt 3 Div. 1
Subdiv. (33)
(Heading)
repealed by
No. 23/1991
s. 8(2).

* * * * *

S. 471
amended by
Nos 9427
s. 6(1)(Sch. 5
item 41),
110/1986
s. 140(2),
repealed by
No. 124/1986
s. 74(e).

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Division 2—Punishment

(1) *Sentences for offences*

Pt 3 Div. 2
Subdiv. (1)
(Heading)
amended by
No. 10084
s. 15(b).

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Ss 472–476A
repealed.³⁹

476B Young person sentenced to life imprisonment

Where a person under the age of 21 years is sentenced to be imprisoned for the term of his natural life he shall be kept in safe custody in such place as is directed by the Minister administering the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005** from time to time upon the recommendation of the Secretary within the meaning of that Act and if the place at which he is at any time being so kept is a youth justice centre, remand centre, or other institution which is not a prison established under the **Corrections Act 1986**, shall be deemed to be serving that sentence of imprisonment by way of detention in such centre or institution.

S. 476B
inserted by
No. 9242 s. 3,
amended by
Nos 16/1987
ss 4(3)(Sch. 1
item 8(b)),
12(Sch. 2
item 6(b)),
46/1998
s. 7(Sch. 1),
48/2006
s. 42(Sch.
item 9.4).

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Ss 477–479
repealed.⁴⁰

cf. [1742–3]
16 George II,
c. XXXI
ss 3, 4.
[1751–2] 25
George II,
c. XXXVII s. 9.
S. 479A
inserted by
No. 9407
s. 2(g),
amended by
Nos 49/1991
s. 119(1)
(Sch. 2
item 49),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 100).

479A Rescuing of prisoner from lawful custody

Any person who, by force, rescues or attempts to rescue from lawful custody any prisoner shall be guilty of an indictable offence and shall be liable to level 5 imprisonment (10 years maximum).

S. 479B
inserted by
No. 9407
s. 2(g),
amended by
Nos 117/1986
s. 6(Sch. 1
item 1(8)(c)),
129/1993
s. 9(1),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 101).

479B Aiding a prisoner in escaping

Any person who—

S. 479B(a)
substituted by
No. 117/1986
s. 6(Sch. 1
item 1(8)(b)),
amended by
No. 25/1989
s. 20(k),
repealed by
No. 63/2014
s. 7(7).

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- (b) conveys anything or causes anything to be conveyed into a prison or to a prisoner with intent to facilitate the escape of any prisoner—

shall be guilty of an indictable offence punishable on conviction by level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

479C Escape and related offences

S. 479C
inserted by
No. 117/1986
s. 6(Sch. 1
item 1(8)(d)).

(1) A person who, whether by force or not, escapes or attempts to escape—

S. 479C(1)
amended by
Nos 129/1993
s. 9(2),
45/1996
s. 18(Sch. 2
item 6.1),
26/1997
s. 52(1),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 101),
substituted by
No. 45/2001
s. 40(3).

(a) from a prison or police gaol; or

(b) if the person is in the legal custody of the Secretary to the Department of Justice or the Chief Commissioner of Police, from the physical custody of—

(i) an officer within the meaning of Part 5 of the **Corrections Act 1986** or an escort officer under that Act; or

(ii) a police officer; or

S. 479C(1)
(b)(ii)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.42).

(iii) a person acting on lawful authority on behalf of the Secretary or the Chief Commissioner—

is guilty of an indictable offence punishable on conviction by level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

(2) A prisoner who is authorized to be absent from a prison under the **Corrections Act 1986** and who—

S. 479C(2)
amended by
Nos 129/1993
s. 9(2),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 101).

(a) does not return to prison when the instrument of authority expires or when otherwise required by the instrument to do so; or

S. 479C
(2)(c)
amended by
No. 37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.42).

(b) is required by the instrument authorizing the absence to be under the supervision of another person and wilfully ceases to be under that supervision; or

(c) does not return to prison upon being informed by an officer of the Office of Corrections or a police officer that the instrument authorizing the absence has been revoked—

is guilty of an indictable offence punishable on conviction by level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 479C(3)
amended by
Nos 129/1993
s. 9(2),
48/1997
s. 60(1)(Sch. 1
item 101).

(3) A prisoner who is outside a prison or a police gaol but in custody and who wilfully ceases to be in custody is guilty of an indictable offence punishable on conviction by level 6 imprisonment (5 years maximum).

S. 479C(4)
amended by
Nos 45/1996
s. 18(Sch. 2
item 6.2),
26/1997
s. 52(2),
substituted by
No. 45/2001
s. 40(4).

(4) For the purposes of subsection (3), *prisoner* includes a person who is in the custody of a court.

(5) Evidence that a prisoner has, without reasonable excuse, left a cell, or attempted to avoid detection by officers at a prison or police gaol is evidence that the prisoner is attempting to escape from the prison or police gaol.

(6) Sections 325, 459 and 459A apply to offences under this section and section 479B as if the offences were serious indictable offences.

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part III—Procedure and punishment

*	*	*	*	*	Pt 3 Div. 2 Subdiv. (2) (Heading) repealed by No. 25/1989 s. 20(l)(i).
*	*	*	*	*	Ss 480–484 repealed. ⁴¹
(3) Execution of sentences					Pt 3 Div. 2 Subdiv. (3) (Heading) amended by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(c).
*	*	*	*	*	Ss 485–492 repealed ⁴² .
493 Sentences of imprisonment etc. to be carried out according to law relating to prisons					No. 6103 s. 493. S. 493 amended by Nos 8338 s. 7(b), 8426 s. 9(2)(a)(b) (as amended by No. 8701 s. 7(f)), 8870 s. 7(b), 8998 s. 4, 9554 s. 2(1)(Sch. 1 item 9), 9945 s. 3(3)(Sch. 2 item 12), 10087 s. 3(1)(Sch. 1 item 28), 16/1987 s. 4(3)(Sch. 1 item 8(c)), 48/2006 s. 42(Sch. item 9.5).
Every sentence of imprisonment which is passed for any indictable offence every sentence of attendance at an attendance centre, every award of imprisonment or attendance at an attendance centre, and every direction for detention in a youth justice centre within the meaning of the Children, Youth and Families Act 2005 for any offence punishable on summary conviction, shall be carried out in the manner for the time being provided by any Acts in force relating to prisons or penal establishments in that behalf according to the tenor of every such sentence.					
*	*	*	*	*	S. 494 repealed by No. 9554 s. 2(1)(Sch. 1 item 7).

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part III—Procedure and punishment

Pt 3 Div. 2 Subdiv. (4) (Heading) repealed by No. 65/1997 s. 82(2)(c).	*	*	*	*	*
Ss 495–497 repealed. ⁴³	*	*	*	*	*
S. 498 substituted by No. 6884 s. 3, amended by No. 117/1986 s. 6(Sch. 1 item 2(5)), repealed by No. 65/1997 s. 82(2)(c). ⁴⁴	*	*	*	*	*
Ss 499–502 repealed. ⁴⁵	*	*	*	*	*
S. 503 amended by No. 7332 s. 2(Sch. 1 item 20), repealed by No. 65/1997 s. 82(2)(c).	*	*	*	*	*
Pt 3 Div. 2 Subdiv. (5) (Heading and s. 504) amended by No. 7705 s. 10, repealed by No. 10084 s. 9.	*	*	*	*	*
Pt 3 Div. 2 Subdiv. (6) (Heading) repealed by No. 25/1989 s. 20(I)(ii).	*	*	*	*	*
S. 505 repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).	*	*	*	*	*

Division 3—Regulations

505A Regulations

The Governor in Council may make regulations for or with respect to any matter or thing which by this Part is authorized or required or permitted to be prescribed or that is necessary or convenient to be prescribed for carrying out or giving effect to the provisions of this Part.

Pt 3 Div. 3
(Heading and
s. 505A)
inserted by
No. 10026 s. 7.

S. 505A
inserted by
No. 10026 s. 7.

Part IV—Probation and parole provisions

506 Definitions

No. 6103
s. 506.
S. 506
amended by
Nos 6651
s. 57(b),
46/1998
s. 7(Sch. 1)
(ILA s. 39B(1)).

- (1) In this Part unless inconsistent with the context or subject-matter—

Board means the Parole Board under this Part;

child has the same meaning that it has in the
Children, Youth and Families Act 2005;

S. 506(1)
def. of
child
inserted by
No. 9966
s. 21(1)(a),
amended by
Nos 56/1989
s. 286(Sch. 2
item 7.16),
48/2006
s. 42(Sch.
item 9.6).

S. 506(1)
def. of
Director-General
amended by
No. 9902
s. 2(1)(Sch.
item 55),
substituted by
No. 9966
s. 21(1)(b),
repealed by
No. 45/1996
s. 18(Sch. 2
item 6.4).

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Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part IV—Probation and parole provisions

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S. 506(1)
def. of
*Director-
General of
Community
Welfare
Services*
inserted by
No. 9966
s. 21(1)(b),
repealed by
No. 46/1998
s. 7(Sch. 1).

prescribed means prescribed by this Part or the
regulations thereunder;

Secretary means the Secretary to the Department
of Justice;

S. 506(1)
def. of
Secretary
inserted by
No. 46/1998
s. 7(Sch. 1).

term, in relation to imprisonment, includes the
aggregate of two or more terms, whether
cumulative or concurrent.

- (2) If under the **Public Administration Act 2004** the
name of the Department of Justice is changed, a
reference in the definition of *Secretary* in
subsection (1) to that Department must, from the
date when the name is changed, be treated as a
reference to the Department by its new name.

S. 506(2)
inserted by
No. 46/1998
s. 7(Sch. 1),
amended by
No. 108/2004
s. 117(1)
(Sch. 3
item 48).

Division 1—Probation

(1) *Probation officers*

507 Probation officers

No. 6103
s. 507.

S. 507(1)
amended by
Nos 6651
s. 57(c), 9427
s. 3(Sch. 2
item 6), 9966
s. 21(2)(a),
10260
s. 114(Sch. 4
item 5),
46/1998
s. 7(Sch. 1),
108/2004
s. 117(1)
(Sch. 3
item 48).

S. 507(2)
amended by
No. 10260
s. 114(Sch. 4
item 5).

- (1) Subject to the **Public Administration Act 2004** there may from time to time be appointed such stipendiary probation officers as the Governor in Council thinks necessary for the purposes of Part 5 of the **Penalties and Sentences Act 1985**.
- (2) The Governor in Council may from time to time appoint fit persons to be honorary probation officers for the purposes of Part 5 of the **Penalties and Sentences Act 1985** and may at any time remove any person so appointed.
- (3) All persons who immediately before the commencement of the **Penal Reform Act 1956** were probation officers by virtue of appointment pursuant to section five hundred and thirty-six of the **Crimes Act 1928** are declared to have been as on and from the said commencement honorary probation officers as if appointed under the last preceding subsection.

S. 507(4)
amended by
No. 9966
s. 21(2)(b)(i)(ii),
repealed by
No. 10260
s. 114(Sch. 4
item 5).

* * * *

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part IV—Probation and parole provisions

(4A) All stipendiary and honorary probation officers appointed under this section shall be under the control of the Secretary to the Department of Justice.					S. 507(4A) inserted by No. 9966 s. 21(2)(c), amended by No. 45/1996 s. 18(Sch. 2 item 6.5).
*	*	*	*	*	S. 507(5) amended by No. 9966 s. 21(2)(d), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).
(6) The Secretary to the Department of Justice and Community Safety shall when so required by any court cause to be prepared and submitted to that court such reports upon and information with respect to the convicted person as the court requires.					S. 507(6) amended by Nos 9966 s. 21(2)(e)(i)(ii), 45/1996 s. 18(Sch. 2 item 6.6), 46/1998 s. 7(Sch. 1), 41/2025 s. 4(Sch. 2 item 8).
*	*	*	*	*	S. 507(7) amended by No. 9966 s. 21(2)(f), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).
*	*	*	*	*	Pt 4 Div. 1 Subdiv. (2) (Heading) repealed by No. 25/1989 s. 20(m)(i).
*	*	*	*	*	Ss 508, 509 repealed. ⁴⁶

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part IV—Probation and parole provisions

Pt 4 Div. 1 Subdiv. (3) (Heading) repealed by No. 25/1989 s. 20(m)(ii).	*	*	*	*	*
Ss 510–515A repealed. ⁴⁷	*	*	*	*	*
Pt 4 Div. 1 Subdiv. (4) (Heading) repealed by No. 25/1989 s. 20(m)(iii).	*	*	*	*	*
Ss 516–519A repealed. ⁴⁸	*	*	*	*	*
Pt 4 Div. 1 Subdiv. (5) (Heading) repealed by No. 25/1989 s. 20(m)(iv).	*	*	*	*	*
S. 520 amended by Nos 7876 s. 8(3), 10084 s. 10(a)–(c), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).	*	*	*	*	*

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Part IV—Probation and parole provisions

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Pt 4 Div. 2
(Heading and
ss 521–541)
amended by
Nos 6572
ss 2–4, 6651
s. 57(d)(e),
6884 s. 4, 6994
s. 2, 7184
ss 10, 11, 7269
ss 2–4, 7332
s. 2(Sch. 1
item 21), 7705
s. 10, 7876
s. 2(3), 8338
s. 7(a)(b)(i),
repealed by
No. 8493
s. 33(e).

Division 3—Regulations

542 Regulations

- (1) The Governor in Council may make regulations
for or with respect to prescribing any matter or
thing by this Part authorized or directed to be
prescribed or necessary or expedient to be
prescribed for the purposes of this Part.

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No. 6103
s. 538.

S. 542(2)
repealed by
No. 6888 s. 3.

Pt 5 (Heading)
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1).

Part V—Property of persons convicted of treason or an indictable offence. Orders as to costs

Ss 543–544
repealed.⁴⁹

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No. 6103
s. 541.
S. 545
amended by
Nos 9576
s. 11(1),
19/1989
s. 16(Sch.
item 16.11),
25/1989
s. 20(n).

545 Persons convicted of treason or indictable offence may pay costs

The court by which judgment is pronounced or recorded upon the conviction of any person for treason or an indictable offence in addition to such sentence as may otherwise by law be passed may condemn such person to the payment of the whole or any part of the costs or expenses incurred in and about the prosecution and conviction for the offence of which he is convicted, and the payments of such costs and expenses or any part thereof may be ordered by the court to be made out of any moneys taken from such person on his apprehension, or may be enforced at the instance of any person liable to pay or who may have paid the same in such and the same manner (subject to the provisions of this Part) as the payment of any costs ordered to be paid by the judgment or order of any court of competent jurisdiction in any civil proceeding may for the time being be enforced:

Provided that in the meantime and until the recovery of such costs and expenses from the person so convicted as aforesaid or from his estate the same shall be paid and provided for in the same manner as if this Part of this Act had not been passed, and any money which may be recovered in respect thereof from the person so convicted or from his estate shall be applicable to the reimbursement of any person or fund by whom or out of which such costs and expenses may have been paid or defrayed.

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S. 546
amended by
No. 7705 s. 10,
substituted by
No. 7994 s. 4,
amended by
No. 8280
s. 18(a)(i)(ii)(b),
repealed by
No. 10260
s. 114(Sch. 4
item 4).

547 Definition of *forfeiture* and *convict*

No. 6103
s. 543.

The word *forfeiture* in the construction of this Part shall not include any fine or penalty imposed on any convict by virtue of his sentence, and the expression *convict*⁵⁰ shall be deemed to mean any person against whom after the passing of this Act judgment of imprisonment has been pronounced or recorded by any court of competent jurisdiction in Victoria upon any charge of treason or indictable offence.

S. 547
amended by
Nos 8679
s. 3(1)(e), 9576
s. 11(1), 9945
s. 3(3)(Sch. 2
item 14).

548 When convict shall cease to be subject to operation of this Part

No. 6103
s. 544.

When any convict dies or is adjudicated bankrupt, or has undergone the full term of imprisonment for which judgment has been pronounced or recorded against him, or such other punishment as may by competent authority have been substituted for such full term, or has received a pardon for the treason or indictable offence of which he has been convicted, he shall thenceforth so far as relates to the provisions hereinafter contained cease to be subject to the operation of this Part.

S. 548
amended by
Nos 8679
s. 3(1)(f), 9576
s. 11(1), 9945
s. 3(3)(Sch. 2
item 15).

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Ss 549–561
repealed by
No. 8410
s. 5(1).

No. 6103
s. 558.
S. 562
amended by
No. 8410
s. 5(2).

562 Execution of judgments against convict provided for

All judgments or orders for the payment of money of any court of law or equity against such convict which have been duly recovered or made either before or after his conviction may be executed against any property of such convict in the hands of any person who may have taken upon himself the possession or management thereof without legal authority in the same manner as if such property were in the possession or power of such convict.

No. 6103
s. 559.
S. 563
amended by
Nos 8410
s. 5(3)(a)(b),
19/1989
s. 16(Sch.
item
16.12(a)(b)).

563 Proceedings to recover property of convict from third person

The Attorney-General or any person who (if such convict were dead intestate) would be entitled to his real or personal estate or any share thereof or any person authorized by the Attorney-General in that behalf may apply in a summary way to any court which (if such convict were dead) would have jurisdiction to entertain a proceeding for the administration of his real or personal estate to issue a writ calling upon any person who without legal authority has possessed himself of any part of the property of such convict to account for his receipts and payments in respect of the property of such convict in such manner as such court directs, and such court thereupon may issue such writ rule or other process and may enforce obedience thereto and to all orders and proceedings of such court consequent thereon in the same manner as in any other case of process lawfully issuing out of such court, and such court shall thereupon have full power jurisdiction and authority to take all such accounts and to make and give all such orders and directions as to it seems proper or necessary for the purpose of securing the due and proper care administration and management of the property of such convict and the due and proper

application of the same and of the income thereof and the accumulation and investment of such balances (if any) as may from time to time remain in the hands of any such other person as aforesaid in respect of such property.

564 Third person etc. accountable to convict when property reverts

Subject to the provisions of this Part every such person as aforesaid shall from and after the time when such convict shall cease to be subject to the operation of this Part be accountable to such convict for all property of such convict which has been by him possessed or received and not duly administered in the same manner in which any guardian or trustee is so accountable to his ward or cestui que trust.

No. 6103
s. 560.
S. 564
amended by
No. 8410
s. 5(4)(a)(b).

565 Saving of general law as to indictable offence

Nothing in this Part shall be deemed to alter or in anywise affect the law relating to indictable offences in Victoria except as in this Part is expressly enacted.

No. 6103
s. 561.
S. 565
amended by
No. 9576
s. 11(1).

* * * * *

Pt 6
(Headings
and
ss 566–584)
repealed.⁵¹

Part 7—General

Pt 7 (Heading
and s. 585)
inserted by
No. 26/1997
s. 53.

585 Supreme Court—limitation of jurisdiction

S. 585
inserted by
No. 26/1997
s. 53,
amended by
No. 65/1997
s. 82(4)(e).

- (1) It is the intention of section 361 as amended by the **Police and Corrections (Amendment) Act 1997** and the **Crimes (Mental Impairment and Unfitness to be Tried) Act 1997** to alter or vary section 85 of the **Constitution Act 1975**.

S. 585(1)
amended by
No. 81/1997
s. 29(2) (ILA
s. 39B(1)).

- (2) It is the intention of section 464ZH, as amended by section 29(1) of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997**, to alter or vary section 85 of the **Constitution Act 1975**.

S. 585(2)
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 29(2).

585AAA Regulations

S. 585AAA
inserted by
No. 28/2016
s. 13.

- (1) The Governor in Council may make regulations for or with respect to any matter or thing required or permitted by this Act to be prescribed or necessary to be prescribed to give effect to this Act.
- (2) The regulations—
- (a) may be of general or limited application; and
 - (b) may differ according to differences in time, place or circumstances.

585AA Transitional provisions—(Crimes (Theft) Act 1973)

S. 585AA
inserted by
No. 70/2013
s. 5(Sch. 3
item 1).

- (1) Section 3(1) of the **Crimes (Theft) Act 1973** continues in effect despite its repeal.

Note

Section 3(1) of the **Crimes (Theft) Act 1973** abolished the common law offences of larceny, robbery, burglary, receiving stolen property, obtaining property by threats, extortion by colour of office or franchise, false accounting by public officers, concealment of treasure trove, and except in regard to offences relating to public revenue, cheating, for all purposes not related to offences committed before the commencement of the 1973 Act.

- (2) Except as regards offences committed before the commencement of the **Crimes (Theft) Act 1973** and except insofar as the context otherwise requires—
- (a) references in any enactment passed before the commencement of the **Crimes (Theft) Act 1973** to an offence abolished by that 1973 Act shall, subject to any express amendment or repeal made by that 1973 Act, have effect as references to the corresponding offence under Division 2 of Part I of this Act and in any such enactment the expression "receive" (when it relates to an offence of receiving) shall mean handle, and "receiver" shall be construed accordingly; and
 - (b) without prejudice to paragraph (a), references in any enactment, whenever passed, to theft or stealing (including references to stolen goods), and references to robbery, blackmail, burglary, aggravated burglary or handling stolen goods shall be construed in accordance with the provisions of Division 2 of Part I of this Act.

- (3) Division 2 of Part I of this Act as re-enacted by the **Crimes (Theft) Act 1973**, shall, save as otherwise provided by that 1973 Act, have effect only in relation to offences wholly or partly committed on or after the commencement of that 1973 Act.
- (4) The re-enactment by this section of sections 3(2) and 4 of the **Crimes (Theft) Act 1973** does not affect the operation of any Act enacted after that 1973 Act.

S. 585AB
inserted by
No. 70/2013
s. 5(Sch. 3
item 1).

585AB Transitional provisions—(Crimes (Criminal Damage) Act 1978)

- (1) The provisions of this Act as in force immediately before the commencement of the **Crimes (Criminal Damage) Act 1978** shall apply to and with respect to offences against this Act as so in force committed or alleged to have been committed before the commencement of that 1978 Act.
- (2) The provisions of this Act as amended by the **Crimes (Criminal Damage) Act 1978** shall apply to and with respect to offences against this Act as so amended committed or alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that 1978 Act.
- (3) Section 3 of the **Crimes (Criminal Damage) Act 1978** continues in effect despite its repeal.

Note

Section 3 of the **Crimes (Criminal Damage) Act 1978** abolished the common law offence of arson for all purposes not related to offences committed before the commencement of that 1978 Act.

- (4) The re-enactment by this section of section 1(4) and (5) of the **Crimes (Criminal Damage) Act 1978** does not affect the operation of any Act enacted after that 1978 Act.

585AC Transitional provisions—(Crimes (Classification of Offences) Act 1981)

S. 585AC
inserted by
No. 70/2013
s. 5(Sch. 3
item 1).

- (1) Notwithstanding section 3A(1) of this Act as amended by the **Crimes (Classification of Offences) Act 1981**, the provisions of that subsection shall apply only in relation to acts of violence occurring after the commencement of the **Crimes (Classification of Offences) Act 1981**.
- (2) Notwithstanding sections 3A(2) and 322D of this Act as amended by the **Crimes (Classification of Offences) Act 1981**, the felony-murder rule referred to in section 3A(2) shall continue to have full force and effect in relation to acts of violence which occurred before the commencement of the **Crimes (Classification of Offences) Act 1981**.
- (3) Section 9 of the **Crimes (Classification of Offences) Act 1981** continues in effect despite its repeal.

Note

Section 9 of the **Crimes (Classification of Offences) Act 1981** abolished any power to bring proceedings for an indictable offence by criminal information in the Supreme Court or in the County Court.

- (4) The re-enactment by this section of section 3(2) and (3) of the **Crimes (Classification of Offences) Act 1981** does not affect the operation of any Act enacted after that 1981 Act.

585AD Transitional provisions—(Crimes (Conspiracy and Incitement) Act 1984)

S. 585AD
inserted by
No. 70/2013
s. 5(Sch. 3
item 1).

- (1) The abolition of the offence of conspiracy at common law effected by section 321F of this Act as amended by the **Crimes (Conspiracy and Incitement) Act 1984** shall not affect—
 - (a) any proceedings commenced before the commencement of the **Crimes (Conspiracy and Incitement) Act 1984**; or

- (b) any proceedings commenced after the commencement of the **Crimes (Conspiracy and Incitement) Act 1984** in respect of an agreement which is alleged to have been made at a time prior to the commencement of that 1984 Act.
- (2) The abolition of the offence of incitement at common law effected by section 321L of this Act as amended by the **Crimes (Conspiracy and Incitement) Act 1984** shall not affect—
 - (a) any proceedings commenced before the commencement of the **Crimes (Conspiracy and Incitement) Act 1984**; or
 - (b) any proceedings commenced after the commencement of the **Crimes (Conspiracy and Incitement) Act 1984** in respect of an offence of incitement alleged to have been committed at a time prior to the commencement of that 1984 Act.
- (3) Subject to subsections (1) and (2), this Act as amended by the **Crimes (Conspiracy and Incitement) Act 1984** shall apply to acts done before as well as to acts done after the commencement of that 1984 Act.
- (4) The re-enactment by this section of sections 4, 5 and 6 of the **Crimes (Conspiracy and Incitement) Act 1984** does not affect the operation of any Act enacted after that 1984 Act.

S. 585AE
inserted by
No. 70/2013
s. 5(Sch. 3
item 1).

585AE Transitional provisions—(Crimes (Custody and Investigation) Act 1988)

- (1) This Act as amended by sections 4 and 5 of the **Crimes (Custody and Investigation) Act 1988** applies to—
 - (a) persons taken into custody; or
 - (b) persons questioned; or

- (c) persons in respect of whom an application is made under section 464B(1) to a court—

in a proclaimed region after the commencement of the **Crimes (Custody and Investigation) Act 1988**.

Note

The whole of Victoria was proclaimed to be a proclaimed region on the same day that the **Crimes (Custody and Investigation) Act 1988** commenced.

- (2) The re-enactment by this section of section 6(2) of the **Crimes (Custody and Investigation) Act 1988** does not affect the operation of any Act enacted after that 1988 Act.

585AF Transitional provisions—(Crimes (Fingerprinting) Act 1988)

S. 585AF
inserted by
No. 70/2013
s. 5(Sch. 3
item 1).

- (1) This Act as amended by a section of the **Crimes (Fingerprinting) Act 1988** or section 11, 12, 13 or 14 of the **Crimes Legislation (Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 1989** applies only with respect to fingerprints taken after the commencement of section 9 of the **Crimes (Fingerprinting) Act 1988**.
- (2) The re-enactment by this section of section 9 of the **Crimes (Fingerprinting) Act 1988** does not affect the operation of any Act enacted after that 1988 Act.

585A Transitional provisions—(Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1991)

S. 585A
inserted by
No. 10/2005
s. 4(Sch. 2
item 1).

- (1) The amendments made by the following provisions of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1991** apply to a proceeding that occurs on or after the commencement of the provision, irrespective of when the offence to which the proceeding relates is alleged to have been committed—

- (a) section 3 to the extent that it—
 - (i) abolishes the requirement of corroboration in sections 51(5), 54(2) and 55(2) of this Act by repealing those sections;
 - (ii) inserts a new section 61 in this Act;
 - (b) section 6(c);
 - (c) any provision of Part 3;
 - (d) any provision of section 13, 15, 16(1)(a), (b), (c), (d) or (e) or 19.
- (2) Subject to subsection (1)(a), the amendments made by section 3, 6(a), 6(b), 6(d) or 6(e) of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1991** apply only to offences alleged to have been committed after the commencement of that section.
 - (3) The amendments made by any provision of section 4, 5, 14, 16(1)(f) or 16(2) of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1991** apply only to proceedings relating to offences alleged to have been committed after the commencement of the provision.
 - (4) For the purposes of this section an offence is not alleged to have been committed after the commencement of a provision if it is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after that commencement.
 - (5) This section adds to, and does not take away from, the provisions of the **Interpretation of Legislation Act 1984**.
 - (6) The re-enactment by this section of section 21(2) of, and the Schedule to, the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1991** does not affect the operation of any Act enacted after the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1991**.

585B Transitional provisions—(Crimes (Amendment) Act 1993)

- (1) This Act, as amended by section 7 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1993**, does not apply to an application to a court for fingerprints or a blood sample—
 - (a) made before the commencement of section 7 of that Act; or
 - (b) made after that commencement arising from a refusal to give fingerprints or a blood sample before the commencement.
- (2) Subject to section 464P of this Act (as inserted by the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1993**) this Act as in force immediately before the commencement of section 7 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1993** continues to apply to fingerprints and blood samples taken before that commencement.
- (3) The re-enactment by this section of section 11 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1993** does not affect the operation of any Act enacted after the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1993**.

585C Transitional provisions—(Miscellaneous Acts (Omnibus Amendments) Act 1996)

- (1) This Act as amended by sections 6(1) and 6(3) of the **Miscellaneous Acts (Omnibus Amendments) Act 1996** applies only with respect to applications for warrants made on or after the commencement of section 6 of that 1996 Act under section 465 of this Act or section 81 of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981**.

S. 585C
inserted by
No. 10/2005
s. 4(Sch. 2
item 1).

- (2) This Act as amended by section 8 of the **Miscellaneous Acts (Omnibus Amendments) Act 1996** applies to any child pornography, film, photograph, publication or computer game seized, whether before or after the commencement of section 8 of that 1996 Act.
- (3) The expressions used in subsection (2) have the same meaning as in section 67A of this Act.
- (4) The re-enactment by this section of sections 6(4) and 9 of the **Miscellaneous Acts (Omnibus Amendments) Act 1996** does not affect the operation of any Act enacted after the **Miscellaneous Acts (Omnibus Amendments) Act 1996**.

S. 585D
inserted by
No. 10/2005
s. 4(Sch. 2
item 1).

585D Transitional provisions—(Sentencing and Other Acts (Amendment) Act 1997)

- (1) The amendment of this Act made by section 54 or 56 of the **Sentencing and Other Acts (Amendment) Act 1997** applies only to offences alleged to have been committed after the commencement of that amendment.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates and an amendment of this Act by section 54 or 56 of the **Sentencing and Other Acts (Amendment) Act 1997** commenced on a date between those two dates, the offence is alleged to have been committed before the commencement of that amendment.
- (3) The amendments of section 568 of this Act made by section 59 of the **Sentencing and Other Acts (Amendment) Act 1997** apply to appeals heard and determined by the Court of Appeal after the commencement of section 59 of the **Sentencing and Other Acts (Amendment) Act 1997**,

irrespective of when the notice of appeal or notice of application for leave to appeal was given.

- (4) The re-enactment by this section of section 63 of the **Sentencing and Other Acts (Amendment) Act 1997** does not affect the operation of any Act enacted after the **Sentencing and Other Acts (Amendment) Act 1997**.

586 Transitional provisions (Sentencing (Amendment) Act 1997)

S. 586
inserted by
No. 69/1997
s. 25.

- (1) The amendment of section 443A(3) made by section 22(12) of the **Sentencing (Amendment) Act 1997** effecting a change from indictable to summary in the nature of an offence against that section applies to a proceeding for an offence that is commenced after the commencement of section 22(12) of that Act, irrespective of when the offence to which the proceeding relates is alleged to have been committed.
- (2) The amendments of section 567A made by section 24 of the **Sentencing (Amendment) Act 1997** apply to appeals against sentences passed after the commencement of section 24 of that Act, irrespective of when the offence was committed.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (2) a sentence passed by an appellate court on setting aside a sentencing order must be taken to have been passed at the time the original sentencing order was made.

587 Transitional provisions (Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997—Part 2)

S. 587
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 8.

- (1) The amendments of this Act made by sections 4, 6 and 7 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997** apply to any trial that commences on or after 1 January 1998, irrespective of when the offence

to which the trial relates is alleged to have been committed.

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), a trial commences on arraignment of the accused in accordance with Subdivision (12) of Division 1 of Part III.
- (3) The amendments of section 47A of this Act made by section 5(1) of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997** apply only to offences against section 47A(1) alleged to have been committed on or after 1 January 1998.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates of which one is before and one is on or after 1 January 1998, the offence is alleged to have been committed before 1 January 1998.
- (5) The amendments of section 47A of this Act made by section 5(2), (3), (4) and (5) of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997** apply to offences against section 47A(1) for which a charge is filed on or after 1 January 1998, irrespective of when the offence is alleged to have been committed.

S. 588
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 15.

588 Transitional provisions (Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997—Part 3)

- (1) Section 398A applies to any trial, committal proceeding or hearing of a charge for an offence that commences on or after 1 January 1998, irrespective of when the offence to which the trial, committal proceeding or hearing relates is alleged to have been committed.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1)—
 - (a) a trial commences on arraignment of the accused in accordance with Subdivision (12) of Division 1 of Part III; and

- (b) a committal proceeding commences on the committal mention date; and
- (c) a hearing of a charge for an offence commences on the taking of a formal plea from the accused.

589 Transitional provisions (Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997—Part 4)

S. 589
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 30.

- (1) The amendment of this Act made by section 16(f), 17 or 18 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997** applies to applications made under section 464T(1), 464U(3) or 464V (as the case requires) irrespective of when the offence in respect of which the application is made is alleged to have been committed.
- (2) The amendment of this Act made by section 22 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997** only applies with respect to orders made by a court on or after the commencement of that section.
- (3) The amendments of this Act made by section 24 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997** apply to any proceedings that commence on or after the commencement of that section of that Act, irrespective of when the offence to which the proceedings relate is alleged to have been committed.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3)—
 - (a) a trial commences on arraignment of the accused in accordance with Subdivision (12) of Division 1 of Part III; and
 - (b) a committal proceeding commences on the committal mention date; and
 - (c) a hearing of a charge for an offence commences on the taking of a formal plea from the accused.

- (5) The first report submitted to the Attorney-General in accordance with section 464ZFE must relate to the period beginning with the day on which section 26 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997** comes into operation.
- (6) The amendments of section 464ZG(3)(a) and (4)(a) made by section 27(2)(b) and (3)(b) of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997** apply only to samples taken in forensic procedures conducted on or after the commencement of section 27 of that Act and any related material and information within the meaning of Subdivision (30A) of Division 1 of Part III in relation to such samples.
- (7) The amendments of section 464ZG(8) and (9) made by section 27(5) and (6) of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997** apply only to offences alleged to have been committed after the commencement of section 27 of that Act.
- (8) For the purposes of subsection (7), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates and section 27 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997** commences on a date between those two dates, the offence is alleged to have been committed before the commencement of that section.

S. 590
inserted by
No. 80/1998
s. 4.

590 Transitional provision—Crimes, Confiscation and Evidence Acts (Amendment) Act 1998

The amendments to this Act made by section 3 of the **Crimes, Confiscation and Evidence Acts (Amendment) Act 1998** apply only with respect to forensic procedures within the meaning of Subdivision (30A) of Division 1 of Part III conducted after the commencement of that section.

591 Transitional provision—Crimes (Amendment) Act 1998

- (1) The amendments of section 60B of this Act made by section 3 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1998** apply only to offences alleged to have been committed after the commencement of section 3.
- (2) If an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates and section 3 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1998** commences on a date between those two dates, for the purposes of subsection (1) the offence must be taken to have been alleged to have been committed before the commencement of that section.

S. 590
inserted by
No. 65/1998
s. 4,
re-numbered
as s. 591 by
No. 10/1999
s. 31(5)(e).

592 Transitional provisions—Magistrates' Court (Amendment) Act 1999

The amendments of this Act made by section 18(4) of the **Magistrates' Court (Amendment) Act 1999** apply only in relation to appeals to the Court of Appeal for which the notice of appeal or notice of application for leave to appeal is given on or after 1 July 1999.

S. 592
inserted by
No. 10/1999
s. 20.

593 Transitional provisions—Crimes (Amendment) Act 2000

- (1) In this section *commencement day* means the day on which the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2000** comes into operation.
- (2) The amendment of section 38 of this Act made by section 4 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2000** applies only to offences alleged to have been committed after the commencement day.
- (3) The amendment of section 70 of this Act made by section 6 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2000** applies only to offences alleged to have been committed after the commencement day.

S. 593
inserted by
No. 67/2000
s. 8.

- (4) For the purposes of subsections (2) and (3), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one on or after the commencement day, the offence is alleged to have been committed before the commencement day.
- (5) From any time on or after the commencement day a charge or presentment may be filed against a person for an offence against section 45 of this Act, as substituted by section 5 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2000**, irrespective of whether the offence is alleged to have been committed before, on or after the commencement day provided it is not alleged to have been committed before 5 August 1991.
- (6) For the purposes of subsection (5), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one on or after 5 August 1991, the offence is alleged to have been committed before 5 August 1991.
- (7) Section 359A(1) of this Act, as in force before the commencement day, continues to apply to an alleged offence against section 45 or 46 (as in force before the commencement day) or an attempt to commit any such offence or an assault with intent to commit any such offence for which a person is directed to be tried, or with which a person is charged on indictment or presentment, before the commencement day.
- (8) The amendments of section 425(1) of this Act made by section 7 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2000** apply to any trial that commences on or after the commencement day and an accused may be found guilty in such a trial of an offence against section 45 of this Act, as substituted by section 5 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2000**, irrespective of whether the conduct constituting

the offence is alleged to have occurred before, on or after the commencement day provided it is not alleged to have occurred before 5 August 1991.

(9) For the purposes of subsection (8)—

- (a) a trial commences on arraignment of the accused in accordance with Subdivision (12) of Division 1 of Part III of this Act; and
- (b) if conduct constituting an offence is alleged to have occurred between two dates, one before and one on or after 5 August 1991, the conduct is alleged to have occurred before 5 August 1991.

(10) Section 425(3) of this Act, as in force before the commencement day, continues to apply to any trial of an offence against section 45(1) or 46(1) (as in force before the commencement day) that occurs on or after the commencement day, irrespective of whether that trial commenced before, on or after the commencement day.

593A Transitional provision—Crimes (Questioning of Suspects) Act 2000

S. 593A
inserted by
No. 86/2000
s. 7.

The amendments of this Act made by the **Crimes (Questioning of Suspects) Act 2000** applies to any person who is, at any time on or after the commencement of that Act, a person of a kind referred to in section 464B(1)(a), irrespective of when the offence to which the questioning or investigation relates was committed or alleged to have been committed.

594 Transitional provision—Magistrates' Court (Committal Proceedings) Act 2000

S. 594
inserted by
No. 92/2000
s. 12.

The amendments of section 359AA of this Act made by section 11 of the **Magistrates' Court (Committal Proceedings) Act 2000** apply to applications made under that section on or after the commencement of that section of that Act

irrespective of when the charge for the summary offence was filed under section 26 of the **Magistrates' Court Act 1989**.

S. 596
inserted by
No. 16/2002
s. 19.

596 Transitional provisions—Crimes (DNA Database) Act 2002

- (1) The amendments of section 464Z of this Act made by section 7 of the **Crimes (DNA Database) Act 2002** apply to the taking of a scraping of the mouth on or after the commencement of section 7 of that Act.
- (2) The amendment of section 464ZFB of this Act made by section 13 of the **Crimes (DNA Database) Act 2002** applies to a person found guilty of an offence on or after the commencement of section 13 of that Act.
- (3) The amendment of this Act made by section 16 of the **Crimes (DNA Database) Act 2002** applies to any offence or suspected offence, irrespective of when the offence is alleged to have been committed.
- (4) The amendments of this Act made by section 17 of the **Crimes (DNA Database) Act 2002** only apply to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of section 17 of that Act.
- (5) The amendments of this Act made by section 18(1) of the **Crimes (DNA Database) Act 2002** only apply to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of section 18(1) of that Act.
- (6) For the purposes of subsections (4) and (5), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of section 17 or 18(1) (as the case requires) of the **Crimes (DNA Database)**

Act 2002, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

597 Transitional provision—Crimes (Property Damage and Computer Offences) Act 2003

S. 597
inserted by
No. 10/2003
s. 9.

- (1) The amendments of this Act made by the **Crimes (Property Damage and Computer Offences) Act 2003** apply only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Act.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of the **Crimes (Property Damage and Computer Offences) Act 2003**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

598 Transitional provision—Crimes (Stalking) Act 2003

S. 598
inserted by
No. 105/2003
s. 6.

- (1) The amendments of section 21A of this Act made by Part 2 of the **Crimes (Stalking) Act 2003** apply to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Act.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of the **Crimes (Stalking) Act 2003**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.
- (3) The amendments of section 21A of this Act made by Part 2 of the **Crimes (Stalking) Act 2003** do not affect the rights of the parties in the proceeding known as *DPP v Sutcliffe* (No. 6562 of 2000) in the Supreme Court.

S. 599
inserted by
No. 104/2003
s. 4.

599 Transitional provision—Crimes (Money Laundering) Act 2003

- (1) The amendments of this Act made by the **Crimes (Money Laundering) Act 2003** apply only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of section 3 of that Act.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of section 3 of the **Crimes (Money Laundering) Act 2003**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

S. 600
inserted by
No. 59/2004
s. 8.

600 Transitional provisions—Crimes (Dangerous Driving) Act 2004

- (1) Section 88 (as amended by section 3 of the **Crimes (Dangerous Driving) Act 2004**) applies only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Act.
- (2) Section 88A (as inserted by section 4 of the **Crimes (Dangerous Driving) Act 2004**) applies to any trial that commences on or after the commencement of that Act regardless of when the offences are alleged to have been committed.
- (3) Section 319 (as inserted by section 6 of the **Crimes (Dangerous Driving) Act 2004**) applies only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Act.
- (4) For the purposes of this section—
 - (a) if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of the **Crimes (Dangerous Driving) Act 2004**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement; and

- (b) a trial commences on arraignment of the accused in accordance with Subdivision (12) of Division 1 of Part III of this Act.

601 Transitional provision—Children and Young Persons (Age Jurisdiction) Act 2004

S. 601
inserted by
No. 72/2004
s. 33.

- (1) An amendment made to this Act by a provision of the **Children and Young Persons (Age Jurisdiction) Act 2004** applies to all persons on and after the commencement of that provision regardless of whether or not immediately before that commencement—
- (a) the person was in custody within the meaning of Subdivision (30A) of Division 1 of Part III; or
 - (b) the person had consented to undergo a forensic procedure under section 464R but the procedure had not yet been conducted; or
 - (c) the conduct of a non-intimate compulsory procedure was authorised under section 464SA but the procedure had not yet been conducted; or
 - (d) the person had consented to give a sample in accordance with section 464ZGB but the sample had not yet been taken.
- (2) Without limiting subsection (1) or section 14(2) of the **Interpretation of Legislation Act 1984**, an amendment made to this Act by a provision of the **Children and Young Persons (Age Jurisdiction) Act 2004** does not affect any order made by a court under Subdivision (30A) of Division 1 of Part III before the commencement of that provision and any such order may be executed or enforced, and any period of custody specified in it may be extended, as if this Act had not been amended by that provision.

S. 602
inserted by
No. 66/2005
s. 7.

602 Transitional provision—Crimes (Contamination of Goods) Act 2005

- (1) The amendments of this Act made by the **Crimes (Contamination of Goods) Act 2005** apply only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Act.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of the **Crimes (Contamination of Goods) Act 2005**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

S. 603
inserted by
No. 77/2005
s. 7.

603 Transitional provision—Crimes (Homicide) Act 2005

- (1) An amendment of this Act made by section 3, 4, 5 or 6 of the **Crimes (Homicide) Act 2005** applies only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Act.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1) if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of the **Crimes (Homicide) Act 2005**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

S. 604
inserted by
No. 14/2006
s. 15.

604 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation (Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 2006

The amendments made to this Act by sections 13 and 14 of the **Justice Legislation (Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 2006** only apply to appeals for which the notice of appeal or notice of application for leave to appeal is given after the commencement of those sections.

605 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation (Further Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 2006

S. 605
inserted by
No. 27/2006
s. 18.

- (1) The amendments made to this Act by sections 3(b), 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15 and 16 of the **Justice Legislation (Further Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 2006** only apply with respect to findings of not guilty because of mental impairment on or after the commencement of that Act.
- (2) The amendments made to this Act by sections 3(c) and 17 of the **Justice Legislation (Further Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 2006** only apply to recordings made on or after the commencement of that Act.

606 Transitional provision—Courts Legislation (Jurisdiction) Act 2006

S. 606
inserted by
No. 50/2006
s. 11.

- (1) Section 353(2B) applies with respect to an offence for which a presentment is served on or after the commencement of section 6 of the **Courts Legislation (Jurisdiction) Act 2006**, irrespective of when the offence is alleged to have been committed.
- (2) The amendments made to this Act by section 7 of the **Courts Legislation (Jurisdiction) Act 2006** apply to a proceeding that occurs on or after the commencement of that section, irrespective of when the offence to which the proceeding relates is alleged to have been committed.
- (3) Section 359B applies to any trial or summary hearing that commences on or after the commencement of section 8 of the **Courts Legislation (Jurisdiction) Act 2006**, irrespective of when the offence to which the trial or summary hearing relates is alleged to have been committed.

- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3) a trial commences on arraignment of the accused in accordance with Subdivision (12) of Division 1 of Part III.
- (5) The amendments made to this Act by section 10 of the **Courts Legislation (Jurisdiction) Act 2006** apply in relation to appeals heard by the Court of Appeal on or after the commencement of that section irrespective of when—
 - (a) the notice of appeal or notice of application for leave to appeal was given; or
 - (b) the offence is alleged to have been committed.

S. 606A
inserted by
No. 2/2006
s. 19A (as
amended by
No. 76/2006
s. 10).

606A Transitional provision—Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 2006

- (1) An amendment made to this Act by a provision of section 4 or 5 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 2006** applies to any trial that commences on or after the commencement of that provision, irrespective of when the offence to which the trial relates is alleged to have been committed.
- (2) An amendment made to this Act by a provision of section 6, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12 or 17(4) or (5) of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 2006** applies only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that provision.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), a trial commences on arraignment of the accused in accordance with Subdivision (12) of Division 1 of Part III.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (2), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of a provision of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 2006**, the offence is

alleged to have been committed before the commencement of that provision.

607 Transitional provision—Crimes (Sexual Offences) (Further Amendment) Act 2006

S. 607
inserted by
No. 76/2006
s. 4.

The amendments made to this Act by section 3 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) (Further Amendment) Act 2006** apply to any proceeding that commences on or after the commencement of that section, irrespective of when the offence to which the proceeding relates is alleged to have been committed.

608 Transitional provisions—Crimes Amendment (DNA Database) Act 2007

S. 608
inserted by
No. 32/2007
s. 12.

- (1) An amendment made to this Act by the Amendment Act applies only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Act.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one after the commencement of the Amendment Act, the offence is alleged to have been committed before the commencement of that Act.
- (3) On the commencement of the Amendment Act, a computerised database or DNA database kept under section 464ZFD before that commencement is taken to be the DNA database system kept under section 464ZFD(1AA) by the Chief Commissioner of Police.
- (4) A matching of a DNA profile made in accordance with the Table to section 464ZGI before the commencement of the Amendment Act continues on and after that commencement as if the matching had occurred in accordance with the Table as in force after that commencement.

- (5) An arrangement under section 464ZGN in force immediately before the commencement of the Amendment Act continues in force on the same terms and conditions and for the same period after that commencement as if it had been entered into under section 464ZGN as in force after that commencement.

- (6) In this section—

Amendment Act means the **Crimes Amendment (DNA Database) Act 2007**.

S. 609
inserted by
No. 57/2007
s. 9.

609 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment (Rape) Act 2007

- (1) An amendment made to this Act by section 3, 4 or 8 of the **Crimes Amendment (Rape) Act 2007** applies to any trial that commences on or after the commencement of that section of that Act, irrespective of when the offence to which the trial relates is alleged to have been committed.
- (2) An amendment made to this Act by section 5, 6 or 7 of the **Crimes Amendment (Rape) Act 2007** applies only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of those sections of that Act.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (1), a trial commences on arraignment of the accused in accordance with Subdivision (12) of Division 1 of Part III.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (2), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of sections 5, 6 and 7 of the **Crimes Amendment (Rape) Act 2007**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before the commencement of those sections of that Act.

**610 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment
(Child Homicide) Act 2008**

S. 610
inserted by
No. 7/2008
s. 6.

- (1) The amendments of this Act made by the **Crimes Amendment (Child Homicide) Act 2008** apply only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Act.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1) if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of the **Crimes Amendment (Child Homicide) Act 2008**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

**612 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation
Amendment (Sex Offences Procedure) Act 2008**

S. 612
inserted by
No. 18/2008
s. 4.

The amendments made to this Act by section 3 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Sex Offences Procedure) Act 2008**—

- (a) apply to any legal proceeding that commences before or after the commencement of section 3, irrespective of when the offence to which the proceeding relates is alleged to have been committed; but
- (b) do not apply to any legal proceeding that commenced before the commencement of section 3 if, before the commencement of section 3, the accused had been committed for trial or charged on indictment or presentment with the offence to which the proceeding relates.

S. 613
inserted by
No. 69/2009
s. 51.

**613 Transitional provision—Statute Law Amendment
(Evidence Consequential Provisions) Act 2009**

- (1) This Act, as amended by the **Statute Law Amendment (Evidence Consequential Provisions) Act 2009**, applies to any proceeding commenced on or after the day that Act commences.
- (2) In the case of any proceeding that commenced before the day the **Statute Law Amendment (Evidence Consequential Provisions) Act 2009** commenced, this Act, as amended by the **Statute Law Amendment (Evidence Consequential Provisions) Act 2009**, applies to that part of the proceeding that takes place on or after that day, other than a hearing in the proceeding to which subsection (3) applies.
- (3) This Act as in force immediately before the commencement of the **Statute Law Amendment (Evidence Consequential Provisions) Act 2009** continues to apply to any hearing in a proceeding that commenced before the day that Act commenced and that—
 - (a) continues on or after that day; or
 - (b) was adjourned until that day or a day after that day.

S. 614
inserted by
No. 87/2009
s. 5 (as
amended by
No. 30/2010
s. 84(1)).

**614 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation
Miscellaneous Amendments Act 2009**

Section 464H as amended by section 3 of the **Justice Legislation Miscellaneous Amendments Act 2009** applies to an audio recording or an audiovisual recording made on or after the commencement of section 3 of that Act.

615 Transitional provision—Transport Legislation Amendment (Hoon Boating and Other Amendments) Act 2009

S. 615
inserted by
No. 93/2009
s. 46.

- (1) Division 9 of Part I as amended by sections 44 and 45 of the **Transport Legislation Amendment (Hoon Boating and Other Amendments) Act 2009** applies only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of sections 44 and 45 of that Act.
- (2) For the purposes of this section, if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of sections 44 and 45 of the **Transport Legislation Amendment (Hoon Boating and Other Amendments) Act 2009**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

616 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation Further Amendment Act 2010

S. 616
inserted by
No. 64/2010
s. 6.

The amendments made to sections 464JA, 464JC and 464JD by Part 2 of the **Justice Legislation Further Amendment Act 2010** apply to an audio recording or an audiovisual recording made on or after the commencement of that Part.

617 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment (Bullying) Act 2011

S. 617
inserted by
No. 20/2011
s. 4.

- (1) Section 21A as amended by section 3 of the **Crimes Amendment (Bullying) Act 2011** applies only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of section 3 of that Act.

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of section 3 of the **Crimes Amendment (Bullying) Act 2011**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

S. 618
inserted by
No. 6/2013
s. 6.

618 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment (Gross Violence Offences) Act 2013

- (1) This Act as amended by Part 2 of the **Crimes Amendment (Gross Violence Offences) Act 2013** applies to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Act.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one after the commencement of the **Crimes Amendment (Gross Violence Offences) Act 2013**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

S. 619
inserted by
No. 20/2013
s. 4.

619 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment (Integrity in Sports) Act 2013

- (1) This Act as amended by the **Crimes Amendment (Integrity in Sports) Act 2013** applies to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Act.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one after the commencement of the **Crimes Amendment (Integrity in Sports) Act 2013**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

**620 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment
(Investigation Powers) Act 2013**

S. 620
inserted by
No. 72/2013
s. 17.

- (1) This Act as amended by sections 4, 5(2), 6, 7 and 8 of the **Crimes Amendment (Investigation Powers) Act 2013** applies to questioning for or investigation of any offence that occurs on or after the commencement of sections 4, 5(2), 6, 7 and 8 of that Act, irrespective of when the offence under investigation is alleged to have been committed.
- (2) This Act as amended by sections 11 and 12 of the **Crimes Amendment (Investigation Powers) Act 2013** applies to persons found guilty, or not guilty because of mental impairment, on or after the commencement of sections 11 and 12 of that Act, irrespective of when the offence is alleged to have been committed.

**621 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment
(Grooming) Act 2014**

S. 621
inserted by
No. 7/2014
s. 4.

Section 49B as inserted by the **Crimes Amendment (Grooming) Act 2014** applies to an offence alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Act.

**621A Transitional provision—Justice Legislation
Amendment (Confiscation and Other Matters)
Act 2014**

S. 621A
(Heading)
amended by
No. 38/2017
s. 81(2).

Section 465AA applies with respect to a warrant issued under section 465 irrespective of whether the warrant was issued before, on or after the commencement of section 69 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Confiscation and Other Matters) Act 2014**.

S. 621A
inserted by
No. 79/2014
s. 70.

S. 622
inserted by
No. 36/2014
s. 5.

**622 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment
(Protection of Children) Act 2014**

- (1) Section 49C as inserted by section 3 of the **Crimes Amendment (Protection of Children) Act 2014** applies to an offence alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of section 3 of that Act, irrespective of when the risk was created.
- (2) Section 327 as inserted by section 4 of the **Crimes Amendment (Protection of Children) Act 2014** applies to a person if the victim of the alleged sexual offence is still a child under the age of 16 years on the commencement of section 4 of that Act (irrespective of whether information is received or a reasonable belief is formed before or after the commencement of section 4 of that Act) unless the person has already disclosed the information referred to in section 327(2) to a police officer before the commencement of section 4 of that Act.

S. 622(2)
amended by
No. 36/2014
s. 7(3).

S. 623
inserted by
No. 63/2014
s. 8.

**623 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment
(Abolition of Defensive Homicide) Act 2014**

- (1) This Act as amended by sections 3 and 4 of the **Crimes Amendment (Abolition of Defensive Homicide) Act 2014** applies to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of sections 3 and 4 of that Act.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one after the commencement of sections 3 and 4 of the **Crimes Amendment (Abolition of Defensive Homicide) Act 2014**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

(3) This Act as amended by section 6 of the **Crimes Amendment (Abolition of Defensive Homicide) Act 2014** applies to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of section 6 of that Act.

(4) For the purposes of subsection (3), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one after the commencement of section 6 of the **Crimes Amendment (Abolition of Defensive Homicide) Act 2014**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

624 Transitional provisions—Sentencing Amendment (Coward's Punch Manslaughter and Other Matters) Act 2014

S. 624
inserted by
No. 72/2014
s. 5.

(1) Section 4A only applies to an offence alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of section 3 of the **Sentencing Amendment (Coward's Punch Manslaughter and Other Matters) Act 2014**.

(2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one after the commencement of section 3 of the **Sentencing Amendment (Coward's Punch Manslaughter and Other Matters) Act 2014**, it is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

625 Transitional provision—Sentencing Amendment (Emergency Workers) Act 2014

S. 625
inserted by
No. 69/2014
s. 12 (as
amended by
No. 72/2014
s. 13(3)(4)).

(1) The amendments made to this Act by section 11 of the **Sentencing Amendment (Emergency Workers) Act 2014** only apply to the sentencing of an offender on or after the commencement of that section for an offence alleged to have been committed on or after that commencement.

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one after the commencement of section 11 of the **Sentencing Amendment (Emergency Workers) Act 2014**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

S. 626
inserted by
No. 74/2014
s. 9.

**626 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment
(Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2014**

- (1) The amendments made to this Act by sections 3 and 7(2) and (3) of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2014** apply only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of those sections.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement of sections 3 and 7(2) and (3) of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2014**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.
- (3) The amendments made to this Act by section 6 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2014** apply only to an offence alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that section.
- (4) For the purposes of subsection (3), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between two dates, one before and one after the commencement of section 6 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2014**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

- (5) The amendments made to this Act by section 8 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2014** apply to a proceeding that commences before, on or after the commencement of that section, irrespective of when the offence to which the proceeding relates is alleged to have been committed.
- (6) Despite subsection (5), the amendments made to this Act by section 8 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2014** do not apply to a proceeding in which the hearing or trial (as the case requires) has commenced before the commencement of that section.

Note

See section 210 of the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009** regarding when a trial commences.

627 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation Amendment Act 2015

S. 627
inserted by
No. 20/2015
s. 24.

- (1) The amendments made to this Act by section 22 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment Act 2015** apply only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that section.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement of section 22 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment Act 2015**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

628 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment (Child Pornography and Other Matters) Act 2015

S. 628
inserted by
No. 42/2015
s. 11.

- (1) Section 70AAAE applies to the following proceedings or part proceedings, irrespective of when the offence to which the proceeding relates is alleged to have been committed—

- (a) a trial that commences on or after the day on which section 6 of the **Crimes Amendment (Child Pornography and Other Matters) Act 2015** comes into operation (*the commencement day*);

Note

See section 210 of the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009** for when a trial commences.

- (b) a summary proceeding that commences on or after the commencement day;
- (c) for a summary proceeding that commenced before the commencement day, that part of the proceeding that takes place on or after that day, other than any hearing in the proceeding that commenced before that day and continued on or after that day or was adjourned until that day or a day after that day.
- (2) Section 465AAA applies with respect to a warrant issued under section 465 irrespective of when the offence to which the warrant relates is suspected to have been committed.

S. 629
inserted by
No. 43/2017
s. 64(5),
re-numbered
as s. 628A by
No. 5/2018
s. 42.

**628A Transitional provision—Children and Justice
Legislation Amendment (Youth Justice Reform)
Act 2017**

- (1) The amendments made to this Act by Division 1 of Part 8 of the **Children and Justice Legislation Amendment (Youth Justice Reform) Act 2017** apply to the sentencing of an offender for an offence alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Part.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one after the commencement of Division 1 of Part 8 of the **Children and Justice Legislation Amendment (Youth Justice**

Reform) Act 2017, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

629 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016

S. 629
inserted by
No. 47/2016
s. 22.

The amendments made to this Act by section 21 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016** apply only to a trial that commences (within the meaning of section 210 of the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009**) on or after the day on which that section comes into operation.

630 Transitional provision—Police and Justice Legislation Amendment (Miscellaneous) Act 2016

S. 630
inserted by
No. 54/2016
s. 30.

- (1) An arrangement entered into by the Minister under section 464ZGN(2) with CrimTrac before 1 July 2016 that is in effect immediately before 1 July 2016 is taken, on and from 1 July 2016, to be an arrangement entered into by the Minister under that section with the Australian Crime Commission.
- (2) On and from 1 July 2016, information transmitted from the Victorian DNA database to the Australian Crime Commission is taken to have been lawfully transmitted in accordance with an arrangement entered into under section 464ZGN(2).
- (3) On and from 1 July 2016, information transmitted from the Australian Crime Commission to the Chief Commissioner of Police is taken to have been lawfully transmitted in accordance with an arrangement entered into under section 464ZGN(2).

(4) In this section—

CrimTrac means the CrimTrac Agency established as an Executive Agency by the Governor-General by order under section 65 of the Public Service Act 1999 of the Commonwealth.

S. 631
inserted by
No. 6/2017
s. 14.

631 Transitional provision—Crimes Legislation Further Amendment Act 2017

- (1) The amendments made to this Act by Part 4 of the **Crimes Legislation Further Amendment Act 2017** apply only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Part.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement of Part 4 of the **Crimes Legislation Further Amendment Act 2017**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

S. 632
inserted by
No. 19/2017
s. 55.

632 Transitional provision—Family Violence Protection Amendment Act 2017

Section 327 as amended by section 54 of the **Family Violence Protection Amendment Act 2017** applies to a prosecution for an offence under section 327(2) that is commenced on or after the day on which section 54 of that Act comes into operation irrespective of when that offence is alleged to have been committed.

S. 633
inserted by
No. 5/2018
s. 10.

633 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation Amendment (Victims) Act 2018

- (1) Despite the amendment made to section 464ZGA by section 9 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Victims) Act 2018**, section 464ZGA as in force immediately before the commencement day continues to apply to—

- (a) a sample that was taken in accordance with an order under section 464ZF(2) that was made before the commencement day; or
 - (b) a sample in respect of which an order under section 464ZFB(1) was made before the commencement day.
- (2) Section 464ZGA, as amended by section 9 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Victims) Act 2018**, applies in relation to a sample—
 - (a) taken in accordance with an order under section 464ZF(2) that was made on or after the commencement day; or
 - (b) that is the subject of an order under section 464ZFB(1) that was made on or after the commencement day.
- (3) In this section—

commencement day means the day on which section 9 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Victims) Act 2018** comes into operation.

634 Transitional provision—Crimes Legislation Amendment (Protection of Emergency Workers and Others) Act 2017

S. 634
inserted by
No. 65/2017
s. 24(1).

- (1) For the purposes of sections 317AD and 317AF as inserted by Division 1 of Part 2 of the **Crimes Legislation Amendment (Protection of Emergency Workers and Others) Act 2017**, a reference to an indictable offence committed in connection with an offence alleged to have been committed under section 317AC or 317AE, as the case requires, is a reference to an offence committed on or after the commencement of that Division.

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an indictable offence is committed between 2 dates, one before and one after the commencement of Division 1 of Part 2 of the **Crimes Legislation Amendment (Protection of Emergency Workers and Others) Act 2017**, the offence is taken to have been committed before that commencement.

S. 635
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 77.

635 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation Amendment (Police and Other Matters) Act 2019

- (1) The amendments made to this Act by sections 52, 53 and 55 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Police and Other Matters) Act 2019** apply—
- (a) to an offence alleged to have been committed before the day on which those sections come into operation if a criminal proceeding in respect of the alleged offence has not been commenced before that day; and
 - (b) to an offence alleged to have been committed on or after the day on which those sections come into operation.
- (2) The amendments made to this Act by section 62 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Police and Other Matters) Act 2019** apply to a person found guilty or found not guilty because of mental impairment on or after the day on which that section comes into operation.

S. 636
inserted by
No. 30/2019
s. 17.

636 Transitional provision—Children Legislation Amendment Act 2019

- (1) The amendment to section 327 of this Act made by section 16 of the **Children Legislation Amendment Act 2019** applies to an offence alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that section of that Act.

- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if any of the conduct constituting the offence set out in section 327(2) of this Act is alleged to have occurred between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement of section 16 of the **Children Legislation Amendment Act 2019**, all of the conduct constituting the offence is taken to have occurred before that commencement.

637 Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment (Manslaughter and Related Offences) Act 2020

S. 637
inserted by
No. 16/2020
s. 9.

- (1) In this section—
amending Act means the **Crimes Amendment (Manslaughter and Related Offences) Act 2020**.
- (2) Section 5 as amended by section 3 of the amending Act applies to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of section 3 of that Act.
- (3) For the purposes of subsection (2), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement of section 3 of the amending Act, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.
- (4) Section 5A as amended by section 4(2) of the amending Act applies to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of section 4(2) of that Act.
- (5) For the purposes of subsection (4), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement of section 4(2) of the amending Act, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

- (6) Section 5B as inserted by section 5 of the amending Act applies to an offence alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that section.
- (7) For the purposes of subsection (6), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement of section 5 of the amending Act, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

S. 637A
inserted by
No. 44/2022
s. 84.

637A Transitional provision—Major Crime and Community Safety Legislation Amendment Act 2022

- (1) In this section—
amending Act means the **Major Crime and Community Safety Legislation Amendment Act 2022**.
- (2) The amendments made to this Act by Division 1 of Part 3 of the amending Act only apply to warrants issued under section 465 on or after the commencement of Division 1 of Part 3 of the amending Act.
- (3) The amendments made to this Act by Division 2 of Part 3 of the amending Act only apply to fingerprints taken on or after the commencement of Division 2 of Part 3 of the amending Act.

S. 638
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 91(3).

638 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2022—jury directions

- (1) Despite section 626(1), the repeal of section 37AAA(e) by the 2014 provision has effect for the purposes of a proceeding that commences on or after the commencement of the 2022 provisions, irrespective of when the offence to which the proceeding relates is alleged to have been committed.

(2) In this section—

2014 provision means section 7(3) of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2014**;

2022 provisions means Division 1 of Part 4 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2022**.

638A Transitional provision—Justice Legislation Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2022—consent

S. 638A
inserted by
No. 38/2022
s. 91(3).

(1) An amendment made to this Act by a provision of Part 2 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2022** applies only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that provision.

(2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement of a provision of Part 2 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2022**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

639 Transitional provision—Sex Work Decriminalisation Act 2022

S. 639
inserted by
No. 7/2022
s. 43.

(1) The amendments made to this Act by the **Sex Work Decriminalisation Act 2022** apply to an offence alleged to have been committed on or after the repeal of the **Sex Work Act 1994**.

(2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the repeal of the **Sex Work Act 1994**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that repeal.

S. 640
inserted by
No. 20/2025
s. 4.

**640 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation
Amendment (Miscellaneous) Act 2025**

- (1) Section 180 as substituted by Part 2 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Miscellaneous) Act 2025** is taken to have been in force, instead of section 180 as in force before the commencement of that Part, during the period—
- (a) beginning on and including 1 April 1959;
and
 - (b) ending immediately before the
commencement of that Part.
- (2) Without limiting subsection (1), that subsection applies for the purposes of any offence relating to section 180 during the period specified in that subsection, including the following offences—
- (a) an offence against section 181 in respect of—
 - (i) the doing of an act or thing in
contravention of section 180; or
 - (ii) the doing of an act or thing outside
Victoria or partially outside Victoria
which, if done within Victoria, would
contravene section 180;
 - (b) an offence against section 182 in respect of
the doing or attempting of an act or thing
without authority which, if authorised, would
contravene section 180;
 - (c) an offence against section 321(1) in
circumstances where the offence that is the
subject of the agreement is an offence
against section 180;
 - (d) an offence against section 321M that is
constituted by an attempt to commit an
offence against section 180.

- (3) Despite subsection (1), conduct that was engaged in before the commencement of Part 2 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Miscellaneous) Act 2025** does not contravene section 180 as substituted by that Part if the conduct was given assent pursuant to section 180 as in force before the commencement of that Part.
- (4) Despite subsection (1), if a person was found guilty of an offence specified in subsection (5) before the commencement of Part 2 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Miscellaneous) Act 2025**, subsection (1) does not affect that finding of guilt or anything arising from that finding of guilt.
- (5) The offences specified for the purposes of subsection (4) are—
 - (a) an offence against section 180 as in force before the commencement of Part 2 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Miscellaneous) Act 2025**; and
 - (b) an offence that relates to an offence against section 180 as in force before the commencement of Part 2 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Miscellaneous) Act 2025**.

640A Crimes Amendment (Retail, Fast Food, Hospitality and Transport Worker Harm) Act 2025

S. 640A
inserted by
No. 52/2025
s. 5.

- (1) Section 77 as amended by Division 2 of Part 2 of the **Crimes Amendment (Retail, Fast Food, Hospitality and Transport Worker Harm) Act 2025** applies only to an offence alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Division.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement

of Division 2 of Part 2 of the **Crimes Amendment (Retail, Fast Food, Hospitality and Transport Worker Harm) Act 2025**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

S. 640B
inserted by
No. 54/2025
s. 27.

640B Transitional provision—Justice Legislation Amendment (Community Safety) Act 2025

- (1) Section 79 as amended by Division 3 of Part 2 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Community Safety) Act 2025** applies only to an offence alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement of that Division.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement of Division 3 of Part 2 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Community Safety) Act 2025**, the offence is alleged to have been committed before that commencement.

S. 640C
inserted by
No. 8/2026
s. 4.

640C Transitional provision—Crimes Amendment Act 2026

Section 195Q as substituted by section 3 of the **Crimes Amendment Act 2026** applies in relation to an offence against section 195N(1) or 195O(1) irrespective of when the offence is alleged to have been committed.

S. 644
inserted by
No. 55/2025
s. 18.

644 Justice Legislation Amendment (Police and Other Matters) Act 2025

On and after the commencement of Part 4 of the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Police and Other Matters) Act 2025**, sections 464T, 464U, 464V, 464W and 464X as in force immediately before that commencement continue to apply, despite the amendments made by that Part, in relation to an application under section 464T(1),

464U(3) or 464V(2) that was made but not determined before that commencement.

641 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation Amendment (Family Violence, Stalking and Other Matters) Act 2026—stalking

S. 641
inserted by
No. 1/2026
s. 69.

- (1) Section 21A as amended by Division 1 of Part 3 of the amending Act applies only to offences alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement day.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement day, the offence is alleged to have been committed before the commencement day.
- (3) In this section—

amending Act means the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Family Violence, Stalking and Other Matters) Act 2026**;

commencement day means the day on which Division 1 of Part 3 of the amending Act comes into operation.

642 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation Amendment (Family Violence, Stalking and Other Matters) Act 2026—alternative verdicts

S. 642
inserted by
No. 1/2026
s. 69.

- (1) Section 425 as inserted by Division 2 of Part 3 of the amending Act applies only to a proceeding for an offence alleged to have been committed on or after the commencement day.
- (2) For the purposes of subsection (1), if an offence is alleged to have been committed between 2 dates, one before and one on or after the commencement day, the offence is alleged to have been committed before the commencement day.

(3) In this section—

amending Act means the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Family Violence, Stalking and Other Matters) Act 2026**;

commencement day means the day on which Division 2 of Part 3 of the amending Act comes into operation.

S. 643
inserted by
No. 1/2026
s. 69.

643 Transitional provision—Justice Legislation Amendment (Family Violence, Stalking and Other Matters) Act 2026—jury directions

- (1) On and after the day on which Division 2 of Part 6 of the amending Act commences, section 626(1) and (2) no longer has the effect of preserving the operation of sections 37, 37AAA and 37AA (as in force before 1 July 2015) for offences alleged to have been committed before 1 July 2015.

Note

See Division 1AAB of Part 5 of the **Jury Directions Act 2015** for jury directions in relation to consent for sexual offences alleged to have been committed before 1 July 2015.

- (2) Subsection (1) does not apply to—
- (a) a trial that has commenced (within the meaning of the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009**) before the day on which Division 2 of Part 6 of the amending Act commences; or
 - (b) a summary hearing, committal proceeding, pre-trial hearing, appeal, case stated or special hearing referred to in section 4A(1) of the **Jury Directions Act 2015** for which the specified day is before the day on which Division 2 of Part 6 of the amending Act commences.

(3) In this section—

amending Act means the **Justice Legislation Amendment (Family Violence, Stalking and Other Matters) Act 2026**;

specified day means—

- (a) for a committal proceeding under the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009**, the day on which the committal hearing commences; and
 - (b) for a case stated under the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009** or Part 5.4 of the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005**, the day of the commencement of the hearing from which the question of law arises; and
 - (c) in any other case, the day of the commencement of the summary hearing, the pre-trial hearing, the hearing of the appeal, or the special hearing (as the case requires).
- (4) On and after the commencement of Chapter 8 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**, the reference in the definition of ***specified day*** to Part 5.4 of the **Children, Youth and Families Act 2005** is taken to include a reference to Chapter 8 of the **Youth Justice Act 2024**.

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Schedules

Schedules

First Schedule

<i>Number of Act</i>	<i>Title of Act</i>	<i>Extent of Repeal</i>
6103	Crimes Act 1957	The whole
6166	Crimes (Amendment) Act 1957	The whole
6167	Crimes (Parole Board) Act 1957	The whole

Sch. 2
repealed by
No. 6958
s. 8(4)(d).

* * * *

Sch. 3
substituted by
No. 9848
s. 18(1),
amended by
No. 43/1994
s. 56(Sch.
item 1.8),
repealed by
No. 7/2009
s. 422(5) (as
amended by
No. 68/2009
s. 54(h)).

* * * *

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958

*	*	*	*	*	Sch. 4 amended by Nos 8338 s. 7(m), 9576 s. 11(1), 9848 s. 18(1), 110/1986 s. 140(2), repealed by No. 25/1989 s. 18(1), new Sch. 4 inserted by No. 49/1991 s. 119(7) (Sch. 4 item 4.4), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(6) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).
*	*	*	*	*	Sch. 5 amended by Nos 8338 s. 7(n), 9576 s. 11(1), 9848 s. 18(1), 110/1986 s. 140(2), repealed by No. 25/1989 s. 18(1), new Sch. 5 inserted by No. 49/1991 s. 119(7) (Sch. 4 item 4.4), repealed by No. 68/2009 s. 97(Sch. item 40.42).
*	*	*	*	*	Sch. 6 repealed. ⁵²

Sch. 7
repealed by
No. 8143 s. 11,
new Sch. 7
inserted by
No. 129/1993
s. 8,
amended by
Nos 20/2011
s. 5(2),
37/2014
s. 10(Sch.
item 36.43).

Schedule 7—Summary offences for which a person may be fingerprinted

Sections 464K, 464L, 464M

- 1 A summary offence where the maximum penalty (whether for a first or subsequent offence) is or includes a period of imprisonment.
- 2 An offence under section 3(2) or 3(4) of the **Court Security Act 1980**.
- 3 An offence under section 6(2) of the **Control of Weapons Act 1990**.
- 4 An offence under section 36A of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981**.
- * * * *
- 6 An offence under section 20, 24ZQ(3), 24ZR(1), 24ZR(2), 24ZR(3), 24ZS(1), 24ZS(2) or 35(6) of the **Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act 1986**.

* * * *

Sch. 7A
inserted by
No. 7546 s. 13,
substituted by
No. 7782 s. 14,
repealed by
No. 8143 s. 11.

Schedule 8—Forensic sample offences

Sections 464ZF, 464ZFAAA

A forensic sample offence is:

Offences against the person—non-sexual offences

* * * * *

- 2 An offence against, or for which the penalty or the maximum or minimum penalty is fixed by, section 4 (conspiracy to murder) (as amended) of the **Crimes Act 1958** repealed on 1 June 1984 by section 8(b) of the **Crimes (Conspiracy and Incitement) Act 1984**.

* * * * *

- 5 An offence against, or for which the penalty or the maximum or minimum penalty is fixed by, any of the following provisions (as amended) of the **Crimes Act 1958** repealed on 24 March 1986 by section 8(2) of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 1985**:

- (a) section 17 (intentionally causing grievous bodily harm or shooting, etc. with intention to do grievous bodily harm or to resist or prevent arrest);
- (b) section 19 (inflicting bodily injury);
- (c) section 19A (inflicting grievous bodily harm);
- (d) section 20 (attempting to choke, etc. in order to commit an indictable offence).

* * * * *

Offences against the person—sexual offences

* * * * *

- 7A An offence against section 45(1) (sexual penetration of child under the age of 10) (as amended) of the **Crimes Act 1958** inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 5 August 1991 by section 3 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences)**

Sch. 8
repealed by
No. 8143 s. 11,
new Sch. 8
inserted by
No. 8870
s. 6(2),
amended by
Nos 9848
s. 18(1),
16/1986 s. 30,
repealed by
No. 25/1989
s. 18(1),
new Sch. 8
inserted by
No. 81/1997
s. 31,
amended by
Nos 67/2000
s. 7(7)–(9),
61/2001
s. 16(1)(c),
16/2002
s. 18(1)(2),
35/2002
s. 28(Sch.
item 3.4),
10/2003
s. 8(a)(b),
77/2005
s. 8(3)(e),
27/2006 s. 16,
2/2006 ss 19B
(as amended
by No.
76/2006 s. 10),
42(a)(b),
7/2008
s. 7(3)(g),
18/2008 s. 5,
6/2013 s. 7,
72/2013 s. 18,
74/2014
s. 7(9),
47/2016 s. 23.

Act 1991 and repealed by section 5 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2000**.

- 7B An offence against section 46(1) (sexual penetration of child aged between 10 and 16) (as amended) of the **Crimes Act 1958** inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 5 August 1991 by section 3 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1991** and repealed by section 5 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2000**.
- 8 An offence against, or for which the penalty or the maximum or minimum penalty is fixed by, any of the following provisions (as amended) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 5 August 1991 by section 3 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1991** and repealed on 1 January 1992 by section 3 of the **Crimes (Rape) Act 1991**:
- (a) section 40 (rape);
 - (b) section 41 (rape with aggravating circumstances);
 - (c) section 43 (indecent assault with aggravating circumstances).
- 9 An offence against, or for which the penalty or the maximum or minimum penalty is fixed by, any of the following provisions (as amended) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 1 March 1981 by section 5 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1980** and repealed on 5 August 1991 by section 3 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1991**:
- (a) section 44(1) (indecent assault);
 - (b) section 44(2) (indecent assault with aggravating circumstances);
 - (c) section 45(1) (rape);
 - (d) section 45(2) (attempted rape);
 - (e) section 45(2) (assault with intent to commit rape);
 - (f) section 45(3) (rape with aggravating circumstances);

- (g) section 45(4) (attempted rape with aggravating circumstances);
- (h) section 45(4) (assault with intent to commit rape with aggravating circumstances);
- (i) section 47(1) (sexual penetration of child under the age of 10);
- (j) section 47(2) (attempted sexual penetration of child under the age of 10);
- (k) section 47(2) (assault with intent to take part in act of sexual penetration with child under the age of 10);
- (l) section 48(1) (sexual penetration of child aged between 10 and 16);
- (m) section 48(2) (attempted sexual penetration of child aged between 10 and 16);
- (n) section 48(2) (assault with intent to take part in act of sexual penetration with child aged between 10 and 16);
- (o) section 50(1) (gross indecency with child under the age of 16);
- (p) section 51 (sexual penetration of mentally ill or intellectually defective person);
- (q) section 51 (attempted sexual penetration of mentally ill or intellectually defective person);
- (r) section 51 (assault with intent to take part in act of sexual penetration with mentally ill or intellectually defective person);
- (s) section 52 (incest) but not section 52(4) or (5) if both people are aged 18 or older and each consented to taking part in the act of sexual penetration;
- (t) section 54 (procuring persons by threats or fraud);
- (u) section 55 (administration of drugs, etc.);

- (v) section 56 (abduction and detention);
 - (w) section 61 (unlawful detention for purposes of sexual penetration).
- 10 An offence against, or for which the penalty or the maximum or minimum penalty is fixed by, any of the following provisions (as amended) of the **Crimes Act 1958** repealed on 1 March 1981 by section 5 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1980**:
- (a) section 44(1) (rape);
 - (b) section 44(2) (rape with mitigating circumstances);
 - (c) section 45 (attempted rape);
 - (d) section 45 (assault with intent to rape);
 - (e) section 46 (unlawfully and carnally knowing and abusing a girl under the age of 10);
 - (f) section 47 (attempting to unlawfully and carnally know and abuse girl under the age of 10);
 - (g) section 47 (assault with intent to unlawfully and carnally know and abuse girl under the age of 10);
 - (h) section 48(1) (unlawfully and carnally knowing and abusing girl aged between 10 and 16);
 - (i) section 48(2) (attempting to unlawfully and carnally know and abuse girl aged between 10 and 16);
 - (j) section 48(2) (assault with intent to unlawfully and carnally know and abuse girl aged between 10 and 16);
 - (k) section 52 (incest) but not section 52(3) or (4) if the woman or girl is the sister of the offender and both are aged 18 or older and the carnal knowledge or attempt or assault with intent to have unlawful carnal knowledge was or was made with the consent of the sister;

- (l) section 54 (carnal knowledge of female mentally ill or intellectually defective person);
 - (m) section 54 (attempted carnal knowledge of female mentally ill or intellectually defective person);
 - (n) section 54 (assault with intent to carnally know female mentally ill or intellectually defective person);
 - (o) section 55(1) (indecent assault);
 - (p) section 55(3) (felonious indecent assault);
 - (q) section 57(1) or (2) (procuring defilement of woman by threats or fraud or administering drugs);
 - (r) section 59 (abduction of girl under eighteen with intent to have carnal knowledge);
 - (s) section 60 (unlawful detention with intent to have carnal knowledge);
 - (t) section 62 (forcible abduction of woman);
 - (u) section 68(1) (buggery);
 - (v) section 68(3A) or (3B) (indecent assault on male person);
 - (w) section 69(1) (act of gross indecency with girl under the age of 16).
- 11 An offence against, or for which the penalty or the maximum or minimum penalty is fixed by, section 61 (abduction of woman from motives of lucre) of the **Crimes Act 1958** repealed on 1 March 1980 by section 5 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1980**.
- 11A An offence against section 38 or 39 of the **Crimes Act 1958** inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 1 January 1992 by section 3 of the **Crimes (Rape) Act 1991** and repealed by section 4 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2014**.

- 11B An offence against section 40 of the **Crimes Act 1958** inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 15 August 1993 by section 20 of the **Sentencing (Amendment) Act 1993** and repealed by section 4 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2014**.
- 11C An offence against section 34B(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (offence to interfere with corpse of a human being) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 1 July 2005 by section 185 of the **Cemeteries and Crematoria Act 2003** and repealed by section 3 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- 11D An offence against any of the following provisions of the **Crimes Act 1958** inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 5 August 1991 by section 3 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1991** and repealed by section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**:
- (a) section 44(1), (2), (3) or (4) (incest);
 - (b) section 47(1) (indecent act with child under the age of 16);
 - (c) section 47A(1) (persistent sexual abuse of child under the age of 16);
 - (d) section 48(1) (sexual penetration of 16 or 17 year old child);
 - (e) section 53(1) (administration of drugs etc.);
 - (f) section 54 (occupier etc. permitting unlawful sexual penetration);
 - (g) section 55 (abduction or detention);
 - (h) section 56(1) or (2) (abduction of child under the age of 16);
 - (i) section 57(1) or (2) (procuring sexual penetration by threats or fraud);
 - (j) section 59(1) (bestiality).

- 11E An offence against section 45(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (sexual penetration of child under the age of 16) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 22 November 2000 by section 5 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2000** and repealed by section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- 11F An offence against section 49(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (indecent act with 16 or 17 year old child) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 1 December 2006 by section 13 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 2006** and repealed by section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- 11G An offence against section 49A(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (facilitating sexual offences against children) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 13 June 1995 by section 93 of the **Sex Work Act 1994** and repealed by section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- 11H An offence against section 49B(2) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (grooming for sexual conduct with child under the age of 16 years) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 9 April 2014 by section 3 of the **Crimes Amendment (Grooming) Act 2014** and repealed by section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- 11I An offence against section 49C(2) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (failure by person in authority to protect child from sexual offence) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 1 July 2015 by section 3 of the **Crimes Amendment (Protection of Children) Act 2014** and repealed by section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- 11J An offence against section 51(1) or (2) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (sexual offences against persons with a cognitive impairment by providers of medical or therapeutic services) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 1 December 2006 by section 16 of the **Crimes (Sexual**

Offences) Act 2006 and repealed by section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.

- 11K An offence against section 52(1) or (2) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (sexual offences against persons with a cognitive impairment by workers) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 1 December 2006 by section 17 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 2006** and repealed by section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- 11L An offence against section 53(2) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (administration of drugs etc.) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 11 February 2009 by section 3 of the **Crimes Legislation Amendment (Food and Drink Spiking) Act 2009** and repealed by section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- 11M An offence against section 58(1), (2) or (3) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (procuring sexual penetration of a child) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 1 December 2006 by section 18 of the **Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 2006** and repealed by section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- 11N An offence against section 60AB(2), (3) or (4) (sexual servitude), 60AC(1) (aggravated sexual servitude), 60AD(1) (deceptive recruiting for commercial sexual services) or 60AE(1) (aggravated deceptive recruiting for commercial sexual services) of the **Crimes Act 1958** inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 19 May 2004 by section 3 of the **Justice Legislation (Sexual Offences and Bail) Act 2004** and repealed by section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- 11O An offence against section 68(1) (production of child pornography) or 69(1) (procurement etc. of minor for child pornography) of the **Crimes Act 1958** inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 1 January 1996 by section 88 of the **Classification (Publications, Films and Computer Games) (Enforcement) Act 1995** and repealed by

section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.

- 11P An offence against section 70(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (possession of child pornography) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 22 November 2000 by section 6 of the **Crimes (Amendment) Act 2000** and repealed by section 16 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- 11Q An offence against section 70AAAB(1) (administering a child pornography website), 70AAAC(1) (encouraging use of a website to deal with child pornography) or 70AAAD(1) (assisting a person to avoid apprehension) of the **Crimes Act 1958** inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 1 December 2015 by section 6 of the **Crimes Amendment (Child Pornography and Other Matters) Act 2015** and repealed by section 18 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- 11R An offence against section 70AC of the **Crimes Act 1958** (sexual performance involving a minor) inserted in the **Crimes Act 1958** on 19 May 2004 by section 7 of the **Justice Legislation (Sexual Offences and Bail) Act 2004** and repealed by section 18 of the **Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016**.
- * * * * *
- 12A An offence that, at the time it was committed, was a forensic sample offence.

Property offences

- * * * * *
- 14 An offence against, or for which the penalty or the maximum or minimum penalty is fixed by, any of the following provisions of the **Crimes Act 1958** repealed on 1 October 1974 by section 2(1)(b) of the **Crimes (Theft) Act 1973**:

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- (a) section 117 (robbery; larceny from the person);
 - (b) section 118 (assault with intent to rob);
 - (c) section 119 (robbery with wounding);
 - (d) section 120 (robbery under arms or company);
 - (e) section 128 (burglary by breaking out);
 - (f) section 130 (burglary with wounding);
 - (g) section 132 (entering house at night with intent to commit a felony);
 - (h) section 133 (breaking into etc., building within curtilage);
 - (i) section 134 (house-breaking);
 - (j) section 135 (house-breaking etc., with intent etc.);
 - (k) section 138 (larceny in the house);
 - (l) section 139 (larceny with menaces).
- 15 The common law offence of robbery abolished on 1 October 1974 by section 3(1) of the **Crimes (Theft) Act 1973**.
- 16 The common law offence of burglary abolished on 1 October 1974 by section 3(1) of the **Crimes (Theft) Act 1973**.
- * * * * *
- 18 An offence against, or for which the penalty or the maximum or minimum penalty is fixed by, any of the following provisions of the **Crimes Act 1958** repealed on 1 July 1979 by section 2(1)(c) of the **Crimes (Criminal Damage) Act 1978**:
- (a) section 196 (setting fire to church etc.);
 - (b) section 197 (setting fire to house anyone being in it);
 - (c) section 199 (setting fire to railway buildings etc.);

- (d) section 200 (setting fire to public buildings);
 - (e) section 201 (setting fire to other buildings);
 - (f) section 202 (setting fire to goods in buildings);
 - (g) section 203 (attempting to set fire to buildings).
- 19 An offence against section 203A (placing inflammable substance with intent to destroy, damage, etc.) (as amended) of the **Crimes Act 1958** repealed on 1 July 1979 by section 2(1)(c) of the **Crimes (Criminal Damage) Act 1978**.

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Explosive substances

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Parties to offence

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Drug offences

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- 29 An offence against section 71 of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981** as in force immediately before the commencement of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances (Amendment) Act 2001** (trafficking in a drug of dependence).
- 30 An offence against section 72(1)(ab) of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981** as in force immediately before the commencement of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances (Amendment) Act 2001** (cultivation of a narcotic plant in circumstances where the offence is committed in relation to a quantity of a drug of dependence, being a narcotic plant, that is not less than the commercial quantity applicable to that narcotic plant).

- 31 An offence against section 72(1)(b) of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981** as in force immediately before the commencement of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances (Amendment) Act 2001** (cultivation of a narcotic plant for a purpose related to trafficking in that narcotic plant).

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Section 464(2)

New Sch. 9
inserted by
No. 3/2019
s. 78,
amended by
Nos 50/2019
s. 9, 16/2020
s. 8.

- 1 Child homicide.
- 1A Homicide by firearm.
- 2 Murder.
- 3 Manslaughter.
- 4 Treason.
- 5 An offence against section 15A(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (causing serious injury intentionally in circumstances of gross violence).
- 6 An offence against section 15B(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (causing serious injury recklessly in circumstances of gross violence).
- 7 An offence against section 16 of the **Crimes Act 1958** (causing serious injury intentionally).
- 8 An offence against section 21A(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (stalking) and the accused has within the preceding 10 years been convicted or found guilty of an offence against that section in relation to any person or an offence in the course of committing which the accused used or threatened to use violence against any person.
- 9 An offence against section 38(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (rape).
- 10 An offence against section 39(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (rape by compelling sexual penetration).
- 11 An offence against section 42(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (assault with intent to commit a sexual offence).
- 12 An offence against section 47(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (abduction or detention for a sexual purpose).

- 13 An offence against section 49A(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (sexual penetration of a child under the age of 12).
- 14 An offence against section 49B(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (sexual penetration of a child under the age of 16) in circumstances other than where at the time of the alleged offence the child was 12 years of age or more and the accused was not more than 2 years older than the child.
- 15 An offence against section 49J(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (persistent sexual abuse of a child under the age of 16).
- 16 An offence against section 49P(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (abduction or detention of a child under the age of 16 for a sexual purpose).
- 17 An offence against any of the following provisions of Subdivision (8C) of Division 1 of Part I of the **Crimes Act 1958** (incest) in circumstances other than where both people are aged 18 or older—
 - (a) section 50C(1) (sexual penetration of a child or lineal descendant);
 - (b) section 50D(1) (sexual penetration of a step-child);
 - (c) section 50E(1) (sexual penetration of a parent, lineal ancestor or step-parent);
 - (d) section 50F(1) (sexual penetration of a sibling or half-sibling).
- 18 An offence against section 63A of the **Crimes Act 1958** (kidnapping).
- 19 An offence against section 75A(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (armed robbery).
- 20 An offence against section 77 of the **Crimes Act 1958** (aggravated burglary).

- 21 Any indictable offence in the course of committing which the accused, or any person involved in the commission of the offence, is alleged to have used or threatened to use a firearm, offensive weapon, or explosive as defined by section 77(1A) of the **Crimes Act 1958**.
- 22 An offence against section 77A of the **Crimes Act 1958** (home invasion).
- 23 An offence against section 77B of the **Crimes Act 1958** (aggravated home invasion).
- 24 An offence against section 79 of the **Crimes Act 1958** (carjacking).
- 25 An offence against section 79A of the **Crimes Act 1958** (aggravated carjacking).
- 26 An offence against section 197A of the **Crimes Act 1958** (arson causing death).
- 27 An offence against section 318(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (culpable driving causing death).
- 28 An offence against section 319(1) or (1A) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (dangerous driving causing death or serious injury).
- 29 An offence against section 319AA(1) of the **Crimes Act 1958** (dangerous or negligent driving while pursued by police).
- 30 An offence against any of the following provisions of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981** (as in force immediately before the commencement of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances (Amendment) Act 2001**)—
 - (a) section 71(1) (trafficking in a drug of dependence) in circumstances where the offence is committed in relation to a quantity of a drug of dependence that is not less than the commercial quantity applicable to that drug of dependence;

- (b) section 72(1) (cultivation of narcotic plants) in circumstances where the offence is committed in relation to a quantity of a drug of dependence, being a narcotic plant, that is not less than the commercial quantity applicable to that narcotic plant;
 - (c) section 79(1) (conspiracy) in circumstances where the conspiracy is to commit an offence referred to in paragraph (a) or (b).
- 31 An offence against any of the following provisions of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981** (as in force immediately before the commencement of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances (Amendment) Act 2001**)—
 - (a) section 71(1) (trafficking in a drug of dependence);
 - (b) section 72(1) (cultivation of narcotic plants);
 - (c) section 79(1) (conspiracy) in circumstances where the conspiracy is to commit an offence referred to in paragraph (a) or (b).
- 32 An offence against any of the following provisions of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981**—
 - (a) section 71 (trafficking in a quantity of a drug or drugs of dependence that is not less than the large commercial quantity applicable to that drug or those drugs);
 - (b) section 71AA (trafficking in a quantity of a drug or drugs of dependence that is not less than the commercial quantity applicable to that drug or those drugs);
 - (c) section 72 (cultivation of a narcotic plant in a quantity of a drug of dependence, being a narcotic plant, that is not less than the large commercial quantity applicable to that narcotic plant);

- (d) section 72A (cultivation of a narcotic plant in a quantity of a drug of dependence, being a narcotic plant, that is not less than the commercial quantity applicable to that narcotic plant);
 - (e) section 79(1) (conspiracy) in circumstances where the conspiracy is to commit an offence referred to in paragraph (a), (b), (c) or (d).
- 33 An offence against any of the following provisions of the **Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981**—
 - (a) section 71AB (trafficking in a drug of dependence to a child);
 - (b) section 71AC (trafficking in a drug of dependence);
 - (c) section 72B (cultivation of narcotic plants);
 - (d) section 79(1) (conspiracy) in circumstances where the conspiracy is to commit an offence referred to in paragraph (a), (b) or (c).
- 34 An offence against section 37A or 123A of the **Family Violence Protection Act 2008** of contravening a family violence intervention order or family violence safety notice (as the case requires) in the course of committing which the accused is alleged to have used or threatened to use violence and the accused has within the preceding 10 years been convicted or found guilty of an offence in the course of committing which the accused used or threatened to use violence against any person.
- 35 An offence against section 125A(1) of the **Family Violence Protection Act 2008** (persistent contravention of family violence safety notices and family violence intervention orders).
- 35A An offence against section 39G(1) or (2) of the **Occupational Health and Safety Act 2004** (workplace manslaughter).

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- 35B An offence against section 144(1) of the **Occupational Health and Safety Act 2004** arising in respect of a contravention of section 39G(1) of that Act (workplace manslaughter—liability of officers of bodies corporate).
- 36 An offence against section 4B(1) or 21W of the **Terrorism (Community Protection) Act 2003**.
- 37 An offence of conspiracy to commit, incitement to commit or attempting to commit an offence referred to in any other item of this Schedule.

Schs 8A–11
repealed.⁵³

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Endnotes

1 General information

See www.legislation.vic.gov.au for Victorian Bills, Acts and current authorised versions of legislation and up-to-date legislative information.

The **Crimes Act 1958** was assented to on 30 September 1958 and came into operation on 1 April 1959: Government Gazette 18 March 1959 page 892.

INTERPRETATION OF LEGISLATION ACT 1984 (ILA)

Style changes

Section 54A of the ILA authorises the making of the style changes set out in Schedule 1 to that Act.

References to ILA s. 39B

Sidenotes which cite ILA s. 39B refer to section 39B of the ILA which provides that where an undivided section or clause of a Schedule is amended by the insertion of one or more subsections or subclauses, the original section or clause becomes subsection or subclause (1) and is amended by the insertion of the expression "(1)" at the beginning of the original section or clause.

Interpretation

As from 1 January 2001, amendments to section 36 of the ILA have the following effects:

- **Headings**

All headings included in an Act which is passed on or after 1 January 2001 form part of that Act. Any heading inserted in an Act which was passed before 1 January 2001, by an Act passed on or after 1 January 2001, forms part of that Act. This includes headings to Parts, Divisions or Subdivisions in a Schedule; sections; clauses; items; tables; columns; examples; diagrams; notes or forms. See section 36(1A)(2A).

- **Examples, diagrams or notes**

All examples, diagrams or notes included in an Act which is passed on or after 1 January 2001 form part of that Act. Any examples, diagrams or notes inserted in an Act which was passed before 1 January 2001, by an Act passed on or after 1 January 2001, form part of that Act. See section 36(3A).

- **Punctuation**

All punctuation included in an Act which is passed on or after 1 January 2001 forms part of that Act. Any punctuation inserted in an Act which was passed before 1 January 2001, by an Act passed on or after 1 January 2001, forms part of that Act. See section 36(3B).

- **Provision numbers**

All provision numbers included in an Act form part of that Act, whether inserted in the Act before, on or after 1 January 2001. Provision numbers include section numbers, subsection numbers, paragraphs and subparagraphs. See section 36(3C).

- **Location of "legislative items"**

A "legislative item" is a penalty, an example or a note. As from 13 October 2004, a legislative item relating to a provision of an Act is taken to be at the foot of that provision even if it is preceded or followed by another legislative item that relates to that provision. For example, if a penalty at the foot of a provision is followed by a note, both of these legislative items will be regarded as being at the foot of that provision. See section 36B.

- **Other material**

Any explanatory memorandum, table of provisions, endnotes, index and other material printed after the Endnotes does not form part of an Act. See section 36(3)(3D)(3E).

2 Table of Amendments

This publication incorporates amendments made to the **Crimes Act 1958** by Acts and subordinate instruments.

Companies Act 1958, No. 6455/1958

Assent Date: 2.12.58
Commencement Date: 1.4.59: Government Gazette 4.3.59 p. 496
Current State: All of Act in operation

Statute Law Revision Act 1959, No. 6505/1959

Assent Date: 5.5.59
Commencement Date: 1.4.59: s. 1(2)
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Penalties) Act 1959, No. 6561/1959

Assent Date: 17.11.59
Commencement Date: 17.11.59
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Sentences and Parole) Act 1959, No. 6572/1959

Assent Date: 1.12.59
Commencement Date: 1.1.60: Government Gazette 16.12.59 p. 3638
Current State: All of Act in operation

Social Welfare Act 1960, No. 6651/1960

Assent Date: 15.6.60
Commencement Date: S. 57(b)–(e) on 11.7.60: Government Gazette 6.7.60 p. 2210; s. 57(a) on 1.7.65: Government Gazette 30.6.65 p. 2016
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Motor Car (Driving) Act 1960, No. 6658/1960

Assent Date: 15.6.60
Commencement Date: 15.8.60: Government Gazette 27.7.60 p. 2565
Current State: All of Act in operation

Statute Law Revision Act 1960, No. 6716/1960

Assent Date: 21.12.60
Commencement Date: Sch. 1 on 1.4.59: s. 3
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Kidnapping) Act 1960, No. 6731/1960

Assent Date: 21.12.60
Commencement Date: 21.12.60
Current State: All of Act in operation

Evidence (Children) Act 1961, No. 6758/1961

Assent Date: 26.4.61
Commencement Date: 26.4.61
Current State: All of Act in operation

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Prostitution Act 1961, No. 6761/1961

Assent Date: 26.4.61
Commencement Date: 26.4.61
Current State: All of Act in operation

Motor Car (Amendment) Act 1961, No. 6762/1961

Assent Date: 26.4.61
Commencement Date: S. 13 on 5.6.61: Government Gazette 31.5.61 p. 1850
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Breath Test Evidence) Act 1961, No. 6806/1961

Assent Date: 5.12.61
Commencement Date: 20.12.61: Government Gazette 20.12.61 p. 4335
Current State: All of Act in operation

Companies Act 1961, No. 6839/1961

Assent Date: 19.12.61
Commencement Date: 1.7.62: Government Gazette 21.2.62 p. 392
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Detention) Act 1962, No. 6884/1962

Assent Date: 2.5.62
Commencement Date: 17.9.62: Government Gazette 12.9.62 p. 3228
Current State: All of Act in operation

Subordinate Legislation Act 1962, No. 6886/1962

Assent Date: 8.5.62
Commencement Date: 1.8.62: Government Gazette 4.7.62 p. 2314
Current State: All of Act in operation

Justices (Amendment) Act 1962, No. 6958/1962

Assent Date: 18.12.62
Commencement Date: 18.12.62
Current State: All of Act in operation

Parole Board Membership Act 1963, No. 6994/1963

Assent Date: 7.5.63
Commencement Date: 7.5.63
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Aircraft) Act 1963, No. 7088/1963 (as amended by No. 7142/1964)

Assent Date: 10.12.63
Commencement Date: 10.12.63
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1964, No. 7184/1964

Assent Date: 2.12.64
Commencement Date: 15.2.65: Government Gazette 10.2.65 p. 279
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Illegal Use of Motor Cars) Act 1965, No. 7263/1965

Assent Date: 18.5.65
Commencement Date: 18.5.65
Current State: All of Act in operation

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Crimes (Parole) Act 1965, No. 7269/1965

Assent Date: 25.5.65
Commencement Date: 25.5.65
Current State: All of Act in operation

Motor Car (Driving Offences) Act 1965, No. 7327/1965

Assent Date: 7.12.65
Commencement Date: 1.2.66: Government Gazette 19.1.66 p. 209
Current State: All of Act in operation

Statute Law Revision Act 1965, No. 7332/1965

Assent Date: 14.12.65
Commencement Date: 14.12.65: subject to s. 3
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Dangerous Driving) Act 1966, No. 7407/1966

Assent Date: 17.5.66
Commencement Date: 1.7.66: Government Gazette 22.6.66 p. 2205
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes Act 1967, No. 7546/1967

Assent Date: 17.3.67
Commencement Date: 17.3.67
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1967, No. 7577/1967

Assent Date: 8.11.67
Commencement Date: 8.11.67
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Driving Offences) Act 1967, No. 7645/1967 (as amended by No. 7696/1968)

Assent Date: 19.12.67
Commencement Date: 1.3.68: Government Gazette 1.3.68 p. 577
Current State: All of Act in operation

Juries Act 1967, No. 7651/1967 (as amended by No. 7725/1968)

Assent Date: 19.12.67
Commencement Date: S. 2(1)(Sch. 1 Pt 2 item 3) on 1.1.69: Government Gazette 4.12.68 p. 3919
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1968, No. 7696/1968

Assent Date: 7.5.68
Commencement Date: 7.5.68
Current State: All of Act in operation

Abolition of Bailiwicks Act 1968, No. 7703/1968

Assent Date: 15.10.68
Commencement Date: 1.1.69: Government Gazette 4.12.68 p. 3930
Current State: All of Act in operation

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County Court (Jurisdiction) Act 1968, No. 7705/1968

Assent Date: 15.10.68
Commencement Date: 1.1.69: Government Gazette 4.12.68 p. 3919
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Evidence) Act 1968, No. 7782/1968

Assent Date: 18.12.68
Commencement Date: 18.12.68
Current State: All of Act in operation

Justices (Amendment) Act 1969, No. 7876/1969

Assent Date: 25.11.69
Commencement Date: All of Act (*except* ss 3, 5–7(k)(m)–(o)) on 1.4.70;
ss 3, 5–7(k)(m)–(o) on 1.7.70: Government Gazette
25.2.70 p. 463
Current State: All of Act in operation

Abolition of Obsolete Offences Act 1969, No. 7884/1969

Assent Date: 2.12.69
Commencement Date: 2.12.69
Current State: All of Act in operation

Legal Aid Act 1969, No. 7919/1969

Assent Date: 16.12.69
Commencement Date: All of Act (*except* Pt 1) on 1.6.70: Government
Gazette 6.5.70 p. 1210; Pt 1 on 1.10.70:
Government Gazette 16.9.70 p. 3073
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1970, No. 7994/1970

Assent Date: 4.11.70
Commencement Date: 4.11.70
Current State: All of Act in operation

Criminal Appeals Act 1970, No. 8063/1970

Assent Date: 22.12.70
Commencement Date: 15.4.71: Government Gazette 7.4.71 p. 830
Current State: All of Act in operation

Motor Car (Driving Offences) Act 1971, No. 8143/1971

Assent Date: 4.5.71
Commencement Date: 1.8.71: Government Gazette 28.7.71 p. 2502
Current State: All of Act in operation

Police Regulation (Amendment) (No. 2) Act 1971, No. 8179/1971

Assent Date: 23.11.71
Commencement Date: 15.12.71: Government Gazette 15.12.71 p. 3845
Current State: All of Act in operation

Statute Law Revision Act 1971, No. 8181/1971

Assent Date: 23.11.71
Commencement Date: 23.11.71: subject to s. 2(2)
Current State: All of Act in operation

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Crimes (Powers of Arrest) Act 1972, No. 8247/1972

Assent Date: 6.4.72
Commencement Date: 1.7.72: Government Gazette 28.6.72 p. 2360
Current State: All of Act in operation

Justices Act 1972, No. 8275/1972

Assent Date: 13.5.72
Commencement Date: 15.1.73: Government Gazette 10.1.73 p. 45
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1972, No. 8280/1972

Assent Date: 13.5.72
Commencement Date: 13.5.72
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes Act 1972, No. 8338/1972

Assent Date: 5.12.72
Commencement Date: 29.1.73: Government Gazette 24.1.73 p. 164
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1973, No. 8410/1973

Assent Date: 17.4.73
Commencement Date: Ss 1–4 on 9.5.73: Government Gazette 9.5.73 p. 1014; s. 5 on 1.7.73: Government Gazette 20.6.73 p. 2064
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Theft) Act 1973, No. 8425/1973 (as amended by No. 9019/1977)

Assent Date: 17.4.73
Commencement Date: 1.10.74: Government Gazette 3.4.74 p. 790
Current State: All of Act in operation

Social Welfare (Amendment) Act 1973, No. 8426/1973 (as amended by No. 8701/1975)

Assent Date: 17.4.73
Commencement Date: S. 9 on 7.6.76: Government Gazette 19.5.76 p. 1388
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Magistrates' Courts (Jurisdiction) Act 1973, No. 8427/1973

Assent Date: 17.4.73
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 6, 8(b), 10(1) (*except* (k)), 11 on 3.2.75: Government Gazette 22.1.75 p. 122; rest of Act on 1.9.75: Government Gazette 30.7.75 p. 2705
Current State: All of Act in operation

Social Welfare Act 1973, No. 8493/1973

Assent Date: 4.12.73
Commencement Date: S. 33 on 2.7.74: Government Gazette 22.5.74 p. 1712
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

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Crimes (Capital Offences) Act 1975, No. 8679/1975

Assent Date: 29.4.75
Commencement Date: 29.4.75
Current State: All of Act in operation

Magistrates (Summary Proceedings) Act 1975, No. 8731/1975

Assent Date: 16.5.75
Commencement Date: S. 173(Sch. 3) on 1.7.76: Government Gazette 24.3.76 p. 848
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Constitution Act 1975, No. 8750/1975

Assent Date: 19.11.75
Commencement Date: 1.12.75: Government Gazette 26.11.75 p. 3888
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes Act 1976, No. 8870/1976

Assent Date: 16.6.76
Commencement Date: Ss 1–3, 5, 7, 8 on 1.3.77: Government Gazette 26.1.77 p. 177; s. 4 on 1.7.76: s. 4(5); s. 6 on 1.7.77: Government Gazette 22.6.77 p. 1712
Current State: All of Act in operation

Rape Offences (Proceedings) Act 1976, No. 8950/1976

Assent Date: 14.12.76
Commencement Date: 1.7.77: Government Gazette 22.6.77 p. 1712
Current State: All of Act in operation

Magistrates' Courts (Commitment) Act 1977, No. 8998/1977

Assent Date: 10.5.77
Commencement Date: 10.5.77
Current State: All of Act in operation

Bail Act 1977, No. 9008/1977

Assent Date: 10.5.77
Commencement Date: 1.9.77: Government Gazette 17.8.77 p. 2654
Current State: All of Act in operation

Statute Law Revision Act 1977, No. 9019/1977

Assent Date: 17.5.77
Commencement Date: 17.5.77: subject to s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Armed Robbery) Act 1977, No. 9048/1977

Assent Date: 22.11.77
Commencement Date: 22.11.77
Current State: All of Act in operation

Statute Law Revision Act 1977, No. 9059/1977

Assent Date: 29.11.77
Commencement Date: 29.11.77: subject to s. 2(2)
Current State: All of Act in operation

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Crimes (Married Persons' Liability) Act 1977, No. 9073/1977

Assent Date: 6.12.77
Commencement Date: 1.2.78: Government Gazette 25.1.78 p. 201
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Hijackings and Other Offences) Act 1978, No. 9155/1978

Assent Date: 30.5.78
Commencement Date: 1.10.78: Government Gazette 6.9.78 p. 2869
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Criminal Damage) Act 1978, No. 9228/1978 (as amended by
No. 9427/1980)

Assent Date: 19.12.78
Commencement Date: 1.7.79: Government Gazette 4.4.79 p. 901
Current State: All of Act in operation

**Crimes (Competence and Compellability of Spouse Witnesses) Act 1978,
No. 9230/1978**

Assent Date: 19.12.78
Commencement Date: 1.7.79: Government Gazette 4.4.79 p. 901
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1978, No. 9242/1978

Assent Date: 19.12.78
Commencement Date: Ss 1, 3 on 19.12.78: s. 1(3); ss 2, 4 on 1.4.79:
Government Gazette 21.3.79 p. 729
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1979, No. 9323/1979

Assent Date: 18.12.79
Commencement Date: 1.7.80: Government Gazette 25.6.80 p. 2121
Current State: All of Act in operation

Imperial Law Re-enactment Act 1980, No. 9407/1980

Assent Date: 20.5.80
Commencement Date: 2.7.80: Government Gazette 2.7.80 p. 2257
Current State: All of Act in operation

Statute Law Revision Act 1980, No. 9427/1980

Assent Date: 27.5.80
Commencement Date: 27.5.80 (*except* as otherwise provided in s. 6(2)):
s. 1(2)
Current State: All of Act in operation

Community Welfare Services (Extradition) Act 1980, No. 9498/1980

Assent Date: 23.12.80
Commencement Date: 23.12.80
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1980, No. 9509/1980

Assent Date: 23.12.80
Commencement Date: 1.3.81: Government Gazette 4.2.81 p. 338
Current State: All of Act in operation

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Statute Law Revision Act 1981, No. 9549/1981

Assent Date: 19.5.81
Commencement Date: 19.5.81: subject to s. 2(2)
Current State: All of Act in operation

Penalties and Sentences Act 1981, No. 9554/1981

Assent Date: 19.5.81
Commencement Date: S. 44 on 26.9.80: s. 1(3); ss 36–46 on 3.6.81: Government Gazette 3.6.81 p. 1778; rest of Act on 1.9.81: Government Gazette 26.8.81 p. 2799
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Classification of Offences) Act 1981, No. 9576/1981 (as amended by No. 9902/1983)

Assent Date: 26.5.81
Commencement Date: 1.9.81: Government Gazette 26.8.81 p. 2799
Current State: All of Act in operation

Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances Act 1981, No. 9719/1981

Assent Date: 12.1.82
Commencement Date: 18.12.83: Government Gazette 14.12.83 p. 3955
Current State: All of Act in operation

Director of Public Prosecutions Act 1982, No. 9848/1982

Assent Date: 21.12.82
Commencement Date: Ss 1–8, 17 on 12.1.83: Government Gazette 12.1.83 p. 80; rest of Act on 1.6.83: Government Gazette 11.5.83 p. 1146
Current State: All of Act in operation

Statute Law Revision Act 1983, No. 9902/1983

Assent Date: 15.6.83
Commencement Date: 15.6.83: subject to s. 2(2)
Current State: All of Act in operation

Transport Act 1983, No. 9921/1983

Assent Date: 23.6.83
Commencement Date: S. 255(Sch. 12) on 1.7.83: s. 1(2)(c)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Penalties and Sentences (Amendment) Act 1983, No. 9945/1983

Assent Date: 20.9.83
Commencement Date: S. 3(3)(Sch. 2 items 9–15) on 20.12.83: Government Gazette 14.12.83 p. 4035
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Community Welfare Services (Director-General of Corrections) Act 1983, No. 9966/1983

Assent Date: 22.11.83
Commencement Date: S. 21 on 1.2.84: Government Gazette 25.1.84 p. 162
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Crimes (Procedure) Act 1983, No. 10026/1983

Assent Date: 20.12.83
Commencement Date: 7.2.84: Government Gazette 7.2.84 p. 381
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Criminal Investigations) Act 1984, No. 10076/1984

Assent Date: 15.5.84
Commencement Date: 5.6.84: Government Gazette 5.6.84 p. 1777
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Conspiracy and Incitement) Act 1984, No. 10079/1984

Assent Date: 15.5.84
Commencement Date: 1.7.84: Government Gazette 27.6.84 p. 2119
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (General Amendment) Act 1984, No. 10084/1984

Assent Date: 22.5.84
Commencement Date: 1.7.84: Government Gazette 27.6.84 p. 2119
Current State: All of Act in operation

Statute Law Revision Act 1984, No. 10087/1984

Assent Date: 22.5.84
Commencement Date: 22.5.84: subject to s. 3(2)
Current State: All of Act in operation

Planning (Brothels) Act 1984, No. 10094/1984 (as amended by No. 124/1986)

Assent Date: 22.5.84
Commencement Date: S. 14 on 2.7.84: Government Gazette 30.5.84 p. 1674
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Penalties and Sentences (Amendment) Act 1984, No. 10152/1984

Assent Date: 20.11.84
Commencement Date: S. 9 on 1.6.85: Government Gazette 22.5.85 p. 1667
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1985, No. 10233/1985

Assent Date: 10.12.85
Commencement Date: Ss 1–3, 10 on 22.1.86: Government Gazette 22.1.86 p. 144; rest of Act on 24.3.86: Government Gazette 12.2.86 p. 382
Current State: All of Act in operation

Registration of Births Deaths and Marriages (Amendment) Act 1985, No. 10244/1985

Assent Date: 10.12.85
Commencement Date: 31.10.86: Government Gazette 29.10.86 p. 4114
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Magistrates (Summary Proceedings) (Amendment) Act 1985, No. 10249/1985

Assent Date: 10.12.85
Commencement Date: S. 13 on 5.3.86: Government Gazette 5.3.86 p. 581
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Penalties and Sentences Act 1985, No. 10260/1985

Assent Date: 10.12.85
Commencement Date: S. 114(Sch. 4 items 4, 5) on 1.6.86: Government Gazette 30.4.86 p. 1116; Sch. 4 item 6 was never proclaimed, repealed by No. 49/1991 s. 118(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Courts Amendment Act 1986, No. 16/1986

Assent Date: 22.4.86
Commencement Date: S. 30 on 1.7.86: Government Gazette 25.6.86 p. 2180
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1986, No. 37/1986 (as amended by No. 35/1990)

Assent Date: 20.5.86
Commencement Date: 1.7.86: Government Gazette 25.6.86 p. 2239
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Confiscation of Profits) Act 1986, No. 101/1986

Assent Date: 16.12.86
Commencement Date: 1.8.87: Government Gazette 22.7.87 p. 1924
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Proceedings) Act 1986, No. 102/1986

Assent Date: 16.12.86
Commencement Date: 1.4.87: Government Gazette 11.3.87 p. 539
Current State: All of Act in operation

Supreme Court Act 1986, No. 110/1986

Assent Date: 16.12.86
Commencement Date: 1.1.87: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Transport Accident Act 1986, No. 111/1986

Assent Date: 16.12.86
Commencement Date: S. 180(2)(Sch. 2 item 5) on 1.2.87: Government Gazette 28.1.87 p. 180
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Corrections Act 1986, No. 117/1986

Assent Date: 23.12.86
Commencement Date: S. 6(Sch. 1 item 2(4)(5)) on 6.5.87: Government Gazette 6.5.87 p. 1004; Sch. 1 item 1(8) on 1.3.88: Government Gazette 24.2.88 p. 363
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Prostitution Regulation Act 1986, No. 124/1986

Assent Date: 23.12.86
Commencement Date: Ss 74(a)(b)(d)(e), 80 on 16.8.87: Government Gazette 12.8.87 p. 2175; s. 74(c) on 1.4.90: Government Gazette 28.3.90 p. 895
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Road Safety Act 1986, No. 127/1986

Assent Date: 23.12.86
Commencement Date: S. 102 on 1.3.87: Government Gazette 25.2.87 p. 445; Sch. 4 items 5.1–5.5 on 1.7.87: Special Gazette (No. 27) 25.6.87 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Community Services Act 1987, No. 16/1987

Assent Date: 12.5.87
Commencement Date: Ss 1–6, 9–13 on 22.2.89: Government Gazette 22.2.89 p. 386; Sch. 2 items 1–13 on 15.3.89: Government Gazette 15.3.89 p. 587; ss 7, 8 on 25.6.92: Government Gazette 24.6.92 p. 1532
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Family Violence) Act 1987, No. 19/1987

Assent Date: 12.5.87
Commencement Date: 1.12.87: Government Gazette 23.9.87 p. 2521
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1987, No. 70/1987

Assent Date: 24.11.87
Commencement Date: Ss 1–3, 5–7 on 6.12.87: Government Gazette 2.12.87 p. 3309; s. 8 on 1.9.88: Government Gazette 31.8.88 p. 2598; s. 4 on 27.6.89: Special Gazette (No. 35) 27.6.89 p. 1
Current State: All of Act in operation

Road Safety (Amendment) Act 1987, No. 78/1987

Assent Date: 24.11.87
Commencement Date: S. 10 on 1.3.87: s. 2(2); rest of Act on 9.12.87: Government Gazette 9.12.87 p. 3328
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Computers) Act 1988, No. 36/1988

Assent Date: 24.5.88
Commencement Date: 1.6.88: Government Gazette 1.6.88 p. 1487
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Custody and Investigation) Act 1988, No. 37/1988 (as amended by No. 38/1988)

Assent Date: 24.5.88
Commencement Date: 15.3.89: Government Gazette 15.3.89 p. 589
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Crimes (Fingerprinting) Act 1988, No. 38/1988 (as amended by No. 25/1989)

Assent Date: 24.5.88
Commencement Date: Ss 4, 5 on 1.1.90: Government Gazette 20.12.89 p. 3290
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Firearms (Amendment) Act 1988, No. 40/1988

Assent Date: 24.5.88
Commencement Date: S. 22 on 25.5.88: Government Gazette 25.5.88 p. 1458
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Local Government (Consequential Provisions) Act 1989, No. 12/1989 (as amended by No. 13/1990)

Assent Date: 9.5.89
Commencement Date: S. 4(1)(Sch. 2 item 20.1) on 1.11.89: Government Gazette 1.11.89 p. 2798
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

County Court (Amendment) Act 1989, No. 19/1989

Assent Date: 16.5.89
Commencement Date: 1.8.89: Government Gazette 26.7.89 p. 1858
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes Legislation (Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 1989, No. 25/1989

Assent Date: 6.6.89
Commencement Date: Ss 3–10, 15–20 on 25.6.89: Special Gazette (No. 34) 20.6.89 p. 1; ss 11–13 on 1.1.90: Government Gazette 20.12.89 p. 3290; s. 14 on 1.9.90: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Prescribed Weapons Act 1989, No. 39/1989

Assent Date: 6.6.89
Commencement Date: 1.9.89: Government Gazette 30.8.89 p. 2210
Current State: All of Act in operation

Transport (Amendment) Act 1989, No. 44/1989

Assent Date: 6.6.89
Commencement Date: S. 41(Sch. 2 item 7) on 1.7.89: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Magistrates' Court Act 1989, No. 51/1989

Assent Date: 14.6.89
Commencement Date: S. 143 on 1.9.90: Government Gazette 25.7.90 p. 2216
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Children and Young Persons Act 1989, No. 56/1989

Assent Date: 14.6.89
Commencement Date: S. 286(Sch. 2 items 7.1, 7.2, 7.5–7.9, 7.11, 7.12, 7.14, 7.15) on 31.1.91: Special Gazette (No. 9) 31.1.91 p. 2; Sch. 2 items 7.3, 7.4, 7.10, 7.13, 7.16 on 23.9.91: Government Gazette 28.8.91 p. 2368
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Magistrates' Court (Consequential Amendments) Act 1989, No. 57/1989
(as amended by No. 34/1990)

Assent Date: 14.6.89
Commencement Date: S. 4(1)(a)–(e)(2) on 1.9.89: Government Gazette 30.8.89 p. 2210; rest of Act on 1.9.90: Government Gazette 25.7.90 p. 2217
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Blood Samples) Act 1989, No. 84/1989

Assent Date: 5.12.89
Commencement Date: Ss 1–6, 9, 10 on 1.6.90: Government Gazette 30.5.90 p. 1662; s. 7 on 1.9.90: Government Gazette 25.7.90 p. 2217; s. 8 on 31.1.91: Special Gazette (No. 9) 31.1.91 p. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Control of Weapons Act 1990, No. 24/1990

Assent Date: 5.6.90
Commencement Date: 31.8.90: Government Gazette 29.8.90 p. 2616
Current State: All of Act in operation

Courts (Amendment) Act 1990, No. 64/1990

Assent Date: 20.11.90
Commencement Date: Ss 12, 20(Sch. item 3(a)(b)) on 1.1.91: Government Gazette 19.12.90 p. 3750
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Children and Young Persons (Amendment) Act 1990, No. 93/1990

Assent Date: 18.12.90
Commencement Date: All of Act (*except* s. 8(2)) on 31.1.91: Special Gazette (No. 9) 31.1.91 p. 2; s. 8(2) on 30.9.92: Government Gazette 26.8.92 p. 2470
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 1991, No. 8/1991

Assent Date: 16.4.91
Commencement Date: S. 22(1) on 16.4.91: s. 2(2); ss 3–6 on 5.8.91: Government Gazette 24.7.91 p. 2026
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Legislation (Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 1991, No. 23/1991

Assent Date: 31.5.91
Commencement Date: 31.5.91: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Sentencing Act 1991, No. 49/1991 (as amended by No. 81/1991)

Assent Date: 25.6.91
Commencement Date: 22.4.92: Government Gazette 15.4.92 p. 898
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Year and A Day Rule) Act 1991, No. 65/1991

Assent Date: 19.11.91
Commencement Date: 19.11.91: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Rape) Act 1991, No. 81/1991

Assent Date: 3.12.91
Commencement Date: Ss 7, 8 on 16.4.91: s. 2(2); ss 1–4, 6, 9, 10 on 1.1.92: Government Gazette 18.12.91 p. 3486; s. 5 on 1.2.92: Government Gazette 22.1.92 p. 114
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Culpable Driving) Act 1992, No. 13/1992

Assent Date: 2.6.92
Commencement Date: 13.6.92: Government Gazette 10.6.92 p. 1418
Current State: All of Act in operation

Evidence (Unsworn Evidence) Act 1993, No. 12/1993

Assent Date: 11.5.93
Commencement Date: 11.5.93: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (HIV) Act 1993, No. 19/1993

Assent Date: 25.5.93
Commencement Date: 25.5.93: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Sentencing (Amendment) Act 1993, No. 41/1993

Assent Date: 1.6.93
Commencement Date: Ss 1, 2 on 1.6.93: s. 2(1); rest of Act (*except* ss 13, 15) on 15.8.93; ss 13, 15 on 1.11.93: Government Gazette 12.8.93 p. 2244
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Criminal Trials) Act 1993, No. 60/1993

Assent Date: 8.6.93
Commencement Date: Ss 1–3 on 8.6.93: s. 2(1); s. 27 on 21.6.93: Special Gazette (No. 40) 17.6.93 p. 1; rest of Act (ss 4–26, 28) on 1.7.93: Government Gazette 1.7.93 p. 1735
Current State: All of Act in operation

Transport (Amendment) Act 1993, No. 120/1993

Assent Date: 7.12.93
Commencement Date: S. 79 on 7.12.93: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1993, No. 129/1993 (as amended by No. 33/1994)

Assent Date: 14.12.93
Commencement Date: Pt 1 (ss 1–3) on 14.12.93: s. 2(1); s. 10 on 21.12.93: Special Gazette (No. 95) 21.12.93 p. 1; ss 4–9, 11 on 1.6.94: s. 2(3)
Current State: All of Act in operation

Medical Practice Act 1994, No. 23/1994

Assent Date: 17.5.94
Commencement Date: Ss 1, 2 on 17.5.94: s. 2(1); rest of Act on 1.7.94: Government Gazette 23.6.94 p. 1672
Current State: All of Act in operation

Public Prosecutions Act 1994, No. 43/1994

Assent Date: 7.6.94
Commencement Date: S. 56(Sch. items 1.1–1.8) on 1.7.94: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1994, No. 95/1994

Assent Date: 13.12.94
Commencement Date: Pt 1 (ss 1, 2) on 13.12.94: s. 2(1); ss 3–10 on 23.1.95: Government Gazette 19.1.95 p. 121; rest of Act on 13.6.95: s. 2(3)
Current State: All of Act in operation

Prostitution Control Act 1994, No. 102/1994

Assent Date: 13.12.94
Commencement Date: Ss 1, 2 on 13.12.94: s. 2(1); rest of Act on 13.6.95: s. 2(3)
Current State: All of Act in operation

Constitution (Court of Appeal) Act 1994, No. 109/1994

Assent Date: 20.12.94
Commencement Date: Pt 1 (ss 1, 2) on 20.12.94: s. 2(1); rest of Act on 7.6.95: Special Gazette (No. 41) 23.5.95 p. 1
Current State: All of Act in operation

Legal Aid Commission (Amendment) Act 1995, No. 48/1995

Assent Date: 14.6.95
Commencement Date: Pt 1 (ss 1–3) on 14.6.95: s. 2(1); rest of Act on 14.12.95: s. 2(3)
Current State: All of Act in operation

Classification (Publications, Films and Computer Games) (Enforcement) Act 1995, No. 90/1995

Assent Date: 5.12.95
Commencement Date: Pt 1 (ss 1–5) on 5.12.95: s. 2(1); rest of Act on 1.1.96: Government Gazette 21.12.95 p. 3570
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Mental Health (Amendment) Act 1995, No. 98/1995

Assent Date: 5.12.95
Commencement Date: S. 65(Sch. 1 item 3) on 1.7.96: Government Gazette 27.6.96 p. 1593
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Miscellaneous Acts (Omnibus Amendments) Act 1996, No. 22/1996

Assent Date: 2.7.96
Commencement Date: Ss 5–8 on 2.7.96: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Legal Practice Act 1996, No. 35/1996

Assent Date: 6.11.96
Commencement Date: S. 453(Sch. 1 items 16.1–16.20) on 1.1.97: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Corrections (Amendment) Act 1996, No. 45/1996

Assent Date: 26.11.96
Commencement Date: S. 18(Sch. 2 items 6.1–6.6) on 6.2.97: Government Gazette 6.2.97 p. 257
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Female Genital Mutilation) Act 1996, No. 46/1996

Assent Date: 26.11.96
Commencement Date: 26.11.96: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Firearms Act 1996, No. 66/1996 (as amended by Nos 26/1997, 74/2000)

Assent Date: 17.12.96
Commencement Date: Ss 201(1)(2) on 29.4.97: Government Gazette 24.4.97 p. 921; s. 202 on 31.1.98: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Police and Corrections (Amendment) Act 1997, No. 26/1997

Assent Date: 20.5.97
Commencement Date: Ss 51–53 on 22.5.97: Government Gazette 22.5.97 p. 1131
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Road Safety (Disclosure of Information) Act 1997, No. 30/1997

Assent Date: 27.5.97
Commencement Date: S. 6 on 1.9.97: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Law and Justice Legislation Amendment Act 1997, No. 44/1997

Assent Date: 11.6.97
Commencement Date: S. 3 on 19.6.97: Government Gazette 19.6.97 p. 1384
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Sentencing and Other Acts (Amendment) Act 1997, No. 48/1997

Assent Date: 11.6.97
Commencement Date: Ss 54–58, 60–63, Sch. 1 on 1.9.97: s. 2(2), s. 59 on 20.11.97: Government Gazette 20.11.97 p. 3169
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Mental Impairment and Unfitness to be Tried) Act 1997, No. 65/1997

Assent Date: 18.11.97
Commencement Date: S. 82 on 18.4.98: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Sentencing (Amendment) Act 1997, No. 69/1997

Assent Date: 18.11.97
Commencement Date: Pt 3 (ss 22–25) on 18.11.97: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1997, No. 81/1997

Assent Date: 2.12.97
Commencement Date: Ss 4–8, 14, 15 on 1.1.98: s. 2(2); ss 16–31 on 1.7.98: s. 2(4)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Rail Corporations (Amendment) Act 1997, No. 104/1997

Assent Date: 16.12.97
Commencement Date: S. 42 on 31.3.98: Special Gazette (No. 23) 31.3.98 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Confiscation Act 1997, No. 108/1997

Assent Date: 23.12.97
Commencement Date: S. 151 on 1.7.98: Government Gazette 25.6.98 p. 1561
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Public Sector Reform (Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 1998, No. 46/1998
(as amended by No. 12/1999)

Assent Date: 26.5.98
Commencement Date: S. 7(Sch. 1) on 1.7.98: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Tribunals and Licensing Authorities (Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 1998, No. 52/1998

Assent Date: 2.6.98
Commencement Date: S. 311(Sch. 1 item 17) on 1.7.98: Government Gazette 18.6.98 p. 1512
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Crimes (Amendment) Act 1998, No. 65/1998

Assent Date: 4.11.98
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 4, 6 on 4.11.98: s. 2(1); s. 5 on 1.1.99: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes, Confiscation and Evidence Acts (Amendment) Act 1998, No. 80/1998

Assent Date: 13.11.98
Commencement Date: Pt 2 (ss 3, 4) on 13.11.98: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Magistrates' Court (Amendment) Act 1999, No. 10/1999

Assent Date: 11.5.99
Commencement Date: S. 31(5) on 11.5.99: s. 2(1); ss 8(5), 18(4), 20 on 1.7.99: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Dental Practice Act 1999, No. 26/1999

Assent Date: 1.6.99
Commencement Date: S. 107(Sch. item 1) on 1.7.00: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Criminal Trials) Act 1999, No. 35/1999

Assent Date: 8.6.99
Commencement Date: S. 34 on 1.9.99: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Juries Act 2000, No. 53/2000

Assent Date: 12.9.00
Commencement Date: S. 94 on 1.8.01: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Amendment) Act 2000, No. 67/2000

Assent Date: 21.11.00
Commencement Date: 22.11.00: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Statute Law Revision Act 2000, No. 74/2000

Assent Date: 21.11.00
Commencement Date: S. 3(Sch. 1 item 30) on 22.11.00: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Questioning of Suspects) Act 2000, No. 86/2000

Assent Date: 5.12.00
Commencement Date: 6.12.00: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Magistrates' Court (Committal Proceedings) Act 2000, No. 92/2000

Assent Date: 5.12.00
Commencement Date: Ss 11, 12 on 1.7.01: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Corrections (Custody) Act 2001, No. 45/2001

Assent Date: 27.6.01
Commencement Date: S. 40 on 1.3.02: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Validation of Orders) Act 2001, No. 58/2001

Assent Date: 16.10.01
Commencement Date: 17.10.01: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Drugs, Poisons and Controlled Substances (Amendment) Act 2001, No. 61/2001

Assent Date: 23.10.01
Commencement Date: S. 16(1) on 1.1.02: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Classification (Publications, Films and Computer Games) (Enforcement) (Amendment) Act 2001, No. 69/2001

Assent Date: 7.11.01
Commencement Date: S. 20 on 8.11.01: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Sentencing (Emergency Service Costs) Act 2001, No. 80/2001

Assent Date: 4.12.01
Commencement Date: S. 7 on 5.12.01: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Statute Law (Further Revision) Act 2002, No. 11/2002

Assent Date: 23.4.02
Commencement Date: S. 3(Sch. 1 item 13) on 24.4.02: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (DNA Database) Act 2002, No. 16/2002

Assent Date: 21.5.02
Commencement Date: S. 18(2) on 1.1.02: s. 2(2); ss 1–18(1), 19 on 22.5.02: s. 2(1)
Current State: All of Act in operation

Criminal Justice Legislation (Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 2002, No. 35/2002

Assent Date: 18.6.02
Commencement Date: Ss 3–5, 28(Sch. item 3) on 19.6.02: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
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Crimes (Property Damage and Computer Offences) Act 2003, No. 10/2003

Assent Date: 6.5.03
Commencement Date: Ss 4–9 on 7.5.03: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Australian Crime Commission (State Provisions) Act 2003, No. 52/2003

Assent Date: 16.6.03
Commencement Date: S. 52(Sch. 1 item 2) on 17.6.03: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Confiscation (Amendment) Act 2003, No. 63/2003

Assent Date: 30.9.03
Commencement Date: S. 43, 44 on 1.12.03: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Cemeteries and Crematoria Act 2003, No. 80/2003

Assent Date: 11.11.03
Commencement Date: S. 185 on 1.7.05: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Money Laundering) Act 2003, No. 104/2003

Assent Date: 9.12.03
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 4 on 1.1.04: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Stalking) Act 2003, No. 105/2003

Assent Date: 9.12.03
Commencement Date: 10.12.03: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Justice Legislation (Sexual Offences and Bail) Act 2004, No. 20/2004

Assent Date: 18.5.04
Commencement Date: Ss 3–7 on 19.5.04: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Amendment) Act 2004, No. 41/2004

Assent Date: 16.6.04
Commencement Date: 17.6.04: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Sex Offenders Registration Act 2004, No. 56/2004

Assent Date: 21.9.04
Commencement Date: S. 79 on 1.10.04: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Dangerous Driving) Act 2004, No. 59/2004

Assent Date: 12.10.04
Commencement Date: 13.10.04: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
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Sentencing (Superannuation Orders) Act 2004, No. 65/2004

Assent Date: 12.10.04
Commencement Date: S. 4(1) on 13.10.04: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Children and Young Persons (Age Jurisdiction) Act 2004, No. 72/2004

Assent Date: 9.11.04
Commencement Date: Ss 24–33 on 1.7.05: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Public Administration Act 2004, No. 108/2004

Assent Date: 21.12.04
Commencement Date: S. 117(1)(Sch. 3 item 48) on 5.4.05: Government Gazette 31.3.05 p. 602
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Classification (Publications, Films and Computer Games) (Enforcement) (Amendment) Act 2005, No. 6/2005

Assent Date: 27.4.05
Commencement Date: S. 12 on 28.4.05: s. 2; s. 13(1)–(3) on 26.5.05: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Statute Law Revision Act 2005, No. 10/2005

Assent Date: 27.4.05
Commencement Date: S. 4(Sch. 2 item 1) on 28.4.05: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Legal Profession (Consequential Amendments) Act 2005, No. 18/2005

Assent Date: 24.5.05
Commencement Date: S. 18(Sch. 1 item 27) on 12.12.05: Government Gazette 1.12.05 p. 2781
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Vagrancy (Repeal) and Summary Offences (Amendment) Act 2005, No. 56/2005

Assent Date: 13.9.05
Commencement Date: Ss 6, 7 on 14.9.05: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Contamination of Goods) Act 2005, No. 66/2005

Assent Date: 11.10.05
Commencement Date: 12.10.05: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Crimes (Homicide) Act 2005, No. 77/2005

Assent Date: 22.11.05
Commencement Date: Ss 3–7, 8(3), 9 on 23.11.05: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
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**Road Safety and Other Acts (Vehicle Impoundment and Other Amendments)
Act 2005, No. 93/2005**

Assent Date: 29.11.05
Commencement Date: S. 9 on 1.7.06: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Health Professions Registration Act 2005, No. 97/2005

Assent Date: 7.12.05
Commencement Date: S. 182(Sch. 4 item 14) on 1.7.07: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Sexual Offences) Act 2006, No. 2/2006 (as amended by No. 76/2006)

Assent Date: 7.3.06
Commencement Date: Ss 3–19B, 42 on 1.12.06: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Document Destruction) Act 2006, No. 6/2006

Assent Date: 4.4.06
Commencement Date: S. 3 on 1.9.06: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation (Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 2006, No. 14/2006

Assent Date: 11.4.06
Commencement Date: Ss 13–15 on 12.4.06: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Disability Act 2006, No. 23/2006

Assent Date: 16.5.06
Commencement Date: S. 236 on 1.7.07: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation (Further Miscellaneous Amendments) Act 2006, No. 27/2006

Assent Date: 6.6.06
Commencement Date: Ss 3–18 on 30.6.06: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

**Children, Youth and Families (Consequential and Other Amendments) Act 2006,
No. 48/2006**

Assent Date: 15.8.06
Commencement Date: S. 42(Sch. item 9) on 23.4.07: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
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Courts Legislation (Jurisdiction) Act 2006, No. 50/2006

Assent Date: 15.8.06
Commencement Date: Ss 7, 9, 11 on 16.8.06: s. 2(1); s. 10 on 1.11.06: Government Gazette 5.10.06 p. 2100; ss 6, 8, 12 on 1.7.07: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes (Sexual Offences) (Further Amendment) Act 2006, No. 76/2006

Assent Date: 10.10.06
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 4 on 1.12.06: s. 2(4)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (DNA Database) Act 2007, No. 32/2007

Assent Date: 24.7.07
Commencement Date: 25.7.07: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Firearms Amendment Act 2007, No. 50/2007

Assent Date: 17.10.07
Commencement Date: S. 57 on 30.6.08: Government Gazette 26.6.08 p. 1388
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Rape) Act 2007, No. 57/2007

Assent Date: 27.11.07
Commencement Date: Ss 8, 9 on 28.11.07: s. 2(2); ss 3–7 on 1.1.08: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Child Homicide) Act 2008, No. 7/2008

Assent Date: 18.3.08
Commencement Date: Ss 3–6, 7(3) on 19.3.08: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Criminal Procedure Legislation Amendment Act 2008, No. 8/2008

Assent Date: 18.3.08
Commencement Date: S. 22(1) on 23.4.07: s. 2(2); s. 13 on 1.7.08: s. 2(5)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Infringements and Other Acts Amendment Act 2008, No. 9/2008

Assent Date: 18.3.08
Commencement Date: S. 10 on 1.7.08: Special Gazette (No. 172) 27.6.08 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Relationships Act 2008, No. 12/2008

Assent Date: 15.4.08
Commencement Date: S. 73(1)(Sch. 1 item 16) on 1.12.08: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Justice Legislation Amendment (Sex Offences Procedure) Act 2008, No. 18/2008

Assent Date: 13.5.08
Commencement Date: Ss 3–5 on 1.7.08: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Courts Legislation Amendment (Associate Judges) Act 2008, No. 24/2008

Assent Date: 3.6.08
Commencement Date: S. 77 on 17.12.08: Special Gazette (No. 377) 16.12.08 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Police Integrity Act 2008, No. 34/2008

Assent Date: 1.7.08
Commencement Date: S. 143(Sch. 2 item 3) on 5.12.08: Special Gazette (No. 340) 4.12.08 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Public Health and Wellbeing Act 2008, No. 46/2008

Assent Date: 2.9.08
Commencement Date: S. 272 on 1.1.10: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Family Violence Protection Act 2008, No. 52/2008

Assent Date: 23.9.08
Commencement Date: S. 242 on 8.12.08: Special Gazette (No. 339) 4.12.08 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Abortion Law Reform Act 2008, No. 58/2008

Assent Date: 22.10.08
Commencement Date: Ss 9–11 on 23.10.08: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Stalking Intervention Orders Act 2008, No. 68/2008

Assent Date: 18.11.08
Commencement Date: S. 69 on 8.12.08: Special Gazette (No. 339) 4.12.08 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Courts Legislation Amendment (Costs Court and Other Matters) Act 2008, No. 78/2008

Assent Date: 11.12.08
Commencement Date: S. 25 on 31.12.09: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
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Crimes Legislation Amendment (Food and Drink Spiking) Act 2009, No. 1/2009

Assent Date: 10.2.09
Commencement Date: S. 3 on 11.2.09: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Relationships Amendment (Caring Relationships) Act 2009, No. 4/2009

Assent Date: 10.2.09
Commencement Date: S. 37(Sch. 1 item 9) on 1.12.09: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Criminal Procedure Act 2009, No. 7/2009 (as amended by No. 68/2009)

Assent Date: 10.3.09
Commencement Date: S. 422 on 1.1.10: Government Gazette 10.12.09 p. 3215
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Identity Crime) Act 2009, No. 22/2009

Assent Date: 17.6.09
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 4 on 16.7.09: Government Gazette 16.7.09 p. 1884
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment Act 2009, No. 25/2009

Assent Date: 17.6.09
Commencement Date: Ss 3–5 on 3.9.09: Government Gazette 3.9.09 p. 2331
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Criminal Procedure Amendment (Consequential and Transitional Provisions) Act 2009, No. 68/2009 (as amended by No. 29/2011)

Assent Date: 24.11.09
Commencement Date: S. 97(Sch. item 40) on 1.1.10: Government Gazette 10.12.09 p. 3215
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Statute Law Amendment (Evidence Consequential Provisions) Act 2009, No. 69/2009

Assent Date: 24.11.09
Commencement Date: Ss 37–51 on 1.1.10: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Miscellaneous Amendments Act 2009, No. 87/2009
(as amended by No. 30/2010)

Assent Date: 15.12.09
Commencement Date: Ss 3–5 on 1.11.10: s. 2(5)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
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Transport Legislation Amendment (Hoon Boating and Other Amendments) Act 2009, No. 93/2009

Assent Date: 15.12.09
Commencement Date: Ss 44–46 on 17.12.09: Government Gazette 17.12.09 p. 3339
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Legislation Amendment Act 2010, No. 7/2010

Assent Date: 16.3.10
Commencement Date: S. 3 on 17.3.10: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Statute Law Amendment (National Health Practitioner Regulation) Act 2010, No. 13/2010

Assent Date: 30.3.10
Commencement Date: S. 51(Sch. item 17) on 1.7.10: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Supported Residential Services (Private Proprietors) Act 2010, No. 49/2010

Assent Date: 24.8.10
Commencement Date: Ss 227, 228 on 1.7.12: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Personal Safety Intervention Orders Act 2010, No. 53/2010

Assent Date: 7.9.10
Commencement Date: S. 221(Sch. item 4) on 5.9.11: Special Gazette (No. 271) 23.8.11 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Consumer Affairs Legislation Amendment (Reform) Act 2010, No. 63/2010

Assent Date: 28.9.10
Commencement Date: S. 81(Sch. item 4) on 1.11.10: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Further Amendment Act 2010, No. 64/2010

Assent Date: 28.9.10
Commencement Date: Ss 3–6 on 1.11.10: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Marine Safety Act 2010, No. 65/2010

Assent Date: 28.9.10
Commencement Date: S. 420(Sch. 3 item 3) on 1.7.12: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
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Crimes Amendment (Bullying) Act 2011, No. 20/2011

Assent Date: 7.6.11
Commencement Date: S. 5(2) on 12.12.07: s. 2(2); ss 3–5(1) on 8.6.11: s. 2(4)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Infringement Offences) Act 2011, No. 27/2011
(as amended by No. 26/2012)

Assent Date: 21.6.11
Commencement Date: S. 5 on 1.7.14: s. 2(5)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Protective Services Officers) Act 2011, No. 43/2011

Assent Date: 6.9.11
Commencement Date: Ss 14–17 on 28.11.11: Special Gazette (No. 379) 22.11.11 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes and Domestic Animals Acts Amendment (Offences and Penalties) Act 2011, No. 55/2011

Assent Date: 2.11.11
Commencement Date: S. 3 on 3.11.11: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Children's Services Amendment Act 2011, No. 80/2011

Assent Date: 21.12.11
Commencement Date: S. 79(Sch. item 3) on 1.1.12: Special Gazette (No. 423) 21.12.11 p. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Statute Law Revision Act 2012, No. 43/2012

Assent Date: 27.6.12
Commencement Date: S. 3(Sch. item 11) on 28.6.12: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Criminal Procedure Amendment Act 2012, No. 48/2012

Assent Date: 4.9.12
Commencement Date: S. 47 on 5.9.12: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Integrity and Accountability Legislation Amendment Act 2012, No. 82/2012

Assent Date: 18.12.12
Commencement Date: S. 159 on 10.2.13: Special Gazette (No. 32) 6.2.13 p. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Justice Legislation Amendment (Family Violence and Other Matters) Act 2012, No. 83/2012

Assent Date: 18.12.12
Commencement Date: S. 32 on 20.12.12: Special Gazette (No. 444) 19.12.12 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Gross Violence Offences) Act 2013, No. 6/2013

Assent Date: 26.2.13
Commencement Date: Ss 3–7 on 1.7.13: Special Gazette (No. 180) 21.5.13 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Integrity in Sports) Act 2013, No. 20/2013

Assent Date: 23.4.13
Commencement Date: 24.4.13: s. 2
Current State: All of Act in operation

Succession to the Crown (Request) Act 2013, No. 60/2013

Assent Date: 22.10.13
Commencement Date: S. 6(Sch. 2 item 1) on 26.3.15: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Statute Law Revision Act 2013, No. 70/2013

Assent Date: 19.11.13
Commencement Date: S. 5(Sch. 3 item 1) on 1.12.13: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Investigation Powers) Act 2013, No. 72/2013

Assent Date: 3.12.13
Commencement Date: Ss 3–18 on 1.7.14: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Miscellaneous) Act 2013, No. 77/2013

Assent Date: 17.12.13
Commencement Date: Ss 15, 16 on 18.12.13: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Grooming) Act 2014, No. 7/2014

Assent Date: 25.2.14
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 4 on 9.4.14: Special Gazette (No. 112) 8.4.14 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
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Domestic Animals Amendment Act 2014, No. 8/2014

Assent Date: 25.2.14
Commencement Date: Ss 32–35 on 1.7.14: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Legal Profession Uniform Law Application Act 2014, No. 17/2014

Assent Date: 25.3.14
Commencement Date: S. 160(Sch. 2 item 28) on 1.7.15: Special Gazette (No. 151) 16.6.15 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Discovery, Disclosure and Other Matters) Act 2014, No. 25/2014

Assent Date: 8.4.14
Commencement Date: Ss 14, 15 on 9.4.14: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Mental Health Act 2014, No. 26/2014

Assent Date: 8.4.14
Commencement Date: S. 455(Sch. item 7) on 1.7.14: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Protection of Children) Act 2014, No. 36/2014

Assent Date: 3.6.14
Commencement Date: Ss 4, 5 on 27.10.14: Special Gazette (No. 350) 7.10.14 p. 1; s. 7(1)(2)(3) on 27.10.14: s. 2(2); s. 8 on 27.10.14: s. 2(3); s. 3 on 1.7.15: s. 2(5)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Victoria Police Amendment (Consequential and Other Matters) Act 2014, No. 37/2014

Assent Date: 3.6.14
Commencement Date: S. 10(Sch. item 36) on 1.7.14: Special Gazette (No. 200) 24.6.14 p. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Sentencing Amendment (Baseline Sentences) Act 2014, No. 52/2014

Assent Date: 12.8.14
Commencement Date: Ss 11–16 on 2.11.14: Special Gazette (No. 350) 7.10.14 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Powers of Attorney Act 2014, No. 57/2014

Assent Date: 26.8.14
Commencement Date: S. 149 on 1.9.15: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Privacy and Data Protection Act 2014, No. 60/2014

Assent Date: 2.9.14
Commencement Date: S. 140(Sch. 3 item 8) on 17.9.14: Special Gazette (No. 317) 16.9.14 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Abolition of Defensive Homicide) Act 2014, No. 63/2014

Assent Date: 9.9.14
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 4, 6, 7(3)–(7), 8 on 1.11.14: Special Gazette (No. 350) 7.10.14 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Sentencing Amendment (Emergency Workers) Act 2014, No. 69/2014 (as amended by No. 72/2014)

Assent Date: 23.9.14
Commencement Date: Ss 8, 11–13 on 2.11.14: Special Gazette (No. 330) 23.9.14 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Sentencing Amendment (Coward's Punch Manslaughter and Other Matters) Act 2014, No. 72/2014

Assent Date: 30.9.14
Commencement Date: Ss 3–5 on 1.11.14: s. 2(4)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2014, No. 74/2014 (as amended by No. 14/2015 s. 69(2))

Assent Date: 21.10.14
Commencement Date: Ss 5, 6 on 22.10.14: s. 2(1); ss 8, 9 on 3.11.14: Special Gazette (No. 400) 29.10.14 p. 1; ss 3, 4, 7 on 1.7.15: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Confiscation and Other Matters) Act 2014, No. 79/2014

Assent Date: 21.10.14
Commencement Date: Ss 69, 70 on 22.10.14: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Jury Directions Act 2015, No. 14/2015

Assent Date: 12.5.15
Commencement Date: Ss 69(7)(8), 79 on 29.6.15: s. 2(4)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Crimes Amendment (Repeal of Section 19A) Act 2015, No. 17/2015

Assent Date: 2.6.15
Commencement Date: S. 3 on 3.6.15: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment Act 2015, No. 20/2015

Assent Date: 16.6.15
Commencement Date: Ss 21–24, 49 on 17.6.15: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Child Pornography and Other Matters) Act 2015, No. 42/2015

Assent Date: 22.9.15
Commencement Date: Ss 3–11 on 1.12.15: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Firearms Amendment (Trafficking and Other Measures) Act 2015, No. 44/2015

Assent Date: 22.9.15
Commencement Date: S. 9 on 1.12.15: Special Gazette (No. 349) 18.11.15 p. 1.
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Police Custody Officers) Act 2015, No. 59/2015

Assent Date: 18.11.15
Commencement Date: Ss 25–27 on 19.11.15: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Bail Amendment Act 2016, No. 1/2016

Assent Date: 16.2.16
Commencement Date: S. 22(1) on 2.5.16: Special Gazette (No. 103) 19.4.16 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Access to Medicinal Cannabis Act 2016, No. 20/2016

Assent Date: 26.4.16
Commencement Date: Ss 143–145 on 14.9.16: Special Gazette (No. 284) 13.9.16 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Health Complaints Act 2016, No. 22/2016

Assent Date: 3.5.16
Commencement Date: Ss 167, 168 on 1.2.17: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Crimes Legislation Amendment Act 2016, No. 28/2016

Assent Date: 31.5.16
Commencement Date: S. 13 on 1.6.16: s. 2(1); ss 6, 7 on 3.10.16: Special Gazette (No. 296) 27.9.16 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Witness Protection Amendment Act 2016, No. 34/2016

Assent Date: 15.6.16
Commencement Date: S. 40 on 5.10.16: Special Gazette (No. 289) 20.9.16 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Sexual Offences) Act 2016, No. 47/2016

Assent Date: 6.9.16
Commencement Date: Ss 3–23 on 1.7.17: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Carjacking and Home Invasion) Act 2016, No. 50/2016

Assent Date: 18.10.16
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 4 on 7.12.16: Special Gazette (No. 375) 6.12.16 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Police and Justice Legislation Amendment (Miscellaneous) Act 2016, No. 54/2016

Assent Date: 18.10.16
Commencement Date: Ss 27–30 on 19.10.16: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Sentencing (Community Correction Order) and Other Acts Amendment Act 2016, No. 65/2016

Assent Date: 15.11.16
Commencement Date: Ss 20, 25 on 20.3.17: Special Gazette (No. 17) 31.1.17 p. 1; s. 24 on 1.7.17: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Legislation Further Amendment Act 2017, No. 6/2017

Assent Date: 15.3.17
Commencement Date: Ss 13, 14 on 1.4.17: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Family Violence Protection Amendment Act 2017, No. 19/2017

Assent Date: 16.5.17
Commencement Date: Ss 54, 55 on 16.11.17: Special Gazette (No. 388) 15.11.17 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Freedom of Information Amendment (Office of the Victorian Information Commissioner) Act 2017, No. 20/2017

Assent Date: 16.5.17
Commencement Date: S. 134(Sch. 1 item 5) on 1.9.17: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Sex Offenders Registration Amendment (Miscellaneous) Act 2017, No. 25/2017
(as amended by No. 3/2019)

Assent Date: 20.6.17
Commencement Date: Ss 50–52, 54, 55 on 1.3.18: s. 2(4); s. 53 on 1.3.21: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Bail Amendment (Stage One) Act 2017, No. 26/2017

Assent Date: 27.6.17
Commencement Date: S. 21 on 21.5.18: Special Gazette (No. 218) 15.5.18 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Legislation Amendment (Public Order) Act 2017, No. 32/2017

Assent Date: 15.8.17
Commencement Date: Ss 8, 10 on 13.9.17: Special Gazette (No. 303) 12.9.17 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Sentencing Amendment (Sentencing Standards) Act 2017, No. 34/2017

Assent Date: 15.8.17
Commencement Date: Ss 12–14 on 29.11.17: Special Gazette (No. 406) 28.11.17 p. 1; ss 24–35 on 1.2.18: Special Gazette (No. 28) 30.1.18 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Court Security, Juries and Other Matters) Act 2017, No. 38/2017

Assent Date: 29.8.17
Commencement Date: S. 81 on 30.8.17: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Children and Justice Legislation Amendment (Youth Justice Reform) Act 2017, No. 43/2017

Assent Date: 26.9.17
Commencement Date: S. 64(5) on 30.11.17: Special Gazette (No. 406) 28.11.17 p. 1; s. 4 on 26.2.18: Special Gazette (No. 406) 28.11.17 p. 1; s. 48 on 5.4.18: Special Gazette (No. 136) 27.3.18 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Justice Legislation Amendment (Protective Services Officers and Other Matters) Act 2017, No. 45/2017

Assent Date: 26.9.17
Commencement Date: Ss 15, 52 on 1.4.18: Special Gazette (No. 136) 27.3.18 p. 3
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Legislation Amendment (Protection of Emergency Workers and Others) Act 2017, No. 65/2017

Assent Date: 19.12.17
Commencement Date: Ss 3–14, 24(1) on 5.4.18: Special Gazette (No. 136) 27.3.18 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Victims) Act 2018, No. 5/2018

Assent Date: 27.2.18
Commencement Date: Ss 3–10, 42 on 28.2.18: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Oaths and Affirmations Act 2018, No. 6/2018

Assent Date: 27.2.18
Commencement Date: Ss 63, 68(Sch. 2 item 35) on 1.3.19: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Road Safety Amendment (Automated Vehicles) Act 2018, No. 8/2018

Assent Date: 27.2.18
Commencement Date: S. 14 on 28.2.18: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Terrorism) Act 2018, No. 32/2018

Assent Date: 7.8.18
Commencement Date: S. 131 on 8.8.18: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Family Violence Protection and Other Matters) Act 2018, No. 33/2018

Assent Date: 14.8.18
Commencement Date: Ss 86, 87 on 31.7.19: Special Gazette (No. 306) 30.7.19 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Justice Legislation Miscellaneous Amendment Act 2018, No. 48/2018

Assent Date: 25.9.18
Commencement Date: Ss 19, 19A, 85–96 on 28.10.18: Special Gazette (No. 480) 16.10.18 p. 1; ss 16–18 on 1.10.19: s. 2(5)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Police and Other Matters) Act 2019, No. 3/2019

Assent Date: 13.3.19
Commencement Date: Ss 3–5 on 5.6.19: Special Gazette (No. 215) 4.6.19 p. 1; ss 52–78 on 1.7.19: Special Gazette (No. 215) 4.6.19 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Guardianship and Administration Act 2019, No. 13/2019

Assent Date: 4.6.19
Commencement Date: S. 221(Sch. 1 item 11) on 1.3.20: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Disability (National Disability Insurance Scheme Transition) Amendment Act 2019, No. 19/2019

Assent Date: 25.6.19
Commencement Date: S. 257 on 1.7.19: Special Gazette (No. 254) 25.6.19 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Children Legislation Amendment Act 2019, No. 30/2019

Assent Date: 17.9.19
Commencement Date: Ss 16, 17 on 17.2.20: Special Gazette (No. 49) 4.2.20 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Health Legislation Amendment and Repeal Act 2019, No. 34/2019

Assent Date: 22.10.19
Commencement Date: Ss 45–47 on 23.10.19: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Workplace Safety Legislation Amendment (Workplace Manslaughter and Other Matters) Act 2019, No. 50/2019

Assent Date: 3.12.19
Commencement Date: S. 9 on 1.7.20: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Manslaughter and Related Offences) Act 2020, No. 16/2020

Assent Date: 10.6.20
Commencement Date: Ss 3–9 on 1.7.20: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Sentencing Amendment (Emergency Worker Harm) Act 2020, No. 23/2020

Assent Date: 30.6.20
Commencement Date: Ss 9–18 on 1.7.20: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Police and Emergency Legislation Amendment Act 2020, No. 29/2020

Assent Date: 27.10.20
Commencement Date: S. 9 on 2.12.20: Special Gazette (No. 624) 1.12.20 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Social Services Regulation Act 2021, No. 37/2021 (as amended by No. 40/2022)

Assent Date: 21.9.21
Commencement Date: S. 389 on 1.7.24: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Sex Work Decriminalisation Act 2022, No. 7/2022 (as amended by No. 38/2022)

Assent Date: 1.3.22
Commencement Date: Ss 39–43 on 1.12.23: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Legislation Amendment Act 2022, No. 35/2022

Assent Date: 30.8.22
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 4 on 3.7.23: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

**Justice Legislation Amendment (Sexual Offences and Other Matters) Act 2022,
No. 38/2022**

Assent Date: 6.9.22
Commencement Date: S. 91 on 1.1.23: s. 2(6); ss 3(1), 4–14, 20–22 on
30.7.23: s. 2(5)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Mental Health and Wellbeing Act 2022, No. 39/2022

Assent Date: 6.9.22
Commencement Date: Ss 811–814 on 1.9.23: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

**Major Crime and Community Safety Legislation Amendment Act 2022,
No. 44/2022**

Assent Date: 27.9.22
Commencement Date: Ss 72–84 on 1.8.23: s. 2(4)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Disability and Social Services Regulation Amendment Act 2023, No. 9/2023

Assent Date: 23.5.23
Commencement Date: S. 233 on 24.5.23: s. 2(1); s. 254 on 1.7.24: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Children and Health Legislation Amendment (Statement of Recognition, Aboriginal Self-determination and Other Matters) Act 2023, No. 17/2023

Assent Date: 27.6.23
Commencement Date: S. 59 on 1.7.24: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Statute Law Amendment (References to the Sovereign) Act 2023, No. 25/2023

Assent Date: 5.9.23
Commencement Date: S. 7(Sch. 1 item 6) on 6.9.23: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment Act 2023, No. 26/2023

Assent Date: 10.10.23
Commencement Date: Ss 76–78 on 1.1.24: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Non-fatal Strangulation) Act 2023, No. 37/2023

Assent Date: 5.12.23
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 4 on 13.10.24: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Integrity, Defamation and Other Matters) Act 2024, No. 31/2024

Assent Date: 10.9.24
Commencement Date: S. 113(Sch. 1 item 7) on 10.2.25: Special Gazette (No. 648) 26.11.24 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Youth Justice Act 2024, No. 32/2024

Assent Date: 10.9.24
Commencement Date: Ss 796–810 on 30.9.25: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Victorian Institute of Forensic Medicine Act 2024, No. 34/2024

Assent Date: 17.9.24
Commencement Date: Ss 50, 51 on 1.7.25: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

Justice Legislation Amendment (Anti-vilification and Social Cohesion) Act 2025, No. 11/2025

Assent Date: 8.4.25
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 4 on 20.9.25: s. 2(3)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Miscellaneous) Act 2025, No. 20/2025

Assent Date: 18.6.25
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 4 on 19.6.25: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Roads and Ports Legislation Amendment (Road Safety and Other Matters) Act 2025, No. 25/2025

Assent Date: 5.8.25
Commencement Date: S. 99 on 6.8.25: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Performance Crime) Act 2025, No. 29/2025

Assent Date: 19.8.25
Commencement Date: S. 3 on 20.8.25: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Statute Law Revision Act 2025, No. 41/2025

Assent Date: 21.10.25
Commencement Date: S. 4(Sch. 2 item 8) on 22.10.25: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment (Retail, Fast Food, Hospitality and Transport Worker Harm) Act 2025, No. 52/2025

Assent Date: 9.12.25
Commencement Date: S. 3 on 10.12.25: s. 2(1); ss 4–6 on 16.3.26: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Community Safety) Act 2025, No. 54/2025

Assent Date: 9.12.25
Commencement Date: Ss 3–7, 9, 10, 27 on 10.12.25: s. 2(1)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Justice Legislation Amendment (Police and Other Matters) Act 2025, No. 55/2025

Assent Date: 9.12.25
Commencement Date: Ss 12–18 on 30.1.26: Special Gazette (No. 42) 28.1.26 p. 1
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Act 1958
No. 6231 of 1958
Endnotes

**Justice Legislation Amendment (Family Violence, Stalking and Other Matters)
Act 2026, No. 1/2026**

Assent Date: 10.2.26
Commencement Date: Ss 68–70 on 11.2.26: s. 2(1); s. 67 on 26.4.26: s. 2(2)
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Crimes Amendment Act 2026, No. 8/2026

Assent Date: 11.3.26
Commencement Date: Ss 3, 4 on 12.3.26: s. 2
Current State: This information relates only to the provision/s
amending the **Crimes Act 1958**

Criminal Appeal Rules 1965, S.R. No. 144/1965 (as amended by S.R. No. 75/1987)

Date of Making: 6.7.65
Date of Commencement: 1.2.66: reg. 1(1)

3 Explanatory details

¹ Pt 1 Div. 1 Subdiv. (3):

Pt 1 Div. 1 Subdiv. (3) (Heading) repealed by No. 25/1989 s. 20(b).

Ss 11–13 amended by No. 9576 s. 11(1), repealed by No. 10233 s. 8(1).

S. 14 amended by No. 9576 s. 11(1), repealed by No. 10233 s. 5.

² Pt 1 Div. 1 Subdiv. (8C) (Heading and ss 52, 53) inserted by No. 9509 s. 5, amended by No. 9848 s. 18(1), substituted as Pt 1 Div. 1 Subdiv. (8C) (Heading and ss 45–49) by No. 8/1991 s. 3, amended by Nos 49/1991 s. 119(3)(Sch. 3 items 4A, 5–8), 102/1994 s. 93, 48/1997 s. 60(1)(Sch. 1 items 22–27), 81/1997 s. 5, 67/2000 s. 5, 2/2006 ss 9–13, 8/2008 s. 22(1), 68/2009 s. 97(Sch. items 40.3, 40.4), 7/2010 s. 3, 7/2014 s. 3, 36/2014 s. 3, 37/2014 s. 10(Sch. item 36.4), 52/2014 ss 14, 15, 74/2014 ss 5, 6, 65/2016 s. 20(16)(17), substituted as Pt 1 Div. 1 Subdiv. (8C) (Heading and ss 50A–50K) by No. 47/2016 s. 16.

³ Pt 1 Div. 1 Subdiv. (12): See section 6 as to the offence of infanticide.

⁴ Ss 96–174:

S. 96 amended by No. 7876 s. 2(3), substituted by No. 8425 s. 2(1)(b), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

Ss 97–173 repealed by No. 8425 s. 2(1)(b).

S. 174 repealed by No. 7705 s. 10.

⁵ S. 175: As to trade and commerce with other countries and among the States and to dealings with the Commonwealth, see Parts 7.6 and 7.7 of Chapter 7 of the Criminal Code contained in the Schedule to the Criminal Code Act 1995 of the Commonwealth.

⁶ S. 176: See note 5.

⁷ S. 177: See note 5.

⁸ S. 178: See note 5.

⁹ S. 179: See note 5.

¹⁰ S. 181: See note 5.

¹¹ S. 182: See note 5.

¹² S. 184: See note 5.

¹³ S. 185: See note 5.

¹⁴ S. 186: See note 5.

¹⁵ S. 206: See section 435.

¹⁶ S. 232: Compare sections 25–28.

¹⁷ S. 233: See note 17.

¹⁸ Pt 1 Div. 8: See also sections 15–31, Pt 1 Div. 3, section 466 of this Act and the **Dangerous Goods Act 1985**, No. 10189/1985.

¹⁹ S. 317(9)(d): See section 466 of this Act and the **Dangerous Goods Act 1985**, No. 10189/1985.

²⁰ S. 317AC(3): The amendment proposed by section 7(2) of the **Crimes Legislation Amendment (Protection of Emergency Workers and Others) Act 2017**, No. 65/2017 (*repealed*) is not included in this publication because the words "or a custodial officer" do not appear in section 317AC(3) (excluding the Notes).

Section 7(2) read as follows:

7 Intentionally exposing an emergency worker or a custodial officer to risk by driving

- (2) In section 317AC(1)(b), (2) and (3) (excluding the Notes) of the **Crimes Act 1958**, for "or a custodial officer" (wherever occurring) **substitute** ", a custodial officer or a youth justice custodial worker."

²¹ Ss 327–332:

S. 327 amended by No. 6731 s. 4, repealed by No. 9576 s. 4(1).

S. 328 repealed by No. 9576 s. 4(1).

Ss 329–332 repealed by No. 8425 s. 2(1)(h).

²² Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (1) (Heading and ss 351–356) amended by Nos 7546 s. 7, 7703 s. 5, 7705 s. 10, 9407 s. 2(d), 9576 s. 11(1), 9848 s. 18(1), 10026 s. 3(1)(2), 10233 s. 9(c), 110/1986 s. 140(2), 19/1989 s. 16(Sch. item 16.2), 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. items 42.20, 42.21), 64/1990 s. 12(1), 43/1994 s. 56(Sch. items 1.1–1.5), 10/1999 s. 31(5)(b), 35/1999 s. 34(1), 53/2000 s. 94(2), 50/2006 ss 6, 7(1)(2), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

²³ Section 359 amended by Nos 7703 s. 5, 7705 s. 10, 8338 s. 7(a)(d)–(f)(q), 9008 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 2(c)), 9848 s. 18(1), 10087 s. 3(1)(Sch. 1 item 26), 110/1986 s. 140(2), 16/1987 s. 4(3)(Sch. 1 item 8(a)), 19/1989 s. 16(Sch. item 16.3), 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. item 42.23), 64/1990 s. 12(2)–(4), 43/1994 s. 56(Sch. item 1.6), 35/1996 s. 453(Sch. 1 item 16.2), 46/1998 s. 7(Sch. 1), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

²⁴ Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (5) (Heading and s. 360) amended by Nos 7703 s. 5, 7705 s. 10, 8338 s. 7(a), 9008 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 2(d)), 9427 s. 6(1)(Sch. 5 item 37), 9576 s. 11(1), 9848 s. 18(1), 60/1993 s. 27, 43/1994 s. 56(Sch. item 1.7), 48/1995 s. 11(3)(a), 65/1998 s. 6, 18/2005 s. 18(Sch. 1 items 27.4, 27.5), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

²⁵ Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (6) (Heading and s. 361) amended by Nos 7703 s. 5, 8280 s. 14, 8338 s. 7(a)(d)(g), 9019 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 41), 110/1986 s. 140(2), 19/1989 s. 16(Sch. item 16.4), 26/1997 s. 51, 65/1997 s. 82(1), 45/2001 s. 40(1), 11/2002 s. 3(Sch. 1 item 13), 23/2006 s. 236(3), 48/2006 s. 42(Sch. item 9.1), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

²⁶ Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (9) (Heading and ss 364–387) amended by Nos 8425 s. 2(1)(h)(j)(k), 9019 s. 2(1)(Sch. items 42, 43), 9427 s. 6(1)(Sch. 5 item 38), 9576 s. 11(1), 10079 s. 8(e), 10084 s. 6(1)(2), 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5), 25/1989 ss 9, 20(i), 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. item 42.27), 49/1991 s. 119(7)(Sch. 4 item 4.2), 81/1997 s. 7(1), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

²⁷ S. 393 (*repealed*): Schedule 3 to the **Crimes (Mental Impairment and Unfitness to be Tried) Act 1997**, No. 65/1997 reads as follows:

Schedule 3—Savings and transitional provisions

Section 89

1 Definitions

In this Schedule—

commencement day means the day on which this Schedule comes into operation;

existing detainee means a person who, immediately before the commencement day, was subject to an order under section 393 or 420 of the **Crimes Act 1958** (whether by the court or by the Governor).

2 Existing detainees

- (1) Each existing detainee is, on and after the commencement day, deemed to be subject to a custodial supervision order under this Act.

- (2) The nominal term of the custodial supervision order is to be determined in accordance with section 28 as if the maximum penalty for the offence which led to the person becoming an existing detainee were the maximum penalty attaching to that offence on the commencement day.
- (3) If the offence referred to in subsection (2) no longer exists—
 - (a) the Supreme Court, on application by the existing detainee or the Director of Public Prosecutions, must determine whether there is an existing offence, as at the commencement day, with which the existing detainee could have been charged had it existed at the time of the original charge; and
 - (b) if there is such an offence, the nominal term is to be determined by reference to the maximum penalty for that offence as at the commencement day.
- (4) The nominal term runs from the day on which the existing detainee was made subject to the order under section 393 or 420 of the **Crimes Act 1958**.

Sch. 3 cl. 2(5) amended by No. 43/1998 s. 40(b)(i).

- (5) If the nominal term has expired, a major review must be held within 6 months after the commencement day.

3 Leave

- (1) Subject to this clause, an existing detainee who, immediately before the commencement day, was on leave from the place of detention that corresponds to leave that may be granted under Part 7 is deemed to be on the corresponding leave as if granted under that Part, and any conditions to which the leave was subject immediately before the commencement day continue to apply.

Sch. 3 cl. 3(2) amended by No. 43/1998 s. 40(b)(ii).

- (2) Subclause (1) applies for the period of 12 months commencing on, and including, the commencement day.
- (3) For the purposes of this clause, leave granted before the commencement day corresponds to leave that may be granted under Part 7 if it is substantially similar to that leave.

Sch. 3 cl. 3(4) inserted by No. 7/2002 s. 33(1).

- (4) Sections 53 and 54, as in force immediately before the commencement of sections 24 and 25 of the **Forensic Health Legislation (Amendment) Act 2002**, continue to apply in relation to any limited off-ground leave granted before that commencement, until the expiry of that leave.

4 Revocation of supervision order

- (1) Despite anything to the contrary in Part 5, an existing detainee who has been, or is deemed to have been, on extended leave for a period of at least 12 months may apply to the court that made the original order under which he or she was detained for revocation of his or her supervision order.
- (2) On an application under subclause (1) the court may revoke the supervision order if satisfied on the evidence available that the safety of the existing detainee or members of the public will not be seriously endangered as a result of the revocation of the order.
- (3) In considering an application for revocation of a supervision order in respect of an existing detainee the court may take into account any reports on the existing detainee made by, or submitted to, the Adult Parole Board before the commencement day.

5 Persons released under section 498 of Crimes Act 1958

Despite the repeal of section 498 of the **Crimes Act 1958**, any conditions imposed on a person under that section that were in force immediately before the commencement day continue to apply on and after the commencement day.

6 Unfitness to stand trial

- (1) Part 2 applies with respect to an offence that is alleged to have been committed, whether before, on or after the commencement day.
- (2) If a person has been found unfit to stand trial but no order has been made in respect of the person before the commencement day, the court must proceed to hold a special hearing under Part 3 in respect of the person.

7 Mental impairment and insanity

- (1) Despite section 25, the defence of insanity continues to apply with respect to any offence alleged to have been committed before the commencement day.
- (2) If a jury returns a verdict of not guilty on account of insanity in relation to a person charged with an offence alleged to have been committed before the commencement day, that verdict is to be taken for all purposes to be a finding of not guilty because of mental impairment under Part 4.

Sch. 3 cl. 8 inserted by No. 7/2002 s. 33(2).

8 Periodic major reviews

Section 35, as amended by section 14 of the **Forensic Health Legislation (Amendment) Act 2002**, applies to a supervision order made before, on or after the commencement of that section 14.

Sch. 3 cl. 9 inserted by No. 7/2002 s. 33(2).

9 Notification requirements

Sections 38A, 38B, 38C and 38E, as inserted by section 17 of the **Forensic Health Legislation (Amendment) Act 2002**, apply to—

- (a) applications that are made after the commencement of that section 17; and
- (b) reviews that are listed by the court after the commencement of that section 17.

Sch. 3 cl. 10 inserted by No. 7/2002 s. 33(2).

10 Appeals

- (1) An order for unconditional release can be appealed under section 19A or 24A (as the case may be) whether the order was made before or after the commencement of that section, unless—
 - (a) the order had been appealed before that commencement; or
 - (b) any time limit for appealing the order had expired before that commencement.
- (2) A supervision order can be appealed under section 28A whether the order was made before or after the commencement of that section, unless—
 - (a) the order had been appealed before that commencement; or
 - (b) any time limit for appealing the order had expired before that commencement.
- (3) An order confirming, varying or revoking a supervision order can be appealed under section 34 (as substituted by section 13 of the **Forensic Health Legislation (Amendment) Act 2002**) or section 34A (as the case may be) whether the order was made before or after the commencement of that section, unless—

- (a) the order had been appealed before that commencement; or
- (b) any time limit for appealing the order had expired before that commencement.
- (4) A refusal to grant extended leave or a grant of extended leave can be appealed under section 57B whether the refusal or grant was made before or after the commencement of that section.
- (5) A revocation of extended leave or a refusal to revoke extended leave can be appealed under section 58A whether the revocation or refusal was made before or after the commencement of that section.
- (6) Any appeal referred to in subclause (1)(a), (2)(a) or (3)(a) that has not been determined before the commencement referred to in that subclause is to be determined in accordance with this Act as in force immediately before that commencement.

Sch. 3 cl. 11 inserted by No. 68/2009 s. 97(Sch. item 39.52).

11 Transitional provisions—Criminal Procedure Act 2009

- (1) Section 14A as inserted by section 423 of the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009** applies to a finding on an investigation under Part 2 that an accused is unfit to stand trial made on or after the commencement of section 423 of that Act.
- (2) Section 24AA as inserted by section 424 of the **Criminal Procedure Act 2009** applies to a verdict of not guilty because of mental impairment recorded on or after the commencement of section 424 of that Act.

Sch. 3 cl. 12 inserted by No. 68/2009 s. 97(Sch. item 39.52).

**12 Transitional provisions—Criminal Procedure
Amendment (Consequential and Transitional
Provisions) Act 2009**

- (1) Section 19A as amended by item 39.17 of the Schedule to the **Criminal Procedure Amendment (Consequential and Transitional Provisions) Act 2009** applies to an appeal under that section where the order to which the appeal relates is made on or after the commencement of that item.
- (2) Section 24A as amended by item 39.24 of the Schedule to the **Criminal Procedure Amendment (Consequential and Transitional Provisions) Act 2009** applies to an appeal under that section where the order to which the appeal relates is made on or after the commencement of that item.
- (3) Section 28A as amended by item 39.25 of the Schedule to the **Criminal Procedure Amendment (Consequential and Transitional Provisions) Act 2009** applies to an appeal under that section where the order to which the appeal relates is made on or after the commencement of that item.
- (4) Section 34 as amended by item 39.28 of the Schedule to the **Criminal Procedure Amendment (Consequential and Transitional Provisions) Act 2009** applies to an appeal under that section where the order to which the appeal relates is made on or after the commencement of that item.
- (5) Section 34A as amended by item 39.31 of the Schedule to the **Criminal Procedure Amendment (Consequential and Transitional Provisions) Act 2009** applies to an appeal against

the revocation of a non-custodial supervision order where the order revoking the supervision order is made on or after the commencement of that item.

- (6) Section 57B as amended by item 39.38 of the Schedule to the **Criminal Procedure Amendment (Consequential and Transitional Provisions) Act 2009** applies to an appeal under that section where the application for extended leave is refused or granted, as the case may be, on or after the commencement of that item.
- (7) Section 58A as amended by item 39.40 of the Schedule to the **Criminal Procedure Amendment (Consequential and Transitional Provisions) Act 2009** applies to an appeal under that section where the extended leave is revoked or the application for revocation of extended leave is refused, as the case may be, on or after the commencement of that item.
- (8) Section 73H as amended by item 39.44 of the Schedule to the **Criminal Procedure Amendment (Consequential and Transitional Provisions) Act 2009** applies to an appeal under that section where the order to which the appeal relates is made on or after the commencement of that item.
- (9) Section 73N as amended by item 39.46 of the Schedule to the **Criminal Procedure Amendment (Consequential and Transitional Provisions) Act 2009** applies to an appeal under that section where the order to which the appeal relates is made on or after the commencement of that item.

Sch. 3 cl. 13 (Heading) amended by No. 29/2011 s. 3(Sch. 1 item 23).

Sch. 3 cl. 13 inserted by No. 29/2010 s. 36.

13 Transitional provision—Health and Human Services Legislation Amendment Act 2010

Any act matter or thing of a continuing nature that was done by or in relation to, or any proceeding brought by or against, the Secretary to the Department of Human Services before the commencement of Division 1 of Part 5 of the **Health and Human Services Legislation Amendment Act 2010** is to be taken to be done by or in relation to, and may be brought by or against, the Secretary to the Department of Health after that commencement if the act matter or thing or proceeding relates to—

- (a) a forensic patient; or
- (b) an approved mental health service.

Sch. 3 cl. 15 inserted by No. 55/2014 s. 131.

15 Transitional provision—Criminal Organisations Control and Other Acts Amendment Act 2014

This Act as amended by Division 1 of Part 5 of the **Criminal Organisations Control and Other Acts Amendment Act 2014** applies to—

- (a) a proceeding for an offence that is commenced on or after the commencement of Division 1 of Part 5 of that Act; and
- (b) a proceeding for an offence that, on the commencement of Division 1 of Part 5 of that Act, is before the Children's Court, irrespective of when the proceeding was commenced.

Sch. 3 cl. 16 inserted by No. 6/2017 s. 12.

16 Transitional provision—Crimes Legislation Further Amendment Act 2017

This Act as amended by Part 3 of the **Crimes Legislation Further Amendment Act 2017** applies to an investigation into the fitness of an accused to stand trial that commences on or after the day on which that Part comes into operation.

Sch. 3 cl. 16A inserted by No. 11/2020 s. 31.

16A Transitional provision—COVID-19 Omnibus (Emergency Measures) Act 2020—investigations into fitness to stand trial

- (1) Despite the repeal of Part 11, an investigation into the fitness of an accused—
 - (a) that, immediately before that repeal, was being conducted by the court, without a jury, in accordance with that Part; and
 - (b) in which the court had not yet made a finding—is to continue, after that repeal, to be conducted by the court, without a jury, in accordance with that Part.
- (2) For the purposes of an investigation that continues in accordance with subsection (1), Part 11 continues to have effect despite its repeal.
- (3) After the conclusion of an investigation that was continued in accordance with subsection (1), sections 95, 96, 97 and 98 continue to apply in relation to that investigation despite their repeal.
- (4) Subject to this section, on and after the repeal of Part 11, a finding of a court, on an investigation conducted in accordance with that Part, that an accused was or was not fit to stand trial has, for all purposes, the same effect as a finding of a jury.

Sch. 3 cl. 16B inserted by No. 11/2020 s. 31.

**16B Transitional provision—COVID-19 Omnibus
(Emergency Measures) Act 2020—special hearings**

- (1) Despite the repeal of Part 11, a special hearing by judge alone in which judgment was not delivered before that repeal may continue to be held by judge alone, without a jury, after that repeal.
- (2) For the purposes of a special hearing that continues in accordance with subsection (1), Part 11 continues to have effect despite its repeal.
- (3) On and after the repeal of section 103, a finding of a judge at a special hearing by judge alone has, for all purposes, the same effect as a finding of a jury.
- (4) Subsection (3) has effect despite the repeal of section 103.
- (5) In this section—
special hearing by judge alone means a special hearing held in accordance with an order under section 101 as in force immediately before its repeal.

Sch. 3 cl. 16C inserted by No. 11/2020 s. 31.

**16C Transitional provision—COVID-19 Omnibus
(Emergency Measures) Act 2020—special hearings**

On and after the repeal of section 121, that section continues to apply, despite its repeal, in relation to any issue, application or review that a court—

- (a) has determined to decide or determine entirely on the basis of written submissions and without the appearance of the parties;
and
- (b) has not yet so decided or determined.

Sch. 3 cl. 16D inserted by No. 11/2022 s. 7.

**16D Transitional provision—Justice Legislation
Amendment (Trial by Judge Alone and Other
Matters) Act 2022**

- (1) If an application for an order under section 94 is made before the repeal of Part 11, and is not determined before that repeal, then despite that repeal—
 - (a) the application may be heard and determined as if Part 11 had not been repealed; and
 - (b) for the purposes of the application, and any order made on the application, and any special hearing to which that order relates, Part 11 as in force immediately before its repeal continues to have effect.
- (2) If, immediately before the repeal of Part 11, there was in force an order under section 94 and judgment had not yet been delivered in the special hearing to which that order relates, then despite that repeal—
 - (a) the order continues to have effect as if Part 11 had not been repealed; and
 - (b) for the purposes of the order and the special hearing to which it relates, Part 11 as in force immediately before its repeal continues to have effect.
- (3) Subsection (2) applies in relation to an order whether or not the special hearing to which the order relates commenced before the repeal of Part 11.
- (4) On and after the repeal of section 96, a finding of a judge at a special hearing by judge alone has, for all purposes, the same effect as a finding of a jury.
- (5) Subsection (4) has effect despite the repeal of section 96.

(6) Nothing in this section limits section 14 of the
Interpretation of Legislation Act 1984.

(7) In this section—

special hearing by judge alone means a special
hearing held in accordance with an order
under section 94 as in force before its repeal.

²⁸ Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (12) (Heading and ss 390–396) amended by Nos 6884 s. 2(1), 7705 s. 10, 7994 s. 2, 8338 s. 7(j), 9576 ss 5, 11(1), 9848 s. 18(1), 10026 ss 5, 6, 10084 s. 6(3), 10233 s. 9(d), 102/1986 s. 8(a)(b), 19/1989 s. 16(Sch. item 16.5), 25/1989 s. 19(c)(d), 56/1989 s. 286(Sch. 2 item 7.2), 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. items 42.30, 42.31) (as amended by No. 34/1990 s. 5(Sch. 4 item 23)), 35/1996 s. 453(Sch. 1 items 16.4, 16.5), 48/1997 s. 57, 65/1997 s. 82(2)(a), 45/2001 s. 40(2), 50/2006 s. 9, repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

²⁹ Ss 406–408A:

S. 406 repealed by No. 9576 s. 11(1).

S. 407 repealed by No. 25/1989 s. 9.

S. 408 amended by Nos 6886 s. 3, 7184 s. 5, 7327 s. 3(a)(b), 7696 s. 2, repealed by No. 8143 s. 11.

S. 408A inserted by No. 6806 s. 2, amended by Nos 7327 s. 3(a)–(d), 7546 s. 10(1)(2), 7645 s. 6, 7696 s. 3, 7782 ss 2, 3, repealed by No. 8143 s. 11.

³⁰ S. 420 (*repealed*): See note 26.

³¹ Pt 3 Div. 1 Subdiv. (25) (Heading and ss 446–450) amended by Nos 7705 s. 10, 8338 s. 7(c), 9008 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 2(h)(j)), 9242 s. 2, 9576 s. 11(1), 9848 s. 18(1), 110/1986 s. 140(2), 51/1989 s. 143(c)–(e), 60/1993 s. 28, 109/1994 s. 25, 35/1996 s. 453(Sch. 1 item 16.14), 78/2008 s. 25(2), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(2)(a) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

³² S. 464S: The amendments proposed by section 118(Sch. 1 items 15.2–15.6, 15.8) to the **Medical Practice Act 1994**, No. 23/1994 (*repealed*) are not included in this publication because section 464S had been substituted before the proposed amendments came into operation.

³³ S. 464T(1)(c): See note 31.

³⁴ S. 464U(5): See note 31.

³⁵ S. 464V(6)(d): See note 31.

³⁶ S. 464X(1): See note 31.

³⁷ S. 464ZE: See note 31.

³⁸ S. 466: See **Dangerous Goods Act 1985**, No. 10189/1985.

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³⁹ Ss 472–476A:

S. 472 repealed by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(b), new s. 472 inserted by No. 9576 s. 8(b), amended by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4), repealed by No. 70/1987 s. 6.

S. 473 substituted by No. 6884 s. 2(3), amended by No. 7651 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 3), repealed by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(b).

Ss 474, 475 repealed by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(b).

S. 476 amended by Nos 8338 s. 7(a), 8426 s. 9(1) (as amended by No. 8701 s. 7(f)), 8870 s. 7(a), 9554 s. 47(a)(b), 9945 s. 3(3)(Sch. 2 item 9), substituted by No. 10084 s. 8(1), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

S. 476A inserted by No. 6651 s. 57(a), repealed by No. 10084 s. 8(2).

⁴⁰ Ss 477–479:

S. 477 amended by Nos 6731 s. 5, 8338 s. 7(a)(b), repealed by No. 9554 s. 2(1)(Sch. 1 item 7).

S. 478 amended by Nos 8280 s. 16, 9576 ss 8(c), 11(1), 9945 s. 3(3)(Sch. 2 item 10), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

S. 479 amended by No. 7705 s. 10, repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

⁴¹ Ss 480–484:

Ss 480, 481 amended by No. 8181 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 31), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

Ss 482, 483 amended by No. 10087 s. 3(1)(Sch. 1 item 27), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

S. 484 amended by Nos 9554 s. 2(1)(Sch. 1 item 8), 9945 s. 3(3)(Sch. 2 item 11), 10152 s. 9(b)(i)(ii), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

⁴² Ss 485–492:

S. 485 amended by No. 8338 s. 7(b), repealed by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(b).

Ss 486, 487 amended by No. 8338 s. 7(a)(c), repealed by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(b).

S. 488 amended by No. 8338 s. 7(a)(c)(l), repealed by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(b).

Ss 489, 490 amended by No. 8338 s. 7(a), repealed by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(b).

S. 491 repealed by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(b).

S. 492 amended by No. 8338 s. 7(a), repealed by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(b).

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⁴³ Ss 495–497:

S. 495 repealed by No. 9945 s. 3(3)(Sch. 2 item 13).

S. 496 repealed by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(b).

S. 497 amended by No. 8280 s. 17, repealed by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(b).

⁴⁴ S. 498 (*repealed*): See note 26.

⁴⁵ Ss 499–502:

S. 499 substituted by No. 6884 s. 3, amended by Nos 9498 s. 3, 16/1986 s. 30, repealed by No. 117/1986 s. 6(Sch. 1 item 2(4)).

S. 500 amended by Nos 8493 s. 33(c), 9549 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 51), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

S. 501 repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

S. 502 amended by Nos 7876 s. 2(3), 8493 s. 33(d), 8731 s. 173, 10087 s. 3(1)(Sch. 1 item 29), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

⁴⁶ Ss 508, 509:

S. 508 amended by Nos 7263 s. 2(c)(i)–(iv), 7705 s. 10, 7876 s. 2(3), 9059 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 11), 9966 s. 21(3)(a)–(f), 10087 s. 3(Sch. 1 item 30), 10152 s. 9(c), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

S. 509 amended by No. 10152 s. 9(d), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

⁴⁷ Ss 510–515A:

S. 510 amended by Nos 7577 s. 6, 7705 s. 10, 7876 s. 2(3), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

S. 511 amended by No. 9966 s. 21(4), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

S. 512 amended by Nos 7263 s. 2(d), 7876 s. 2(3), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

S. 513 amended by Nos 7263 s. 2(e), 9966 s. 21(4)(5), 10152 s. 9(e), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

S. 514 repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

S. 515 amended by No. 9966 s. 21(4), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

S. 515A inserted by No. 10152 s. 9(f), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

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⁴⁸ Ss 516–519A:

S. 516 amended by Nos 7184 s. 8, 7705 s. 10, 7876 s. 2(3), 9554 s. 2(2)(Sch. 2 item 62), 9848 s. 18(1), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

S. 517 amended by Nos 7184 s. 8, 7705 s. 10, 7876 s. 2(3), 8181 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 35), 9848 s. 18(1), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

S. 518 amended by No. 7705 s. 10, repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

S. 519 amended by Nos 8731 s. 173, 9019 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 46), 9059 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 12), 10087 s. 3(1)(Sch. 1 item 30), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

S. 519A inserted by No. 7184 s. 9, repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5).

⁴⁹ Ss 543–544:

S. 543 amended by Nos 9576 s. 11(1), 9902 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 56), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

S. 543A inserted by No. 9407 s. 2(h), amended by No. 9576 s. 11(1), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

S. 544 amended by No. 8679 s. 3(1)(d), substituted by No. 9576 s. 11(1), repealed by No. 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 4).

⁵⁰ S. 547: As to trust property vested in any person who becomes a "convict", see section 72 of the **Trustee Act 1958**, No. 6401/1958.

⁵¹ Pt 6 (Headings and ss 566–584) amended by Nos 7184 s. 12, 7546 s. 12, 7705 s. 10, 7919 s. 2(1), 8063 s. 2, 8280 ss 19, 20, 8338 s. 7(a)(p), 8425 s. 2(1)(n), 8679 s. 3(1)(g), 8870 s. 8, 9019 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 47), 9242 s. 4, 9576 s. 11(1), 9848 s. 18(1), 10026 s. 8, 10084 ss 11–14, 10260 s. 114(Sch. 4 item 5), 110/1986 s. 140(2), 16/1987 s. 4(3)(Sch. 1 item 8(d)), 19/1989 s. 16(Sch. item 16.13), 25/1989 ss 17(1)(4), 20(o), 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. items 42.70–42.74), 49/1991 s. 119(7)(Sch. 4 item 4.3), 109/1994 ss 26–28, 35/1996 s. 453(Sch. 1 items 16.18, 16.19), 48/1997 s. 59, 65/1997 s. 82(3)(4)(a)–(d), 69/1997 s. 24, 10/1999 s. 18(4), 56/2004 s. 79, 65/2004 s. 4(1), 93/2005 s. 9, 48/2006 s. 42(Sch. item 9.7), 50/2006 s. 10, 78/2008 s. 25(4), repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(4) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

⁵² Sch. 6 amended by S.R. No. 144/1965 Order 7 (as amended by S.R. No. 75/1987 cl. 5), Nos 7705 s. 10, 8181 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 32), S.R. No. 372/1973 reg. 2, 8425 s. 2(1)(o), 9019 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 48), 9228 s. 2(1)(k), 9427 s. 6(1)(Sch. 5 item 42), 9576 s. 11(1), 9848 s. 18(1), 9921 s. 255, 10233 s. 9(e)–(g), 25/1989 ss 18(2), 20(p), 44/1989 s. 41(Sch. 2

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item 7), 57/1989 s. 3(Sch. item 42.77), 8/1991 s. 6(e), 48/1995 s. 11(3)(b), 35/1996 s. 453(Sch. 1 item 16.20), 104/1997 s. 42, repealed by No. 7/2009 s. 422(7) (as amended by No. 68/2009 s. 54(h)).

⁵³ Schs 8A–11:

Sch. 8A inserted by No. 7184 s. 13, amended by No. 8338 s. 7(a)(d), repealed by No. 10152 s. 9(g).

Sch. 9 amended by No. 8338 s. 7(a), repealed by No. 9059 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 13).

Sch. 10 amended by No. 8338 s. 7(o), repealed by No. 9059 s. 2(1)(Sch. item 13).

Sch. 11 amended by No. 7705 s. 10, repealed by No. 8493 s. 33(f).